A Categorical Theory of Agency from True-Concurrent Games

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Abstract

Agency involves control over possible actions, information on which to act, criteria for comparing alternatives, and institutions that permit or enable execution. A compositional theory must explain how these structures interact when agents are combined, delegated, informed, or continued after a history. We construct such a categorical theory for pure policies and qualitative information, with true-concurrent strategies providing its operational semantics.

The construction gives each owner a space of complete contingent policies and assigns each joint policy a concurrent realization. A dependent linear–nonlinear completion represents these agents as first-class linear objects with displayed ownership. The representation respects composition, compact wiring, and ownerwise policy substitution. From it we construct controlled alternatives, observation-based legal choice, contextual equilibrium, witnessed institutional action, and continuing agency. Finite causal protocols identify owner policies with complete multiplayer strategies and implement the communication on which epistemic change depends.

The principal comparisons determine what survives between these descriptions. They relate complete policies to delivered messages, local execution witnesses to secured interaction, and retained agent structure to exact abstractions. In particular, locally permitted choices can fail joint legality, and hiding execution events can lose alternatives needed for modal reasoning. Further local-to-global constructions give an affine obstruction to decentralized decisions, an exact and approximate integration theory for unilateral gains, and certificates for failure of robust coalitional solvability.

Soundness, reconstruction, classifying-model completeness, and finite behavioural characterization establish the scope of the resulting calculus. Together, the constructions connect what an owner can choose, know, and achieve to the concurrent interactions that realize its agency.

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Introduction

We develop a categorical theory of agency: a compositional account of agents, their controlled alternatives, and the interactions that realize their choices. The account includes the information available for a decision, the comparison of its alternatives, and the institutional conditions under which it can be executed. These structures change when agents are composed, when a group acts through a common controller, or when an institution grants permission for a later action. The questions arise together: an available action may be forbidden, a legal choice may depend on unavailable information, and a successful exchange may leave an owner with different possibilities for the future. The constructions below make these distinctions explicit and establish their relationships.

The compositional problem is to retain the right data at an interface. A realized action alone does not determine who could have changed it. An outcome alone does not record the communication that made a decision possible. Nor does knowledge that an authorization exists provide the certificate needed to execute it. When a system is assembled from components, each of these structures must have a specified composition law and a comparison with the resulting execution. Category theory supplies the means to formulate that requirement: interfaces are objects, interactions compose, and universal constructions derive the associated alternatives, predicates, and witnesses.

Compositional game theory already makes strategic interaction compositional, including equilibrium and off-equilibrium comparisons (Ghani et al., 2018). Open games with agency retain complete choices by named players, and categorical cybernetics organizes their evaluation through selection and backward transport (Capucci et al., 2022b,a). We build on these separations of control, realization, and evaluation. Our operational foundation is the event-structure semantics of Castellan et al. (2017), in which causality and independent activity remain visible. The task undertaken here is to construct a dependent categorical theory over that foundation and prove the comparisons that connect its strategic, epistemic, institutional, and operational descriptions.

The starting datum is an owner-indexed family of complete policies together with a concurrent realization of each joint policy. A complete policy specifies responses at all relevant decision positions, including positions that a particular execution never reaches. One owner may control several positions; changing its policy can change all of them together. We represent the resulting interaction as a linear object that can itself be passed to another process. Ownership remains a displayed index of this object, so composition records both the resources used in an execution and the owner responsible for each policy coordinate.

This representation supplies the organizing construction. Owner-coordinate projections determine controlled alternatives. Observation quotients determine which responses an owner can implement from its information. Restriction to a legal domain and dependent quantification construct informed legal choice. Pulling comparisons back along realization gives best response and equilibrium. Witnessed transitions then describe institutional action and its effect on future possibilities. The theory therefore develops these forms of agency from a common presentation, with each comparison identifying the structure it preserves.

We state the results in four groups. Theorem A establishes the representation and its compatibility with concurrent composition. The compact closed strategy category and the completion methods are established ingredients; the displayed agent representation, its owner-preserving operations, and the reconstruction of secured interaction from local witnesses connect them to the theory of agency developed here.

Theorem A (Concurrent agents and compositional representation)**.** *Receptive courteous strategies on polarized event structures form a compact closed category $\mathcal{C}$ under secured interaction and hiding. Its restricted Yoneda completion $\mathcal{V}$ is symmetric monoidal closed*

and supports the indexed dependent linear–nonlinear structure. For every finite owner list N, ordinary complete-policy family $\vec{\Sigma} = (\Sigma_i)_{i\in N}$ and original arenas A, B, there is a natural bijection

$$\mathcal{V}(I, [\mathsf{Lin}(\prod_i \Sigma_i) \otimes yA, yB]) \cong \mathbf{Set}(\prod_i \Sigma_i, \mathcal{C}(A, B)).$$

Under the displayed ownership signature, this representation preserves sequential and parallel composition, ownerwise reparametrizations, and the realization-preserving 2-cells of the owned-open-arena bicategory. This bicategory has coherent compact object duals; its quotient by invertible 2-cells is compact closed. Transposition and trace preserve the ownerwise complete-policy families. Each owner's complete policies are canonically the states of its own linear policy interface, and joint application recovers the given concurrent realization. For an exhibited secured synchronization, the causally saturated site carries a sheaf of matching histories; its global sections reconstruct the original secured pullback, compatibly with parallel interaction.

The representation becomes a theory of choice once alternatives are indexed by their controllers and evaluated in a state context. Theorem B constructs this structure, including the restrictions imposed by observation and legal permission. It also distinguishes a claim that an action is possible from the execution witness an institution can pass to its successor.

Theorem B (Controlled, situated, and institutional agency)**.** *Owner-coordinate projections determine compositional coalition counterfactuals. Owner regrouping and associative delegation preserve the realized concurrent interaction and admit exact deviation comparisons on the implemented policy image. Predicate feedback along realization constructs canonical selection, best response, and equilibrium. Observation quotients construct admissible policy descent and knowledge; dependent universal images construct observation-uniform legal policies. Witnessed record-changing institutions form a symmetric monoidal bicategory, and their dependent sums and products determine proof-relevant dynamic modalities compatible with sequential execution. Owner evaluation of measured records descends to profile utility exactly when it equalizes the completed-witness kernel pair. Pullback of these values to controlled deviations gives the cost-sensitive equilibrium test. For owner-scope covers, legal-policy descent is exact precisely when the specified local inspections recover the legal domain. Its failure is preserved under delegation onto the implemented image and can alter legal best responses and equilibrium.*

The information used in those choices must also have an operational account. Theorem C implements finite communication, relates complete policies to multiplayer strategies and public messages, and constructs agency after a history. These comparisons preserve alternatives from the particular source under consideration; agreement only on the current outcome would not suffice for reasoning about what an owner could do or know.

Theorem C (Communication, epistemic change, and continuation)**.** *Finite owned causal decision protocols and finite binary sessions admit true-concurrent realizations preserving complete off-path policies. For finite causal decision protocols, the owners are the players of a multiplayer event-structure semantics: complete strategies are canonically their policy spaces, interaction compiles to the original realization, and legal deviations and the designated strategic and epistemic tests are preserved. Their residual operations satisfy subject reduction, and secured interaction is adequate for the completed communication witnesses. Actual delivery records determine epistemic action-event quotients. For complete truthful message policies, evaluation into the truthful public-message model is a split surjection with the designated strategic and epistemic lifting properties. At the completed delivery boundary,*

collective disclosure transports distributed knowledge to the stated common-knowledge and announcement-ability predicates. Complete local policies generate their residual controllers, with the constructed criterion for finite-state implementation; witnessed residual transitions support temporal fixed-point agency and exact visible refinement. On finite public game trees with the displayed round meter, backward decomposition computes each child equilibrium at its inherited charge. For exhibited finite secured protocols, persistent-policy witness sheaves and anchored completed observation records admit exact sourcewise lifting and modal transport of the designated epistemic and strategic alternatives.

Finally, the theory must specify what its representations retain and what a smaller model may forget. Theorem D gives reconstruction and exact comparison results. It separates equational completeness across a class of models from operational separation and modal characterization within the fixed concurrent semantics.

Theorem D (Soundness, recovery, and finite behavioural completeness)**.** *The ordinary, linear, displayed-agent, and contextual judgments of the agency calculus are sound in the completed true-concurrent semantics. The owner-indexed and enriched situated presentations are recovered by the explicit reconstruction maps, while reductions relative to designated tests retain their exhibited alternative-lifting properties. Retaining the measured record recovers both its charge and outcome; retaining the evaluated continuation tests preserves the corresponding subgame-perfect predicates.*

The first-layer equational calculus is complete for its class of split indexed linear–nonlinear models by the syntactic classifying model. In the fixed concurrent completion, original arenas separate open agent morphisms. On image-finite retained frames, the exact bisimulation quotient identifies precisely the states satisfying the same designated Boolean modal tests; on finite frames, characteristic formulas define all bisimulation-invariant predicates. Explicit finite causal-agent interpretations have decidable semantic equality. The structured local witness presentations recover their completed secured histories and retained-image modal predicates by global sections and source-fixed lifts.

Construction-to-theorem guide. The following table locates the constructions and proofs supporting Theorems A–D. It distinguishes the categorical foundations used from the comparisons required for their interpretation as agency.

Claim	Construction and comparison	Proof location
A	Imported secured interaction and Day convolution; constructed $\mathsf{Lin} \dashv \mathsf{Val}$, local secured-witness gluing, and agent representation.	Theorems 1.11, 1.12, 1.17, 1.38, 2.18 and 2.19.
B	Ownerwise deviations, exact legal-policy inspection descent, delegation lifting, and measured institutional witnesses.	Lemma 4.10 and Theorems 5.45, 7.2, 7.7 and 8.8.
C	Finite causal wiring and multiplayer realization; complete-policy witness sheaves, actual delivery, and exact modal transport.	Theorems 8.4, 9.34, 10.5, 10.23, 10.55 and 12.33.
D	Structured reconstruction and first-layer classifying model; original-arena separation and finite modal characterization.	Theorems 14.4, 14.26, 14.32, 14.35 and 14.36.

The comparisons are proved alongside their constructions in Parts I–V. Section 14 assembles reconstruction and exact abstraction. Appendix A records the inference rules, and Appendix B supplies the soundness and classifying-model arguments for the calculus.

Finite economic obstructions. The framework also makes several failures of collective agency precise. Decentralized responses form global sections of a decision-incidence sheaf; in its affine fragment, a first cohomology class is the complete obstruction to implementation (Theorems 7.20 and 7.23). Section 11.7.1 evaluates a binary team task in which one-bit disclosure removes this obstruction, including every equilibrium and the fee threshold for the resulting welfare improvement.

Evaluation yields a second obstruction. On the legal-deviation graph, local potential primitives integrate unilateral gains exactly when their torsor class vanishes. Cycle means determine the best uniform integration error and certify an approximate equilibrium (Theorems 13.8 and 13.14). Common and own-policy charges preserve this class, and whole-owner delegation preserves and reflects its vanishing on implemented policies. Finally, Theorem 7.55 constructs destabilizing integer preferences exactly when a finite blocking-selection certificate exists. This last result belongs to the interaction-array account of coalitional solvability; its relation to ordinary sheaf locality is specified in Remark 7.51.

How to read the construction. The exposition uses three semantic levels. Ordinary policies and their dependent families live in **Set**. Linear interfaces describe the resources used by concurrent execution. Assertions express properties of states and execution witnesses. Thus considering several policies for one device does not consume several copies of that device; running several copies requires the corresponding linear resources. Retaining a witness can additionally identify the event that establishes an assertion.

Ownership, observations, preferences, and permission rules are explicit data of an agent presentation. The theory derives their consequences through projections, images, comprehension, and dependent adjoints. Execution supplies enabled events, causal dependencies, signals, and residual processes. The comparisons between these levels explain when a strategic or epistemic claim is realized by an actual interaction.

Several local presentations will appear, each serving a different purpose. Causal patches localize execution histories; owner scopes localize inspection of legal policies; decision incidences localize decentralized responses; and legal-deviation graphs localize potential primitives. Their separate gluing problems should be kept distinct. They refine the same agent semantics without introducing additional type constructors.

A running finite instance. A two-owner example will test the distinctions between control, information, permission, and execution. Each owner observes a private bit: the world carrier is $W = 2 \times 2$, with observations $o_1(x, y) = x$ and $o_2(x, y) = y$. At separate decision nodes owner 1 applies $\pi_1 : 2 \to 2$ to x and owner 2 applies $\pi_2 : 2 \to 2$ to y. Thus $\Sigma_1 = 2^2$, $\Sigma_2 = 2^2$, and the complete profile carrier has 16 elements, including all off-path responses. The operational realization is the tensor of the two response strategies, with their specified private inputs. An institutional rule can couple the policies: we use the concrete legal domain

$$L = \{(\pi_1, \pi_2) : \pi_1(1) \leq \pi_2(1)\} \hookrightarrow \Sigma_1 \times \Sigma_2,$$

which has 12 elements, using the usual order on $2 = \{0, 1\}$. To compare choices at a given world, start with the exact rational payoffs $u_1(a, b) = 2ab - a$ and $u_2(a, b) = 2ab - b$, where $a = \pi_1(x)$ and $b = \pi_2(y)$. A collector later delivers (x, y) to the agents. A separate checker enforces the permission rule for final execution. Its owner-local policy images jointly contain

all 16 profiles, although only 12 are legal. Secured collection of the off-path policy entries provides the missing joint inspection evidence. Thus identical current actions can arise from profiles with different legal status. The calculations in Sections 11.10 and 11.12 determine profitable deviations, facts made common knowledge by delivery, and the evidence passed to the executor. The example illustrates the theory's comparisons; the construction itself applies to the displayed agent interfaces developed below.

Route through the paper. Part I constructs the concurrent semantic foundation and represents agents as first-class linear objects. Part II develops composition, control, delegation, and evaluation. Part III adds observation, informed legal choice, institutional execution, and epistemic update. Part IV realizes communication and compares complete policies with delivered information. Part V constructs continuations, studies rationality and economic obstructions, and establishes reconstruction and exact abstraction. The appendices present the calculus and its metatheory.

Relation to the literature

Composing controlled and evaluated interaction. Open games provide a symmetric monoidal account of strategic interaction, with equilibrium and off-equilibrium best responses (Ghani et al., 2018). Open games with agency retain complete contingent choices, allow a player to control several decisions, and regroup player coordinates (Capucci et al., 2022b). Categorical cybernetics places these constructions within a wider treatment of parameterization, optics, and selection (Capucci et al., 2022a). These are antecedents of the policy and evaluation interfaces used here. Our contribution at this level is their representation by owned concurrent realizations and the comparison with displayed first-class agent types, including compact wiring, legal alternatives, and measured execution. The contextual treatment of wiring follows Atkey et al. (2021); Hedges (2020); the distinction between an economic owner and operational polarity remains explicit.

Cartesian frames give a calculus for the division of control between agent and environment (Garrabrant, Herrmann, and Lopez-Wild, 2021). Section 4 recovers this division on unrestricted policy products and computes the available alternatives when legality couples the coordinates. Its delegation comparison concerns the policies actually implemented by the subordinate interface. Resource-sensitive action calculi and agency logics already connect action with linear structure (Barber et al., 1998; Porello and Troquard, 2014). Here the agent itself is a linear resource, with ownership retained by the displayed signature during higher-order use.

Realizing agency by concurrent interaction. The category of receptive courteous event-structure strategies and its secured composition are taken from Castellan et al. (2017). Restricted Yoneda, Day convolution, and dependent linear–nonlinear semantics supply the completion methods (Day, 1970; Jacobs, 1999; Vákár, 2015). The paper constructs the resulting agent representation, its owned composition, and local reconstruction of secured witnesses.

There are also established multiplayer interpretations of partial information. Abramsky (2007) uses agent-labelled structures and closure-operator strategies; partial-order Boolean and finite-action games retain responses at player-controlled decision nodes (Bradfield, Gutierrez, and Wooldridge, 2016; Zahoransky et al., 2022). Our finite causal protocol construction identifies these complete response families with the owner policies and compares their interaction with the given concurrent implementation. The comparison retains observation quotients, legal domains, and whole-owner deviations. Information discipline

and non-zero-sum interaction have related treatments in Clairambault, Gutierrez, and Winskel (2013); Gutierrez and Wooldridge (2014). Session calculi relate communication to cut (Caires and Pfenning, 2010); the finite session construction here additionally retains complete endpoint policies and the matched events witnessing delivery.

Connecting information change to delivered evidence. Dynamic epistemic logic supplies public-announcement and action-model semantics (Baltag, Moss, and Solecki, 1998); resource and multi-type accounts make their algebraic interfaces explicit (Baltag, Coecke, and Sadrzadeh, 2007; Frittella et al., 2016). Observation quotients implement the local-state perspective of Halpern and Fagin (1989). Public restriction, general epistemic update, and distributed or common knowledge are therefore established ingredients. We construct their comparison with complete communication policies and actual delivery witnesses. The comparison lifts the designated alternatives from each fixed source, which is what permits transport of the corresponding modal and fixed-point tests. It also distinguishes a fact revealed by pooled information from a formula whose truth must be re-evaluated after the update, as in the study of resolving distributed knowledge (Ågotnes and Wáng, 2016).

Locality, obstruction, and exact comparison. Local-to-global methods already appear in game semantics, decision models, and epistemic tasks (Hirschowitz et al., 2008; Tohmé et al., 2017; Tohmé and Fioriti, 2024; Kishida, 2013; Goubault et al., 2021; Felber et al., 2025). Here the causal site detects the dependencies and finite inconsistencies of secured matching. The owner-scope site instead detects whether local inspections recover the legal policy domain. Its higher abelian sheaf cohomology vanishes (Corollary 7.4), so the economic cohomological obstructions use other sites. Decision incidences retain actual local responses and yield an exact affine obstruction, in relation to section and cohomological treatments of contextuality (Abramsky and Brandenburger, 2011; Abramsky et al., 2012). Legal-deviation graphs connect potential and graph-flow analysis (Candogan et al., 2011) to coupled legality, execution prices, delegation, and a sharp uniform approximation bound.

Interaction sheaves already relate acyclicity to robust coalitional solvability (Abdou and Keiding, 2008, 2009). Our finite blocking-selection argument gives a certificate and constructs destabilizing integer preferences directly on the specified legal domain. The distinct notion of locality used by interaction arrays is retained throughout that comparison. Finally, the Hennessy–Milner theorems provide the precedent for modal separation (Hennessy and Milner, 1980, 1985). The finite characterization here applies to the designated epistemic, deviation, and witnessed-transition tests of the retained agent frame.

These comparisons locate the contribution in the constructed theory and its preservation results. The categorical ingredients give the representation; the legal, operational, and epistemic lifting arguments establish which forms of agency that representation preserves.

Use of AI-assisted tools. Generative AI systems were used during the research and development of this manuscript. Responsibility for the mathematical content, arguments, and conclusions rests with the author.

Part I
Concurrent semantics and first-class agents

1 True-Concurrent Games and Dependent Linear Semantics

We begin with the executions that agents will control. Polarized event structures record causal prerequisites, conflict, and independent events; secured interaction composes them without imposing an order on independent activity. We use the strategy category of Castellan et al. (2017) as the operational foundation.

Two constructions prepare it for agency. Finite response and collection protocols show how ordinary data are carried by concurrent interactions, including the synchronization barriers imposed by collection. Restricted Yoneda and Day convolution then supply the dependent linear interfaces needed to treat a policy-parameterized interaction as an object. Full faithfulness preserves the original meaning of arrows between arenas.

1.1 Operational event structures and concurrent interaction

1.1.1 Concurrent histories

Definition 1.1 (Event structures and configurations)**.** An **event** is one occurrence of an action or communication, so two occurrences of the same kind of action remain distinct events. **True concurrency** records prerequisites and compatibility directly, without first choosing a total schedule for independent events. In the formal data below, a down-closed set contains every prerequisite of each of its events. An event is **enabled** after a configuration x when $e \notin x$ and $x \cup \{e\}$ is again a configuration. Two distinct events are concurrent when they can occur together and neither causally precedes the other; incompatible collections are in conflict. The consistency family also records incompatibilities involving more than two events.

An **event structure** is a triple $E = (|E|, \leq_E, \mathrm{Con}_E)$. The relation $\leq_E$ is a partial order with finite principal downsets. The family Con_E consists of finite subsets of $|E|$, contains the empty set and every singleton, is closed under subsets, and satisfies

$$X \in \mathrm{Con}_E, \quad e \leq_E e' \in X \quad \Longrightarrow \quad X \cup \{e\} \in \mathrm{Con}_E\,.$$

A finite **configuration** is a down-closed consistent subset. Write $\mathrm{Conf}(E)$ for the set of finite configurations.

We use configurations as histories, retaining their partial order through interaction and composition.

Construction 1.2 (Enabled-event span)**.**

(1) **Enabled extensions.** For an event structure E put $W_E = \mathrm{Conf}(E)$ and define

$$\mathsf{Step}(E) = \{(x, e) \in W_E \times |E| : e \notin x,\ x \cup \{e\} \in W_E\}.$$

It has projections $p(x, e) = x$ and $\ell(x, e) = e$, and a target $t(x, e) = x \cup \{e\}$.

(2) **Source and target.** Thus

$$W_E \xleftarrow{p} \mathsf{Step}(E) \xrightarrow{t} W_E$$

is a relation span: (p, t) is jointly injective, since $e = t(x, e) \setminus x$ is determined by its two endpoints. The inclusion $\mathsf{Step}(E) \hookrightarrow W_E \times |E|$ is the comprehension of the event-enablement predicate.

(3) **Execution in a configuration.** Every event of a finite configuration can be executed in some linear extension of that configuration's causal order, but the span does not choose a linear extension.

The incidence inclusion and source projection give the enabled-event diagram.

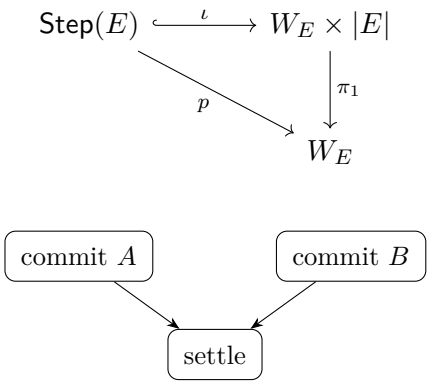


Figure 1: Causal dependence without a scheduler-imposed order.

Definition 1.3 (Total event-structure map)**.** For event structures E, F, a **total map of event structures** is a function $f : |E| \to |F|$ satisfying, for every finite configuration $x \in \mathrm{Conf}(E)$,

$$f[x] \in \mathrm{Conf}(F), \qquad f|_x : x \longrightarrow f[x] \text{ is injective.}$$

It thus preserves configurations and is locally injective. It need not preserve every source causal order as an order relation between event labels: a strategy may add dependencies specifying when it responds.

Definition 1.4 (Polarized arenas)**.** The polarity is relative to an interaction boundary: negative events are moves the surrounding interaction may supply, and positive events are moves the strategy may make. Reversing an interface reverses these roles. Economic ownership is recorded by the separate owner-indexed policy signature. For example, several players' chosen messages can all be positive outputs of separate components, while becoming negative inputs of the component that receives them.

An **arena** is an event structure with a polarity $\mathrm{pol} : |A| \to \{-, +\}$. Its dual $A^{\perp}$ reverses polarities. The parallel arena $A \parallel B$ is the disjoint union, with componentwise causality and consistency. The empty arena is denoted I.

1.1.2 Strategies and their composition

An output and an input at a shared interface can synchronize only if their combined prerequisites admit a causal order. The synchronization pullback records the secured history for each match. Two matches with identical visible labels may therefore remain distinct when their histories are incompatible.

We use the secured-bijection pullback of Castellan et al. (2017). Its universal property supplies the synchronization object subsequently used in interaction and hiding.

Definition 1.5 (Secured matching)**.** Let $f : S \to A$ and $g : T \to A$ be total maps of unpolarized event structures. A matching is a finite graph $\varphi \subseteq |S| \times |T|$ whose projections

are configurations, which is the graph of a bijection between those configurations, and for which $f(s) = g(t)$ whenever $(s,t) \in \varphi$. Order its pairs by the transitive closure of

$$(s,t) \trianglelefteq (s',t') \quad \text{if} \quad s \leq_S s' \text{ or } t \leq_T t'.$$

The matching is secured when this closure is antisymmetric. It is prime when this finite partial order has a greatest pair. Write $\mathcal{M}(f,g)$ and $\mathcal{M}_\bullet(f,g)$ for the secured and prime secured matchings.

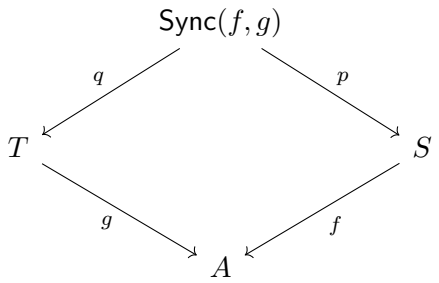
Construction 1.6 (Synchronization object)**.**

(1) **Events and order.** The events of $\mathsf{Sync}(f,g)$ are $\mathcal{M}_\bullet(f,g)$, ordered by inclusion.

(2) **Consistency.** A finite set of primes is consistent precisely when its union is a secured matching.

(3) **Projections.** A prime is projected to the coordinates of its greatest pair, giving maps $p : \mathsf{Sync}(f,g) \to S$ and $q : \mathsf{Sync}(f,g) \to T$.

The pullback compares the two occurrences proposed for synchronization by their images at the shared interface.



Theorem 1.7 (Synchronization universal property; recalled)**.** *The construction is an event structure, with a bijection*

$$\mathrm{Conf}(\mathsf{Sync}(f,g)) \cong \mathcal{M}(f,g), \qquad X \longmapsto \bigcup X.$$

The maps p, q exhibit it as the pullback of f, g in the category of event structures and total maps.

Source and identification.

(1) **Secured operational interaction.** This is the secured-bijection pullback theorem of Castellan et al. (2017). In the notation fixed above, a secured matching φ determines the configuration

$$X_\varphi = \{\downarrow_\varphi u : u \in \varphi\}$$

of prime secured matchings, and a configuration X of primes recovers the secured matching $\bigcup X$. These operations are inverse.

(2) **Lifting through the comparison.** The maps p and q take a prime to the coordinates of its greatest pair, and the cited pullback theorem identifies the unique lift of a cone with the prime secured histories generated by its configurations. We use that universal property below; no different synchronization construction is introduced here.

□

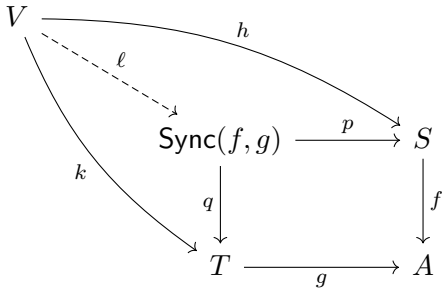


Figure 2: Prime secured histories supply the synchronization pullback.

Locality of secured synchronization. A secured interaction has partially visible causal histories even before hiding. The following site makes those partial histories precise. In contrast with a cover by arbitrary event labels, a cover must expose the causal predecessors and the finite incompatibilities relevant to the synchronization. The resulting descent theorem is specific to secured event-structure pullbacks; it is not a sheafification of the Day completion introduced below. The local-strategy viewpoint of Hirschowitz et al. (2008) motivates this question, while the operational pullback remains the one of Castellan et al. (2017).

Construction 1.8 (Causally saturated site of a synchronization)**.**

(1) **Form the causal patches.** Fix total event-structure maps $f : S \to E$ and $g : T \to E$. Let $\mathcal{O}_{f,g}$ be the poset of subsets $U \subseteq |E|$ satisfying

$$\begin{aligned} e' \leq_E e \in U &\Longrightarrow e' \in U, \\ s' \leq_S s,\ f(s) \in U &\Longrightarrow f(s') \in U, \\ t' \leq_T t,\ g(t) \in U &\Longrightarrow g(t') \in U. \end{aligned}$$

Write $S_U = S|_{f^{-1}U}$, $T_U = T|_{g^{-1}U}$, and $E_U = E|_U$, with inherited order and consistency. The restricted maps $f_U : S_U \to E_U$ and $g_U : T_U \to E_U$ are total event-structure maps.

(2) **Detect finite incompatibility.** A finite subset $F \subseteq |S_U|$ is *minimally inconsistent* when $F \notin \mathrm{Con}_{S_U}$ and every proper subset belongs to Con_{S_U}. Use the analogous definition in T_U.

(3) **Specify covers.** A covering family of U is a *nonempty finite* family $(U_j \subseteq U)_{j \in J}$ of saturated patches such that $U = \bigcup_j U_j$ and every minimally inconsistent finite set F in S_U, respectively T_U, has its whole label set $f[F]$, respectively $g[F]$, contained in one U_j. At $U = \varnothing$ the identity family is a cover; the empty family is not declared covering.

Lemma 1.9 (Pretopology and valid restrictions)**.** *The covering families of Construction 1.8 form a Grothendieck pretopology. Restriction of a secured matching to a saturated patch is a secured matching, and restrictions compose strictly.*

Proof.

(1) **Restriction of maps and configurations.** The inverse images of U in S, T are downward closed by saturation. Therefore every configuration of S_U or T_U is a configuration of the original structure. Configuration preservation and local injectivity of f_U, g_U follow from those of f, g. Intersecting a matching graph with pairs whose common label lies in U keeps downward-closed configurations; the induced secured order is a restriction of the original acyclic order.

(2) **Identity and base change.** The identity cover detects every minimal inconsistency. If $V \subseteq U$ is saturated and (U_j) covers U, then $(V \cap U_j)$ covers V: a minimally inconsistent set in S_V or T_V is also minimally inconsistent in S_U or T_U, so the covering member that contains its labels continues to do so upon intersection with V.

(3) **Transitivity.** If each U_j is covered by (U_{jk}), a minimal inconsistent set over U first has all its labels in some U_j, where it remains minimally inconsistent; it then has all its labels in some U_{jk}. The composite finite family covers the underlying events. All families remain nonempty, including at the empty patch. Intersection of restrictions is strict.

□

Construction 1.10 (The secured-matching sheaf)**.**

(1) **Assign local matchings.** Define

$$\mathscr{M}_{f,g}(U) = \mathcal{M}(f_U, g_U).$$

For $V \subseteq U$ saturated, restrict a matching φ to $\varphi|_V = \{(s,t) \in \varphi : f(s) = g(t) \in V\}$.

(2) **Retain the empty history.** There is a unique matching on the empty patch, and its restriction is the empty graph. This records the absence of matched events, not an arbitrary choice of a linear schedule.

Theorem 1.11 (Sheaf descent for secured matchings)**.** *For every covering family $(U_j)_{j\in J}$ of U, restriction gives a natural bijection*

$$\mathscr{M}_{f,g}(U) \;\cong\; \mathrm{Eq}\left(\prod_j \mathscr{M}_{f,g}(U_j) \rightrightarrows \prod_{j,k} \mathscr{M}_{f,g}(U_j \cap U_k)\right). \tag{1.1}$$

In particular $\mathscr{M}_{f,g}$ is a sheaf for the displayed Grothendieck pretopology.

Proof.

(1) **Amalgamate a matching family.** For compatible secured matchings (φ_j) set $\varphi = \bigcup_j \varphi_j$. This graph is finite. If the same s were paired with different t, t', the common label $f(s) = g(t) = g(t')$ belongs to the intersection of their patches, and compatibility there forces $t = t'$. The analogous argument proves injectivity of the other projection. Thus φ is the graph of a bijection and $\varphi|_{U_j} = \varphi_j$.

(2) **Recover causal closure.** A predecessor $s' \leq_S s$ of any s appearing in φ_j has its label in U_j by saturation, and belongs to the configuration projected from φ_j. The union's source projection is therefore downward closed. Likewise for the target projection.

(3) **Recover finite consistency.** If the finite source projection were inconsistent, it would contain a minimally inconsistent finite subset F. Some patch U_j contains all of $f[F]$, so $F \subseteq \mathrm{pr}_S(\varphi_j)$, contradicting consistency. The argument for the target projection is identical. Both projections are thus configurations.

(4) **Recover securedness.** A cycle in the transitive closure of the combined source and target causal orders on φ has a finite cycle of matched pairs. Choose a patch containing one pair. Along each causal edge, saturation forces the preceding pair into any patch containing the succeeding pair. Traversing the cycle backwards puts all its pairs in the chosen patch. This contradicts the securedness of φ_j. Hence the global matching is secured.

(5) **Prove uniqueness and naturality.** Every pair in any global amalgamation is supported in a covering patch, where its value is prescribed. Its graph must be $\bigcup_j \varphi_j$. Union and restriction are inverse. Passing to a smaller saturated patch commutes with both constructions, proving naturality.

□

The sheaf equalizer records agreement on all pairwise causal overlaps.

$$\mathscr{M}_{f,g}(U) \xhookrightarrow{\text{res}} \prod_j \mathscr{M}_{f,g}(U_j) \underset{r_2}{\overset{r_1}{\rightrightarrows}} \prod_{j,k} \mathscr{M}_{f,g}(U_j \cap U_k)$$

Theorem 1.12 (Reconstruction of secured interaction)**.** *For the synchronization pullback $P = \mathsf{Sync}(f, g)$ of Theorem 1.7,*

$$\Gamma(\mathscr{M}_{f,g}) \cong \mathcal{M}(f, g) \cong \mathrm{Conf}(P). \tag{1.2}$$

The same sections recover the prime events, order, and consistency:

$$|P| = \mathcal{M}_\bullet(f, g), \qquad p \leq_P q \iff p \subseteq q, \qquad \{p_1, \ldots, p_n\} \in \mathrm{Con}_P \iff \bigcup_j p_j \in \mathcal{M}(f, g).$$

For parallel pairs of matching maps, restriction to componentwise patches satisfies the natural product comparison

$$\mathscr{M}_{f\|f',g\|g'}(U \sqcup U') \cong \mathscr{M}_{f,g}(U) \times \mathscr{M}_{f',g'}(U').$$

Proof.

(1) **Recover global sections.** The full carrier $|E|$ is terminal in the site. A natural section is determined by its value there and its restrictions, giving the first bijection. The second is the secured-pullback correspondence in Theorem 1.7. Prime secured matchings are the principal histories generated by greatest pairs, with the displayed order and finite-consistency test. Thus reconstruction retains the actual event structure, not just a set of linear extensions.

(2) **Prove the product comparison.** No matched pair in a disjoint-union interface can cross between its two summands. A matching splits uniquely into one matching in each summand; source and target configurations and the absence of causal cycles are componentwise. Disjoint union is the inverse. Intersections and restrictions of componentwise patches commute with this bijection.

(3) **Recover composition.** In the manuscript's sequential interaction, apply the theorem to the augmented maps into $A^\perp \parallel B \parallel C$, then apply the existing hiding operation to the reconstructed secured pullback. The result is the original composite, so the already proved associativity, copycat and interchange equations apply unchanged. This claim is about reconstruction of interaction, not a new monoidal closed structure on the sheaf category.

□

Example 1.13 (A concurrent gluing and two failed covers)**.** For the identity maps on the event structure $c < a$, $c < b$ with a, b independent, the patches $\{c, a\}$ and $\{c, b\}$ cover. Their compatible identity matchings glue to the five configurations $\varnothing$, $\{c\}$, $\{c, a\}$, $\{c, b\}$, $\{c, a, b\}$; neither schedule c, a, b nor c, b, a is chosen.

The causal and consistency conditions on covers are essential. If the arena has two independent labels a, b, while one source orders $a < b$ and the other orders $b < a$, the two singleton identity-labelled matchings would glue along an arbitrary label cover to a causal cycle. Those singleton patches are not saturated. If instead a, b are conflicting in both sources with no order, the singleton patches are saturated but their local matchings have an inconsistent union; they fail the minimal-inconsistency covering test. These are counterexamples to the naive label-cover sheaf condition.

Remark 1.14 (Prime events are recovered after gluing). A prime matching need not restrict to a prime matching. For instance, if independent a, b both precede c, the prime history with greatest pair labelled c restricts to the nonprime history $\{a, b\}$ on the saturated patch $\{a, b\}$. Thus the sheaf stores secured matching configurations; its prime events are reconstructed by Theorem 1.12. General presheaves in $\widehat{\mathcal{C}}$ and sheaves on $\mathcal{O}_{f,g}$ serve distinct purposes.

Definition 1.15 (Concurrent strategy)**.** Receptivity requires a unique extension in the strategy for the arrival of each enabled negative event. Courtesy permits the strategy to wait for an input before producing an output, but prevents it from inserting arbitrary new dependencies between moves whose ordering is already controlled by the arena. Here $e \lessdot e'$ means an immediate causal dependency, with no event strictly between them. Thus a protocol may wait for both submitted messages before announcing their joint outcome without imposing an order between the two submissions.

A concurrent strategy from A to B is a polarity-preserving total map

$$s : S \longrightarrow A^{\perp} \parallel B$$

with two conditions. **Receptivity** says that every enabled negative move has a unique extension in the strategy. More explicitly, if x is a configuration of S and $s(x) \cup \{a\}$ is a configuration extending $s(x)$ by a negative event, there is a unique e with $s(e) = a$ and $x \cup \{e\} \in \mathrm{Conf}(S)$. **Courtesy** says that a new immediate dependency may only run from a negative event to a positive event. Thus, if $e \lessdot_S e'$ and either $\mathrm{pol}(e) = +$ or $\mathrm{pol}(e') = -$, then $s(e) \lessdot s(e')$ in the arena.

Construction 1.16 (Secured interaction and hiding)**.**

(1) **Synchronize the shared interface.** For strategies $S \to A^{\perp} \parallel B$ and $T \to B^{\perp} \parallel C$, interaction synchronizes the occurrences on B. Only **secured** synchronizations are admitted: the combined causal orders of the matched histories must be acyclic.

(2) **Hide the internal events.** Composition then hides the matched B-events while retaining the induced order on visible events. The acyclicity condition prevents a circular collection of unfulfilled prerequisites from being mistaken for a possible interaction.

Theorem 1.17 (Concurrent composition; imported)**.** *Polarized event structures and receptive courteous strategies, taken up to isomorphism over their arenas, form a compact closed category $\mathcal{C}$. Composition is secured interaction followed by hiding, identity is copycat, tensor is parallel composition, and duality reverses polarity.*

Reference and size verification.

(1) **Composition.** For composition and compact closure, see Castellan et al. (2017). Parallel composition, finite secured histories, and hiding preserve countability. On a fixed countable carrier, orders, consistency families, polarities, and labellings range over sets.

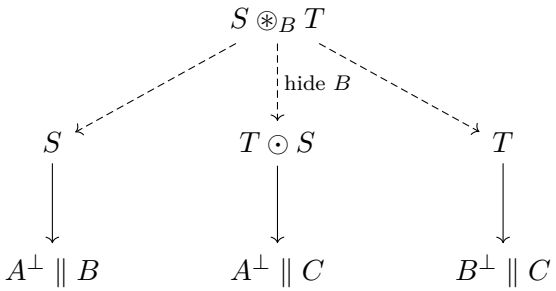


Figure 3: Interaction precedes hiding. Dashed arrows are partial maps of event structures: projection forgets events private to the other component, and hiding forgets internal events. Solid arrows are total strategy maps.

(2) **Causal execution.** Taking a set of countable carriers and quotienting strategy presentations by isomorphism therefore gives a set $\mathcal{C}(A, B)$ for every A, B.

□

Notation 1.18 (Compact structure)**.** We write $\otimes$ for parallel composition in $\mathcal{C}$ and I for the empty arena. Arena-preserving strategy isomorphisms represent equality of arrows. Put

$$\widetilde{\eta}_A = I \xrightarrow{\eta_A} A^\perp \otimes A \xrightarrow{\gamma} A \otimes A^\perp.$$

Interaction polarities are independent of economic ownership.

1.1.3 The linear account of interaction

Construction 1.19 (Composition and copycat in the chosen convention)**.**

(1) **Form the interaction.** The preceding pullback describes the interaction used by Theorem 1.17. Forget the polarities on the shared interface while forming the pullback of

$$S \parallel C \xrightarrow{s\parallel \mathrm{id}} A^\perp \parallel B \parallel C \xleftarrow{\mathrm{id}\parallel t} A^\perp \parallel T.$$

The additional factors carry the events private to the other component.

(2) **Restrict to the exterior arena.** The pullback has a map to the three-interface arena. Keep just its events labelled in $A^\perp \parallel C$, restrict order and consistency, and restrict the labelling map. This gives the composite. Restricting the transitive order retains the visible consequence of an internal causal chain; it does not simply erase the chain's dependencies.

(3) **Construct copycat.** The copycat strategy of Castellan et al. (2017) is constructed as follows: start with the two interface copies of A, add the forwarding edge from the negative occurrence of each arena event to its positive occurrence, take transitive closure, and define consistency through the causal closure in the arena. We use the cited verification that this gives a receptive courteous strategy and that it is the identity for secured interaction followed by hiding. Thus no separate copycat correctness claim is being introduced here; the concrete description only fixes the convention used by the imported compact-closed structure.

Construction 1.20 (The closed structure of concurrent interaction)**.**

(1) **Tensor and internal hom.** The tensor is $A \otimes B = A \parallel B$, with unit the empty arena. Compact closure constructs the internal hom $A \multimap B = A^{\perp} \parallel B$ and the natural bijection

$$\mathcal{C}(X \otimes A, B) \cong \mathcal{C}(X, A \multimap B).$$

(2) **Evaluation and transposition.** Evaluation and transposition are obtained from the displayed cups, caps, and symmetry. The snake equations prove the inverse laws for this bijection. Identity is copycat, composition is interaction and hiding, and tensor places interactions in parallel.

Compact closure provides a tensor for combining linear interfaces and an internal hom for linear interaction, as in Girard (1987). An agent type also needs an ordinary parameter that can index several uses of a policy description. Section 1.2 constructs such parameters and the linear interfaces that depend on them.

Remark 1.21 (Related concurrent semantics). The extension by symmetry and the construction of concurrent Hyland–Ong games are developed in Castellan, Clairambault, and Winskel (2019). Winskel (2023) relates concurrent strategies to functional models, including lenses and optics. These works situate the chosen operational category and its functional fragments; the constructions used here are the ones explicitly specified above and below.

1.1.4 Ordinary functions as response protocols

Construction 1.22 (Finite value arenas and response strategies)**.**

(1) **Form the value arena.** For a finite set X, let $D(X)$ be the positive arena with one event for each $x \in X$, no nontrivial causal order, and configurations $\varnothing$ and the singletons. Distinct values conflict.

(2) **Realize a response.** A function $f : X \to Y$ determines a strategy $\widehat{f} : D(X) \to D(Y)$. For each x, its corresponding branch contains a negative input event x and a positive output event labelled $f(x)$, with the input preceding the output; different input branches conflict.

Proposition 1.23. *The assignments $X \mapsto D(X)$ and $f \mapsto \widehat{f}$ form a faithful functor from finite sets and functions to $\mathcal{C}$.*

Proof.

(1) **Secured operational interaction.** The only added dependency is negative-to-positive, so courtesy holds. At the empty configuration every input is accepted once; after an input, all other inputs conflict with it in the arena.

(2) **Receptivity and functional composition.** This proves receptivity. Synchronizing $\widehat{f}$ and $\widehat{g}$ produces, on the branch indexed by x, the chain $x \to f(x) \to g(f(x))$. Hiding the middle event gives $\widehat{g \circ f}$.

(3) **Secured operational interaction.** For the identity function the construction is copycat on $D(X)$. Distinct functions differ on an input and therefore on an output label of the corresponding strategy; they cannot be isomorphic over the arena.

□

The point strategies form a natural family with respect to finite response maps.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} I & \xrightarrow{\mathsf{pt}_X(x)} & D(X) \\ \| & & \downarrow \widehat{f} \\ I & \xrightarrow[\mathsf{pt}_Y(f(x))]{} & D(Y) \end{array}$$

Notation 1.24 (Value states)**.** For $x \in X$, write

$$\mathsf{pt}_X(x) : I \longrightarrow D(X)$$

for the one-event positive strategy selecting x. Equivalently, if $\bar{x} : 1 \to X$ is the corresponding function and $\upsilon : I \to D(1)$ is the unique one-event state, then

$$\mathsf{pt}_X(x) = \widehat{\bar{x}} \circ \upsilon.$$

Functoriality gives the naturality equation

$$\widehat{f} \circ \mathsf{pt}_X(x) = \mathsf{pt}_Y(f(x)). \tag{1.3}$$

Equivalently, under $X \cong \mathbf{FinSet}(1, X)$, the functions $\mathsf{pt}_X : X \to \mathcal{C}(I, D(X))$ are the components of the natural transformation

$$\mathsf{pt} : \mathbf{FinSet}(1, -) \Longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(I, D(-)),$$

between functors $\mathbf{FinSet} \to \mathbf{Set}$. Its construction is the hom-functor action of D on $X \cong \mathbf{FinSet}(1, X)$, followed by precomposition with υ. The symbol denotes a selected point of a data arena and is separate from both compact coevaluation η_A and later quotation.

A recipient of $D(X \times Y)$ receives one report containing both values. A recipient of $D(X) \otimes D(Y)$ can receive either output first. Faithfulness records the distinctions between the original response maps. Collecting independent outputs into a joint report imposes a further requirement. The collector must wait for both, which determines when a later policy may first use both values.

1.1.5 Communication of data and synchronization barriers

Construction 1.25 (Copying and disposal of data)**.**

(1) **Specify the data maps.** For data that may be reported to several recipients there are explicit copying and disposal strategies

$$\Delta_X : D(X) \to D(X) \otimes D(X), \qquad \epsilon_X : D(X) \to I.$$

(2) **Copy an input.** The source of Δ_X has, for each value x, one negative input and two independent positive outputs, each labelled x and each dependent on the input. Different input branches conflict.

(3) **Dispose of an input.** The source of ϵ_X is just the negative input arena. These are receptive and courteous by direct inspection: every input is accepted uniquely, and the only new dependencies are negative-to-positive.

Proposition 1.26 (Duplicable data)**.** *The triple $(D(X), \Delta_X, \epsilon_X)$ is a commutative comonoid in $\mathcal{C}$. For every finite function $f : X \to Y$,*

$$(\widehat{f} \otimes \widehat{f})\Delta_X = \Delta_Y \widehat{f}, \qquad \epsilon_Y \widehat{f} = \epsilon_X.$$

Proof.

(1) **Associativity.** Both bracketings of the iterated copy strategy have, after interaction and hiding, one negative input event labelled x and three independent positive output events labelled x, each with that input as its prerequisite. Matching corresponding events gives an isomorphism over the arena.

(2) **Copying comonoid laws.** This proves coassociativity, including its prescribed associators. Swapping the two outputs is a branchwise isomorphism, proving cocommutativity. Composing either output with disposal leaves one input and its single copied output, exactly copycat. This proves the two counit equations.

(3) **Causal execution.** For the naturality equation, each side has an input branch for x and two independent outputs labelled $f(x)$. Their only visible causal prerequisite is the input. The branchwise identification is again an isomorphism.

(4) **Secured operational interaction.** Discarding the output of $\widehat{f}$ leaves just its receptive input behavior, which is ϵ_X.

□

Naturality of copying is expressed by the following commuting square.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D(X) & \xrightarrow{\Delta_X} & D(X) \otimes D(X) \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \widehat{f}} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \widehat{f} \otimes \widehat{f}} \\ D(Y) & \xrightarrow[\Delta_Y]{} & D(Y) \otimes D(Y) \end{array}$$

Copying and disposal are designated operations on these finite data interfaces, not structural rules of the linear syntax. An isomorphism in the ambient concurrent category can transport a comonoid structure, so material nonduplicability cannot be inferred from an object's isomorphism class alone. Material feasibility and authorization are instead tracked by exhibited certificates and witnessed institutional executions, as constructed in Section 8.1; an ambient morphism alone does not establish either property. Thus communication may copy a signal without thereby certifying another authorization or resource occurrence.

Construction 1.27 (Distribution of a paired value)**.**

(1) **Distribute a paired input.** There is also a distributor $d_{X,Y} : D(X \times Y) \to D(X) \otimes D(Y)$. For each pair (x, y) its source has one negative input labelled (x, y) and two independent positive outputs labelled x and y, both following that input. Different paired inputs conflict.

(2) **Verify the strategy conditions.** It is receptive and courteous by the same direct check as the response protocols above.

A collector must accommodate partially received tuples. Completed tuples sharing a channel value therefore share the corresponding negative input event, rather than generating incompatible copies of that input. The canonical collector below makes this sharing explicit.

Construction 1.28 (Canonical finite collector)**.**

(1) **Form the input and output events.** Let J be a finite index set and let $(X_j)_{j \in J}$ be finite sets. Put $X_J = \prod_{j \in J} X_j$. Define an event structure $C_{\mathbf{X}}$ with negative events

$$e_{j,x} \qquad (j \in J,\ x \in X_j)$$

and positive events

$$o_{\mathbf{x}} \qquad (\mathbf{x} = (x_j)_{j \in J} \in X_J).$$

(2) **Generate order and consistency.** Generate its causal order by

$$e_{j,x_j} < o_{\mathbf{x}} \qquad (j \in J).$$

A finite set of events is consistent precisely when it contains at most one input value on each component, at most one tuple output, and every input that occurs together with $o_{\mathbf{x}}$ has the value prescribed by $\mathbf{x}$.

(3) **Label the collector.** Label $e_{j,x}$ by the input occurrence x on component j and label $o_{\mathbf{x}}$ by the tuple $\mathbf{x}$. Denote the resulting map by

$$c_{\mathbf{X}} : C_{\mathbf{X}} \longrightarrow \left(\bigotimes_{j \in J} D(X_j) \right)^{\perp} \parr D(X_J).$$

For $J = \{1, 2\}$ write $c_{X,Y}$, and for $J = \varnothing$ write $c_0 : I \to D(1)$.

Proposition 1.29 (Finite collectors)**.** *The map $c_{\mathbf{X}}$ is a receptive courteous strategy*

$$c_{X_j \,|\, j \in J} : \bigotimes_{j \in J} D(X_j) \longrightarrow D\left(\prod_{j \in J} X_j \right).$$

A configuration containing the tuple output $o_{\mathbf{x}}$ contains exactly its required input events e_{j,x_j} in their causal past. Every iterated binary collector, followed by the canonical reassociation of the Cartesian product, is isomorphic to this strategy over its arena. The nullary collector c_0 is the one-event positive state selecting the empty tuple.

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** A principal downset of an input event is a singleton, while

$$\downarrow o_{\mathbf{x}} = \{o_{\mathbf{x}}\} \cup \{e_{j,x_j} : j \in J\},$$

so principal downsets are finite. Consistency is downward closed. For the cause-extension axiom, the only nontrivial case is $e_{j,x_j} \leq o_{\mathbf{x}}$ with $o_{\mathbf{x}}$ already in a consistent set.

(2) **Causal execution: second comparison.** Such a set cannot contain a different input value on component j; therefore adjoining e_{j,x_j} preserves consistency. Thus $C_{\mathbf{X}}$ is an event structure.

(3) **Causal execution.** A configuration containing $o_{\mathbf{x}}$ is down-closed, hence contains all e_{j,x_j}, and its image is a configuration of the arrow arena. A configuration without an output contains at most one value on each input component. The labelling is injective on either kind of configuration, so it is a total map of event structures.

(4) **Secured operational interaction.** For receptivity, let z be a source configuration and suppose that the arrow arena enables a negative input $x \in X_j$. Then z contains no input on component j. It cannot contain a tuple output either, because down-closure of such an output would already contain an input on component j.

(5) **Collector receptivity and courtesy.** Hence $z \cup \{e_{j,x}\}$ is a configuration. The source has exactly one event with that arena label, so the lift is unique. Every added causal edge is of the form $e_{j,x_j} < o_{\mathbf{x}}$, hence is negative-to-positive; courtesy follows.

(6) **Secured operational interaction.** Now expand any iterated binary collector before hiding its intermediate tuple events. On a completed tuple $\mathbf{x}$, the visible source events are the original inputs e_{j,x_j} and the final tuple output. The internal tuple events form a directed tree from those inputs to the final output, so secured interaction is acyclic.

(7) **Secured operational interaction: second comparison.** Hiding the internal tuple events leaves $e_{j,x_j} < o_{\mathbf{x}}$ for every j and adds no order between distinct inputs. Its visible consistency condition is exactly the one in Construction 1.28. Matching equally labelled visible events therefore gives an isomorphism over the arena.

(8) **Causal execution.** Cartesian coherence identifies every parenthesization with the same product tuple. The nullary case has no negative events and one positive event labelled by the unique element of 1.

□

Proposition 1.30 (Lax symmetric-monoidal data interface)**.** *The faithful functor $D : \mathbf{FinSet} \to \mathcal{C}$ of Proposition 1.23, together with*

$$c_{X,Y} : D(X) \otimes D(Y) \to D(X \times Y), \qquad c_0 : I \to D(1),$$

is lax symmetric monoidal. Its canonical J-ary comparison maps are the finite collectors of Proposition 1.29.

Proof.

(1) **Coherence of finite collectors.** The associativity and unit diagrams compare two iterated collectors with the same finite collector; Proposition 1.29 supplies the required isomorphisms, and their coherence is the coherence of Cartesian reassociation together with symmetric-monoidal coherence in $\mathcal{C}$. Symmetry exchanges the input components and sends a tuple to its permuted tuple, giving the symmetry diagram branchwise.

(2) **Causal execution.** For functions $f_j : X_j \to Y_j$, both composites

$$\widehat{\prod_j f_j} \circ c_{X_j \,|\, j \in J} \quad \text{and} \quad c_{Y_j \,|\, j \in J} \circ \bigotimes_j \widehat{f_j}$$

have one input event $e_{j,x}$ for each supplied coordinate and one final output labelled $(f_j(x_j))_j$, depending on all of those inputs. After hiding the intermediate response events they are isomorphic over the arena. This proves naturality and the lax symmetric-monoidal laws.

□

The lax monoidal structure records the naturality of finite collection.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D(X) \otimes D(Y) & \xrightarrow{c_{X,Y}} & D(X \times Y) \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \widehat{f} \otimes \widehat{g}} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \widehat{f \times g}} \\ D(X') \otimes D(Y') & \xrightarrow[c_{X',Y'}]{} & D(X' \times Y') \end{array}$$

Proposition 1.31 (The synchronization barrier)**.** *One has*

$$c_{X,Y} \circ d_{X,Y} = \mathrm{id}_{D(X \times Y)}.$$

For nonempty X, Y, the reverse composite is not the identity on $D(X) \otimes D(Y)$: each of its outputs depends on both inputs.

Proof.

(1) **Secured operational interaction.** In the first composite there is one negative input pair and, after hiding its two distributed occurrences, one positive output carrying the same pair. Its source is copycat on $D(X \times Y)$.

(2) **Reverse implication.** In the reverse composite the collector's tuple output requires both independent input events. Each distributed output therefore inherits both prerequisites after hiding. In identity copycat on $D(X) \otimes D(Y)$, the first positive output can occur after its own negative input alone, before the second input.

(3) **Secured operational interaction.** Choosing any values in the two nonempty sets exhibits a configuration present in copycat and absent from $d_{X,Y} \circ c_{X,Y}$, so the two strategies are not isomorphic over their arena.

□

Collection and distribution determine a retraction onto paired data.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D(X \times Y) & \xrightarrow{d_{X,Y}} & D(X) \otimes D(Y) \\ & \searrow^{\mathrm{id}} & \downarrow{\scriptstyle c_{X,Y}} \\ & & D(X \times Y) \end{array}$$

The retraction identifies one paired report with the completed collection of two channels. Its reverse retains the synchronization barrier: neither output can be forwarded before both inputs have arrived. This causal difference persists in protocols that make decisions between individual submissions and completion of a joint report.

1.2 Dependent completion of concurrent interfaces

The operational category $\mathcal{C}$ describes executions, but it does not yet supply all the objects needed to quantify over policies or form policy-dependent boundaries. We first index its arrows by ordinary parameters and then use the presheaf completion with Day tensor. The resulting dependent linear–nonlinear model supplies those interfaces while retaining every arrow between original arenas. In Section 2, its internal hom will represent an entire policy-parameterized interaction as an agent object.

1.2.1 Indexed families of true-concurrent interactions

Construction 1.32 (Indexed operational category)**.**

(1) **Index the operational arrows.** The ordinary parameters of an economic model are kept separate from its linear interfaces. For a set Γ, let $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$ have the same objects as $\mathcal{C}$ and hom-sets

$$\mathcal{C}_\Gamma(A, B) = \mathbf{Set}(\Gamma, \mathcal{C}(A, B)).$$

(2) **Lift composition and tensor.** Composition, tensor, identity, symmetry, cups, and caps are defined pointwise.

(3) **Reindex the parameters.** A function $f : \Delta \to \Gamma$ induces reindexing

$$f^* : \mathcal{C}_\Gamma \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}_\Delta, \qquad (f^* t)_\delta = t_{f(\delta)}.$$

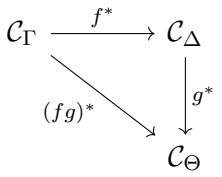
Proposition 1.33 (Indexed operational semantics)**.** *The assignment* $\Gamma \mapsto \mathcal{C}_\Gamma$ *and* $f \mapsto f^*$ *is contravariantly functorial. Every fiber* $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$ *is compact closed with the pointwise structure inherited from* $\mathcal{C}$*, and every reindexing functor preserves that structure. Thus ordinary parameter substitution and linear interaction form an indexed compact-closed semantics over* **Set**.

Proof.

(1) **Monoidal comparison.** Identity and successive reindexing are the identity and associativity laws for function composition. Every categorical operation is evaluated at one parameter value at a time, so reindexing commutes with composition and tensor and sends the constant identity, symmetry, cup, and cap families to the same constant families. The compact-closed equations therefore hold pointwise in every fiber because they hold in $\mathcal{C}$.

□

Successive parameter substitutions commute with indexed realization.



Definition 1.34 (Owner-indexed parameter category)**.** Fix a finite set N of economic agents and put

$$\mathbf{Par}_N = \mathbf{Set}^N, \qquad \Pi_N(\vec{\Sigma}) = \prod_{i \in N} \Sigma_i.$$

The product functor $\Pi_N : \mathbf{Par}_N \to \mathbf{Set}$ forgets which factor is controlled by which owner while retaining the total profile space. Pulling the indexed operational semantics back along Π_N leaves the true-concurrent operational category unchanged and records exactly the factorization of ordinary alternatives that will determine deviations.

1.2.2 The canonical completion of concurrent interfaces

Economically, the completion supplies spaces in which policy families, their dependent alternatives, and predicates can coexist with the original operational interfaces. Its new objects organize those families; they do not add new economic decisions to a given arena. Full faithfulness of Yoneda will ensure that an arrow between original interfaces still denotes exactly one original concurrent strategy.

Lemma 1.35 (Scalars and the obstruction to empty linear limits)**.** *The scalar set* $\mathcal{C}(I, I)$ *is a singleton. Every arena* A *has a state* $I \to A$*, but* $\mathcal{C}$ *has neither an initial nor a terminal object.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** A total event-structure map to the empty arena has empty source, proving the scalar assertion. In A take the induced substructure

$$A_- = \{e \in A : d \leq_A e \implies \mathrm{pol}(d) = -\}.$$

It is downward closed. Its inclusion into A is a total event-structure map and is courteous: an immediate dependency in this downward-closed substructure is immediate in A.

(2) **Lifting through the comparison.** If a negative event is enabled after an image configuration, all its strict predecessors belong to that configuration, so it belongs to A_- and has a unique lift. The inclusion is therefore a receptive courteous strategy $I \to A$.

(3) **Causal execution.** If O were initial, its state $s : I \to O$ and the unique $r : O \to I$ would satisfy $rs = 1_I$ by scalar uniqueness and $sr = 1_O$ by initiality. Then I would be initial. The one-positive-event arena, however, has distinct empty-source and one-event-source strategies from I.

(4) **Secured operational interaction.** Neither violates receptivity, and their sources are not isomorphic. This is a contradiction. Compact duality exchanges initial and terminal objects, so a terminal object is impossible as well.

□

Convention 1.36 (Base, size, and finite ownership)**. Set** denotes the ordinary set-theoretic parameter category. The ambient logic is classical. Predicate calculations use its subobject doctrine, written with Heyting operations; arguments that use classical order or finite maximization are identified as such. Set-indexed meets, joins, and power objects are taken in this base. The operational category $\mathcal{C}$ has arbitrary countable arena carriers. For each fixed pair of arenas, its arrows form the set of countable strategy presentations whose source carriers are subsets of $\mathbb{N}$, modulo arena-preserving isomorphism. Every countable source admits such a presentation, so this convention retains every operational arrow. Let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be the full subcategory on arenas whose event carriers are subsets of $\mathbb{N}$, and write $J : \mathcal{C}_0 \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}$ for the inclusion. The category $\mathcal{C}_0$ is small. Fixed bijections for finite tagged carriers equip it with a tensor $\otimes_0$ and coherent comparisons making J strong symmetric monoidal. The empty arena is its unit I. Every countable arena is isomorphic to some Jc by transport of its structure along an injection into $\mathbb{N}$. This is an objectwise existence statement; no simultaneous choice of representatives is made. The owner set is a fixed finite list N. A coalition $C \subseteq N$ inherits its order from this list, and $-C$ denotes the complementary list. Thus $\Sigma_C = \prod_{i \in C} \Sigma_i$ retains exactly its members' controlled coordinates. Empty products are singletons and empty conjunctions are true; the empty coalition changes no coordinate. Collective improvement predicates below explicitly quantify over nonempty coalitions.

An empty dependent linear sum or product requires limits and colimits not present in the original arena category. We use the small monoidal category $\mathcal{C}_0$ and the fully faithful, essentially surjective inclusion $J : \mathcal{C}_0 \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}$ from Convention 1.36. Presentations with carriers in $\mathbb{N}$ retain finite data arenas $D(X)$ and residual arenas as objects of $\mathcal{C}$. For each original arena, restricted Yoneda recovers its concurrent arrows. The new colimits and limits permit dependent interfaces that the operational arena category itself lacks. Thus the completion enlarges the language of interfaces, not the possible executions of any already specified original strategy.

Construction 1.37 (Presheaves and Day convolution)**.**

(1) **Form the presheaves and their tensor.** Put $\widehat{\mathcal{C}} = [\mathcal{C}_0^{\mathrm{op}}, \mathbf{Set}]$ and write $yA = \mathcal{C}(J(-), A)$ for restricted Yoneda. For presheaves P, Q and $c \in \mathcal{C}_0$ define

$$(P \otimes_D Q)(c) = \int^{a,b \in \mathcal{C}_0} \mathcal{C}_0(c, a \otimes_0 b) \times P(a) \times Q(b), \qquad \widehat{I} = yI,$$

$$[P, Q]_D(c) = \mathrm{Nat}\big(P, Q(c \otimes_0 -)\big).$$

(2) **Identify coend representatives.** The coend is the quotient of the disjoint union over pairs (a, b) by the relations induced by arrows in either variable. For example, for

$u : a' \to a$, it identifies $(k, P(u)x, z)$ with $((u \otimes_0 1)k, x, z)$; the other variable is treated identically.

(3) **Reindex and take limits.** Reindexing in c is precomposition. Limits and colimits of presheaves are formed objectwise.

Theorem 1.38 (Completion and exact recovery of concurrent arrows)**.** *The category $\widehat{\mathcal{C}}$ is complete, cocomplete, and symmetric monoidal closed under the displayed operations. Tensor preserves colimits separately. Yoneda is fully faithful and strong symmetric monoidal, and preserves the original internal hom:*

$$\begin{aligned}\widehat{\mathcal{C}}(yA, yB) &\cong \mathcal{C}(A, B),\\ yA \otimes_D yB &\cong y(A \otimes B),\\ [yA, yB]_D &\cong y(A \multimap B).\end{aligned}$$

It preserves the compact duals of representable objects. A natural transformation $\alpha : yA \to yB$ recovers the unique original strategy

$$\alpha_c(u) \circ u^{-1} : A \longrightarrow B, \qquad u : Jc \xrightarrow{\cong} A.$$

The result is independent of the chosen isomorphism u.

Proof.

(1) **Day-convolution calculation.** Day's convolution theorem supplies the monoidal coherence and closed structure (Day, 1970). In the present formulas, the coend universal property gives directly

$$\widehat{\mathcal{C}}(R \otimes_D P, Q) \cong \widehat{\mathcal{C}}(R, [P, Q]_D).$$

Products with fixed sets and coends preserve colimits, proving the separate cocontinuity of tensor. Objectwise limits and colimits prove completeness and cocompleteness.

(2) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** We first verify restricted Yoneda directly. Choose, for this argument only, an isomorphism $u : Jc \to A$. Put $f = \alpha_c(u)u^{-1}$.

(3) **Functoriality and substitution.** For any $t : Jd \to A$, fullness of J gives the unique arrow $v : d \to c$ with $Jv = u^{-1}t$. Naturality yields $\alpha_d(t) = \alpha_c(u)Jv = ft$. Thus $\alpha = yf$, and evaluation at u proves uniqueness. The recovered f is therefore independent of the local witness u.

(4) **Day-convolution calculation.** The strong monoidal comparison of J induces canonical maps $yA \otimes_D yB \to y(A \otimes B)$. For $A = Ja$ and $B = Jb$, co-Yoneda makes these maps isomorphisms. Every A, B is locally isomorphic to such a pair, so the same canonical maps are isomorphisms for all A, B.

(5) **Unit and identity laws.** The unit comparison is likewise an isomorphism; coherence follows from these canonical maps and that of J. For the closed structure the same local argument gives

$$[yA, yB]_D(c) \cong \mathcal{C}(Jc \otimes A, B) \cong \mathcal{C}(Jc, A \multimap B).$$

The comparisons are natural and require no global choice of arena presentations. They carry cups and caps to cups and caps, preserving their snake equations.

(6) **Equation reflection under Yoneda.** Full faithfulness proves exact recovery and reflection of equations between original strategies.

□

The Yoneda comparison intertwines the original tensor product and Day convolution.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{C}_0 \times \mathcal{C}_0 & \xrightarrow{y \times y} & \widehat{\mathcal{C}} \times \widehat{\mathcal{C}} \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \otimes_0} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \otimes_D} \\ \mathcal{C}_0 & \xrightarrow[y]{} & \widehat{\mathcal{C}} \end{array}$$

Every presheaf is canonically a colimit of representables: $P \cong \int^{c \in \mathcal{C}_0} P(c) \cdot y(Jc)$, where the dot denotes a copower. Thus the new interfaces are generated from the concurrent ones by specified categorical constructions. They need not themselves be single event structures. General presheaves have the proved symmetric monoidal closed structure; compact duality remains available on the original arena fragment. The theorem is a preservation and recovery result for semantic arrows. Proposition 1.44 exhibits a completed policy interface that has no compact dual.

1.2.3 Dependent ordinary and linear fibres

Dependence in this model is on ordinary parameters. The discrete index category Γ_{disc} indexes a family of presheaf interfaces, so substitution changes the parameter at which a linear object is read. The linear context still accounts for resource occurrences. This division allows dependent quantification without turning a linear resource into an ordinary variable.

Construction 1.39 (The two indexed categories)**.**

(1) **Define the two fibres.** For a set Γ define

$$\mathsf{T}(\Gamma) = \mathbf{Set}^{\Gamma_{\mathrm{disc}}}, \qquad \mathsf{L}(\Gamma) = \widehat{\mathcal{C}}^{\Gamma_{\mathrm{disc}}}.$$

Objects of $\mathsf{T}(\Gamma)$ are ordinary dependent families; objects of $\mathsf{L}(\Gamma)$ are linear dependent families. Their morphisms are families of functions and natural transformations, respectively.

(2) **Reindex the families.** For $f : \Delta \to \Gamma$ put $(f^* A)_\delta = A_{f(\delta)}$. Composition, tensor, internal hom, and their comparisons in the linear fibres are pointwise. The unit is the constant family $\widehat{I}$.

(3) **Extend the ordinary context.** An ordinary family X has context extension $p_X : \Gamma.X = \coprod_\gamma X_\gamma \to \Gamma$.

Proposition 1.40 (Substitution and the original indexed fragment)**.** *These assignments are contravariantly functorial. Ordinary reindexing preserves the cartesian closed structure, and linear reindexing preserves the symmetric monoidal closed structure. Pointwise Yoneda embeds $\mathcal{C}^{\Gamma_{\mathrm{disc}}}$ fully faithfully into $\mathsf{L}(\Gamma)$, compatibly with substitution. Its constant-arena part is exactly $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$.*

Proof.

(1) **Functoriality and substitution.** Both identity and composite substitution are identities of index precomposition. Every listed structure is evaluated at a single index, so reindexing preserves its defining universal property and comparison.

(2) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** The hom-set of constant representables yA, yB is

$$\coprod_{\gamma\in\Gamma} \widehat{\mathcal{C}}(yA, yB) \cong \mathbf{Set}(\Gamma, \mathcal{C}(A, B)).$$

Theorem 1.38, applied at each index, proves the remaining preservation and full-faithfulness assertions.

□

Proposition 1.41 (Indexed operational equations)**.** *Composition, tensor, and currying of parameterized concurrent arrows commute with parameter substitution. They satisfy associativity, units, interchange, and the closed-structure equations*

$$\mathrm{ev} \circ (\Lambda_A t \otimes 1_A) = t, \qquad \Lambda_A(\mathrm{ev} \circ (u \otimes 1_A)) = u.$$

The same equations hold in every completed linear fibre.

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** In the original fragment each equation holds at every parameter by compact closure, with the two displayed equations reducing to the snake identities. In the completion they are the triangle identities for the closed adjunction. Reindexing evaluates the identical map at the substituted index, proving compatibility.

□

Ordinary parameters may be reused to describe or compare different interactions; a linear occurrence must instead be consumed according to its process. The functor Val extracts monoidal states of a linear interface, not economic values, while Lin makes an ordinary family of chosen states available linearly. Their adjunction is the required bridge between policy descriptions and interactive resources; it introduces no copying operation on arbitrary resources.

Construction 1.42 (Values and linearization)**.**

(1) **Form the two functors.** Define functors between the two fibres by

$$(\mathsf{Val}_\Gamma A)_\gamma = \widehat{\mathcal{C}}(\widehat{I}, A_\gamma) = A_\gamma(I), \qquad (\mathsf{Lin}_\Gamma X)_\gamma = \coprod_{x\in X_\gamma} \widehat{I}.$$

(2) **Construct comprehension.** For a linear family its comprehension is

$$p_A : \Gamma.A = \coprod_{\gamma\in\Gamma} (\mathsf{Val}_\Gamma A)_\gamma \longrightarrow \Gamma.$$

The generic element at (γ, a) is the state $a : \widehat{I} \to A_\gamma$.

Theorem 1.43 (Constructed comprehension and linear–nonlinear adjunction)**.** *There is a substitution-stable adjunction* $\mathsf{Lin}_\Gamma \dashv \mathsf{Val}_\Gamma$ *with* Lin_Γ *strong symmetric monoidal. Linear comprehension has the representing bijection*

$$\mathsf{L}(\Delta)(\widehat{I}, f^*A) \cong \mathbf{Set}/\Gamma(f, p_A).$$

Moreover $\mathsf{Val}_\Gamma \mathsf{Lin}_\Gamma X \cong X$*, so* Lin_Γ *is fully faithful and* $\Gamma.\mathsf{Lin}_\Gamma X \cong \Gamma.X$ *over* Γ*.*

Comprehension transports linear states into ordinary sections of the displayed family.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{L}(\Delta)(\widehat{I}, f^*A) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \mathbf{Set}/\Gamma(f, p_A) \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle g^*} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle (-)\circ g} \\ \mathsf{L}(\Theta)(\widehat{I}, (fg)^*A) & \xrightarrow[\cong]{} & \mathbf{Set}/\Gamma(fg, p_A) \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** The coproduct universal property gives

$$\mathsf{L}(\Gamma)(\mathsf{Lin}_\Gamma X, A) \cong \prod_\gamma \mathbf{Set}(X_\gamma, \widehat{\mathcal{C}}(\widehat{I}, A_\gamma)) = \mathsf{T}(\Gamma)(X, \mathsf{Val}_\Gamma A).$$

Separate cocontinuity of tensor gives $\mathsf{Lin}(X \times Y) \cong \mathsf{Lin}(X) \otimes_D \mathsf{Lin}(Y)$ and $\mathsf{Lin}(1) \cong \widehat{I}$.

(2) **Monoidal comparison.** On summands the comparisons are unitors and the bijection between pairs of indices; their coherence follows on each summand from monoidal coherence. Evaluation at I yields

$$(\mathsf{ValLin}X)_\gamma = \coprod_{x \in X_\gamma} \mathcal{C}(I, I) \cong X_\gamma$$

by Lemma 1.35. This is the adjunction unit, proving full faithfulness.

(3) **Secured operational interaction.** For comprehension, a family of states $a_\delta : \widehat{I} \to A_{f(\delta)}$ corresponds to the map $\delta \mapsto (f(\delta), a_\delta)$; projection recovers the family. Pullback reindexes these same pairs. All the constructions commute with index precomposition, establishing their substitution comparisons and coherence.

□

Proposition 1.44 (A nondualizable completed policy interface)**.** *The policy interface* $\mathsf{Lin2} = \widehat{I} \amalg \widehat{I}$ *is not dualizable in* $\widehat{\mathcal{C}}$*. Consequently the completed linear category is not compact closed, although restricted Yoneda preserves every original compact dual.*

Proof.

(1) **Compute a consequence of dualizability.** For a dualizable P, the functor

$$\widehat{\mathcal{C}}(P, -) \cong \widehat{\mathcal{C}}(\widehat{I}, P^\vee \otimes_D -)$$

preserves colimits: tensor is separately cocontinuous by Theorem 1.38, and maps out of the representable unit are evaluation at I, which preserves presheaf colimits.

(2) **Calculate the binary coproduct comparison.** Put $P = \mathsf{Lin2}$. The copower formula and scalar uniqueness give

$$\widehat{\mathcal{C}}(P, \widehat{I}) \amalg \widehat{\mathcal{C}}(P, \widehat{I}) \cong 1 \amalg 1, \qquad \widehat{\mathcal{C}}(P, \widehat{I} \amalg \widehat{I}) \cong \mathbf{Set}(2, 2).$$

The canonical comparison includes the two constant functions and misses the two nonconstant functions. It is not bijective, so P cannot be dualizable. The preservation of original duals is already part of Theorem 1.38.

□

Construction 1.45 (The exponential)**.**

(1) **Define the comonad.** Put $!_\Gamma = \mathsf{Lin}_\Gamma \mathsf{Val}_\Gamma$. The counit $\epsilon_A : !A \to A$ evaluates the state labelling each summand; the comultiplication is $\mathsf{Lin}(\eta_{\mathsf{Val}A})$. The adjunction triangles prove the comonad identities.

(2) **Transport the structural maps.** The diagonal and terminal map of $\mathsf{Val}A$, transported through the strong monoidal functor Lin, give $!A \to !A \otimes_D !A$ and $!A \to \widehat{I}$ and their commutative-comonoid laws. Thus these structural maps are constructed, and are stable under substitution. Here $!$ is idempotent because η is invertible. This is the monoidal-adjunction account of linear–nonlinear semantics (Benton, 1995).

(3) **Construct the monoidal comparison.** For completeness, the lax monoidal comparison on values sends a pair of states $a : \widehat{I} \to A$, $b : \widehat{I} \to B$ to

$$\widehat{I} \cong \widehat{I} \otimes_D \widehat{I} \xrightarrow{a \otimes_D b} A \otimes_D B;$$

its unit is the identity state of $\widehat{I}$. Applying Lin gives the monoidal comparison $!A \otimes_D !B \to !(A \otimes_D B)$. Its coherence, and compatibility with the comonad maps, can be checked on each pair of state-labelled summands: both sides evaluate the same tensor of states. Also

$$!(A \,\&\, B) \cong !A \otimes_D !B, \qquad !\top \cong \widehat{I},$$

because values preserve products and Lin is strong monoidal.

The exponential renders named states reusable through the ordinary interface. It does not turn the physical response arena $D(X)$ into a copower: $\mathsf{Lin}(1) = \widehat{I}$, whereas $yD(1)$ has more than one state and is not isomorphic to $\widehat{I}$. The copying and collection strategies on finite data therefore retain the causal behaviour proved above, independently of the abstract linear–nonlinear adjunction.

1.2.4 Dependent adjoints, additives, and equality

Construction 1.46 (Dependent sums and products)**.**

(1) **Form sums and products on fibres.** For $f : \Delta \to \Gamma$ define

$$(\Sigma^\ell_f A)_\gamma = \coprod_{\delta :\, f(\delta) = \gamma} A_\delta, \qquad (\Pi^\ell_f A)_\gamma = \prod_{\delta :\, f(\delta) = \gamma} A_\delta.$$

They act on arrows componentwise using coproduct injections and product projections.

(2) **Recover the ordinary adjoints.** The identical set formulas define ordinary functors $\Sigma^{\mathrm{c}}_f, \Pi^{\mathrm{c}}_f$ on T.

Theorem 1.47 (Adjunctions, base change, and Frobenius)**.** *For every f, $\Sigma^\ell_f \dashv f^* \dashv \Pi^\ell_f$. Both adjoints satisfy Beck–Chevalley for pullback squares. There is a natural Frobenius isomorphism*

$$\Sigma^\ell_f (f^* B \otimes_D A) \cong B \otimes_D \Sigma^\ell_f A.$$

The comparisons are coherent with identity and composite substitution. The ordinary adjoints have the corresponding properties, with cartesian product in place of tensor. All empty fibres are included.

Proof.

(1) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** The coproduct universal property gives

$$\mathsf{L}(\Gamma)(\Sigma_f^\ell A, B) \cong \prod_\gamma \prod_{f(\delta)=\gamma} \widehat{\mathcal{C}}(A_\delta, B_\gamma) \cong \mathsf{L}(\Delta)(A, f^*B).$$

Replacing the coproduct universal property by the product universal property gives the right adjunction.

(2) **Base-change comparison.** For a pullback square $\Delta' \xrightarrow{a} \Delta$, $\Gamma' \xrightarrow{b} \Gamma$ with vertical arrows f', f, the map a is a bijection between the fibre of f' at γ' and the fibre of f at $b\gamma'$. It therefore induces $b^*\Sigma_f^\ell \cong \Sigma_{f'}^\ell a^*$ and $b^*\Pi_f^\ell \cong \Pi_{f'}^\ell a^*$. Successive pullback comparisons compose the same index bijections, so their coherence follows.

(3) **Base-change comparison: completion.** Frobenius is, at each γ, the distribution of $B_\gamma \otimes_D -$ over the coproduct indexed by that fibre. Its comparison on each summand is the identity; this also proves compatibility with base change. The set-valued proof is identical.

□

The pullback square supplies Beck–Chevalley comparisons for both dependent adjoints.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Delta' & \xrightarrow{a} & \Delta \\ {\scriptstyle f'}\downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f} \\ \Gamma' & \xrightarrow[b]{} & \Gamma \end{array}$$

Construction 1.48 (Additives and equality)**.**

(1) **Form the additive types.** Finite products and coproducts in each linear fibre give $A \,\&\, B$, $\top$, $A \oplus B$, and 0. The object $\top$ is the terminal presheaf; the tensor unit is $\widehat{I} = yI$.

(2) **Construct the equality family.** For an ordinary family X let $d : \Gamma.X \to \Gamma.X.X$ be its diagonal and put

$$\mathrm{Id}_X^\ell = \Sigma_d^\ell \widehat{I}.$$

Its fibre at (γ, x, x') is $\widehat{I}$ if $x = x'$ and 0 otherwise. It equals $\mathsf{Lin}(\mathrm{Eq}_X)$, where Eq_X is the ordinary equality family. Reflexivity is the identity of $\widehat{I}$ on the diagonal.

(3) **Obtain equality elimination.** For any linear E, D over $\Gamma.X.X$, Frobenius and adjunction give

$$\mathsf{L}(\Gamma.X.X)(E \otimes_D \mathrm{Id}_X^\ell, D) \cong \mathsf{L}(\Gamma.X)(d^*E, d^*D).$$

This is its equality-elimination universal property; the adjunction identities give evaluation and uniqueness. All these constructions are stable under substitution by Theorem 1.47.

Proposition 1.49 (Recovery of ordinary dependent structure)**.** *Every ordinary context extension is the comprehension of a linearized family. Moreover*

$$\mathsf{Val}(\Sigma_f^\ell \mathsf{Lin} X) \cong \Sigma_f^{\mathrm{c}} X, \qquad \mathsf{Val}(\Pi_f^\ell \mathsf{Lin} X) \cong \Pi_f^{\mathrm{c}} X.$$

For $p : \Gamma.X \to \Gamma$ and $B \in \mathsf{L}(\Gamma)$,

$$\Sigma_p^\ell p^* B \cong \mathsf{Lin} X \otimes_D B, \qquad \Pi_p^\ell p^* B \cong [\mathsf{Lin} X, B]_D.$$

Proof.

(1) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** Evaluation at I preserves objectwise products and coproducts, and $\mathsf{ValLin}X \cong X$. This proves the first two comparisons and, by Theorem 1.43, the context claim. The constant-family sum distributes B over one copy of $\widehat{I}$ per x; the product comparison follows by applying closedness to that copower. These calculations are natural in all parameters.

□

Dependent ordinary families are transported along the pullback of context extension.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Delta \times_\Gamma (\Gamma.X) & \longrightarrow & \Gamma.X \\ \downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle p} \\ \Delta & \xrightarrow[f]{} & \Gamma \end{array}$$

Theorem 1.50 (The categorical dependent linear model)**.** *The constructed ordinary and linear indexed categories, comprehension, and substitution-stable monoidal adjunction form a dependent linear–nonlinear model over* **Set**. *They carry ordinary dependent sums, products, and extensional equality; linear multiplicatives and additives; the exponential of Construction 1.45; and the dependent linear sums, products, and equality just constructed. Dependence is on ordinary parameters. Original concurrent arena families embed fully faithfully, preserving their operational structure, and all original ordinary families are recovered by* ValLin.

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** Proposition 1.40 supplies the indexed monoidal structure and its substitution laws. Theorem 1.43 constructs the comprehension representing property and the monoidal adjunction. Theorem 1.47 proves the adjoints, Beck–Chevalley, and Frobenius, including their coherence.

(2) **Assembly of dependent linear structure.** Construction 1.48 gives equality and additives. These are the structural requirements in the indexed comprehension account of dependent linear semantics (Vákár, 2015, Sections 3–4). The preservation assertions are Theorem 1.38 and Proposition 1.49.

□

Proposition 1.51 (Transport of dependent linear realizations)**.** *For $A, B \in \mathsf{L}(W)$ and any $t : U \to W$, an ordinary section $\rho : 1_W \to \mathsf{Val}_W[A, B]_D$ determines a section*

$$t^*\rho : 1_U \to \mathsf{Val}_U[t^*A, t^*B]_D.$$

Under the linear–nonlinear adjunction, its linear transpose is $t^*\widetilde{\rho} : t^*A \to t^*B$. These comparisons commute with composition of state maps, and, for representable fibres, recover the original concurrent strategies pointwise by Yoneda.

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At $u \in U$ the transported state is the arrow $\rho_{t(u)} : A_{t(u)} \to B_{t(u)}$. The adjunction is pointwise, so transposing before or after reindexing gives that same component. Successive substitutions select the same component. For representables, $\widehat{\mathcal{C}}(yA, yB) \cong \mathcal{C}(A, B)$ proves recovery.

□

The transport result will be needed when an epistemic action changes the ordinary state index. Its reindexed family still denotes the same pointwise concurrent arrow; later residualization can therefore track an interaction across the update without replacing it by an abstract scalar.

1.2.5 Policy-parameterized interactions and their composition

Construction 1.52 (Dependent owned realization)**.**

(1) **Specify the policy family and its realization.** Fix $A, B \in \mathsf{L}(\Gamma)$ and ordinary policy families $\vec{\Sigma} = (\Sigma_i)_{i \in N}$; put $\Sigma = \prod_i \Sigma_i$. A realization is an ordinary morphism

$$g : \Sigma \longrightarrow \mathsf{Val}_\Gamma[A, B]_D.$$

Since $\mathsf{Val}[A, B]_D \cong (\widehat{\mathcal{C}}(A_\gamma, B_\gamma))_\gamma$, it specifies $g_{\gamma,\sigma} : A_\gamma \to B_\gamma$.

(2) **Transpose the realization.** Adjunction and closedness give the equivalent single linear morphism

$$\widetilde{g} : \mathsf{Lin}_\Gamma \Sigma \otimes_D A \longrightarrow B.$$

(3) **Change policy coordinates.** An ownerwise map $r_i : \Theta_i \to \Sigma_i$ reparametrizes g by $\prod_i r_i$; its linear form is precomposition with $\mathsf{Lin}(\prod_i r_i) \otimes_D 1_A$.

Proposition 1.53 (Categorical construction of dependent game composition)**.** *Dependent owned realizations have sequential and parallel composition, identity, and ownerwise reparametrizations. With the canonical ownerwise product comparisons they form a symmetric monoidal bicategory at each* Γ*, stable under substitution of* Γ*. On original representable interfaces the construction recovers precisely the concurrent open arenas and their compositions of Section 3.2.*

The realization of a composite is computed by composing the policy-indexed arrows.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma \times T & \xrightarrow{g \times h} & \mathcal{C}(A, B) \times \mathcal{C}(B, C) \\ \cong \big\downarrow & & \big\downarrow \circ \\ \prod_i (\Sigma_i \times T_i) & \xrightarrow[h \circ g]{} & \mathcal{C}(A, C) \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Composition through linearized policy sums.** For $\widetilde{g} : \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes_D A \to B$ and $\widetilde{h} : \mathsf{Lin}\mathcal{T} \otimes_D B \to C$, form

$$\mathsf{Lin}(\Sigma \times \mathcal{T}) \otimes_D A \cong \mathsf{Lin}\mathcal{T} \otimes_D \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes_D A \xrightarrow{1 \otimes \widetilde{g}} \mathsf{Lin}\mathcal{T} \otimes_D B \xrightarrow{\widetilde{h}} C.$$

Its policy component is $h_{\gamma,\tau} g_{\gamma,\sigma}$.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Parallel composition uses the strong monoidal comparison for Lin and symmetry to apply the two realized arrows to their respective inputs; its component is $g_{\gamma,\sigma} \otimes_D k_{\gamma,\rho}$. For each owner use the paired policy family, so the total-profile comparison is the canonical rearrangement of those pairs. Identity uses singleton policies.

(3) **Ownerwise alternatives: second comparison.** A 2-cell is an ownerwise map preserving the realization, and horizontal and parallel composition take products of these maps. Associators, unitors, and interchange rearrange the same named policy coordinates; their realization equations are the category and monoidal equations in $\mathsf{L}(\Gamma)$. Thus every coherence diagram has identical coordinate maps and identical realizations.

(4) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** Substitution evaluates these formulas at the substituted index. Finally $\mathsf{Val}[yA, yB]_D \cong \mathcal{C}(A, B)$ and Yoneda preserves composition and tensor, proving exact recovery.

□

The owner-indexed factorization remains displayed after the dependent realization is curried. A diagonal can require two components to use one policy description, but changing the reference parameter does not restrict which alternative policies exist. The next section makes agent types from these policy families; subsequent state-context and comparison constructions will distinguish reference substitution from changes of controlled alternatives.

1.3 The indexed model underlying agent types

The operational category, its restricted Yoneda completion, and its substitution-stable dependent linear–nonlinear structure have already been constructed in Theorems 1.17, 1.38 and 1.50. In the present notation the canonical comparisons are

$$\mathcal{V}(yA, yB) \cong \mathcal{C}(A, B), \qquad yA \otimes yB \cong y(A \otimes B). \tag{1.4}$$

Put $\mathcal{T}(W) = \mathbf{Set}^{W_{\mathrm{disc}}}$, $\mathcal{L}(W) = \mathcal{V}^{W_{\mathrm{disc}}}$ and $\mathcal{P}(W) = \mathrm{Sub}(W)$. The functors $\mathsf{Lin}X = \coprod_{x \in X} \mathsf{I}$ and $\mathsf{Val}A = \mathcal{V}(\mathsf{I}, A)$, and their indexed forms, are those of Construction 1.42; in particular $\mathsf{Lin}(X \times Y) \cong \mathsf{Lin}X \otimes \mathsf{Lin}Y$ and $\mathsf{Val}\mathsf{Lin}X \cong X$ by Theorem 1.43. For $f : V \to W$ the previously constructed linear adjoints have fibres

$$(\Sigma^{\ell}_f A)_w = \coprod_{f(v)=w} A_v, \qquad (\Pi^{\ell}_f A)_w = \prod_{f(v)=w} A_v. \tag{1.5}$$

The ordinary adjoints use set sums and products; the predicate adjoints use existential and universal quantification along the same fibres.

Corollary 1.54 (Indexed adjunctions and substitution)**.** *The displayed fibres inherit the adjunctions, Beck–Chevalley and Frobenius comparisons, including empty fibres and successive substitutions, of Theorems 1.47 and 5.22.*

Proof.

(1) **Identify the fibres.** The linear and ordinary families are exactly those of the cited construction. Its subterminal reflection supplies the predicate adjoints; thus the same fibre bijections and universal properties supply all three comparisons.

□

Proposition 1.55 (Linearization as a dependent sum of units)**.** *For an ordinary family X over Γ and its comprehension $p : \Gamma.X \to \Gamma$ there are substitution-natural isomorphisms*

$$\mathsf{Lin}_{\Gamma} X \cong \Sigma^{\ell}_p \mathsf{I}_{\Gamma.X}, \qquad \mathsf{Lin}_{\Gamma} X \otimes B \cong \Sigma^{\ell}_p p^* B.$$

They interpret Lin*-elimination with an independent linear continuation.*

Proof.

(1) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** The first fibre is the coproduct of one tensor unit for each $x \in X_\gamma$, by the definitions of Lin and Σ_p^ℓ; the second comparison is the Frobenius isomorphism of Theorem 1.47. Both comparisons are natural in γ and preserve substitution by Beck–Chevalley.

□

1.3.1 Closed reindexing and dependent-product coherence

Lemma 1.56 (Closed reindexing in the concrete indexed model)**.** *For every ordinary substitution $f : V \to W$, the canonical comparison $f^*[A, B] \to [f^*A, f^*B]$ is a natural isomorphism, coherent under successive substitutions.*

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At $v \in V$ both sides are canonically the same internal hom:

$$(f^*[A, B])_v = [A, B]_{f(v)} = [A_{f(v)}, B_{f(v)}] = [(f^*A)_v, (f^*B)_v].$$

The comparison and its inverse are the identities on these fibres. Both orders of successive reindexing select $A_{f(g(u))}$ and $B_{f(g(u))}$, proving naturality and coherence, including empty indexing sets.

□

Reindexing commutes with the internal hom by the identity on each fibre.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f^*[A, B] & \xrightarrow{\cong} & [f^*A, f^*B] \\ {\scriptstyle g^*}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle g^*} \\ (fg)^*[A, B] & \xrightarrow[\cong]{} & [(fg)^*A, (fg)^*B] \end{array}$$

The completion now supplies ordinary parameters, linear interfaces, and substitution-stable dependent operations, with the original concurrent arrows fully retained. These are the ingredients needed to represent a whole policy-parameterized interaction as an object.

2 Agents as First-Class Linear Objects

The completed semantics can now contain an interaction as a value of a linear type. To represent agency, that value must also retain which owner controls each complete policy. We construct a displayed agent interface over the linear object and prove its equivalence with owner-indexed concurrent presentations. This is the representation used throughout the paper: later notions of control, knowledge, and institutional action will be constructed from its explicitly retained data.

2.1 Agent types and distinct levels of control

One owner can control several decision positions. A complete policy groups their contingent responses into the parameter that the owner may replace, as in Capucci et al. (2022b). The linear realization describes how those responses interact with other components. Keeping these roles distinct is necessary before packaging the interaction as an agent type.

Four distinctions in the agent calculus. An *owner identity* indexes control and can occur at several decision positions. A *linear occurrence* of an agent is a resource in a typing context; its use must be accounted for. A *complete policy* is an ordinary parameter specifying responses at all relevant decision positions, including positions not reached during a particular execution. A *situated agent* is an agent presentation together with a legal domain, a reference-state space, observation maps, and comparison data.

If one owner makes two decisions, both entries belong to its complete policy. Replacing that policy can change both decisions together. The same device can admit several alternative policies. Running two copies of it would require two linear occurrences in the execution.

Constructed and supplied interfaces. An institution supplies its permission rule, and an owner supplies its comparison of outcomes. The calculus represents these inputs by typed maps or subobjects. Once a protocol is wired, its signals and certificates have causal histories. Images, pullbacks, and dependent quantification then determine which observations and legal executions those histories support.

The agent-type construction. For the joint policy carrier Σ, the internal hom represents an interaction that consumes a policy value and an input at A to produce an output at B:

$$\left|\mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B)\right| = [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A, B]. \tag{2.1}$$

The signature keeps ownership displayed rather than attempting to recover it from the underlying linear object. In this sense "first-class" concerns the linear occurrence and higher-order use of the agent resource; ownership is a displayed index of its typing judgment, not a property of its underlying object alone. Theorems 2.15 and 2.19 identify dependent abstraction and owned presentations. This lets an agent occur as a resource in another interaction while retaining its owners. The comparisons in Theorems 3.2 and 4.14 and Construction 4.13 will then identify the effects of composition, regrouping, and delegation on that same representation.

2.2 Economic vocabulary: policies, outcomes, and information

The representation separates the complete policy from its concurrent realizer. The following vocabulary specifies the additional economic data: ownership identifies the coordinate that may change, comparison evaluates the resulting alternatives, and observation constrains the information available to the owner. Section 2.3 will package these data into the displayed interface.

Definition 2.1 (Agent identities, policies, and profiles)**.** An **economic game** in ordinary strategic form consists of a finite owner list N, sets Σ_i of available policies, an outcome set Z, a realization, and strict comparison relations:

$$\Sigma = \prod_{i \in N} \Sigma_i, \qquad z : \Sigma \longrightarrow Z, \qquad \prec_i \hookrightarrow Z \times Z \quad (i \in N).$$

An **agent identity** i controls the coordinate Σ_i. The term **owner** describes this coordinate control; **player** is the customary game-theoretic name for the agent when its incentives are considered. The same identity may own several decisions in one process. A **pure policy** $\sigma_i \in \Sigma_i$ is a complete contingent plan for the decisions of i; a **profile** is $\sigma = (\sigma_i)_{i \in N} \in \Sigma$. Write σ_{-i} for the profile of the other owners.

More explicitly, at a decision node v with effective observation set O_v and action set A_v, a decision policy has type $\pi_v : O_v \to A_v$ and chooses the **action** $\pi_v(o) \in A_v$ upon

observation o. For a protocol with node set V and ownership $i(v)$, the complete owner policy space is

$$\Sigma_i = \prod_{v \in V:\, i(v)=i} A_v^{O_v},$$

including decisions at nodes not reached by realized play. The general open-arena interface takes the sets Σ_i as parameters; its operational realization has type $g : \Sigma \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$. An economic policy is an element of Σ_i, whereas an **operational concurrent strategy** is an event-structure morphism representing an arrow $g(\sigma)$ of $\mathcal{C}$. These are distinct kinds of objects.

Definition 2.2 (Coalitions and deviations)**.** A **coalition** is a subset $C \subseteq N$ of owners, with complement $-C = N \setminus C$ and policy carriers $\Sigma_C = \prod_{i \in C} \Sigma_i$ and $\Sigma_{-C} = \prod_{i \notin C} \Sigma_i$. Its **deviation relation** is the kernel pair of the outsider projection:

$$\Sigma \xleftarrow{p_1} D_C = \Sigma \times_{\Sigma_{-C}} \Sigma \xrightarrow{p_2} \Sigma, \qquad (\sigma, \tau) \in D_C \iff \sigma_{-C} = \tau_{-C}.$$

A coalition deviation from a reference σ is an element of the fibre $\mathsf{Alt}_C(\sigma) = p_1^{-1}(\sigma)$; for the ordinary outcome realization z its paired outcome is $\delta_C^z = (zp_1, zp_2) : D_C \to Z^2$. A **unilateral deviation** has $C = \{i\}$; the **grand coalition** has $C = N$. For $C = \varnothing$, D_C is the diagonal, so no policy changes. The word deviation denotes a comparison of available alternatives, not a temporal adjustment.

Joint control of these coordinates is distinct from a collective preference, pooled access to observations, or common resource endowments. Joint choice and guaranteed outcomes against arbitrary outsider choices therefore have different quantifier structures. Control of material resources is represented separately through occurrence-preserving processes and their certificates.

Definition 2.3 (Preferences, utilities, and valuations)**.** For an outcome set Z, an agent's **strict preference** is a relation $\prec_i \hookrightarrow Z \times Z$; $z \prec_i z'$ means that z' is strictly better than z for owner i. For exact numerical evaluations write $R_+ = \mathbb{Q}_{\geq 0}$ and $R_\pm = \mathrm{Gr}(R_+) \cong \mathbb{Q}$, with inclusion $\eta : R_+ \to R_\pm$. Explicitly, the pair (a, b) represents the signed rational $a - b$, and (a, b) and (c, d) represent the same value precisely when $a + d = b + c$. In numerical game statements $\mathbb{K}$ denotes $R_\pm$ in the exact presentation and $\mathbb{R}$ in the classical real-valued presentation. Finite numerical examples use the former unless otherwise indicated. A numerical **utility** or **payoff** for completed plays evaluates the measured result via $e_i : T_C Z \to \mathbb{K}$ (Constructions 2.7 and 2.8). An outcome-only payoff $u_i : Z \to \mathbb{K}$ represents the given relation on Z when

$$z \prec_i z' \quad \iff \quad u_i(z) < u_i(z').$$

For an allocation carrier X, a numerical **valuation** is a map $v_i : X \to \mathbb{K}$ assigning the value of an allocation before separately specified payments. Alternatively, when owner i receives a bundle in X_i through $a_i : X \to X_i$, use $v_i : X_i \to \mathbb{K}$ and the composite $v_i a_i : X \to \mathbb{K}$. The resulting **social welfare** is the map

$$\mathrm{SW} : X \longrightarrow \mathbb{K}, \qquad \mathrm{SW}(x) = \sum_{i \in N} v_i(a_i(x)),$$

with $a_i = \mathrm{id}_X$ in the common-allocation presentation. A valuation need not be an agent's final utility after payments, and an allocation's resource feasibility is separately witnessed.

The general theory uses the supplied comparison relation directly, including when no numerical utility representation is available. When numerical utilities are supplied, their differences measure incentive gains. The displayed welfare map records the specified sum of valuations, not an additional rationality law on agents.

Definition 2.4 (Best responses and Nash equilibrium)**.** Let $z : \Sigma \to Z$ realize the outcome of a policy profile. Against fixed outsider policies σ_{-i}, a policy $a_i \in \Sigma_i$ is a **best response** if no available $b_i \in \Sigma_i$ satisfies

$$z(a_i, \sigma_{-i}) \prec_i z(b_i, \sigma_{-i}).$$

For a numerical utility this is equivalent to $u_i(z(a_i, \sigma_{-i})) \geq u_i(z(b_i, \sigma_{-i}))$ for every b_i. A **Nash equilibrium** is a profile σ at which each σ_i is a best response to σ_{-i}. With a legal domain, the alternatives are restricted to those that complete the fixed outsiders to a legal profile.

Equilibrium expresses stability of a profile under the designated deviations. Coalitional stability tests joint changes using an explicitly stated improvement criterion. The selection construction below recovers these predicates and retains all ties.

Example 2.5 (Individual and joint incentives)**.** Two agents choose whether to contribute to a project, with actions $a_1, a_2 \in \{0, 1\}$. Let

$$u_1(a_1, a_2) = 2a_1a_2 - a_1, \qquad u_2(a_1, a_2) = 2a_1a_2 - a_2.$$

At $(0, 0)$ each receives 0. Either unilateral contribution gives its contributor -1, so $(0, 0)$ is Nash. The joint change to $(1, 1)$ gives both agents 1, so the same profile admits a strict improvement by the grand coalition. At $(1, 1)$ either unilateral withdrawal reduces the withdrawing agent's payoff to 0, so that profile is Nash as well. This calculation separates individual stability from joint improvement. The joint improvement is assessed in each agent's own utility; no collective utility is needed.

Definition 2.6 (Legality, observational admissibility, and resource feasibility)**. Legality** of a policy profile is a subobject $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, with exactly the elements of L permitted. For a history set H, an effective observation quotient $o : H \twoheadrightarrow O$, and an action set A, a response $f : H \to A$ is **observationally admissible** precisely when there is a map $\pi : O \to A$ with $f = \pi o$. Equivalently, for the kernel-pair projections $p_1, p_2 : H \times_O H \rightrightarrows H$, one has

$$fp_1 = fp_2;$$

the descended π is unique by effective descent in **Set**.

A **resource feasibility certificate** is retained in an exhibited carrier K together with its realization $w : K \to Z$ into the specified allocation or outcome carrier. Its existential feasibility predicate is

$$\mathrm{Feas}_w = \mathrm{im}(w) \hookrightarrow Z.$$

The image says which outcomes admit a certificate, while K retains the certificates themselves. Institutional legality, information-dependent admissibility, and physical feasibility therefore have different carriers and need not coincide.

Construction 2.7 (The writer of measured outcomes)**.**

(1) **Form the ordinary writer.** For a commutative charge monoid $(C, +, 0)$ put $T_C Z = C \times Z$ and $T_C f = 1_C \times f$. Its maps

$$\eta^T_Z(z) = (0, z), \qquad \mu^T_Z(c, (d, z)) = (c + d, z)$$

insert a result at zero cost and combine nested records. For $f : X \to T_C Y$ its extension is $f^\dagger = \mu^T_Y T_C f$: if $f(x) = (d, y)$, then $f^\dagger(c, x) = (c + d, y)$. This is the writer interpretation of cost in Niu et al. (2022, Section 1.1). Here its input cost is obtained from a displayed execution witness.

(2) **Verify the sequential and parallel laws.** Naturality of η^T, μ^T follows by applying the same outcome map on both sides. The two unit laws reduce to $0 + c = c = c + 0$; the two multiplications on $(b, (c, (d, z)))$ agree by associativity. Thus $(g^\dagger f)^\dagger = g^\dagger f^\dagger$ for consecutive measured operations. The strength sends $(x, (c, y))$ to $(c, (x, y))$. Running two independent branches in either order yields $(c + d, (x, y))$ from $(c, x), (d, y)$, by commutativity. For a triple the two bracketings give the sum of the same three charges; a unit branch adds zero, and symmetry permutes the paired outcomes. These calculations give the symmetric monoidal comparison, fibrewise also in ordinary parameter contexts.

(3) **Erase, regrade and evaluate.** The projection $\epsilon_Z(c, z) = z$ is a monad morphism to the identity. A monoid map $j : C \to C'$ induces the monad morphism $T_j(c, z) = (j(c), z)$, by $j(0) = 0$ and $j(c + d) = j(c) + j(d)$. Each owner supplies an evaluator $e_i : T_C Z \to V_i$ with a comparison on V_i. An ordinary utility u_i gives $e_i = u_i \epsilon_Z$, also on nonzero charges. An ordinary game with outcome map z embeds by $\eta^T_Z z$; $\epsilon_Z \eta^T_Z = \mathrm{id}_Z$ recovers its outcomes. More generally, $e_i(c, z) = u_i(z) - \ell_i(c)$ for an additive price $\ell_i : C \to (\mathbb{K}, +)$. A product charge monoid allows each owner to price its own coordinates. An arbitrary evaluator can also assign different rankings at different accumulated charges.

Construction 2.8 (Measured outcomes of completed executions)**.**

(1) **Retain the completed witness.** For a specified result interface, let $p : K \to \Sigma$ send each completed execution witness to its policy profile and let $a : K \to Z$ read its outcome. A measurement with values in a commutative monoid $(C, +, 0)$ gives an ordinary term $m : K \to C$. The measured outcome and its erasure are

$$r = z^{\mathrm{m}} = \langle m, a \rangle : K \longrightarrow T_C Z, \qquad \epsilon_Z r = a.$$

The fibre K_σ can be empty or contain several executions. A witness of zero cost is still an element of this fibre.

(2) **Compare measured outcomes.** Give owner i a strict improvement relation $P_i \hookrightarrow (T_C Z)^2$. A value presentation takes $P_i = (e_i \times e_i)^* \prec_i$, so the actual witness value is $v_i = e_i r$. The paired records of two witnesses are tested by $(z^{\mathrm{m}} \times z^{\mathrm{m}})^* P_i$. Taking $P_i = (\epsilon_Z \times \epsilon_Z)^* \prec_i$ recovers the original outcome comparison by composition of pullbacks. In the exact numerical instance, use $u_i : Z \to R_\pm$, a charge $m_i : K \to R_+$ read from a coordinate of m, and a price $\lambda_i \in R_+$. The net value is

$$v_i(k) = u_i(a(k)) - \eta(\lambda_i m_i(k)) \in R_\pm,$$

where $\eta : R_+ \hookrightarrow R_\pm$ is the canonical inclusion. An owner can compare records directly even when the charge has no price.

(3) **Restrict to a budget.** For $B \hookrightarrow C$ retain $K_B = K \times_C B$. The image of $a|_{K_B}$ consists of outcomes with an execution meeting the budget. Taking this image after the pullback permits two witnesses for the same outcome to have different costs. The budget is a predicate on the measurement and can be used independently of the owner's comparison.

Words with more than one role. The following distinctions will be maintained when the constructions meet.

Term	Meaning in this paper
Agent	A persistent owner identity with a complete policy interface in an interaction; its situated record includes observations and comparison feedback.
Policy	An ordinary complete contingent plan. Its realized concurrent strategy is the corresponding arrow of the operational category.
State	A monoidal state is an arrow from the tensor unit. An economic reference state indexes a policy profile; a public state records a stage of a protocol.
Context	A state context indexes references, an operational context surrounds an interaction by wiring, and a comparison context supplies the outcome comparisons used for incentives.
Type	A dependent type is a family in the semantic model. An economic type indexes an agent's valuation or utility. A resource type names a kind of material occurrence.
Value	Val extracts states of a linear object. An economic valuation or utility instead evaluates desirability.
History	A concurrent history is a configuration. A tree history records a path of decisions or completed public rounds.

Remark 2.9 (Probabilistic boundary). Policies here are pure, and epistemic models retain possibilities. Mixed strategies are probability distributions on pure policies; priors, conditional posteriors, expected utilities, and chance kernels belong to a probabilistic extension. None enters the constructions below.

The carrier presentations in Convention 1.36 establish smallness of the presheaf indexing category. Policy parameters retain their ordinary set-theoretic meaning.

Notation 2.10 (Operational and ordinary structure)**.** The symbol $A \multimap B$ denotes the internal hom of concurrent interaction interfaces. Ordinary predicates have implication $P \Rightarrow Q$. Policy parameters are ordinary objects; resource occurrences belong to the linear interfaces. Their categorical relationship is constructed in Section 1.2.

2.3 Owned agents and their situated interfaces

The policy-parameterized concurrent realization is now available, but an agent must also retain an identity across all of its controlled decisions. This section packages those decisions into one complete policy interface and connects it to the canonical selection relation. Legal choices and observations are displayed with their state contexts, so that neither evaluation nor information is mistaken for part of operational polarity.

2.3.1 Agent identities, complete policies, and situated interfaces

Selection enters as a comparison interface, not as a property of a concurrent event. The canonical relation below accepts a proposed policy when no available alternative is designated as an improvement. It retains all ties; the later feedback construction supplies the actual improvement predicate.

Definition 2.11 (Selection at a comparison interface)**.** For a set S, a **selection relation** has the type

$$\varepsilon_S \hookrightarrow S \times (S \to \mathsf{Pred}(S)), \qquad \varepsilon_S(a, q) \iff \forall b \in S\ \neg q(a)(b).$$

Here a is a state of $\mathbb{L}(S)$, and $q : S \to \mathsf{Pred}(S)$ is a comparison costate: $q(a)$ is the predicate of improving alternatives to a. The selection relation retains ties and does not choose a representative; for numerical utilities it expresses maximization among all available choices.

In the terminology of Definition 3.4, a **concurrent open game** consists of the typed owned arena $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$ with the canonical tuple $(\varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^G})_{i \in N}$ of such owner interfaces. An **evaluated concurrent open game** is $(G, (\varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^G})_i, P)$ with $P \in \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A, B)$. Connecting the agent interfaces to the pulled-back comparison costates constructs $\mathsf{BR}_G(P) \hookrightarrow (\Sigma^G)^2$ in Section 5.6. A numerical evaluation retains both its value maps and their induced comparison relations. This is the selection-relation interface of Capucci et al. (2022a) specialized to the paper's canonical qualitative feedback.

Definition 2.12 (Agent interface and situated agent)**.** In an owned open game $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$, the **agent interface** of identity $i \in N$ is

$$\mathsf{Ag}_i(G) = (i, \Sigma_i^G, \varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^G}).$$

The complete policy carrier belongs to this occurrence of the interface; the identity i is retained when occurrences are composed. Its contextual realization is

$$\alpha_i^G : \Sigma_{-i}^G \times \Sigma_i^G \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A, B), \qquad \alpha_i^G(u, a) = g_{(u,a)}.$$

An **agent process** is the owned open game connecting these interfaces through g. A **situated, evaluated agent presentation** consists of the process together with a legal comprehension $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma^G$, a reference map $s : W \to L$, observation maps $o_i : W \to O_i$, and a comparison context $P_i \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A, B)^2$. The unrestricted case uses $L = \Sigma^G$. The ordinary reference context of the presentation is ms. The corresponding situated agent is the record

$$(\mathsf{Ag}_i(G), \alpha_i^G, o_i, P_i, m, s).$$

Its legal interface at $\sigma \in L$ is the dependent carrier

$$S_i^L(\sigma_{-i}) = \{a \in \Sigma_i^G : (\sigma_{-i}, a) \in L\},$$

with its own canonical selection relation and the restriction of α_i^G. The outsider tuple indexes available alternatives; the observation map specifies the information available to the agent.

The owned policy parameter and the concurrent arrow g_σ have different types and different roles. The former supplies an alternative; the latter executes that alternative. Selection, contextual comparison, and execution are consequently interpreted by different constructions, which are connected only after the evaluation context has been specified.

The triple $\mathsf{Ag}_i(G)$ records control and the canonical selection interface, but it does not by itself determine observation, objective, legality, or implementation. The situated presentation retains those fields so that knowledge, rationality, ability, and commitment can be posed as distinct predicates. In particular, failing a rationality or knowledge test does not remove the agent's control interface.

Over an ordinary parameter context Γ, the dependent version uses the same record in each fibre. Its implementation is the linear map $\widetilde{g} : \mathsf{Lin}_\Gamma \Sigma \otimes_D A \to B$; world-indexed observations and comparisons remain ordinary dependent terms. This makes the situated interface compatible with substitution and with the original representable arena fragment.

Proposition 2.13 (Recovery of the owned presentation from agent interfaces)**.** *Bundling an owned open game and its displayed state, observation, comparison, and legal data*

into the preceding agent presentation, and then unpacking it, recovers the original data. Conversely, unpacking and rebundling recovers the agent presentation. These constructions preserve ownerwise maps, sequential and parallel composition of the underlying processes, and substitution of the ordinary base. Displayed state, observation, and comparison data are retained under the same context transport.

Proof.

(1) **Secured operational interaction.** The interfaces retain the same indexed carriers Σ_i, and the process retains g. Its contextual realization is obtained by the canonical rearrangement $\Sigma_{-i} \times \Sigma_i \cong \Sigma$; evaluating it on the corresponding coordinates recovers g. The selection relation is the displayed predicate constructed from Σ_i.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** All additional data remain the same maps m, s, o_i, P_i. Thus the two constructions are inverse in indexed family notation. An ownerwise map remains the same family of maps and satisfies the same realization equation.

(3) **Policy-level comparison.** Products of its coordinates give the same composition comparisons, and substitution selects the same fibre. In slice notation the comparison is the canonical equivalence between a displayed map and the disjoint union of its fibres. No policy representative is chosen.

□

2.3.2 Displayed ownership and the underlying linear object

Definition 2.14 (Displayed agent signatures and judgments)**.** An agent signature over Γ is a tuple $\mathfrak{s} = (N, \vec{\Sigma}, A, B)$ comprising a finite owner list, ordinary families $\vec{\Sigma} = (\Sigma_i)_{i \in N}$, and linear boundaries A, B. Write $\Sigma = \prod_i \Sigma_i$. The signature is part of the judgment:

$$\Gamma \vdash \mathfrak{s}\ \mathsf{AgSig}, \qquad \Gamma; \Delta \vdash a : \mathsf{Ag}_{\mathfrak{s}}.$$

Its underlying linear type, obtained by forgetting the display, is

$$\left|\mathsf{Ag}_{\mathfrak{s}}\right| = H_{\mathfrak{s}} := [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A, B].$$

Formally a displayed agent term is a pair $(\mathfrak{s}, t)$ with $\Gamma; |\Delta| \vdash t : H_{\mathfrak{s}}$. The notation $\mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B)$ suppresses the other entries of $\mathfrak{s}$. Unpacking forgets the tag and returns t; packing t with a specified signature returns $(\mathfrak{s}, t)$. Packing and unpacking are definitionally inverse, and their equations are those of the underlying linear calculus. Every linear constructor acts on the underlying terms; a resulting agent is tagged by an explicitly constructed signature.

Ordinary substitution transports both an agent signature and its term, whereas linear substitution transports the term with its signature fixed. Consequently, conversion of displayed agent types must respect the owner factors. An isomorphism of underlying hom objects cannot by itself say whether two coordinates are controlled by one owner or by two: the signatures (2×2) and $(2, 2)$ have isomorphic total profiles but different unilateral-deviation kernel pairs. Thus ownership cannot be recovered from the underlying object $H_{\mathfrak{s}}$.

An agent variable $a : \mathsf{Ag}_{\mathfrak{s}}$ occurs linearly in Δ and can be packed with its specified signature. Because an agent term is linear, another process may receive it as an input without acquiring permission to duplicate its occurrences. The owner-indexed display has a different purpose: it specifies which reparametrizations count as strategic maps. An underlying arrow between agent objects need not preserve those coordinates, and repacking

a term with a different display is not a strategic morphism. The category of elements in Theorem 2.19 characterizes the realization-preserving ownerwise maps. Regrouping and delegation then give explicit changes of display, while higher-order linear terms use agents as resources.

Complete policies persist under causal localization. The displayed signature is not inferred from a partially observed execution. A local secured history may contain no occurrence of an owner's action, yet the complete off-path policy remains an ordinary parameter of that owner. The policy-indexed witness sheaf of Construction 8.3 therefore restricts causal matching graphs but keeps the parameter and its owner factors fixed. This distinction will be needed when local execution evidence is compared with global legal alternatives.

2.3.3 Introduction, execution, and extensionality

The derived introduction and execution rules are

$$\frac{\Gamma, \sigma : \Sigma; \Delta, x : A \vdash t : B}{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash \Lambda\sigma.\lambda x.t : \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B)},$$

$$\frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash a : \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B) \quad \Gamma \vdash \sigma : \Sigma \quad \Gamma; \Theta \vdash x : A}{\Gamma; \Delta, \Theta \vdash a[\sigma](x) : B}.$$

In the first rule, Δ, A, B are pulled back along the policy parameter. The introduction first forms the underlying linear term

$$\lambda z.\, \mathsf{let}\ u \otimes x = z\ \mathsf{in}\ \big(\mathsf{let}\ \mathsf{return}(\sigma) = u\ \ \mathsf{in}\ t\big),$$

where $u : \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma$ and the ordinary variable σ is bound in the second elimination. The specified signature tag is then attached. Execution unpacks the agent and supplies $\mathsf{return}(\sigma) \otimes x$ to the internal hom. Neither operation changes the ownership tag implicitly. The equations are

$$(\Lambda\sigma.\lambda x.t)[\tau](u) = t[\tau/\sigma, u/x], \tag{2.2}$$

$$\Lambda\sigma.\lambda x.a[\sigma](x) = a. \tag{2.3}$$

The second equation follows from the uniqueness equations for internal hom, tensor, and Lin elimination applied to the displayed nested term. The β-equation is elimination after introduction and the η-equation is the corresponding universal-property uniqueness. Both are equations of open terms, so no separation of arrows by global points is invoked.

Theorem 2.15 (Agent abstraction is a dependent linear product)**.** *Let $p : \Gamma.\Sigma \to \Gamma$ be the ordinary comprehension of the complete policy family. In the indexed linear–nonlinear semantics of Section 1.3, there is a substitution-natural isomorphism*

$$[\mathsf{Lin}_{\Gamma}\Sigma \otimes A, B] \cong \Pi^{\ell}_{p}[p^{*}A, p^{*}B]. \tag{2.4}$$

Its transposition is precisely agent introduction, and its inverse is policy-indexed application. Hence the displayed agent $\beta\eta$ equations hold on open linear contexts, without using global points to separate arrows or postulating an independent agent abstraction rule.

Proof.

(1) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** For every test object X of $\mathcal{L}(\Gamma)$, closure, Proposition 1.55, Frobenius, the left indexed adjunction, fibrewise closure, and the right indexed adjunction give a natural chain

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathcal{L}(\Gamma)(X, [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A, B]) \\
&\quad \cong \mathcal{L}(\Gamma)(X \otimes \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A, B) \\
&\quad \cong \mathcal{L}(\Gamma)(\Sigma^{\ell}_{p} p^{*}(X \otimes A), B) \\
&\quad \cong \mathcal{L}(\Gamma.\Sigma)(p^{*}(X \otimes A), p^{*}B) \\
&\quad \cong \mathcal{L}(\Gamma.\Sigma)(p^{*}X, [p^{*}A, p^{*}B]) \\
&\quad \cong \mathcal{L}(\Gamma)(X, \Pi^{\ell}_{p}[p^{*}A, p^{*}B]).
\end{aligned}$$

Reindexing preserves tensor by construction and internal hom by Lemma 1.56.

(2) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** Yoneda therefore gives the displayed isomorphism. The first and last transpositions send a body $\Gamma, \sigma : \Sigma; \Delta, x : A \vdash t : B$ to its agent abstraction and back to its application. The triangle identities and the closed-structure $\beta\eta$ equations prove (2.2)–(2.3) even for open terms.

(3) **Base-change comparison.** Each comparison is an indexed adjunction comparison, so Beck–Chevalley makes the isomorphism natural under ordinary substitution.

□

The indexed adjunctions identify agent abstraction with dependent currying.

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathsf{L}(\Gamma)(X, [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A, B]) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \mathsf{L}(\Gamma)(X \otimes \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A, B) \\
\downarrow{\scriptstyle \cong} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \cong} \\
\mathsf{L}(\Gamma)(X, \Pi^{\ell}_{p}[p^{*}A, p^{*}B]) & \xrightarrow[\cong]{} & \mathsf{L}(\Gamma.\Sigma)(p^{*}X, [p^{*}A, p^{*}B])
\end{array}$$

Proposition 2.16 (Agents as additive families of interactions)**.** *The following is the copower–closedness comparison specialized to the canonical model, rather than a property peculiar to event structures. In the canonical model constructed in Section 1.3, there is a natural isomorphism*

$$[\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A, B] \cong \prod_{\sigma \in \Sigma} [A, B].$$

The product is an additive product in the linear category.

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise additive-product representation.** By Theorem 2.15, the left-hand object is $\Pi^{\ell}_{p}[p^{*}A, p^{*}B]$. At γ its fibre is, by the constructed indexed product formula, precisely $\prod_{\sigma \in \Sigma_{\gamma}} [A_{\gamma}, B_{\gamma}]$. Naturality and substitution stability are those of the dependent-product comparison, so the result is a natural isomorphism of linear families.

□

Remark 2.17 (Agent transformations and strategic maps). A linear arrow between agent types is a transformation of agent resources. An ownerwise reparametrization is a more specific piece of displayed data: it changes the policy parameters in a way that identifies which owner controls each change. The category of underlying linear types alone does not recover this distinction. In particular, an isomorphism of total policy sets does not identify their coalition structures.

2.3.4 Open agents

An open term $\Gamma; \Delta \vdash a : \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B)$ denotes, at each ordinary parameter γ, an arrow

$$\bigotimes [\![\Delta]\!]_\gamma \longrightarrow [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma_\gamma \otimes A_\gamma, B_\gamma].$$

Its uncurried form is

$$\bigotimes [\![\Delta]\!]_\gamma \otimes \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma_\gamma \otimes A_\gamma \longrightarrow B_\gamma.$$

The uncurried form accounts for the resources needed to supply an agent separately from the policy and interface supplied when it executes. Thus higher-order application does not erase the linear inputs on which an open agent term depends.

2.3.5 Exact representation of owned presentations

Theorem 2.18 (Representation of agents)**.** *There is a natural bijection*

$$\mathcal{V}(\mathsf{I}, |\mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(yA, yB)|) \cong \mathbf{Set}(\Sigma, \mathcal{C}(A, B)).$$

More generally, for every linear test object $T \in \mathcal{V}$ there is a natural open-context bijection

$$\mathcal{V}(T, [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes yA, yB]) \cong \prod_{\sigma \in \Sigma} \mathcal{V}(T \otimes yA, yB). \tag{2.5}$$

These comparisons identify execution, sequential and parallel composition, ownerwise reparametrization, regrouping, and delegation with the corresponding constructions on owned concurrent realizations.

Proof.

(1) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** Closedness and the coproduct description of Lin give, naturally in T and in the policy set Σ,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{V}(T, [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes yA, yB]) &\cong \mathcal{V}(T \otimes \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes yA, yB) \\ &\cong \mathcal{V}\Big(\coprod_{\sigma \in \Sigma} (T \otimes yA), yB\Big) \\ &\cong \prod_{\sigma \in \Sigma} \mathcal{V}(T \otimes yA, yB).\end{aligned}$$

The middle comparison is an isomorphism because Day tensor preserves coproducts separately; the last is the coproduct universal property.

(2) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** For $T = \mathsf{I}$, restricted Yoneda gives $\mathcal{V}(yA, yB) \cong \mathcal{C}(A, B)$ and hence the first assertion. For $r : \Theta \to \Sigma$, precomposition by $\mathsf{Lin}r \otimes 1$ sends the component at θ to the component at $r(\theta)$. For closed agents, sequential and parallel composition therefore have components $h_\tau g_\sigma$ and $g_\sigma \otimes h_\tau$.

(3) **Composition in open linear contexts.** For agents supplied from T and U, the decoded components for sequential composition are $g_\sigma : T \otimes yA \to yB$ and $h_\tau : U \otimes yB \to yC$. Evaluation of the sequential composite on the (σ, τ)-summand is the arrow

$$(U \otimes T) \otimes yA \xrightarrow{\alpha} U \otimes (T \otimes yA) \xrightarrow{1_U \otimes g_\sigma} U \otimes yB \xrightarrow{h_\tau} yC.$$

For parallel composition take $k_\tau : U \otimes yA' \to yB'$. The component on the same summand rearranges $(T \otimes U) \otimes (yA \otimes yA')$ into $(T \otimes yA) \otimes (U \otimes yA')$ and applies

$g_\sigma \otimes k_\tau$. These formulas result by precomposing the defining evaluation maps with the two policy injections. The coproduct universal property recovers the entire open map from these components. Precomposition in either test object commutes with the displayed rearrangements by tensor naturality. Taking $U = T = \mathsf{I}$ recovers the closed formulas through the unitors.

(4) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Ownerwise regrouping and delegation apply the same named-coordinate substitutions on both sides; the comparison maps obey coherence by ordinary-product and symmetric-monoidal coherence.

(5) **Policy-level comparison.** The equality $g = h \prod_i r_i$ defining a realization-preserving 2-cell becomes exactly the equality between the corresponding reparametrized agent states.

□

Policy indexing, currying, and Yoneda give an exact representation of realized agents.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{V}(\mathsf{I}, [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes yA, yB]) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \mathcal{V}(\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes yA, yB) \\ \cong \downarrow & & \downarrow \cong \\ \mathbf{Set}(\Sigma, \mathcal{C}(A,B)) & \xrightarrow[\cong]{} & \prod_{\sigma\in\Sigma} \mathcal{V}(yA, yB) \end{array}$$

Theorem 2.19 (Equivalence on owned presentations)**.** *For fixed original arenas A, B and owner list N, form the presheaf of agent states on $\mathbf{Set}^N$,*

$$F_{A,B}(\vec{\Sigma}) = \mathcal{V}\big(\mathsf{I}, [\mathsf{Lin}(\prod_i \Sigma_i) \otimes yA, yB]\big), \qquad F_{A,B}(r)(b) = b[r].$$

Let $\mathsf{StateAg}_N(A,B) = \int F_{A,B}$ be its category of elements. Its objects are $(\vec{\Sigma}, a)$ with the retained owner display; an arrow $(\vec{\Sigma}, a) \to (\vec{T}, b)$ is an ownerwise map $r_i : \Sigma_i \to T_i$ satisfying $a = b[r]$. Then execution and restricted Yoneda define an isomorphism of categories

$$\mathsf{StateAg}_N(A,B) \;\cong\; \mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})(A,B).$$

These isomorphisms are compatible with sequential and parallel composition, identity presentations, and their ownerwise associativity and symmetry comparisons. They also commute with ordinary base substitution.

Proof.

(1) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** For $g : \Sigma \to \mathcal{C}(A,B)$, copair the arrows $yg_\sigma : yA \to yB$:

$$\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes yA \cong \coprod_{\sigma\in\Sigma} yA \xrightarrow{[yg_\sigma]_\sigma} yB.$$

Currying and tagging this map constructs the agent state a_g.

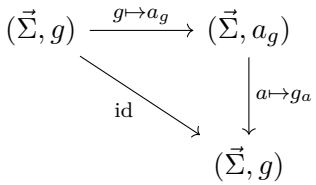
(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, evaluate an agent state a on every coproduct injection, then decode the resulting map $yA \to yB$ by Yoneda; call the family g_a. The coproduct and closed-structure $\beta\eta$ equations give $g_{a_g} = g$ and $a_{g_a} = a$, without relying on global-point extensionality.

(3) **Ownerwise alternatives.** For an ownerwise map r, the equation $a = b[r]$ holds exactly when $g_a(\sigma) = g_b(r(\sigma))$ for every profile, which is precisely the original presentation 2-cell condition and the category-of-elements arrow condition. In particular arbitrary arrows of the underlying linear category are not thereby declared strategic maps. The execution equations (3.1)–(3.2) then identify horizontal and tensor composition.

(4) **Ownerwise alternatives: completion.** Each higher coherence map has the same ownerwise coordinate projections and the same concurrent realizations on both sides. The ordinary and symmetric-monoidal coherence laws prove compatibility with all comparison maps. Pointwise execution also commutes with ordinary substitution.

□

Copairing and componentwise execution are inverse correspondences on owned presentations.



Proposition 2.20 (Interpretation of open terms)**.** *Every core derivation determines a morphism* $\bigotimes[\![\Delta]\!] \to [\![A]\!]$ *in* $\mathcal{L}([\![\Gamma]\!])$*. Definitional equality gives equality of morphisms. Ordinary and linear substitution are interpreted by reindexing and composition.*

Proof.

(1) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** Interpret context splitting by tensor, abstraction and application by closedness, additives by products and coproducts, the ordinary–linear rules by $\mathsf{Lin} \dashv \mathsf{Val}$ together with Proposition 1.55, and indexed binders by (1.5). Corollary 1.54 makes ordinary substitution commute with these operations.

(2) **Fixed-point argument.** The induction of Lemma A.1 interprets linear substitution as composition. Each β equation is an evaluation equation of one of these universal properties; each η equation is its uniqueness equation. Commuting conversions express naturality. Agent constructors are the specified composites of these operations.

□

Remark 2.21 (Linearization and physical data). The functor Lin organizes ordinary alternatives in the completion. The physical finite-data functor is $D : \mathbf{FinSet} \to \mathcal{C}$. Its collector $D(X) \otimes D(Y) \to D(X \times Y)$ waits for both inputs and belongs to a lax monoidal structure; it is generally not an isomorphism. We retain D for communication implementations and Lin for the ordinary–linear adjunction. Identifying them would erase a real synchronization barrier.

2.3.6 Policy interfaces as multiplayer strategy spaces

The representation also gives a game semantics in which the displayed owners are the players. Each player supplies a state at its own policy interface, and the represented interaction executes the joint choice. This separates the economic players from the operational system–environment boundary, as in the account of open games in Hedges (2020). For finite causal protocols, Section 10.2 further constructs partial plays and local response strategies on an explicit event structure.

Theorem 2.22 (Mediated multiplayer realization)**.** *Let $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$ be an owned presentation, with $g : \prod_i \Sigma_i \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$. Put $P_i = \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma_i$. There are canonical bijections*

$$\mathcal{V}(\mathsf{I}, P_i) \cong \Sigma_i.$$

Under these bijections, the representing map

$$\widetilde{g} : \left(\bigotimes_{i \in N} P_i\right) \otimes yA \longrightarrow yB$$

realizes yg_σ at profile σ. Replacing a player's state replaces exactly that owner's complete policy. The comparison respects sequential and parallel composition and ownerwise reparametrization. Transport of a legal domain and comparison predicates along the strategy bijections preserves legal deviations, best response, and equilibrium.

Proof.

(1) **Recover the complete policy.** The adjunction and unit isomorphism of Theorem 1.43 give

$$\mathcal{V}(\mathsf{I}, \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma_i) \cong \mathbf{Set}(1, \mathsf{ValLin}\Sigma_i) \cong \mathbf{Set}(1, \Sigma_i) \cong \Sigma_i.$$

Write $\widehat{\sigma_i} : \mathsf{I} \to P_i$ for the corresponding state.

(2) **Execute the joint choice.** Use the strong monoidal comparison $\bigotimes_i \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma_i \cong \mathsf{Lin}(\prod_i \Sigma_i)$. The representation of Theorem 2.18 gives

$$\widetilde{g} \circ \left(\left(\bigotimes_i \widehat{\sigma_i}\right) \otimes \underset{yA}{\mathrm{id}}\right) = yg_\sigma,$$

with unitors understood. The same theorem identifies composition and ownerwise substitutions on both sides.

(3) **Compare controlled alternatives.** The product of the strategy bijections preserves each named coordinate. It therefore identifies the fibres obtained by fixing the outsiders to a coalition. A legal subobject and every comparison pulled back along realization have the same membership tests on corresponding profiles. Existential and universal quantification over these fibres give the same selection, best-response, and equilibrium predicates, as developed in Section 5.8.

□

The map $\widetilde{g}$ mediates the interaction of the policy interfaces. This construction applies to every owned presentation in the established completion. A decomposition into local decision nodes is additional constructed structure; ownership alone does not specify its observation wires. The finite protocol construction below supplies that structure and compares its interaction with g.

Proposition 2.23 (Policy interfaces and retained execution records)**.** *Complete policy interfaces cannot in general be replaced by distinct untagged strategies on a fixed countable base arena. Moreover, a fully closed and hidden arrow in $\mathcal{C}$ cannot by itself distinguish outcomes or charges.*

Proof.

(1) **Count operational presentations.** By Convention 1.36, a strategy has a carrier contained in $\mathbb{N}$, an order, a family of finite consistent subsets, and a labelling into a countable arena. There are at most $2^{\aleph_0}$ such presentations and hence at most that many isomorphism classes. Ordinary policy sets are not bounded by this cardinality. The state bijection of Theorem 2.22 retains those larger policy sets in $\mathcal{V}$.

(2) **Retain the evaluation boundary.** By Lemma 1.35, $\mathcal{C}(I, I)$ is a singleton. Thus scalar execution alone cannot carry a nonconstant outcome or charge. The result interface, displayed policy parameters, and retained execution witnesses carry these distinctions; their evaluation is developed in Section 5.

□

We can therefore pass an agent as a linear resource while retaining its complete owner policies. The representation also identifies the result and witness interfaces needed for evaluation. We next determine how these data compose when agents are connected.

Part II
Composition, control, and game-theoretic evaluation

3 The Compositional Calculus of Agents

An agent interface must remain usable when placed inside a larger system. We construct sequential and parallel composition on the represented agents, then identify these operations with wiring of the original concurrent realizations. Ordinary products retain the complete policies controlled by each owner, following the parameterized treatment of open games (Ghani et al., 2018; Atkey et al., 2021). The resulting bicategory also supports compact wiring while preserving those owner factors. This gives the compositional structure needed to compare an owner's choices in context.

3.1 Linear agent operations and ownerwise composition

3.1.1 The two composition operations

For signatures on a common owner set, define $(\vec{\Sigma}\times\vec{T})_i = \Sigma_i \times T_i$. The canonical rearrangement identifies its total profile with $\Sigma \times T$. Unused owners have singleton policy carriers; disjoint owner lists can therefore be combined without identifying owners.

Construction 3.1 (Agent composition)**.**

(1) **Form the linear operations.** The following are linear operations:

$$\mathsf{seq} : \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B) \otimes \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{T}}(B, C) \longrightarrow \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}\times\vec{T}}(A, C),$$
$$\mathsf{par} : \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B) \otimes \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{T}}(A', B') \longrightarrow \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}\times\vec{T}}(A \otimes A', B \otimes B').$$

(2) **Compute their executions.** Their defining executions are

$$(a \,;\, b)[\sigma, \tau](x) = b[\tau](a[\sigma](x)), \tag{3.1}$$
$$(a \parallel b)[\sigma, \tau](x \otimes y) = a[\sigma](x) \otimes b[\tau](y). \tag{3.2}$$

(3) **Supply the identity.** The identity agent has singleton policies and executes $x \mapsto x$.

The first operation consumes each supplied agent once. The second splits both the agent resources and their inputs. These are comparison maps between types; they are not asserted to be isomorphisms. An arbitrary composite agent need not admit a decomposition into two independently supplied agents.

Theorem 3.2 (Coherence of agent composition)**.** *Sequential composition is associative and unital under the canonical ownerwise product bijections. Parallel composition is coherently symmetric monoidal. Sequential and parallel composition satisfy interchange:*

$$(a \parallel b)\,;(c \parallel d) \cong (a\,;c) \parallel (b\,;d),$$

where the comparison regroups the complete policy coordinates.

Proof.

(1) **Associativity.** For associativity, agent abstraction followed by (2.2) reduces both sides, at the same named policy coordinates, to

$$c[\upsilon](b[\tau](a[\sigma](x))).$$

The unit calculation reduces to $a[\sigma](x)$. The tensor comparison is obtained by reassociating and exchanging the linear inputs and the ordinary profile factors.

(2) **Interchange and higher coherence.** For interchange, both executions reduce to

$$c[\upsilon](a[\sigma](x)) \otimes d[\omega](b[\tau](y)).$$

Agent η then gives the open-term equations. In every higher coherence diagram, the ordinary maps have the same coordinate projections and the linear maps are the coherence maps of the symmetric monoidal calculus. The product and monoidal coherence laws therefore give the required commuting diagrams.

□

3.1.2 Ownerwise policy substitution

For ordinary maps $r_i : \Theta_i \to \Sigma_i$, write $r = \prod_i r_i$ and set

$$a[r][\theta](x) = a[r(\theta)](x).$$

This defines a linear map $\mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B) \to \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Theta}}(A, B)$, implemented by precomposition with $\mathsf{Lin}r \otimes 1_A$. Computation proves

$$a[\mathrm{id}] = a, \qquad a[r][s] = a[r \circ s],$$

and

$$(a\,;b)[r \times q] = a[r]\,;b[q], \qquad (a \parallel b)[r \times q] = a[r] \parallel b[q].$$

Here $r \times q$ is formed ownerwise and then flattened.

At the level of declared presentations, an ownerwise map $r : a \Rightarrow b$ has components $r_i : \Sigma_i^a \to \Sigma_i^b$ satisfying $a[\sigma] = b[r(\sigma)]$. Vertical composition is function composition; horizontal and parallel composition take ownerwise products. Together with the preceding coherence maps these presentations form the owned symmetric monoidal bicategory recovered in Section 1.3.

Example 3.3 (Shared policy and duplicated execution)**.** Two occurrences controlled by one owner initially have policy carrier $\Sigma \times \Sigma$. Precomposition with the ordinary diagonal $\Sigma \to \Sigma \times \Sigma$ makes them use the same policy description. Both linear occurrences must still be supplied. The diagonal ties parameters; it does not construct a linear diagonal on the agent type.

3.2 Open arenas, ownership and contextual wiring

Full faithfulness of Yoneda now lets us compute the internal composition on the original concurrent arenas. The wiring map determines the joint realization, and inverse image transports a comparison along that whole map. This retains dependencies between ports: if one owner controls several components, its deviation changes their policies together. The construction applies the contextual treatment of open games in Ghani et al. (2018); Atkey et al. (2021); Capucci et al. (2022b); Hedges (2020) to the concurrent category.

3.2.1 The bicategory of open arenas

Definition 3.4 (Open arenas and open games)**.** An **owned open arena** on a linear interaction boundary (A, B) is the data

$$G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B, \qquad \vec{\Sigma} \in \mathbf{Par}_N, \qquad g : \Sigma^G = \prod_{i \in N} \Sigma_i^G \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A, B).$$

Its owned policy families parameterize the concurrent realizations; at this stage it carries no preference. A **concurrent open game** adds the prescribed owner-selection interfaces

$$\varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^G} \hookrightarrow \Sigma_i^G \times (\Sigma_i^G \to \mathsf{Pred}(\Sigma_i^G)), \qquad \varepsilon_S(a, q) \iff \forall b \in S\ \neg q(a)(b),$$

whose construction is developed in Definition 2.11. An **evaluated concurrent open game** has in addition a comparison context $P = (P_i)_{i \in N}$ of type

$$P \in \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A, B) = \prod_{i \in N} \mathsf{Pred}(\mathcal{C}(A, B)^2).$$

Connecting this context to the owner interfaces determines the best-response relation $\mathsf{BR}_G(P) \hookrightarrow (\Sigma^G)^2$. The outcome interface can retain the entire exposed concurrent interaction, with scalar evaluations and material allocations as particular observations.

Definition 3.5 (Reparametrisations of owned open arenas)**.** For owned open arenas $G = (\vec{\Sigma}^G, g)$ and $G' = (\vec{\Sigma}^{G'}, g')$ on the same linear interaction boundary (A, B), a **reparametrisation** or 2-cell $f : G \Rightarrow G'$ is an ownerwise map $f_i : \Sigma_i^G \to \Sigma_i^{G'}$ satisfying $g = g' \Pi_N f$. An element of Σ_i^G is a complete policy of owner i. A presentation is **owned by** i if the other policy sets are singletons, and **nonstrategic** if every policy set is a singleton. The backward interface of an owned open arena is the canonical predicate feedback constructed from its realization below, not additional unspecified data.

Construction 3.6 (Horizontal and parallel composition)**.**

(1) **Compose in sequence.** For $G : A \to B$ and $H : B \to C$, put

$$\Sigma_i^{H \circ G} = \Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H, \qquad (h \circ g)_{(\sigma,\tau)} = h_\tau \circ g_\sigma.$$

(2) **Compose in parallel.** For $G : A \to B$ and $K : A' \to B'$, put

$$\Sigma_i^{G \otimes K} = \Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^K, \qquad (g \otimes k)_{(\sigma,\rho)} = g_\sigma \otimes k_\rho.$$

Use the canonical product rearrangements throughout.

(3) **Act on maps and identities.** Both operations on 2-cells are ownerwise products. The identity at A has singleton policy sets and realizes id_A.

Theorem 3.7 (Bicategory of concurrent open arenas)**.** *These operations define a symmetric monoidal bicategory* $\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})$*. Its hom-category at* (A, B) *is the category of elements of the presheaf*

$$F_{A,B} : \mathbf{Par}_N^{\mathrm{op}} \to \mathbf{Set}, \qquad F_{A,B}(\vec{\Sigma}) = \mathbf{Set}(\Pi_N \vec{\Sigma}, \mathcal{C}(A, B)).$$

The quotient by invertible 2*-cells is a symmetric monoidal category* $\mathsf{Arenalso}_N(\mathcal{C})$*.*

Proof.

(1) **Functoriality and substitution.** The category-of-elements description is exactly the equation defining a 2-cell. The comparison $\Pi_N(\vec{\Sigma} \times \vec{\Theta}) \cong \Pi_N \vec{\Sigma} \times \Pi_N \vec{\Theta}$ is natural. It therefore makes the displayed horizontal operations functorial on hom-categories.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The associator and unitors are the canonical ownerwise product bijections; their realization equations are the associativity and unit equations in $\mathcal{C}$. Their pentagon and triangle hold coordinatewise.

(3) **Ownerwise alternatives: second comparison.** The tensor compositor is the ownerwise permutation between the parameter orders of $(H \otimes H') \circ (G \otimes G')$ and $(H \circ G) \otimes (H' \circ G')$. Its realization equation is interchange in $\mathcal{C}$. The monoidal associator, unitors, and symmetry have singleton parameters and realize those of $\mathcal{C}$; their naturality 2-cells are the corresponding product rearrangements.

(4) **Monoidal comparison.** In each coherence diagram both parameter maps send every named coordinate to the same coordinate. The realized arrows agree by symmetric monoidal coherence in $\mathcal{C}$ (Selinger, 2011). Since a 2-cell is determined by its parameter maps, this verifies the coherence diagrams themselves.

(5) **Passage to isomorphism classes.** Finally, invertible 2-cells are exactly ownerwise bijections; the coherence maps become equalities on their isomorphism classes.

□

Ownerwise reparametrization commutes with evaluation of the composite realization.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma^G \times \Sigma^H & \xrightarrow{r \times s} & \Sigma^{G'} \times \Sigma^{H'} \\ {\scriptstyle h \circ g}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle h' \circ g'} \\ \mathcal{C}(A, C) & = & \mathcal{C}(A, C) \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma^G \times \Sigma^H & \xrightarrow{g \times h} & \mathcal{C}(A, B) \times \mathcal{C}(B, C) \\ {\scriptstyle \cong}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \circ} \\ \Sigma^{H \circ G} & \xrightarrow[h \circ g]{} & \mathcal{C}(A, C) \end{array}$$

Construction 3.8 (Reindexing and the nonstrategic embedding)**.**

(1) **Reindex an owned arena.** For an ownerwise map $f : \vec{\Theta} \to \vec{\Sigma}$ define

$$f^* G = (\vec{\Theta}, g \Pi_N f). \tag{3.3}$$

It carries the canonical 2-cell $f : f^*G \Rightarrow G$.

(2) **Embed an ordinary arrow.** Define

$$\mathbf{j}_N : \mathcal{C} \to \mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C}), \qquad u \longmapsto (\vec{1}, \mathrm{const}_u). \tag{3.4}$$

Its structure maps are the ownerwise bijections $1 \times 1 \cong 1$.

Proposition 3.9 (Reindexing and nonstrategic recovery)**.** *Reindexing is functorial and gives the cartesian arrows of each category-of-elements projection to* $\mathbf{Par}_N$*. The functor* $\mathbf{j}_N$ *is locally fully faithful and its image is biequivalent to the nonstrategic sub-bicategory.*

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The cartesian universal property is substitution of the equation $g = g'\Pi_N f$. Between two singleton-parameter presentations there is one possible ownerwise map, and it is a 2-cell exactly when their realized arrows are equal. Every family of singleton policy sets is uniquely isomorphic to $\vec{1}$.

□

Remark 3.10 (Reference sharing and policy restriction). Reindexing a family of reference states to a diagonal does not change its space of alternative policies. To enforce reuse of a policy in two components, use the ownerwise diagonal $\Sigma_i \to \Sigma_i \times \Sigma_i$ in Construction 3.8, or construct the corresponding legal subobject. These are changes to the available policy presentation; ordinary substitution of the reference state alone is not such a change.

3.2.2 Compact wiring with owner-indexed policies

The nonstrategic embedding transports the compact structure of the concurrent category to owned presentations. This is the transport principle of Hedges (2020, Proposition 1); here the parameter maps also exhibit its coherence and its effect on complete owner policies. The underlying concurrent cups and caps are those of Castellan et al. (2017).

Theorem 3.11 (Owner-indexed compact closure)**.** *The symmetric monoidal category* $\mathsf{Arenalso}_N(\mathcal{C})$ *is compact closed. Its dual object and compact maps are*

$$A^\vee = A^\perp, \qquad \eta_A^N = \mathbf{j}_N(\eta_A) : I \longrightarrow A^\perp \otimes A, \qquad \epsilon_A^N = \mathbf{j}_N(\epsilon_A) : A \otimes A^\perp \longrightarrow I.$$

Before quotienting, these maps give every object of $\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})$ *a coherent dual in its symmetric monoidal bicategory. The nonstrategic embedding preserves these duals. For* $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$*, compact transposition is*

$$G^\vee = (\vec{\Sigma}, \sigma \mapsto g_\sigma^\vee) : B^\perp \to A^\perp. \tag{3.5}$$

It preserves each owner's policy set and commutes with ownerwise reparametrization.

Proof.

(1) **Transport the compact maps.** The cups and caps in $\mathcal{C}$ have singleton policy families under $\mathbf{j}_N$. Each snake composite therefore has a product of singleton sets at each owner. The unique ownerwise bijection to $\vec{1}$ is an invertible 2-cell, since its realized arrow is id_A or $\mathrm{id}_{A^\perp}$ by the snake equations in $\mathcal{C}$. Passing to isomorphism classes gives the compact equations.

(2) **Verify the dual-pair coherence.** The snake 2-isomorphisms and their swallowtail comparisons involve only singleton-parameter presentations. Between any two such presentations of the same concurrent arrow there is exactly one 2-cell. The realized coherence diagrams commute in $\mathcal{C}$, so the corresponding 2-cell diagrams commute as well. This is object duality in the monoidal bicategory; it does not identify arbitrary owned 1-cells with adjoints for sequential composition.

(3) **Transpose a complete-policy family.** Bending the boundary uses G once and otherwise only nonstrategic compact maps. Removing the singleton factors gives its original policy family. At each profile, with associators and unitors suppressed,

$$g_\sigma^\vee = (\underset{A^\perp}{\mathrm{id}} \otimes \epsilon_B)(\underset{A^\perp}{\mathrm{id}} \otimes g_\sigma \otimes \underset{B^\perp}{\mathrm{id}})(\eta_A \otimes \underset{B^\perp}{\mathrm{id}}).$$

Thus the constructed presentation has (3.5).

(4) **Retain reparametrization and ownership.** If $r : G \Rightarrow H$, then $g_\sigma = h_{r\sigma}$ implies $g_\sigma^\vee = h_{r\sigma}^\vee$. The same ownerwise map is therefore a 2-cell $G^\vee \Rightarrow H^\vee$. Reversal of 1-cell composition uses the canonical exchange of policy factors; double duality and the tensor comparisons follow from those in $\mathcal{C}$. Every comparison preserves the named owner coordinates.

□

Proposition 3.12 (Closed transposition with fixed owner policies)**.** *There are natural equivalences of hom-categories*

$$\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})(A \otimes B, C) \simeq \mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})(A, B^\perp \otimes C).$$

They preserve ownerwise policy sets and their reparametrization maps.

Proof.

(1) **Transpose each realization.** Apply the compact closed bijection $\mathcal{C}(A \otimes B, C) \cong \mathcal{C}(A, B^\perp \otimes C)$ at every profile. It preserves the equations defining 2-cells, and its inverse does the same.

(2) **Check the comparisons.** The inverse and naturality equations are the pointwise compact equations. Their policy maps are identities, apart from canonical singleton and product comparisons. These give the stated equivalences.

□

Theorem 3.13 (Owner-preserving trace)**.** *For $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \otimes U \to B \otimes U$, the compact trace is*

$$\mathrm{Tr}_N^U(G) = (\vec{\Sigma}, \sigma \mapsto \mathrm{Tr}_{\mathcal{C}}^U(g_\sigma)). \tag{3.6}$$

It satisfies the trace equations in $\mathsf{Arenalso}_N(\mathcal{C})$ *and their canonical invertible* 2*-cell comparisons in* $\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})$*. Under the canonical parameter identifications,*

$$\mathrm{Tr}_N^U(r^* G) = r^* \,\mathrm{Tr}_N^U(G), \qquad (\mathrm{Tr}_N^U\, G)_{\sigma[i:=a]} = \mathrm{Tr}_{\mathcal{C}}^U(g_{\sigma[i:=a]}).$$

Proof.

(1) **Construct feedback from the compact maps.** Put $\widetilde{\eta}_U : I \to U \otimes U^\perp$ for the coevaluation followed by symmetry. At profile σ the composite is

$$A \xrightarrow{\mathrm{id}_A \otimes \widetilde{\eta}_U} A \otimes U \otimes U^\perp \xrightarrow{g_\sigma \otimes \mathrm{id}_{U^\perp}} B \otimes U \otimes U^\perp \xrightarrow{\mathrm{id}_B \otimes \epsilon_U} B.$$

Only G contributes nonsingleton parameters. Flattening the unit factors gives exactly (3.6).

(2) **Verify the trace equations.** Naturality, dinaturality, vanishing, superposing and yanking hold at each fixed profile by the compact trace equations (Joyal, Street, and Verity, 1996). Each equation contains the same varying components once on each side. The corresponding permutations of their named policy factors are bijective and give the required 2-isomorphisms. Their coherence holds coordinatewise.

(3) **Commute with policy replacement.** Reparametrization precomposes the profile-indexed family. Taking its trace and then precomposing therefore gives the same family as precomposing first. Replacing one owner's coordinate is the displayed pointwise case.

□

Compact feedback commutes with ownerwise reparametrization.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \prod_i \Theta_i & \xrightarrow{\Pi_N r} & \prod_i \Sigma_i \\ {\scriptstyle \sigma \mapsto \mathrm{Tr}^U(g_{r\sigma})}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \sigma \mapsto \mathrm{Tr}^U(g_\sigma)} \\ \mathcal{C}(A,B) & = & \mathcal{C}(A,B) \end{array}$$

Proposition 3.14 (Parametrized-morphism presentation)**.** *Let $F = \mathsf{Lin} \circ \Pi_N : \mathbf{Par}_N \to \mathcal{V}$ and give $\mathcal{V}$ the action $\vec{\Sigma} \cdot P = F(\vec{\Sigma}) \otimes P$. The owned bicategory is symmetrically monoidally biequivalent to the parametrized-morphism bicategory for this action, restricted to representable boundaries and with reparametrizations oriented as in Definition 3.5. With the convention of Capucci et al. (2022a, Definition 2), this is the local opposite*

$$\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C}) \simeq (\mathbf{Para}_F(\mathcal{V})|_{\mathrm{repr}})^{\mathrm{co}}.$$

Proof.

(1) **Construct the action.** The product functor Π_N and linearization are strong symmetric monoidal. Their comparisons therefore supply the action and its coherence.

(2) **Identify the parametrized arrows.** The copower description and full faithfulness of restricted Yoneda give

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{V}(F(\vec{\Sigma}) \otimes yA, yB) &\cong \prod_{\sigma \in \Pi_N \vec{\Sigma}} \mathcal{V}(yA, yB) \\ &\cong \mathbf{Set}(\Pi_N \vec{\Sigma}, \mathcal{C}(A,B)). \end{aligned}$$

This is the representing map of Theorem 2.18.

(3) **Identify the 2-cells and composition.** The equation $\widetilde{g} = \widetilde{h}(F(r) \otimes \mathrm{id})$ is precisely $g_\sigma = h_{r\sigma}$. The cited Para convention directs its 2-cell from a family to its reindexed family; the present convention directs it from the reindexed family to the original one. Taking the local opposite reconciles those directions. Composition and tensor agree under the canonical ownerwise parameter permutations, proving the monoidal biequivalence.

□

The objects of this compact semantics are operational boundaries; its morphisms are multiplayer systems with complete owner policies. The owner-labelled arenas of Section 10.2 describe the partial plays of the finite protocol fragment. Ownership does not change when a boundary is transposed. The completed linear category supplies the additional dependent interfaces; its distinction from a compact category is witnessed by Proposition 1.44. The teleological structure of lens-based open games in Hedges (2017) has no general coevaluation. Here the concurrent base supplies cups and caps and the nonstrategic embedding retains them, so the compact transport argument applies directly.

3.2.3 Joint feedback for concurrent wiring

When the same owner controls two components, a change in one can alter the value of a change in the other. Pulling the comparison back along the entire wiring function tests both choices in the same composite execution.

Construction 3.15 (Multi-input coplay)**.**

(1) **Wire the interaction maps.** Let $H_j = \mathcal{C}(A_j, B_j)$, and let $m : \prod_{j=1}^{r} H_j \to H$ be a wiring function constructed using composition, tensor, fixed concurrent arrows, and their coherent reassociations. Compact transposition and trace are included by their cup-and-cap constructions in Theorems 3.11 and 3.13. Apply $\mathbb{L}$ to m.

(2) **Transport comparisons.** For a comparison $P \hookrightarrow H^2$ its transported costate is the comparison

$$m^\sharp P((f_j)_j, (f'_j)_j) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad P(m((f_j)_j), m((f'_j)_j)). \tag{3.7}$$

The input continuation interface is $\mathbb{L}(\prod_j H_j)$: feedback is a predicate on joint alternatives.

(3) **Compute the coplay of the composite.** For component arenas G_j with plays g_j, their wired play is $m \circ \prod_j g_j$, followed by the ownerwise parameter rearrangement. Its coplay is the canonical coplay of that composite function.

Theorem 3.16 (Canonical coplay and open-arena coherence)**.** *Wiring substitution commutes with backward feedback. In particular,*

$$(mn)^\sharp = n^\sharp m^\sharp, \qquad (m \circ \textstyle\prod_j g_j)^\sharp = (\prod_j g_j)^\sharp m^\sharp.$$

The sequential, parallel, unit, symmetry, and reparametrisation laws of open arenas hold for both play and coplay. Every arena retains its owner-indexed policy sets and its complete concurrent play map.

Proof.

(1) **Equality of the two constructions.** The displayed equations are $((mn) \times (mn))^* = (n \times n)^*(m \times m)^*$. For sequential composition the two arguments of a transported comparison are $(h_\tau g_\sigma, h_{\tau'} g_{\sigma'})$. For a triple composite the two bracketings give

$$P(k_\upsilon(h_\tau g_\sigma), k_{\upsilon'}(h_{\tau'} g_{\sigma'})) = P((k_\upsilon h_\tau) g_\sigma, (k_{\upsilon'} h_{\tau'}) g_{\sigma'}).$$

Associativity in $\mathcal{C}$ proves equality.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Interchange, units, and symmetry are handled by their equations in $\mathcal{C}$ on both arguments. The ownerwise permutations are exactly those of Theorem 3.7. For a reparametrisation f, the equation $g = g'\Pi_N f$ yields

$$(g \times g)^* P = (\Pi_N f \times \Pi_N f)^* (g' \times g')^* P.$$

Thus all coherence diagrams commute also on costates.

(3) **Recovery of canonical coplay.** Finally, forgetting the canonical backward map recovers the same g and the same policy coordinates, while Theorem 5.11 reconstructs that backward map uniquely by the displayed construction.

□

Proposition 3.17 (Strategic comparison under compact wiring)**.** *For a one-input wiring operation $m : \mathcal{C}(A, B) \to \mathcal{C}(A', B')$, including compact transposition or trace, put $m_*G = (\vec{\Sigma}, m \circ g)$. For a legal domain $L \hookrightarrow \prod_i \Sigma_i$ and comparison context P' on the target boundary, transport each comparison by*

$$(m^\sharp P'_i)(f, h) \iff P'_i(m(f), m(h)).$$

The legal coalition-deviation fibres are unchanged, and

$$\mathsf{NE}_L(m_*G; P') = \mathsf{NE}_L(G; m^\sharp P').$$

The corresponding best-response and coalition-improvement predicates agree under the same comparison, coherently with state substitution.

Proof.

(1) **Retain the alternatives.** The ownerwise policy family and its legal subobject L are unchanged. Fixing outsider coordinates therefore gives exactly the same coalition-deviation fibre in both presentations.

(2) **Compare every alternative.** For each legal pair (σ, τ), the defining equation is

$$P'_i(m(g_\sigma), m(g_\tau)) = (m^\sharp P'_i)(g_\sigma, g_\tau).$$

Quantifying over the same alternative fibres proves the best-response, equilibrium and coalition assertions. State substitution evaluates this same equation in each state fibre.

□

Witness-dependent evaluations continue to use their displayed witness carriers and quantifiers. The proposition transports comparisons of exposed arrows; it does not infer descent of a hidden outcome or charge. In particular, scalar uniqueness in Lemma 1.35 explains why complete closure of a concurrent boundary cannot itself retain a nonconstant outcome. The explicit result ports and measured witnesses remain the interfaces for those evaluations.

Ownerwise reparametrization commutes with joint wiring.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \prod_j \Sigma_j & \xrightarrow{\prod_j r_j} & \prod_j \Theta_j \\ {\scriptstyle m\circ\prod_j g_j}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle m\circ\prod_j h_j} \\ H & = & H \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (\Sigma^G \times \Sigma^H)^2 & \xrightarrow{(g\times h)^2} & (H_{A,B} \times H_{B,C})^2 \\ {\scriptstyle (h\circ g)^2}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle m^2} \\ H^2_{A,C} & = & H^2_{A,C} \end{array}$$

The owner grading records precisely the policy factors preserved by composition. When an owner acts in more than one component, its composite coordinate is the product of those decisions. The graded-arrow structure below packages parameter-indexed hom-families with their unit, composition, strength, and reindexing; its coherence says that these operations commute with substitution and concurrent tensor.

Proposition 3.18 (The owner grading)**.** *The family*

$$\mathcal{A}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A,B) = \mathbf{Set}(\Pi_N \vec{\Sigma}, \mathcal{C}(A,B))$$

is a commutative $\mathbf{Par}_N^{\mathrm{op}}$*-graded arrow over* $\mathcal{C}$*: its unit is the singleton family, composition uses ownerwise products, reparametrisation is precomposition, and strength sends* g_σ *to* $g_\sigma \otimes \mathrm{id}_Z$*.*

Proof.

(1) **Naturality.** Naturality in the grade is substitution. Graded associativity and the unit equations are the corresponding equations of $\mathcal{C}$ after the canonical product comparisons of Π_N. The strength laws are functoriality and associativity of tensor.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The two ways of forming parallel composition agree by interchange. These are precisely the graded-arrow equations of Atkey et al. (2021), verified here for the constructed owner grading. Taking its category of elements retains the reparametrisations and yields the bicategory already constructed.

□

Owner grading respects the two ways of inserting a fixed interaction.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{A}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A,B) & \xrightarrow{-\otimes \mathrm{id}_Z} & \mathcal{A}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A\otimes Z, B\otimes Z) \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle r^*} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle r^*} \\ \mathcal{A}_{\vec{\Theta}}(A,B) & \xrightarrow[-\otimes \mathrm{id}_Z]{} & \mathcal{A}_{\vec{\Theta}}(A\otimes Z, B\otimes Z) \end{array}$$

The grading extends the agency and contextual-wiring constructions of Capucci et al. (2022b,a); Hedges (2020). It matters because feedback must evaluate a repeated owner's *complete* policy. For an owner acting in G and H, the forward carrier is $\Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H$ and the backward carrier is $\mathsf{Pred}(\Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H)$. The next step fixes the other owners' coordinates to obtain the individual costate, as in Section 5.6.

3.2.4 Composition of contexts and their logical interfaces

Construction 3.19 (Sequential and parallel context composition)**.**

(1) **Compose the state contexts.** For $G : A \to B$, $H : B \to C$, use the canonical owner rearrangement $\Sigma^{H\circ G} \cong \Sigma^G \times \Sigma^H$ to define

$$\mathsf{St}(G) \times \mathsf{St}(H) \longrightarrow \mathsf{St}(H \circ G), \qquad (W \xrightarrow{s} \Sigma^G, V \xrightarrow{t} \Sigma^H) \longmapsto (W \times V \xrightarrow{s\times t} \Sigma^{H\circ G}).$$

Its realization is $(w,v) \mapsto h_{t(v)} g_{s(w)}$.

(2) **Form the parallel context.** For parallel arenas use the same product context and realization $(w,v) \mapsto g_{s(w)} \otimes k_{t(v)}$.

(3) **Combine its predicates.** Predicates have an external conjunction $P \boxtimes Q = \pi_W^* P \wedge \pi_V^* Q$, while the complete fibre is $\mathsf{Pred}(W \times V)$, including arbitrary joint predicates.

Theorem 3.20 (Fibred coherence of concurrent wiring)**.** *The context-composition functors preserve cartesian lifts jointly in their inputs. External conjunction commutes with these lifts. Their associativity, units, symmetry, and interchange comparisons satisfy the corresponding bicategorical coherence laws. For any concurrent wiring* $m : \prod_j H_j \to H$ *and realizations* $a_j : W_j \to H_j$*,*

$$(m \circ \textstyle\prod_j a_j)^* Q = (\prod_j a_j)^* m^* Q, \qquad (m \circ \prod_j a_j)^\sharp P = (\prod_j a_j)^\sharp m^\sharp P.$$

Proof.

(1) **Monoidal comparison.** For maps to X and Y there is a natural bijection

$$(S \times_X W) \times (T \times_Y V) \cong (S \times T) \times_{X \times Y} (W \times V).$$

Both sides consist of tuples (s, t, w, v) satisfying the same two equations. It identifies the product of the cartesian lifts in Theorem 5.3 with the cartesian lift of their composite. Inverse image commutes with conjunction and projections, proving the predicate assertion.

(2) **Coherence.** The coherence maps rearrange the same named coordinates. Their realizations agree by associativity and interchange in $\mathcal{C}$, so the coherence diagrams commute in the tower itself. The final equations are functoriality of inverse image, applied once to the realization and once to its square.

□

Cartesian lifts are compatible with products of independently wired state contexts.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (S \times_X W) \times (T \times_Y V) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & (S \times T) \times_{X \times Y} (W \times V) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ S \times T & = & S \times T \end{array}$$

Remark 3.21 (Whole joint feedback). The source interface for a product of carriers is $\mathbb{L}(X \times Y) = (X \times Y, \mathsf{Pred}(X \times Y))$. The ordinary lens tensor instead has backward carrier $\mathsf{Pred}(X) \times \mathsf{Pred}(Y)$; it is not identified with the former. In particular $\mathbb{L}$ is faithful but not strong monoidal for the cartesian tensor on sets and the Cartesian-product tensor on lenses. The constructed context fibre keeps whole joint feedback until ownership determines which alternatives are varied. This implements the distinction between joint and partially evaluated feedback described by Capucci (2023). The graded-arrow organization remains the one proved in Proposition 3.18; fibrational lenses and related variants are developed in Atkey et al. (2021, Section 6).

3.2.5 Composition of complete agent interfaces

Proposition 3.22 (The complete-policy composition law)**.** *For composable agent processes $G : A \to B$ and $H : B \to C$, and for $K : A' \to B'$, the agent of identity i has interfaces*

$$\mathsf{Ag}_i(H \circ G) = \big(i, \Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H, \varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H}\big),$$
$$\mathsf{Ag}_i(G \otimes K) = \big(i, \Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^K, \varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^K}\big).$$

The realizations are $h_\tau g_\sigma$ and $g_\sigma \otimes k_\rho$. The identity process has singleton agent policies. These operations and ownerwise realization-preserving reparametrizations form the agent calculus of $\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})$*, with its symmetric monoidal coherence. They are stable under substitution in the dependent model.*

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The parameter family of a composite is the ownerwise product by Proposition 1.53. Applying Definition 2.12 gives the displayed interfaces. Three sequential components have the same flattened policy tuple $(\sigma_i, \tau_i, \upsilon_i)$ for each i, and both bracketings realize $k_\upsilon h_\tau g_\sigma$.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives: second comparison.** Unit comparisons remove singleton coordinates; tensor comparisons reassociate and permute named coordinates. Interchange holds because it holds in $\mathcal{C}$. Products of ownerwise maps preserve these equations.

(3) **Dependent substitution of the composite.** Thus every coherence diagram is the corresponding product coordinate diagram together with the same realized concurrent arrow. The dependent construction evaluates these formulas at each base index, so substitution commutes with all comparisons.

□

The composite realization is obtained by joining the two complete-policy profiles.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma^{H\circ G} & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \Sigma^G \times \Sigma^H \\ {\scriptstyle g^{H\circ G}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle g\times h} \\ \mathcal{C}(A,C) & \xleftarrow[\circ]{} & \mathcal{C}(A,B)\times\mathcal{C}(B,C) \end{array}$$

Section 5.6 uses the comparison on the whole composite to calculate best responses. For a single owner with payoff $u(x,y) = xy$, neither bit alone can improve on $(0,0)$. Changing the complete policy to $(1,1)$ raises the payoff. The ownerwise product makes this a unilateral deviation.

Reparametrization and reference substitution must remain distinct. The map $r_i : \Theta_i \to \Sigma_i$ changes the implemented policy presentation by precomposition; substitution of a state reference changes which policy is currently being tested but leaves the alternative carrier intact. The transport laws in Theorem 5.71 make this difference precise.

3.2.6 The semantic composition map on open agent resources

Let $G = [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A, B]$ and $H = [\mathsf{Lin}T \otimes B, C]$. The uncurried sequential operation is

$$\begin{aligned} G \otimes H \otimes \mathsf{Lin}(\Sigma \times T) \otimes A &\cong H \otimes \mathsf{Lin}T \otimes G \otimes \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A \\ &\xrightarrow{1\otimes 1\otimes \mathrm{ev}} H \otimes \mathsf{Lin}T \otimes B \xrightarrow{\mathrm{ev}} C. \end{aligned}$$

Currying gives the map of Section 3.1. For the parallel operation, rearrange

$$G \otimes H \otimes \mathsf{Lin}(\Sigma \times T) \otimes A \otimes A'$$

into the tensor of $G \otimes \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes A$ and $H \otimes \mathsf{Lin}T \otimes A'$, evaluate each, and curry. These descriptions prove naturality on arbitrary test objects and open linear contexts. They do not reduce equality of morphisms to equality only on global states.

The composition laws preserve both concurrent wiring and owner-indexed policies, including in open linear contexts. Those owner coordinates now provide the projections from which controlled alternatives are constructed.

4 Control, Coalitions, and Delegation

Composition retains the owner coordinates. They now determine what an individual or a coalition can change: two profiles are alternatives for a group precisely when their outsider coordinates agree. Projection onto those outsiders therefore constructs the deviation relation by a kernel pair. We transport it through regrouping and delegation, distinguishing joint control of existing decisions from implementation of a parent's policy by subordinate choices.

The resulting comparisons recover the division of control in Cartesian frames (Garrabrant, Herrmann, and Lopez-Wild, 2021) and identify the alternatives available on an implemented policy image.

4.1 Complete-policy alternatives and their composition

We first construct controlled alternatives without evaluating them. The outsider projection retains exactly the coordinates that a coalition cannot change. Its kernel pair therefore supplies the comparison relation needed to follow a coalition's complete choices through composition.

Construction 4.1 (Counterfactual policy alternatives)**.**

(1) **Keep the outsider policies fixed.** For a coalition $C \subseteq N$ and $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$, write $\Sigma = \prod_i \Sigma_i$ and $\Sigma_C = \prod_{i \in C} \Sigma_i$. The counterfactual alternative span is the kernel pair

$$\Sigma \xleftarrow{p_1} D_C = \Sigma \times_{\Sigma_{-C}} \Sigma \xrightarrow{p_2} \Sigma, \qquad \mathsf{Alt}_C(\sigma) = p_1^{-1}(\sigma). \tag{4.1}$$

Put $D_i = D_{\{i\}}$.

(2) **Identify its coordinates.** The coordinate bijection is

$$\chi_C : \Sigma_{-C} \times \Sigma_C \times \Sigma_C \xrightarrow{\cong} D_C, \quad (u, a, b) \longmapsto ((u, a), (u, b)). \tag{4.2}$$

(3) **Realize and compare alternatives.** Define

$$\delta_C^G = (gp_1, gp_2) : D_C \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)^2. \tag{4.3}$$

A comparison P_i pulls back to $(\delta_C^G)^* P_i$ on D_C. The first leg retains the reference profile and the second its alternative.

These kernel pairs support existential and universal deviation modalities: the reference stays fixed while the quantifier ranges over changes of the coalition's coordinates. "Counterfactual" implies no temporal move.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D_C & \xrightarrow{p_2} & \Sigma \\ {\scriptstyle p_1}\downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_{-C}} \\ \Sigma & \xrightarrow[\pi_{-C}]{} & \Sigma_{-C} \end{array} \qquad\qquad \begin{array}{ccc} D_C & \xrightarrow{(p_1,p_2)} & \Sigma^2 \\ & {\scriptstyle \delta_C^G}\searrow & \downarrow{\scriptstyle g\times g} \\ & & \mathcal{C}(A,B)^2 \end{array}$$

Construction 4.2 (Counterfactualization)**.**

(1) **Duplicate the controlled coordinates.** Define $\mathsf{Dup}_C : \mathbf{Par}_N \to \mathbf{Par}_N$ by squaring the coordinates in C, leaving the others unchanged, and acting on maps by $f_i \times f_i$ or f_i respectively. Identify $\Pi_N \mathsf{Dup}_C \vec{\Sigma}$ with D_C through χ_C.

(2) **Act on arenas and maps.** On objects put $\mathsf{CF}_C(A) = (A, A)$; on open arenas put

$$\mathsf{CF}_C(G) = (\mathsf{Dup}_C \vec{\Sigma}, \delta_C^G) \quad \text{in } \mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{C}).$$

On 2-cells use $\mathsf{Dup}_C f$.

(3) **Compose the two realizations.** Write $\mathrm{Comp}((f_0, f_1), (h_0, h_1)) = (h_0 f_0, h_1 f_1)$ and define Ten coordinatewise.

Theorem 4.3 (Compositional counterfactualization)**.** CF_C *is a symmetric monoidal pseudofunctor. In particular there is a canonical bijection* $\rho_C : D_C^{H\circ G} \cong D_C^G \times D_C^H$ *such that*

$$\delta_C^{H\circ G} = \mathrm{Comp}(\delta_C^G \times \delta_C^H)\rho_C. \tag{4.4}$$

The tensor equation uses Ten*.*

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The strong product comparison of Dup_C at a coalition coordinate is the bijection

$$((a,b),(a',b')) \longmapsto ((a,a'),(b,b')).$$

Outside the coalition it is the identity product comparison. These comparisons and $1 \times 1 \cong 1$ are natural and satisfy symmetric monoidal coherence, since every composite has the same action on named coordinates. They induce ρ_C.

(2) **Policy-level comparison.** Both realizations in the displayed equation send a tuple of reference and alternative policies to $(h_\tau g_\sigma, h_{\tau'} g_{\sigma'})$. A realization-preserving 2-cell stays realization-preserving after duplication. The pseudofunctor and monoidal coherence equations reduce to these product comparisons and the equations in $\mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{C}$.

□

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D_C^{H\circ G} & \xrightarrow[\cong]{\rho_C} & D_C^G \times D_C^H \\ {\scriptstyle \delta_C^{H\circ G}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \delta_C^G \times \delta_C^H} \\ \mathcal{C}(A,C)^2 & \xleftarrow[\mathrm{Comp}]{} & \mathcal{C}(A,B)^2 \times \mathcal{C}(B,C)^2 \end{array}$$

Corollary 4.4 (Compositional counterfactual tests)**.** *For a predicate* $P \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A,C)^2$*,*

$$(\delta_C^{H\circ G})^* P = \rho_C^* (\delta_C^G \times \delta_C^H)^* \,\mathrm{Comp}^*\, P.$$

Proof.

(1) **Functoriality and substitution.** Apply functoriality of pullback to Equation (4.4).

□

The dependent reading of D_C takes p_1 as the reference map and the second projection as the alternative. Its paired realization is a term into a constant comparison type. Thus the composition result above is also a substitution law in the state-context doctrine of Theorem 3.20: changing a reference preserves the entire dependent family of alternative policies.

Owner scopes as local policy views. The factorization $\Sigma = \prod_i \Sigma_i$ also determines a separate locality notion, unrelated to causal event patches. For an owner scope $U \subseteq N$, the projection $\pi_U : \Sigma \to \Sigma_U$ retains the complete policies of those owners, not merely the actions played on one history. Compatible such projections glue by their common coordinates. For institutional $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, however, membership in each image $\pi_U(L)$ need not imply membership in L. Section 7.1 constructs the corresponding local-policy presheaf and computes its failure of descent. This uses the same owner-coordinate projections as D_C, but tests global permission rather than the possibilities under a fixed outsider policy.

4.2 Collective control and regrouping of agent interfaces

A coalition may be treated as one controller without altering the component policies it controls. Regrouping collects its coordinates into a single owner factor, leaving the realized interaction unchanged. This changes the deviation relation, not the members' preferences: collective evaluation is still supplied by a separate comparison. The construction therefore distinguishes common control from a common objective.

The coalition-deviation relation D_C was defined in Equation (4.1) as the kernel pair of $\pi_{-C} : \Sigma \to \Sigma_{-C}$. Regrouping will identify it with the unilateral-deviation relation of the new collective owner, without changing the underlying profile tuple.

Proposition 4.5. *On a full product profile space,*

$$D_C; D_D = D_{C \cup D}.$$

Proof.

(1) **Composition of coalition changes.** Two successive changes in C and D preserve every coordinate outside $C \cup D$. Conversely, if σ and τ agree outside $C \cup D$, let ρ have τ's coordinates on C and σ's coordinates elsewhere. Then $\sigma D_C \rho$ and $\rho D_D \tau$. The construction also covers overlap between C and D.

□

Construction 4.6 (Regrouping by right Kan extension)**.**

(1) **Take the right Kan extension.** Regard an owner family $\vec{\Sigma}$ as a functor

$$\Sigma : N_{\mathrm{disc}} \longrightarrow \mathbf{Set}.$$

For a map of finite owner sets $c : N \to J$, regarded as a functor between the corresponding discrete categories, define

$$c_* \Sigma = \mathrm{Ran}_c \, \Sigma.$$

Because the categories are discrete, the right Kan extension is the finite product over each fiber, with the empty product equal to 1:

$$(c_* \Sigma)_j = \prod_{i \in c^{-1}(j)} \Sigma_i. \tag{4.5}$$

(2) **Flatten its fibres.** There is a canonical flattening bijection

$$\kappa_\Sigma : \prod_{j \in J} (c_* \Sigma)_j \xrightarrow{\cong} \prod_{i \in N} \Sigma_i. \tag{4.6}$$

Theorem 4.7 (Owner regrouping)**.** *Every map of finite owner sets $c : N \to J$ induces a symmetric-monoidal pseudofunctor*

$$c_* : \mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C}) \longrightarrow \mathbf{Arena}_J(\mathcal{C})$$

which is the identity on arenas. For an open arena $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$ its regrouping has parameter family $c_* \vec{\Sigma}$ and realization

$$g^c = g \circ \kappa_\Sigma.$$

For a 2-cell $f : G \Rightarrow G'$, its jth component is

$$(c_* f)_j = \prod_{i \in c^{-1}(j)} f_i.$$

Under the flattening bijection, deviation by the new owner j is exactly deviation by the old coalition $c^{-1}(j)$:

$$D_j^{c_*G} \cong D^G_{c^{-1}(j)}.$$

For another finite owner map $d : J \to K$ there is a canonical pseudonatural isomorphism

$$d_* c_* \cong (d \circ c)_*.$$

Proof.

(1) **Naturality.** Naturality of the flattening bijections gives

$$\kappa_{\Sigma'} \circ \prod_j (c_* f)_j = \left(\prod_i f_i \right) \circ \kappa_\Sigma.$$

Hence, if $g = g' \prod_i f_i$, then

$$g\kappa_\Sigma = g' \kappa_{\Sigma'} \prod_j (c_* f)_j,$$

so $c_* f$ is realization-preserving.

(2) **Monoidal comparison.** The right Kan extension is strong monoidal for the pointwise Cartesian products used in owned composition and tensor. Its component is the canonical bijection

$$\prod_{i \in c^{-1}(j)} (\Sigma_i \times \Theta_i) \cong \left(\prod_{i \in c^{-1}(j)} \Sigma_i \right) \times \left(\prod_{i \in c^{-1}(j)} \Theta_i \right),$$

and it sends the singleton owner family to the singleton owner family.

(3) **Monoidal comparison: second comparison.** These maps supply the compositor and unitor of the induced pseudofunctor. Their coherence is Cartesian-product coherence. Since composition and tensor of realized interactions are evaluated after flattening the same parameter tuple, the required realization equations are respectively associativity and interchange in $\mathcal{C}$. The same strong-monoidal maps give compatibility with tensor and symmetry.

(4) **Ownerwise alternatives.** For the deviation statement, forgetting the new j-coordinate from $\prod_{k \in J} (c_* \Sigma)_k$ forgets, after κ_Σ, precisely the old coordinates indexed by $c^{-1}(j)$. The two forgetful maps therefore commute up to the canonical bijections, and their kernel pairs are canonically isomorphic. For an empty block both relations are the diagonal, since its policy carrier is 1. This yields $D_j^{c_*G} \cong D^G_{c^{-1}(j)}$.

(5) **Iterated right Kan extension.** Finally, the component at $k \in K$ of $d_* c_* \Sigma$ is

$$\prod_{j \in d^{-1}(k)} \prod_{i \in c^{-1}(j)} \Sigma_i,$$

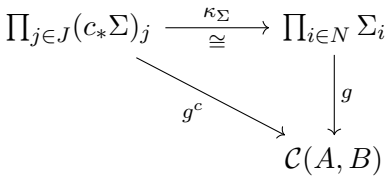
canonically isomorphic to

$$\prod_{i \in (d \circ c)^{-1}(k)} \Sigma_i = ((d \circ c)_* \Sigma)_k.$$

These reassociations are natural and satisfy the pseudofunctorial coherence because every composite is the same flattening of the same owner-indexed tuple.

□

Flattening preserves realized arrows while identifying a regrouped owner with its original coalition.



Regrouping gives the coalition authority to change a block of policies. To rank the changes, it still needs a collective comparison, such as a welfare order or a Pareto rule. Delegation poses a further question. Which subordinate decisions actually implement the parent's choice?

4.3 Delegation and substitution of agent interfaces

Regrouping reallocates control over existing coordinates; delegation must additionally say how subordinate policies implement each parent choice. The implementation maps therefore precede any comparison of preferences. This follows the separation of agency from selection in Capucci et al. (2022b) and makes the distinction from Cartesian frame subagents explicit (Garrabrant, Herrmann, and Lopez-Wild, 2021). The main issue is which parent alternatives remain available after the subordinate implementation is fixed.

Construction 4.8 (Substitution of controlled policies)**.**

(1) **Specify the implementation maps.** Let $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$ have finite owner set N. A delegation presentation consists of a finite set J, a map $c : J \to N$, subordinate policy carriers Θ_j, and maps

$$h_i : \prod_{j\in c^{-1}(i)} \Theta_j \longrightarrow \Sigma_i.$$

Write $\Theta = \prod_{j\in J} \Theta_j$. An empty block has carrier 1; its specified map $h_i : 1 \to \Sigma_i$ implements a fixed parent policy. No additional policy is selected.

(2) **Compose the controlled realizations.** Regrouping and the product of the h_i give $h : \Theta \to \Sigma$. The substituted process

$$G[h] = (\vec{\Theta}, gh) : A \to B$$

is owned by J.

(3) **Pull back the legal domain.** If $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ is the legal domain, its substituted legal domain is $L_h = h^{-1}(L)$. The construction retains the implementation maps h_i: an unimplemented parent policy is not silently made available to the delegates.

Theorem 4.9 (Associative delegation and compatibility with composition)**.** *For $d : K \to J$ and $k_j : \prod_{\ell\in d^{-1}(j)} \Xi_\ell \to \Theta_j$, define*

$$(h \star k)_i = h_i \circ \left(\prod_{j\in c^{-1}(i)} k_j \right) \circ \kappa_i,$$

where κ_i groups the Ξ-coordinates over $(cd)^{-1}(i)$ by their intermediate owner j. Then

$$(G[h])[k] \cong G[h \star k], \qquad (L_h)_k = L_{h\star k}.$$

Identity implementation maps are units, and three successive substitutions agree under the canonical product reassociations.

Suppose also that $H : B \to C$ has owner set N, and that $r_i : \prod_{j \in c^{-1}(i)} \Lambda_j \to \Sigma_i^H$ implements its policies using the same owner map c. Define $h \boxtimes r$ at owner i by the canonical map

$$\prod_{j \in c^{-1}(i)} (\Theta_j \times \Lambda_j) \longrightarrow \left(\prod_{j \in c^{-1}(i)} \Theta_j \right) \times \left(\prod_{j \in c^{-1}(i)} \Lambda_j \right) \xrightarrow{h_i \times r_i} \Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H.$$

There are canonical realization-preserving comparisons

$$(H \circ G)[h \boxtimes r] \cong H[r] \circ G[h].$$

The same assertion holds for tensor whenever the boundaries are those of a tensor product. In particular, delegation respects the complete-policy composition law without identifying the subordinate owners.

Proof.

(1) **Monoidal comparison.** On a subordinate tuple ξ, the ith parent coordinate of either iterated implementation is $h_i((k_j((\xi_\ell)_{\ell \in d^{-1}(j)}))_{j \in c^{-1}(i)})$. Thus the realizations agree after the displayed product bijection. Inverse images compose, giving the legal-domain equality.

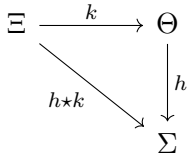
(2) **Monoidal comparison: second comparison.** For three levels, both bracketings evaluate the same nested coordinate functions; the product reassociations are coherent because they have identical coordinate projections. Identity maps leave every coordinate unchanged.

(3) **Composition.** For sequential composition, both sides have, after rearrangement, the J-indexed carrier $(\Theta_j \times \Lambda_j)_j$. Their value at (θ, λ) is $r_H(\lambda) \circ r_G(\theta)$, where $r_G = gh$ and r_H is the realization of H composed with r. For tensor the common value is $r_G(\theta) \otimes r_H(\lambda)$.

(4) **Witness and legality comparison.** The comparison maps are products of coordinate rearrangements, so preserve realizations, identities, and the associativity and symmetry comparisons. If legal domains on a composite are specified by an additional comprehension, pulling that comprehension back through either equal implementation map gives the same legal domain. No independence of that additional rule is required.

□

Associative delegation expresses equality of the iterated implementation maps.



Lemma 4.10 (Ownerwise lifting of legal alternatives)**.** *Let $r_i : T_i \twoheadrightarrow S_i$ be surjections over a finite owner set N, put $r = \prod_i r_i$, and let $L \hookrightarrow S = \prod_i S_i$ be any legal domain. With $K = r^{-1}(L)$, for every coalition $C \subseteq N$ the canonical map over K*

$$\lambda_C : D_C^K \longrightarrow K \times_{L, p_1} D_C^L, \qquad (x, x') \longmapsto (x, (r(x), r(x')))$$

is surjective. For any $g : S \to H$, it preserves both realized endpoints under the factorized realization $g \circ r$. Writing $g_L = g|_L : L \to H$ and $(gr)_K = (gr)|_K : K \to H$, and setting $\delta_C^{g,L} = (g_L p_1, g_L p_2)$ and $\delta_C^{gr,K} = ((gr)_K p_1, (gr)_K p_2)$, for every comparison $Q \hookrightarrow H^2$ one consequently has an equality of predicates on K:

$$r|_K^* \exists_{p_1 : D_C^L \to L} (\delta_C^{g,L})^* Q = \exists_{p_1 : D_C^K \to K} (\delta_C^{gr,K})^* Q. \tag{4.7}$$

Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** A point of the target is $x \in K$ and $y \in L$ agreeing with $r(x)$ outside C. Keep $x'_i = x_i$ for $i \notin C$. For each $i \in C$, surjectivity of r_i provides $x'_i \in T_i$ with $r_i(x'_i) = y_i$.

(2) **Witness and legality comparison.** The finitely many coordinate witnesses assemble to $x' \in T$. Then $r(x') = y \in L$, so $x' \in K$, and x' agrees with x outside C. Hence $(x, x') \in D_C^K$ maps to $(x, (r(x), y))$.

(3) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The case $C = \varnothing$ uses $x' = x$, including empty owner lists. Both endpoints are preserved because the delegated realization is $g \circ r$ by construction. To prove (4.7), fix $x \in K$.

(4) **Witness and legality comparison.** The predicate on the right has a witness x' exactly when $x D_C^K x'$ and $Q(grx, grx')$. Such a witness maps through λ_C to the target alternative (rx, rx'), giving the left predicate.

(5) **Reverse implication.** Conversely a witness $y \in L$ for the left predicate is a target point $(x, (rx, y))$ of λ_C; the explicit coordinate construction above lifts it to x' at that *same* reference x. The two realized endpoints agree, so $Q(grx, grx')$ holds. This gives equality of the existential predicates; applying negation and intersecting the specified coalitional tests gives exact stability transport.

□

Starting from the given subordinate profile, the lift realizes the proposed legal parent alternative with every outsider block fixed.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D_C^K & \xrightarrow{\lambda_C} & K \times_L D_C^L \\ {\scriptstyle p_1}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_1} \\ K & = & K \end{array}$$

Theorem 4.11 (Exact strategic comparison with implemented parent policies)**.** *For the preceding delegation, put $T_i = \mathrm{im}(h_i)$, $T = \prod_i T_i$, and $L_T = L \cap T$. Restrict the parent process to T and regroup the subordinate process by c. Write $\Theta^c = \prod_{i \in N} \prod_{j \in c^{-1}(i)} \Theta_j$ for the regrouped profile carrier, identified with Θ by flattening. The induced map*

$$\bar{h} : \Theta^c \longrightarrow T$$

is ownerwise surjective and takes L_h onto L_T. For every coalition $I \subseteq N$, every $\theta \in L_h$, and every $t' \in L_T$ agreeing with $\bar{h}(\theta)$ outside I, there is $\theta' \in L_h$ agreeing with θ outside the blocks indexed by I and satisfying $\bar{h}(\theta') = t'$. Realizations of both the reference and the alternative are preserved.

Consequently, writing $\bar{h}_L : L_h \twoheadrightarrow L_T$ for its legal restriction and pulling the same parent comparisons back through realization,

$$\mathsf{NE}_{c_* G[h],\, L_h} = \bar{h}_L^* \mathsf{NE}_{G|_T,\, L_T}.$$

The same equality holds for stability against any specified family of parent coalitions, using the corresponding whole blocks of delegates and the same coalition comparisons.

Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** Corestricting each implementation map h_i to its image T_i produces an ownerwise surjection $\bar{h} : \Theta^c \twoheadrightarrow T$. Its inverse-image legal domain is exactly $L_h = \bar{h}^{-1}(L_T)$. Lemma 4.10 now gives the required lift of every legal I-alternative, keeping the entire outsider blocks fixed and preserving both concurrent realizations.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, every legal subordinate block deviation maps to a legal parent deviation. Thus an improving deviation exists at a subordinate reference if and only if one exists at its implemented parent reference. Universal negation over singleton parent owners proves the displayed Nash equality; the same comparison for each designated coalition proves the final stability statement.

□

The image factorization retains the exact implemented parent policies.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L_h & \xrightarrow{\bar{h}_L} & L_T \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \Theta^c & \xrightarrow{\bar{h}} & T \end{array}$$

The image factorization answers that issue even when the delegation maps h_i are not surjective onto the original parent carriers: every implemented parent alternative has a subordinate lift with the outsider blocks fixed. Collective authority is nevertheless distinct from a collective preference. If delegates share their parent's comparison, whole-block stability implies individual stability, but not conversely. For two delegate bits $x, y \in \{0, 1\}$, with $h(x, y) = (x, y)$ and common value xy, the profile $(0, 0)$ has no profitable isolated change, while the block improves to $(1, 1)$. Thus exact parent comparison requires whole-block deviations.

Proposition 4.12 (The Cartesian frame underlying a control interface)**.** *On an unrestricted profile carrier, every coalition C determines the Cartesian frame*

$$\mathsf{Frame}_C(G) = \left(\Sigma_C, \Sigma_{-C}, (a, e) \longmapsto g_{(a,e)}\right)$$

with outcome set $\mathcal{C}(A, B)$. If $C \subseteq D$, write $X = \Sigma_C$, $Y = \Sigma_{D \setminus C}$, and $Z = \Sigma_{-D}$. The two frames have the form

$$(X, Y \times Z, p), \qquad (X \times Y, Z, p)$$

for the same three-variable outcome function. Thus their relation is exactly the multiplicative redistribution of control and environment used in Cartesian frames. Restricting the controlled carrier to $K \subseteq \Sigma_C$ instead gives the corresponding additive restriction.

Proof.

(1) **Policy-level comparison.** Reassociate the profile product as $X \times Y \times Z$. For C, the Y-coordinates belong to the environment; for D, they belong to the controlled coordinates. Both evaluation maps are the same g after this reassociation. Restricting the first coordinate of the evaluation to K gives its additive restriction.

□

A permission rule may couple a coalition's decisions to an outsider's choice. The available actions then form a family $S_C^L(e)$ indexed by that choice. This is where the comparison with a rectangular Cartesian frame reaches its limit. A Chu-style map also reverses the environment coordinate, whereas an owned map here preserves a specified implementation. To pass from joint control to a corporate judgement or commitment requires the corresponding aggregation or update data, as in List and Pettit (2011).

Legal comprehension turns this distinction into a dependent interface and supplies the legal context (L, m). For $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, the kernel pair of the outsider map gives $D_C^L = L \times_{L_{-C}} L$; its two legs select a legal reference and a legal alternative term in $\Delta_G L$. The following dependent choice spaces are the fibres of that span, so coupled legal opportunities are not replaced by unrestricted products.

4.4 Displayed coalition and delegation operations

4.4.1 Counterfactual alternatives in agent syntax

For $C \subseteq N$, the unrestricted deviation is $D_C = \Sigma \times_{\Sigma_{-C}} \Sigma$, as constructed in Construction 4.1 and Theorem 4.3. On a legal domain $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, its actual alternatives are instead

$$D_C^L = L \times_{\Sigma_{-C}} L. \tag{4.8}$$

Their paired realization is $(a[\sigma], a[\tau])$. The coordinate comparison in Theorem 4.3 gives $D_C^{\vec{\Sigma} \times \vec{T}} \cong D_C^{\vec{\Sigma}} \times D_C^{\vec{T}}$, including the sequential and parallel agent presentations. Likewise Proposition 4.5 proves $D_C ; D_D = D_{C \cup D}$ on the unrestricted profile product. For legal carriers the intermediate profile of that proof need not be legal; legal relations compose by their actual pullback and image, not by replacing them with unrestricted products.

Construction 4.13 (Displayed regrouping and delegation)**.**

(1) **Transport regrouping.** Under Theorem 2.19, a finite owner map $c : N \to J$ acts by the right Kan extension of Theorem 4.7. Its execution is

$$(c_* a)[\theta](x) = a[\kappa_{\vec{\Sigma}}(\theta)](x).$$

Thus $d_* c_* a \cong (dc)_* a$ and $D_j^{c_* a} \cong D^a_{c^{-1}(j)}$, compatibly with sequential and parallel composition. The underlying linear types are canonically isomorphic; the displayed owner interface changes.

(2) **Transport implementation.** For $c : J \to N$ and $h_i : \prod_{cj=i} \Theta_j \to \Sigma_i$, the delegated agent $a[h]$ executes $a[h(\theta)]$ on legal carrier $h^{-1}L$. The comparisons of Theorem 4.9 give $(a[h])[k] \cong a[h \star k]$, compatibility with both compositions, and $(h \star k)^{-1} L = k^{-1}(h^{-1} L)$.

(3) **Restrict alternatives.** The owned-presentation comparison retains the policy projections. Their kernel-pair isomorphisms therefore restrict along the transported legal inclusion, giving the same comparisons for legal deviations.

The kernel-pair comparison preserves the deviations controlled by each regrouped owner.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D_j^{c_* a} & \xrightarrow{\cong} & D^a_{c^{-1}(j)} \\ {\scriptstyle p_2}\downarrow\downarrow{\scriptstyle p_1} & & {\scriptstyle p_2}\downarrow\downarrow{\scriptstyle p_1} \\ \Sigma^{c_* a} & \xrightarrow[\cong]{\kappa_\Sigma} & \Sigma^a \end{array}$$

A coalition C is represented by the partition with block C and singleton outsiders. The empty coalition has unit policy carrier and identity alternatives. Overlapping coalitions are represented by their different projections $\Sigma \to \Sigma_{-C}$; they need not be blocks of a single partition. Thus the calculus retains both nested collective agents and overlapping coalitional tests.

Regrouping determines joint control. Collective observation is constructed in Sections 6.5.4 and 9.3; collective evaluation is constructed in Section 5.8. The original owner list and regrouping map remain displayed, so members' separate observations and comparisons are not lost.

Theorem 4.14 (Exact implemented alternatives)**.** *Put $T_i = \mathrm{im}(h_i)$, $T = \prod_i T_i$, and $L_T = L \cap T$. The regrouped delegated legal carrier maps onto L_T. Every legal parent alternative in a coalition $C \subseteq N$ lifts to a change of exactly the subordinate blocks over C, with all other subordinate coordinates fixed.*

Proof.

(1) **Transport the implemented image.** Apply Theorem 4.11 through the owned-presentation isomorphism of Theorem 2.19. Its source-fixed lift in Lemma 4.10 retains every outsider block and covers exactly L_T.

□

Example 4.15 (Delegated choices and collective authority)**.** Two delegates choose bits x, y, with common outcome value xy. At $(0, 0)$ neither isolated delegate has a strictly improving change, but the whole block can change to $(1, 1)$. Consequently the exact strategic comparison in Theorem 4.14 is between parent coalitions and whole delegate blocks. The distinction is produced by the explicit projections defining alternatives.

5 Contextual Evaluation and Strategic Equilibrium

Control specifies the alternatives an owner can make. Evaluation must compare those alternatives in the interaction where they are used. We construct this comparison by pulling a predicate on realizations back to complete policies, then quantify over controlled alternatives to obtain selection, best response, and equilibrium. This specializes the selection interface of categorical cybernetics (Capucci et al., 2022a) and recovers pure Nash equilibrium in the finite normal-form case.

Here *feedback* is backward transport of evaluation. A signal reaching a controller has a separate operational realization. This distinction lets the theory evaluate a measured execution even when its charge is not observed by the owner. Once a comparison descends to policies, it can test their legal alternatives while the presentation retains execution witnesses.

5.1 Presentations, state contexts, and assertions

A policy specifies what to do. A reference state specifies the circumstances in which we evaluate that policy and may carry a history or an observation. The fibration below lets us change the reference and pull back assertions. It keeps the owner's policies available for the counterfactual comparison that defines coplay.

Definition 5.1 (Economic state contexts)**.** A state context $s : W \to \Sigma^G$ is a family of reference profiles indexed by W.

Its points need not be policies themselves: an epistemic world may also carry information about which other worlds an agent considers possible. Several points of W may consequently have the same profile. A predicate on W asks a question at those references, while the full policy space still supplies alternatives. This use of state is distinct from a monoidal state $I \to A$.

Definition 5.2 (The tower over a concurrent interface)**.** Put $\mathcal{A}_{A,B} = \mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})(A,B)$. The profile functor $U_{A,B} : \mathcal{A}_{A,B} \to \mathbf{Set}$ sends G to Σ^G and an ownerwise reparametrisation r to $\bar{r} = \Pi_N r$. The category $\mathsf{St}_{A,B}$ has objects $(G, s : W \to \Sigma^G)$ and arrows

$$(r,u) : (G, s : W \to \Sigma^G) \longrightarrow (H, t : V \to \Sigma^H), \qquad tu = \bar{r}s.$$

An object of $\mathsf{Assn}_{A,B}$ additionally carries a predicate $P \hookrightarrow W$. An arrow over (r,u) from P to Q exists exactly when $P \leq u^*Q$, and is then unique over that arrow. Here $\mathsf{Pred}(W) = \mathrm{Sub}_{\mathbf{Set}}(W)$ and $u^*Q = u^{-1}(Q)$. Composition uses composition of the two displayed maps and functoriality of inverse image. The projections form the tower

$$\mathsf{Assn}_{A,B} \xrightarrow{\ p\ } \mathsf{St}_{A,B} \xrightarrow{\ q\ } \mathcal{A}_{A,B} \xrightarrow{\ \pi\ } \mathbf{Par}_N.$$

The category $\mathsf{St}(G) = q^{-1}(G)$ is the category of **state contexts** of G. Its objects retain their reference map to the full policy space.

Theorem 5.3 (Cartesian lifts and the logical fibres)**.** *All three projections in Definition 5.2 are fibrations. There are canonical identifications*

$$\mathsf{St}(G) = \mathbf{Set}/\Sigma^G, \qquad p^{-1}(G, s : W \to \Sigma^G) = \mathsf{Pred}(W).$$

More precisely, p is a posetal *fibration, obtained by change of base of the subobject fibration along the domain functor $\mathsf{St}_{A,B} \to \mathbf{Set}$; q is the change of base of the codomain fibration along $U_{A,B}$; and π is a* discrete *fibration, as the category-of-elements projection of the presheaf $F_{A,B}$.*

Proof.

(1) **Lifting through the comparison.** For π, lifting an owner map $r : \vec{\Theta} \to \vec{\Sigma}$ at g gives $(\vec{\Theta}, g\Pi_N r)$, and the factorization equation is unique. This is the category-of-elements construction of Theorem 3.7.

(2) **Lifting along the surjection: second comparison.** For q, lift $t : V \to \Sigma^H$ along $r : G \to H$ by the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma^G \times_{\Sigma^H} V & \xrightarrow{\ a\ } & V \\ {\scriptstyle s}\downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle t} \\ \Sigma^G & \xrightarrow[\ \bar{r}\ ]{} & \Sigma^H. \end{array}$$

If $(r\ell, v) : (K, z) \to (H, t)$ lies over $r\ell$, its unique factorization through this square sends w to $(\bar{\ell}z(w), v(w))$.

(3) **Cartesian lifting of assertion predicates.** This proves cartesianness. Finally the lift of $Q \hookrightarrow V$ along (r,u) is $u^*Q \hookrightarrow W$. A factorization into it exists exactly when its predicate is below the inverse image of u^*Q; functoriality of inverse image gives precisely the required condition. The two change-of-base descriptions and the fibre identifications follow from the definitions.

□

The state-context fibration is obtained by changing base along the policy projection.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma^G \times_{\Sigma^H} V & \longrightarrow & V \\ \downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow t \\ \Sigma^G & \xrightarrow[\bar{r}]{} & \Sigma^H \end{array}$$

Construction 5.4 (Indexed presentation and constant types)**.**

(1) **Index the state presentation.** Write $\mathsf{P}_G : \mathsf{St}(G)^{\mathrm{op}} \to \mathbf{Pos}$ for the indexed predicate assignment $(W, s) \mapsto \mathsf{Pred}(W)$. The terminal context is $1_G = (\Sigma^G \xrightarrow{\mathrm{id}} \Sigma^G)$.

(2) **Interpret constants and their tests.** For an ordinary set X, its constant type is

$$\Delta_G X = (\Sigma^G \times X \xrightarrow{\pi_1} \Sigma^G).$$

For $s : W \to \Sigma^G$, a term $a : W \to X$ is represented by $(s, a) : (W, s) \to \Delta_G X$. A predicate $Q \hookrightarrow X$ is represented by $\Delta_G Q = \Sigma^G \times Q \hookrightarrow \Sigma^G \times X$. Consequently

$$(s, a)^* \Delta_G Q = a^* Q. \tag{5.1}$$

(3) **Represent play and ownership.** In particular play is the section $\widehat{g} = (\mathrm{id}, g) : 1_G \to \Delta_G \mathcal{C}(A, B)$. Each owner projection likewise gives a section of $\Delta_G \Sigma_i^G$.

Proposition 5.5 (Change of game and constant types)**.** *A reparametrisation $r : G \to H$ induces pullback $\bar{r}^* : \mathsf{St}(H) \to \mathsf{St}(G)$ and, on each predicate, inverse image along the top map of its cartesian lift. There are natural isomorphisms*

$$\bar{r}^* \Delta_H X \cong \Delta_G X, \qquad \overline{tr}^* \cong \bar{r}^* \bar{t}^*.$$

They satisfy the identity and associativity coherence equations. Under the first isomorphism the pullback of $\widehat{h}$ is $\widehat{g}$.

Proof.

(1) **Pullback comparison isomorphisms.** The first map sends $(\sigma, (\bar{r}\sigma, x))$ to (σ, x). The second forgets the repeated intermediate coordinate in an iterated pullback. Their inverses insert the displayed coordinates.

(2) **Coherence.** Every coherence composite therefore inserts or deletes the same coordinates. The final assertion is the realization equation $g = h\bar{r}$. Equivalently, represent a context as its family of fibres (W_σ); reindexing is $(W_\eta) \mapsto (W_{\bar{r}\sigma})$, with strict substitution.

(3) **Equivalence with split families.** Passing between this split presentation and slices uses the canonical bijection $W \cong \coprod_\sigma W_\sigma$.

□

Construction 5.6 (Dependent fibres over state contexts)**.**

(1) **Pull back the two fibres.** Pull back the indexed categories T and L along $\mathrm{Dom} : \mathsf{St}_{A,B} \to \mathbf{Set}$, which sends (G, W, s) to W and (r, u) to u. Their fibres are $\mathsf{T}(W) \simeq \mathbf{Set}/W$ and $\mathsf{L}(W)$, with reindexing u^*.

(2) **Construct the fibrations.** Their Grothendieck constructions are fibrations: the cartesian arrow above u is the identity $u^*E \to u^*E$ in the source fibre, and every factorization is forced by composition of index maps. The comparison, comprehension, and adjunction maps of Theorem 1.50 pull back to these fibrations. The original $\mathcal{C}_W$ is their constant representable linear fragment, by Proposition 1.40.

The original assertion fibre is recovered as $\mathsf{Pred}(W) = \mathrm{Sub}_{\mathsf{T}(W)}(1)$: a subterminal family has a singleton or empty fibre at each state. These are the ordinary subobject structures of Jacobs (1999, Chapters 1, 4, and 10), now situated inside the constructed dependent linear–nonlinear model. For the original boundary, the realization section is equivalently a section of $\mathsf{Val}_W[yA, yB]_D$, since this family is constant with value $\mathcal{C}(A, B)$.

5.2 Predicate feedback, canonical lenses, and coplay

A forward map already determines how to carry a test backward by taking its inverse image. Power objects represent this operation by the canonical lens used here for *coplay*. Its forward value can be an entire concurrent strategy. Its backward value compares alternatives. This gives the particular continuation semantics used here, within the broader account of Capucci (2023).

Definition 5.7 (Play, predicate feedback, and canonical coplay)**.** For a forward realization $f : X \to Y$, a **predicate continuation** is $Q \in \mathsf{Pred}(Y)$. The subobject fibration supplies its **predicate feedback** by reindexing. The **canonical coplay** of the induced lens is this same map:

$$\mathsf{coplay}_f = f^* : \mathsf{Pred}(Y) \longrightarrow \mathsf{Pred}(X), \qquad Q \longmapsto f^{-1}(Q).$$

A numerical or other V-valued continuation has type $k : Y \to V$, and its backward transport has type $f_V^- : V^Y \to V^X$, $k \mapsto kf$. For a comparison predicate $P \hookrightarrow Y^2$, its transported comparison is $(f \times f)^* P \hookrightarrow X^2$. These are the backward components of the canonical lenses constructed below. Play returns a result; coplay tests which alternatives produce desired results, and does not execute a physical protocol backwards.

For example, let X encode keeping or exchanging a resource and let f return the resulting bundle. Pulling back the goal of possessing a specified resource selects exactly the choices achieving it. The calculation evaluates forward possibilities; it does not run the protocol backwards.

Definition 5.8 (Lenses and comparison interfaces)**.** Write $\mathsf{Pred}(X) = \mathrm{Sub}_{\mathbf{Set}}(X)$. A lens $(X, S) \to (Y, R)$ is a pair of maps $f : X \to Y$ and $f^- : X \times R \to S$. Its composite with $(h, h^-) : (Y, R) \to (Z, T)$ is

$$(hf,\ (x, t) \longmapsto f^-(x, h^-(f(x), t))).$$

The identity has backward map $(x, s) \mapsto s$. The tensor is the componentwise product of forward and backward maps, with unit $(1, 1)$. These operations define $\mathsf{Lens}(\mathbf{Set})$. The **comparison interface** on X is

$$\mathbb{L}(X) = (X, \mathsf{Pred}(X)).$$

A comparison $P \hookrightarrow X \times X$ is represented by the costate $q_P : X \to \mathsf{Pred}(X)$, where $q_P(x) = \{x' : P(x, x')\}$. Thus its backward output at a reference x is the predicate of alternatives compared favorably with that reference.

Definition 5.9 (Lens states and comparison costates)**.** A lens state is an arrow $(1, 1) \to \mathbb{L}(X)$, hence an element $x \in X$. A lens costate is an arrow $\mathbb{L}(X) \to (1, 1)$, hence a map $q : X \to \mathsf{Pred}(X)$. The two arguments of $q(x)(x')$ have distinct roles: x is the reference and x' is its candidate alternative.

To test improvement one must know both the reference outcome and the proposed replacement. The costate on X retains this pair, so it can distinguish two changes that start from the same acceptable outcome.

Construction 5.10 (Canonical relational and numerical feedback)**.**

(1) **Pull back a predicate.** The cartesian lift of $Q \hookrightarrow Y$ along $f : X \to Y$ is $f^*Q \hookrightarrow X$. Using the membership predicates of the power objects to represent this operation, define

$$\mathbb{L}(f) = (f, f^-), \qquad f^-(x, Q) = f^*Q.$$

(2) **Pull back a value map.** For a value object V, put $\mathbb{L}_V(X) = (X, V^X)$ and define $\mathbb{L}_V(f)$ with backward map $(x, k) \mapsto kf$. Numerical values, their differences, and arbitrary comparison predicates can consequently be transported along the same forward map. A value presentation consists of the actual map $k : X \to V$ and its comparison relation; the numerical map remains part of the evaluation data.

Theorem 5.11 (Functorial feedback and comparison costates)**.** *The assignments* $\mathbb{L}$ *and* $\mathbb{L}_V$ *are faithful functors from* **Set** *to* $\mathsf{Lens}(\mathbf{Set})$*. Transporting a comparison costate along* $\mathbb{L}(f)$ *gives*

$$(\mathbb{L}(f)^* q_P)(x)(x') \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad P(f(x), f(x')), \tag{5.2}$$

so its uncurried comparison is $(f \times f)^* P$*.*

Proof.

(1) **Functoriality of predicate feedback.** For $f : X \to Y$ and $h : Y \to Z$, the composite backward map sends Q to $f^*(h^*Q) = (hf)^*Q$; identities give identity pullback. For numerical continuation interfaces the same calculation is $(kh)f = k(hf)$. The forward component recovers the original map, which proves faithfulness.

(2) **Pullback of comparison costates.** A costate of $(Y, \mathsf{Pred}(Y))$ sends the reference $f(x)$ to $q_P(f(x))$. Pullback along f then tests $P(f(x), f(x'))$, proving the displayed equivalence.

□

The canonical coplay is functorial under composition of forward realizations.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{Pred}(Z) & \xrightarrow{h^*} & \mathsf{Pred}(Y) \\ & {\scriptstyle (hf)^*} \searrow & \downarrow {\scriptstyle f^*} \\ & & \mathsf{Pred}(X) \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X \times X & \xrightarrow{f \times f} & Y \times Y \\ {\scriptstyle (x,x') \mapsto P(fx, fx')} \downarrow & & \downarrow {\scriptstyle P} \\ \mathsf{Pred}(1) & = & \mathsf{Pred}(1) \end{array}$$

Here a predicate is displayed as a truth-value map only to draw its classification square; all subsequent constructions use subobjects and pullback, as developed in Section 5.5.

The forward carriers used below are hom-sets $H_{A,B} = \mathcal{C}(A, B)$. Therefore a value of the play map is the entire concurrent strategy of Section 1.1. Applying $\mathbb{L}$ to an ordinary map into such a hom-set constructs feedback on that strategy; the linear interaction ports are still the original objects A, B. For families $u, v : \Gamma \to H_{A,B}$, write $\mathrm{Test}_P(u, v) = \langle u, v \rangle^* P$. Section 5.5 derives the logical structure of this testing operation.

Applied to the realization $g : \Sigma^G \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$, this construction equips the arena with $\mathbb{L}(g)$ and backward map $g^-(\sigma, Q) = g^*Q$. The same operation is substitution along $\widehat{g}$ into a

constant predicate type in its state doctrine. The equation $g = h\bar{r}$ for a reparametrisation therefore gives both the forward equation and $\mathbb{L}(g) = \mathbb{L}(h)\mathbb{L}(\bar{r})$.

When an operation incurs a charge, its continuation receives that charge along with the output. Pulling back an evaluator must therefore account for the cost already incurred before it compares what could happen next. The writer extension below gives precisely this backward action under sequential composition.

Proposition 5.12 (Feedback for a measured operation)**.** *For $f : X \to T_C Y$, define $f_C^\sharp(e) = ef^\dagger$ on evaluators $e : T_C Y \to V$, and act on paired comparison predicates by inverse image along $f^\dagger \times f^\dagger$. For $g : Y \to T_C Z$ and $h = g^\dagger f$, one has $h_C^\sharp = f_C^\sharp g_C^\sharp$ and $(\eta^T)_C^\sharp = 1$.*

Proof.

(1) **Compute the continuation.** If $f(x) = (d, y)$ then $f_C^\sharp(e)(c, x) = e(c + d, y)$. A further operation $g(y) = (b, z)$ gives $e((c + d) + b, z) = e(c + (d + b), z)$; the unit inserts zero.

(2) **Transport comparisons.** Both legs of each paired test compose by the same extension law. Apply Theorem 5.11 to the ordinary functions $f^\dagger, g^\dagger$ on the measured carriers. For a witness-indexed game the forward measured term is defined on its witness carrier; pull the test back along that term before taking any profile image.

□

5.3 Observable outcomes

Proposition 5.13 (Economic closure retains an outcome interface)**.** *$\mathcal{C}(I, I)$ is a singleton. Therefore an evaluation depending only on a fully hidden operational scalar is constant.*

Proof.

(1) **Constancy of scalar evaluation.** This is the scalar calculation in Lemma 1.35. Any function on that singleton is constant.

□

Definition 5.14 (Economically closed realization)**.** An economically closed realization has type $I \to O$, with O a retained outcome interface. Economic closure supplies the decision inputs; it does not hide O before evaluation.

5.4 The category of operational contexts

Definition 5.15 (Operational contexts, comparison contexts, and environments)**.** An **operational context** from (A, B) to (A', B') is an allowed wiring-induced function

$$T : \mathcal{C}(A, B) \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A', B'), \qquad T \in \mathsf{Ctx}(\mathcal{C})((A, B), (A', B')),$$

where the generators of $\mathsf{Ctx}(\mathcal{C})$ are defined below. A **comparison context** at (A', B') is a tuple $P \in \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A', B')$ of predicates on pairs of interactions. An **environment** for (A, B) is a typed pair (T, P); its induced comparison has type $T^\sharp P \in \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A, B)$, with

$$(T^\sharp P)_i = (T \times T)^* P_i.$$

A value-presented environment in particular may give $a : I \to A$, $b : B \to O$, value maps $u_i : \mathcal{C}(I, O) \to V_i$, and $\prec_i \hookrightarrow V_i^2$. It induces

$$k_i : \mathcal{C}(A, B) \to V_i, \qquad k_i(f) = u_i(bfa), \qquad (k_i \times k_i)^* \prec_i \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A, B)^2.$$

A **state context** $s : W \to \Sigma^G$ instead indexes reference profiles; it is distinct from these operational and comparison contexts.

Definition 5.16 (Operational context)**.** An interface pair is an ordered pair (A, B) of objects of $\mathcal{C}$. The category $\mathsf{Ctx}(\mathcal{C})$ has interface pairs as objects. Its arrows $(A, B) \to (A', B')$ are functions

$$T : \mathcal{C}(A, B) \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A', B')$$

generated under composition by identities, whiskering $f \mapsto bfa$ for $a : A' \to A$, $b : B \to B'$, and tensor insertion $f \mapsto f \otimes r$ or $f \mapsto r \otimes f$ for a fixed arrow r. Generated functions are identified when they are equal. A parameterized context is an ordinary family of such functions.

Construction 5.17 (Backward action on tests)**.**

(1) **Form the comparison space.** Put

$$\mathsf{Cmp}_N(A, B) = \prod_{i \in N} \mathsf{Pred}(\mathcal{C}(A, B)^2).$$

(2) **Transport the tests.** For a context T, define

$$T^\sharp : \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A', B') \to \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A, B), \qquad (T^\sharp P)_i = (T \times T)^* P_i.$$

(3) **Transport the values.** For value maps $k_i : \mathcal{C}(A', B') \to V_i$, the corresponding action is $k_i \mapsto k_i T$.

Theorem 5.18 (Contextual evaluation and coherence)**.** Cmp_N *with this action is a contravariant functor* $\mathsf{Ctx}(\mathcal{C})^{\mathrm{op}} \to \mathbf{Pos}$*. It preserves the pointwise predicate operations under reindexing, and*

$$\mathrm{Test}_{T^\sharp P}(u, v) = \mathrm{Test}_P(Tu, Tv)$$

for families $u, v : \Gamma \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$*. The action respects every equation between operational contexts.*

Proof.

(1) **Composition of contextual predicate pullback.** The costate action is the comparison part of the canonical lens functor in Theorem 5.11. In particular, for contexts T, U, $((UT) \times (UT))^* = (T \times T)^*(U \times U)^*$. Testing follows by the same pullback identity: $\langle u, v \rangle^* (T \times T)^* P = \langle Tu, Tv \rangle^* P$.

(2) **Functoriality and substitution.** All context equations are equalities of the generated functions, so their backward actions agree by this functoriality.

□

The external test and its contextual pullback coincide.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Gamma & \xrightarrow{\langle u,v \rangle} & \mathcal{C}(A,B)^2 \\ \| & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle T \times T} \\ \Gamma & \xrightarrow[\langle Tu,Tv \rangle]{} & \mathcal{C}(A',B')^2 \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Gamma & \xrightarrow{(u,v)} & \mathcal{C}(A,B)^2 \\ & {\scriptstyle (Tu,Tv)} \searrow & \downarrow{\scriptstyle T \times T} \\ & & \mathcal{C}(A',B')^2 \end{array} \qquad \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A,B) \xleftarrow{T^\sharp} \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A',B') \xleftarrow{U^\sharp} \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A'',B'') \quad \text{with } (UT)^\sharp \text{ over the top}$$

Construction 5.19 (Evaluation supplied by an environment)**.**

(1) **Close an interaction in its environment.** For $a : I \to A$, $b : B \to O$, and $u_i : \mathcal{C}(I, O) \to V_i$, define

$$k_i(f) = u_i(bfa).$$

More generally a comparison context is an element $P \in \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A, B)$; it need not have a numerical representation. If $\prec_i \subseteq V_i^2$, define $P_i = (k_i \times k_i)^* \prec_i$.

(2) **Specialize the comparison to each component.** For open arenas $G : A \to B$ and $H : B \to C$, the contexts obtained by fixing $\tau \in \Sigma^H$ or $\sigma \in \Sigma^G$ are

$$T_\tau(f) = h_\tau f, \qquad S_\sigma(h) = h g_\sigma.$$

Write $P^{G|\tau} = T_\tau^\sharp P$ and $P^{H|\sigma} = S_\sigma^\sharp P$.

Proposition 5.20 (Context action for sequential and parallel composition)**.** *For fixed $h : B \to C$, $j : C \to D$, $T_{jh}^\sharp = T_h^\sharp T_j^\sharp$. Whiskering on opposite sides commutes. For fixed composable r, r', tensor insertion is compatible with composition by interchange. All these equations hold also for parameterized contexts, pointwise in their parameters.*

Proof.

(1) **Monoidal comparison.** The context functions satisfy $(jh)f = j(hf)$ and $b(fa) = (bf)a$. The tensor assertion follows from $(h \otimes r') \circ (f \otimes r) = (hf) \otimes (r'r)$. Apply Theorem 5.18.

□

The backward context action is the costate action of the canonical lenses of Construction 5.10. Its inputs and outputs are complete concurrent strategies. Closing an evaluation context specifies the comparison received by each agency interface; the retained output arena continues to expose the economic outcome.

5.5 Dependent assertions and semantic testing

Comparisons of policies become assertions only after a reference context has been chosen. The state-context fibration supplies ordinary dependent objects for policies and witnesses and subterminal objects for predicates. Comprehension restricts contexts to satisfying states; quantifier adjoints express selection and existence of witnesses. We now identify these operations with the standard dependent semantics so that subsequent strategic and epistemic tests use the same logic.

5.5.1 The predicate fragment and comprehension

A feasibility assertion answers whether at least one allocation certificate exists. An institution that later uses the certificate must also retain a witness. An ordinary dependent family stores those witnesses, and its existential image answers the feasibility question. Comprehension selects the states satisfying a predicate. Its subterminal fragment supplies truth conditions for the assertions about agency.

Definition 5.21 (The assertion hyperdoctrine)**.** For an arena G, use the indexed assignment P_G of Construction 5.4. For $s : W \to \Sigma^G$, an assertion is a subobject of W; entailment is inclusion. Its conjunction, disjunction, implication, and constants are those of $\mathsf{Pred}(W)$, with $\neg P = (P \Rightarrow \bot)$. An arrow $u : (W, s) \to (V, t)$ substitutes predicates by u^*. The ambient notation $\mathsf{Pred}(X)$ permits the same calculation before a reference context is chosen; constant types insert it into the game's doctrine by Equation (5.1).

Theorem 5.22 (Quantifiers, equality, and comprehension)**.** *The indexed assignment* P_G *is the subobject hyperdoctrine of* $\mathbf{Set}/\Sigma^G$*. Every context map has adjoints* $\exists_u \dashv u^* \dashv \forall_u$*, with*

$$(\exists_u P)(v) \iff \exists w\,(u(w) = v \wedge P(w)), \qquad (\forall_u P)(v) \iff \forall w\,(u(w) = v \Rightarrow P(w)).$$

Both quantifiers satisfy Beck–Chevalley for pullback squares. Moreover $\exists_u(P \wedge u^*Q) = \exists_u P \wedge Q$*. Equality on a context* $W \to \Sigma^G$ *is its diagonal in* $W \times_{\Sigma^G} W$*.*

Comprehension of $P \hookrightarrow W$ *is* $\{P\} = (P \hookrightarrow W \xrightarrow{s} \Sigma^G)$*. For the projection* p_G *of the predicate fibration, the truth functor* $\top_G$ *and comprehension satisfy* $p_G \dashv \top_G \dashv \{-\}$*. The same comprehension construction works in the total state-context category and is stable under its cartesian substitutions.*

Comprehension represents the predicates by inclusions of their satisfying contexts.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \{P\} & \xhookrightarrow{m_P} & W \\ {\scriptstyle s|_P}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle s} \\ \Sigma^G & = & \Sigma^G \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Predicate calculation.** A subobject of (W, s) in the slice is exactly a subset of W equipped with the restricted map s. Slice pullbacks have the underlying pullbacks of sets, proving the asserted identification of doctrines.

(2) **Base-change comparison.** The elementwise formulas give

$$\exists_u P \le Q \iff P \le u^*Q, \qquad u^*Q \le P \iff Q \le \forall_u P.$$

In a pullback square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} W' & \xrightarrow{a} & W \\ {\scriptstyle u'}\downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle u} \\ V' & \xrightarrow[b]{} & V \end{array}$$

the fibre of u' at v' is canonically the fibre of u at $b(v')$.

(3) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** The quantifier formulas therefore give $b^*\exists_u = \exists_{u'} a^*$ and $b^*\forall_u = \forall_{u'} a^*$. Frobenius follows because $Q(u(w))$ is constant on a fibre of u. The diagonal classifies equality in the slice product.

(4) **Predicate calculation.** An arrow from a predicate to truth is specified by its underlying context map, proving $p_G \dashv \top_G$. An arrow from a true context to P is a context map whose image lies in P; it factors uniquely through $\{P\}$, proving $\top_G \dashv \{-\}$. In the total category the same factorization keeps its arena reparametrisation unchanged. Inverse image of a subset is its pullback, giving stability of comprehension.

□

5.5.2 Universal predicate fixed points

The complete assertion fibres supply temporal operators without an independent choice of fixed predicates. Regard a predicate lattice as a thin category: an arrow is an entailment. The following construction is the complete-lattice theorem of Tarski (1955), expressed by its initial and terminal universal properties.

Construction 5.23 (Universal predicate fixed points)**.**

(1) **Form the algebra and coalgebra categories.** For a monotone $F : \mathsf{Pred}(X) \to \mathsf{Pred}(X)$, its algebras are the predicates with $F(P) \leq P$, ordered by entailment; its coalgebras have $P \leq F(P)$. Their arrows automatically commute with the structure maps because the ambient category is thin.

(2) **Construct their universal objects.** Put

$$\mu F = \bigwedge \{P : F(P) \leq P\}, \qquad \nu F = \bigvee \{P : P \leq F(P)\}.$$

These meets and joins exist in the already constructed assertion fibres, and in their finite products. They are universal objects, not selected execution witnesses.

Theorem 5.24 (Initial algebras, terminal coalgebras, and predicate induction)**.** *The displayed μF is an initial F-algebra and νF a terminal F-coalgebra. Both structure maps are identities of predicates: $F(\mu F) = \mu F$ and $F(\nu F) = \nu F$. Consequently*

$$F(P) \leq P \Longrightarrow \mu F \leq P, \qquad P \leq F(P) \Longrightarrow P \leq \nu F.$$

For a monotone family F_a, both $a \mapsto \mu F_a$ and $a \mapsto \nu F_a$ are monotone.

Proof.

(1) **Construct the initial algebra.** Write $m = \mu F$. For every prefixed P, monotonicity gives $F(m) \leq F(P) \leq P$, so $F(m) \leq m$. Applying F shows that $F(m)$ is itself prefixed; hence $m \leq F(m)$. The meet gives its unique arrow to every algebra. The dual argument constructs the terminal coalgebra.

(2) **Derive parameter monotonicity.** If $F_a \leq F_b$ pointwise, then μF_b is prefixed for F_a and νF_a is postfixed for F_b. Induction and coinduction give the two parameter inequalities.

□

Lemma 5.25 (Adjoint transport of fixed points)**.** *Let L, M be complete lattices, $H_! \dashv H \dashv H_*$ with $H : L \to M$, and let monotone $F : L \to L$, $G : M \to M$ satisfy $GH = HF$. Then*

$$H(\mu F) = \mu G, \qquad H(\nu F) = \nu G.$$

Proof.

(1) **Transport the initial algebra.** Put $m = \mu G$. Since $H(\mu F)$ is fixed, $m \leq H(\mu F)$. For $Q = H_* m$, the counit gives $HQ \leq m$; hence $HFQ = GHQ \leq Gm = m$. Adjunction yields $FQ \leq Q$. Induction now gives $H(\mu F) \leq HQ \leq m$.

(2) **Transport the terminal coalgebra.** Put $n = \nu G$. Since $H(\nu F)$ is fixed, $H(\nu F) \leq n$. For $Q = H_! n$, the unit gives $n \leq HQ$, so $n = Gn \leq GHQ = HFQ$. Adjunction yields $Q \leq FQ$. Coinduction gives $n \leq HQ \leq H(\nu F)$.

□

Lemma 5.26 (Transport across a retraction)**.** *Let $\rho : L \to M$ and $J : M \to L$ be monotone maps between complete lattices with $\rho J = \mathrm{id}_M$. For monotone $F : M \to M$, put $\widehat{F} = JF\rho$. Then*

$$\mu \widehat{F} = J \mu F, \qquad \nu \widehat{F} = J \nu F.$$

Proof.

(1) **Fixed-point argument.** If $Fx = x$, then $\widehat{F}(Jx) = Jx$. If $\widehat{F}y = y$, then $F(\rho y) = \rho y$ and $J\rho y = y$. Thus J and ρ restrict to inverse order isomorphisms between the two fixed-point posets. They preserve their least and greatest elements.

□

Connectives are the fibrewise Heyting operations, quantifiers are the adjoints of substitution, and relational modalities are their composites along the two projections of a relation. Positive dependence therefore determines a monotone endofunctor; its initial algebra or terminal coalgebra determines the binder. The formal notation for this derived structure, including its variance checks, is recorded in Definition A.5 and Lemma A.6 in the syntax appendix.

Construction 5.27 (Dependent types and predicate types)**.**

(1) **Identify the ordinary fibre.** Over a state context (W, s), a dependent type is a map $E \to W$; its terms are sections. The slice $(\mathbf{Set}/\Sigma^G)/(W, s)$ is canonically $\mathbf{Set}/W$. These are the ordinary fibres of Construction 1.39.

(2) **Form dependent sums and products.** For $u : W \to V$, their dependent sums and products have fibres

$$(\Sigma_u E)_v = \coprod_{u(w)=v} E_w, \qquad (\Pi_u E)_v = \prod_{u(w)=v} E_w.$$

We write Σ_u, Π_u for the ordinary adjoints $\Sigma_u^{\mathrm{c}}, \Pi_u^{\mathrm{c}}$ of Theorem 1.47; their adjunctions follow from the same sum and product universal properties. The image of the dependent sum of a predicate gives $\exists_u$; its dependent product gives $\forall_u$.

(3) **Construct predicate types.** For $W \to \Sigma^G$, the power object has fibre $\mathcal{P}_{\Sigma^G}(W)_\sigma = \mathcal{P}(W_\sigma)$, with fibrewise membership. A subobject of a slice product is uniquely classified by the map sending a parameter to its corresponding subset of W_σ. The truth-value object is $\Sigma^G \times \{0, 1\} \to \Sigma^G$. Thus the construction also supplies higher-order predicate types.

Proposition 5.28 (Propositional reflection and recovery of quantifiers)**.** *For $E \in \mathsf{T}(W)$ define $\|E\|$ by the image of its projection $\coprod_w E_w \to W$. This is left adjoint to the inclusion of subterminal families into ordinary families. It commutes with substitution. For a subterminal P over W and $u : W \to V$,*

$$\exists_u P = \|\Sigma_u^{\mathrm{c}} P\|, \qquad \forall_u P = \Pi_u^{\mathrm{c}} P.$$

Thus the existing predicate doctrine and its quantifiers are recovered inside the constructed dependent semantics.

Proof.

(1) **Characterization of propositional reflection.** The fibre $\|E\|_w$ is a singleton exactly when E_w is inhabited. A map from E_w to a subterminal P_w exists exactly when this inhabitation implies inhabitation of P_w, and is then unique.

(2) **Naturality and quantified reflection.** This proves the adjunction without choosing an element of E_w. Reindexing retains the same fibres, proving substitution stability. The coproduct is inhabited exactly when some summand is inhabited.

(3) **Monoidal comparison.** A product of subterminal sets is a singleton exactly when every factor is inhabited: its element is the uniquely specified family of their unique elements. Otherwise it is empty.

(4) **Quantifiers on empty and inhabited fibres.** This proves the quantifier formulas, including empty indexing fibres, without a choice of witnesses from arbitrary inhabited types.

□

Proposition 5.29 (Logical change of base)**.** *The change of game in Proposition 5.5 preserves the constructed finite-limit, comprehension, and predicate-type structure up to its canonical comparisons. Quantifiers commute with this change of base along the associated pullback squares. These comparisons satisfy substitution coherence.*

Proof.

(1) **Monoidal comparison.** In family notation a context has fibres W_η and a dependent type has fibres $E_{\eta,w}$. Pullback along $\bar{r}$ replaces η by $\bar{r}\sigma$ in these formulas. Products, equalities, subsets, and power objects are consequently the identical constructions on identical fibres.

(2) **Monoidal comparison: completion.** Sums and products indexed by a dependent context map range over the same sets after this substitution. This proves their comparisons and the quantifier equations; repeated substitution of the index proves coherence. The set-theoretic constructions implement the fibred logical semantics of Jacobs (1999).

□

The doctrine lives over state contexts, not over a Cartesian structure on the category $\mathcal{A}_{A,B}$ of agent presentations itself. The latter indexes the contexts and their changes of base; operational contexts in $\mathsf{Ctx}(\mathcal{C})$ separately act on hom-set values as in Section 3.2. Keeping these roles apart is necessary for treating owned reparametrizations and logical substitutions correctly.

5.5.3 Algebras and coalgebras of predicate adjunctions

Definition 5.30 (Posetal monads and comonads)**.** On a poset, a monad is a monotone endomap M with $\mathrm{id} \leq M$ and $M^2 \leq M$; a comonad is a monotone endomap K with $K \leq \mathrm{id}$ and $K \leq K^2$. These inequalities imply idempotence. Their algebra and coalgebra posets are respectively the full subposets $MP = P$ and $KP = P$.

Theorem 5.31 (The two universal approximations to invariant assertions)**.** *For a surjection $q : X \twoheadrightarrow Q$, let $\mathsf{Inv}(q)$ be the full subposet of predicates constant on the fibers of q, with inclusion $j : \mathsf{Inv}(q) \hookrightarrow \mathsf{Pred}(X)$. Then*

$$M_q = q^*\exists_q \dashv j \dashv K_q = q^*\forall_q, \qquad \mathrm{Alg}(M_q) \cong \mathsf{Inv}(q) \cong \mathrm{Coalg}(K_q) \cong \mathsf{Pred}(Q).$$

In the adjunction display, M_q and K_q are corestricted to $\mathsf{Inv}(q)$; as endomaps they are the resulting idempotent monad and comonad.

Proof.

(1) **Verification of the universal property.** Surjectivity gives $\exists_q q^* = \forall_q q^* = \mathrm{id}$. Thus M_q and K_q have invariant values, are idempotent, and the adjunction units and counits give $P \leq M_q P$ and $K_q P \leq P$. If $Q' = q^*\bar{Q}$ is invariant, then

$$M_q P \leq Q' \iff P \leq Q', \qquad Q' \leq K_q P \iff Q' \leq P$$

by the two quantifier adjunctions.

(2) **Predicate calculation.** These are the claimed universal properties. Their fixed predicates are precisely those in the image of q^*, and effective predicate descent identifies this image with $\mathsf{Pred}(Q)$.

□

Invariant predicates descend uniquely along the observation quotient.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{Pred}(Q) & \xrightarrow[\cong]{q^*} & \mathsf{Inv}(q) \\ \| & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle j} \\ \mathsf{Pred}(Q) & \xrightarrow[q^*]{} & \mathsf{Pred}(X) \end{array}$$

$$\mathsf{Pred}(X) \underset{j}{\overset{M_q}{\rightleftarrows}} \mathsf{Inv}(q) \xrightarrow{\simeq} \mathsf{Pred}(Q), \qquad K_q : \mathsf{Pred}(X) \to \mathsf{Inv}(q)$$

Remark 5.32 (One construction, several economic meanings). Observation quotients give epistemic invariant assertions. Owner-coordinate quotients give assertions invariant under the corresponding deviations. Quotients of redundant presentations give representation-independent assertions. The adjunction is the same; the constructed quotient specifies its economic meaning.

5.5.4 Realization terms and their assertion predicates

Construction 5.33 (Semantic testing)**.**

(1) **Pull back the designated predicate.** For $t : \Gamma \to X$ and $P \hookrightarrow X$, put $\mathrm{Test}_P(t) = t^*P$. In a state context $s : \Gamma \to \Sigma^G$, its typed expression is $(s,t)^*\Delta_G P = t^*P$, by Equation (5.1). Thus the same test is an internal assertion on the reference context.

(2) **Test a tuple.** For a finite tuple of indexed arrows use $X = \prod_k \mathcal{C}(A_k, B_k)$ and

$$\mathrm{Test}_P(t_1, \ldots, t_n) = \langle t_1, \ldots, t_n \rangle^* P.$$

Theorem 5.34 (Classification of semantic tests)**.** *Predicates on X correspond bijectively to assignments $\tau_\Gamma(t) \in \mathsf{Pred}(\Gamma)$ for $t : \Gamma \to X$ that are natural under substitution. The inverse sends τ to $\tau_X(\mathrm{id}_X)$. In particular,*

$$f^* \,\mathrm{Test}_P(t) = \mathrm{Test}_P(tf). \tag{5.3}$$

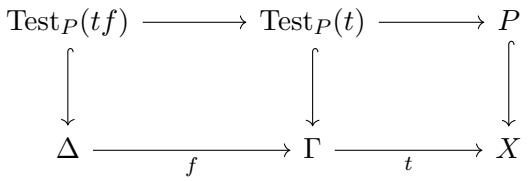
For $F : X \to Y$ one has $\mathrm{Test}_{F^*Q}(t) = \mathrm{Test}_Q(Ft)$.

Proof.

(1) **Naturality.** Naturality at $t : \Gamma \to X$ forces $\tau_\Gamma(t) = t^*\tau_X(\mathrm{id}_X)$. Conversely pullback is functorial, so every predicate gives such an assignment. These operations are inverse. This is the Yoneda argument in its elementwise form.

□

For $f : \Delta \to \Gamma$ and $t : \Gamma \to X$, both squares in the following diagram are pullbacks.



Indeed, δ lies over the middle comprehension exactly when $t(f(\delta)) \in P$. This identifies its pullback along f with the left comprehension and gives (5.3). The classification concerns tests of the specified semantic values. Ownership, observations, and legality supply additional data; it does not assert that every assertion about them depends only on the realized arrow.

5.5.5 State contexts, legal comprehension, and operational substitution

Definition 5.35 (State realization)**.** A state realization is an object (W, s) of $\mathsf{St}(G)$. Its operational family is $gs : W \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$, equivalently a morphism $yA \to yB$ in $\mathsf{L}(W)$. Its realization section (s, gs) takes values in the ordinary family $\mathsf{Val}_W[yA, yB]_D$, identified with the constant concurrent-arrow family by Theorem 1.38. For a legal predicate with comprehension $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma^G$, a legal state realization is a context over that comprehension, $s : W \to L$, with operational family gms. For $f : W' \to W$, substitution is $s \mapsto sf$ and $P \mapsto f^*P$.

Proposition 5.36 (Synchronized substitution)**.** *For every semantic predicate Q,*

$$f^* \,\mathrm{Test}_Q(gms) = \mathrm{Test}_Q(gmsf).$$

The intermediate state space need not contain representatives of every available alternative policy.

Proof.

(1) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** The equality is Theorem 5.34. The definitions require only the displayed map s and impose no surjectivity condition on it.

□

Theorem 5.37 (Fibred compatibility of dependent realization and assertions)**.** *Over $\mathsf{St}_{A,B}$ the indexed ordinary and linear categories of Construction 5.6, their comprehension, monoidal adjunction, and dependent adjoints share coherent substitution. The assertion fibration is their subterminal ordinary fragment. The original indexed operational category embeds fully faithfully in the linear fibration, preserving its concurrent structure.*

If $t : W \to \prod_j \mathcal{C}(A_j, B_j)$ is a tuple of realized families, m is composition, tensor, or another exhibited operation on these arrow carriers, and Q is a predicate on its target, then

$$u^* \,\mathrm{Test}_Q(mt) = \mathrm{Test}_Q(m(tu)) = \mathrm{Test}_{m^*Q}(tu)$$

for every $u : V \to W$. The same equations hold for comparison predicates on paired carriers. For dependent boundaries, replace the constant carriers by $\mathsf{Val}[A, B]_D$ and use their fibrewise operations.

Proof.

(1) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** The categorical assertions follow by change of base of Theorem 1.50 along Dom. Proposition 5.28 identifies the assertion fibration, and pointwise Yoneda proves the embedding assertion. Each cartesian lift reindexes the same ordinary parameter, so all the comparison maps are those already proved coherent in the model theorem.

(2) **Secured operational interaction.** For the displayed equalities, $(mt)u = m(tu)$ and $(m(tu))^*Q = (tu)^*m^*Q$ are inverse-image functoriality. The paired and dependent cases are the identical calculation on the corresponding fibres.

□

5.5.6 Effective descent of terms and predicates

Observation descent gives a concrete example of this logical architecture. If $q : H \to O$ identifies histories an agent cannot distinguish, an implementable response $f : H \to A$ must be constant on the fibres of q and hence factor through O. It cannot prescribe different actions at histories producing the same signal. The quotient thus has an operational meaning before knowledge modalities are introduced, and its dependent extension will retain complete families of such responses.

Proposition 5.38 (Descent and finite products of quotients)**.** *Let $q : X \twoheadrightarrow Y$ have kernel pair $p_1, p_2 : X \times_Y X \rightrightarrows X$. A map $F : X \to Z$ descends uniquely to Y exactly when $Fp_1 = Fp_2$. A predicate $P \hookrightarrow X$ descends uniquely exactly when $p_1^*P = p_2^*P$; its descent is*

$$\bar{P}(y) \iff \exists x\, (q(x) = y \wedge P(x)).$$

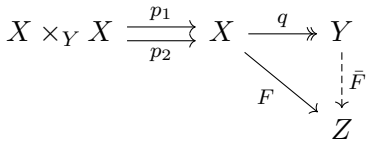
Surjections are effective regular epimorphisms and are stable under pullbacks and finite products, including the nullary product.

Proof.

(1) **Predicate calculation.** These are the effective-descent properties of sets (Jacobs, 1999, Chapters 4–5). Explicitly, the relation $\bar{F}(y) = z \iff \exists x\, (q(x) = y \wedge F(x) = z)$ is total and single-valued precisely when F is fiber-constant. The displayed formula for $\bar{P}$ pulls back to P precisely when P is fiber-invariant.

(2) **Verification of the universal property.** Surjectivity gives uniqueness in both cases. A pullback has the same fibers as the original surjection. Products of two surjections are composites of two such pullbacks; finite induction includes the identity on 1.

□



5.5.7 Substituting the reference state

Consider an owner with $\Sigma_i = \{a, b\}$. Selecting a as the current policy leaves b available as a deviation. Restricting the owner's carrier to $\{a\}$ removes it. The following comparison of spans shows why changing the reference state preserves the deviation fibre even when the two reference maps look alike.

Construction 5.39 (Reference pullback)**.**

(1) **Pull back the source leg.** For $X \xleftarrow{p} R \xrightarrow{q} Y$ and $f : U \to X$, put $R_f = U \times_X R$, with legs $p_f : R_f \to U$ and $q_f = q\,\mathrm{pr}_R : R_f \to Y$.

(2) **Recover coalition alternatives.** For $s : W \to \Sigma$, the available C-alternatives are $\mathsf{Alt}_C(s) = W \times_{\Sigma,p_1} D_C$. Their paired realization sends (w, τ) to $(gs(w), g\tau)$.

Proposition 5.40 (Substitution of relational assertions)**.** *$f^*[R]P = [R_f]P$ and $f^*\langle R\rangle P = \langle R_f\rangle P$. More generally, for a predicate Q on the relation itself, $f^*\forall_p Q = \forall_{p_f} \mathrm{pr}_R^* Q$, and similarly for $\exists$. No target alternative has to lie in the image of f.*

Proof.

(1) **Base-change comparison.** Apply both Beck–Chevalley equations of Theorem 5.22 to the displayed cartesian lift. Proposition 7.11 types its target as a term into $\Delta_G Y$, so pulling back the reference context retains every target alternative. This proves both modal identities and their quantified form.

□

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} R_f & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{pr}_R} & R & \xrightarrow{q} & Y \\ {\scriptstyle p_f}\downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle p} & & \\ U & \xrightarrow[f]{} & X & & \end{array}$$

5.6 Selection and logical equilibrium

The assertion doctrine now lets us express evaluation as a predicate on alternatives. Pullback along the controlled-deviation interface compares one owner's complete policies with the outsiders fixed. Universal quantification excludes profitable replacements, and restriction to the diagonal tests equilibrium at the current profile. Keeping the off-diagonal relation also records which replacements were compared and how their two endpoints were realized.

5.6.1 Connecting agent interfaces to joint comparison feedback

The complete owner interface, constructed in Section 2.3, now receives the comparison on the wired interaction. Fixing outsider coordinates turns that joint comparison into a costate on the owner's own policy set. The selection relation then classifies best responses, and its diagonal classifies equilibrium; the same calculation is later restricted to legal alternatives.

Construction 5.41 (Connecting an agent to joint feedback)**.**

(1) **Fix the reference and vary one policy.** Fix an open arena G, comparison context $P = (P_i)_i$, and reference profile σ. For owner i put

$$j_{i,\sigma} : \Sigma_i \to \Sigma, \qquad j_{i,\sigma}(a) = (\sigma_{-i}, a).$$

(2) **Transport the costate.** The agent's costate is the costate transported through $\mathbb{L}(gj_{i,\sigma})$:

$$q_{i,\sigma}(a)(b) \iff P_i(g_{(\sigma_{-i},a)}, g_{(\sigma_{-i},b)}). \tag{5.4}$$

(3) **Form best responses.** Define the best-response relation by

$$\mathsf{BR}_G(P)(\sigma, \tau) \iff \bigwedge_i \varepsilon_{\Sigma_i}(\tau_i, q_{i,\sigma}).$$

For arbitrary comparisons this means absence of an improving alternative; for exact rational and classical real-valued maximization it is the best-response condition of ordinary game theory.

In $\mathsf{BR}_G(P)(\sigma, \tau)$, the first profile σ determines the outsiders against whom responses are evaluated. The second supplies the candidate choices τ_i, each compared with alternatives for that same τ_i while σ_{-i} remains fixed. Evaluating against τ_{-i} would instead change the reference game. Only on the diagonal $\tau = \sigma$ does the relation say that each current choice is a best response to all the other current choices.

Proposition 5.42 (Selection and best response as internal predicates)**.** *For $T_S = S \times (S \to \mathsf{Pred}(S))$, let $B_S \hookrightarrow T_S \times S$ be the predicate $B_S(a, q, b) \iff q(a)(b)$ and let $\rho : T_S \times S \to T_S$. Then the agent's selection predicate is*

$$\varepsilon_S = \forall_\rho \neg B_S \in \mathsf{Pred}(T_S).$$

For an evaluated arena G, define

$$\kappa_i : \Sigma^G \times \Sigma^G \to T_{\Sigma_i^G}, \qquad \kappa_i(\sigma, \tau) = (\tau_i, q_{i,\sigma}).$$

Its complete best-response relation and equilibrium predicate are

$$\mathsf{BR}_G(P) = \bigwedge_i \kappa_i^* \varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^G}, \qquad \mathsf{NE}_G = \Delta^*_{\Sigma^G} \mathsf{BR}_G(P).$$

All these expressions are terms and predicates of P_G using the constant types of Construction 5.4.

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** The fibre of ρ at (a, q) is S, so its universal quantifier is exactly $\forall b\, \neg q(a)(b)$. Substitution along κ_i gives the agent condition defining best response, and substitution along the diagonal makes its candidate response equal to the reference. The constant-type interpretation preserves each pullback by Equation (5.1).

(2) **Strategic comparison: completion.** This retains the off-diagonal relation; passage to equilibrium is the displayed additional pullback.

□

The selection-relation approach of Capucci et al. (2022a,b) organizes selection covariantly over lenses, with the Nash product giving a monoidal opfibration. Here the corresponding predicates live in a contravariant assertion fibration. Connecting feedback to selection is the specified substitution, not an identification of those two variances. A repeated owner retains one complete policy carrier before this test is performed.

Definition 5.43 (Legal domains and legal choice fibres)**.** A **legal domain** is a specified subobject $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ of profiles permitted by the institution. Against outsiders σ_{-i}, the **legal choice fibre** is

$$S_i^L(\sigma_{-i}) = \{a_i \in \Sigma_i : (a_i, \sigma_{-i}) \in L\}.$$

Legality can couple owners' choices even when their unrestricted policy space is a product. The set available to one owner may therefore depend on the outsiders' coordinates. Pulling back the legal subobject along a fixed outsider profile constructs this dependent menu, rather than mistaking its coordinate image for an independently feasible choice.

Construction 5.44 (Legal selection fibers)**.**

(1) **Form the legal fibre.** For a reference $\sigma \in L$ and owner i, put

$$S_i^L(\sigma_{-i}) = \{a \in \Sigma_i : (\sigma_{-i}, a) \in L\}.$$

Let $j_{i,\sigma}^L : S_i^L(\sigma_{-i}) \to L$ insert the fixed outsider coordinates.

(2) **Transport the comparison.** If $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ is the inclusion, the agent's legal feedback is the costate transported through $\mathbb{L}(gmj_{i,\sigma}^L)$. Connect the agent selection relation $\varepsilon_{S_i^L(\sigma_{-i})}$ to this dependent interface.

(3) **Extend to a coalition.** For a coalition C, replace i by C and use the corresponding joint choice fiber. All legally admissible changes of its members are then made at one coalition interface.

Theorem 5.45 (Selection, counterfactual feedback, and logical equilibrium)**.** *For every comparison context, the following predicates on Σ agree:*

(i) *the diagonal* $\mathsf{BR}_G(P)(\sigma, \sigma)$*;*

(ii) *satisfaction of every agent selection relation after connecting the agent interfaces to the arena;*

(iii) $\bigwedge_i \forall_{p_1 : D_i \to \Sigma} \neg(\delta_i^G)^* P_i$.

The equality retains the off-diagonal best-response relation and all paired deviation realizations as separate, constructed semantic data. More generally, on a legal carrier $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, write $D_i^L = L \times_{\Sigma_{-i}} L$ and let $P_i^L \hookrightarrow L^2$ be the displayed paired improvement test. Then

$$\mathsf{NE}_L = \bigwedge_i \forall_{p_1 : D_i^L \to L} \neg(p_1, p_2)^* P_i^L, \qquad \mathsf{NE}_L(\sigma) \iff \bigwedge_i \varepsilon_{S_i^L(\sigma_{-i})}(\sigma_i, q_{i,\sigma}^L),$$

where $q_{i,\sigma}^L(a)(b) = P_i^L(\sigma[i := a], \sigma[i := b])$. The same fibre comparison holds for any coalition and its joint legal choice fibre. Taking $L = \Sigma$ recovers the unrestricted statements above.

Proof.

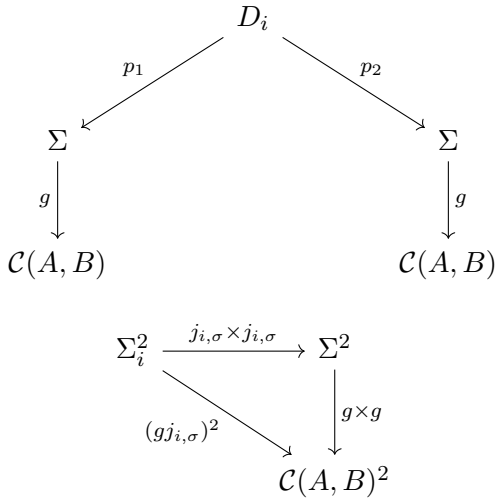
(1) **Identify the legal alternative fibre.** At $\sigma \in L$, insertion $a \mapsto \sigma[i := a]$ is a bijection from $S_i^L(\sigma_{-i})$ to the source fibre of D_i^L. Under it the paired improvement predicate is exactly $q_{i,\sigma}^L(\sigma_i)(a)$. Its universally quantified negation is the selection predicate. The same insertion proves the coalition statement, and $L = \Sigma$ gives the three unrestricted descriptions, including the diagonal of the full best-response relation.

(2) **Retain the typed feedback.** Proposition 7.11 types both realized endpoints into the constant comparison carrier. Thus the equality is internal to the assertion fibre. It uses no order property of the comparison. For classical linearly ordered values, absence of strict improvement is the weak inequality, retaining all ties.

(3) **Evaluate measured records.** For descended profile values, use their two endpoint values as P_i^L. The same fibre calculation applies on the completed legal carrier; the precise descent criterion is Proposition 5.50.

□

The two projections of a unilateral deviation determine the pair of realized interactions.



Independent owners recover the relational Nash product: every owner receives the comparison obtained by fixing the other owners' policies. A repeated owner has one larger carrier Σ_i containing all its decisions, and therefore must be tested against changes to that entire carrier. This is the distinction on which equilibrium under composition depends.

Construction 5.46 (Maximum of a finite numerical family)**.**

(1) **Compute the maximum.** For scalars in $\mathbb{K}$, a nonempty finite list $(a_1, \dots, a_m)$ has a maximum constructed by $b_1 = a_1$ and $b_{k+1} = \max(b_k, a_{k+1})$.

(2) **Retain a maximizing record.** To retain a maximizing record from a displayed finite ordered domain, retain its first record at a tie. Induction proves that b_k is the maximum of the first k values and that the retained record has that value. Thus it provides both a maximum value and a specified first maximizer. For exact rational entries, comparison by cross multiplication of positive denominators makes this recursion a finite algorithm. For classical real entries its correctness uses the usual linear order.

Definition 5.47 (Gain on a deviation)**.** For a numerical utility $u_i : \Sigma \to \mathbb{K}$ and a deviation $(\sigma, \tau) \in D_i$, put $\Delta_i u(\sigma, \tau) = u_i(\tau) - u_i(\sigma)$. Strict profitable deviation is the inverse image of $\mathbb{K}_{>0}$. For composable deviations of the same owner these gains add, and reversing a deviation negates its gain, by cancellation of the intermediate utility.

5.6.2 Comparison contexts and equilibrium

Definition 5.48 (Preferences and value presentations)**.** A strict comparison records an improvement, while a weak comparison allows equally valued alternatives. For a preorder, two alternatives are **indifferent** when each is weakly preferred to the other and **incomparable** when neither is. Both fail to be strict improvements over one another, for different reasons. The general comparison context can be an arbitrary relation; preference-order terminology applies when the indicated preorder or numerical presentation is supplied. The second argument of Better_i is always the candidate improvement.

A comparison context for $G : A \to B$ is $\mathsf{Better} \in \mathsf{Cmp}_N(A, B)$, with the second argument denoting the improved interaction. No order law is part of this type. A value presentation is a family $k_i : \mathcal{C}(A, B) \to V_i$ with relations $\prec_i \subseteq V_i^2$ such that $\mathsf{Better}_i = (k_i \times k_i)^* \prec_i$. This gives $v_i^G = k_i g$ for an arrow-level value context. For a measured completion the numerical input is $e_i r$ on witnesses; Proposition 5.50 gives its profile-level form, including values that distinguish implementations of the same hidden arrow. When V_i is preordered, its strict part is $x \prec_i y \iff x \preceq_i y \wedge \neg(y \preceq_i x)$. Every comparison has the tautological relational

presentation $V_i = \mathcal{C}(A, B)$, $k_i = \mathrm{id}$. For an arbitrary comparison, the selection predicate expresses *stability against the specified relation*; it has the Nash interpretation when that relation is strict improvement. In particular, reflexivity or irreflexivity is not inferred from the bare type $\mathsf{Cmp}_N(A, B)$.

A policy can have several completed executions. An analyst may assign it a single payoff when the owner gives every execution over that policy the same value. An auditor who needs the actual expense asks more of the record. The dashed arrow in the proof exists precisely in the first case, and the same argument applied to the whole record tests the second.

Construction 5.49 (The coarsest quotient retaining specified data)**.**

(1) **Retain the requested quantities.** Given $q : K \twoheadrightarrow D$ and a displayed map $b : K \to V$, form

$$K \xrightarrow{r} D_b := \mathrm{im}\langle q, b\rangle \hookrightarrow D \times V.$$

The projections recover q and b from r. Several retained quantities use their tuple as b. Its kernel pair is exactly $\ker(q) \cap \ker(b)$.

(2) **Verify the universal property.** If a quotient $s : K \twoheadrightarrow Z$ retains $q = q_Z s$ and $b = b_Z s$, then $\langle q_Z, b_Z\rangle$ takes values in D_b: each z has a preimage under s. It therefore corestricts to the unique surjection $h : Z \twoheadrightarrow D_b$ with $r = hs$. Thus D_b is terminal among quotients retaining both maps. No representative or section is selected.

For measured executions, take $b = e_i\langle m, a\rangle$ to retain one owner's value, or $b = \langle m, a\rangle$ to retain the whole record. The refined carrier supports that quantity canonically. Whether it already descends to the original profile carrier D is still exactly the following kernel-pair test. Independently specified transition relations are subsequently retained by the exact refinement of Theorem 12.33.

Proposition 5.50 (Descent of measured comparisons to policy profiles)**.** *Write $q : K \twoheadrightarrow D = \mathrm{im}(p)$ and $r = \langle m, a\rangle : K \to T_C Z$. The record descends to D exactly when m and a each equalize the kernel pair of q. For a fixed owner the value $v_i = e_i r$ descends exactly when v_i equalizes that kernel pair. Either descended map is unique. In particular, a unique completed witness at each profile gives total descended records and values. For a legal completed carrier $L \hookrightarrow D$, the descended values determine equilibrium by*

$$\mathsf{NE}_L(\sigma) \iff \bigwedge_i \forall \tau \in L\ \big(\sigma_{-i} = \tau_{-i} \ \Rightarrow\ \neg(\bar{v}_i(\sigma) \prec_i \bar{v}_i(\tau))\big).$$

Proof.

(1) **Descend exactly the observed quantity.** For any $b : K \to V$ constant on fibres, define $\bar{b}(\sigma)$ as the unique value $b(k)$ for $q(k) = \sigma$. Surjectivity supplies a witness and constancy gives uniqueness. Conversely $b = \bar{b}q$ equalizes the kernel pair. Apply this once to the pair (m, a) and once to $e_i r$. For example, erasure can identify different charges on the same outcome. The value square is

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K & \xrightarrow{\ r\ } & T_C Z \\ {\scriptstyle q}\big\downarrow & & \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle e_i} \\ D & \xrightarrow[\bar{v}_i]{} & V_i \end{array}$$

To represent $\bar{v}_i$ on the image of the hidden concurrent realizer $g|_D$, apply the same argument to its image surjection. Profile descent and factorization through the hidden arrow are distinct tests.

(2) **Pull the comparison back to legal alternatives.** Restrict K to $K_L = q^{-1}(L)$. Put $D_i^L = \{(\sigma,\tau) \in L^2 : \sigma_{-i} = \tau_{-i}\}$ and $\widetilde{D}_i = (K_L \times K_L) \times_{L^2} D_i^L$. The projection $\widetilde{D}_i \to D_i^L$ is onto because each of the two endpoints has a witness. A predicate on witness pairs descends exactly when it agrees on the fibres of this projection, by the same image argument applied to its characteristic function. When values descend, the improving-pair test is the inverse image of $\bar{v}_i p_1 \prec_i \bar{v}_i p_2$. Universal exclusion of those alternatives is the displayed Nash formula, by the coordinate argument of Theorem 5.45.

(3) **Keep unresolved outcomes on witnesses.** Without paired-test descent, existential and universal images along $\widetilde{D}_i \to D_i^L$ give the respective tests that some or every completing pair improves. An empty execution fibre contributes no point to D. For outcome-only evaluation $e_i = u_i \epsilon_Z$ this calculation recovers the usual numerical predicate whenever $u_i a$ descends.

□

Construction 5.51 (Profitable deviations and equilibrium)**.**

(1) **Exclude profitable deviations.** On D_i put $\mathsf{Prof}_i = (\delta_i^G)^* \mathsf{Better}_i$ and define

$$\mathsf{NE}_G = \bigwedge_{i \in N} \forall_{p_1 : D_i \to \Sigma} \neg \mathsf{Prof}_i. \tag{5.5}$$

(2) **Name the resulting predicate.** Write $\mathrm{NE}(G, \mathsf{Better})$ for this predicate, and $\mathrm{NE}(G,k)$ when the value presentation is understood.

Specializing Theorem 5.45 gives

$$\mathsf{NE}_G(\sigma) \iff \bigwedge_i \forall a_i \in \Sigma_i \ \neg \mathsf{Better}_i(g_\sigma, g_{(\sigma_{-i}, a_i)}). \tag{5.6}$$

For classical linearly ordered $\mathbb{K}$-values this is $v_i(\sigma) \geq v_i(\sigma_{-i}, a_i)$ for every i, a_i. For measured play use the descended values $\bar{v}_i q = e_i r$ on D_i^L; the arrow formulation applies exactly when the paired test factors through the realizations. An incomplete preorder instead gives absence of strict improvement without a comparability assertion.

Construction 5.52 (The ordinary dependent object of equilibrium proofs)**.**

(1) **Form the dependent product.** Regard each $\mathsf{Prof}_i(\sigma,\tau)$ as its subterminal ordinary family, and write $D_i(\sigma)$ for the fibre of the deviation projection. Construct in $\mathsf{T}(\Sigma)$

$$\mathsf{Eqm}_G(\sigma) = \prod_{i \in N} \prod_{\tau \in D_i(\sigma)} (\mathsf{Prof}_i(\sigma,\tau) \to 0).$$

(2) **Identify its fibres.** Each factor and therefore the product is subterminal. Its fibre is inhabited precisely when there is no profitable deviation of any owner, so it is the subterminal object classifying NE_G. This follows from Proposition 5.28, applied to the displayed dependent products.

(3) **Substitute the reference.** Reference substitution pulls back the complete deviation fibres, as in Theorem 5.37.

Construction 5.53 (Improvement relation)**.**

(1) **Restrict comparison to controlled alternatives.** Put $\mathsf{Cmp}_i^G = (g \times g)^* \mathsf{Better}_i$ on Σ^2 and $\mathsf{PDev}_i = D_i \cap \mathsf{Cmp}_i^G$. For descended measured values take $\mathsf{Cmp}_i^G = (\bar{v}_i \times \bar{v}_i)^* \prec_i$ on the completed carrier. Intersecting it with the deviation span then gives the same modal safety formula below.

Proposition 5.54 (Equilibrium as modal safety)**.**

$$\mathsf{NE}_G = \bigwedge_i \neg\langle \mathsf{PDev}_i \rangle \top. \tag{5.7}$$

For a state map $s : W \to \Sigma$, testing and quantifying the reference pullback $\mathsf{Alt}_i(s)$ yields exactly $s^*\mathsf{NE}_G$.

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** An existential successor of PDev_i is precisely a profitable i-deviation. The state-indexed assertion follows from Proposition 5.40 with the predicate $\neg\mathsf{Prof}_i$ on D_i.

□

Proposition 5.55 (Preferences are not determined by interaction)**.** *No predicate depending only on the concurrent open-arena realization defines equilibrium for all comparison contexts.*

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** Use one owner and two distinct value-state realizations. Rank the first strictly above the second, and then reverse the ranking. The two equilibrium sets are different singletons, while the open-arena realization is unchanged.

□

5.6.3 Contextual decisions

Proposition 5.56 (The open-decision calculation)**.** *For a decision presentation $\mathsf{Dec}_i(X, Y)$, fix an observed input $x \in X$ and a continuation $k : Y \to \mathbb{K}$. Define the comparison by*

$$P_{x,k}(f, f') \iff \exists y, y' \ (f\mathsf{pt}(x) = \mathsf{pt}(y) \wedge f'\mathsf{pt}(x) = \mathsf{pt}(y') \wedge k(y) < k(y')).$$

Its equilibrium condition is

$$\pi \in \mathrm{NE}(x, k) \iff \pi(x) \in \arg\max_{y \in Y} k(y).$$

Proof.

(1) **Policy-level comparison.** The response-state equation gives $\widehat{\pi}\mathsf{pt}(x) = \mathsf{pt}(\pi(x))$. Consequently the comparison on response policies is $k(\pi(x)) < k(\pi'(x))$. Every action y occurs at x under the constant policy with value y.

(2) **Policy-level comparison: completion.** Quantifying over policies is therefore equivalent to quantifying over actions. This recovers the contextual utility-maximizing decision of Ghani et al. (2018).

□

5.6.4 Exact recovery of pure normal-form games

Definition 5.57 (Normal-form games)**.** A **normal-form game** consists of an agent set N, a policy set Σ_i for each agent, and payoff maps $u_i : \prod_{j \in N} \Sigma_j \to \mathbb{K}$. It specifies a payoff for each joint policy profile without displaying the internal order of decisions. A policy in this representation may itself be a contingent plan from a larger protocol.

For a finite normal-form game, each pure action profile produces a singleton outcome. On these singletons the Hoare preorder agrees with the ordinary numerical payoff order, although it also compares other strategy states. The specialization below therefore tests the general selection construction against the usual pure Nash inequalities.

Construction 5.58 (Realizing a finite normal-form game)**.**

(1) **Realize independent actions.** Let A_i be finite nonempty action sets and $u_i : \prod_j A_j \to \mathbb{K}$ utilities. Player i has a singly owned open game $G_i : I \to D(A_i)$ whose parameter a_i realizes the one-event strategy $\mathsf{pt}_{A_i}(a_i)$ selecting a_i. Form

$$G = \bigotimes_{i \in N} G_i : I \longrightarrow O, \qquad O = \bigotimes_{i \in N} D(A_i).$$

At a profile a, the realization has one event for each agent, all independent. Its unique maximal configuration contains the tuple a.

(2) **Evaluate outcome sets.** The following evaluation is defined on the full hom-set $\mathcal{C}(I, O)$. Let $\mathrm{Out}(f)$ be the set of tuples labelling configurations of f with one event on every output component. Define

$$k_i(f) = \{u_i(a) : a \in \mathrm{Out}(f)\}.$$

(3) **Order the sets of values.** Order subsets of $\mathbb{K}$ by the Hoare preorder

$$U \preceq_H V \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \forall u \in U \ \exists v \in V \ (u \leq v).$$

This is reflexive and transitive: reflexivity uses $v = u$, and transitivity composes the two witnesses with transitivity of $\leq$. On singleton sets it restricts to the order on $\mathbb{K}$. This particular extension to nondeterministic or incomplete outcomes is used only to make the context total; the extension provides a total comparison context for this construction.

Theorem 5.59. *The constructed concurrent open game has profile space $\prod_i A_i$, the ordinary unilateral deviations, and exactly the pure Nash equilibria of (A_i, u_i). Its equilibrium assertion in the extended linear language is the ordinary Nash inequality.*

Proof.

(1) **Recovery of normal-form payoffs.** All factors except agent i's factor in G_i are singletons; consequently the composite has $\Sigma_i = A_i$. Its realized outcome set at a is $\{a\}$. The measured presentation has $K = \prod_i A_i$, $p = \mathrm{id}$, $r(a) = \eta^T(a) = (0, a)$ and evaluator $e_i = u_i \epsilon$. Consequently $\bar{v}_i(a) = e_i(r(a)) = u_i(a)$ and $k_i(g_a) = \{\bar{v}_i(a)\}$. Strict comparison of these singleton values is strict comparison of the utilities.

(2) **Descent along the kernel pair.** The kernel pair D_i fixes exactly the other agents' actions. Substituting these facts into Equation (5.6) gives precisely the ordinary Nash inequalities.

□

The diagram shows the classical case $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{R}$. The pure action profile and its realized concurrent strategy determine identical payoffs.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \prod_i A_i & \xrightarrow{\ g\ } & \mathcal{C}(I, O) \\ {\scriptstyle u_i}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle k_i} \\ \mathbb{R} & \xrightarrow[r \mapsto \{r\}]{} & \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{R}) \end{array}$$

The recovered pure-equilibrium predicate can be empty. In **matching pennies**, both agents choose H or T. Player 1 receives 1 when the choices agree and -1 otherwise; agent 2 receives the opposite payoff. At an agreeing profile agent 2 improves by switching, and at a disagreeing profile agent 1 improves by switching. Thus every pure profile has a profitable unilateral deviation. A mixed strategy would instead be a probability distribution over H, T; existence results using such strategies belong to the probabilistic extension.

5.6.5 Boolean games

Definition 5.60 (Boolean games and truth assignments)**.** A **finite Boolean game** consists of a finite partition $V = \coprod_{i \in N} V_i$ of propositional variables, with policy sets

$$\Sigma_i = 2^{V_i}, \qquad \Sigma = \prod_i \Sigma_i \cong 2^V,$$

and a propositional goal $\gamma_i \in \mathrm{Form}(V)$ for each agent. Here a **valuation** is a propositional truth assignment $\sigma : V \to 2$. Interpret the formula by its satisfaction subobject $[\![\gamma_i]\!] \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ and give agent i the payoff map

$$u_i : \Sigma \longrightarrow \{0,1\}, \qquad u_i(\sigma) = \begin{cases} 1, & \sigma \models \gamma_i, \\ 0, & \sigma \not\models \gamma_i. \end{cases}$$

Thus satisfying a goal is strictly preferred to failing it. The constructed game is the Boolean-game instance of Bonzon et al. (2006), realized by the concurrent action protocol.

Truth of a finite propositional formula at a valuation is decidable by structural recursion, and quantification over the finitely many assignments to V_i is likewise decidable. The case distinction in the proof below therefore does not invoke a general excluded-middle principle for the assertion language.

Corollary 5.61. *For a joint valuation a,*

$$a \in \mathrm{NE} \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad a \models \bigwedge_{i \in N} (\gamma_i \vee \neg \exists V_i \, \gamma_i),$$

where the quantified variables are changed while all other variables retain their values at a.

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** If γ_i already holds, the utility is 1 and cannot increase. If it fails, a profitable deviation exists precisely when some assignment of V_i makes it true while the other variables remain fixed. Taking the conjunction over agents gives the result.

□

The Boolean-game formula is a predicate on complete valuations, not a linear operation on the move realizing a valuation. Consequently logical goals may be tested against resource-sensitive interactions without turning a truth value into a consumable resource.

5.6.6 Equilibrium under composition and reparameterization

Theorem 5.62 (Selection after sequential and parallel wiring)**.** *Let $G : A \to B$ and $H : B \to C$ be concurrent open arenas. Fix a comparison context P on $\mathcal{C}(A, C)$ and a reference profile (σ, τ). The feedback at the composed interface of owner i is*

$$q_i^{H \circ G}((a,b))((a',b')) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad P_i\big(h_{(\tau_{-i},b)} g_{(\sigma_{-i},a)}, \; h_{(\tau_{-i},b')} g_{(\sigma_{-i},a')}\big).$$

For every candidate response (σ', τ'),

$$\mathsf{BR}_{H\circ G}(P)((\sigma,\tau),(\sigma',\tau')) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \bigwedge_i \varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H}((\sigma_i', \tau_i'), q_i^{H\circ G}).$$

The same construction for parallel wiring replaces composition of concurrent arrows by their tensor. Both laws respect reassociation, unit insertion, and interchange. They hold for arbitrary comparisons and repeated ownership of components.

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The ownerwise product in the composite arena gives the agency carrier $\Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H$. Insert the fixed outsider coordinates in each component, apply the two plays, and then apply the concurrent composition map. Pulling P_i back along both arguments of this function gives the displayed $q_i^{H\circ G}$ by Theorem 5.11.

(2) **Strategic comparison.** Applying the agent selection relation to that costate is precisely the definition of the composite best-response relation. This calculation uses all alternatives (a', b') at once. Equivalently, Theorem 4.3 identifies their paired realizations with the component deviation pairs followed by concurrent composition.

(3) **Base-change comparison.** The tensor calculation uses the same product of policy coordinates and the tensor wiring function. Construction 3.19 gives the composite reference context, and Theorem 3.20 gives coherence of its cartesian lifts and feedback. Pulling back the internal selection predicates of Proposition 5.42 along equal costate terms therefore preserves those equations.

□

Example 5.63 (One owner with complementary decisions)**.** Equilibrium must compare the complete policy of each owner, including the owner's coordinates in separate components. Consider one agent choosing bits x and y in two components, with value xy. At $(0,0)$, changing either coordinate alone gives no improvement, while the joint change $(0,0) \mapsto (1,1)$ is profitable. Componentwise stationarity is therefore strictly weaker than the correct unilateral-deviation condition.

Construction 5.64 (Component deviation subrelations)**.**

(1) **Separate the component deviations.** Under the canonical isomorphism of Theorem 4.3, define the subrelations

$$E_i^G = D_i^G \times \Delta_{\Sigma^H},$$
$$E_i^H = \Delta_{\Sigma^G} \times D_i^H$$

of $D_i^{H\circ G}$.

(2) **Identify the changing coordinate.** The first consists of deviations that change only the G-policy of owner i, and the second of deviations that change only its H-policy.

Theorem 5.65 (Deviation-cover factorization)**.** *Suppose that for every owner i the two component-deviation subrelations cover the composite deviation relation,*

$$D_i^{H\circ G} = E_i^G \cup E_i^H. \tag{5.8}$$

Then, for every composite profile (σ, τ),

$$(\sigma,\tau) \in \mathrm{NE}(H \circ G, \mathsf{Better}) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \begin{cases} \sigma \in \mathrm{NE}(G, \mathsf{Better}^{G|\tau}), \\ \tau \in \mathrm{NE}(H, \mathsf{Better}^{H|\sigma}). \end{cases}$$

The analogous statement holds for tensor and its pullback comparison contexts.

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** If the composite profile is an equilibrium, every G-only deviation is a composite deviation with the H-profile held fixed. Its two realized interactions are

$$h_\tau \circ g_\sigma \quad \text{and} \quad h_\tau \circ g_{\sigma'},$$

so its comparison is exactly $\mathsf{Better}_i^{G|\tau}(g_\sigma, g_{\sigma'})$. Hence no profitable G-deviation exists. The same argument for H-only deviations gives the second component equilibrium.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely suppose both component equilibrium predicates hold and take any composite i-deviation. By Equation (5.8) it is either in E_i^G or in E_i^H. In the first case its H-coordinate is unchanged, so profitability would contradict the G-equilibrium with comparison $\mathsf{Better}^{G|\tau}$.

(3) **Strategic comparison.** In the second case profitability would contradict the H-equilibrium with comparison $\mathsf{Better}^{H|\sigma}$. Thus no profitable composite i-deviation exists. The tensor proof is identical with whiskering by composition replaced by tensoring with the fixed other component.

□

Disjoint active ownership is a classical sufficient criterion for the cover equation.

Corollary 5.66 (Disjoint active owners; classical specialization)**.** *In ordinary classical* **Set***, let*

$$\mathrm{act}(G) = \{i : |\Sigma_i^G| > 1\}.$$

If $\mathrm{act}(G) \cap \mathrm{act}(H) = \varnothing$*, then*

$$(\sigma, \tau) \in \mathrm{NE}(H \circ G, \mathsf{Better}) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \begin{cases} \sigma \in \mathrm{NE}(G, \mathsf{Better}^{G|\tau}), \\ \tau \in \mathrm{NE}(H, \mathsf{Better}^{H|\sigma}). \end{cases}$$

The analogous equivalence holds for tensor.

Proof.

(1) **Construction on policy coordinates.** Fix i. If the composite profile space is empty there is nothing to prove for its deviation relation. Otherwise the two policy factors of owner i are inhabited.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Classical disjointness of the active-owner sets implies that at least one of Σ_i^G, Σ_i^H has at most one element; being inhabited, that factor is a singleton. Hence every composite i-deviation changes only the other factor, so $D_i^{H\circ G} = E_i^G \cup E_i^H$. Apply Theorem 5.65.

□

Corollary 5.67 (Selection by one agent across a composite interaction)**.** *For* $G : A \to B$*,* $H : B \to C$*, and a comparison context* P *on* $\mathcal{C}(A, C)$*, the equilibrium condition at* (σ, τ) *is*

$$\bigwedge_i \ \forall a \in \Sigma_i^G \ \forall b \in \Sigma_i^H \ \neg P_i\big(h_\tau g_\sigma, h_{\tau[i\leftarrow b]} g_{\sigma[i\leftarrow a]}\big).$$

For tensor composition, replace the two sequential composites by the corresponding tensor products. These are selections on the complete agent interfaces of Proposition 3.22.

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** The alternatives of agent i in the composite are exactly the pairs $(a, b) \in \Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H$. Substitute its composite realization in Theorem 5.45. Its universal quantifier over that product is the displayed pair of quantifiers. The tensor case is the same substitution using the tensor realization.

□

5.6.7 Additive reward composition

The deviation-cover condition is one route to equilibrium factorization. Another is a specified separable reward: if the evaluation is additive across the two components, a joint change improves the sum only if the component best-response conditions fail somewhere. This argument applies even when one owner controls both components, because its complete paired policy remains the unit of deviation.

Construction 5.68 (Additive reward composition)**.**

(1) **Add the component rewards.** For two games with separate retained outcome records, form their parallel interaction and evaluate agent i by $v_i(s, t) = u_i^G(s) + u_i^H(t)$. For disjoint measured branches with respective records $(c, z), (d, z')$, take additive intrinsic rewards and an additive price ℓ_i. The writer pairs the outcomes at charge $c + d$, so

$$u_i^G(z) + u_i^H(z') - \ell_i(c + d) = (u_i^G(z) - \ell_i(c)) + (u_i^H(z') - \ell_i(d)).$$

This gives the displayed factorization for the evaluated component utilities. In general an evaluator of $c + d$ can couple the two choices.

(2) **Retain joint ownership.** This defines the additive reward composition, with owner i controlling both s_i and t_i.

Proposition 5.69 (Additive equilibrium factorization)**.**

$$\mathrm{NE}(G \boxplus H) = \mathrm{NE}(G) \times \mathrm{NE}(H).$$

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** A profitable component deviation gives a profitable joint deviation by keeping the other coordinate fixed. Conversely, at two component equilibria each component's utility weakly decreases under its corresponding deviation, so their sum cannot increase under any joint deviation. This is a specified economic composition with a proof; it does not impose separability on an arbitrary pre-existing institutional context.

□

5.6.8 Fibred substitution and changes of strategic power

Construction 5.70 (The deviation comparison of a reparametrisation)**.**

(1) **Construct the comparison map.** For $r : G \to H$ and $i \in N$, put

$$E_i(r) = \Sigma^G \times_{\Sigma^H, p_1} D_i^H, \qquad \lambda_i : D_i^G \to E_i(r), \quad (\sigma, \tau) \mapsto (\sigma, (\bar{r}\sigma, \bar{r}\tau)).$$

It is a map over Σ^G.

(2) **Compare its endpoints.** Its paired realization in H equals the paired realization in G, because $g = h\bar{r}$. These maps commute with composition of reparametrisations: factoring through successive reference pullbacks or through their composite sends (σ, τ) to the same pair of images.

Theorem 5.71 (Strategic transport and exact quotient transport)**.** *For every ownerwise reparametrisation $r : G \to H$ and common comparison context on their concurrent-arrow sort,*

$$\bar{r}^* \mathsf{NE}_H \leq \mathsf{NE}_G. \tag{5.9}$$

For the ownerwise quotient presentations of Theorem 5.73, the comparison maps λ_i are surjective and the displayed inclusion is equality. For a reference context $s : W \to \Sigma^G$, by contrast, substitution always gives the exact predicate

$$s^* \mathsf{NE}_G = \bigwedge_i \forall_{d_i^s} \neg(\delta_i^G a_i)^* P_i, \quad D_i^s = W \times_{\Sigma^G, p_1} D_i^G, \tag{5.10}$$

where d_i^s and a_i are the two pullback projections.

A reparametrization carries each source deviation to a deviation at the same target reference.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D_i^G & \xrightarrow{\lambda_i} & \Sigma^G \times_{\Sigma^H} D_i^H \\ {\scriptstyle p_1}\downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \Sigma^G & = & \Sigma^G \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** An alternative in D_i^G maps under λ_i to an alternative of H at the image reference, with identical realized interactions. If none of the latter alternatives improves the comparison, neither does an original alternative. Conjunction over i proves Equation (5.9).

(2) **Lifting along the surjection.** For an ownerwise quotient r, take an element $(\sigma, (\bar{r}\sigma, \eta))$ of $E_i(r)$. Its outsiders already agree with those of $\bar{r}\sigma$. Surjectivity of r_i supplies $b \in \Sigma_i^G$ with $r_i(b) = \eta_i$.

(3) **Lifting along the surjection: second comparison.** The profile $\tau = (\sigma_{-i}, b)$ is a lift. Thus every alternative in the reference pullback has an original representative with the same comparison. Universal quantification over these fibres gives equality. Only the displayed single alternative is lifted; no section of the quotient is selected.

(4) **Beck–Chevalley for reference reindexing.** Finally, D_i^s is the cartesian lift of the deviation context along s. Beck–Chevalley from Theorem 5.22 gives $s^* \forall_{p_1} = \forall_{d_i^s} a_i^*$. Inverse image preserves negation and conjunction, proving Equation (5.10).

□

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} D_i^G & \xrightarrow{\lambda_i} & E_i(r) & \longrightarrow & D_i^H \\ & {\scriptstyle p_1}\searrow & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle p_1} \\ & & \Sigma^G & \xrightarrow[\bar{r}]{} & \Sigma^H \end{array}$$

Example 5.72 (A restriction is a change of game)**.** One owner has policies a, b with values $0, 1$. The larger game's equilibrium predicate is $\{b\}$. Reparametrising along $\{a\} \hookrightarrow \{a, b\}$ constructs the one-policy game, whose equilibrium predicate is $\{a\}$; the inverse image of $\{b\}$ is empty. Reference substitution along the same underlying map instead retains the alternative b in D_i^s, and correctly returns the empty predicate. The two operations have the same reference map but different deviation contexts.

5.6.9 Changing the presentation of available strategies

Theorem 5.73. *Let $f_i : \Sigma_i^G \twoheadrightarrow \Sigma_i^H$ be surjective maps with $g_\sigma = h_{f(\sigma)}$. In the same comparison context,*

$$\mathrm{NE}(G, \mathsf{Better}) = f^{-1}(\mathrm{NE}(H, \mathsf{Better})).$$

In a value-presented context the same equation is written with k in place of Better*.*

Proof.

(1) **Lifting deviations along surjective maps.** Apply Lemma 4.10 to the ownerwise surjection f, with full legal domain. It lifts every unilateral target deviation at a given reference while fixing all outsider policies. Since both realized endpoints agree under $g = hf$, the predicates of profitable deviations agree.

(2) **Lifting along the surjection.** Universal negation gives the stated equality of Nash predicates. The lift chooses preimages only for the finitely many coordinates varied by the deviation.

□

Remark 5.74 (Restriction of available policies). For injective parameter maps the useful implication is different. A profile that is an equilibrium in a larger strategy space remains an equilibrium when the available deviations are restricted and that profile is retained. The converse fails because enlarging a strategy space can create a profitable deviation. The 2-cell language therefore distinguishes redundant descriptions from genuine changes in strategic power.

Example 5.75 (Complementary commitments)**.** Two owners independently choose 0 or 1. Tensor their value-state presentations and evaluate the completed record by

$$u(0,0) = (0,0), \quad u(0,1) = (0,-1), \quad u(1,0) = (-1,0), \quad u(1,1) = (1,1).$$

The profile $(0,0)$ has only unilateral deviations giving the deviator -1; at $(1,1)$ a unilateral withdrawal gives 0. Both are equilibria. At either off-diagonal profile the contributor improves by withdrawing. Hence the equilibrium set is exactly $\{(0,0),(1,1)\}$.

5.7 Situated agent presentations

5.7.1 Declared presentations and reference states

Definition 5.76 (Situated presentation)**.** A situated presentation is displayed data

$$\mathsf{Ctx} = (a, L \hookrightarrow \Sigma, s : W \to L, (o_i : W \to O_i)_{i \in N}, (P_i)_{i \in N}).$$

Here a is an owned agent presentation, L is its legal policy domain, s selects the reference profile, o_i specifies observation, and P_i is its comparison interface, typed in Section 5.8. The state space may retain histories, private inputs, policies, and institutional records. Each observation is corestricted to its effective image whenever local states are quantified.

Construction 5.77 (Situated and legal presentations generated by a protocol)**.**

(1) **Realize the finite protocol.** Let U be the product of the external-input carriers of a finite causal decision protocol, V its node set, and Σ its complete owner profile space. The causal-height recursion gives the unique map

$$r : U \times \Sigma \longrightarrow \prod_{v \in V} M_v, \qquad W_{\mathrm{prot}} = \{(u, \sigma, a) : a = r(u, \sigma)\} \cong U \times \Sigma.$$

Let $s : W_{\mathrm{prot}} \to \Sigma$ be projection and $z : W_{\mathrm{prot}} \to Z$ the specified outcome-record map.

(2) **Read the observations.** Nodewise observations are the maps of Theorem 10.29: they are evaluated on their *own causal prefix* and use only actually available incoming wires. They need not coincide with one owner's later, accumulated observation record. Any final owner observation used in a situated presentation is the image of the specified actually delivered end-of-protocol signal; it is not the unrestricted product of all its earlier and later signals.

(3) **Form the acceptance and policy domains.** For an exhibited institutional acceptance predicate $Q \hookrightarrow Z$, first form the accepted-*state* subobject $P = z^*Q \hookrightarrow W_{\mathrm{prot}}$. There are canonical, distinct policy-domain constructions:

$$L_\exists = \exists_s P = \mathrm{im}(s|_P) \hookrightarrow \Sigma,$$
$$L_\forall = \forall_s P \hookrightarrow \Sigma.$$

The restricted map $s|_P$ factors canonically into a surjection $P \twoheadrightarrow L_\exists$ and its image inclusion; this gives the situated presentation of *accepted executions*. Pulling back s along $L_\forall \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ gives $W_\forall \to L_\forall$, the presentation of policies whose *every* external-input execution passes the acceptance test.

(4) **Retain certificates.** For exhibited certificates $k : K \to W_{\mathrm{prot}}$, the policy domain is $L_K = \mathrm{im}(sk)$, retaining K as its witness carrier. None of these subobjects is confused with the accepted-state predicate P. Preference comparisons and institutional acceptance rules remain separately supplied economic and normative inputs.

Proposition 5.78 (Universal characterization of protocol legality)**.** *$L_\exists$ consists exactly of profiles having at least one accepted execution. The subobject $L_\forall$ is the greatest $J \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ such that all protocol states with reference in J lie in P. These constructions are stable under substitution of ordinary protocol parameters along cartesian squares.*

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The first assertion is the image formula $\sigma \in L_\exists \iff \exists w\,(s(w) = \sigma \wedge P(w))$. For the second, the indexed adjunction gives

$$s^*J \subseteq P \iff J \subseteq \forall_s P.$$

Taking $J = L_\forall$ yields its desired acceptance and greatestness. Beck–Chevalley for the image/existential and the right dependent adjoint supplies substitution, with the same source pullback as the protocol's reference map. No execution representative is selected. □

The accepted execution space factors onto precisely the existentially legal profiles.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} P & \twoheadrightarrow & L_\exists \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ W_{\mathrm{prot}} & \xrightarrow[s]{} & \Sigma \end{array}$$

A situated presentation depends on declared owner and policy data. It does not extract a new reusable owner presentation from an arbitrary linear agent variable. Instead, an agent executes within a state context, whose displayed signature determines which control and observation tests are meaningful.

The need for the economic fields can be checked independently of the categorical construction. Reverse the preference on the same two-choice concurrent process: equilibrium

changes, although realization does not. Change the permitted subobject from E to $\varnothing$ for an unchanged execution span: permission changes without changing the underlying process. Replace a constant observation by an injective observation of the same worlds: knowledge changes without changing execution. Preferences, permissions, and nondelivered signals therefore cannot be reconstructed from a bare operational arrow. Where the information is generated by a protocol, Construction 5.77 instead derives its associated maps by image, pullback, and quotient. No additional agency equation is needed.

These constructions occupy three judgments: ordinary terms in $\mathcal{T}(W)$, linear terms in $\mathcal{L}(W)$, and assertions in $\mathcal{P}(W)$. The entailment $W \mid \Phi \vdash \varphi$ means $\bigcap_{\psi\in\Phi}[\![\psi]\!] \subseteq [\![\varphi]\!]$. Logical conjunction, implication, and ordinary quantification act on assertions; they do not supply a tensor diagonal to a linear resource. The concrete predicate fibres are Boolean, while proofs using only the adjunctions and Heyting operations remain constructive.

5.8 Legal feedback, best response and equilibrium

5.8.1 Comparison feedback and its pullback

The legal version of selection must compare only legal alternatives. Let H denote the retained outcome or interaction carrier, let $g : L \to H$ be its realization, and let $Q_i \hookrightarrow H \times H$ classify strict improvement in the second coordinate. Pulling this relation back along the paired realization supplies the improvement predicate on legal profiles.

$$P_i(\sigma,\tau) \iff Q_i(g\sigma, g\tau).$$

The realization g and comparison Q_i may be indexed by outsider policies or by an ordinary state context; the calculation is the same in each fibre. Evaluating a component inside a larger interaction first supplies its contextual realization into H. Inverse image of the joint comparison then gives the component feedback, compatibly with further wiring.

Proposition 5.79 (Compositional comparison feedback)**.** *If $k : H \to Z$ is a further contextual realization and $Q \subseteq Z^2$, then*

$$(g \times g)^*(k \times k)^* Q = ((kg) \times (kg))^* Q.$$

Hence evaluating a component in a composite context agrees with successive contextual evaluations, retaining the entire joint predicate.

Proof.

(1) **Compose inverse images.** Functoriality in Theorems 3.16 and 5.11 identifies both sides with $Q(kg\sigma, kg\tau)$, retaining the joint test.

□

The backward comparison must remain joint: separate marginal predicates would lose improvements that depend on complementary changes at decisions controlled by the same owner.

5.8.2 Selection and best response

Use the legal selection of Construction 5.44, now with feedback pulled back from Q_i on H. Its agent notation is

$$\mathrm{Sel}_i(u,v) = \varepsilon_{S_i^L(u)}(v, q_{i,u}^L), \qquad q_{i,u}^L(v)(v') = Q_i(g(u,v), g(u,v')),$$

for $v \in S_i^L(u)$, and it is false outside this legal fibre. The complete best response and its diagonal are

$$\mathsf{BR}_i(\sigma, v) = \mathrm{Sel}_i(\sigma_{-i}, v), \qquad \mathsf{NE}(\sigma) = \bigwedge_i \mathsf{BR}_i(\sigma, \sigma_i).$$

A situated state substitutes $\sigma = s(w)$.

Proposition 5.80 (Equilibrium from owned alternatives)**.**

$$\mathsf{NE}(\sigma) \iff \bigwedge_{i \in N} \forall \tau \, (\sigma D_i^L \tau \Rightarrow \neg P_i(\sigma, \tau)).$$

It is therefore an assertion constructed from the agent's displayed control, legality, realization, and comparison interfaces.

Proof.

(1) **Apply the legal fibre comparison.** This is the legal instance of Theorem 5.45 with $P_i = (g \times g)^* Q_i$. Its source-fixed insertion identifies the same legal choices and the same paired feedback.

□

Write $\Pi = \mathsf{Pol}_{o_i}(F_i)$ for the uniformly legal informed policies. For $\pi, \rho \in \Pi$ let

$$Q_w(\pi, \rho) = Q_i(g(s(w)[i := \pi(o_i w)]), g(s(w)[i := \rho(o_i w)])).$$

Two selection predicates on this same carrier have different meanings:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{EverywhereBest}(\pi) &\iff \forall w \in W \; \forall \rho \in \Pi \; \neg Q_w(\pi, \rho), \\ \mathsf{StrictlyUndominated}(\pi) &\iff \neg \exists \rho \in \Pi \; \forall w \in W \; Q_w(\pi, \rho). \end{aligned}$$

The first excludes improvement at each reference. The second excludes a single informed competitor that strictly improves at every reference. For two indistinguishable worlds and two always legal constant responses with payoff vectors $(1, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$, both responses satisfy the second predicate and neither satisfies the first. The two references can realize different outsider coordinates while giving i the same observation. Example 5.63 applies here: the product law $\Sigma_i^{a;b} = \Sigma_i^a \times \Sigma_i^b$ makes a joint change of this owner's component policies one unilateral deviation. Isolated decision tests do not establish equilibrium.

Proposition 5.81 (Equilibrium and the local inspection completion)**.** *Let $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ be a legal domain, and let $\mathcal{U}$ be any covering family of owner scopes. Retain the same realization and strict comparison predicates on all profiles. Then*

$$\mathrm{NE}_{\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L)} \cap L \;\subseteq\; \mathrm{NE}_L \,. \tag{5.11}$$

The inclusion can be strict. The operator $\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}$ is the local-inspection completion constructed in Theorem 7.2; it is not used to redefine the institution's permitted profiles.

Proof.

(1) **Compare legal alternative fibres.** The inflationary inclusion $L \subseteq \mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L)$ takes any legal deviation at $\sigma \in L$ to a deviation in the larger local-completion domain, leaving outsiders and both realized endpoints unchanged. The universal absence of improving deviations in the larger domain therefore entails the same absence in L.

(2) **Exhibit strictness.** Let two owners have policies $a, b \in 2$, legal domain $L = \{(a, b) : a \leq b\}$, and payoffs $u_1(a, b) = a$, $u_2(a, b) = 0$. The singleton-owner images of L are both 2, so the local completion is 2^2. At $(0, 0)$ owner 1 has no legal deviation to $a = 1$ with b fixed and owner 2 is indifferent; hence $(0, 0) \in \mathrm{NE}_L$. In the local completion the change $(0, 0) \mapsto (1, 0)$ is available and profitable for owner 1, so $(0, 0)$ fails its Nash test there. □

Evaluation has now been reduced to a predicate on the appropriate legal alternatives. The final example shows why the legal domain must remain explicit: enlarging it can remove an equilibrium. The next part determines which of those alternatives an owner can select from its information.

Part III
Information, institution, and epistemic dynamics

6 Observation, Perspective, and Knowledge

The preceding comparison tests complete policies against their alternatives. To determine which policies an owner can use, we must now account for its information. An observation map identifies histories that supply the same signal. Following the local-state account of Halpern and Fagin (1989), its quotient constructs both observation-based responses and knowledge. We extend this descent to dependent families so that resources and witnesses can be interpreted from the same perspective. Joint observation will then provide a precise comparison between decentralized choice and choice after information is pooled.

6.1 Observation and admissible policies

First take the image of the raw signal map. Two histories lie over the same point of this image precisely when the decision interface receives the same signal. Kernel-pair descent identifies the responses implementable at that interface. Section A.2.14 uses the same fibres to decide which assertions the owner knows.

6.2 Observation-based responses of an agent

Construction 6.1 (Observation quotient and admissible policies)**.**

(1) **Form the observation quotient.** Let H be a set of histories available at a decision and let $\widetilde{o} : H \to Y$ be the raw signal supplied by the protocol. Construct the observation object by the image factorization in **Set**,

$$H \xrightarrow{o} O \hookrightarrow Y, \qquad O = \widetilde{o}[H],$$

so o is the effective quotient obtained by corestricting the raw signal to its image. Equivalently, if indistinguishability is supplied directly as an equivalence relation $R \rightrightarrows H$, one may take its coequalizer $H \twoheadrightarrow H/R$.

(2) **Describe its policies.** Available policies with action set A are then functions $\pi : O \to A$. When H, O, A are finite, these functions have the concurrent realization of Proposition 1.23.

For a concrete example take histories $H = \{h_1, h_2, h_3\}$, observations $O = \{o, o'\}$ with $o(h_1) = o(h_2) = o$ and $o(h_3) = o'$, and actions $A = \{0, 1\}$. An admissible history response is determined by two choices, one for o and one for o', so there are four such policies. The response assigning 0 at h_1 and 1 at h_2 is inadmissible for this observation. The raw signal's image removes unused signal labels without changing any decision the agent can make.

Proposition 6.2 (Admissibility as effective descent)**.** *Let*

$$H \times_O H \underset{p_1}{\overset{p_2}{\rightrightarrows}} H \xrightarrow{o} O$$

be the kernel pair of the constructed observation quotient. For every action set A, precomposition gives an equalizer

$$A^O \xrightarrow{o^*} A^H \underset{p_1^*}{\overset{p_2^*}{\rightrightarrows}} A^{H \times_O H}.$$

Consequently a response $f : H \to A$ is implementable using only the observation o exactly when it equalizes the observation kernel pair, equivalently when there is a unique $\pi : O \to A$ with $f = \pi o$.

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** The image factorization makes o surjective. By effective regularity of **Set** it is the coequalizer of its kernel pair. A map $f : H \to A$ equalizes the two projections precisely when

$$o(h) = o(h') \Longrightarrow f(h) = f(h').$$

The coequalizer universal property therefore gives a unique factor $\pi : O \to A$ with $f = \pi o$.

(2) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** Applying the contravariant representable $\mathbf{Set}(-, A)$ to this coequalizer is exactly the displayed equalizer. Thus "admissible" introduces no further policy datum: it names this descent property.

□

Admissible response strategies factor through the effective observation quotient.

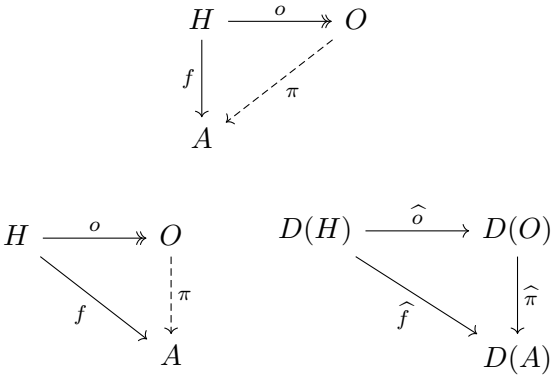


Figure 4: An information restriction is effective descent through the constructed observation quotient; finite response protocols realize the factorization concurrently.

The left square expresses the information restriction; for finite data, Proposition 1.23 realizes the same factorization by concurrent response strategies. The policy responds after its actual observation event. Other strategies on the arenas may stall or behave differently; effective descent classifies the specified total response family. In particular, a decision cannot depend on a signal whose event has not occurred in its causal past.

6.3 An individual agent's knowledge from observation

Definition 6.3 (Observations, indistinguishability, and knowledge)**.** An **observation** is information actually made available to an agent. States yielding the same observation are **indistinguishable** to that agent. It knows a predicate when the predicate holds at every indistinguishable state.

Let W be a set of economic states and $o_i : W \to O_i$ an observation map. Its epistemic relation is the kernel-pair span

$$W \xleftarrow{p_1} W \times_{O_i} W \xrightarrow{p_2} W.$$

Knowledge is the corresponding universal span modality:

$$K_i P = [\ker(o_i)]P = \forall_{p_1} p_2^* P. \tag{6.1}$$

For example, observing whether a public total is zero need not reveal the individual contributions that produced it. The resulting knowledge concerns everything forced by that observation, not a probability assigned to the unobserved states.

Definition 6.4 (Factivity and introspection)**.** A knowledge operator K_i is **factive** when $K_i P \le P$ for every predicate P. It has **positive introspection** when $K_i P \le K_i K_i P$, and **negative introspection** when $\neg K_i P \le K_i \neg K_i P$. These conditions say, respectively, that knowledge implies truth, that an agent knows what it knows, and that it knows when it does not know.

Because an observation kernel pair is an equivalence relation, it also determines the familiar factivity and introspection conditions. The same reasoning applies after epistemic action update when the updated relation arises from the effective observation quotient of Proposition 9.22.

Proposition 6.5 (Factivity and introspection)**.** *For an observation map, $K_i P \le P$, $K_i P \le K_i K_i P$, and $\neg K_i P \le K_i \neg K_i P$.*

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** The observation kernel pair is reflexive, so the reference state is an alternative. Every related state has the same equivalence class. Truth of P throughout that class is therefore invariant throughout it, as is its negation.

(2) **Predicate calculation.** These arguments use the implication and negation operations of the predicate doctrine.

□

Two kernel pairs appear in strategic reasoning. Fixing outsider policies compares changes under a coalition's control. Fixing an observation compares states the owner cannot distinguish. The modalities for intervention and for knowledge therefore quantify over different pairs, even when they are predicates on the same state carrier.

Corollary 6.6 (Observation quotients classify invariant predicates)**.** *For a constructed observation quotient $o : W \twoheadrightarrow O$, put $K_o = o^* \forall_o$ and $M_o = o^* \exists_o$. Knowledge is the idempotent comonad K_o, and possibility is the idempotent monad M_o. For a predicate P, the following are equivalent: it is the pullback of a unique predicate on O; it is invariant on* $\ker(o)$*; $K_o P = P$; and $M_o P = P$. Moreover $K_o P \le P \le M_o P$ and*

$$\mathrm{Coalg}(K_o) \cong \mathsf{Pred}(O) \cong \mathrm{Alg}(M_o).$$

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The relation factorization identifies the knowledge and possibility operators with the displayed composites. Apply Theorem 5.31 and effective predicate descent.

□

The quotient plays two roles that are now visibly linked. Its maps into action sets classify implementable responses by Proposition 6.2; its descended predicates classify observation-invariant assertions by Corollary 6.6. The operational and epistemic interpretations therefore arise from one effective quotient, not from separate information primitives.

Proposition 6.7 (An agent's responses and observation-local assertions)**.** *For an effective observation quotient $o_i : W \twoheadrightarrow \Omega_i$ and an action set M, there are canonical identifications*

$$M^{\Omega_i} \cong \{f : W \to M : \ker(o_i) \subseteq \ker(f)\}, \qquad \mathsf{Pred}(\Omega_i) \cong \{P \in \mathsf{Pred}(W) : K_i P = P\}.$$

The first identifies admissible responses; the second identifies assertions local to the agent's current observation.

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** The first bijection is precomposition with o_i and its inverse is the unique factorization of Proposition 6.2.

(2) **Lifting along the surjection.** For the second, $o_i^* B$ is constant on every observation fibre, hence equals its own knowledge predicate. If $K_i P = P$, every fibre meeting P lies entirely in P, so $P = o_i^{-1}(o_i[P])$. Surjectivity makes the representing subset unique.

(3) **Observation and knowledge.** These maps are exactly the predicate descent and knowledge identifications already constructed.

□

Observation-local assertions live on the common situated carrier W alongside assertions about other agents and later events. At a particular decision, however, the relevant quotient is that decision's actual history-to-signal map. Applying the same factorization at the correct causal stage yields precisely the responses available there.

Observation descent versus causal descent. The effective observation quotient above concerns a map of ordinary state sets and classifies history responses uniform on its kernel pair. The causal sheaf of Theorem 1.11 instead glues compatible partial synchronization witnesses. Neither descent theorem implies the other. In particular, knowledge following a delivered event must be evaluated on records retaining that event; a restriction that forgets the receipt can identify worlds previously distinguished. The observation-anchored retained-witness comparison of Theorem 9.34 establishes the exact relationship for the finite protocols whose receipt records are constructed in Section 10.4.

6.4 Qualitative belief and common knowledge

Definition 6.8 (Possibility model and belief)**.** A **possibility model** records which states each agent considers possible. An agent **believes** a predicate when it holds at every state it considers possible. The actual state need not be among them, so belief need not imply truth. If the possibility set is empty, universal belief is vacuous; no nonemptiness condition is implicit.

A possibility model over a profile space Σ consists of a set W, a map $s : W \to \Sigma$, and relations $R_i \hookrightarrow W^2$. Put $P_i(w) = \{w' : wR_iw'\}$, $B_i = [R_i]$, and $E(P) = \bigwedge_i B_iP$. No relational laws are implicit. Observation maps construct the special case $R_i = \ker(o_i)$.

Definition 6.9 (Common belief and common knowledge)**. Common belief** requires belief by every agent, belief by every agent that all agents believe, and all further finite iterations. For observation relations, **common knowledge** also includes truth at the current state. The two fixed points below distinguish iterated belief from truth along all finite chains, including the chain of length zero.

Define

$$\mathsf{CB}(P) = \nu X\, E(P \wedge X), \qquad C_P = \nu X\, (P \wedge E(X)). \tag{6.2}$$

When the relations are observation kernel pairs, call C_P the **common-knowledge predicate** $\mathsf{CK}(P)$. Let $R = \bigcup_i R_i$ and let R^* be the reflexive transitive closure constructed from finite R-paths, including paths of length zero.

Proposition 6.10 (Truth, common belief, and finite paths)**.** *For every finite owner list, including the empty list,*

$$C_P = P \wedge \mathsf{CB}(P) = [R^*]P.$$

In particular $\mathsf{CK}(P) \leq P$*.*

Proof.

(1) **Coinduction and bisimulation.** The fixed-point equation for C_P gives $C_P \leq P$ and $C_P \leq E(C_P) = E(P \wedge C_P)$, so coinduction gives $C_P \leq P \wedge \mathsf{CB}(P)$.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, with $B = \mathsf{CB}(P)$, the predicate $P \wedge B$ equals $P \wedge E(P \wedge B)$ and is fixed for the operator defining C_P. For the path description, any post-fixed point of $X \mapsto P \wedge E(X)$ satisfies P after every finite path by induction on path length.

(3) **Reverse implication: completion.** Conversely $[R^*]P \leq P$ by the zero-length path and is closed under one further R-step, so it is post-fixed. Coinduction proves equality. For $N = \varnothing$, these formulas give $\mathsf{CB}(P) = \top$ and $C_P = P$, as required.

□

Theorem 6.11 (Common knowledge as a coreflection)**.** *For observation relations* $R_i = \ker(o_i)$*, the relation* $E = (\bigcup_i R_i)^*$ *is an equivalence relation. Its quotient* $c : W \twoheadrightarrow W/E$ *satisfies*

$$\mathsf{CK} = c^*\forall_c, \qquad \mathrm{Coalg}(\mathsf{CK}) = \bigcap_i \mathrm{Coalg}(K_i).$$

Thus common knowledge is the greatest jointly observation-invariant predicate below the given predicate.

Proof.

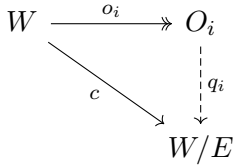
(1) **Fixed-point argument.** Reflexivity and transitivity hold by the path construction. Reversing each edge of a finite path proves symmetry. A predicate is E-invariant iff it is invariant under every R_i: one direction uses the inclusions and the other is induction on path length.

(2) **Adjunction and transposition.** The finite-path characterization gives $\mathsf{CK} = [E] = c^*\forall_c$. Apply Theorem 5.31 to c and to the image factorization of each o_i. Their fixed predicates are exactly the invariant predicates just identified.

(3) **Ownerwise alternatives.** If the owner list is empty, E is equality and the same proof gives the identity coreflection.

□

Each observation quotient factors through the equivalence quotient defining common knowledge.



Corollary 6.12 (Common knowledge after epistemic action update)**.** *Let $R_i = \ker(o_i)$ and $S_i = \ker(b_i)$ in the action model of Section 9.1.3. On the updated carrier U, put $c_{\mathcal{E}} : U \twoheadrightarrow U/{\sim}$, where $\sim$ is generated by the union of its updated knowledge relations. Then*

$$\mathsf{CK}_{\mathcal{E}}(Q) = \left[\left(\bigcup_i R_i^{\mathcal{E}}\right)^*\right] Q = c_{\mathcal{E}}^* \forall_{c_{\mathcal{E}}} Q.$$

For the pointed action e, the corresponding assertion at the old state sort is $[\mathcal{E}, e]\mathsf{CK}_{\mathcal{E}}(Q)$. For a singleton public action, this recovers the common-knowledge specialization of Section 9.1.1.

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** Proposition 9.22 constructs each updated kernel relation. Their reflexive transitive union is an equivalence relation, and Theorem 6.11 identifies its box with the displayed quotient coreflection. Equation (9.10) transports the result through the chosen action component; the singleton case is Theorem 9.16.

□

Theorem 6.13 (Categorical validity of agency operations)**.** *The ordinary dependent fibres and their subterminal fragment recover P_G, its quantifier adjunctions, and comprehension. The relation-action and comprehension-update equations hold in these fibres, as do the order-theoretic induction and coinduction properties of positive fixed-point operators. For external parameters Γ and a fixed state sort X, pointwise parameterized fixed points commute with ordinary substitution in Γ.*

Proof.

(1) **Base-change comparison.** Theorem 5.22 supplies the quantifier adjunctions, equality, comprehension, and Beck–Chevalley. Construction 5.27 supplies dependent types; Proposition 7.11 supplies the internal modal typing.

(2) **Fixed-point argument.** The modal and update equations were proved using these operations, and Theorem 5.37 identifies their operational tests with substitution of concurrent realization terms. For fixed relations the ordinary polarity induction proves monotonicity. For the extended contextual grammar, Lemma A.6 gives the corresponding induction after expanding the changing domains. The fixed-point theorem then applies.

(3) **Fixed-point argument: second comparison.** For a family F_γ on $\mathsf{Pred}(X)$, the operator on $\mathsf{Pred}(\Gamma \times X)$ acting fiberwise has least fixed point with fiber μF_γ: it is fixed fiberwise and lies below every fixed predicate fiberwise. The greatest case is dual. Substitution in Γ merely selects these same fibers.

(4) **Functoriality and substitution.** Changes to the state carrier are handled by the separate transport results, not by this parameter-substitution assertion.

□

Remark 6.14 (Relation to strategy logics). Explicit quantification over complete policies places these assertions in contact with strategy logics such as Mogavero et al. (2012). Here the interpretation is supplied by concurrent open-arena realizations and the predicate doctrine. The soundness theorem concerns this interpretation; it does not import model-checking results for a different class of models.

A completed charge $m : K \to C$ can enter the institutional evaluator even when an owner receives only $o_i : K \to O_i$. Corestrict o_i to its effective image. The owner can read the charge from that observation exactly when m is constant on $\ker(o_i)$, by effective descent. A public or private charge report instead gives a new observation $\langle o_i, m\rangle$ to the recipients and the corresponding kernel relation. Preference evaluation alone supplies no such report.

6.5 Dependent observation descent

Observation has so far classified individual responses and known predicates. An agent can also carry a dependent family of resources or witnesses. Effective descent transports that family to the observation interface; Morita comparisons identify presentations of the same observations, and kernel inclusions compare their strength. This provides the family-level comparison needed to distinguish independent local responses from responses to a delivered joint signal.

6.5.1 Descent in the dependent-type fibration

Construction 6.15 (The slice adjunctions)**.**

(1) **Define the fibrewise functors.** For a map $q : X \to Q$, regard an object of $\mathbf{Set}/X$ as a family $(E_x)_{x\in X}$. Define

$$(q_!E)_u = \coprod_{q(x)=u} E_x, \qquad (q^*F)_x = F_{q(x)}, \qquad (q_*E)_u = \prod_{q(x)=u} E_x.$$

(2) **Construct their adjunctions.** The universal properties of disjoint union and product give natural bijections proving $q_! \dashv q^* \dashv q_*$. The empty sum and empty product are included. On maps these functors act componentwise.

(3) **Form the monad and comonad.** Write $T_q = q^*q_!$ and $G_q = q^*q_*$ for the induced monad and comonad on $\mathbf{Set}/X$.

Definition 6.16 (Kernel groupoid and its actions)**.** For a surjection $q : X \twoheadrightarrow Q$, the **presentation groupoid** R_q has objects X and an arrow $(x, y) : y \to x$ exactly when $q(x) = q(y)$. Its identity, inverse, and composition are (x, x), $(x, y)^{-1} = (y, x)$, and $(x, y)(y, z) = (x, z)$. An action of R_q is a family E_x with maps $\tau_{xy} : E_y \to E_x$ satisfying

$$\tau_{xx} = \mathrm{id}, \qquad \tau_{xy}\tau_{yz} = \tau_{xz}.$$

An equivariant map is a family of functions commuting with all these maps. The resulting category is denoted $\mathrm{Act}(R_q)$.

Theorem 6.17 (Effective descent as algebra and coalgebra)**.** *There are canonical equivalences*

$$\mathrm{Alg}(T_q) \simeq \mathrm{Act}(R_q) \simeq \mathbf{Set}/Q \simeq \mathrm{Coalg}(G_q).$$

The comparison from $\mathbf{Set}/Q$ *is pullback with its canonical transport. It requires no chosen section of* q*.*

Proof.

(1) **Unit and identity laws.** The unit of T_q includes E_x in the x-summand, and its multiplication forgets the middle index in a twice-indexed sum. Consequently a T_q-algebra is exactly a family τ_{xy} with the displayed identity and composition equations. These equations imply that τ_{xy} and τ_{yx} are inverse. Algebra morphisms are exactly equivariant maps.

(2) **Construction on states and events.** Given an action, define

$$\bar{E}_u = \left(\coprod_{q(x)=u} E_x \right) / \sim, \qquad (x,e) \sim (y,e') \iff e = \tau_{xy}(e').$$

The action laws prove that this is an equivalence relation. For each x, the map $E_x \to \bar{E}_{q(x)}$, $e \mapsto [(x,e)]$, is injective by $\tau_{xx} = \mathrm{id}$ and surjective because $[(y,e')] = [(x, \tau_{xy}(e'))]$.

(3) **Descent along the kernel pair.** These bijections intertwine the action with the identity transports on the pullback of $\bar{E}$. Equivariant maps descend by $[(x,e)] \mapsto [(x, f_x(e))]$.

(4) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, pulling back a family on Q and applying this quotient returns the original family: the map $[(x,e)] \mapsto e$ is a bijection on each fiber, with surjectivity supplied by q. The displayed maps are natural, establishing the equivalence.

(5) **Structure of perspective coalgebras.** A G_q-coalgebra is a family $c_x : E_x \to \prod_{q(y)=q(x)} E_y$. Its counit law says that the x-component of c_x is the identity. Its coassociativity says that the component maps from E_x to E_y and then E_z compose to the component from E_x to E_z.

(6) **Equivalence with groupoid actions.** Thus its components are precisely the transports τ_{yx} above; coalgebra morphisms are again equivariant maps.

(7) **Conclusion of the calculation: completion.** This proves the remaining equivalence. The slice adjunctions follow the categorical-logical account of Jacobs (1999); the fiber formulas give the descent used here.

□

$$\mathbf{Set}/Q \underset{q_*}{\overset{q^*}{\underset{\longleftarrow}{\overset{\longrightarrow}{q_!}}}} \mathbf{Set}/X \qquad \mathrm{Alg}(T_q) \xrightarrow{\simeq} \mathrm{Act}(R_q) \xrightarrow{\simeq} \mathbf{Set}/Q$$

The same observable information can have different raw-history presentations. Suppose $X \twoheadrightarrow Q$ and $Y \twoheadrightarrow Q$ present the quotient Q. The pullback of pairs (x,y) with the same image gives the comparison bibundle. Its principal actions ensure that policies and dependent families descended from Q do not depend on a chosen history presentation; no additional signal becomes available to an agent.

Definition 6.18 (Principal comparison and Morita equivalence)**.** Fix groupoids G and H in **Set**. A (G, H)-**bibundle** consists of anchor maps $G_0 \xleftarrow{\alpha} P \xrightarrow{\beta} H_0$ and commuting left and right actions, typed as

$$G_1 \times_{s,\alpha} P \longrightarrow P, \quad (g, p) \mapsto gp, \qquad P \times_{\beta,t} H_1 \longrightarrow P, \quad (p, h) \mapsto ph.$$

Each action satisfies its groupoid unit and composition laws and preserves the opposite anchor. It is **biprincipal** when both anchors are surjective and both canonical maps

$$G_1 \times_{s,\alpha} P \xrightarrow{\cong} P \times_{\beta} P, \quad (g, p) \longmapsto (gp, p),$$
$$P \times_{\beta,t} H_1 \xrightarrow{\cong} P \times_{\alpha} P, \quad (p, h) \longmapsto (p, ph)$$

are bijective. Thus, over either anchor, two points differ by a unique arrow of the other groupoid. **Morita equivalence** here means an equivalence implemented by such a bibundle. The balanced product identifies $(p \cdot h, p')$ with $(p, h \cdot p')$ wherever defined. All these groupoids are set-based; compare Landsman (2001).

Theorem 6.19 (Morita invariance of effective presentations)**.** *For surjections $X \xrightarrow{q} Q \xleftarrow{r} Y$, the set $P = X \times_Q Y$ is a biprincipal (R_q, R_r)-bibundle. Moreover*

$$P \otimes_{R_r} P^{\mathrm{op}} \cong R_q, \qquad P^{\mathrm{op}} \otimes_{R_q} P \cong R_r, \qquad \mathrm{Act}(R_q) \simeq \mathbf{Set}/Q \simeq \mathrm{Act}(R_r).$$

These equivalences preserve data descended from Q.

Proof.

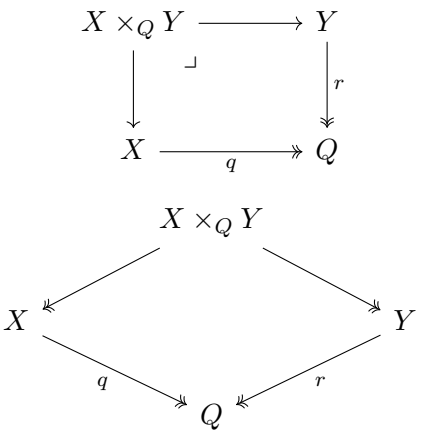
(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** The anchors are the two projections. The actions replace the X or Y coordinate along the corresponding kernel arrow and therefore commute. The anchors are surjective by pullback stability of surjections.

(2) **Monoidal comparison.** Over a fixed y, the unique arrow from (x, y) to (x', y) is (x', x); the other principality equation is identical with the roles reversed. The first balanced product sends the class of $((x, y), (y, x'))$ to (x, x'). Each admissible pair (x, x') has such a representative because r is surjective.

(3) **Monoidal comparison: completion.** Any two choices of y differ by the unique kernel arrow and hence give the same balanced class. This proves the first bijection, including equivariance; the second is symmetric. The equivalences of action categories follow from Theorem 6.17. Both identify pulled-back data with the same family on Q, which proves the last assertion.

□

The comparison bibundle is the pullback of the two quotient presentations.



Remark 6.20 (What the comparison retains). A semantic realization $Q \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$, an observation on Q, or a predicate on Q pulls back to both presentations. Data not constant on the quotient fibers remain on the larger presentation. In particular, economic invariance also requires the deviation comparisons constructed in Section 14.1; it does not follow from equivalence of unadorned groupoids alone.

For a response term $a : W \to A$ and observation $o : W \to O$, descent along o says that a is constant on the kernel of o. Its unique factor is $\bar{a}$, and tests satisfy $a^*P = o^*\bar{a}^*P$. This factorization through o also holds for dependent policies in the corresponding slice; constant types place it in the state context of an owned arena. This identifies the mathematical meaning of a policy's dependence on available information.

Proposition 6.21 (Effective descent of dependent linear interfaces)**.** *Let $q : X \twoheadrightarrow Y$. A family $A_x \in \widehat{\mathcal{C}}$ with natural isomorphisms $\theta_{x'x} : A_x \to A_{x'}$ whenever $q(x) = q(x')$, satisfying identity and composition, descends to a family $\bar{A}_y$, uniquely up to its canonical isomorphism. Equivariant families of arrows descend as well.*

Proof.

(1) **Predicate calculation.** For each y, c form the set

$$\bar{A}_y(c) = \left(\coprod_{q(x)=y} A_x(c) \right) / ((x, a) \sim (x', \theta_{x'x,c}(a))).$$

The identity and composition equations make this an equivalence relation. For $v : d \to c$ define restriction by $[x, a] \mapsto [x, A_x(v)a]$; naturality of θ makes it well-defined. The presheaf identities hold on representatives.

(2) **Functoriality and substitution.** For each x the map $a \mapsto [x, a]$ is bijective onto $\bar{A}_{q(x)}(c)$: its inverse sends $[x', a']$ to $\theta_{xx',c}(a')$. This formula is independent of the representative and is natural in c. An equivariant arrow sends $[x, a]$ to the class of its image.

(3) **Descent along the kernel pair.** The same formula proves uniqueness of descent and of its canonical comparison with any other descended family. No representative of a fibre of q is selected. Tensor and the other fibre constructions transport along these natural isomorphisms; their substitution comparisons are those of Theorem 1.50.

□

6.5.2 Observation quotients and local agreement

Theorem 6.22 (Testing the order of information)**.** *For two observation maps $o_j : H \twoheadrightarrow O_j$, the following are equivalent:*

(i) *there is a map $q : O_2 \to O_1$ with $o_1 = qo_2$;*

(ii) $\ker(o_2) \subseteq \ker(o_1)$*;*

(iii) *for every action set A, every response implementable using o_1 is implementable using o_2;*

(iv) *the response $o_1 : H \to O_1$, induced by the identity policy on O_1, is implementable using o_2;*

(v) *every binary-valued policy based on o_1 is implementable using o_2.*

The factor q is unique and surjective.

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** Factorization implies kernel inclusion. Conversely, if $\ker(o_2) \subseteq \ker(o_1)$, then o_1 equalizes the kernel pair of o_2. Since o_2 is the coequalizer of its kernel pair, there is a unique q with $o_1 = qo_2$.

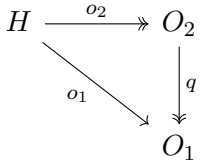
(2) **Verification of the universal property.** Surjectivity of q follows from $o_1 = qo_2$ and surjectivity of o_1.

(3) **Policy-level comparison.** If $o_1 = qo_2$ and $\pi : O_1 \to A$, then the same response is implemented using o_2 by the policy πq, proving the third clause. The third clause applied to $A = O_1$ and $\pi = \mathrm{id}_{O_1}$ gives the fourth. The fourth clause is exactly the existence of a map q with $o_1 = qo_2$, so the cycle of implications closes.

(4) **Separate observations by binary tests.** The third clause implies the fifth. Conversely, if $o_2(h) = o_2(h')$ but $o_1(h) \neq o_1(h')$, the characteristic function of $\{o_1(h)\}$ separates the two o_1-observations and cannot factor through o_2. In the existing classical **Set** base this uses no finiteness of either carrier.

□

Information refinement is witnessed by factorization of effective observation maps.



Proposition 6.23 (Gluing observation-based policies)**.** *Let $H = \bigcup_\alpha H_\alpha$, and suppose local policies $\pi_\alpha : o[H_\alpha] \to A$ are given. They glue to one admissible policy iff*

$$o(h) = o(h'),\ h \in H_\alpha,\ h' \in H_\beta \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \pi_\alpha(o(h)) = \pi_\beta(o(h')).$$

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** Necessity follows by restriction of a common function. For sufficiency, fix an observation $z \in O$. Because the patches cover H and o is onto, there is a pair (α, h) with $h \in H_\alpha$ and $o(h) = z$.

(2) **Gluing observation-based policies.** The displayed agreement shows that all such pairs determine the same value $\pi_\alpha(z)$. Thus there exists a unique value $a_z \in A$ with this property; define $\pi(z) = a_z$. This pointwise unique-value construction gives the global function without choosing representatives, and proves uniqueness.

(3) **Observation and knowledge.** Agreement only on the literal intersections $H_\alpha \cap H_\beta$ would be insufficient: disjoint history patches can still contain observationally indistinguishable histories.

□

6.5.3 Information refinement and complete agent policies

Construction 6.24 (Information refinement and its presentation map)**.**

(1) **Embed the old policies.** Suppose $o_1 = q \circ o_2$ for observation quotients $o_j : H \twoheadrightarrow O_j$. Surjectivity of o_1 implies that $q : O_2 \twoheadrightarrow O_1$ is surjective. Precomposition gives

$$q^* : A^{O_1} \hookrightarrow A^{O_2}, \qquad \pi \longmapsto \pi \circ q.$$

It is injective because equal composites with a surjection are equal. The resulting responses on H are unchanged. Thus old policies embed in the more informed policy space, preserving their realized behavior.

When H, O_j, A are finite this embedding is itself a 2-cell of open arenas.

(2) **Realize the change of observation.** Define the single-owner observed decision arena

$$\mathsf{ObsDec}_i(o, A) : D(H) \longrightarrow D(A)$$

by

$$\Sigma_i = A^O, \qquad \Sigma_j = 1 \ (j \neq i), \qquad \pi \longmapsto \widehat{\pi} \circ \widehat{o} = \widehat{\pi o}.$$

If $o_1 = qo_2$, functoriality of the response protocols gives

$$\widehat{\pi o_1} = \widehat{(\pi q) o_2},$$

so the injective map $q^* : A^{O_1} \hookrightarrow A^{O_2}$ is a realization-preserving 2-cell

$$\mathsf{ObsDec}_i(o_1, A) \Longrightarrow \mathsf{ObsDec}_i(o_2, A).$$

Thus refinement of information is represented by ordinary parameter reindexing in $\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})$, while the observation wire itself is the explicitly constructed map $\widehat{o}$.

A finer signal lets a policy prescribe different actions where previously it had to give the same response. The injection above embeds the old policies into this enlarged carrier. Stability against the enlarged set implies stability against the old choices at a retained profile. An old equilibrium can fail the new test because the signal makes a profitable deviation implementable.

Construction 6.25 (Pooled observation)**.**

(1) **Take the joint observation image.** For a coalition C of observers on a common history space, form the product map

$$\langle o_i \rangle_{i \in C} : H \longrightarrow \prod_{i \in C} O_i$$

and take its image factorization

$$H \twoheadrightarrow O_C \hookrightarrow \prod_{i \in C} O_i.$$

This is the pooled observation quotient.

(2) **Compute its kernel pair.** Its kernel pair is

$$\ker(o_C) = \bigcap_{i \in C} \ker(o_i),$$

because equality in the product is coordinatewise equality. Thus pooled information is constructed as the effective quotient of the joint signal, not assumed to fill the whole Cartesian product of observation values. Pooling information remains distinct from allowing a coalition to coordinate its choices; either operation may occur without the other.

Proposition 6.26 (Decentralized policies inside the pooled-information interface)**.** *For a nonempty coalition C, let $o_C : H \twoheadrightarrow O_C$ be the pooled observation quotient and $p_i : O_C \twoheadrightarrow O_i$ its coordinate maps. For action sets M_i there is a canonical injection*

$$J_C : \prod_{i\in C} M_i^{O_i} \hookrightarrow \left(\prod_{i\in C} M_i\right)^{O_C}, \qquad J_C((\pi_i)_i)(o) = (\pi_i(p_i(o)))_i.$$

Its image consists exactly of joint policies whose ith output is constant on $\ker(p_i)$ for each i. Its composite with the observation o_C is the original tuple of decentralized responses on H.

Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** Each p_i is surjective because $p_i o_C = o_i$ and o_i is surjective. Consequently equality after precomposition with every p_i implies equality of every π_i, proving injectivity. If a joint policy is in the image, its ith component factors through p_i and is constant on its kernel pair.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely such constancy gives a unique factor $\pi_i : O_i \to M_i$ by effective descent. Their tuple is the unique preimage under J_C. Finally $p_i o_C = o_i$ gives $J_C((\pi_i)_i)o_C = (\pi_i o_i)_i$.

□

Decentralized responses coincide with evaluation of the induced pooled policy.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H & \xrightarrow{\;o_C\;} & O_C \\ {\scriptstyle (\pi_i o_i)_i}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle J_C((\pi_i)_i)} \\ \prod_i M_i & = & \prod_i M_i \end{array}$$

Placing two decisions under joint control leaves their information channels as they were. Delivering the pooled signal changes which policies can be executed. The injection above identifies the pooled policies already realizable with separate observations. The finite collector supplies the missing channel for the others, and its synchronization barrier specifies when the joint observation becomes available.

Observation and implementable dependence. The quotient equalizer of Proposition 6.2 characterizes observation-based responses; Theorem 6.17 and Proposition 6.21 extend it to dependent families. Consequently the response $\pi_i o_i$ uses only the effective signal actually displayed. No separate admissibility predicate needs to be added to this response construction.

6.5.4 Local linear reasoning

Knowledge is a predicate on the states compatible with an observation. A linear argument may instead carry resources that vary across those states. For an effective observation $o : W \twoheadrightarrow O$, strong monoidal reindexing $o^* : \mathcal{L}(O) \to \mathcal{L}(W)$ has right adjoint Π_o^ℓ. A local family X is indexed by observations, whereas a world family A is indexed by states. Their adjunction is

$$\mathcal{L}(W)(o^*X, A) \cong \mathcal{L}(O)(X, \Pi_o^\ell A), \qquad (\Pi_o^\ell A)_z = \prod_{o(w)=z} A_w. \tag{6.3}$$

The right adjoint packages one compatible linear argument for every world in an observation fibre. In judgment form it transposes $O; \Delta \vdash u : \Pi^\ell_o A$ and $W; o^*\Delta \vdash \widetilde{u} : A$. This is proof-relevant perspective: the product retains the resources available across indistinguishable worlds, rather than only the assertion that all such worlds satisfy a predicate.

Definition 6.27 (Proof-relevant perspective)**.** Define $K^\ell_o = o^*\Pi^\ell_o : \mathcal{L}(W) \to \mathcal{L}(W)$. Its counit is projection at the actual state:

$$\epsilon_{A,w} : \prod_{v:o(v)=o(w)} A_v \longrightarrow A_w.$$

Its comultiplication has, for every v in that fibre, the component identity into the same product:

$$\delta_{A,w} : \prod_{u:o(u)=o(w)} A_u \longrightarrow \prod_{v:o(v)=o(w)} \prod_{u:o(u)=o(v)} A_u.$$

Proposition 6.28 (Perspective comonad)**.** *The displayed counit and comultiplication make K^ℓ_o a comonad.*

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** They are the counit and $o^*\eta\Pi^\ell_o$ of the adjunction $o^* \dashv \Pi^\ell_o$. Explicitly, either counit composite projects back to the original indexed family. Both coassociativity composites have, at an index (v, u, t), the projection to A_t. Product uniqueness proves the equations, including empty products where applicable.

□

Unlike the predicate knowledge operator, the linear perspective comonad need not be idempotent. Reapplying it can retain multiple additive copies of world-indexed witness products, so its comultiplication need not be invertible. In particular, the construction introduces no contraction map $A \to A \otimes A$.

For a concrete distinction in this very model, take two indistinguishable worlds and the constant family $\mathsf{Lin2}$. Evaluation at the original unit gives $(\mathsf{Lin2})(I) = 2$, since $\mathcal{C}(I, I)$ is a singleton. The first perspective product has four such values, whereas its iterated product has sixteen. Thus its comultiplication cannot be an isomorphism. Evaluation at the tensor unit distinguishes the two presheaf objects directly.

6.5.5 Compatibility with linear composition

Theorem 6.29 (Monoidal perspective comparison)**.** *There are coherent natural maps*

$$\Pi^\ell_o A \otimes \Pi^\ell_o B \longrightarrow \Pi^\ell_o(A \otimes B), \qquad \mathsf{I}_O \longrightarrow \Pi^\ell_o \mathsf{I}_W.$$

Consequently K^ℓ_o is lax symmetric monoidal. For world-indexed agents there is, in particular, a natural operation

$$K^\ell_o \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B) \otimes K^\ell_o \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{T}}(B, C) \longrightarrow K^\ell_o \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}\times\vec{T}}(A, C),$$

and a corresponding parallel-composition operation.

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** At observation z, for each w with $o(w) = z$, tensor the two projections to obtain a map into $A_w \otimes B_w$. Product uniqueness gives the comparison. The unit comparison is the family of identity maps on I.

(2) **Associativity.** For associativity, each composite followed by the projection at w is the tensor of the same three projections, reassociated coherently. Units and symmetry are checked by the same argument. Naturality follows by postcomposing the projections with the given component maps.

(3) **Composition under linear perspective.** Applying o^* gives the comparisons for K_o^ℓ. Compose the first comparison with $K_o^\ell(\mathsf{seq})$ to obtain agent composition; replace seq by par for the parallel operation. Their coherence follows from the comparison coherence and Theorem 3.2.

□

The perspective comparison is characterized by its projections at each observationally possible world.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Pi_o^\ell A \otimes \Pi_o^\ell B & \xrightarrow{m_{A,B}} & \Pi_o^\ell(A \otimes B) \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_w^A \otimes \pi_w^B} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_w^{A\otimes B}} \\ A_w \otimes B_w & = & A_w \otimes B_w \end{array}$$

The lax monoidal map combines two resources that are each available from the same perspective; it does not create two copies of one agent or pool observations from different owners. Pooling requires its own joint observation map and, when implemented, a communication protocol. This separates composability of perspective-sensitive resources from access to shared information.

6.5.6 Perspective coherence and its unit

The comparison $m_{A,B} : \Pi_o A \otimes \Pi_o B \to \Pi_o(A \otimes B)$ has component $\pi_w^A \otimes \pi_w^B$. Either associativity route, followed by the w-projection, is $\pi_w^A \otimes \pi_w^B \otimes \pi_w^C$ under tensor reassociation. The unit route uses id_I at every w and then the tensor unitor. This proves lax monoidal coherence directly. The counit is monoidal because its projection at the actual world selects precisely these tensor projections. The comultiplication is compatible because all its repeated components are the same indexed-family map. These checks explain why perspective and agent composition are compatible even though the lax comparison need not be invertible.

6.5.7 Knowledge as the predicate fragment

For $P \subseteq W$, define

$$K_o P = o^* \forall_o P, \qquad K_o P(w) \iff \forall v\, (o(v) = o(w) \Rightarrow P(v)).$$

The accessibility relation is $R_o = \ker(o)$. Since it is an equivalence relation, the following properties are immediate consequences of its fibres.

Proposition 6.30 (Epistemic laws)**.** *K_o preserves finite conjunction and truth, is monotone and factive, and satisfies $K_o K_o P = K_o P$ and $\neg K_o P \subseteq K_o \neg K_o P$. It validates the normal modal distribution rule.*

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The kernel pair $R_o = \ker(o)$ is an equivalence relation. Corollary 6.6 and Theorem 5.31 identify $K_o = o^* \forall_o$ with the universal kernel-pair modality and prove its factivity, idempotence, and invariant-predicate characterization. Preservation of conjunction and truth follows from the right-adjoint universal quantifier.

(2) **Predicate calculation.** The negation of a fibre-invariant predicate is fibre-invariant, giving negative introspection. The normal modal implication rule follows from meet preservation: since $K_o((P \Rightarrow Q) \wedge P) \leq K_o Q$, one has $K_o(P \Rightarrow Q) \wedge K_o P \leq K_o Q$, and hence $K_o(P \Rightarrow Q) \leq (K_o P \Rightarrow K_o Q)$ by the Heyting implication adjunction. No preservation-of-implication equality is asserted.

(3) **Restriction to the predicate fragment.** These are the same S5 equations on the ordinary subterminal fragment, not claims about idempotence of K_o^ℓ.

□

Proposition 6.31 (Predicate reflection of linear perspective)**.** *For $P \subseteq W$, let $\widehat{P} \in \mathcal{T}(W)$ be the subterminal ordinary family with fibre 1 on P and 0 elsewhere. In the canonical completed concurrent model there is a natural isomorphism*

$$\mathsf{Val}_W K_o^\ell \mathsf{Lin}_W \widehat{P} \cong \widehat{K_o P}.$$

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The scalar calculation $\mathcal{C}(I, I) = 1$ gives $\mathsf{ValLin}X \cong X$ in this canonical model. As a right adjoint, Val preserves products. Therefore at w the left side is

$$\mathsf{Val}\left(\prod_{o(v)=o(w)} \mathsf{Lin}\widehat{P}_v\right) \cong \prod_{o(v)=o(w)} \mathsf{ValLin}\widehat{P}_v \cong \prod_{o(v)=o(w)} \widehat{P}_v.$$

This subterminal product is inhabited exactly when every world in the observation fibre satisfies P, which is $\widehat{K_o P}_w$.

(2) **Functoriality and substitution.** The maps preserve all reindexings and predicate inclusions, proving naturality. The comparison uses the proved $\mathsf{ValLin} \cong 1$ for the chosen concurrent completion, not an equation in every abstract LNL model.

□

The predicate reflection keeps exactly the truth information that is constant across an observation fibre. The proof-relevant linear perspective instead retains the associated product of witness objects. Hence its non-idempotence is compatible with the idempotent S5 operator on assertions.

6.5.8 Distributed and common knowledge

For nonempty $C \subseteq N$, factor the tuple of observations through its image:

$$W \xrightarrow{q_C} O_C \hookrightarrow \prod_{i \in C} O_i.$$

Its kernel is $R_C^\cap = \bigcap_{i \in C} R_i$. Define $\mathsf{DK}_C P = [R_C^\cap]P$. This is knowledge of a joint signal. A decentralized coalition does not automatically possess a policy on O_C; Section 7.8 constructs the exact comparison.

Let R_C^* be the relation generated by finite paths whose steps belong to some R_i, $i \in C$. It is an equivalence relation. Let $q_C^* : W \to W/R_C^*$ be its quotient, and define $\mathsf{CK}_C P = (q_C^*)^* \forall_{q_C^*} P$.

Proposition 6.32 (Common knowledge as a greatest fixed point)**.**

$$\mathsf{CK}_C P = \nu X. \left(P \wedge \bigwedge_{i \in C} K_i X\right).$$

Proof.

(1) **Finite-path characterization of knowledge.** Apply the finite-path construction in Proposition 6.10 and Theorem 6.11 to the subfamily $(\ker(o_i))_{i\in C}$. Its equivalence closure consists exactly of finite C-paths, including paths of length zero. The proof there identifies its box with the greatest post-fixed point of $X \mapsto P \wedge \bigwedge_{i\in C} K_i X$. For $C = \varnothing$, the path relation is equality and both sides are P.

□

6.5.9 Perspective and contextual adjunction rules

For $f : V \to W$, the dependent-adjoint rules are the transpositions

$$\frac{V; \Delta \vdash t : f^* B}{W; \Sigma^\ell_f \Delta \vdash \overline{t} : B}, \qquad \frac{V; f^* \Delta \vdash t : A}{W; \Delta \vdash \widehat{t} : \Pi^\ell_f A}.$$

In the first rule Δ denotes its tensor object, and the premise is the corresponding arrow from that object; this notation does not distribute Σ^ℓ_f separately over every context entry. In the second, f^* preserves the tensor context. Both transpositions have inverse elimination rules and their adjunction $\beta\eta$ equations. Perspective uses the second rule at an observation o.

At the predicate level, for $P \subseteq V$, $Q \subseteq W$,

$$\exists_f P \subseteq Q \iff P \subseteq f^* Q, \qquad f^* Q \subseteq P \iff Q \subseteq \forall_f P.$$

These supply existential and universal introduction and elimination. Knowledge is the definition $K_o = o^* \forall_o$, and action modalities are the definitions $\exists_s t^*$ and $\forall_s t^*$. Their monotonicity rules follow from functoriality. Factivity, introspection, and reduction equations are the derived results of the main text, not operations acting on arbitrary linear resources.

Common knowledge has the unfolding equation $\mathsf{CK}_C P = P \wedge \bigwedge_{i\in C} K_i \mathsf{CK}_C P$ and the rule

$$\frac{X \subseteq P \qquad X \subseteq K_i X \text{ for all } i \in C}{X \subseteq \mathsf{CK}_C P}.$$

The finite-path construction proves both. Under epistemic update the relations in these rules are those of the updated model.

7 Informed Choice and Collective Agency

Observation-based choice must also respect institutional permission. If several worlds give an owner the same signal, its response must be legal in every one of them. Dependent universal images construct this common menu, and sections give the informed legal policies. Before making that construction, we determine whether local inspection of owner coordinates recovers the joint legal domain at all. These are different obstacles to collective action: incomplete inspection can miss a joint restriction, while decentralized information can prevent implementation of a permitted choice. The resulting legal interfaces support coalition effectivity and stability (Pauly, 2002).

7.1 Local inspection and the descent of legal agency

A rule may couple complete policies even when every owner-local projection is unrestricted. The coordinate projections of Section 4 give a finite site whose gluing test identifies this failure. Its objects are policy views, in contrast to the causal patches used to reconstruct

execution. The comparison complements the studies of coalitional power and local/global decisions in Abdou and Keiding (2009); Tohmé et al. (2017), while retaining the given institutional rule and deviation relation.

Construction 7.1 (Owner-scope sheaves and locally extendable legality)**.**

(1) **Form the site of policy scopes.** For a nonempty finite owner set N, let $\mathcal{O}_N$ be its subsets, with inclusions as arrows and union families as covers, including the empty cover of $\varnothing$. Put $\Sigma_U = \prod_{i\in U} \Sigma_i$ and use coordinate restriction on inclusions.

(2) **Glue unrestricted profiles.** Define $\mathscr{P}(U) = \Sigma_U$. Compatible tuples on scopes covering U reconstruct one tuple in Σ_U by agreement on common owner coordinates. Thus $\mathscr{P}$ is a sheaf.

(3) **Keep legal extendability distinct from legality.** For $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, put $\mathscr{L}(U) = \pi_U(L)$ at nonempty U, with $\mathscr{L}(\varnothing) = 1$ and the unique restrictions into this empty-scope value. The assignment is a presheaf of locally extendable complete-policy tuples, but need not be a sheaf. The choice $\mathscr{L}(\varnothing) = 1$ records the unique empty tuple, not the existence of a legal global completion.

Theorem 7.2 (Exact obstruction to legal-policy gluing)**.** *For a cover $\mathcal{U} = (U_j)_{j\in J}$ of N by nonempty scopes, the matching object of $\mathscr{L}$ is canonically the subset*

$$\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L) := \bigcap_{j\in J} \pi_{U_j}^{-1}(\pi_{U_j}(L)) \;\hookrightarrow\; \Sigma. \tag{7.1}$$

The restriction map $L \to \mathrm{Match}_{\mathcal{U}}(\mathscr{L})$ is injective and is surjective exactly when $L = \mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L)$. Moreover

$$\mathscr{L} \text{ is a sheaf on } \mathcal{O}_N \quad\Longleftrightarrow\quad L = \prod_{i\in N} \pi_{\{i\}}(L).$$

The operator $\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}$ is extensive, monotone, and idempotent. It is the least domain containing L that is a conjunction of predicates, each inspecting only one scope U_j. More precisely, it is the idempotent monad SR of the adjunction

$$R : \mathrm{Sub}(\Sigma) \rightleftarrows \prod_j \mathrm{Sub}(\Sigma_{U_j}) : S, \quad R(L) = (\exists_{\pi_{U_j}} L)_j, \quad S((Q_j)_j) = \bigwedge_j \pi_{U_j}^* Q_j, \qquad R \dashv S.$$

Proof.

(1) **Identify matching tuples.** A compatible family $s_j \in \pi_{U_j}(L)$ assigns a well-defined value to each owner: two scopes containing that owner agree on their intersection. The cover therefore determines a unique $\sigma \in \Sigma$ such that $\pi_{U_j}(\sigma) = s_j$ for every j. The possible σ are exactly the elements of (7.1). Restricting a legal profile is injective because the scopes cover all owners.

(2) **Characterize sheaf descent.** Apply the preceding calculation to the singleton cover to obtain the necessary product equality. Conversely, if $L = \prod_i \pi_{\{i\}}(L)$, all nonempty scope images are the corresponding products. Compatible local tuples then glue to an element of L for any union cover. The empty-scope value is terminal, as required by its empty covering family.

(3) **Derive the reflection by adjunction.** In the existing subobject doctrine, existential image is left adjoint to inverse image (Jacobs, 1999, Chapters 4–5). Thus

$$R(L) \le (Q_j)_j \iff \forall j\ (\exists_{\pi_{U_j}} L \le Q_j) \iff L \le \bigwedge_j \pi_{U_j}^* Q_j \iff L \le S((Q_j)_j).$$

The induced monad SR is exactly (7.1). Its unit is the inclusion $L \subseteq SR(L)$. If L' is a conjunction of scope predicates containing L, the adjunction gives $SR(L) \subseteq L'$, proving the leastness assertion. Finally $\pi_{U_j}(SR(L)) = \pi_{U_j}(L)$: one inclusion follows from the unit, the other from $SR(L) \subseteq \pi_{U_j}^{-1}\pi_{U_j}(L)$. Consequently $SR(SR(L)) = SR(L)$, proving idempotence and monotonicity.

□

Proposition 7.3 (Sheafification of locally extendable legality)**.** *For the owner-scope site of Construction 7.1, restriction to singleton scopes is an equivalence*

$$\mathrm{Sh}(\mathcal{O}_N) \simeq \mathbf{Set}^N, \qquad F \longmapsto (F(\{i\}))_{i\in N}.$$

The associated sheaf of the locally extendable legality presheaf is canonically, as a subobject of the unrestricted-policy sheaf,

$$(a\mathscr{L})(U) \cong \prod_{i\in U} \pi_{\{i\}}(L) \;\hookrightarrow\; \Sigma_U. \tag{7.2}$$

Its unit at the full scope is the inclusion $L \hookrightarrow \prod_i \pi_{\{i\}}(L)$. Thus the associated-sheaf construction is the singleton-scope completion, not in general the completion for a specified cover by larger scopes. For the ownerwise surjection $\bar{h} : \Theta \twoheadrightarrow T$ of Theorem 7.7, it satisfies the canonical comparison

$$(a\mathscr{L}_h)(U) = \bar{h}_U^{-1}((a\mathscr{L}_T)(U)) \quad \textit{inside } \Theta_U.$$

Proof. Every U is covered by its singleton scopes (including the empty cover at $U = \varnothing$). The sheaf condition therefore gives $F(U) \cong \prod_{i\in U} F(\{i\})$, naturally in U. Conversely, a family $(F_i)_{i\in N}$ defines a sheaf by $U \mapsto \prod_{i\in U} F_i$, and these two constructions are mutually inverse. For any sheaf F, a presheaf map $\mathscr{L} \to F$ is determined by its singleton components $\pi_{\{i\}}(L) \to F(\{i\})$: at any scope U, the ith component is necessarily that singleton map composed with coordinate restriction. Conversely these components assemble a natural map on every scope. This proves the universal property of (7.2), including the empty scope. Finally, Theorem 7.7 gives $\pi_{\{i\}}(L_h) = \bar{h}_i^{-1}(\pi_{\{i\}}(L_T))$. Taking products of these equalities over $i \in U$ proves the last comparison. No independent policy admissibility condition is used. □

Corollary 7.4 (Higher cohomology of the owner-scope site)**.** *For every abelian sheaf $\mathcal{A}$ on $\mathcal{O}_N$, $H^q(\mathcal{O}_N, \mathcal{A}) = 0$ for $q > 0$.*

Proof.

(1) **Recover the component groups.** The singleton-cover comparison of Proposition 7.3 respects the abelian-group operations, giving $\mathrm{Sh}(\mathcal{O}_N, \mathbf{Ab}) \simeq \mathbf{Ab}^N$.

(2) **Compute global sections.** Under this equivalence, global sections are the finite product of the component groups. Finite products preserve exact sequences of abelian groups, so the higher right derived functors of global sections vanish.

□

The defect in Theorem 7.2 is therefore a failure of the legality presheaf to satisfy descent, rather than a nonzero higher cohomology class on this discrete owner site. The decision-incidence space of Construction 7.19 and the legal-deviation graph of Construction 13.7 retain different overlaps. Their cohomology detects, respectively, incompatible local decisions and

failure to integrate unilateral gains. Each space is constructed from the existing observation or deviation interface.
The matching object is a conjunction of locally possible complete-policy records, whereas the legal domain is the institution's actual joint permission predicate.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L & \hookrightarrow & \mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \Sigma & = & \Sigma \end{array}$$

Example 7.5 (The authorization rule fails owner-local descent)**.** In the running two-bit protocol, $\Sigma_1 = \Sigma_2 = 2^2$ and

$$L = \{(\pi_1, \pi_2) : \pi_1(1) \le \pi_2(1)\}.$$

Both singleton-owner projections of L are surjective. Therefore

$$|L| = 12, \qquad \mathrm{Loc}_{\{\{1\},\{2\}\}}(L) = \Sigma, \qquad |\Sigma| = 16.$$

The four locally compatible yet illegal profiles have $\pi_1(1) = 1$ and $\pi_2(1) = 0$. Thus checking individual extendability cannot implement the joint rule. The extra policy entries delivered to the checker in Section 11.12 are exactly the evidence used to test the missing comparison.

Example 7.6 (Pairwise local inspections do not suffice)**.** Let $N = \{1, 2, 3\}$, $\Sigma_i = 2$, and $L = \{(a, b, c) : a \oplus b \oplus c = 0\}$. Every projection onto a proper nonempty owner scope is surjective. For the three pairwise scopes one obtains

$$|L| = 4, \qquad \mathrm{Loc}_{\{\{1,2\},\{1,3\},\{2,3\}\}}(L) = 2^3.$$

There is no conjunction of tests confined to these pairwise scopes that accepts all legal profiles and rejects every illegal profile: the least such conjunction is already the full eight-element domain.

Theorem 7.7 (Delegation transports local descent exactly)**.** *For the delegation of Section 4.3, regroup subordinate owners into the parent blocks and write $T_i = \mathrm{im}(h_i)$ and $T = \prod_i T_i$. Put $L_T = L \cap T$, let $\bar{h} : \Theta \twoheadrightarrow T$ be the ownerwise surjective corestriction, and let $L_h = \bar{h}^{-1}(L_T)$. For every nonempty owner scope U,*

$$\pi^{\Theta}_U(L_h) = \bar{h}_U^{-1}(\pi^T_U(L_T)).$$

Consequently, for every family $\mathcal{U}$ of nonempty owner scopes,

$$\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L_h) = \bar{h}^{-1}(\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L_T)). \tag{7.3}$$

For a covering family, exact descent holds at L_h if and only if it holds at L_T. If the parent's strict comparisons are pulled back along realization, then

$$\mathrm{NE}_{\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L_h)} = \bar{h}^{-1}\,\mathrm{NE}_{\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L_T)}$$

when subordinate deviations are taken by whole parent blocks.

Proof.

(1) **Construct the regular-image comparison.** For an owner scope U, the commutative square of coordinate projections and ownerwise surjections has a canonical comparison

$$\beta_U : \Theta \longrightarrow \Theta_U \times_{T_U} T, \qquad \theta \longmapsto (\pi_U^{\Theta}\theta, \bar{h}\theta).$$

It is surjective: given (θ_U, t) with $\bar{h}_U(\theta_U) = \pi_U^T(t)$, retain θ_U and lift each coordinate t_i for $i \notin U$ along $\bar{h}_i$. The finitely many coordinates assemble a preimage of (θ_U, t).

(2) **Derive existential-image base change.** For every $P \hookrightarrow T$, the preceding surjective comparison gives the regular-image Beck–Chevalley equality

$$\exists_{\pi_U^{\Theta}} \bar{h}^* P = \bar{h}_U^* \exists_{\pi_U^T} P. \tag{7.4}$$

Indeed, a point on the right is (θ_U, t) in the indicated pullback with $t \in P$; lifting it along β_U gives exactly a witness on the left, and every left witness projects to a right one. This is the regular-image calculation of the existing predicate doctrine (Jacobs, 1999, Chapters 4–5).

(3) **Compute the obstruction.** Apply (7.4) to $P = L_T$ and then apply each scope projection. Inverse image preserves finite intersections, so

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L_h) &= \bigcap_{U \in \mathcal{U}} (\pi_U^{\Theta})^* \exists_{\pi_U^{\Theta}} \bar{h}^* L_T \\ &= \bar{h}^* \bigcap_{U \in \mathcal{U}} (\pi_U^T)^* \exists_{\pi_U^T} L_T = \bar{h}^* \, \mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L_T). \end{aligned}$$

Surjectivity of $\bar{h}$ makes its inverse-image map order-reflecting, giving the exact-descent equivalence.

(4) **Transport stability.** The completed legal domain on the left is the inverse image of the completed legal domain on the right. The source-fixed map of Lemma 4.10 is onto for every whole-block coalition deviation; both realized endpoints are preserved. Its existential image therefore gives exactly the pulled-back improving deviation predicate. Negation and conjunction over the designated coalitions yield the displayed Nash and coalitional-stability equations.

□

Ownerwise implementation and local inspection commute after restriction to the actually implemented parent policies.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L_h & \xrightarrow{\quad \bar{h} \quad} & L_T \\ \big\downarrow & & \big\downarrow \\ \mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L_h) & \xrightarrow[\quad \bar{h} \quad]{} & \mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L_T) \end{array}$$

What the obstruction does and does not assert. The gluing obstruction is a property of the specified independent inspection scopes. It is not an impossibility of institutional execution. A checker may collect the relevant policy entries using the finite collector of Proposition 1.29 and apply a genuinely joint acceptance predicate. In particular, replacing L by $\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L)$ would alter permission; it is not a harmless sheafification of an institution. The exact quotient and selection comparisons below therefore continue to use the institution's original legal domain.

7.2 Institutionally available agent interfaces

For the legal inclusion $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, write $L_S = \mathrm{im}(\pi_S m)$ and $e_S : L \twoheadrightarrow L_S$. These image-factorized coordinate maps specify the available outsider indices used here; their full functorial construction is given in Section 7.7.

The legal fibres and their feedback are those of Construction 5.44.

Proposition 7.8 (Legal agency and logical equilibrium)**.** *The conjunction of legal agent selections at a profile $\sigma \in L$ is exactly the legal Nash predicate of Theorem 5.45. More generally, the coalition interface has paired realization $\delta_C^L : D_C^L \to \mathcal{C}(A,B)^2$, where $D_C^L = \ker(e_{-C} : L \to L_{-C})$ and L_{-C} is the image of the outsider-coordinate map. Its feedback is $(\delta_C^L)^* P$.*

Proof.

(1) **Identify the coalition kernel pair.** The inclusion $L_{-C} \hookrightarrow \Sigma_{-C}$ is monic, so $\ker(e_{-C}) = L \times_{\Sigma_{-C}} L$. Apply the coalition fibre comparison of Theorem 5.45; singletons give the stated conjunction for legal Nash equilibrium.

□

Legal choice fibres are pullbacks of the realizable outsider-coordinate map.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} S_C^L(u) & \xrightarrow{j^L_{C,u}} & L \\ \downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle e_{-C}} \\ 1 & \xrightarrow[u]{} & L_{-C} \end{array} \qquad \begin{array}{ccc} S_C^L(\sigma_{-C}) & \xrightarrow{j^L_{C,\sigma}} & L \\ \downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle e_{-C}} \\ 1 & \xrightarrow[\sigma_{-C}]{} & L_{-C} \end{array}$$

The pullback fixes outsiders and retains exactly the legal alternative choices at that reference. Effectivity has a different quantifier order: a coalition first chooses a realizable coordinate and then requires the goal at every legal completion. The same legal map supports both operations, but they answer different agency questions.

Coalitional power pulls an outcome goal back to legal profiles, quantifies universally over completions of a proposed coalition choice, and then existentially over realizable choices. The base of the final quantifier is the image L_C, which removes choices without any legal completion. Thus a formally vacuous universal predicate cannot be mistaken for an enforceable goal.

7.3 Institutional arrangements and collective agent interfaces

Definition 7.9 (Institutional arrangement on an agent process)**.** An **institutional arrangement** on a situated agent process is its displayed legal subobject, observation interfaces, and comparison or outcome terms, together with the concurrent wiring that implements its specified communication and outcome rules. A **collective agent interface** for a nonempty coalition $C \subseteq N$ is obtained by regrouping its controlled policy coordinates. Its available legal carrier against outsiders u is $S_C^L(u)$. When the arrangement supplies a collective observation and comparison, these are attached as the situated and evaluated interfaces of

that collective agent. The constituent agents' interfaces remain recorded by the original indexing and the regrouping map. The empty coalition has the unit control carrier $\Sigma_\varnothing = 1$ and identity alternatives; at a legal reference its legal choice fibre is a singleton. This is the nullary control interface, requiring no nonempty block in a regrouping partition.

For nonempty C, the partition with block C and singleton outsiders has control given by the regrouping of Theorem 4.7. A particular collective comparison constructed from the members is

$$P_C(f, f') = \bigwedge_{i \in C} P_i(f, f').$$

The collective selection interface tests legal joint deviations against the displayed conjunction of members' comparisons. Its construction uses the choice-fibre bijection of Proposition 7.8; different rules for collective preference are not inferred from regrouping. This is the comparison later used to distinguish collective stability from ability to secure an outcome.

For independent arrangements, the legal domain of the composite is $L_G \times L_H \hookrightarrow \Sigma^G \times \Sigma^H$. Additional institutional rules are further comprehensions, and simultaneous rules intersect. These operations remain coherent with product reassociation. They also reveal why the legal domain of a composite cannot in general be read off from its separate marginal projections: a joint rule may couple otherwise available decisions.

7.4 Quantified spans and their action

Definition 7.10 (Relation modalities)**.** For a relation presented by its jointly monic span $X \xleftarrow{p} R \xrightarrow{q} Y$, put

$$[R] = \forall_p q^*, \qquad \langle R \rangle = \exists_p q^*. \tag{7.5}$$

The converse is denoted $R^\smile$. Relational composition $R; S$ first forms $R \times_Y S$ and then takes its image in the two external factors.

Proposition 7.11 (Internal typing of an alternative span)**.** *Let $s : X \to \Sigma^G$ be a reference context and $X \xleftarrow{p} R \xrightarrow{q} Y$ a span of alternatives. Its source leg is the context map $p : (R, sp) \to (X, s)$; its target is the term $(sp, q) : (R, sp) \to \Delta_G Y$. For $P \hookrightarrow Y$,*

$$[R]P = \forall_p (sp, q)^* \Delta_G P, \qquad \langle R \rangle P = \exists_p (sp, q)^* \Delta_G P.$$

Thus both modalities are operations of P_G even when the target alternative changes the reference strategy.

Proof.

(1) **Predicate calculation.** Projection of (sp, q) to Σ^G is sp, so it is a slice arrow. Equation (5.1) identifies its predicate pullback with q^*P. The two quantifiers along p then give precisely Equation (7.5). No equality between the reference of an alternative and the original reference is required.

□

Theorem 7.12 (The adjunction of a relation)**.** *For $R \subseteq X \times Y$, put $R_! = \exists_q p^* : \mathsf{Pred}(X) \to \mathsf{Pred}(Y)$. Then*

$$R_! = \langle R^\smile \rangle \dashv [R] = \forall_p q^*.$$

Consequently $[R]R_!$ is an idempotent monad on $\mathsf{Pred}(X)$ and $R_![R]$ is an idempotent comonad on $\mathsf{Pred}(Y)$.

Proof.

(1) **Relational adjunction and idempotence.** For $P \in \mathsf{Pred}(X)$ and $Q \in \mathsf{Pred}(Y)$,

$$\exists_q p^* P \leq Q \iff p^* P \leq q^* Q \iff P \leq \forall_p q^* Q.$$

The unit and counit supply the monad and comonad inequalities; monotonicity gives the reverse idempotence inequalities. The converse relation interchanges p and q, proving the first identity.

□

Remark 7.13 (Direction of adjunction and qualitative belief). The left adjoint of $[R]$ is the diamond of the converse relation. When R is symmetric this is $\langle R \rangle$ itself. An arbitrary belief operator $[R]$ is not thereby a comonad: for a nonempty state set and the empty relation, $[R]\bot = \top$, so no counit $[R] \leq \mathrm{id}$ exists. The universally available comonad is the composite $R_![R]$ on the indicated carrier.

Proposition 7.14 (Relation action and graph modalities)**.** *One has* $[R;S] = [R][S]$ *and* $\langle R;S \rangle = \langle R \rangle \langle S \rangle$*. For the graph* Γ_f *of* $f : X \to Y$*,*

$$[\Gamma_f] = \langle \Gamma_f \rangle = f^*, \qquad [\Gamma_f^\smile] = \forall_f, \qquad \langle \Gamma_f^\smile \rangle = \exists_f.$$

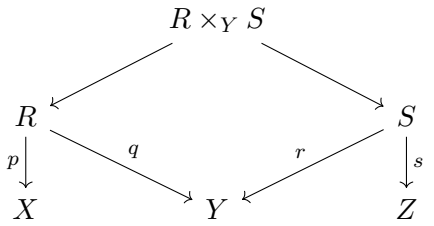
In particular,

$$[\ker f] = f^* \forall_f, \qquad \langle \ker f \rangle = f^* \exists_f. \tag{7.6}$$

Proof.

(1) **Witness and legality comparison.** Expanding a composite box gives $\forall y\,(R(x,y) \Rightarrow \forall z\,(S(y,z) \Rightarrow P(z)))$, which is equivalent to the box for the image relation. The existential calculation combines the two witnesses. For a graph the sole forward candidate is $f(x)$; its converse has exactly the fiber $f^{-1}(y)$. Finally $\ker f = \Gamma_f ; \Gamma_f^\smile$.

□



7.5 Informed legal policies as sections of a dependent product

The individual choice fibre is not yet an informed policy. At the same observation, several worlds may have different feasible menus, so a single response must lie in their intersection. The right adjoint to inverse image constructs that universally feasible menu over each observation. Taking its sections then produces precisely the policies that are simultaneously legal and observation-based.

Construction 7.15 (The informed legal interface)**.**

(1) **Transport legality along observation.** Let $o : W \twoheadrightarrow O$ be an effective observation quotient, M an action carrier, and $F \hookrightarrow W \times M$ the specified feasibility predicate. Put $u = o \times \mathrm{id}_M$ and define

$$A_o = \forall_u F \hookrightarrow O \times M, \qquad A_o(z) = \{a \in M : \forall w \in o^{-1}(z)\ (w,a) \in F\}.$$

(2) **Take sections of the resulting family.** The informed legal policy carrier is the set of sections

$$\mathsf{Pol}_o(F) = \mathrm{Sect}_O(A_o \to O) = \{\pi : O \to M : \forall w \in W\ (w, \pi(o(w))) \in F\}.$$

Thus ordinary descent imposes dependence on observations, and dependent universal quantification imposes legality at every world with that observation. The predicate F may describe physical availability, institutional permission, or their intersection; these interpretations remain explicit in the supplied data.

Proposition 7.16 (Universal characterization and information refinement)**.** *For every $\pi : O \to M$, writing Γ_π for its graph,*

$$\Gamma_\pi \subseteq A_o \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad u^*\Gamma_\pi \subseteq F.$$

In particular, $\mathsf{Pol}_o(F)$ is the maximal subobject of M^O whose evaluated responses satisfy F. If $o = q\,o'$ for surjective observation maps $o' : W \twoheadrightarrow O'$ and $q : O' \twoheadrightarrow O$, then

$$A_o = \forall_{q \times \mathrm{id}_M} A_{o'}, \qquad q^* : \mathsf{Pol}_o(F) \hookrightarrow \mathsf{Pol}_{o'}(F), \quad \pi \longmapsto \pi q.$$

Its image consists exactly of the fine-observation legal policies constant on the fibres of q, and it preserves their responses on W.

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The first equivalence is the adjunction $u^* \dashv \forall_u$. The inverse-image graph consists of exactly $(w, \pi(o(w)))$, so it is contained in F exactly when that response is feasible at every w. This proves both the section formula and maximality.

(2) **Adjunction and transposition: second comparison.** Since $u = (q \times \mathrm{id}_M)(o' \times \mathrm{id}_M)$, composition of right adjoints gives the displayed equality for A_o. Equivalently, the intersection of feasible menus over $o^{-1}(z)$ is the intersection of the corresponding fine-observation menus over $q^{-1}(z)$. If π is legal, πq has exactly the same world response, so is legal.

(3) **Verification of the universal property.** Surjectivity of q makes precomposition injective. A fine policy constant on $\ker q$ descends uniquely to π; its identical world response satisfies F, proving the image claim.

□

Proposition 7.17 (Compatibility of admissibility, legality, and knowledge)**.** *For the effective observation $o : W \twoheadrightarrow O$ and $F \hookrightarrow W \times M$ above, let $F_a = \{w \in W : (w, a) \in F\}$. The following square of sets is a pullback, in which both horizontal arrows and the right vertical arrow are inclusions or injections:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{Pol}_o(F) & \hookrightarrow & M^O \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle o^*} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle o^*} \\ \{f : W \to M : \forall w\ F(w, f(w))\} & \hookrightarrow & M^W. \end{array}$$

Furthermore, for each $a \in M$ the predicate obtained by pulling the universally legal menu back to the history carrier is knowledge of feasibility of that action:

$$(o \times \underset{M}{\mathrm{id}})^* A_o(w, a) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad K_o(F_a)(w).$$

Thus the same effective observation quotient simultaneously determines which responses descend, which descended responses are uniformly legal, and which individual-action feasibility predicates are known.

Proof.

(1) **Descent of responses.** By Proposition 6.2, precomposition with o embeds M^O into M^W and its image is the set of functions constant on the kernel pair of o. This is the right vertical map.

(2) **Legal pullback.** The inverse image under this embedding of the lower-left set consists exactly of those π for which $F(w, \pi(o(w)))$ holds for every w. By Proposition 7.16, this set is $\mathsf{Pol}_o(F)$; hence the square is cartesian.

(3) **Knowledge of the universally legal menu.** The definition of A_o gives

$$A_o(o(w), a) \iff \forall v\,(o(v) = o(w) \Rightarrow F(v, a)),$$

which is exactly the kernel-pair knowledge predicate $K_o F_a(w)$ of Definition 6.3. All identities are over the original observation and therefore commute with substitution of a state reference by the relevant pullback square.

□

The dependent universal image identifies the observation-uniform legal actions.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} W \times M & \xrightarrow{o\times\mathrm{id}} & O \times M \\ {\scriptstyle \pi_W}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_O} \\ W & \xrightarrow[o]{} & O \end{array}$$

For example, let $W = \{w_0, w_1\}$ have one observation and $M = \{a, b\}$, with feasible menus $\{a\}$ and $\{b\}$ at the two worlds. Then A_o has empty fibre and there is no informed legal policy. Under the fully revealing observation, the policy $w_0 \mapsto a$, $w_1 \mapsto b$ is legal. The empty universal image exhibits the obstruction to a coarse-observation legal policy.

The construction applies directly to a situated agent. For $s : W \to L$, take $M = \Sigma_i$ and

$$F_i(w, a) \iff (s(w)_{-i}, a) \in L.$$

The sections are complete-policy deviations that depend only on the agent's observation and remain legal at every compatible reference state. When the decision is a local action rather than a complete policy, its own action set and enabling predicate must be used instead. The distinction is fixed by the causal stage of the protocol.

Proposition 7.18 (Decentralized legal coalition policies)**.** *For observers $o_i : W \twoheadrightarrow O_i$, a nonempty coalition C, and a joint feasibility predicate $F_C \hookrightarrow W \times \prod_{i\in C} M_i$, let $o_C : W \twoheadrightarrow O_C$ be the pooled quotient. Then*

$$\mathsf{Pol}_C^{\mathrm{dec}}(F_C) = J_C^{-1}(\mathrm{Sect}_{O_C}(\forall_{o_C\times\mathrm{id}} F_C \to O_C)) \hookrightarrow \prod_{i\in C} M_i^{O_i},$$

where J_C is Proposition 6.26. The inclusion into pooled legal policies is injective, and its image is exactly those pooled legal policies whose ith output descends along $p_i : O_C \to O_i$ for every i.

Proof.

(1) **Policy-level comparison.** The response at w of $J_C((\pi_i)_i)$ is $(\pi_i(o_i(w)))_i$. By the section characterization, this pooled policy is legal exactly when that tuple lies in $F_C(w)$ at every w. This is precisely decentralized joint feasibility.

(2) **Characterization of decentralized legal policies.** The image characterization and injectivity follow by restricting the injection and image characterization of J_C to this comprehension.

□

Decentralized legal policies embed in the globally pooled admissible-policy space.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{Pol}_C^{\mathrm{dec}}(F_C) & \hookrightarrow & \mathsf{Pol}_{o_C}(F_C) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \prod_i M_i^{O_i} & \xrightarrow[J_C]{} & (\prod_i M_i)^{O_C} \end{array}$$

Separate marginal feasibility does not imply joint legal feasibility. If two binary actions must agree, the joint possibilities $(0,0)$ and $(1,1)$ give both owners nonempty marginal menus, but the product also admits the illegal tuple $(0,1)$. The dependent joint predicate retains this coupling and is therefore needed for informed coalition choice.

The resulting interface is the deterministic policy structure of team decision problems: each agent chooses from its own information, while a joint evaluation is attached to the combined response. The comparison with Radner (1962) concerns these information and decision interfaces, not a probability or optimality principle added to the present qualitative construction.

7.5.1 A sheaf of decentralized joint decisions

The preceding section condition asks whether local responses can satisfy a joint requirement. To identify an obstruction, we retain the incidence between each decision and the worlds in which its response must agree. The resulting sheaf has decentralized joint policies as global sections, connecting the construction with distributed-task semantics (Goubault et al., 2021; Felber et al., 2025). Here world and observation carriers are finite; the protocols of Section 10 also provide finite action instances. The response relations remain set-valued. This is a question of compatible choice before any probability law or utility is supplied.

Construction 7.19 (The decision-incidence sheaf)**.**

(1) **Retain local decisions.** For actual observation images $o_i : W \twoheadrightarrow O_i$, let M_i be the local action carrier and let $R_w \subseteq \prod_i M_i$ be the specified joint response relation at w. Put $X = \coprod_i \{i\} \times O_i$. Form the finite poset P with tagged objects $W \amalg X$ and nonidentity relations $w < (i, o_i(w))$. Worlds with the same joint observation remain distinct objects, so their separate response constraints are retained.

(2) **Assign compatible local data.** Give P the upper Alexandrov topology. Define its stalk diagram by

$$\mathcal{F}_R(w) = R_w, \qquad \mathcal{F}_R(i,z) = M_i, \qquad R_w \longrightarrow M_i, \quad (a_j)_j \longmapsto a_i.$$

For an open set, take the compatible tuples in this diagram. Such tuples glue uniquely by their entries, defining an ordinary sheaf. The section over a minimal open neighbourhood is determined by the entry at its initial object and its images, recovering the displayed stalks, including empty response stalks.

(3) **Retain complete-policy legality.** When the institution also supplies a predicate $L \subseteq \prod_i M_i^{O_i}$ on complete policies, impose this predicate on the resulting global sections. It can inspect entries outside a current execution. It is not replaced by the pointwise response relations unless those relations already present that predicate.

Theorem 7.20 (Global sections are decentralized implementations)**.** *There is a canonical bijection*

$$\Gamma(P, \mathcal{F}_R) \cong \left\{ (\pi_i)_i \in \prod_i M_i^{O_i} : (\pi_i(o_i(w)))_i \in R_w \text{ for every } w \right\}.$$

With a separate complete-policy predicate L, the legal implementations are exactly the intersection of the displayed carrier with L. For a coalition this recovers Proposition 7.18 on its designated owner coordinates.

Proof.

(1) **Extract policies from a section.** A section assigns an action $s_{i,z}$ to each decision object and a tuple $r_w \in R_w$ to each world. Compatibility says $(r_w)_i = s_{i,o_i(w)}$. Define $\pi_i(z) = s_{i,z}$. The tuple of evaluated responses at each world is r_w, proving joint feasibility.

(2) **Reconstruct the section.** Given these policies, place $\pi_i(z)$ at each decision object and $r_w = (\pi_i(o_i(w)))_i$ at each world. These are compatible and uniquely determined. The two operations are inverse. Intersecting with the unchanged predicate L proves the legality statement.

□

Evaluation at every world gives the following pullback of sets. The lower arrow retains the actual joint response relations.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Gamma(P, \mathcal{F}_R) & \hookrightarrow & \prod_i M_i^{O_i} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \text{eval}} \\ \prod_{w \in W} R_w & \hookrightarrow & (\prod_i M_i)^W. \end{array}$$

For arbitrary R_w, section existence is the exact constraint problem in the original action sets. Passing to free abelian groups need not preserve its solutions. The cohomological methods of Abramsky et al. (2012) provide obstruction tests, but do not justify a complete linear test for every response relation. The following affine fragment has a complete obstruction without such a replacement.

Lemma 7.21 (Graph integration and the canonical primitive torsor)**.** *For a finite loop-free multigraph K and an abelian group A, let $C^0(K; A) = A^{V(K)}$. Let $C^1(K; A)$ consist of functions on directed traversals of edges with $c(\bar{e}) = -c(e)$, where $\bar{e}$ reverses the same edge. Define*

$$(d\phi)(e) = \phi(t(e)) - \phi(s(e)), \qquad H^1(K; A) = C^1(K; A)/dC^0(K; A).$$

For $c \in C^1(K; A)$ the following are equivalent: $[c] = 0$; every closed walk has zero signed c-sum; and every fundamental cycle of a spanning forest has zero signed c-sum. When these hold, the canonical fibre

$$\mathrm{Prim}(c) = \{s \in C^0(K; A) : ds = c\}$$

is a torsor under $A^{\pi_0(K)}$. A spanning forest gives coordinates on this torsor and an isomorphism $H^1(K;A) \cong A^{e-v+k}$, where v, e, k are the vertex, edge, and component counts. The fibre, torsor action, and obstruction class do not depend on these coordinates.

Proof.

(1) **Test the periods.** Exact cochains telescope on closed walks. Conversely, a root value in each component and signed sums along its unique forest paths define a primitive on the forest. Each remaining edge closes a fundamental cycle; its zero period gives the remaining edge equation. Distinct parallel edges retain their distinct equations. A finite spanning forest is obtained by adjoining edges joining different components until none remain.

(2) **Construct all primitives together.** The fibre $d^{-1}(c)$ is defined without selecting a root, forest, or primitive. Differences of its elements lie in $\ker d$, precisely the functions constant on connected components. Translation by these functions is free and transitive. Forest integration is a coordinate presentation of this already defined torsor.

(3) **Compute the obstruction coordinates.** Subtract the forest primitive with zero root values from an arbitrary cochain. The residual vanishes on forest edges and records the fundamental-cycle periods on the others. Every such residual occurs, and it is exact only if it vanishes. There are $e - v + k$ nonforest edges. Choosing one orientation per edge identifies the antisymmetric cochains with $A^{E(K)}$; reversing it negates that coordinate and changes neither the construction nor its vanishing test.

□

Construction 7.22 (Affine comparisons of local decisions)**.**

(1) **Form the decision graph.** Let K be a finite loop-free graph whose vertices are designated local decision entries with values in an abelian group A. An oriented edge $e : u \to v$ specifies the joint response relation

$$R_e = \{(a, b) \in A^2 : b - a = c(e)\}, \qquad c \in A^{E(K)}.$$

Distinct comparisons of the same entries remain distinct edges. Thus parallel edges, for example from different worlds with the same observations, are retained. Institutional comparisons of this form are included among these edges.

(2) **Identify the local torsor.** Each R_e is an A-torsor under simultaneous translation; its two coordinate projections are bijections. The edge-decision incidence sheaf has these relations and projections as its stalk diagram. Inverting the projections identifies it with the local system whose transport along e is $a \mapsto a + c(e)$.

(3) **Form the obstruction.** Put $d : A^{V(K)} \to A^{E(K)}$, $(ds)(e) = s(v) - s(u)$, and $H^1(K;A) = A^{E(K)}/dA^{V(K)}$. The translation cocycle has class $[c]$. This is ordinary graph cohomology, equivalently the first sheaf cohomology of locally constant A-values on the graph.

The affine constraint is exactly the commutativity of the local projection square.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} R_e & \xrightarrow[\cong]{\pi_u} & A \\ {\scriptstyle \pi_v}\downarrow{\scriptstyle \cong} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle a\mapsto a+c(e)} \\ A & = & A. \end{array}$$

Theorem 7.23 (Exact obstruction to affine social implementation)**.** *The affine comparisons of Construction 7.22 admit a decentralized implementation exactly when* $[c] = 0$ *in* $H^1(K; A)$*. Equivalently, every closed walk has zero signed sum of the edge labels. When the class vanishes, integration along a spanning forest constructs all implementations, with one free additive constant per component.*

Proof.

(1) **Identify the section equations.** Compatibility in Theorem 7.20 is exactly $ds = c$ on the decision graph, including its parallel edges.

(2) **Apply graph integration.** Lemma 7.21 identifies existence with the vanishing obstruction and all implementations with $\mathrm{Prim}(c)$. Its forest coordinates give the stated explicit reconstruction.

□

A separate complete-policy rule not expressed by these affine comparisons is still imposed by the intersection in Theorem 7.20. Thus $[c]$ is a complete obstruction for the displayed affine problem, including the institutional constraints among its edges. The relation between incompatible local assignments and global sections also underlies the contextuality analysis of Abramsky and Brandenburger (2011); no physical or probabilistic interpretation is required for the present decisions.

Proposition 7.24 (Observation refinement and obstruction pullback)**.** *For refinements* $o_i = r_i o_i'$ *through actual observation images, precomposition defines an injection from coarse decentralized implementations to fine ones and preserves their response at every world. In the binary affine presentation of these worldwise response relations, refinement splits decision vertices and induces a graph map* $f : K' \to K$ *with the same constraint edges. Its labels and obstruction satisfy*

$$c' = f^* c, \qquad [c'] = f^*[c].$$

Proof.

(1) **Transport complete responses.** Send π_i to $\pi_i r_i$. Since $o_i = r_i o_i'$, each world response is unchanged, so each R_w remains satisfied. Surjectivity of r_i makes precomposition injective. A separate complete-policy predicate is transported by its specified policy comparison; it is not inferred from worldwise response equality.

(2) **Transport the affine equations.** Each fine decision entry maps to its coarse entry, and each world comparison keeps its label. Hence $df^* = f^* d$ and $c' = f^* c$, inducing the stated map on the quotient by exact cochains. A nonzero coarse class can vanish after this vertex splitting.

□

7.6 Local states, knowledge, and a uniform ability witness

Proposition 7.25 (Local-state presentation of an observation frame)**.** *The map*

$$\ell : W \longrightarrow W \times \prod_{i \in N} O_i, \qquad \ell(w) = (w, (o_i(w))_i)$$

is injective. On its image, equality of agent i*'s local coordinate pulls back to* $\ker o_i$*. An observation policy* $\pi_i : O_i \to M_i$ *evaluates at the local coordinate exactly as the original response* $\pi_i o_i$*.*

Proof.

(1) **Functoriality and substitution.** The first coordinate recovers w, proving injectivity. Equality of the ith local coordinates is the equation $o_i(w) = o_i(v)$, and evaluation is substitution in π_i.

□

This yields the static local-state interface of interpreted-systems semantics (Halpern and Fagin, 1989). The carrier W may consist of histories or points of runs supplied by a protocol; transition relations arise separately from executions or epistemic actions. Knowing one's own currently selected policy, when modeled, is an additional observation fact, not a consequence of ownership alone.

To distinguish knowledge of pointwise availability from possession of one informed ability witness, let Π be a specified policy carrier and $S \hookrightarrow W \times \Pi$ a success predicate. For example, $S(w, \pi)$ may already universally quantify legal outsiders' responses. At a current world w, compare

$$\forall v \; (o_i(v) = o_i(w) \Rightarrow \exists \pi \in \Pi \; S(v, \pi))$$

with

$$\exists \pi \in \Pi \; \forall v \; (o_i(v) = o_i(w) \Rightarrow S(v, \pi)).$$

The second formula exhibits one policy succeeding across the whole information class; the first only says that each possible world admits some successful policy. The implication cannot be reversed. For two indistinguishable worlds, take policies π_0, π_1 with $S(w_j, \pi_k)$ precisely when $j = k$. Each world has a successful policy, but neither policy succeeds at both. The distinction between knowledge that success is possible and knowing how to secure it is the point of the comparison with Jamroga and van der Hoek (2004).

7.7 Legal coalition effectivity and stability

Regrouping gives coalitions a joint control interface, and legal comprehension gives each controlled choice its permitted completions. To determine power, we must now place the quantifiers in the order that corresponds to a coalition choosing before its outsiders. Image factorization removes unrealizable choices, while the same kernel-pair relations continue to express legal deviations. We then compare coalitional guarantees with preference-based stability.

The collective-control map is Theorem 4.7; legal selection is Proposition 7.8; and the comparison of decentralized with pooled information is Proposition 6.26. These supply separate ingredients of the effectivity calculation. The resulting relationship between dependence, preference, and coalitional power also connects with Chen, Shi, and Wang (2022).

7.7.1 Institutional choices and power to secure a goal

Definition 7.26 (Coalition effectivity and enforcement)**.** Let $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ be a legal profile domain, $e_C : L \twoheadrightarrow L_C$ the image-factorized projection to the coalition's coordinates, $q : L \to Z$ an outcome, and $P \hookrightarrow Z$ a goal. **Coalition effectivity** is the predicate-valued operator

$$[C]_{L,q} : \mathsf{Pred}(Z) \longrightarrow \mathsf{Pred}(1), \qquad [C]_{L,q}(P) = \exists_{!:L_C \to 1} \forall_{e_C : L \to L_C} \, q^* P.$$

Equivalently, it holds just when some $c \in L_C$ satisfies $\forall \ell \in L \, (e_C(\ell) = c \Rightarrow q(\ell) \in P)$. A coalition **enforces** P by such a realizable coordinate; every legal completion must satisfy the

goal. For fixed q, the outcome subscript is suppressed, giving the notation $[C]_L$ used below. The image L_C excludes unrealizable choices and therefore excludes vacuous enforcement by them. Equilibrium and institutional sanctions are evaluated through their respective additional interfaces. Its state-dependent version is constructed by dependent quantification in the public-state and announcement sections.

Here "enforce" refers to a quantified guarantee, not to rationality or preference satisfaction. A coalition enforces a goal when one realizable choice yields it under every legal completion by outsiders. The enforcing policy need not be an equilibrium choice, since the ability predicate does not compare its desirability with other policies.

Construction 7.27 (Legal profiles and realizable coordinate images)**.**

(1) **Specify the legal profiles.** Let

$$m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma = \prod_{i \in N} \Sigma_i$$

be a specified subobject of legal profiles. The ordinary unconstrained case is $m = \mathrm{id}_\Sigma$.

(2) **Take the coordinate images.** For every $S \subseteq N$, factor the coordinate map through its image,

$$L \xrightarrow{e_S} L_S \xhookrightarrow{j_S} \Sigma_S, \qquad \pi_S m = j_S e_S. \tag{7.7}$$

Thus L_S is the set of realizable S-coordinates and e_S is a surjection by construction. No legal choice is introduced by selecting a representative of an equivalence class.

The coordinate images inherit all coordinate restrictions by effective descent.

Proposition 7.28 (The realizable-coordinate functor)**.** *For every inclusion $S \subseteq T \subseteq N$ there is a unique surjection*

$$\rho_S^T : L_T \twoheadrightarrow L_S$$

satisfying

$$\rho_S^T e_T = e_S. \tag{7.8}$$

These maps obey

$$\rho_S^S = \mathrm{id}_{L_S}, \qquad \rho_R^S \rho_S^T = \rho_R^T \quad (R \subseteq S \subseteq T).$$

Hence realizable coordinates form a contravariant functor

$$L_{(-)} : \mathcal{P}(N)^{\mathrm{op}} \longrightarrow \mathbf{Set}, \qquad S \longmapsto L_S,$$

where the powerset is ordered by inclusion.

Proof.

(1) **Construction of the comparison.** Let $\pi_S^T : \Sigma_T \to \Sigma_S$ be the ordinary coordinate projection. If $e_T(\ell) = e_T(\ell')$, monicity of the image inclusion $L_T \hookrightarrow \Sigma_T$ gives $\pi_T m(\ell) = \pi_T m(\ell')$. Applying π_S^T gives $\pi_S m(\ell) = \pi_S m(\ell')$, and monicity of $L_S \hookrightarrow \Sigma_S$ therefore gives $e_S(\ell) = e_S(\ell')$.

(2) **Construction by quotient descent.** Thus e_S equalizes the kernel pair of the surjection e_T. Proposition 5.38 supplies a unique map ρ_S^T satisfying Equation (7.8).

(3) **Lifting along the surjection.** It is surjective because every $s \in L_S$ has the form $s = e_S(\ell)$ and then

$$s = \rho_S^T(e_T(\ell)).$$

For $R \subseteq S \subseteq T$, both $\rho_R^S \rho_S^T$ and ρ_R^T become e_R after precomposition with the surjection e_T; cancellation of that epimorphism gives equality. The identity equation is the same argument with $S = T$.

□

Construction 7.29 (Legal deviation kernel pairs)**.**

(1) **Form the legal kernel pair.** The corresponding legal deviation relation is the kernel pair

$$D_C^L = L \times_{L_{-C}} L \overset{p_2}{\underset{p_1}{\rightrightarrows}} L \tag{7.9}$$

of e_{-C}.

(2) **Identify the outsider fibre.** It relates exactly those legal profiles that agree on their realizable outsider coordinate. When $L = \Sigma$ this is the deviation relation D_C constructed in Equation (4.1).

Proposition 7.30 (Functional dependence of legal policy coordinates)**.** *For $S \subseteq N$ and $j \in N$, form the kernel pair $K_S = L \times_{L_S} L$ of e_S, with projections p_1, p_2. The assertion that the S-coordinates locally determine owner j's coordinate is the predicate*

$$\mathsf{FD}_{S \Rightarrow j} = \forall_{p_1 : K_S \to L} \operatorname{Eq}\big((\pi_j m)p_1, (\pi_j m)p_2\big) \quad \in \mathsf{Pred}(L).$$

It holds at ℓ exactly when every legal profile agreeing with ℓ on S also agrees on coordinate j. Moreover $\mathsf{FD}_{S \Rightarrow j} = \top_L$ exactly when $\pi_j m$ factors uniquely through $e_S : L \twoheadrightarrow L_S$. This is the functional-dependence test associated with the preference-and- dependence interpretation of Chen, Shi, and Wang (2022), expressed in the existing assertion doctrine.

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** The fibre of p_1 at ℓ consists of all legal profiles having S-coordinate $e_S(\ell)$; universal quantification of equality proves the pointwise claim. Global truth says precisely that $(\pi_j m)p_1 = (\pi_j m)p_2$. Since e_S is the coequalizer of its kernel pair, Proposition 5.38 gives the unique factor.

□

Proposition 7.31 (Legal deviation is dynamic restriction)**.** *For every coalition C,*

$$D_C^L \cong (m \times m)^* D_C. \tag{7.10}$$

Thus the legal deviation relation is exactly the ordinary coalition-deviation relation restricted to the legal state space. The image object L_{-C} does not introduce a new accessibility relation; it presents the realizable outsider coordinate through which that restricted relation is the kernel pair.

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** By definition $D_C^L = \ker(e_{-C})$. Since

$$\pi_{-C} m = j_{-C} e_{-C}$$

and j_{-C} is monic,

$$e_{-C}(\ell) = e_{-C}(\ell') \Longleftrightarrow \pi_{-C}m(\ell) = \pi_{-C}m(\ell').$$

Hence $\ker(e_{-C}) = \ker(\pi_{-C}m)$. Kernel pairs are pullbacks of a map along itself and therefore are stable under change of base.

(2) **Pullback of deviation kernel pairs.** Pulling $D_C = \ker(\pi_{-C})$ back along $m \times m$ gives $\ker(\pi_{-C}m)$, proving the claimed isomorphism.

□

Construction 7.32 (Legal domains from institutional data)**.**

(1) **Impose institutional constraints.** A legal subobject need not be introduced by an uninterpreted legality predicate when lower-level institutional data are available. For a set-indexed family, if $c_\alpha : \Sigma \to Y_\alpha$ are typed constraint maps and $A_\alpha \hookrightarrow Y_\alpha$ are their permitted-value subobjects, define

$$L = \bigwedge_\alpha c_\alpha^* A_\alpha \hookrightarrow \Sigma.$$

(2) **Take certificate images.** If legality instead means that a profile admits an institutional witness, start from a witness object W and a map $w : W \to \Sigma$ and define

$$L = \mathrm{im}(w) \hookrightarrow \Sigma.$$

(3) **Combine the conditions.** Finite combinations of such conditions are obtained by pullback and image factorization. Thus the generic subobject $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ below is supplied institutional data only when no lower-level construction has been specified; whenever constraints or witnesses are supplied, legality is the subobject constructed from them.

For an open-arena realization $g : \Sigma \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$, the legal counterfactual semantics of coalition C is

$$\delta_C^{G,L} = (g \circ m \circ p_1, g \circ m \circ p_2) : D_C^L \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A, B)^2, \tag{7.11}$$

The legal instance of Theorem 5.45 uses $\mathsf{Prof}_i^L = (\delta_i^{G,L})^* \mathsf{Better}_i$:

$$\mathsf{NE}_{G,L} = \bigwedge_{i \in N} \forall_{p_1 : D_i^L \to L} \neg \mathsf{Prof}_i^L. \tag{7.12}$$

For measured records, substitute the descended pair predicate of Proposition 5.50, in particular $(\bar{v}_i p_1, \bar{v}_i p_2)^* \prec_i$ when values descend. The unrestricted case is $L = \Sigma$.

Proposition 7.33 (Legal equilibrium as restricted modal stability)**.** *Let*

$$\mathsf{PDev}_i = D_i \cap (g \times g)^* \mathsf{Better}_i \hookrightarrow \Sigma \times \Sigma.$$

Then its legal restriction is

$$\mathsf{PDev}_i^L = (m \times m)^* \mathsf{PDev}_i,$$

and

$$\mathsf{NE}_{G,L} = \bigwedge_i \neg \langle \mathsf{PDev}_i^L \rangle \top. \tag{7.13}$$

Viewed again as a predicate on the ambient profile space through the dynamic box $[!m] = \forall_m$*,*

$$[!m]\mathsf{NE}_{G,L} = L \Rightarrow \bigwedge_i \neg \langle \mathsf{PDev}_i \rangle L. \tag{7.14}$$

Thus restricting legality can create equilibria exactly by removing profitable alternatives; legal equilibrium is not generally the pullback of unrestricted equilibrium.

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Proposition 7.31 gives $D_i^L = (m \times m)^* D_i$, while functoriality of pullback gives

$$((gm) \times (gm))^* \mathsf{Better}_i = (m \times m)^* (g \times g)^* \mathsf{Better}_i.$$

Pullback preserves finite meets, hence the profitable-deviation relation restricts as displayed. Proposition 5.54 applied in the state space L gives Equation (7.13).

(2) **Witness and legality comparison.** Write $A = \exists_m \top$ for the ambient predicate represented by the legal subobject and put

$$S = \bigwedge_i \neg\langle \mathsf{PDev}_i \rangle A \in \mathsf{Pred}(\Sigma).$$

For every relation $R \hookrightarrow \Sigma \times \Sigma$, change of base along m gives

$$m^* \langle R \rangle A = \langle (m \times m)^* R \rangle \top. \tag{7.15}$$

To see this entirely in the relation calculus, let Γ_m be the graph of m.

(3) **Predicate calculation.** Proposition 7.14 gives

$$m^* = \langle \Gamma_m \rangle, \qquad A = \exists_m \top = \langle \Gamma_m^\smile \rangle \top.$$

Hence

$$\begin{aligned} m^* \langle R \rangle A &= \langle \Gamma_m ; R ; \Gamma_m^\smile \rangle \top \\ &= \langle (m \times m)^* R \rangle \top, \end{aligned}$$

because $\Gamma_m ; R ; \Gamma_m^\smile$ is exactly the restriction of R to the subobject L.

(4) **Legal Nash reduction by implication.** Therefore

$$m^* S = \bigwedge_i \neg\langle \mathsf{PDev}_i^L \rangle \top = \mathsf{NE}_{G,L}.$$

For the monomorphism $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, each fibre has one element over a point of $A = \exists_m \top$ and no elements outside A. The universal and existential fibre formulas therefore give $\forall_m Q = A \Rightarrow \exists_m Q$ for every predicate Q on L: outside A the universal clause is vacuous, and on A its unique preimage determines both quantifiers. Frobenius gives

$$\begin{aligned} [!m]\mathsf{NE}_{G,L} &= A \Rightarrow \exists_m \mathsf{NE}_{G,L} \\ &= A \Rightarrow \exists_m m^* S \\ &= A \Rightarrow (A \wedge S) \\ &= A \Rightarrow S. \end{aligned}$$

Identifying the image predicate A with the displayed legal predicate L gives Equation (7.14).

□

Definition 7.34 (Amalgamation of legal choices)**.** For disjoint coalitions $C, D \subseteq N$, use the restriction maps of Proposition 7.28 to form the **amalgamation comparison**

$$\lambda_{C,D} = \langle \rho_C^{C \cup D}, \rho_D^{C \cup D} \rangle : L_{C \cup D} \longrightarrow L_C \times L_D.$$

Two separately realizable coordinates $c \in L_C$ and $d \in L_D$ **amalgamate** precisely when the dependent witness fibre

$$\mathsf{Amal}_{C,D}(c,d) = \{u \in L_{C\cup D} : \lambda_{C,D}(u) = (c,d)\}$$

is inhabited. All such pairs amalgamate precisely when $\lambda_{C,D}$ is surjective. A witness is a single realizable joint coordinate simultaneously extending both choices.

Suppose either agent may request a resource, but the institution cannot grant both requests together. Each request has a legal completion when considered on its own. Their pair has none. The amalgamation map below tests exactly this failure of compatibility. On an unrestricted product domain, taking the pair of choices supplies the desired completion.

Definition 7.35 (Coalition effectivity specialized to an evaluated arena)**.** For an open-arena realization $g : \Sigma \to \mathcal{C}(A,B)$ with an observable evaluation $o : \mathcal{C}(A,B) \to Z$, the outcome map in Definition 7.26 is $q = o \circ g \circ m : L \to Z$; it may also be supplied directly. The already constructed effectivity operator, now written $[C]_L$, is

$$[C]_L P = \exists_{!:L_C \to 1} \forall_{e_C : L \to L_C} q^* P. \tag{7.16}$$

This agrees with the elementwise enforcing criterion of Definition 7.26: a realizable coalition coordinate $c \in L_C$ guarantees the goal under every legal completion. Because e_C is surjective, every quantified coalition choice has at least one legal completion. Hence ability cannot be obtained vacuously from an unrealizable coordinate. If $L = \Sigma$ and the profile space is inhabited, then every factor is inhabited, $L_C \cong \Sigma_C$, and the fiber of e_C is canonically Σ_{-C}; Equation (7.16) becomes

$$[C]P \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \exists s_C \in \Sigma_C \; \forall s_{-C} \in \Sigma_{-C},\; q(s_C, s_{-C}) \in P. \tag{7.17}$$

For an empty profile space the image construction leaves no realizable coalition choice and therefore introduces no vacuous power.

The coalition must choose a single action that succeeds against every legal outsider response. Reversing the quantifiers would let it tailor its action to the outsider's choice even though the two act simultaneously. The coordinate image specifies which actions have a legal completion, and the order of the dependent quantifiers specifies who can rely on whose choice.

For disjoint coalitions C, D, the realizable-coordinate functor constructs the comparison

$$\lambda_{C,D} = \langle \rho_C^{C\cup D}, \rho_D^{C\cup D} \rangle : L_{C\cup D} \longrightarrow L_C \times L_D. \tag{7.18}$$

It measures exactly whether separately realizable choices of C and D can be amalgamated into one legal joint choice.

Theorem 7.36 (Coalition ability and legal amalgamation)**.** *Let $C \cap D = \varnothing$. If $\lambda_{C,D}$ is surjective, then for every outcome map $q : L \to Z$ and predicates $P, Q \hookrightarrow Z$,*

$$[C]_L P \;\wedge\; [D]_L Q \quad \Longrightarrow \quad [C \cup D]_L (P \cap Q).$$

Conversely, if this implication holds for every q, P, Q, then $\lambda_{C,D}$ is surjective. In particular the implication holds for the ordinary full-product game.

Proof.

(1) **Choice of representatives and quotients.** Let $c \in L_C$ and $d \in L_D$ witness the two ability assertions. If $\lambda_{C,D}$ is surjective, take $u \in L_{C\cup D}$ with $\lambda_{C,D}(u) = (c, d)$. For any legal profile ℓ with $e_{C\cup D}(\ell) = u$, functoriality of coordinate restriction gives $e_C(\ell) = c$ and $e_D(\ell) = d$.

(2) **Joint coalition witness.** Hence $q(\ell) \in P$ by the first witness and $q(\ell) \in Q$ by the second. Thus u witnesses $[C \cup D]_L(P \cap Q)$.

(3) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, take an arbitrary pair $(c, d) \in L_C \times L_D$. Let

$$q = (e_C, e_D) : L \longrightarrow L_C \times L_D, \qquad P = \{c\} \times L_D, \qquad Q = L_C \times \{d\}.$$

Then c witnesses $[C]_L P$ and d witnesses $[D]_L Q$. By the assumed superadditivity there is $u \in L_{C\cup D}$ such that every legal completion of u is sent to (c, d).

(4) **Verification of the universal property.** Surjectivity of $e_{C\cup D} : L \twoheadrightarrow L_{C\cup D}$ supplies such a completion ℓ, and

$$\lambda_{C,D}(u) = \lambda_{C,D} e_{C\cup D}(\ell) = (e_C(\ell), e_D(\ell)) = (c, d).$$

Hence $\lambda_{C,D}$ is surjective.

(5) **Lifting along the surjection.** For $L = \Sigma$ a nonempty full product has $L_S \cong \Sigma_S$, and for disjoint C, D the map $\lambda_{C,D}$ is the canonical product comparison and is surjective. If Σ is empty, every L_S is empty and the same map is the unique surjection $\varnothing \to \varnothing$. Thus the ordinary full-product implication holds in either case.

□

For product choices the resulting implication recovers the familiar superadditivity pattern of coalition effectivity Pauly (2002), while the quantifier order parallels the coalition modalities of alternating-time logic (Alur, Henzinger, and Kupferman, 2002). Here the image comparison identifies the exact amalgamation condition needed when legality couples the choices.

Construction 7.37 (Outsider-coordinate amalgamation map)**.**

(1) **Project to common outsider coordinates.** There is a parallel exact criterion for composing legal deviation relations. Put $O = N \setminus (C \cup D)$. Proposition 7.28 constructs the restriction maps

$$\rho_O^{-C} : L_{-C} \to L_O, \qquad \rho_O^{-D} : L_{-D} \to L_O.$$

(2) **Form the matching pullback.** Form their pullback

$$P_{C,D} = L_{-C} \times_{L_O} L_{-D}$$

and the canonical comparison

$$a_{C,D} : L \longrightarrow P_{C,D}, \qquad \ell \longmapsto (e_{-C}(\ell), e_{-D}(\ell)). \tag{7.19}$$

Proposition 7.38 (Legal deviation amalgamation)**.** *For arbitrary $C, D \subseteq N$,*

$$D_C^L ; D_D^L = D_{C\cup D}^L \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad a_{C,D} \text{ is surjective.}$$

Proof.

(1) **Inclusion of successive legal deviations.** A successive C-change and D-change preserves every coordinate outside $C \cup D$, so $D_C^L; D_D^L \subseteq D_{C\cup D}^L$ always.

(2) **Forward implication.** Suppose first that $a_{C,D}$ is surjective and $\sigma D_{C\cup D}^L \tau$. Then the pair

$$(e_{-C}(\sigma), e_{-D}(\tau))$$

has equal images in L_O, because σ and τ agree on the realizable coordinate outside $C \cup D$. It therefore lies in $P_{C,D}$.

(3) **Choice of representatives and quotients.** Choose $\rho \in L$ above this point under the surjection $a_{C,D}$. Then

$$e_{-C}(\rho) = e_{-C}(\sigma), \qquad e_{-D}(\rho) = e_{-D}(\tau),$$

so $\sigma D_C^L \rho D_D^L \tau$.

(4) **Reverse implication.** Conversely assume equality of the relations and take $(x, y) \in P_{C,D}$. Since the image maps e_{-C} and e_{-D} are surjective, choose legal profiles σ, τ with $e_{-C}(\sigma) = x$ and $e_{-D}(\tau) = y$. Compatibility of (x, y) over L_O says $\sigma D_{C\cup D}^L \tau$.

(5) **Lifting along the surjection.** By the assumed equality there is ρ with $\sigma D_C^L \rho D_D^L \tau$. Hence $a_{C,D}(\rho) = (x, y)$, proving surjectivity.

□

The comparison for successive legal deviations is induced by the pullback of outsider-coordinate images.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L_{-C} \times_{L_O} L_{-D} & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{pr}_2} & L_{-D} \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle \mathrm{pr}_1} & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \rho_O^{-D}} \\ L_{-C} & \xrightarrow[\rho_O^{-C}]{} & L_O \end{array}$$

For the concrete dependent domain

$$L = \{(0,0), (1,1)\} \subseteq \{0,1\}^2,$$

one has $L_{\{1\}} = L_{\{2\}} = \{0, 1\}$, while $\lambda_{\{1\},\{2\}} : L \to \{0,1\}^2$ is the diagonal inclusion and is not surjective. Taking $q = \mathrm{id}_L$, $P = \{(0,0)\}$, and $Q = \{(1,1)\}$, agent 1 can force P with its realizable choice 0 and agent 2 can force Q with its realizable choice 1, but their witnesses have no legal amalgamation and $P \cap Q = \varnothing$. Likewise both singleton deviation relations are identities whereas the two-player relation is $L \times L$. The example separates legal dependence from the full-product case.

7.7.2 Choice cells and the one-stage logic of agency

Effectivity asks whether some coalition choice guarantees a goal. A related one-stage operation asks what is guaranteed by the coalition's already selected choice. This distinction makes contact with the seeing-to-it-that interpretation of agency (Horty and Belnap, 1995): choice and ability quantify over different fibres even when they use the same legal domain.

Proposition 7.39 (Choice-cell guarantees and effectivity)**.** *For $e_C : L \twoheadrightarrow L_C$, put*

$$Q_C = \ker e_C = D^L_{N\setminus C}.$$

For a predicate $R \hookrightarrow L$, the guarantee of the current coalition choice is

$$[Q_C]R = e_C^* \forall_{e_C} R.$$

Some realizable coalition choice guarantees R exactly when $\exists_{!:L_C \to 1} \forall_{e_C} R$ holds. At a legal reference ℓ, the predicate

$$[Q_C]R \ \wedge \ \neg[L \times L]R$$

says that the current choice guarantees R while R is not already inevitable among all legal profiles.

Proof.

(1) **Policy-level comparison.** The Q_C-successors of ℓ are exactly the legal profiles ℓ' with $e_C(\ell') = e_C(\ell)$, which proves the first equation by the fibre formula for $\forall_{e_C}$. Existentially quantifying over its image L_C gives the second assertion and excludes unrealizable choices. The universal relation $L \times L$ tests R at every legal profile, giving the final conjunction.

(2) **Complementary choice-cell relation.** Finally, fixing the C-coordinates is exactly allowing changes of their complement, which proves the equality with $D^L_{N\setminus C}$.

□

The current-choice modality ranges over outsiders' legal completions; profitable-deviation modalities instead range over changes to the owner's own policy with outsiders fixed. Interchanging these relations would reverse the control interpretation. Their conjunction in the one-stage deliberative clause therefore records two genuinely different tests.

For unrestricted products, independently fixed choices of different owners always have a common realization, given by their coordinate tuple. Coupled legality need not have this property: with $L = \{(0,0),(1,1)\}$, choosing 0 for one owner and 1 for the other produces no joint legal profile. Compatibility of choices must therefore be established from the legal domain, not from ownership alone.

7.7.3 Collective improvements and stability

Definition 7.40 (Blocking and cores)**.** Let L be a reference carrier. For each nonempty coalition $C \subseteq N$, a specified **blocking-witness family** is a map $p_C : B_C \to L$, whose fibre $B_C(\ell) = p_C^{-1}(\ell)$ contains the exhibited C-blocks at ℓ. The **blocking predicate** and its corresponding **core** are

$$\mathsf{Block}_C = \exists_{p_C} \top \hookrightarrow L, \qquad \mathsf{Core}_B = \bigwedge_{\varnothing \neq C \subseteq N} \neg \mathsf{Block}_C \hookrightarrow L.$$

For strict strong-Nash blocks, B_C is the comprehension of $\mathsf{Improve}^L_C \hookrightarrow D^L_C$, with p_C induced by the first deviation projection. For effectivity blocks it is the family of enforcing coalition coordinates; for endowment blocks it is the family of certified reallocations of the coalition's resources. These are different cores because their witness and alternative carriers are different.

The distinctions used here are:

Stability notion	Alternative ruled out
Nash equilibrium	One agent strictly improves while outsiders retain their policies.
Strong Nash stability	A nonempty coalition changes its policies, with outsiders fixed, and every member strictly improves.
Strong-Pareto stability	A coalition changes its policies, with outsiders fixed; all members weakly improve and at least one strictly improves.
Effectivity core	A coalition chooses a coordinate whose every legal completion strictly improves all its members.
Endowment core	A coalition reallocates its own initial resources so that every member strictly improves, using a certified reallocation of its endowment.

In the endowment interpretation, the outsider comparison concerns exclusion of outsiders' resources, leaving their policy coordinates. These are consequently different stability predicates.

Definition 7.41 (Strict coalitional improvement and strong Nash stability)**.** For a nonempty coalition C, put

$$\mathsf{Improve}_C = \bigwedge_{i\in C} (\delta_C^G)^* \mathsf{Better}_i^{A,B} \quad \hookrightarrow D_C. \tag{7.20}$$

Define strong Nash stability by

$$\mathsf{SNE}_G = \bigwedge_{\varnothing\neq C\subseteq N} \forall_{p_1:D_C\to\Sigma} \neg \mathsf{Improve}_C. \tag{7.21}$$

For the legal domain $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, put

$$\mathsf{Improve}_C^L = \bigwedge_{i\in C} (\delta_C^{G,L})^* \mathsf{Better}_i^{A,B} \quad \hookrightarrow D_C^L$$

and

$$\mathsf{SNE}_{G,L} = \bigwedge_{\varnothing\neq C\subseteq N} \forall_{p_1:D_C^L\to L} \neg \mathsf{Improve}_C^L. \tag{7.22}$$

For measured profile utilities replace each arrow comparison on D_C^L by $(\bar{v}_i p_1, \bar{v}_i p_2)^* \prec_i$, keeping the same outsider-fixed projection and universal quantifier. The Pareto-improvement variant is made into an explicit optimality predicate in Construction 7.42 below.

Construction 7.42 (Weak and strong Pareto optimality)**.**

(1) **Evaluate individual improvements.** On the legal completed profile space L take v_i to be the descent of the numerical evaluation $e_i r$ and form each strict improvement by comparing these two endpoint values, as in Proposition 5.50. An arrow-level presentation gives the instance $v_i(\ell) = k_i(g(m\ell))$. For every nonempty coalition C, the existing strict coalition-improvement predicate is $\mathsf{Improve}_C^L \hookrightarrow D_C^L$.

(2) **Form Pareto improvement.** Construct the Pareto-improvement predicate on that same dependent alternative space by

$$\mathsf{ParetoGain}_C^L(\ell,\ell') \iff \left(\bigwedge_{i\in C} v_i(\ell') \geq v_i(\ell)\right) \wedge \left(\bigvee_{i\in C} v_i(\ell') > v_i(\ell)\right).$$

(3) **Test the legal alternatives.** Define the weak and strong Pareto-optimality assertions on L by

$$\mathsf{WPO}_{C,L} = \forall_{p_1 : D_C^L \to L} \neg \mathsf{Improve}_C^L, \qquad \mathsf{SPO}_{C,L} = \forall_{p_1 : D_C^L \to L} \neg \mathsf{ParetoGain}_C^L.$$

For the empty coalition both predicates are $\top_L$. Weak Pareto optimality rules out an alternative strictly improving every member; strong Pareto optimality rules out an alternative weakly improving every member and strictly improving at least one. For $C = N$ these are the ordinary global Pareto predicates relative to L; for other coalitions outsider coordinates remain fixed. Their fibres are subterminal ordinary dependent objects. For preorder-valued preferences, the construction evaluates the supplied weak preorder and its strict part (Chen, Shi, and Wang, 2022).

Proposition 7.43 (Pareto optimality and strategic stability)**.** *For either numerical presentation, for every coalition C, $\mathsf{SPO}_{C,L} \leq \mathsf{WPO}_{C,L}$. Moreover*

$$\mathsf{NE}_{G,L} = \bigwedge_{i \in N} \mathsf{WPO}_{\{i\},L} = \bigwedge_{i \in N} \mathsf{SPO}_{\{i\},L}, \qquad \mathsf{SNE}_{G,L} = \bigwedge_{\varnothing \neq C \subseteq N} \mathsf{WPO}_{C,L},$$

and the all-coalition strong-Pareto condition satisfies

$$\bigwedge_{\varnothing \neq C \subseteq N} \mathsf{SPO}_{C,L} \;\leq\; \mathsf{SNE}_{G,L}.$$

All these assertions commute with substitution of a reference context; legal strategic quotients preserve and reflect them when the utility comparisons descend.

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** A strict gain for every member is a weak gain for every member with at least one strict gain; taking complements and universally quantifying gives $\mathsf{SPO}_{C,L} \leq \mathsf{WPO}_{C,L}$. For a singleton coalition the two improvement predicates coincide and are exactly the profitable unilateral-deviation predicate. Their conjunction is legal Nash equilibrium.

(2) **Base-change comparison.** Conjoining the weak Pareto predicates over all nonempty coalitions gives the definition of strong Nash stability. The final inequality follows pointwise from the first. Substitution retains the entire alternative fibre by Beck–Chevalley, and the quotient claim follows from alternative lifting in Theorem 14.18 and preservation of the descended comparisons.

□

Proposition 7.44 (Coalitional interpretation and quotient invariance)**.** *For $\mathbb{K}$-valued utilities, $\mathsf{SNE}_G(\sigma)$ holds exactly when, for every nonempty C, there is no τ_C such that $v_i(\tau_C, \sigma_{-C}) > v_i(\sigma)$ for all $i \in C$. On L the same assertion ranges over legal alternatives with the actual outsider coordinates fixed. Legality-sensitive strategic reduction preserves and reflects these predicates, and also the Pareto variant when its utility comparisons descend.*

Proof.

(1) **Lifting through the comparison.** The fiber of p_1 over the reference consists precisely of the stated alternatives. Expand the right quantifier and the pulled-back comparisons. For quotient invariance, Theorem 14.18 supplies both forward preservation and lifting of every reduced legal alternative.

(2) **Strategic comparison.** The commuting counterfactual realizations preserve each comparison. A profitable alternative therefore exists on one side exactly when it exists on the other. Finite conjunction over the coalitions gives the result.

□

Remark 7.45 (Carriers of collective alternatives). Strong Nash stability fixes actual outsiders. Effectivity quantifies over all legal completions of a coalition choice. Exchange economies use another carrier: certificates for reallocating a coalition's own initial endowment. Its core predicate uses the same assertion doctrine with that distinct form of collective control.

Definition 7.46 (Enforceable blocks and the effectivity core)**.** For $\mathbb{K}$-valued utilities, $\ell \in L$, and nonempty C, define

$$P_{\ell,C}(\ell') \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \bigwedge_{i \in C} v_i(\ell') > v_i(\ell).$$

An enforceable block at ℓ is a realizable coalition coordinate $c \in L_C$ such that every legal completion ℓ' of c satisfies $P_{\ell,C}$. Thus existence of such a block is exactly $[C]_L P_{\ell,C}$, using the identity outcome map of L. Define the effectivity core by

$$\mathsf{Core}^{\mathrm{eff}}_{G,L}(\ell) = \bigwedge_{\varnothing \neq C \subseteq N} \neg [C]_L P_{\ell,C}.$$

This is a notion of stability defined by effectivity. Characteristic-function games and cores with transferable utility require their own specified data.

Proposition 7.47 (Amalgamation turns enforceable blocks into deviations)**.** *An enforcing coordinate $c \in L_C$ has a candidate with the actual outsiders of ℓ exactly when*

$$(c, e_{-C}(\ell)) \in \mathrm{im}(\lambda_{C,-C} : L \to L_C \times L_{-C}).$$

Whenever this condition holds, the candidate is a strict strong-Nash block. In particular surjectivity of $\lambda_{C,-C}$ makes every enforceable block a strong-Nash block. The condition holds on a full product.

Proof.

(1) **Image characterization of deviations.** Membership in the displayed image says exactly that there is an $\ell' \in L$ with $e_C(\ell') = c$ and $e_{-C}(\ell') = e_{-C}(\ell)$. The latter equality places (ℓ, ℓ') in D^L_C; the former invokes the enforcing property, so every member strictly benefits. Surjectivity provides that witness for every pair. On a full product the witness is the tuple (c, ℓ_{-C}).

□

Example 7.48 (Authority and information in complementary commitments)**.** For Example 5.75, the coalition of both owners can move from $(0,0)$ to $(1,1)$ and strictly benefit both members. Thus $(0,0)$ fails strong Nash stability while $(1,1)$ satisfies it. Regrouping the owners turns this joint deviation into a unilateral deviation of the new owner; pooling their observations alone does not change its ownership. A collective preference for a regrouped owner remains separate from that structural change.

7.7.4 Interaction arrays and robust coalitional solvability

Blocking tests a given preference profile. Robust solvability asks instead whether every assignment of outcome preferences admits a stable legal profile. The interaction-sheaf account already relates this question to acyclicity (Abdou and Keiding, 2009). We construct a finite blocking-selection certificate on the actual legal domain and derive destabilizing integer preferences from it. This retains coupled permission rules throughout the comparison. The definition and cycle numbering below follow the authors' working version (Abdou and Keiding, 2008).

Construction 7.49 (Outcome-dependent interaction arrays)**.**

(1) **Retain legal alternatives and their outcomes.** Let $L \subseteq \prod_i \Sigma_i$ be finite and nonempty, $q : L \twoheadrightarrow Z$ a finite outcome image, and $\mathcal{M} \subseteq \mathcal{P}(N) \setminus \{\varnothing\}$ the designated coalitions. Use $D_C^L(\sigma) = \{\tau \in L : \tau_{-C} = \sigma_{-C}\}$. The map q retains everything used by the outcome preferences. The choice $q = \mathrm{id}_L$ is available when a smaller outcome would forget relevant policy or measured-value data.

(2) **Test a common array throughout an outcome fibre.** An array is $\varphi = (\varphi_C)_{C \in \mathcal{M}}$ with $\varphi_C \subseteq Z$. Put

$$I(z) = \{\varphi : \forall \sigma \in q^{-1}(z)\ \exists C \in \mathcal{M}\ \exists \tau \in D_C^L(\sigma)\ q(\tau) \in \varphi_C\},$$
$$E(U) = \bigcap_{z \in U} I(z), \qquad U \subseteq Z.$$

The coalition and its witness may depend on the profile over z. The universal quantifier over that fibre retains stable and unstable realizations of the same outcome separately.

(3) **Include boundary cases.** If $\mathcal{M}$ is empty, $I(z)$ is empty and every legal profile is stable. For nonempty U, the all-empty array is not in $E(U)$, so allowing it in the ambient array set does not affect the interaction test. The empty legal domain is already infeasible and has no stable profile.

Proposition 7.50 (Intersection locality of interaction arrays)**.** *The sets $E(U)$ are upward closed in arrays, reverse inclusion of outcome sets, and satisfy*

$$E\left(\bigcup_j U_j\right) = \bigcap_j E(U_j).$$

They define an interaction sheaf in the sense of Abdou and Keiding (2008, Definition 3.1) on the finite discrete outcome space.

Proof.

(1) **Enlarge targets and restrict sources.** Increasing each φ_C preserves every deviation witness. Restricting the universally quantified outcome set removes tests, giving inclusion reversal.

(2) **Compute the union test.** A common array works for every outcome in a union exactly when it works for every outcome in each member. This proves the intersection law, including the empty union with its ambient-array value.

□

Remark 7.51 (Interaction locality and ordinary sheaf gluing). The preceding intersection law concerns one common array, not arbitrary gluing of different local arrays. For example, take

two owners, one with two policies and the other with one, identity outcomes $Z = \{0, 1\}$, and designate only the first owner's coalition. All changes by that owner are allowed. Each of $E(\{0\})$, $E(\{1\})$, and $E(Z)$ consists of the three nonempty target subsets. An ordinary set-valued sheaf on the disjoint singleton cover would instead have nine global sections. Its empty value would have to be terminal, whereas $E(\varnothing)$ contains every array. One can form the ordinary sheaf $\mathcal{I}(U) = \prod_{z \in U} I(z)$ on the discrete outcome space; for nonempty U, $E(U)$ selects its sections with one constant array. No ordinary higher-cohomology conclusion follows from the interaction terminology. The solvability obstruction below uses its explicit coalitional witnesses.

For outcome utilities $v_i : Z \to \mathbb{R}$, write $\mathsf{Stab}_{\mathcal{M}} \subseteq L$ for profiles having no $C \in \mathcal{M}$ and $\tau \in D_C^L(\sigma)$ with $v_i(q\tau) > v_i(q\sigma)$ for every $i \in C$. This is the existing strict blocking predicate, restricted to the designated coalitions. Singletons give legal Nash equilibrium; all nonempty coalitions give strict strong Nash stability. Put

$$P_z(C) = \{z' \in Z : \forall i \in C \; v_i(z') > v_i(z)\}.$$

Theorem 7.52 (Exact recovery of stable outcomes)**.** *The interaction data recover the stable outcomes by*

$$q(\mathsf{Stab}_{\mathcal{M}}) = \{z \in Z : P_z \notin I(z)\}.$$

Proof.

(1) **Expand interaction membership.** The assertion $P_z \in I(z)$ says that every legal profile over z has a designated legal deviation strictly improving every member of its coalition. Thus no profile over z is stable.

(2) **Recover the stable fibre.** Failure of that assertion means that at least one legal profile over z has no such block. This is membership in the image on the left. On finite encoded preference tables, enumerate the fibre and each legal deviation to construct the stable representative whenever this test succeeds.

□

Example 7.53 (A stable realization cannot be discarded)**.** Let $L = \{00, 10, 11\}$, $q(00) = q(11) = a$, and $q(10) = b$; designate the singleton coalitions. Owner 1 prefers b to a and owner 2 prefers a to b. Profile 00 is unstable through owner 1's deviation to 10. Profile 11 is stable: the first owner's change to 01 is illegal, and the second owner's change to 10 is worse. Hence a is a stable outcome. Testing whether some preimage of a is unstable would incorrectly remove it.

Definition 7.54 (A blocking-selection certificate)**.** A blocking selection chooses, for every $\sigma \in L$, a pair (C_σ, τ_σ) with $C_\sigma \in \mathcal{M}$ and $\tau_\sigma \in D_{C_\sigma}^L(\sigma)$. For each owner i, form a directed graph H_i on Z with edges

$$q(\sigma) \longrightarrow q(\tau_\sigma) \quad \text{whenever } i \in C_\sigma.$$

The selection is a certificate when every H_i is acyclic, including absence of self-loops. The institution is **robustly $\mathcal{M}$-solvable** when it has a stable legal profile for every profile of numerical outcome preferences.

Theorem 7.55 (A complete finite obstruction to robust solvability)**.** *For the finite legal domain and outcome interface of Construction 7.49, the following are equivalent:*

(1) *Some profile of numerical outcome preferences admits no legal $\mathcal{M}$-stable profile.*

(2) *A blocking-selection certificate exists.*

(3) *For each $z \in Z$ one can select $\varphi^z \in I(z)$ so that, for each owner i, the graph with edges $z \to z'$ whenever $z' \in \varphi^z_C$ for some $C \ni i$ is acyclic.*

Whenever these conditions hold, integer utilities in $\{0, \dots, |Z| - 1\}$ witnessing nonexistence can be constructed. Consequently robust $\mathcal{M}$-solvability is equivalent to the absence of such a certificate. Arbitrary coupling in L is retained.

Proof.

(1) **Extract a certificate from destabilizing preferences.** For every profile choose one profitable designated deviation. Every edge of H_i strictly increases v_i, so no H_i has a directed cycle. These are finitely many witness choices, proving (1)⇒(2).

(2) **Construct destabilizing integer preferences.** Given (2), let $v_i(z)$ be the length of a longest directed path ending at z in H_i, with zero for an isolated vertex. Acyclicity makes this an integer between zero and $|Z| - 1$. Appending an edge raises the rank by at least one, so each selected deviation strictly benefits all its members. Every legal profile is blocked, proving (2)⇒(1).

(3) **Aggregate the selected witnesses by outcome.** Put

$$\varphi^z_C = \{q(\tau_\sigma) : q(\sigma) = z,\ C_\sigma = C\}.$$

Every source profile over z has its selected witness, giving $\varphi^z \in I(z)$. The induced owner graphs are exactly the H_i, proving (2)⇒(3).

(4) **Recover a selection from interaction arrays.** For each profile use the witness supplied by $\varphi^{q(\sigma)} \in I(q(\sigma))$. The resulting owner graphs are subgraphs of the acyclic graphs in (3), proving (3)⇒(2). The equivalence gives the robustness statement; on finite encoded data its certificate tests are decidable. No independent amalgamation of coalition and outsider choices has been used.

□

Proposition 7.56 (Comparison with the finite interaction-cycle criterion)**.** *On the finite discrete outcome space, condition* (3) *of Theorem 7.55 is equivalent to a cycle in Abdou and Keiding (2008, Definition 4.1), applied to E.*

Proof.

(1) **State the covering condition.** Write $R_i(\varphi) = \bigcup_{C \ni i} \varphi_C$. An interaction cycle is a finite cover $(U_k)_k$ of Z with $\varphi^k \in E(U_k)$ such that for each owner i and each nonempty set J of cover indices there is $k \in J$ satisfying

$$U_k \cap R_i(\varphi^j) = \varnothing \qquad (j \in J).$$

(2) **Use the singleton cover.** With $U_z = \{z\}$, the condition says every nonempty induced owner graph has a vertex with no incoming edge. A finite directed graph has this property exactly when it is acyclic: a directed cycle contradicts it, and a finite graph without a source contains a cycle by following incoming edges. This identifies condition (3) with a singleton-cover cycle.

(3) **Refine an arbitrary covering cycle.** Choose for each z an index $k(z)$ with $z \in U_{k(z)}$. Restriction gives $\varphi^{k(z)} \in I(z)$. If the resulting owner graph had a directed cycle, let J be the cover indices assigned to its vertices. The covering condition supplies $k \in J$

whose set U_k meets none of $R_i(\varphi^j)$ for $j \in J$. A cycle vertex assigned index k lies in U_k and is the target of an edge from an array indexed by J, a contradiction. The refined owner graphs are therefore acyclic.

□

Corollary 7.57 (Delegation preserves the interaction obstruction)**.** *Use the ownerwise surjection $h : \prod_i \Theta_i \twoheadrightarrow \prod_i T_i$ onto actually implemented parent policies, put $L_T = L \cap \prod_i T_i$ and $L_h = h^{-1}(L_T)$, and use the corresponding whole-parent-block coalitions of Theorem 4.14. For $q_h = q_T h$,*

$$I_h(z) = I_T(z), \qquad E_h(U) = E_T(U).$$

Thus robust solvability and the certificate obstruction agree between the implementation and its implemented parent domain.

Proof.

(1) **Compare alternatives at a fixed source.** A parent coalition deviation lifts by choosing preimages of its changed coordinates while retaining all outsider coordinates of the given implementation. Conversely a whole-block deviation maps to a legal parent deviation. The resulting outcomes agree.

(2) **Compare every realization of an outcome.** Surjectivity of h covers each parent outcome fibre. The source-fixed lifting proves that the universal fibre tests defining I_h and I_T are equivalent. Intersecting over U gives the second equality; apply Theorem 7.55 for the final claim.

□

Construction 7.58 (A finite robustness decision procedure)**.**

(1) **Enumerate candidate blocks.** For each $\sigma \in L$ list all legal pairs (C, τ) with $C \in \mathcal{M}$ and $q\tau \neq q\sigma$. Enumerate selections of one pair per profile and test each induced owner graph for a directed cycle.

(2) **Return a witnessed obstruction or a robustness result.** An acyclic selection produces destabilizing utilities by the rank construction in Theorem 7.55. If no selection works, the same theorem proves robustness. Given a finite encoded preference table, direct search then finds a stable legal profile. The procedure may be exponential; interaction terminology alone supplies no efficiency bound.

(3) **Compare with preference enumeration.** Enumerating strict total orders on Z for every owner gives an independent finite test. If any numerical preferences destabilize the institution, retain the finitely many strict comparisons used by a blocking selection and extend each owner's acyclic graph by topological sorting. The selected blocks remain strict in these total orders. Thus strict-order enumeration suffices even when the original numerical preferences allowed ties.

7.7.5 Substitution and three different changes of context

Proposition 7.59 (Stability of agent formation)**.** *For $f : V \to W$ there are coherent isomorphisms*

$$f^* \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B) \cong \mathsf{Ag}_{f^*\vec{\Sigma}}(f^*A, f^*B).$$

They preserve sequential and parallel composition, execution, and ownerwise reparametrization.

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At v, both sides are $[\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma_{f(v)} \otimes A_{f(v)}, B_{f(v)}]$. All the named operations are defined by these pointwise tensor, evaluation, and ordinary profile maps. Identity and composition of substitutions give the same evaluations.

□

Three substitutions that can look similar on state carriers have different agency meanings. First, changing the reference state pulls back only the source of an alternative span. For $W \xleftarrow{s} E \xrightarrow{t} Y$ and $f : V \to W$, the new source is the corresponding pullback.

$$V \leftarrow V \times_W E \xrightarrow{t\pi_E} Y.$$

The target remains all of Y, so the original alternatives stay available. Beck–Chevalley then gives exact substitution of existential and universal tests along the reference map.

Second, a policy reparametrization changes the available controlled alternatives themselves. Its comparison is the realization-preserving map and alternative-lifting construction of Section 4.4, not a source-only pullback.

Third, epistemic restriction changes both endpoints of accessibility. For $j : U \hookrightarrow W$, the relation R becomes $(j \times j)^* R$, deleting excluded alternatives as well as excluded references. Public announcements in Section 9.2 use this operation, which is not interchangeable with the first two.

7.8 Uniformly informed and legal policies

7.8.1 The legal local menu in agent syntax

Let $o : W \twoheadrightarrow O$ be an effective observation and $F \hookrightarrow W \times M$ a feasibility or permission relation. The construction in Construction 7.15 gives $A_o = \forall_{o \times 1_M} F$. Its agent-calculus dependent type is

$$\mathsf{Pol}_o(F) = \prod_{z:O} \{m : M \mid A_o(z, m)\}, \tag{7.23}$$

canonically identified with the sections of $A_o \to O$.

Corollary 7.60 (Legal policy types and their comparisons)**.** *The dependent type in* (7.23) *has the following canonical descriptions.*

(1) *Its members are exactly the $\pi : O \to M$ satisfying $F(w, \pi(o(w)))$ for every world w.*

(2) *For effective $o = ro'$, precomposition $\pi \mapsto \pi r$ injects $\mathsf{Pol}_o(F)$ into $\mathsf{Pol}_{o'}(F)$, with image the policies constant on the fibres of r.*

(3) *For $F_C \hookrightarrow W \times \prod_{i \in C} M_i$, the decentralized type is*

$$\mathsf{Pol}_C^{\mathrm{dec}}(F_C) = \{(\pi_i) \in \prod_{i \in C} M_i^{O_i} : \forall w \ F_C(w, (\pi_i(o_i(w)))_i)\}.$$

Its injection into pooled legal policies is $(\pi_i)_i \mapsto (z \mapsto (\pi_i(p_i z))_i)$, with image exactly the pooled policies whose ith output descends along $p_i : O_C \to O_i$ for every i.

Proof.

(1) **Identify sections and descent.** The first two claims are Proposition 7.16 under the sections interpretation of the displayed dependent product. The third is the same identification applied to Propositions 6.26 and 7.18; its map preserves every worldwise joint response.

□

For complete-policy changes take $M = \Sigma_i$ and $F_i(w,u) \iff (s(w)_{-i}, u) \in L$. Pooling may enlarge the legal policy type, but using the pooled signal still requires the communication wiring that delivers it.

7.8.2 Collective evaluation and institutional power

For a nonempty coalition C, one constructed collective comparison is

$$P_C^{\mathrm{all}}(\sigma,\tau) = \bigwedge_{i\in C} P_i(\sigma,\tau).$$

The corresponding stability predicate says that no legal C-deviation strictly improves every member. Weak Pareto improvement is a different predicate, formed from the members' weak comparisons and at least one strict comparison. A designated corporate comparison can also be supplied as the institution's evaluation interface. Regrouping controls does not choose between these evaluations.

For the image comparison of Theorem 4.14, stability for the same pulled-back comparisons agrees between parent coalitions and whole delegate blocks: the source-fixed lift preserves and reflects improving alternatives. In particular, parent Nash equilibrium agrees with Nash equilibrium after each delegate block is regrouped as one owner.

Institutional ability has a different quantifier pattern. Let $e_C : L \twoheadrightarrow L_C = \mathrm{im}(L \to \Sigma_C)$ be the realizable coalition-coordinate map, and let $z : L \to Z$ record outcomes. Define

$$\mathsf{Can}_C(P) \iff \exists u \in L_C \; \forall \ell \in L \, (e_C(\ell) = u \Rightarrow P(z\ell)). \tag{7.24}$$

Each quantified coordinate has an actual legal completion because e_C is surjective. Thus the formula gives no vacuous power to impossible choices. When choices must be informed, the existential witness is a member of the decentralized or pooled legal policy type, and the universal quantification is taken over its compatible worlds and legal completions. This constructs uniform ability directly, with the information constraint in its witness.

A designer who wants to give a coalition the power to act must therefore check three things. Its choice must have a legal completion, must depend only on information available to its members, and must achieve the goal against every relevant outsider response. Preference enters a different test, which asks whether an owner would choose a feasible deviation. The next section follows the witness for an execution through a change of institutional state.

8 Witnessed Institutions and Dynamic Agency

Legal choice has so far been tested in a given state. An institutional action can change that state and supply evidence needed by a later action. We represent such an execution by a witness with source and target records and a concurrent realizer. Matching the records composes institutional actions; retaining the witnesses preserves the certificates passed between them. Dependent sums and products along the resulting spans construct the dynamic modalities. This extends the theory from permitted alternatives to institutions that execute and compose.

8.1 Dependent witnesses and certified realizations

Consider the difference between learning that an authorization exists and receiving the authorization needed for the next action. An existential image answers the first question.

The dependent family retains the certificate and its concurrent realization for the second. These are the proof-irrelevant and proof-relevant readings of the same institutional data.

Construction 8.1 (Dependent witness families)**.**

(1) **Form the dependent witness context.** Let $A, B \in \mathsf{L}(\Gamma)$ and let $K \in \mathsf{T}(\Gamma)$. Its context extension is $p_K : \Gamma.K = \coprod_{\gamma\in\Gamma} K_\gamma \to \Gamma$.

(2) **Realize an individual witness.** A witness realization is an ordinary morphism

$$\rho : K \longrightarrow \mathsf{Val}_\Gamma[A, B]_D.$$

Thus each witness $k \in K_\gamma$ exhibits a linear arrow $\rho_\gamma(k) : A_\gamma \to B_\gamma$. A certified family is a section $\kappa : 1_\Gamma \to K$; its realized family is $g = \rho\kappa$.

(3) **Take its support.** The predicate that a witness exists is

$$\|K\| = \exists_{p_K} \top \hookrightarrow \Gamma.$$

The witness object K, its realization ρ, and any exhibited section remain available separately from this predicate.

(4) **Reindex the family.** For $f : \Delta \to \Gamma$, pullback gives f^*K, $f^*\rho$, and $f^*\kappa$, and

$$f^*(\rho\kappa) = (f^*\rho)(f^*\kappa), \qquad f^*\|K\| = \|f^*K\|.$$

The first equation is functoriality of substitution; the second is Proposition 5.28. Consequently realization and existential feasibility share the constructed substitution while retaining their different carriers. Allocation and production witnesses are particular instances of this construction.

For a constant interaction boundary and a displayed certificate carrier, the compatibility of its tests with operational tests has the following form. Here K denotes the total certificate carrier and U its realization map.

Proposition 8.2 (Certificate tests and operational tests)**.** *Let K be a displayed certificate carrier, $U : K \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$ its concurrent realization, and $\kappa : \Sigma \to K$ a certified arena with $g = U\kappa$. For $Q \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A, B)$ and $P \hookrightarrow K$,*

$$g^*Q = \kappa^*U^*Q, \qquad \mathrm{Test}_P(\kappa) = \kappa^*P.$$

Thus operational and certificate predicates belong to the same assertion fibre, and the second class may retain distinctions unseen by U.

Proof.

(1) **Witness and legality comparison.** The first equality is functoriality of predicate substitution; the second is semantic testing of the certificate term. Both have typed expressions using $\Delta_G K$ and $\Delta_G \mathcal{C}(A, B)$. No inverse to U is needed: the carrier K and the term κ are retained.

□

8.2 Sheaf-local witnesses with persistent complete policies

A witness family retains the policy that parameterizes each execution. To relate it to causal gluing, restrict only the secured matching history to a patch and keep that parameter unchanged. Otherwise an unexecuted branch could disappear from the policy merely because the patch contains no event from it. This construction connects ordinary dependent witness families with local causal histories while preserving the off-path alternatives needed for strategic comparison.

Construction 8.3 (A common site for an owned interaction family)**.**

(1) **Display the ordinary parameters.** Let X be a set whose elements include the required reference and complete owner-profile data, with a map $p : X \to \prod_i \Sigma_i$. A concrete finite protocol may use $X = U \times \prod_i \Sigma_i$, where U is its external-input carrier. For each $x \in X$, take an exhibited pair of total event-structure maps $f_x : S_x \to E$, $g_x : T_x \to E$ representing a secured synchronization problem at a fixed common interface E.

(2) **Use simultaneous causal coverage.** Let $\mathcal{O}_X$ consist of subsets of E saturated for the arena and for both source maps at *every* x. Cover a patch by a nonempty finite family that detects the minimal inconsistencies in every S_x, T_x. Identity, base change and transitivity are verified parameterwise by Lemma 1.9. The full interface $|E|$ is terminal.

(3) **Keep the parameter under restriction.** Define

$$\mathscr{K}_X(V) = \coprod_{x \in X} \mathcal{M}((f_x)_V, (g_x)_V), \qquad (x, \varphi)|_{V'} = (x, \varphi|_{V'}). \tag{8.1}$$

The owner-coordinate record is the map $\mathscr{K}_X \to \underline{\prod_i \Sigma_i}$ induced by p, where $\underline{(-)}$ denotes the constant presheaf on this site.

Theorem 8.4 (Persistent-policy witnessed descent)**.** *The assignment $\mathscr{K}_X$ is a sheaf and*

$$\Gamma(\mathscr{K}_X) \cong \coprod_{x \in X} \mathcal{M}(f_x, g_x).$$

Every constant presheaf $\underline{Y}$ is a sheaf for this nonempty-cover topology. In particular, $\mathscr{K}_X(\varnothing) \cong X$, so the full owner-indexed policy record persists when the local interaction is empty. The map to the complete-policy carrier commutes with causal restriction and with ownerwise reparametrization of the displayed family.

Proof.

(1) **Recover constant policy objects.** Every covering family is nonempty, and its members have the empty patch as a common subpatch. Restrictions of a constant presheaf are identities, so agreement on intersections forces a single value in Y; the matching family glues uniquely. Hence $\underline{Y}$ is a sheaf. Moreover,

$$\underline{X} \cong \coprod_{x \in X} 1$$

in the sheaf topos: the coproduct sheaf has one locally constant component tag, and agreement on the empty patch makes that tag constant across any covering family.

(2) **Apply extensivity to persistent families.** Let $\mathcal{E} = \mathrm{Sh}(\mathcal{O}_X)$. Its infinitary extensivity gives the canonical slice equivalence

$$\mathcal{E}/\underline{X} \;\simeq\; \prod_{x\in X} \mathcal{E}, \qquad (K \to \underline{X}) \longmapsto (K \times_{\underline{X}} 1_x)_{x\in X}.$$

The reverse functor is the coproduct of these fibres (Mac Lane and Moerdijk, 1992, Chapters II–III). Under this equivalence $\mathscr{K}_X$ is the family $(\mathscr{M}_{f_x,g_x})_{x\in X}$ of Theorem 1.11. Equivalently, $\mathscr{K}_X \cong \coprod_x \mathscr{M}_{f_x,g_x}$, so it is a sheaf and its parameter map is the coproduct projection. A causal restriction cannot change that component tag.

(3) **Recover global witnesses and ownership.** Since the full interface is terminal, global sections recover $\mathscr{K}_X(E) = \coprod_x \mathcal{M}(f_x, g_x)$, and at the empty patch each matching is empty, leaving exactly $x \in X$. Composing the coproduct projection with $\underline{p}$ gives the original complete owner-profile record. Naturality under reparametrization is cartesian reindexing of this slice object, as in Proposition 8.5.

□

Proposition 8.5 (Cartesian reparametrization of witnessed families)**.** *For the parameter projection $\pi_X : \mathscr{K}_X \to \underline{X}$ and any ordinary map $r : X' \to X$, the pullback in the existing sheaf topos constructs the reindexed family on the fixed site $\mathcal{O}_X$:*

$$\mathscr{K}[r] = \underline{X'} \times_{\underline{X}} \mathscr{K}_X, \qquad \mathscr{K}[r](V) \cong \coprod_{x'\in X'} \mathcal{M}((f_{r(x')})_V, (g_{r(x')})_V). \tag{8.2}$$

There are canonical, substitution-coherent isomorphisms

$$\Gamma(\mathscr{K}[r]) \cong X' \times_X \Gamma(\mathscr{K}_X), \qquad \mathscr{K}[r\circ t] \cong \underline{X''} \times_{\underline{X'}} \mathscr{K}[r] \quad (t : X'' \to X'). \tag{8.3}$$

If $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$ is formed using the maximal simultaneously saturated patches of the reindexed family, each patch and cover of $\mathcal{O}_X$ is also valid for that family. Its restriction to $\mathcal{O}_X$ is the sheaf in (8.2). The implemented parent-policy record of the pullback is $pr : X' \to \prod_i \Sigma_i$. In particular, when $X = U \times \Sigma$, $X' = U \times \Theta$ and $r = 1_U \times h$ for an ownerwise implementation $h : \Theta \to \Sigma$, the cartesian pullback separately retains the controlled subordinate projection $p_\Theta : X' \to \Theta$; its parent-policy projection is $p_\Sigma r = h p_\Theta$. Thus the two projections, and hence their deviation relations, are not identified by the sheaf pullback.

Proof.

(1) **Construct the cartesian family.** The pullback is computed objectwise because finite limits of sheaves are computed objectwise (Mac Lane and Moerdijk, 1992, Chapters II–III). Its elements at V are precisely the pairs (x', φ) displayed above; restriction changes only φ. In particular the pullback is a sheaf without an additional policy-persistence condition.

(2) **Recover sections and coherence.** The global-section functor is right adjoint to the constant-sheaf functor and preserves limits. Here $\Gamma(\underline{Y}) \cong Y$, since the full interface is terminal. Applying Γ to the pullback gives the first isomorphism. Iterating the universal property of pullbacks gives the second. The two bracketings project to the same x'' and secured matching, proving their unit and associativity coherence.

(3) **Compare the sites.** Saturation for every $x \in X$ implies saturation for every $r(x')$. A cover detecting all minimal inconsistencies for the original family detects those for its reindexed subfamily. Thus the inclusion of patch posets preserves the displayed covers, and the objectwise formula restricts to the fixed-site pullback.

(4) **Distinguish control from implementation.** For the displayed implementation, the two ordinary projections satisfy $p_\Sigma r = h p_\Theta$ by the universal property of the parameter pullback. The first is the implemented policy, whereas p_Θ retains each delegate's available coordinate. Restricting h_i to $T_i = \mathrm{im}(h_i)$ supplies an ownerwise surjection onto $T = \prod_i T_i$. Lemma 4.10 then gives a source-fixed lift of each completed legal parent deviation from a specified subordinate reference, with unchanged outsider blocks. This is a property of the constructed parameter map, not of the local matching labels.

□

Ordinary parameter substitution is a cartesian lift of the witness family, rather than a change of the alternatives inferred from a local history.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathscr{K}[r] & \longrightarrow & \mathscr{K}_X \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_X} \\ \underline{X'} & \xrightarrow[\underline{r}]{} & \underline{X} \end{array}$$

Causal restriction never changes the ordinary policy index attached to a secured history.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathscr{K}_X(V) & \longrightarrow & \underline{X}(V) \\ {\scriptstyle \mathrm{res}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \mathrm{res}} \\ \mathscr{K}_X(V') & \longrightarrow & \underline{X}(V') \end{array}$$

Remark 8.6 (Scope of the witnessed sheaf). The construction is applied to an *exhibited* family of secured synchronization diagrams, not to an unspecified arbitrary arrow of the completed category $\mathcal{V}$. Its global sections retain actual secured matching witnesses; its owner coordinates are carried by the displayed parameter family. The sheaf topos is an auxiliary locality semantics, while $\mathsf{Lin} \dashv \mathsf{Val}$ and the agent representation continue to live in the original indexed model. Completed executions are distinguished from these generally partial matchings in Section 10.5.

8.3 Witnessed institutional executions

To compose two institutional actions we must connect the record produced by the first to the record expected by the second. A witness carries both endpoints and the concurrent process that relates them. This gives a record-based interpretation of institutional power in the sense of Jones and Sergot (1996). If two executions reach the same record with different certificates, keeping both witnesses allows the next institution to distinguish them.

Definition 8.7 (A witnessed institutional execution)**.** An institutional boundary is a pair (X, A) of an ordinary record set X and a linear boundary $A \in \mathcal{C}$. A witnessed execution from (X, A) to (Y, B) is

$$\mathcal{E} = (X \xleftarrow{s} E \xrightarrow{t} Y,\ \rho : E \to \mathcal{C}(A, B),\ P \hookrightarrow E).$$

Here E retains execution witnesses, $\rho(e)$ is the realized concurrent interaction, and P consists of permitted witnesses. A map $\mathcal{E} \Rightarrow \mathcal{E}'$ is a function $f : E \to E'$ with $s'f = s$, $t'f = t$, $\rho' f = \rho$, and $f[P] \subseteq P'$. The last condition preserves permission; reflection of permission is a stronger property and is not included in every map.

An owned arena $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g)$ yields such a witness presentation when execution data include a policy map $\lambda : E \to \Sigma$, record maps, and a permission predicate $P \subseteq \lambda^{-1}(L)$. Its realizer is $\rho = g\lambda$. The witness may retain a policy tuple, a certificate, or hidden communication. Restricting to permitted witnesses changes the institutional action but does not identify distinct executions.

Theorem 8.8 (Composition of witnessed institutions)**.** *Witnessed executions and their maps form a symmetric monoidal bicategory* $\mathbf{Inst}(\mathcal{C})$*. For consecutive executions* $\mathcal{E}_1 : (X, A) \to (Y, B)$ *and* $\mathcal{E}_2 : (Y, B) \to (Z, C)$*, composition is*

$$E_{21} = E_1 \times_Y E_2, \qquad \rho_{21}(e_1, e_2) = \rho_2(e_2) \circ \rho_1(e_1), \qquad P_{21} = P_1 \times_Y P_2.$$

The source and target are $s_1(e_1)$ *and* $t_2(e_2)$*. The identity at* (X, A) *has witness carrier* X*, both endpoint maps equal to* id_X*, constant realizer* id_A*, and every witness permitted. The tensor has*

$$(X, A) \otimes (X', A') = (X \times X', A \otimes A'), \qquad E_{\mathcal{E}\otimes\mathcal{F}} = E \times F, \qquad P_{\mathcal{E}\otimes\mathcal{F}} = P_{\mathcal{E}} \times P_{\mathcal{F}},$$

with coordinatewise endpoints and realizer $\rho_{\mathcal{E}}(e) \otimes \rho_{\mathcal{F}}(f)$*.*

A pair contributes to the composite span exactly when the record produced by the first execution is the input record of the second.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E_1 \times_Y E_2 & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{pr}_2} & E_2 \\ {\scriptstyle \mathrm{pr}_1}\downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle s_2} \\ E_1 & \xrightarrow[t_1]{} & Y \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Secured operational interaction.** For composable witnessed executions, the pullback has the explicit fibrewise description

$$(E_1 \times_Y E_2)(x, z) \cong \coprod_{y \in Y} E_1(x, y) \times E_2(y, z), \tag{8.4}$$

which sends a matching pair to its uniquely determined intermediate record and its two constituent witnesses. Its inverse assembles that pair, so it retains both realizer labels and both permissions.

(2) **Naturality of witnessed composition.** If $f : E_1 \to E_1'$ and $g : E_2 \to E_2'$ preserve the endpoints, $(e_1, e_2) \mapsto (f(e_1), g(e_2))$ is a well-defined map of the pullbacks. It preserves the composite realizer by the two realization equations and sends permitted pairs to permitted pairs. This defines horizontal composition of maps; vertical composition is composition of functions.

(3) **Interchange of witnessed executions.** The interchange equation is pointwise the equality of the two componentwise composite functions.

(4) **Secured operational interaction.** The associator sends $((e_1, e_2), e_3)$ to $(e_1, (e_2, e_3))$. Both sides are exactly the triples with matching consecutive records. Their realizers agree by associativity in $\mathcal{C}$, and their permission predicates are both the conjunction of the three permission predicates.

(5) **Witness and legality comparison.** The unitors delete the unique intermediate identity witness, whose record is already fixed by the adjacent endpoint. Pentagon and triangle coherence follow because each route has the same tuple projections.

(6) **Parallel compatibility.** For tensor and horizontal composition, the comparison

$$(E_1 \times E_1') \times_{Y \times Y'} (E_2 \times E_2') \cong (E_1 \times_Y E_2) \times (E_1' \times_{Y'} E_2')$$

reorders a matching quadruple. The interchange law in $\mathcal{C}$ preserves its realizer, and the four permission tests agree on both sides.

(7) **Secured operational interaction.** The monoidal associativity, unit, and symmetry components are the graph spans of the corresponding bijections of ordinary records, labelled by the corresponding structural isomorphisms of $\mathcal{C}$, with all witnesses permitted. Their naturality and coherence reduce to those bijections and the monoidal coherence of $\mathcal{C}$. This supplies the stated symmetric monoidal bicategory structure.

□

Products here combine ordinary institutional records, not copies of arbitrary linear resources. The realized concurrent interactions continue to compose by secured interaction and hiding. Two distinct witnesses may therefore have identical source and target records while remaining distinguishable by their strategies or certifications.

Proposition 8.9 (Witness retention, permission, and institutional modalities)**.** *Write* $E(x, y) = \{e \in E : s(e) = x,\ t(e) = y\}$. *Composition retains the dependent witness family*

$$E_{21}(x, z) \cong \coprod_{y \in Y} E_1(x, y) \times E_2(y, z).$$

Taking inhabitedness gives ordinary relational composition. For $Q \hookrightarrow Y$, *the source predicates*

$$\langle \mathcal{E} \rangle Q = \exists_s t^* Q, \qquad [\mathcal{E}] Q = \forall_s t^* Q$$

express, respectively, that some witnessed execution reaches Q *and that every witnessed execution reaches* Q. *They obey*

$$\langle \mathcal{E}_2 \circ \mathcal{E}_1 \rangle Q = \langle \mathcal{E}_1 \rangle \langle \mathcal{E}_2 \rangle Q, \qquad [\mathcal{E}_2 \circ \mathcal{E}_1] Q = [\mathcal{E}_1][\mathcal{E}_2] Q.$$

The same equations hold when each execution is restricted to its permitted subobject. A guarantee requiring an actual execution is

$$(\exists_s \top) \wedge \forall_s t^* Q.$$

Finally the violating witnesses of a composite are exactly

$$(E_1 \times_Y E_2) \setminus (P_1 \times_Y P_2) = ((E_1 \setminus P_1) \times_Y E_2) \cup (E_1 \times_Y (E_2 \setminus P_2)).$$

Proof.

(1) **Witness and legality comparison.** A composite witness is a pair with one common intermediate record; recording that value gives the displayed disjoint-union bijection. It has an inhabitant exactly when some intermediate record has an inhabitant in each of the two fibres.

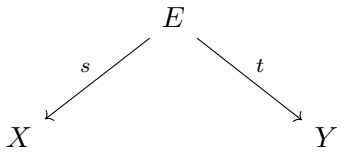
(2) **Fibrewise calculation.** At x, the composite diamond says that there are e_1, e_2 with $s_1(e_1) = x$, $s_2(e_2) = t_1(e_1)$, and $Q(t_2(e_2))$. This is the nested existential formula on the right. The box replaces these existential tests by the two universal tests, giving its equation, including intermediate records with no outgoing witness.

(3) **Predicate calculation.** Categorically these are the dependent quantifier composition and pullback equations. The restricted permitted spans compose by the same pullback, so the argument applies to them as well. The extra conjunct $\exists_s \top$ excludes a source with no execution, where the box alone is vacuously true.

(4) **De Morgan law for matched execution witnesses.** The final equality is the pointwise equivalence $\neg(P_1(e_1) \wedge P_2(e_2))$ with $\neg P_1(e_1) \vee \neg P_2(e_2)$ on the pullback.

□

An institutional execution witness carries a source record and a target record.



The enabling comprehension and target record describe how an authorization changes the institution. The predicate P states whether the execution is permitted. Keeping the execution witness independent of that judgement allows a later audit or sanction to refer to the very occurrence that violated the rule.

8.4 Linear realization and dynamic modalities

The witnessed executions of Definition 8.7 compose in the symmetric monoidal bicategory of Theorem 8.8. We now construct their linear execution maps and the dependent type operations induced by their witness spans. These constructions retain both the realizer and the permission predicate.

8.4.1 Measuring secured witnesses before hiding

Suppose a resource meter charges once for delivering a message. The sender and the receiver each record a local occurrence. Adding their logs before matching the occurrences would charge twice for one delivery. The next construction identifies the matched class first, assigns its weight once, and retains it when the shared interface is hidden.

Construction 8.10 (Additive charges on a finite secured witness)**.**

(1) **Identify matched occurrences.** In a finite interaction retain the component configurations with their tagged occurrences and the actual matches on shared interfaces, using the secured interaction of Castellan et al. (2017). For a finite chain use the full tuple of component configurations with all its matches. On the disjoint union of occurrences take the equivalence relation generated by these matches. Close the component causal orders transitively on the classes. Global securedness means this relation is antisymmetric, so it gives the causal order of the retained witness k. Retain this finite poset $H(k)$ before hiding any internal interface.

(2) **Record each class once.** Use the displayed protocol labels to give each singleton or matched class a signature in G. A matched send and receive can carry a single signature

recording both ports. With $\mathsf{M}(G) = \mathbb{N}^{(G)}$, the finite multisets of signatures, put

$$U(k) = \sum_{H \in H(k)} [g(H)], \qquad m_w(k) = \bar{w}(U(k)), \qquad \bar{w}(n) = \sum_{g \in \mathrm{supp}(n)} n(g)\, w(g).$$

Here $w : G \to C$ gives the weight of one class and $n(g)\, w(g)$ denotes repeated monoid addition. The empty history has multiset zero. The formula for $\bar{w}$ is additive and is forced on every finite multiset by its values on the generators. Thus it is the unique monoid map extending w. In the cost-action interpretation of Niu et al. (2022), successive charges add. Secured matching here determines which occurrences incur one charge.

(3) **Transport the measurement.** An isomorphism transporting the labels and matching induces a bijection on classes and preserves their interpreted weights. Rebracketing a fixed global witness leaves its generating matches and hence its class sum unchanged. Disjoint parallel witnesses give disjoint unions of classes. For a compatible prefix with inherited signatures, partitioning the classes into old and new ones gives $m_w(k') = m_w(k) + m_w(k' \setminus k)$, where the last term is the sum over new classes. A change $j : C \to C'$ of commutative monoids gives $j\bar{w} = \overline{jw}$ by agreement on generators. These comparisons use the original matching even when a hidden class has no visible representative.

(4) **Read span from the order.** For natural durations $d(H)$ compute $t(H) = d(H) + \max(\{0\} \cup \{t(J) : J < H\})$ along the finite order. Induction on strict predecessors identifies $t(H)$ with the maximum duration of a chain ending at H. The maximum over all $t(H)$ and 0 gives the span. Two equally labelled unit events have the same multiset in a chain and an antichain, but spans two and one, respectively.

Proposition 8.11 (Secured prefixes compose in the cost writer)**.** *In a fixed unhidden interaction with its displayed class signatures, let $x \subseteq y$ range over compatible prefixes, inheriting the signatures of the retained occurrences. The charge of an extension is*

$$\delta(x, y) = \sum_{H \in y \setminus x} w(g(H)).$$

Here each index H denotes a synchronized class in that fixed history. The prefix-inclusion category has a functor to the one-object category of $(C, +, 0)$ sending $x \subseteq y$ to $\delta(x, y)$. Following a prefix by a continuation accumulates charges by writer multiplication.

Proof.

(1) **Partition classes.** The empty difference has charge zero. For $x \subseteq y \subseteq z$, the disjoint union of $y \setminus x$ and $z \setminus y$ is $z \setminus x$. The inherited signatures agree on these sets, hence $\delta(x, z) = \delta(x, y) + \delta(y, z)$. This proves identity and composition, including in monoids without subtraction.

(2) **Compute the writer record.** Give $x \subseteq y$ output y and charge $\delta(x, y)$. Concatenating with $y \subseteq z$ at incoming charge c gives $(c + \delta(x, y) + \delta(y, z), z)$. This is the record of the full extension at c by the first step and Construction 2.7. Parallel independent histories give disjoint unions of classes, and their charges add in either order.

(3) **Identify the measurement boundary.** A pair of matching send and receive events is already one class at the cut where it occurs. Thus the above partition counts it once. The computation is over the retained globally matched history; its two independent component logs can contain representatives of that same class. Critical-path duration in Construction 8.10 still uses the partial order in addition to these classes.

□

From matched records to a measured execution. Consider two consecutive institutional executions with shared linear boundary B and intermediate ordinary record set Y. Write $D_{21} = E_1 \times_Y E_2$ for the record pairs of Theorem 8.8. At a pair $(e, f) \in D_{21}$, use the two displayed strategy presentations S_e, T_f of its realizer labels in the secured interaction construction of Section 1.1. Write $U_{e,f} = S_e \circledast_B T_f$ for the unhidden interaction. For its finite configurations let $\mathsf{Done}_{e,f}(z)$ be the completion test of the specified result interface. For a displayed completion port it tests whether its output occurs in z; for the finite session of Theorem 10.41 it tests whether the matched history has reached End, including a session ended at the root. If the record e or f designates a particular local history, retain only configurations whose component projection equals that marked history. The resulting ordinary dependent family and its total carrier are

$$\begin{aligned} H(e,f) &= \{z \in \mathrm{Conf}(U_{e,f}) : \mathsf{Done}_{e,f}(z) \text{ and } z \text{ has the designated projections}\}, \\ K_{21} &= \coprod_{(e,f)\in D_{21}} H(e,f), \qquad d : K_{21} \to D_{21}, \quad (e,f,z) \longmapsto (e,f). \end{aligned} \tag{8.5}$$

A separately displayed family of local marks is included by taking its dependent sum before forming H. The underlying institution supplies d's target and the two realizer labels. Its records can be used without any marks. Measuring occurrences uses the displayed executions and result interface of Constructions 2.8 and 8.10.

To verify (8.5), form the augmented synchronization pullback with the exterior events carried by identity maps, as in the definition of composition. By Theorem 1.7, a configuration of this pullback corresponds to the union of its prime secured matchings. Conversely, the prime pasts of the pairs of a secured matching recover that configuration. The two operations preserve its component histories. Restricting this bijection by the two projection tests and the same completion test on both sides identifies $H(e, f)$ with exactly the completed matching witnesses over (e, f). A change of marked presentations transports configurations, matches and their finite class posets bijectively. Thus the construction is natural under the displayed presentation isomorphisms. With presentations recorded only up to isomorphism one may use their marked isomorphism classes, as in Construction 12.15; the label-preserving class sum descends since it is invariant under every such isomorphism.

For example, take $Y = 1$ and boundary $D(\{0, 1\})$. One component can output either bit, and the other accepts either bit. Retain each of their two completed local bit histories as a separate record. All four pairs match on Y. Only $(0, 0)$ and $(1, 1)$ have a matching bit occurrence, and each has one completed secured matching. The projection d therefore accounts for enabling as well as the recorded endpoints.

The source and target on K_{21} are $s_1(e)$ and $t_2(f)$. Its permission predicate is $d^*(P_1 \times_Y P_2)$, and its charge is $m_{21}(e, f, z) = m_w(z)$ from Construction 8.10. For several stages, keep the tuple of local histories, all interface matches and the globally secured order until the class sum has been formed. Reassociation of this retained tuple has inverse given by the opposite reassociation: it preserves every component, generating match and order, hence also the completion test transported along it and the charge. The unmeasured record composite continues to be $E_1 \times_Y E_2$.

Proposition 8.12 (Budget restriction and change of measurement)**.** *For a witnessed institution $X \xleftarrow{s} E \xrightarrow{t} Y$, let E_{ret} be its displayed completed witnesses and let $m : E_{\mathrm{ret}} \to C$ measure them. A budget $B \hookrightarrow C$ defines the subspan on $E_B = m^{-1}B$. If $j : C \to C'$ regrades the measurement and $B' \hookrightarrow C'$, the budgets B' for jm and j^*B' for m give the same witness subspan. Its existential and universal modalities, and their dependent linear versions, agree.*

Proof.

(1) **Compare fibres.** For a completed witness k the two membership tests are $B'(j(m(k)))$ and $(j^*B')(m(k))$. These are the same predicate by substitution. Intersecting with the institution's permission predicate gives the same permitted subspan as well. The comparison can be displayed on the composite witness carrier:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K_B & \longrightarrow & B \\ \downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow \\ K_{21} & \xrightarrow[m_{21}]{} & C \end{array}$$

Thus feasibility on witnesses can be tested before taking an image in the policy carrier. A hard budget can remove a deviation; pricing the same execution compares values while retaining that deviation.

(2) **Transport the modalities.** Both restrictions have the same source and target maps s_B, t_B. Thus $\exists_{s_B} t_B^*$ and $\forall_{s_B} t_B^*$ agree on predicates, and $\Sigma^\ell_{s_B} t_B^*$ and $\Pi^\ell_{s_B} t_B^*$ have the same indexed summands and factors, including their witness multiplicities. For a composite with measured histories, take $E_{\mathrm{ret}} = K_{21}$ of (8.5). Its witnesses under a regraded budget are the triples (e, f, z) with $j(m_{21}(e, f, z)) \in B'$. This is exactly the comprehension of $m_{21}(e, f, z) \in j^{-1}(B')$ on the same fibre $H(e, f)$.

□

Policy substitution for a measured presentation. Over $p : K \to \Sigma$, an ownerwise reparametrization with total map $\theta : \Theta \to \Sigma$ gives the witness carrier $K_\theta = \Theta \times_\Sigma K$. Its measured record and owner value are $r\pi_K$ and $e_i r\pi_K$. At ϑ the projection identifies its entire witness fibre with $K_{\theta(\vartheta)}$. Successive reparametrizations compose by flattening these pullback tuples. In particular values that descend to policies pull back by θ. For a legal deviation, the further comparison in Lemma 4.10 lifts the alternative at its specified source; the fibre identification then transports its measured records. This construction reindexes the given execution. A physically different implementation has its own secured witnesses.

8.4.2 The linear execution induced by witnesses

Proposition 8.13 (Realized witnessed execution)**.** *For a witnessed execution $\mathcal{E} = (X \xleftarrow{s} E \xrightarrow{t} Y, \rho, P)$, let $\underline{yA}$ and $\underline{yB}$ denote the constant linear families on X and Y, and put $J_E = \Sigma^\ell_s \mathsf{I}_E$. The concurrent realizer constructs a canonical linear map over X:*

$$\mathrm{run}_\rho : \underline{yA} \otimes J_E \longrightarrow \Sigma^\ell_s t^* \underline{yB}. \tag{8.6}$$

These maps compose along the canonical pullback and coproduct-flattening comparisons, with the realizer of a matching pair (e, f) equal to $y\rho_F(f)\, y\rho_E(e)$. Restricting to P gives the corresponding permitted execution map.

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** Pointwise Yoneda gives the family morphism $\rho^\sharp : s^*\underline{yA} \to t^*\underline{yB}$ with component $y\rho(e)$ at e. By Frobenius and the tensor unitor, define

$$\underline{yA} \otimes \Sigma^\ell_s \mathsf{I}_E \xrightarrow{\cong} \Sigma^\ell_s(s^*\underline{yA} \otimes \mathsf{I}_E) \xrightarrow{\Sigma^\ell_s(\rho^\sharp \otimes 1)} \Sigma^\ell_s(t^*\underline{yB} \otimes \mathsf{I}_E) \xrightarrow{\Sigma^\ell_s(\text{right unitor})} \Sigma^\ell_s t^* \underline{yB}.$$

At $x \in X$, this is the copairing of the maps $y\rho(e) : yA \to yB$ over e with $s(e) = x$, retaining each summand's target-record index.

(2) **Base-change comparison.** Under a second execution, Beck–Chevalley and successive dependent sums flatten the summands indexed by matching (e, f); the component map is $y\rho_F(f) \circ y\rho_E(e) = y(\rho_F(f)\rho_E(e))$. The composite execution has exactly that realizer. Coproduct uniqueness proves the comparison equation, and flattening triples proves associativity coherence. Replacing E by its permitted comprehension gives the last assertion.

□

8.4.3 Dynamic type and predicate operations

For the underlying span $X \xleftarrow{s} E \xrightarrow{t} Y$, define

$$\langle E\rangle^{\ell} = \Sigma^{\ell}_s t^*, \qquad [E]^{\ell} = \Pi^{\ell}_s t^*.$$

At x, the first retains a choice of execution and an output resource; the second supplies an additive family indexed by every execution from x. The predicate operations are

$$\langle E\rangle P = \exists_s t^* P, \qquad [E]P = \forall_s t^* P.$$

They quantify over witnessed executions, including distinct executions with the same source and target.

Theorem 8.14 (Compositional dynamic modalities)**.** *For consecutive witnessed spans E, F,*

$$[F \circ E]^{\ell} \cong [E]^{\ell}[F]^{\ell}, \qquad \langle F \circ E\rangle^{\ell} \cong \langle E\rangle^{\ell}\langle F\rangle^{\ell}.$$

The predicate versions are equalities. Identity spans give identity operations. The comparisons are associative and unital.

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At x, the box on the composite is

$$\prod_{\substack{e:s_E(e)=x \\ f:s_F(f)=t_E(e)}} A_{t_F(f)}.$$

Flattening a nested product gives exactly $\prod_{e:s_E(e)=x} \prod_{f:s_F(f)=t_E(e)} A_{t_F(f)}$. The sum proof flattens the corresponding nested coproduct. Both include empty fibres.

(2) **Representation and Yoneda decoding.** Three successive comparisons flatten the same triples of witnesses, so product projections and coproduct injections prove coherence. The identity fibre has its unique record witness. Predicate quantifiers obey the identical nested quantification formulas.

□

For a relation $R \subseteq X \times Y$, the dynamic diamond $\exists_s t^*$ is left adjoint to $\forall_t s^*$, the box associated with the converse direction. The forward diamond and forward box are not generally an adjoint pair. Recording this variance prevents an incorrect transport rule when sequential execution spans are composed.

Passing from a witness span E to its relational image retains existential and universal truth tests on target predicates. It discards proof-relevant multiplicity: distinct executions at one pair of endpoints still contribute separate dependent summands or factors and may retain different strategies or certificates. The institutional type interpretation therefore uses the full span.

8.4.4 Permission and collective institutional agency

Restricting E to P gives permitted modalities. A guarantee of Q with an actual permitted execution is

$$(\exists_{s|P} \top) \wedge \forall_{s|P} (t|P)^* Q.$$

The first conjunct excludes the vacuous truth of a universal test at a record with no permitted execution. On a composite, violation is precisely

$$(\neg P_1 \wedge \top) \ \vee \ (\top \wedge \neg P_2)$$

as a predicate on $E_1 \times_Y E_2$. This records the stage at which permission failed.

An institution can be exposed as a collective agent by retaining its owner-indexed presentation and applying Section 4.4. Its observation and evaluation are then situated collective interfaces. This does not make the institution's normative rules into a preference: who may act, which actions are authorized, and which outcomes the collective prefers remain separately displayed. The preceding bicategory makes their witnessed executions compositional.

9 Public Announcements and Epistemic Actions

An institutional transition can change what an owner knows as well as what it may do. We construct the epistemic effect first at the level of state and event data. Public announcement restricts the state space; a general action model additionally retains which event occurred and what each recipient observed. Comprehension and reindexing realize these updates. We then establish the lifting conditions under which another presentation supports the same modal tests. The communication protocols of the next section will supply concrete delivery events for this comparison.

9.1 Communication and epistemic updates

We begin with the logical effect of an event. Public update restricts the situated state space and reindexes its epistemic relations; general action models retain event observations as well. To compare such updates with communication, we later retain each owner's earlier observation and complete policy alongside the delivered message. Agreement at that message must extend to the alternatives quantified over by knowledge, coalition deviations, and fixed-point assertions. The lifting results below establish this requirement before the operational implementations are introduced.

9.1.1 Public restriction by comprehension

Public announcement is the comprehensional update of public communication logic, originating with Plaza and represented here by Plaza (2007). Its operation on the state set is simple, but its epistemic meaning depends on restricting both arguments of accessibility. We construct this restriction using the predicate doctrine rather than adding an independent update primitive.

Definition 9.1 (Public announcement)**.** Fix a relation frame M with state set W and relations $(R_i)_{i \in N}$. For a predicate $P \hookrightarrow W$, let $a : U = \{P\} \hookrightarrow W$ be its comprehension. The **public announcement** of P updates the entire frame to

$$M|_P = \big(U, (R_i^P)_{i \in N}\big), \qquad R_i^P = (a \times a)^* R_i \hookrightarrow U^2.$$

Its box and diamond are the dependent quantifiers

$$[!P] = \forall_a : \mathsf{Pred}(U) \to \mathsf{Pred}(W), \qquad \langle !P\rangle = \exists_a : \mathsf{Pred}(U) \to \mathsf{Pred}(W).$$

For a fixed predicate $Q \hookrightarrow W$, $[!P](a^*Q) = P \Rightarrow Q$. Writing $[!a]$ and $\langle !a\rangle$ for the same operators when the inclusion a is specified, epistemic formulas in the updated frame are evaluated using the restricted relations R_i^P on both endpoints. Merely substituting reference states would instead retain the original target alternatives and would not be this update.

This changes the epistemic model, not merely the chosen reference state. Selecting only references satisfying P would leave excluded states available as epistemic alternatives; restricting both endpoints removes them. The corresponding reindexed observation fibres represent the information available after the announcement.

Construction 9.2 (Public update)**.**

(1) **Restrict the context.** For a monomorphism $a : U \hookrightarrow W$, put $A = \exists_a \top$. Restrict an operational family t to ta and an assertion to a^*P.

(2) **Construct the modalities.** Define $[!a] = \forall_a$ and $\langle !a\rangle = \exists_a$.

(3) **Restrict both relation endpoints.** For a relation R on W, its restricted relation is $R|_U = (a \times a)^* R$. This restriction changes both endpoints, unlike a reference pullback.

Proposition 9.3 (Monic change of base and its nucleus)**.** *Put $L = \exists_a$, $\rho = a^*$, and $J = \forall_a$. Then $\rho L = \rho J = \mathrm{id}$ and $L\rho(P) = A \wedge P$. Moreover*

$$JQ = A \Rightarrow LQ, \tag{9.1}$$

and

$$J\rho(P) = j_A(P) = A \Rightarrow P. \tag{9.2}$$

Thus L identifies $\mathsf{Pred}(U)$ with $\downarrow A$, and J identifies it with the fixed predicates of the nucleus j_A.

Proof.

(1) **Base-change comparison.** The self-pullback of a monomorphism has identity projections, so Beck–Chevalley gives $\rho L = \rho J = \mathrm{id}$. Frobenius gives $L\rho(P) = A \wedge P$. Consequently $P \le A \Rightarrow LQ$ iff $L\rho P \le LQ$ iff $\rho P \le Q$.

(2) **Verification of the universal property.** Uniqueness of right adjoints proves the formula for J. Substitute $Q = \rho P$. The unit of $\rho \dashv J$ gives inflationarity of $J\rho$; $\rho J = \mathrm{id}$ gives idempotence, and both factors preserve finite meets. The two claimed identifications follow from the same identities.

□

The inclusion of an announced submodel and its existential and universal predicate extensions form the update comparison.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{Pred}(U) & \xrightarrow{\exists_m} & \mathsf{Pred}(W) \\ {\scriptstyle \forall_m}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle m^*} \\ \mathsf{Pred}(W) & \xrightarrow[m^*]{} & \mathsf{Pred}(U) \end{array}$$

Corollary 9.4 (Update monad, support comonad, and restricted knowledge)**.** *For the inclusion $a : U \hookrightarrow W$, the endomaps $L\rho = A \wedge (-)$ and $J\rho = A \Rightarrow (-)$ are respectively an idempotent comonad and monad. Their coalgebra and algebra posets are equivalent to* $\mathsf{Pred}(U)$ *via L and J, respectively. For observational knowledge $K = [\ker(o)]$ and $K^U = [\ker(oa)]$,*

$$K^U = \rho KJ, \qquad JK^U = j_A KJ.$$

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The preceding monic adjunction identities identify both fixed-point posets and give their units and counits. For $u \in U$, the assertion $(\rho KJQ)(u)$ says that every w with $o(w) = o(a(u))$ satisfies JQ. Outside U this is true; inside U it is exactly Q.

(2) **Observation and knowledge.** This is knowledge for the restricted observation oa. Applying J and using $J\rho = j_A$ gives the second equation.

□

Example 9.5 (Restriction and knowledge need not commute)**.** Let $W = \{0, 1\}$ have one observation class and let $A = P = \{0\}$. Then $Kj_AP = W$, whereas $j_AKP = \{1\}$. The restriction formula is $K^U = \rho KJ$; no commutation of K with j_A is used.

Theorem 9.6 (Public-update reduction and composition)**.** *For predicates P on W and Q, Q' on U,*

$$[!a]a^*P = A \Rightarrow P, \qquad [!a](Q \wedge Q') = [!a]Q \wedge [!a]Q',$$
$$[!a](Q \Rightarrow Q') = A \Rightarrow ([!a]Q \Rightarrow [!a]Q'), \qquad [!a]\neg Q = A \Rightarrow \neg[!a]Q.$$

For a relation R on W,

$$[!a][R|_U]Q = A \Rightarrow [R]([!a]Q). \tag{9.3}$$

For $R = \ker o$, the restricted relation is $\ker(oa)$*; hence*

$$[!a]K^UQ = A \Rightarrow K([!a]Q), \tag{9.4}$$

and

$$[!a]K^U(a^*P) = A \Rightarrow K(A \Rightarrow P). \tag{9.5}$$

For $V \overset{b}{\hookrightarrow} U \overset{a}{\hookrightarrow} W$, $[!a][!b] = [!(ab)]$. If $B = \exists_b \top$ in U, then

$$\exists_a B = A \wedge [!a]B. \tag{9.6}$$

Proof.

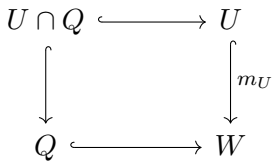
(1) **Reindexed implication and negation.** The first equations follow from $J\rho = j_A$, preservation of meets by J, and preservation of implication by ρ. For implication use $Q \Rightarrow Q' = \rho(JQ \Rightarrow JQ')$; the negation case also uses $J\bot = \neg A$ and the Heyting implication identities. Let Γ_a be the graph of a.

(2) **Descent along the kernel pair.** Then $R|_U = \Gamma_a; R; \Gamma_a^\smile$ and $\Gamma_a^\smile; \Gamma_a$ is the partial identity on A. Its box is $A \Rightarrow (-)$, proving the modal equation by relation composition. Kernel pairs restrict as stated.

(3) **Frobenius law for repeated announcements.** Finally right adjoints compose, and Frobenius with $a^*\forall_a = \mathrm{id}$ gives $\exists_a B = A \wedge \forall_a B$.

□

Repeated public restriction is computed by a composite of comprehension inclusions.



Remark 9.7 (Fixed predicates and re-evaluated epistemic assertions). For an inclusion $a : A \hookrightarrow W$, the equation $\forall_a a^* P = (A \Rightarrow P)$ is an equation about a fixed predicate. It does not imply that an epistemic formula remains true when its own truth set is announced.

Example 9.8 (A truthful announcement that ceases to be true)**.** Take $W = \{x, y\}$, one indiscriminate agent, and $p = \{x\}$. The formula $\varphi = p \wedge \neg Kp$ holds at x. Announcing its truth set leaves $\{x\}$, where Kp holds and φ is false. The factual predicate p has not changed; its epistemic context has.

Corollary 9.9 (Dynamic semantic testing)**.** *For* $\Phi = \mathrm{Test}_P(t_1, \ldots, t_n)$*,*

$$[!a]\,\mathrm{Test}_P(t_1 a, \ldots, t_n a) = A \Rightarrow \Phi, \tag{9.7}$$

and

$$[!a] K_i^U\,\mathrm{Test}_P(t_1 a, \ldots, t_n a) = A \Rightarrow K_i(A \Rightarrow \Phi). \tag{9.8}$$

Proof.

(1) **Functoriality and substitution.** Apply substitution of semantic tests and the preceding reduction equations.

□

Corollary 9.10 (Fixed points under public restriction)**.** *For* $a : U \hookrightarrow W$ *and monotone* F *on* $\mathsf{Pred}(U)$*,*

$$\forall_a(\mu F) = \mu(\forall_a F a^*), \qquad \forall_a(\nu F) = \nu(\forall_a F a^*).$$

Proof.

(1) **Repeated-announcement fixed-point calculation.** Use $a^* \forall_a = \mathrm{id}$ in Lemma 5.26.

□

9.1.2 Epistemic frames and categorical update

The comprehension inclusion for public restriction is a map of state carriers equipped with an accessibility comparison. General action updates have the same shape, but carry an event coordinate as well. To relate their assertions before and after update, we must distinguish ordinary reindexing of dependent families from exact lifting of accessible alternatives.

Definition 9.11 (Relation frames and their maps)**.** An object $M = (W, (R_i)_{i \in N})$ of $\mathbf{Fr}_N$ is a set with an N-indexed family of binary relations. A morphism $f : (U, (T_i)) \to (W, (R_i))$ is a function satisfying

$$T_i \subseteq (f \times f)^* R_i \qquad (i \in N).$$

Write $|M| = W$ for the underlying set. S5 frames form the full subcategory whose relations are equivalence relations. The definitions also permit the paper's non-S5 belief relations.

Proposition 9.12 (Pullbacks and the existing indexed semantics)**.** *The category* $\mathbf{Fr}_N$ *has finite limits. For maps* $f : M \to K$ *and* $g : L \to K$*, its pullback has underlying set* $|M| \times_{|K|} |L|$ *and relations*

$$R_i^{M \times_K L} = (\pi_M \times \pi_M)^* R_i^M \cap (\pi_L \times \pi_L)^* R_i^L.$$

These limits restrict to S5 frames. An epistemic refinement update of M *is an object* $p : U \to M$ *of* $\mathbf{Fr}_N/M$*. Its ordinary and linear families are transported by the existing functors*

$$|p|^* : \mathsf{T}(|M|) \to \mathsf{T}(|U|), \qquad |p|^* : \mathsf{L}(|M|) \to \mathsf{L}(|U|).$$

Successive updates compose as morphisms. Pullback gives base change between the slice categories, coherently up to their canonical isomorphisms.

Proof.

(1) **Predicate calculation.** The set-theoretic pullback carries the displayed relations so that both projections preserve relations. Any compatible cone has a unique underlying map to that pullback. Since both legs preserve each relation, this map preserves their intersection.

(2) **Finite limits of equivalence frames.** This proves the universal property. A singleton with reflexive relations is terminal; products and equalizers follow. Inverse images and intersections preserve equivalence relations.

(3) **Coherence of epistemic pullbacks.** The remaining statements follow by composition of the underlying functions and the universal property of pullback. The canonical reassociation maps preserve the projected tuples, so their associativity and unit diagrams commute. The same uniqueness gives the coherence of iterated base change.

(4) **Base-change comparison.** The indexed categories of Section 1.2 and Beck–Chevalley comparisons apply to these underlying set pullbacks.

□

A public announcement can delete accessible alternatives, so its update projection is treated as a frame map with the separately stated boundedness criteria. For a forward frame map p one has the comparison

$$|p|^*[R_i]\, Q \;\subseteq\; [T_i]|p|^* Q.$$

The forward frame-map comparison gives an inclusion for each predicate Q: every T_i-successor maps to an R_i-successor. Equality requires lifting abstract successors as well, which is the bounded-morphism condition. The exact equations in Section 9.1.4 make this distinction explicit, in line with the categorical treatment of epistemic updates in (Kishida, 2017).

9.1.3 Epistemic action-model updates as dependent comprehension

Public restriction is the singleton-event case of epistemic product update Baltag, Moss, and Solecki (1998). With several possible events, an agent may distinguish some occurrences but not others, and the events may change ordinary observables. The update therefore retains enabled world–event pairs and constructs their new accessibility from both the old state observations and the observations of the action event.

Definition 9.13 (Semantic epistemic action model)**.** Let W be a state set with relations $R_i \hookrightarrow W^2$ for $i \in N$. An **epistemic action model over** W consists of an action-occurrence set E, relations $S_i \hookrightarrow E^2$, and an enabling subobject $P \hookrightarrow W \times E$. Its fibre at $e \in E$ is $P_e = \{w : P(w, e)\} \hookrightarrow W$. The relations R_i and S_i may be arbitrary qualitative possibility relations. If they are observation kernel pairs, they describe knowledge. An updated observable of type Z is a term $v^+ : \{P\} \to Z$; the unchanged-value case is $v^+ = vp$ for $v : W \to Z$, where $p : \{P\} \to W$ is the projection. A state-transition presentation may instead provide $t : \{P\} \to W'$ and set $v^+ = v't$ for $v' : W' \to Z$.

Construction 9.14 (Epistemic product update)**.**

(1) **Take the enabling comprehension.** Take comprehension and its two projections,

$$j : U = \{P\} \hookrightarrow W \times E, \qquad p : U \to W, \quad q : U \to E.$$

(2) **Construct the updated relations.** Write $R_i \boxtimes S_i$ for the product relation on $W \times E$,

$$(R_i \boxtimes S_i)((w, e), (w', e')) \iff R_i(w, w') \wedge S_i(e, e').$$

Define the updated relation on U by

$$R_i^{\mathcal{E}} = (j \times j)^*(R_i \boxtimes S_i) = (p \times p)^* R_i \wedge (q \times q)^* S_i. \tag{9.9}$$

(3) **Interpret pointed updates.** For each e write $a_e : P_e \hookrightarrow W$ for comprehension and $j_e : P_e \to U$ for $w \mapsto (w, e)$. For a predicate $Q \hookrightarrow U$ define its dynamic box and diamond on W by

$$[\mathcal{E}, e]Q = \forall_{a_e} j_e^* Q, \qquad \langle \mathcal{E}, e \rangle Q = \exists_{a_e} j_e^* Q. \tag{9.10}$$

The action model, its comprehension, and the updated relations are ordinary dependent objects and subobjects in the model of Theorem 1.50. They can equally be constructed in the uncompleted **Set** assertion doctrine.

Epistemic product update is a comprehension of enabled world–event pairs.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \hookrightarrow & W \times E \\ {\scriptstyle p}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_1} \\ W & = & W \end{array}$$

Proposition 9.15 (Action models in an economic state context)**.** *For $s : W \to \Sigma^G$, the canonical state context after the action update is $sp : U \to \Sigma^G$. Its updated relations, action-indexed predicates, and postcondition terms belong to the ordinary dependent fibres above U. For a linear family A over W, its unchanged interface after the action is p^*A; a transition-indexed residual interface instead uses its exhibited post-state map $t : U \to W'$ and the dependent family over W'. These reindexings commute with the ordinary comparison tests under the substitution laws of Theorem 5.37. If the action changes the economic reference profile, the changed profile is the specified post-update term $s^+ : U \to \Sigma^G$; the composite sp denotes the unchanged reference.*

Proof.

(1) **Composition.** The composite sp is an object of $\mathbf{Set}/\Sigma^G$. Every relation and postcondition on U is a subobject or term in $\mathsf{T}(U)$; the linear reindexings are index precomposition. Theorem 5.37 gives the asserted comparison-test equations.

(2) **Policy-level comparison.** A post-update profile is simply a term of the constant profile family on U, which supplies its typed state context without imposing any equality with sp.

□

Theorem 9.16 (Action-model semantics, base change, and public specialization)**.** *For every $Q \hookrightarrow U$ and $w \in W$,*

$$[\mathcal{E}, e]Q(w) \iff P_e(w) \Rightarrow Q(w, e),$$
$$\langle \mathcal{E}, e\rangle Q(w) \iff P_e(w) \wedge Q(w, e).$$

If $E = 1$, $S_i = 1^2$, and $P_e = A \hookrightarrow W$, the updated relation and modalities are respectively $R_i|_A$, $[!a]$, and $\langle !a\rangle$ of Section 9.1.1. For $f : W' \to W$, pull back R_i along $f \times f$ and P along $f \times 1_E$. The resulting updated carrier U' is canonically $W' \times_W U$, its relations are inverse images of $R_i^{\mathcal{E}}$, and the action boxes and diamonds commute with this pullback. These comparisons are coherent under successive substitutions.

Proof.

(1) **Predicate calculation.** The fibre of a_e at w is a singleton if $P_e(w)$ holds and empty otherwise. The quantifier formulas of Theorem 5.22 give the two equivalences. For $E = 1$ comprehension identifies U with A, and Equation (9.9) reduces to the ordinary restriction of R_i.

(2) **Base-change comparison.** The dynamic modalities are exactly the two adjoints along a. The universal property of pullback identifies U' with $W' \times_W U$, while relation substitution and both Beck–Chevalley comparisons give the remaining equations. Repeated substitution identifies the same indexed tuples, proving coherence.

□

Changing the economic state context commutes with epistemic product update.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U' & \longrightarrow & U \\ \downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle p} \\ W' & \xrightarrow[f]{} & W \end{array}$$

Theorem 9.17 (Presentation of every semantic refinement by an action model)**.** *Every object $p : (U, (T_i)) \to M = (W, (R_i))$ of $\mathbf{Fr}_N/M$ is isomorphic over M to a semantic action-model update of M. Conversely, every action-model update has such a projection.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** For the forward direction take the event set to be $E = U$, its uncertainty relations to be $S_i = T_i$, and its enabling subobject to be the graph

$$P = \{(w, u) \in W \times U : w = p(u)\}.$$

The updated carrier is P, with canonical bijection $u \mapsto (p(u), u)$. Under this bijection its i-relation is

$$(p \times p)^* R_i \cap T_i = T_i,$$

because p preserves relations. The first projection becomes p.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, the product-update relation $(\pi_W \times \pi_W)^* R_i \cap (\pi_E \times \pi_E)^* S_i$ is contained in the first factor, so its projection is a frame map.

□

The presentation result is relative to a specified base model; its action-event set need not be finite. For finite W, U, the construction in Construction 9.19 realizes its enabling relation and the map $P \to U$ by finite response protocols. For every accessibility relation T_i, its successor map $b_i : U \to \mathcal{P}(U)$, $b_i(u) = \{v : uT_iv\}$, recovers the relation by $uT_iv \iff v \in b_i(u)$. Equivalently, T_i is the pullback of membership along $(u, v) \mapsto (v, b_i(u))$. When T_i is an observation equivalence, the quotient $U \twoheadrightarrow U/T_i$ recovers T_i as its kernel pair. Indeed two states have the same class precisely when they are T_i-related. Conversely, the kernel pair of any observation map is an equivalence relation. The successor-map presentation applies also to directed and nonreflexive belief relations. The witness data retain the underlying execution, so the same update can be compared with an operational protocol when one is supplied.

Construction 9.18 (Updates with state-dependent edge conditions)**.**

(1) **Combine the two edge tests.** Let $P \subseteq W \times E$ be an enabling carrier and let $G_i \subseteq P \times P$ be specified edge conditions. Put

$$T_i = (\pi_W \times \pi_W)^* R_i \cap G_i.$$

This is another object of $\mathbf{Fr}_N/M$, so Theorem 9.17 gives an action-model presentation.

(2) **Recover ordinary product update.** Ordinary product update is the case $G_i = (\pi_E \times \pi_E)^* S_i$. State-dependent edge conditions provide a semantic counterpart of arrow updates. The syntactic arrow-update literature has its own expressivity and synthesis results (van Ditmarsch et al., 2020); those results are not being inferred from this set-based presentation.

Construction 9.19 (Finite operational realization of action enablement)**.**

(1) **Form the enabling strategy.** For finite W, E and an action-enabling predicate $P \hookrightarrow W \times E$, let $U = \{P\}$, regarded as its finite set of enabled pairs. Define a strategy

$$a_P : D(W) \longrightarrow D(U)$$

with one negative input event n_w for every $w \in W$ and one positive event $o_{w,e}$ for every $(w, e) \in U$. Generate the causal edges $n_w < o_{w,e}$. Different input branches conflict; within a branch the positive events conflict, so at most one enabled pair is emitted.

(2) **Label its events.** Label the negative event by w at the input boundary and the positive event by (w, e) at the output boundary. Thus the completed outputs following an input w are exactly the enabled actions $(w, e) \in U$.

(3) **Realize the updated observations.** For an updated value term $v^+ : U \to Z$, corestrict to its finite image $F = v^+[U]$ and compose a_P with $\widehat{v^+} : D(U) \to D(F)$. If updated S5 observations are supplied, their finite image quotients likewise have the response strategies of Proposition 1.23.

Proposition 9.20 (Sound operational realization of finite action models)**.** *The map a_P is a receptive courteous strategy. Its enabled output relation is precisely P and its composition with any finite-image updated observable returns that observable on each completed updated pair. Hence every finite semantic action-model enabling relation and its specified finite-image postconditions admit explicit concurrent operational realizations, while the action uncertainty*

relations S_i remain ordinary epistemic data until observation protocols are specified. Countable action presentations admit the same carrier-based construction; uncountable **Set***-based action models belong to the ordinary dependent semantics and are not claimed to be single countable operational arenas.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** The source has finite principal pasts. Its consistency relation is hereditary and closed under adjoining causes, so it is an event structure. Every source configuration maps injectively to a configuration of $D(W)^{\perp} \parallel D(U)$.

(2) **Fibrewise calculation.** At the empty source configuration every negative input w has exactly the lift n_w; after one input all other negative inputs conflict in the arena. All new immediate causal edges are negative-to-positive. Thus the map is receptive and courteous.

(3) **Causal execution.** Every source configuration containing an output has n_w and precisely one event $o_{w,e}$, with $P(w,e)$; conversely, each $(w,e) \in P$ exhibits such a configuration. If no action is enabled at w, the maximal source configuration $\{n_w\}$ has no positive output.

(4) **Composition.** Composing with the response strategy for the corestriction of v^+ gives the value $v^+(w,e)$ by Equation (1.3) and composition of finite response strategies. The same proof uses countably many branches and outputs when the carriers are countable; every individual causal past remains finite.

□

Proposition 9.21 (Knowledge reduction for epistemic actions)**.** *Put $K_i = [R_i]$ on W and $K_i^{\mathcal{E}} = [R_i^{\mathcal{E}}]$ on U. For every $Q \hookrightarrow U$,*

$$[\mathcal{E}, e]K_i^{\mathcal{E}} Q = P_e \Rightarrow \bigwedge_{f\colon S_i(e,f)} K_i([\mathcal{E}, f]Q). \tag{9.11}$$

The empty meet is $\top$. Ordinary conjunction and unchanged atomic predicates have the reductions

$$[\mathcal{E}, e](Q \wedge Q') = [\mathcal{E}, e]Q \wedge [\mathcal{E}, e]Q',$$
$$[\mathcal{E}, e]p^*V = P_e \Rightarrow V.$$

The same predicate doctrine interprets belief modalities for arbitrary R_i, without asserting factivity.

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At a state $w \in P_e$, the left side requires $Q(w', f)$ for every $(w', f) \in U$ satisfying wR_iw' and eS_if. Reordering the quantifiers yields

$$\forall f\ (eS_if \Rightarrow \forall w'\ (wR_iw' \Rightarrow (P_f(w') \Rightarrow Q(w', f)))).$$

The inner assertion is $K_i([\mathcal{E}, f]Q)(w)$. At states outside P_e both sides are true. Preservation of meets by the right adjoint and $a_e^*p^*V = a_e^*V$ prove the other equations.

□

Proposition 9.22 (Observation quotients after action update)**.** *If $R_i = \ker(o_i)$ and $S_i = \ker(b_i)$ for maps $o_i : W \to O_i$ and $b_i : E \to L_i$, then*

$$R_i^{\mathcal{E}} = \ker\big(\langle o_i p, b_i q\rangle : U \to O_i \times L_i\big).$$

Its image factorization is the effective updated observation quotient. In particular S5 knowledge, the invariant-predicate adjunctions, and the common-knowledge quotient construction remain available after the update, including when U is empty.

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** Two updated pairs have the same displayed observation exactly when their old observations and action observations agree. This is the conjunction of their two kernel-pair relations, which is Equation (9.9). Image factorization and Corollary 6.6 give the effective quotient.

(2) **Observation and knowledge.** Equivalence relations and their generated common-knowledge relation restrict to the new carrier as constructed, with the empty case interpreted in the ordinary predicate doctrine.

□

Example 9.23 (Private epistemic information cannot be reduced to announcement)**.** Let $W = \{w_0, w_1\}$, let two owners initially have the indiscrete observation equivalence, and take $E = \{e_0, e_1\}$ with $P_{e_k} = \{w_k\}$. Give owner 1 the diagonal action relation and owner 2 the indiscrete action relation. Then $U = \{(w_0, e_0), (w_1, e_1)\}$. Owner 1's updated relation is equality, while owner 2's still relates both points. Neither original state is removed. Hence this is a genuine private-information update, not the public restriction of a subset of W.

Construction 9.24 (Sequential semantic action update)**.**

(1) **Specify the two stages.** Let $\mathcal{E} = (E, (S_i), P)$ update a relation model on W to $U = \{P\}$. Let $\mathcal{F} = (F, (T_i), Q)$ be an action model over U, with $Q \hookrightarrow U \times F$.

(2) **Construct the composite update.** Define the composite $\mathcal{E} \diamond \mathcal{F}$ over W with action set $E \times F$, action relations $S_i \boxtimes T_i$, and enabling predicate

$$P \diamond Q\,(w, e, f) \iff P(w, e) \wedge Q((w, e), f). \tag{9.12}$$

The expression involving Q is evaluated only in the fibre where $P(w, e)$ holds, equivalently by the image under comprehension of the second enabling object. Updated value terms on the two-stage carrier are transported by the same canonical reassociation.

Theorem 9.25 (Coherent composition of epistemic actions)**.** *There is a canonical isomorphism of relation models and their retained updated ordinary terms*

$$(W \odot \mathcal{E}) \odot \mathcal{F} \cong W \odot (\mathcal{E} \diamond \mathcal{F}), \qquad ((w, e), f) \longmapsto (w, (e, f)). \tag{9.13}$$

It satisfies associativity and the singleton everywhere-enabled unit laws, including coherent substitution in the reference state. The corresponding dynamic modalities satisfy

$$[\mathcal{E}, e][\mathcal{F}, f]Q = [\mathcal{E} \diamond \mathcal{F}, (e, f)]Q$$

under the indicated identification of final predicates.

Proof.

(1) **Predicate calculation.** The two carriers are defined by the identical conjunction of the two enablement tests after reassociation. The two-stage relation between $((w, e), f)$ and $((w', e'), f')$ is

$$R_i(w, w') \wedge S_i(e, e') \wedge T_i(f, f'),$$

which is the relation of the combined action model. Updated terms are the same functions on these identified points.

(2) **Adjunction and transposition.** Reassociation of triples and quadruples obeys Cartesian coherence, including the unit comparison. For the dynamic box, two successive right adjoints along the inclusions of the action components agree with the right adjoint along their composite by uniqueness of right adjoints; the elementwise precondition is Equation (9.12).

□

Two consecutive epistemic action updates associate by matching the intermediate state.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (W \odot \mathcal{E}) \odot \mathcal{F} & \xrightarrow{\cong} & W \odot (\mathcal{E} \diamond \mathcal{F}) \\ {\scriptstyle p_1}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle p} \\ W \odot \mathcal{E} & \xrightarrow[p]{} & W \end{array}$$

Remark 9.26 (Scope of epistemic action models). The construction is fully semantic: P, R_i, S_i, and updated observable terms are ordinary typed data. Syntactic precondition or postcondition languages are not required. The update changes the state carrier as well as both endpoints of each accessibility relation; it is not the reference pullback of Proposition 5.40. A state map that forgets accessible alternatives need not preserve knowledge formulas merely because it preserves the underlying updated carrier. The bounded morphism and alternative-lifting results of Section 9.1.4 address that distinction.

Corollary 9.27 (Action models transport across bounded state quotients)**.** *Let $f : X \twoheadrightarrow Y$ be a surjective bounded morphism from relations R_i to $\bar{R}_i$. Give Y an epistemic action model with action set E, action relations S_i, and enabling subobject $\bar{P} \hookrightarrow Y \times E$. Pull it back along $f \times 1_E$ to form the action model over X. The induced map on updated carriers*

$$f^+ : X \odot \mathcal{E} \longrightarrow Y \odot \bar{\mathcal{E}}, \qquad (x, e) \longmapsto (f(x), e)$$

is a surjective bounded morphism for the updated relations. For every $e \in E$ and $\bar{Q} \hookrightarrow Y \odot \bar{\mathcal{E}}$,

$$f^*[\bar{\mathcal{E}}, e]\bar{Q} = [\mathcal{E}, e](f^+)^*\bar{Q},$$
$$f^*\langle\bar{\mathcal{E}}, e\rangle\bar{Q} = \langle\mathcal{E}, e\rangle(f^+)^*\bar{Q}.$$

Hence it preserves and reflects every modal fixed-point assertion with atomic tests descended through f^+, including updated knowledge assertions and their dynamic action tests.

Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** For an enabled (y, e), surjectivity of f supplies x with $f(x) = y$; the pullback enabling predicate makes (x, e) enabled. Thus f^+ is surjective. Forward preservation of accessibility is inherited from f, with the unchanged action relation S_i.

(2) **Construction of the comparison.** Given a reduced updated alternative (y', e') accessible from $(f(x), e)$, the back clause of f supplies x' with xR_ix' and $f(x') = y'$. Since $\bar{P}(y', e')$, its pullback $P(x', e')$ holds. Thus (x', e') is the required updated alternative.

(3) **Base-change comparison.** The action-component comprehensions of the two models form pullback squares along f; both Beck–Chevalley identities of Theorem 5.22 give the dynamic box and diamond equations. Apply Theorem 9.30 to f^+.

□

9.1.4 Lifting alternatives and preserving fixed points

Modal predicates inspect alternatives from a particular state. A map that preserves actual states and forward accessibility can still lose some of those alternatives. Exact transport requires every abstract successor to lift from each concrete state representing its source. We call this a source-fixed lift. Together with preservation in the forward direction, it gives the bounded-morphism comparison used below. The adjoint fixed-point argument then extends the comparison from individual modalities to their least and greatest fixed predicates.

Definition 9.28 (Bounded morphism)**.** A map $q : X \to Y$ between families of relation frames is **bounded** if, for every relation index a,

$$xR_a x' \Longrightarrow q(x)\bar{R}_a q(x'),$$

and every $q(x)\bar{R}_a y'$ has a lift $xR_a x'$ with $q(x') = y'$. For interpreted atomic predicates require $P_X = q^* P_Y$. The second clause is equivalently fibrewise coverage by the canonical comparison to the cartesian lift,

$$R_a \longrightarrow X \times_{Y,\bar{p}_1} \bar{R}_a, \qquad (x, x') \longmapsto (x, (q(x), q(x'))).$$

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} R_a & \twoheadrightarrow & X \times_Y \bar{R}_a & \longrightarrow & \bar{R}_a \\ & \searrow^{p_1} & \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \bar{p}_1} \\ & & X & \xrightarrow[q]{} & Y \end{array}$$

Lemma 9.29 (Source-fixed lifting along a regular epimorphism)**.** *In the set model or its constructed sheaf topos, let $q : K \twoheadrightarrow T$ be a regular epimorphism and $R \hookrightarrow T \times T$. Put $R_K = (q \times q)^* R$. The source-fixed comparison*

$$\lambda : R_K \longrightarrow K \times_{T,p_1} R$$

is a regular epimorphism. For every subobject $P \hookrightarrow T$,

$$[R_K]q^*P = q^*[R]P, \qquad \langle R_K\rangle q^*P = q^*\langle R\rangle P.$$

Proof.

(1) **Construct the lift as a pullback.** There is a canonical identification

$$R_K \cong (K \times_{T,p_1} R) \times_{T,p_2} K.$$

Under it λ is the base change of q along the target map p_2. Pullback stability gives regular epicity while retaining the given source.

(2) **Transport both quantifiers.** Factor the source projection through λ. For a regular epimorphism e, inverse image reflects subobject order, and the two adjunctions give $\exists_e e^* Q = Q = \forall_e e^* Q$. Apply these identities to λ and Beck–Chevalley to the source pullback. This gives the diamond and box equations, respectively (Mac Lane and Moerdijk, 1992, Chapters IV–V).

□

Theorem 9.30 (Modal fixed-point adequacy)**.** *Let $q : X \to Y$ be a bounded morphism. Interpret every free predicate variable by a valuation ρ on Y and by its componentwise pullback $q^*\rho$ on X; interpret each designated atomic predicate on X as the pullback of its*

interpretation on Y. Then every formula of the positive modal fixed-point language satisfies the naturality equation

$$[\![\varphi]\!]_X(q^*\rho) = q^*[\![\varphi]\!]_Y(\rho).$$

This includes nested least and greatest fixed points. Validity is preserved; if q is surjective it is also reflected.

Forward preservation of accessibility is a commuting square on relation witnesses.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} R_i & \xrightarrow{f\times f} & S_i \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ X \times X & \xrightarrow[f\times f]{} & Y \times Y \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Compare the logical and modal operations.** Induct on the formal presentation of Definition A.5, using the target valuation and its componentwise pullback. Atoms and variables commute by definition; the fibrewise logical operations commute by Theorem 5.22. Forward preservation and the source-fixed back lifts give

$$[R_a]q^* = q^*[\bar{R}_a], \qquad \langle R_a\rangle q^* = q^*\langle \bar{R}_a\rangle.$$

Indeed every concrete successor has the stated image, and every target successor has a concrete lift at the same source, for both quantifiers.

(2) **Transport the universal fixed points.** At a binder, the induction applies to every target candidate U and its pullback q^*U, giving $F_X q^* = q^* F_Y$. Apply Lemma 5.25 to $\exists_q \dashv q^* \dashv \forall_q$. The same induction handles nested binders while retaining the pulled-back free-variable valuation.

(3) **Reflect validity.** Inverse image preserves the top predicate, and a surjective q reflects it.

□

9.1.5 Local retained witnesses and exact modal transport

A secured history can retain events that are not visible at the chosen observation boundary. Localizing that history and forgetting evidence are different operations: an internal epistemic test after restricting away a receipt can be more demanding than the completed-state test. We therefore localize on patches that keep the specified observed receptions and institutional certificate occurrences. This uses the actual delivered-record extraction of Construction 10.46, not a new event observation stipulated independently of the protocol. The distinction is related to the sheaf treatment of epistemic update in Kishida (2013).

Construction 9.31 (Observation anchor and retained-state image)**.**

(1) **Construct the least observation anchor.** Work in the policy-indexed secured-witness family $\mathscr{K}_X$ of Construction 8.3 over E. Let $H \subseteq |E|$ be the union of the exhibited matched recipient occurrences, issuer and certificate occurrences, and, for a completed boundary, the public final-report occurrences. These are read from the specified protocol wires. For $U \subseteq |E|$ define the monotone operation

$$\Phi_H(U) = H \cup \downarrow_E U \cup \bigcup_{x\in X} f_x[\downarrow_{S_x} f_x^{-1}(U)] \cup \bigcup_{x\in X} g_x[\downarrow_{T_x} g_x^{-1}(U)].$$

Put $U_0 = \varnothing$, $U_{n+1} = \Phi_H(U_n)$ and

$$A = \bigcup_{n<\omega} U_n.$$

Inverse images, direct images and down-closure commute with unions of increasing chains; hence $\Phi_H(A) = A$. This fixed-point equation is precisely simultaneous saturation and inclusion of H. Every saturated patch containing H contains each U_n by induction, so contains A. Therefore A is the least such patch; for the finite protocol the iteration stabilizes in finitely many steps. Equivalently, this closure is left adjoint to the inclusion of saturated patches in $\mathcal{P}(|E|)$.

(2) **Form the anchored site.** Put

$$\mathcal{O}_A = \{U \in \mathcal{O}_X : A \subseteq U\}$$

with the covering families inherited from $\mathcal{O}_X$; every intersection of two anchored patches still contains A. Write $\mathscr{K}_A$ for the restricted sheaf. The state at a patch U retains the entire matching graph over U, and its restriction to A is independent of the choice of anchored patch.

(3) **Read exactly the retained data.** Let $\mathrm{rec}_{i,A}$ extract from the matched causal history on A the received labelled subhistory specified by the finite communication protocol. It keeps the distinguished recipient occurrences and the delivered values, not merely the set of interface labels. Retain also the actual public final-output subhistory $\mathrm{rec}_{0,A}$; when there is no public output its record carrier is 1. Let cert_A retain the specified issuer-produced certificate occurrences and their matched provenance. Form the tuple

$$d_A : \mathscr{K}_X(A) \longrightarrow D, \qquad d_A(x,\varphi) = \big(x, \mathrm{rec}_{0,A}(x,\varphi), (\mathrm{rec}_{i,A}(x,\varphi))_i, \mathrm{cert}_A(x,\varphi)\big),$$

where the codomain is formed in the existing ordinary slice over X. Explicitly, let $V_{0,x}, V_{i,x}, C_x$ be the images of the indicated public, recipient, and issuer-port restriction functions on the finite labelled histories over x (use 1 for an absent port). These restriction functions read the designated event occurrences, their labels and induced secured causal orders, together with any displayed local register projected from x. Their images are sets, constructed by the ordinary image factorization. Put

$$D = D_X = \coprod_{x\in X} \big(V_{0,x} \times \prod_i V_{i,x} \times C_x\big).$$

The displayed x in $d_A(x,\varphi)$ denotes the coproduct tag. For the finite implementation the image inclusions into the already constructed global record carriers identify this readout with the public and recipient maps $d_0, d_i : \Xi \to V_0, V_i$ of Construction 10.46, by the explicit comparison in Proposition 10.50. Thus no extra observation map or uniformity axiom is introduced.

(4) **Construct the image quotient.** Put $T = \mathrm{im}(d_A)$ and define

$$q_U : \mathscr{K}_A(U) \longrightarrow T, \qquad q_U(k) = d_A(k|_A), \tag{9.14}$$

using the corestriction of d_A to its image. These functions commute with restriction and hence determine $q : \mathscr{K}_A \to \underline{T}$.

Lemma 9.32 (Local extension and objectwise surjectivity)**.** *For every anchored patch U, a local matching (x,φ) can be regarded as the same secured matching on the full interface; this gives a map $j_U : \mathscr{K}_A(U) \to \mathscr{K}_A(E)$ with $\mathrm{res}_{E,U}\, j_U = \mathrm{id}$. The retained quotient $q_U : \mathscr{K}_A(U) \twoheadrightarrow T$ is surjective for every U. Thus q is a regular epimorphism of sheaves.*

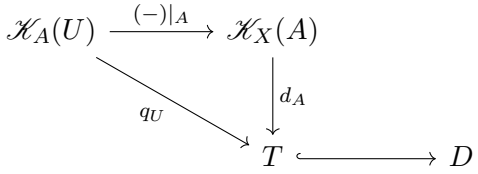
Proof.

(1) **Extend the matching graph.** Since U is saturated, configurations of the restricted source structures are also global configurations, and their matched graph has the same secured causal order. Regard the graph as a global matching without inserting any new event. Restriction returns the original graph.

(2) **Lift every retained record.** Every $t \in T$ has a preimage $k_A \in \mathscr{K}_X(A)$ by definition of the image. Extend k_A to the full interface with j_A and restrict that global matching to U. Its restriction back to A equals k_A, so its image under q_U is t. This constructs a lift at every patch. A sectionwise surjective sheaf morphism is an epimorphism, and every epimorphism in a Grothendieck topos is regular.

□

The retained quotient is read from an anchored causal history, not from an arbitrary hidden scalar.



Construction 9.33 (Lifted epistemic and strategic relations)**.**

(1) **Distinguish receipts from updated knowledge.** The record quotient T has a constructed recipient-record projection $r_i : T \to V_i$, and $\ker(r_i)$ tests equality of delivered receipts. It is not, in general, the owner's updated epistemic relation: the latter also retains the original world observation. For completed situated protocols, the canonical surjection $v_W : T_W \twoheadrightarrow U_W$ and the observation $\beta_i = o_i^+ v_W$ are constructed in Theorem 10.56. The updated relation on T_W is $R_i^{T_W} = \ker(\beta_i)$; distributed knowledge uses $\bigcap_{i \in C} R_i^{T_W}$ and common knowledge the reflexive transitive closure of their union. Their definitions are thus pulled back from actual delivered action events.

(2) **Retain owner-coordinate deviations.** The first component of T includes x and its complete policy $p(x)$. After selecting a situated reference-world projection $w : T \to W$ (or pulling back the finite-input carrier along the given state map), for a coalition C put

$$t D_C^T t' \iff w(t) = w(t') \ \wedge \ p_{-C}(t) = p_{-C}(t').$$

On a legal (or completed legal) retained subcarrier replace this relation by its restriction to that carrier. This relation lies above the original owner-coordinate deviation span. Its different execution records are alternative *witnesses*, not additional choices controlled by the owner; improving comparisons on those records require the manuscript's explicit witness quantifiers or descent to policy values.

(3) **Pull back the relation.** For any such relation $R \hookrightarrow T \times T$, define the relation sheaf

$$\mathscr{R} = (q \times q)^* \underline{R} \rightrightarrows \mathscr{K}_A.$$

Its source and target are the projections of the kernel-style pullback, not event-structure polarities.

Theorem 9.34 (Sourcewise lifting and exact modal descent)**.** *For every retained relation $R \hookrightarrow T^2$ constructed in Construction 9.33, including the world-indexed relations of Theorem 10.56, the comparison over $\mathscr{K}_A$*

$$\lambda_R : \mathscr{R} \longrightarrow \mathscr{K}_A \times_{\underline{T},p_1} \underline{R}, \quad (k,k') \longmapsto (k,(qk,qk')) \tag{9.15}$$

is a regular epimorphism. For every predicate $P \hookrightarrow T$,

$$q^*[R]P = [\mathscr{R}]q^*P, \qquad q^*\langle R\rangle P = \langle\mathscr{R}\rangle q^*P. \tag{9.16}$$

The same equalities hold for distributed knowledge and common knowledge formed from the indicated relations, with the common-knowledge operator interpreted by its finite-path accessibility relation.

Proof.

(1) **Identify the constructed quotient and relation.** Lemma 9.32 constructs the regular epimorphism q, and Construction 9.33 defines $\mathscr{R} = (q\times q)^*\underline{R}$. Thus Lemma 9.29 proves (9.15) and both equations in (9.16).

(2) **Preserve collective alternatives.** Apply the same lemma to the intersection defining distributed knowledge. For common knowledge, each finite retained path lifts successively at its given source, and every witness path projects to a retained path. The sectionwise surjectivity already constructed supplies these finite lifts on each anchored patch. Quantification over these alternatives gives the common-knowledge equation.

□

Lemma 9.35 (Ordinary-predicate adjoints for the retained quotient)**.** *For the retained-record quotient $q : \mathscr{K}_A \twoheadrightarrow \underline{T}$, define*

$$H : \mathcal{P}(T) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Sub}(\mathscr{K}_A), \qquad H(P)(U) = \{k \in \mathscr{K}_A(U) : q_U(k) \in P\}.$$

For $B \hookrightarrow \mathscr{K}_A$, put

$$\begin{aligned} H_!(B) &= \bigcup_{U\in\mathcal{O}_A} q_U[B(U)], \\ H_*(B) &= \{t \in T : \forall U \in \mathcal{O}_A\ \forall k \in \mathscr{K}_A(U),\ q_U(k) = t \Rightarrow k \in B(U)\}. \end{aligned} \tag{9.17}$$

Then $H_! \dashv H \dashv H_*$. The map H preserves all meets, all joins and complements of ordinary predicates, and reflects order.

Proof.

(1) **Construct the ordinary-predicate comparison.** Constant presheaves on the retained site are sheaves. Thus $H(P)$ is the pullback of $\underline{P} \hookrightarrow \underline{T}$ along q, and is a subobject of $\mathscr{K}_A$. The patch category is small, so the displayed union and universal quantification define ordinary subsets of T.

(2) **Verify both adjunctions.** For $P \subseteq T$,

$$H_!(B) \subseteq P \iff \forall U\ B(U) \subseteq q_U^{-1}(P) \iff B \le H(P),$$

and

$$P \subseteq H_*(B) \iff \forall U\ q_U^{-1}(P) \subseteq B(U) \iff H(P) \le B.$$

These prove $H_! \dashv H \dashv H_*$, so H preserves all meets and joins in the indicated lattices.

(3) **Preserve complements and reflect order.** The subobjects $H(P)$ and $H(T \setminus P)$ have empty intersection and union $\mathscr{K}_A$, so they are complementary. If $H(P) \leq H(Q)$ and $t \in P$, the sectionwise surjectivity constructed in Lemma 9.32 supplies a lift of t at a patch. That lift lies in $H(Q)$, hence $t \in Q$.

□

The internal adjoints along q have codomain $\mathrm{Sub}(\underline{T})$ (Mac Lane and Moerdijk, 1992, Chapters IV–V). The displayed $H_!, H_*$ instead have codomain $\mathcal{P}(T)$, which is the ordinary predicate lattice used by the retained modal model.

Corollary 9.36 (Retained fixed-point modal transport)**.** *For the same regular epimorphism q and its pulled-back designated relations, interpret each atomic predicate and each free predicate variable on $\mathscr{K}_A$ by pullback from T. Every formula of the positive Boolean modal fixed-point language, including nested least and greatest fixed points, satisfies*

$$[\![\varphi]\!]_{\mathscr{K}_A}(q^*\rho) = q^*[\![\varphi]\!]_T(\rho).$$

Since q^* is order-reflecting, the corresponding retained-image validity predicates are also reflected.

Proof.

(1) **Compare ordinary and sheaf predicates.** Use $H : \mathcal{P}(T) \to \mathrm{Sub}(\mathscr{K}_A)$ from Lemma 9.35. It preserves Boolean operations and supplies $H_! \dashv H \dashv H_*$ with the required ordinary-predicate codomain. Atoms and free variables are transported by H.

(2) **Compare modal operators.** The source-fixed regular epimorphism of Theorem 9.34 gives the box and diamond equations for the designated pulled-back relation sheaves, including tests after further causal restriction.

(3) **Transport binders and reflect validity.** Induction on a positive body gives $\widehat{F}H = HF$. Apply Lemma 5.25 at every binder. Order reflection in Lemma 9.35 then reflects validity.

□

The fixed-point comparison uses the ordinary powerset on the retained side and the full subobject lattice on the witness side.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{P}(T) & \xrightarrow{H} & \mathrm{Sub}(\mathscr{K}_A) \\ {\scriptstyle F}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \widehat{F}} \\ \mathcal{P}(T) & \xrightarrow[H]{} & \mathrm{Sub}(\mathscr{K}_A) \end{array}$$

The source-fixed witness comparison is a cartesian base change of the retained-record quotient.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathscr{R} & \xrightarrow{\lambda_R} & \mathscr{K}_A \times_{\underline{T},p_1} \underline{R} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle p_2} \\ \mathscr{K}_A & \xrightarrow[q]{} & \underline{T} \end{array}$$

Example 9.37 (Forgetting a receipt changes sheaf-internal knowledge)**.** Take two reference worlds w_0, w_1, indistinguishable before an exchange. At w_0 one positive receipt event e can occur; at w_1 there is no such event. At the completed witness $(w_0, \{e\})$ the observed receipt distinguishes w_0, so the completed-state test $K_i(w = w_0)$ holds. On the unanchored empty causal patch both witnesses restrict to empty matching graphs and have the same received event record. The sheaf-internal universal test considers this restriction and therefore does not establish $K_i(w = w_0)$. Anchoring at e eliminates precisely the restriction that erases the needed evidence. This demonstrates why the theorem concerns actual retained observations, not unrestricted sheaf-internal knowledge on all causal patches.

Remark 9.38 (Exact scope of the modal comparison)*.* The predicates in (9.16) are pulled back from the retained carrier T. An arbitrary predicate on hidden matching witnesses need not descend. If the chosen anchor saturates to all of E, its site has no proper patches: the theorem remains true but makes no nontrivial new localization claim at that completed boundary. Before hiding, the original secured-matching sheaf still supplies its independent local-to-global reconstruction. For visible temporal transitions after hiding, exactness continues to be governed by the source-fixed successor-lifting comparisons of Section 12.2.6.

9.2 Public announcement in the agent calculus

9.2.1 Restricting a situated model

Let M be a situated model on W, and let φ be an assertion interpreted in M. Form its comprehension

$$j : U = \{w \in W \mid M, w \models \varphi\} \hookrightarrow W.$$

The updated model $M|\varphi$ is carried by U. Its valuations and linear families are restricted, and observations become $o_i j$, corestricted to their images when appropriate. Accessibility is $R_i^U = (j \times j)^* R_i$, so excluded worlds disappear from both positions of the relation. Strong monoidality of linear restriction preserves agent types and their composition; only the available epistemic context changes.

The dynamic type operation is Π_j^ℓ. At a state removed by the announcement it is the empty additive product $\top$; at a retained state it is the post-update fibre. The tensor unit I cannot be substituted for $\top$: these are different limits and resource interpretations.

Theorem 9.39 (Perspective after announcement)**.** *For a linear family A over U, there is a natural isomorphism*

$$K_{oj}^\ell A \cong j^* K_o^\ell \Pi_j^\ell A.$$

It is coherent with successive public restrictions and the monoidal perspective comparisons.

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** Right adjoints compose: $\Pi_{oj}^\ell \cong \Pi_o^\ell \Pi_j^\ell$. Also $(oj)^* = j^* o^*$. Their composite gives the displayed isomorphism.

(2) **Fibrewise calculation.** At $u \in U$, the right side takes a product over all old alternatives, with terminal factors for alternatives outside U. Its nonterminal factors are exactly A_v for $v \in U$ with $o(v) = o(u)$. Product projections prove the comparison and its coherence. Tensor comparisons on either side are obtained by tensoring these same remaining projections.

□

9.2.2 Dynamic formulas and reduction

The interpretation of a public-announcement formula is

$$[\![[!\varphi]\psi]\!]_M = \forall_j [\![\psi]\!]_{M|\varphi}. \tag{9.18}$$

The formula ψ is always interpreted in the updated model, using its restricted accessibility relations. This rule continues to apply when the postcondition contains knowledge, another announcement, or a common-knowledge fixed point. Otherwise the reduction would silently evaluate an epistemic operator against the old alternatives.

Theorem 9.40 (Public-announcement reduction laws)**.** *For an atom p whose valuation is restricted by the update,*

$$\begin{aligned}
[!\varphi]p &\leftrightarrow (\varphi \Rightarrow p),\\
[!\varphi](\psi \wedge \chi) &\leftrightarrow [!\varphi]\psi \wedge [!\varphi]\chi,\\
[!\varphi]\neg\psi &\leftrightarrow (\varphi \Rightarrow \neg[!\varphi]\psi),\\
[!\varphi]K_i\psi &\leftrightarrow (\varphi \Rightarrow K_i([!\varphi]\psi)),\\
[!\varphi][!\psi]\chi &\leftrightarrow [!(\varphi \wedge [!\varphi]\psi)]\chi.
\end{aligned}$$

Proof.

(1) **Apply the comprehension reductions.** The atomic, Boolean, and knowledge equations are Theorem 9.6, with the postformula interpreted in the updated model as in (9.18).

(2) **Compose the inclusions.** The second announcement comprehension inside U composes with j to the comprehension of $\varphi \wedge [!\varphi]\psi$ in W. Composition of their right adjoints gives the last equation, including the re-evaluation of epistemic postformulas.

□

The reduction equations follow from comprehension and the right-adjoint interpretation of announcement; compare Plaza (2007); Baltag, Moss, and Solecki (1998). They express the logical operation independently of a physical test or message that might implement it.

Example 9.41 (Re-evaluating an epistemic announcement)**.** Take two indistinguishable worlds, with p true at just one. At that world $p \wedge \neg K_i p$ is true, so its announcement is enabled. Afterward only the p-world remains and $K_i p$ holds. Thus the announced epistemic formula itself becomes false. The update recomputes epistemic formulas in the restricted model; the example shows the possible failure of $[!\varphi]\varphi$.

9.2.3 The effect on policies and resources

Public restriction can change which observation-based policies are uniformly legal. For $F \subseteq W \times M$, restricting to U removes some worlds from surviving observation fibres. With $O_U = \mathrm{im}(oj)$ and $r : O_U \hookrightarrow O$, every former legal policy restricts to one over the new quotient, giving the map below.

$$\mathsf{Pol}_o(F) \longrightarrow \mathsf{Pol}_{oj}((j \times 1)^* F), \qquad \pi \longmapsto \pi r.$$

The restriction map need not be injective: policies distinguished only by observations absent from U become indistinguishable. New uniformly legal actions may also appear after a counterexample world is removed. By contrast, linear execution resources are merely reindexed; a public update does not create a resource or authorization token.

So far the update is logical. To regard it as a physical public announcement, an enabled test or message must have execution witnesses whose successful image is exactly U. The finite communication protocols in the next part provide such realizations and make it possible to compare the epistemic update with the complete policies that produced it.

Proposition 9.42 (Observation-based implementability of a public test)**.** *Let $o : W \twoheadrightarrow O$ be an effective observation and $P \subseteq W$. The following are equivalent:*
(i) P is the inverse image $o^{-1}(B)$ of a predicate $B \subseteq O$;
(ii) P is constant on the kernel pair of o;
(iii) its characteristic function factors as $1_P = \chi o$ for $\chi : O \to 2$.
For finite O, these equivalent descriptions give a receptive courteous protocol accepting the observed input and emitting a success event precisely at worlds in P. Its successful-execution witness image is the comprehension $P \hookrightarrow W$.

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** The first and third descriptions are equivalent by taking the characteristic predicate. Either makes P constant on the kernel pair.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely kernel-pair constancy lets 1_P descend uniquely along the effective quotient o, producing χ and $B = \chi^{-1}(\{1\})$. For finite O, realize χ by $\widehat{\chi} : D(O) \to D(2)$. Connect it to the gate $D(2) \to D(1)$ whose source accepts both negative bit inputs but emits its sole positive success output only following input 1.

(3) **Lifting through the comparison.** It is receptive because both inputs lift uniquely, and courteous because its only added dependency is negative-to-positive. The composite emits success exactly when $\chi(o(w)) = 1$; the image of successful witnesses is therefore P. The absent success event is not reinterpreted as a false operational scalar.

(4) **Observation and knowledge.** A test of a predicate not constant on the available observation fibre requires a different actually delivered signal, not an implicit truth oracle.

□

9.3 General epistemic action models and delivery

9.3.1 General action models

Let an action presentation have event set E, event relations S_i, and an enabling predicate $\mathsf{pre} \subseteq W \times E$. Its updated carrier and relations are

$$U = \{(w, e) : \mathsf{pre}(w, e)\}, \tag{9.19}$$

$$(w, e)R_i^+(v, f) \iff wR_iv \ \wedge \ eS_if. \tag{9.20}$$

The updated relation is the standard dynamic-epistemic product update (Baltag, Moss, and Solecki, 1998). In the observation-generated case, $R_i = \ker(o_i)$ and $S_i = \ker(b_i)$, so the effective updated signal is the image of $(w, e) \mapsto (o_i(w), b_i(e))$. This construction uses the information actually delivered by the event.

The projection $r : U \to W$ forgets the event, and r^* transports linear families and agent types across that change of state. An implemented event also retains a witness family and concurrent realizer, as in Section 8.4. Neither an abstract event relation nor a semantic update alone supplies an operational communication wire.

For an event e, let $j_e : W_e \hookrightarrow W$ be its enabling inclusion, and $k_e : W_e \to U$ send w to (w, e). Define

$$[\mathcal{A}, e]\psi = \forall_{j_e} k_e^* [\![\psi]\!]_{M \otimes \mathcal{A}}.$$

Its type-level version is $\Pi^{\ell}_{j_e} k_e^*$.

Proposition 9.43 (Action reduction and composition)**.** *For a finite event presentation,*

$$[\mathcal{A}, e]K_i\psi \leftrightarrow \mathsf{pre}_e \Rightarrow \bigwedge_{f : eS_i f} K_i([\mathcal{A}, f]\psi).$$

Successive action updates compose by retaining pairs of enabled events, and this composition is associative up to the canonical tuple bijection.

Proof.

(1) **Apply action reduction.** Substitute $Q = [\![\psi]\!]_{M \otimes \mathcal{A}}$ in Proposition 9.21.

(2) **Compose the enabled witnesses.** Theorem 9.25 identifies the sequential carrier with the enabled triples (w, e, f) and its relations with the conjunction of the three relation tests. Its tuple reassociations preserve reindexing and, for implemented actions, the composite concurrent realizer.

□

Proposition 9.44 (Public restriction as singleton action update)**.** *For a state predicate $P \hookrightarrow W$, let the action carrier be $E = 1$, its sole event have enabling predicate P, and every action relation be equality on 1. Its product update is canonically the comprehension $j : \{P\} \hookrightarrow W$, with relations $R_i^+ = (j \times j)^* R_i$. The pointed action box and diamond are $\forall_j$ and $\exists_j$; in particular the corresponding knowledge-reduction law is*

$$[!P]K_i\psi \iff P \Rightarrow K_i([!P]\psi).$$

Proof.

(1) **Specialize the enabled carrier.** Projection $\{(w, *) : P(w)\} \cong \{P\}$ identifies both relation endpoints and the enabling inclusion. Its quantifier adjoints are therefore $\forall_j, \exists_j$; the reduction is the singleton instance of Proposition 9.43.

□

9.3.2 Institutional and epistemic composition coherence

For three execution spans, both bracketings have witness carrier

$$\{(e, f, g) : t_E(e) = s_F(f),\ t_F(f) = s_G(g)\}.$$

Permission is $P_E(e) \wedge P_F(f) \wedge P_G(g)$, and the concurrent realizer is $\rho_G(g)\rho_F(f)\rho_E(e)$. Reassociating the witnesses preserves these fields. The epistemic comparison replaces record matching by enabled event matching and uses the same dependent-sum and -product coherence. Thus repeated updates do not require a new composition law. The extraction of action events from execution witnesses is completed after the finite causal protocol and session adequacy results of Section 10; see Construction 10.46.

Part IV
Operational and strategic communication

10 True-Concurrent Communication Between Agents

The epistemic constructions specify the information available after an exchange. We now construct the exchange itself from finite response strategies, data ports, and secured interaction. Its matching events witness delivery, while independent decisions can proceed before a collector has all its inputs. Complete policies retain responses on unvisited branches.

Two comparisons connect this operational construction to agency. The finite causal protocol yields a multiplayer arena whose players are the owners and whose complete strategies are their policies. Finite binary sessions give typed communication at dual endpoints. Their completed witnesses then determine the action events and observations used to compare communication with epistemic update.

10.1 Agents implemented by causal decision protocols

For finite decisions, the operational realization can be built from the response interfaces already constructed. Each node receives its specified predecessor data, applies the controlling owner's response, and supplies its output to later nodes. The following construction wires these local strategies into one concurrent protocol. Its policy parameter retains every local response, including those not used in the realized play.

Definition 10.1 (Decision generators and generated presentations)**.** Use the locally fully faithful nonstrategic embedding $\mathbf{j}_N$ of Equation (3.4). For finite O, A and $i \in N$, define the singly owned decision presentation

$$\mathsf{Dec}_i(O, A) : D(O) \longrightarrow D(A)$$

by

$$\Sigma_i = A^O, \qquad \Sigma_j = 1 \ (j \neq i), \qquad \pi \longmapsto \widehat{\pi}.$$

Let $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$ be the smallest locally full symmetric monoidal sub-bicategory of $\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})$ that contains the image of $\mathbf{j}_N$ and all finite decision presentations, is closed under horizontal composition and tensor, is closed under the cartesian parameter reindexings of Equation (3.3), and contains every presentation invertibly 2-isomorphic to one already generated. Thus a restriction or duplication of policy descriptions remains in the generated class only through an exhibited parameter map; it is not silently absorbed into the word "decision." This gives an explicit meaning to "generated by singly owned decisions and nonstrategic wiring."

Corollary 10.2 (Compact structure of generated decision presentations)**.** *The bicategory* $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$ *has the coherent object duals of Theorem 3.11. Its quotient by invertible* 2*-cells is compact closed. Compact transposition, the closed hom-category equivalences, and the owner-preserving trace restrict to this generated bicategory.*

Proof.

(1) **Locate the compact generators.** The entire image of $\mathbf{j}_N$ belongs to the generated bicategory, so it contains every original arena and its dual, together with their coevaluations, evaluations and symmetry maps.

(2) **Close the bending constructions.** The formulas for transposition, closed transposition and trace use the given presentation once, tensor and sequential composition, and these nonstrategic compact maps. They therefore remain in the generated class. Local fullness retains the snake and coherence 2-isomorphisms. Quotienting gives the compact equations.

□

Definition 10.3 (Finite causal decision protocol)**.** A **finite causal decision protocol** consists of a finite acyclic directed graph of decision nodes V, an ownership map $i : V \to N$, finite nonempty action sets A_v for $v \in V$, a finite set P_0 of external ports with finite value sets $(X_p)_{p\in P_0}$, and specified typed input wires. Each incoming wire e of a node v has source either an external port p (carrier $X_e = X_p$) or an earlier decision node u (carrier $X_e = A_u$); the wires from nodes respect the directed acyclic graph. If I_v is the finite set of incoming wires to v, its input carrier and raw observation map are

$$H_v = \prod_{e\in I_v} X_e, \qquad \widetilde{o}_v : H_v \to Y_v, \qquad H_v \xrightarrow{o_v} O_v \hookrightarrow Y_v, \quad O_v = \mathrm{im}(\widetilde{o}_v).$$

The effective observation quotient o_v determines the node policies $\pi_v : O_v \to A_v$ and the complete owner policy spaces

$$\Sigma_i = \prod_{v:\, i(v)=i} A_v^{O_v}.$$

The protocol also specifies an outcome function on its full institutional record (external data together with all node actions),

$$z : \left(\prod_{p\in P_0} X_p\right) \times \left(\prod_{v\in V} A_v\right) \longrightarrow Z.$$

The value of z can be corestricted to its finite image for the concurrent response protocol. An action at v is $a_v = \pi_v(o_v((x_e)_{e\in I_v}))$. The graph determines which observations are available at each decision; recording an action for an institution does not create an additional observation wire. The generated arena is constructed and its scheduling independence proved below.

A finite causal decision protocol makes the origin of each observation explicit. Nodes respond to the values arriving along their incoming wires; independent nodes remain concurrent. The owned realization assigns a complete contingent function to every decision node, so a policy includes responses at nodes not encountered during a particular execution. The ensuing construction connects these policies to secured event-structure strategies.

Lemma 10.4 (Decision-event path reflection in a finite protocol)**.** *Fix the external inputs and a complete owner-policy profile of a finite causal decision protocol. Form its secured interaction with all wired occurrences still displayed, before hiding the internal channels. In a completed configuration let d_v be the positive action-output occurrence at decision node v. If $u \neq v$ and $d_u < d_v$ in the induced causal order, then the protocol DAG contains a nonempty directed path from u to v. Consequently the chosen action outputs of incomparable nodes are concurrent in this completed interaction. Hiding preserves this path restriction on any distinct decision-output occurrences retained as visible events.*

Proof.

(1) **Local causal generators.** Expand each response and collector in the protocol into its source event structure. On a completed input branch, a response has only its negative-input to positive-output dependency. A collector has exactly its individual input-to-tuple-output dependencies, with no dependency between its distinct inputs. A copying strategy has an input-to-each-output dependency, with no order between copied outputs. Disposal has no output. These descriptions are the explicit constructions of Propositions 1.23, 1.26 and 1.29.

(2) **Paths through secured matching.** In secured synchronization, each matched internal event is identified with its input/output occurrence on the adjoining components. The secured order is the transitive closure of the component orders, and is acyclic by the secured-matching condition. Hence every strict causal comparison in the unhidden completed interaction is witnessed by a finite chain of local generator edges and matched wire occurrences. The other occurrence of a matched channel cannot insert an edge from its output backwards to its input.

(3) **Reflection into the protocol DAG.** Mark each generator edge that crosses from a decision output towards the next decision input by its specified protocol wire. Edges inside copying or collection boxes only progress towards their outputs. Traversing a chain from d_u to d_v, each passage through a decision component other than the starting one must enter that component through one of its specified incoming wires and leave through its response output. Removing the segments within components therefore gives a directed walk from u to v in the protocol DAG, which is a directed path because the graph is acyclic. External inputs are sources and the final institutional collector is a sink, so neither can introduce a return path between decision nodes.

(4) **Incomparability and hiding.** If u and v are incomparable, neither $d_u < d_v$ nor $d_v < d_u$ can hold. Both occurrences belong to the completed configuration and are therefore consistent, so they are concurrent. Hiding restricts the transitive secured order to visible occurrences; a newly visible comparison between retained decision outputs would already be a comparison in the expanded interaction, which has just been excluded.

□

Theorem 10.5 (Coherence and scheduling independence of finite causal decision protocols)**.** *Every finite causal decision protocol determines an open arena in* $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$*. For each external input and policy profile it has a unique completed action assignment satisfying*

$$a_v = \pi_v\big(o_v((a_u)_{u\to v}, \textit{incoming external data})\big).$$

Every evaluation along a linear extension of the causal order yields that assignment. In the concurrent realization, incomparable decision components remain unordered; a linear extension is only a reading of the same symmetric-monoidal diagram.

Independent nodes can each produce an output. The collector can emit the pair only after both outputs have arrived.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D(M_v)\otimes D(M_w) & \xrightarrow{c_{M_v,M_w}} & D(M_v\times M_w) \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \widehat{f}\otimes\widehat{g}} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \widehat{f\times g}} \\ D(N_v)\otimes D(N_w) & \xrightarrow[c_{N_v,N_w}]{} & D(N_v\times N_w) \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Build the owned wiring.** Route each value to its specified recipients with the data comonoid of Proposition 1.26, using disposal for zero recipients. At decision node v insert

$$\bigotimes_{e \in I_v} D(X_e) \xrightarrow{c_v} D(H_v) \xrightarrow{\widehat{o_v}} D(O_v) \xrightarrow{\widehat{\pi_v}} D(A_v),$$

with the nullary collector $c_0 : I \to D(1)$ when I_v is empty. Copy the action to its successor and institutional-record wires; collect the full record and apply the response for the finite image of z. Every box is nonstrategic wiring or a singly owned decision generator. Grouping the latter's parameters by owner gives exactly Σ_i, so the diagram belongs to $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$.

(2) **Solve the policy equations.** Induct on causal height. At a minimal node the incoming values are external; at any later node they have already been determined. Applying o_v and then π_v therefore determines a unique a_v. The same induction proves that every solution, and every evaluation along a linear extension, has these values.

(3) **Compare readings of the diagram.** Causal height gives a layered expression using tensor within layers and composition between layers. Any two linear extensions differ by adjacent swaps of incomparable nodes: move the first node of one extension past its incomparable predecessors in the other, and iterate. Each swap is monoidal interchange. Symmetry and associativity compare the remaining enumerations and bracketings, and coassociativity and cocommutativity compare copying trees. Thus all readings denote the same concurrent arrow.

(4) **Retain independence of events.** Equality of completed values alone would not establish the causal claim. Lemma 10.4 proves that a causal comparison between distinct decision outputs in the expanded secured interaction requires a directed path in the protocol DAG. Incomparable decisions therefore remain concurrent, including when their outputs are retained through hiding. The linear extension is an external reading of this diagram and inserts no scheduling event or causal edge.

□

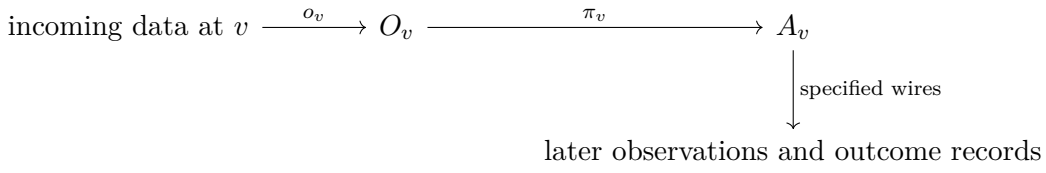


Figure 5: A policy receives its constructed observation quotient. Wiring can retain additional records without making them available to that policy.

The protocol construction now identifies complete economic policies with families of operational response functions. Each function uses the effective observation at its own node, and its realization is receptive and courteous. When several nodes belong to one owner, the resulting policy is their product; ownership neither duplicates the process nor orders otherwise independent events. This provides a concrete implementation of the agent representation.

Remark 10.6 (Protocol coherence and incentives). The linear-logical account of multiparty protocol compatibility in Carbone et al. (2015, 2017) concerns the operational layer. In the

present construction, the causal protocol specifies the agents' implemented interactions, while preference comparisons and profitable deviations determine incentive properties. Section 5.8 constructs the latter; the multiplayer comparison below identifies them on the implemented player strategies.

10.2 Multiplayer game semantics of the agents

The protocol implements the decisions; we now identify its owners as players of a game. Causal assignments form partial plays, and local response interfaces retain the observation quotients. Complete player strategies are then the owner policies, with secured interaction compiling to the protocol of Theorem 10.5. The same comparison identifies legal deviations and the designated strategic and epistemic tests.

The compositional setting remains the owned category of Theorem 3.11 and Corollary 10.2: operational arenas are objects, and owned systems are morphisms. The event structures below present finite partial plays. The retained-event isomorphism of Lemma 10.15 connects them to the expanded concurrent implementation, while compact transposition and feedback retain the complete policy sets.

Agent-labelled interaction and contingent response families have precedents in Abramsky (2007); Bradfield, Gutierrez, and Wooldridge (2016); Zahoransky et al. (2022). The comparison here uses the already specified observation quotients, legal domains, and concurrent realizers. Retaining the information discipline excludes responses that wait for unavailable signals, as related access-level restrictions do in Clairambault, Gutierrez, and Winskel (2013).

10.2.1 Ownership and operational polarity

An owner label specifies who may replace a complete strategy. Polarity specifies input and output responsibility at an operational boundary. They enter different parts of the construction. In particular, grouping owners does not repolarize their implemented components.

Example 10.7 (Repolarizing a coalition can destroy courtesy)**.** Let E have two independent events a, b, owned by $1, 2$ respectively. In player 1's view, make a positive and b negative, and take the strategy with both events independent. In player 2's view, make a negative and b positive, and take the strategy with $a < b$. Both strategies are receptive and courteous: the second introduces only a negative-to-positive dependency.

Their unpolarized secured pullback has $a < b$. Declaring both events positive for the coalition $\{1, 2\}$ makes its inclusion into the original independent arena noncourteous, since it introduces a positive-to-positive immediate dependency. Thus interaction followed by coalition recolouring does not define the required operation in $\mathcal{C}$. The construction below retains explicit local interfaces; regrouping changes their policy control, while their polarities and wiring remain the operational ones of Theorem 10.5.

10.2.2 The arena of causal assignments

Fix a finite causal decision protocol $\mathcal{P}$ as in Definition 10.3. Put $T = P_0 \sqcup V$ and $A_p = X_p$ for $p \in P_0$. Let $\preceq$ be the partial order generated by its specified typed input wires. Repeated wires from one source remain repeated coordinates in H_v; they do not create new source decisions. The effective observation $o_v : H_v \twoheadrightarrow O_v$ may forget a value even when its arrival is a prerequisite of the decision.

Construction 10.8 (Value-labelled causal occurrences)**.**

(1) **Form the events.** An event is a pair

$$(t, \alpha), \qquad t \in T, \qquad \alpha \in \prod_{s \preceq t} A_s.$$

It records the value at t together with its causal history.

(2) **Order and compare histories.** Set

$$(s, \beta) \leq (t, \alpha) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad s \preceq t \ \text{ and } \ \beta = \alpha|_{\downarrow s}.$$

Two events conflict when their assignments disagree on the intersection of their domains. A finite set is consistent when all its assignments agree on overlaps.

(3) **Display control.** Give (v, α) its owner label and external-input events a separate environment label in $N \sqcup \{\mathsf{env}\}$. Denote the resulting owner-labelled event structure by $E_{\mathcal{P}}$.

Lemma 10.9 (Configurations and independent extensions)**.** *The arena $E_{\mathcal{P}}$ is a finite prime event structure, with an order isomorphism*

$$\mathrm{Conf}(E_{\mathcal{P}}) \cong \left\{ (D, a) : D \subseteq T \ \textit{downclosed}, \quad a \in \prod_{t \in D} A_t \right\},$$

where the right side is ordered by extension of partial assignments. If two distinct decision nodes are enabled at one partial assignment, assigning either does not change the other's input. Any prescribed choices at these nodes have a common extension in either execution order.

Proof.

(1) **Verify the event structure.** Restriction makes the event order reflexive, transitive, and antisymmetric. The predecessors of (t, α) are exactly $(s, \alpha|_{\downarrow s})$ for $s \preceq t$, hence are finite and mutually consistent. Disagreement persists under extension of either history, so conflict is hereditary. Consistency is closed under subsets and adjoining causal predecessors.

(2) **Recover the partial assignment.** For a configuration, agreement on overlaps makes the union of its histories a function a. Its domain D is downclosed. Conversely,

$$(D, a) \longmapsto \{(t, a|_{\downarrow t}) : t \in D\}$$

is a configuration. The two constructions are inverse and preserve order.

(3) **Commute independent decisions.** If one enabled but unassigned node preceded the other, the latter would not be enabled. They are therefore incomparable, with all predecessors already assigned. Their extensions agree on the common history and assign different new nodes, so their union is a configuration.

□

The absence of a race between distinct enabled decision nodes follows from the protocol construction. It requires no extra restriction on the finite protocols of Definition 10.3.

10.2.3 Complete strategies and local response interfaces

Definition 10.10 (Complete multiplayer strategy)**.** A complete strategy for player i is a family of total responses $r_v : H_v \to A_v$, one for each v owned by i, constant on the fibres of o_v. Thus its strategy space is

$$\mathsf{Str}_i(\mathcal{P}) = \prod_{v:\, i(v)=i} \{r_v : H_v \to A_v : \ker(o_v) \subseteq \ker(r_v)\}.$$

The same player controls the entire family. The observation quotient specifies which distinctions each response may use.

Proposition 10.11 (Complete strategies are exactly the agent policies)**.** *There are canonical bijections*

$$\mathcal{R}_i : \Sigma_i = \prod_{v:\, i(v)=i} A_v^{O_v} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathsf{Str}_i(\mathcal{P}), \qquad (\pi_v)_v \longmapsto (\pi_v o_v)_v.$$

These complete strategies are faithfully implemented by the families $(\widehat{\pi_v} : D(O_v) \to D(A_v))_{i(v)=i}$.

Proof.

(1) **Factor the response through observation.** For an invariant response r_v, the relation

$$\{(o, a) : \exists h \in H_v \, (o_v(h) = o \ \wedge \ r_v(h) = a)\}$$

is total by surjectivity of o_v and single-valued by invariance. It defines the unique $\pi_v : O_v \to A_v$ with $r_v = \pi_v o_v$. No choice of representatives of observation classes is required. Taking the product over the owner's nodes proves the bijection.

(2) **Recover every local response.** By Proposition 1.23, the response strategy $\widehat{\pi_v}$ contains the prescribed output $\pi_v(o)$ at each input o. An isomorphism over the labelled arena preserves these responses. The whole family therefore recovers every component of the complete policy, including responses not used in a selected execution. □

The owner process can be displayed as

$$R_i(\pi_i) = \bigotimes_{v:\, i(v)=i} \widehat{\pi_v} : \bigotimes_{v:\, i(v)=i} D(O_v) \longrightarrow \bigotimes_{v:\, i(v)=i} D(A_v),$$

with the node interfaces retained. The protocol supplies the prescribed observed input at each interface. An arbitrary arrow between the two tensor boundaries could introduce additional information dependencies; the complete strategies here are the displayed families of finite response strategies. This functional fragment uses the existing concurrent category, consistently with the comparisons of functional models and concurrent strategies in Winskel (2023).

Proposition 10.12 (Operational projection of a player's strategy)**.** *Polarize $E_{\mathcal{P}}$ positively on owner i and negatively on the other labels, obtaining $E_{\mathcal{P}}^{(i)}$. Let $S_i(\pi_i)$ be the induced substructure of events whose histories satisfy every i-owned policy equation occurring in them. Its inclusion into $E_{\mathcal{P}}^{(i)}$ is receptive and courteous. Every conflict between its histories has a disagreement at a negative event in its causal past; there is no independent positive choice left by the policy.*

Proof.

(1) **Restrict histories.** The selected event set is downclosed: every equation in a predecessor history occurs in the larger history. It inherits the event structure and introduces no new immediate causal edge, proving courtesy.

(2) **Accept the environment's enabled moves.** If a negative event is enabled above a selected configuration, its predecessors already satisfy the owner's equations. Its own node is not controlled by i, so its history is selected as well. The inclusion gives a unique lift, proving receptivity.

(3) **Locate the origin of a conflict.** For two conflicting histories, choose a $\preceq$-minimal node at which their values differ. All predecessor values agree. The node cannot belong to i, since the fixed policy applied to the same observation gives the same value. It is therefore negative.

□

Example 10.13 (Off-path policies survive their operational projection)**.** Let one owner control $u \prec v$, choose $u = 0$, and let v observe u. Two policies agreeing at $v(0)$ but differing at $v(1)$ give the same $S_i(\pi_i)$: the earlier choice has already removed the branch $u = 1$. The complete local response family still distinguishes them, since its component at v accepts input 1 and records the prescribed response. Thus the global pruning describes execution, while the family of Proposition 10.11 retains the complete strategy.

Repeated wires can also make some tuples in H_v structurally unreachable. The declared response still has its entire domain O_v. Institutional tests on those entries remain well defined; neither pruning nor an extensive-form unfolding may silently discard them.

10.2.4 Secured interaction and compilation

Fix external data $u \in U_{\mathrm{ext}} = \prod_{p \in P_0} X_p$ and a complete profile π. Let $S_{\mathsf{env}}(u)$ select the histories agreeing with u at every external port in their domain. Forget polarity on the strategy views, so all inclusions have codomain $E_{\mathcal{P}}$.

Theorem 10.14 (Multiplayer interaction and its concurrent implementation)**.** *The multiway secured interaction is canonically*

$$E_{u,\pi} = S_{\mathsf{env}}(u) \cap \bigcap_{i \in N} S_i(\pi_i) \hookrightarrow E_{\mathcal{P}}.$$

It has a unique maximal configuration, whose assignment is the completed solution of Theorem 10.5. Every maximal sequence of enabled extensions reaches it, and independent decision occurrences remain concurrent. Connecting the complete local response families through that theorem's wiring realizes exactly its concurrent arrow g_π. In the fully supplied unhidden implementation, the order between decision outputs is the restriction of $\preceq$ to the decision nodes.

Proof.

(1) **Identify the secured pullback.** All maps are inclusions of downclosed substructures with the inherited order. Matching requires identical labelled events; the combined order is already the acyclic order of $E_{\mathcal{P}}$. All such diagonal matchings are secured. Their pullback is the intersection: every compatible family of maps has image there and factors uniquely through it. This also proves associativity under regrouping.

(2) **Construct the completed play.** At external nodes the values are u. By induction on causal height, the predecessor values determine the raw input, its observation, and

$$a_v = \pi_v\big(o_v((a_{\mathrm{src}(e)})_{e\in I_v})\big).$$

This constructs a full compatible assignment. Every partial assignment in the interaction is its restriction, by the same induction. A proper partial assignment has a minimal missing node and extends at that node, so it is not maximal. Finiteness implies that every maximal sequence of genuine extensions reaches the full assignment. The independent extensions commute by Lemma 10.9.

(3) **Compare the implemented components.** At each node use exactly

$$\bigotimes_{e\in I_v} D(X_e) \xrightarrow{c_v} D(H_v) \xrightarrow{\widehat{o_v}} D(O_v) \xrightarrow{\widehat{\pi_v}} D(A_v).$$

The nullary case uses c_0. Copying routes the chosen value to the specified successors and record wires, and the final collector and response compute z. Thus the local equations and completed outcome are those of the preceding step. If K denotes this fixed wiring,

$$K[(\widehat{\pi_v})_{v\in V}] = g_\pi. \tag{10.1}$$

Both sides are the same symmetric-monoidal composite, so this is equality of concurrent arrows, not only agreement of output values.

(4) **Compare causal orders.** Every specified wire from u to v supplies a causal path from d_u through copying, reception, and collection to d_v. Conversely, the local-generator analysis in Lemma 10.4 projects every path between decision outputs to specified dependency wires. The induced order is therefore exactly the wire-generated order $\preceq$.

□

The owner-labelled interaction is an unpolarized secured pullback; its player views are not asserted to be pairwise dual arenas. Its implementation uses the original polarized response interfaces and composition in $\mathcal{C}$. The expanded implementation retains receipt, copying, collection, and any further institutional occurrences. The smaller arena $E_{\mathcal{P}}$ records the input and decision occurrences. These are distinct presentations: the expanded witnesses remain available for the information and measured-execution tests.

Lemma 10.15 (Retained-event comparison with multiplayer partial plays)**.** *For a finite causal decision protocol and $x = (u, \pi)$, let a^x be its completed assignment. In the fully supplied unhidden implementation Q_x, let J_x consist of the external-source occurrence e_p for each external port and the action-output occurrence e_v for each decision node. There is a canonical event-structure isomorphism*

$$\theta_x : E_{u,\pi} \xrightarrow{\cong} Q_x|J_x, \qquad (t, a^x|_{\downarrow t}) \longmapsto e_t. \tag{10.2}$$

The induced configuration comparison

$$p_x : \mathrm{Conf}(Q_x) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Conf}(E_{u,\pi}), \qquad p_x(k) = \theta_x^{-1}[k \cap J_x]$$

is surjective and bounded for retained one-event extensions and their weak implementations through hidden occurrences.

Proof.

(1) **Identify the surviving occurrences.** The supplied inputs and complete policies determine a unique value at every node. The interaction of Theorem 10.14 has exactly the events $(t, a^x|_{\downarrow t})$, one per node, with order $\preceq$ and no conflict. The generator expansion has exactly one designated source or action-output occurrence for each such node, defining the bijection θ_x.

(2) **Preserve and reflect causal paths.** Every specified typed wire supplies a path between its designated occurrences. Conversely, a path between designated occurrences projects to a path of input wires by Lemma 10.4, applied also to the external-source occurrences. Copying and collection progress toward their outputs; external ports are sources and the final collector is a sink. Hence $e_s \leq e_t$ exactly when $s \preceq t$. Both supplied structures are conflict-free, so the bijection also preserves and reflects consistency.

(3) **Lift configurations at the specified source.** For a target configuration D, the configuration $\downarrow_{Q_x} \theta_x[D]$ maps to D. If a retained event e_t extends $k \cap J_x$, set

$$k' = k \cup \downarrow_{Q_x} e_t.$$

Every retained strict predecessor of e_t already lies in $k \cap J_x$. Thus k' is a configuration and $k' \cap J_x = (k \cap J_x) \cup \{e_t\}$. A finite linear extension of $k' \setminus k$ performs the hidden prerequisites and the single retained event. Conversely each such weak extension projects to the corresponding retained extension. These are the bounded-morphism clauses.

□

Restricting expanded executions to decision occurrences recovers the multiplayer partial plays.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{Conf}(Q_x) & \xrightarrow{k \mapsto k \cap J_x} & \mathrm{Conf}(Q_x|J_x) \\ & \searrow^{p_x} & \cong \downarrow \theta_x^{-1} \\ & & \mathrm{Conf}(E_{u,\pi}) \end{array}$$

The comparison concerns operational occurrences. A player's decision still factors through the specified observation quotient o_v via its complete local response family. The history label in $E_{\mathcal{P}}$ is therefore not an additional observation interface.

Proposition 10.16 (Weak successor lifting for a fully supplied protocol)**.** *Let $Q = Q_{u,\pi}$ be the fully supplied unhidden interaction of the finite protocol, with all its wired occurrences displayed. It is a finite conflict-free event structure. For any retained subset J of its events, with the induced transitive order, the map*

$$q : \mathrm{Conf}(Q) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Conf}(Q|J), \qquad q(k) = k \cap J$$

is surjective. Give the target its one-event e-extension relation for each $e \in J$, and the source the weak relation of extensions adding e and otherwise only hidden events. Then q is a bounded morphism for these relations.

Proof.

(1) **Resolve the supplied branches.** Each external value selects one branch. A response on a supplied input has a unique output, and copying and collection have unique branches at those values. Induction along the finite wiring therefore selects all occurrences consistently. Secured synchronization identifies matching occurrences without introducing alternatives. Thus Q is a finite poset of occurrences with no remaining conflict.

(2) **Lift configurations.** For $D \in \mathrm{Conf}(Q|J)$, the full downclosure $\downarrow_Q D$ is a configuration and intersects J in D. This proves surjectivity.

(3) **Lift at the specified source.** If $q(k)$ admits the extension $q(k) \cup \{e\}$, put

$$k' = k \cup \downarrow_Q e.$$

There is no conflict, so k' is a configuration. Every visible strict predecessor of e is already in $q(k)$; hence $k' \cap J = q(k) \cup \{e\}$. This is the required weak extension from k. Conversely, every such weak extension projects to the stated one-event extension. These are the two clauses of Definition 9.28.

□

By Theorem 9.30, the weak-step comparison transports the modal fixed-point tests whose atoms are retained by q. Receipt events or partial charges forgotten by J still require their corresponding records. Conflict-freedom was derived for the fully supplied finite protocol; the result does not discard hidden-conflict obstructions in arbitrary concurrent strategies.

Example 10.17 (A total forward barrier under feedback)**.** Set $D = D(1)$ and form the collector–splitter barrier $B = d_{1,1}c_{1,1} : D \otimes D \to D \otimes D$. With both inputs supplied, it produces both outputs; each output is causally after both inputs. Tracing the second channel would match its output to an input required for that output. Any configuration containing this feedback matching therefore has a cycle in its combined prerequisite relation and is not secured. The remaining external input can be accepted, but no external output can occur. Thus $\mathrm{Tr}^D(B) : D \to D$ is the receptive strategy with its negative input and no positive output.

By Corollary 10.2, this is an arrow of the generated decision semantics. It is not a total finite acyclic protocol on that supplied input: causal induction in Theorem 10.5 produces a completed output for every such protocol. The finite acyclic compiler therefore provides the total forward fragment of the compact semantics, while general compact feedback retains its secured operational meaning, including this deadlock.

10.2.5 Comparison with closure-operator interaction

The same game has a closure-operator description, making explicit its connection with Abramsky (2007) and Bradfield, Gutierrez, and Wooldridge (2016). Let $\mathcal{D}_{\mathcal{P}}$ be the configuration poset of Lemma 10.9 with a new greatest element $\top_{\mathrm{err}}$ for inconsistency. This is a finite complete lattice. Nonempty meets of configurations are intersections; joins are compatible unions, or $\top_{\mathrm{err}}$ when no common configuration contains the union. The empty meet is $\top_{\mathrm{err}}$ and the empty join is the empty configuration. In partial-assignment notation, a meet retains a common node value only when its whole causal past also agrees. The error element is not a play.

For fixed π_i, define F_i^π on this lattice. If an already assigned i-owned node violates its policy equation, return $\top_{\mathrm{err}}$. Otherwise add the prescribed values at all currently enabled unassigned i-owned nodes. Fix $\top_{\mathrm{err}}$. Let c_i^π be the iteration of F_i^π to stabilization.

Proposition 10.18 (Closure strategies and secured interaction agree)**.** *Each c_i^π is extensive, monotone, and idempotent, and away from $\top_{\mathrm{err}}$ it adds only decisions owned by i. The least common fixed point of the owners' closures above the supplied external assignment u is the completed play of Theorem 10.14.*

Proof.

(1) **Verify monotonicity.** For $x \subseteq y$, a policy violation in x persists in y. Otherwise each response enabled in x has the same input values in y. Its prescribed output is either still to be added, already present, or contradicted by an existing value, in which case $F_i^\pi(y) = \top_{\mathrm{err}}$. Thus $F_i^\pi(x) \leq F_i^\pi(y)$. Extensivity is immediate.

(2) **Stabilize the response.** Iteration preserves these properties and stabilizes on the finite lattice. Applying it again makes no change, proving idempotence. Every nonerror addition is at a node owned by i.

(3) **Identify joint interaction.** Starting at u, every added value agrees with the unique total assignment of Theorem 10.14, by causal induction. No error is reached. A nonerror common fixed point above u cannot omit a decision: a minimal missing node would be added by its owner's closure. Thus it is the unique full assignment. Iterating all owners' closures reaches that assignment, which lies below every common fixed point above u and is therefore the least.

□

This is a comparison for the constructed finite protocol games. As in Example 10.13, a whole-owner closure can forget off-path entries. The faithful strategy object remains the complete local response family of Proposition 10.11.

10.2.6 Strategic and logical adequacy

Retain the legal domain $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ and comparisons of Section 5.8. Put $\mathcal{R} = \prod_i \mathcal{R}_i$ and $\mathsf{Str}(\mathcal{P}) = \prod_i \mathsf{Str}_i(\mathcal{P})$. For a coalition C, coordinatewise bijectivity gives

$$\mathcal{R}\big[\{\rho \in L : \rho_{-C} = \pi_{-C}\}\big] = \{s' \in \mathcal{R}[L] : s'_{-C} = \mathcal{R}(\pi)_{-C}\}. \tag{10.3}$$

The restriction of $\mathcal{R}$ is a bijection of these deviation fibres, including when the institution couples different players' policies.

Theorem 10.19 (Exact strategic adequacy)**.** *Evaluate the constructed multiplayer strategies by their compiled interaction and the existing outcome or witnessed comparison. Legal best response, Nash equilibrium, and coalition-improvement predicates then agree with their agent interpretations. In particular, for a legal reference π and its existing strict-comparison predicate $P_i(u; \pi, \rho)$,*

$$\mathsf{NE}_L(u, \pi) \iff \bigwedge_{i \in N} \forall a \in \Sigma_i \, (\pi[i := a] \in L \Rightarrow \neg P_i(u; \pi, \pi[i := a]))$$

has the same truth value before and after the strategy correspondence.

Proof.

(1) **Identify the alternatives and their realizations.** Equation (10.3) identifies the legal alternative fibres. Equation (10.1) identifies their concurrent realizations and completed outcomes. Each pulled-back pairwise comparison therefore has the same truth value.

(2) **Quantify the same fibres.** The existential, universal, and negation operations constructing selection, best response, and equilibrium range over these identified fibres. Apply Proposition 5.80; the same argument treats coalitional comparisons. If evaluation uses nonsingleton witness fibres, retain those fibres and their specified witness quantifiers. A numerical profile payoff is used only through the descent construction of Proposition 5.50, not by selecting an execution.

□

Corollary 10.20 (Adequacy of retained epistemic and strategic tests)**.** *On the displayed profile and delivered-record carriers, the strategy correspondence identifies the retained observations, legal deviation relations, and atomic predicates. It preserves and reflects their relational assertions, including positive modal least and greatest fixed points.*

Proof. The product bijection leaves the reference world and the compiled record unchanged, so it identifies observation kernels and the owner-deviation relations. Inverse image along this bijection commutes with Boolean operations and the existential and universal images defining the modalities. Its powerset isomorphism transports least and greatest fixed points. Equivalently, apply Theorem 9.30 to this frame isomorphism. For the noninjective hiding comparison, use instead the source-fixed lifts of Proposition 10.16 and its retained atoms. □

Example 10.21 (Decisionwise stability and whole-owner improvement)**.** Example 5.63 applies to the multiplayer arena: one player controls the entire response family. Equilibrium at each decision separately therefore does not imply that player's equilibrium condition.

Non-zero-sum event-structure games and their equilibrium conditions are studied by Gutierrez and Wooldridge (2014). Their principal development uses two players, nondeterministic strategies, and dichotomous preferences. Here strategic adequacy identifies the existing multiplayer pure-policy predicates; it does not infer existence of a pure equilibrium from that different strategy model. Satisfaction adequacy above concerns the designated retained relations. The proof-theoretic completeness statement remains the one established in Appendix B.

10.2.7 Composition and continuing ownership

Proposition 10.22 (Multiplayer realization respects owned composition)**.** *For composable owned presentations $G : A \to B$ and $H : B \to C$, the player i controls $\Sigma_i^{H\circ G} = \Sigma_i^G \times \Sigma_i^H$ and*

$$g^{H\circ G}_{(\sigma,\tau)[i:=(a,b)]} = h_{\tau[i:=b]} \circ g_{\sigma[i:=a]}. \tag{10.4}$$

The analogous tensor equation holds. The finite protocol realization and the mediated realization respect these equations, the existing coherence maps, and exhibited ownerwise reparametrizations.

Proof.

(1) **Retain the response families and their boundaries.** For finite protocol realizations, write K_G and K_H for the exhibited wiring diagrams with their decision-response slots. Assemble them by the existing operations:

$$K_{H\circ G} = K_H \circ K_G, \qquad K_{G\otimes H} = K_G \otimes K_H.$$

Their response slots are the disjoint union of the component slots, grouped by the same owner. Thus owner i supplies (σ_i, τ_i), and substitution of (a, b) replaces precisely its slots in both components. Substituting in the displayed composites proves Equation (10.4) and its tensor counterpart by Equation (10.1). For arbitrary owned presentations the same equations are the defining owned composition and tensor laws; no decision-node decomposition is required for that statement.

(2) **Construct the sequential boundary comparison.** Fix the policies and choose source presentations $s_\sigma : S_\sigma \to A^\perp \parallel B$ and $t_\tau : T_\tau \to B^\perp \parallel C$ of their implemented

strategies. For synchronization forget the polarity on B and form the existing secured pullback:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} P_{\sigma,\tau} & \longrightarrow & A^{\perp} \parallel T_{\tau} \\ \downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \mathrm{id}\parallel t_{\tau}} \\ S_{\sigma} \parallel C & \xrightarrow[s_{\sigma}\parallel \mathrm{id}]{} & A^{\perp} \parallel B \parallel C. \end{array}$$

Restrict its labelling to $A^{\perp} \parallel C$. By Theorem 1.7 and the interaction-and-hiding construction, this is precisely $h_{\tau} \circ g_{\sigma}$. Keeping component expansions displayed instead forms the same wired system by iterated synchronization pullbacks before hiding. The maps between regroupings are the unique maps preserving all component projections; their inverses have the same property. On a fixed assignment arena, regrouping owner response constraints is the intersection of Theorem 10.14. Synchronization of separately presented boundaries is instead supplied by the displayed pullback.

(3) **Compare hiding and parallel assembly.** The interaction comparison descends through hiding by the hiding-witness and zipping construction used in Theorem 1.17 (Castellan et al., 2017, Section 4.3). Concretely, a configuration k of a restriction to retained events has the least expanded witness $\downarrow k$. Inserting this witness at a subsequently synchronized boundary reconstructs the hidden prerequisites. A causal cycle could neither lie inside that secured witness nor traverse it without inducing a cycle in the original boundary matching. Restriction recovers k. This compares the visible strategies; all expanded execution witnesses remain available separately. For tensor, take disjoint parallel component sources and retain both output boundaries. Hence parallel assembly introduces no cross-component causal edge. In particular it does not replace those boundaries by a single collected report: Proposition 1.31 shows why collection followed by distribution would change the strategy.

(4) **Verify coherence and mediated realization.** All reassociations of unhidden interaction preserve the same component projections, so their pentagons commute by uniqueness of the limit comparison; the hiding comparison carries these equations to the exterior strategies. Symmetric-monoidal interchange and the proved data-comonoid equations compare parallel readings and copying trees. This is the existing coherence of Theorems 3.2 and 10.5. The mediated comparison is its image under Theorem 2.22.

(5) **Reparametrize without losing names.** An exhibited map $r_i : \Theta_i \to \Sigma_i$ substitutes $\mathcal{R}_i(r_i(\theta_i))$ into the same finite response slots, or the corresponding state at the mediated policy interface. This commutes with both assemblies, while θ_i remains displayed as in Equation (3.3). Noninjective reparametrization therefore retains distinct strategic names even when their implemented processes coincide.

□

The comparison context continues to evaluate changes of the whole composite policy; its equilibrium set need not be a product of the component equilibrium sets. Likewise, after a partial history the remaining response interfaces retain all their prescribed contingencies. The residual construction of Section 12.2.1 operates on those continuing policies. Each response still uses its specified observation; an owner name alone introduces no extra memory. Compact duality changes operational polarity, not economic preference.

Theorem 10.23 (Multiplayer realization and strategic adequacy)**.** *Every finite causal decision protocol determines a multiplayer game semantics with the following properties:*

(1) *The players are its displayed owners, and their complete strategy sets are canonically the existing policy spaces* Σ_i.

(2) *Partial plays are the consistent causal assignments of* $E_{\mathcal{P}}$. *Joint interaction computes the original completed assignment, independently of a reading schedule.*

(3) *The complete strategies compile to the original concurrent realization, retaining the expanded execution witnesses.*

(4) *Legal deviations correspond bijectively, and the designated economic and retained epistemic tests agree under this correspondence.*

(5) *Sequential and parallel composition preserve ownership and the existing composition equations.*

Proof. Combine Lemma 10.9, Propositions 10.11 and 10.22, Theorems 10.14 and 10.19, and Corollary 10.20. □

For an arbitrary owned presentation, Theorem 2.22 supplies its exact realization in $\mathcal{V}$. For a proposed local response, the quotient criterion $\ker(o_v) \subseteq \ker(r_v)$ both tests the prescribed information restriction and constructs its unique factorization. Thus the finite theorem makes the operational realization explicit within the already specified policy, observation, and wiring structure.

10.3 Causal decision and session protocols

10.3.1 Decision generators and causal diagrams

For finite O, M, the singly owned decision generator is

$$\mathsf{Dec}_i(O, M) : D(O) \to D(M), \qquad \Sigma_i = M^O, \quad \Sigma_j = 1 \ (j \neq i),$$

with policy π realized by $\widehat{\pi}$. The response strategy has an input occurrence for each o and an output labelled $\pi(o)$ dependent on that input. The finite-data construction proves $\widehat{\mathrm{id}} = \mathrm{id}$ and $\widehat{g}\,\widehat{f} = \widehat{gf}$. It supplies data copying and disposal on $D(O)$ and collectors

$$c_{(X_e)} : \bigotimes_e D(X_e) \to D\left(\prod_e X_e\right).$$

A collector output requires all its inputs, without ordering their arrivals.

Definition 10.24 (Finite causal decision syntax)**.** A finite causal decision diagram is a finite directed acyclic graph of nodes v, owned by $i(v)$. Each incoming wire has a finite carrier X_e. A node has an effective observation map $o_v : \prod_{e \to v} X_e \twoheadrightarrow O_v$ and a finite output carrier M_v. External ports and outcome-record functions are specified as typed wires. Its complete owner policy family is

$$\Sigma_i = \prod_{v : i(v) = i} M_v^{O_v}.$$

Terms are formed by composing and tensoring decision generators, nonstrategic data wiring, and exhibited ownerwise parameter maps.

Construction 10.25 (The interpreted finite-data generator signature)**.**

(1) **Interpret finite data.** For each finite X, take the representable linear object $d_X = yD(X)$. Section 1 constructs, for every finite function $f : X \to Y$, the arrow $y\widehat{f} : d_X \to d_Y$, as well as the copying, disposal, distributor, and collector arrows with their concurrent realizations.

(2) **Represent the policy families.** Via Theorem 2.18, the family $\pi \mapsto y\widehat{\pi}$ determines a state

$$\delta_i : \mathsf{I} \longrightarrow \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(d_O, d_M), \qquad \Sigma_i = M^O, \quad \Sigma_j = 1 \ (j \neq i).$$

These are named generators with *exhibited interpretations*, not arrows obtained from Lin, tensor, and the other abstract LNL constructors alone.

(3) **Transport the generator equations.** Their event-structure equations, including data comonoid coherence and collector synchronization, were proved in Section 1 and are used below in that interpretation. Equality of concurrent interpretations is not automatically a definitional equality between freely declared generator names.

Lemma 10.26 (A physically token-guarded finite response)**.** *For finite O, M and $f : O \to M$, the composite*

$$D(1) \otimes D(O) \xrightarrow{c_{1,O}} D(1 \times O) \xrightarrow{\widehat{f}} D(M)$$

(where f is regarded as a map $1 \times O \to M$) is receptive and courteous. Every source configuration containing its positive output labelled $f(o)$ also contains the authorization input event and the input event labelled o in the causal past of that output. Thus the execution cannot deliver its result without receiving both inputs.

Proof.

(1) **Secured operational interaction.** In the finite collector the tuple output $(*, o)$ requires the negative inputs on both components. The response strategy adds the negative-to-positive dependency from this tuple input to its output $f(o)$. Secured composition synchronizes the tuple events; hiding them retains the induced dependencies from both original inputs to the final output.

(2) **Secured operational interaction: completion.** Downward closure of configurations proves the claim. Receptivity and courtesy hold for both factors by the preceding constructions, and are preserved under their secured composition.

□

Remark 10.27 (Typing, issuance, and unforgeability). A single linear variable of type $D(1)$ cannot be contracted by the core rules; however the full concurrent category contains the state $\mathsf{pt}_1(*) : I \to D(1)$. Thus this arena alone is not an unforgeable capability. An institutional issuance process is constructed by composing an actual finite observation-based permission gate (Proposition 9.42) with the token input of the above guarded response and retaining the issuance witness. Its output is causally dependent on successful issuance. The issued event's causal predecessor and its execution witness record which gate produced it. Authenticity of issuers is a property of the institution's exhibited certificate and permission interface, not of the mere type $D(1)$: the independent state $\mathsf{pt}_1(*) : I \to D(1)$ is available in the full operational category. The bearer can therefore prove provenance only when the provenance witness or its verified interface is retained.

Theorem 10.28 (Definability and scheduling independence)**.** *Every finite causal decision diagram has an agent term over the interpreted generator signature of Construction 10.25, with its displayed complete policy family and the concurrent interpretation constructed in the preceding constructions. Each input and profile determine a unique completed assignment of outputs. Different linear readings have the same interpreted concurrent interaction and add no order between independent decisions. Equality of these interpretations is not silently made a definitional equality between unrelated generator terms in the freely presented syntax.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** The generator signature maps each displayed $\mathsf{Dec}_i(O_v, M_v)$ to the same singly owned decision presentation used in the constructive DAG factorization in the proof of Theorem 10.5. Its routing maps, nullary collectors, finite copying/disposal, and ownerwise product coordinates are exactly those of that construction.

(2) **Causal execution: completion.** The causal-height recursion therefore gives the same unique output assignment, while adjacent incomparable-node swaps and collector coherence give the same concurrent interaction for every linear reading. This establishes the interpretation of the agent term, without identifying freely declared primitive terms merely because their interpretations happen to agree.

□

Theorem 10.29 (Prefix realizations and non-anticipation)**.** *For a downward-closed set $D \subseteq V$ of decision nodes, let U_D be the product of external-input coordinates feeding nodes of D, and $\Sigma_D = \prod_{v \in D} M_v^{O_v}$ (regrouped by owner when required). The causal-height recursion constructs a unique prefix realization*

$$r_D : U_D \times \Sigma_D \longrightarrow \prod_{v \in D} M_v.$$

For downward-closed $D \subseteq E$, these maps obey

$$\mathrm{pr}_D \, r_E = r_D(\mathrm{pr}_{U_D} \times \mathrm{pr}_{\Sigma_D}). \tag{10.5}$$

Every node's output therefore depends only on external inputs and policy coordinates at its causal predecessors and itself. For a node v, the actual incoming tuple and declared effective observation determine

$$U_v \times \Sigma_{D_v^-} \xrightarrow{\mathrm{in}_v} H_v := \prod_{e \to v} X_e \xrightarrow{o_v} O_v, \qquad U_v \times \Sigma_{D_v^-} \twoheadrightarrow O_v^{\mathrm{reach}} \hookrightarrow O_v,$$

where the second factorization is the image of $o_v \, \mathrm{in}_v$, D_v^- is the strict causal past, and U_v includes the external ports feeding it or v. Execution evaluates the existing complete policy $\pi_v : O_v \to M_v$ on that image; it does not replace the full policy carrier by one containing only reachable observations.

Proof.

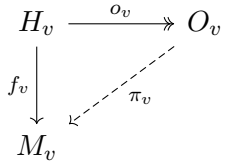
(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At a minimal node of D, both sides of (10.5) evaluate the same external inputs under its same policy coordinate. For a nonminimal $v \in D$, each source of an incoming node wire is already in D, because D is downward closed. By induction on causal height all those values agree between the full and prefix realizations.

(2) **Observation and knowledge.** Applying the same raw observation o_v and the same policy π_v gives the same output. Extensionality of finite products gives the equation. The map in_v is formed by projecting the required external ports and the already recursively calculated predecessor outputs.

(3) **Monoidal comparison.** Image factorization of its composite with the declared o_v gives $O_v^{\mathrm{reach}} \hookrightarrow O_v$ directly. All maps are built by recursion, products, and image factorization in **Set**, so the comparisons commute with pullback substitution of ordinary parameters.

□

The factorization identifies the signal available at this prefix. Histories giving the same signal must receive the same response.



Example 10.30 (One agent informs another)**.** Compose $\mathsf{Dec}_i(O, M)$ with $\mathsf{Dec}_j(M, A)$. At policies $\alpha : O \to M$ and $\beta : M \to A$, the first agent sends $\alpha(o)$ and the second responds with $\beta(\alpha(o))$. Their composite is $\widehat{\beta}\,\widehat{\alpha} = \widehat{\beta\alpha}$. Hiding the message boundary retains both owners' policy coordinates. Recording or forwarding the message uses an explicit output wire.

10.3.2 Finite session boundaries

Finite session types provide a second view of these communications: they prescribe how an endpoint can send, receive, and continue after a message. The treatment of channel references in Harper (2016) supplies programming-language context; the present construction makes the linear protocol discipline and its concurrent realization explicit. We use the dependent finite grammar below.

$$S ::= \mathsf{End} \mid !_{m:M} S_m \mid ?_{m:M} S_m, \tag{10.6}$$

where M is a finite ordinary message type and each continuation is already a finite session. The nondependent notations $!M.S$ and $?M.S$ are special cases. Internal choice $\oplus\{\ell : S_\ell\}$ is a send of a finite label; external choice $\&\{\ell : S_\ell\}$ is its receive dual. The prefix ! here is not the exponential LinVal. Duality is defined recursively by

$$\overline{\mathsf{End}} = \mathsf{End}, \quad \overline{!_{m:M} S_m} = ?_{m:M} \overline{S_m}, \quad \overline{?_{m:M} S_m} = !_{m:M} \overline{S_m}.$$

Sending m consumes the current endpoint of type $!_{m:M} S_m$ and returns its residual endpoint S_m. Its partner consumes the corresponding receive endpoint and continues at $\overline{S_m}$. An ordinary message may be stored, but the old endpoint does not remain available as a second linear resource.

Construction 10.31 (Session arenas)**.**

(1) **Form the history tree.** Let H_S be the finite tree of legal message histories of S, with empty history at its root. A nonterminal history h has an extension hm for each element of its current message carrier M_h.

(2) **Define events and consistency.** Events are nonempty histories, ordered by prefix. A finite event set is consistent when its elements lie on a single branch.

(3) **Assign polarities.** The event hm is positive when the protocol at h sends, and negative when it receives. Write A_S for this polarized event structure.

Predecessor sets are finite, consistency is downward closed, and adjoining a predecessor preserves consistency. Thus the construction is an event structure. Directly, $\mathsf{A}_{\overline{S}} = \mathsf{A}_S^{\perp}$ and $\mathsf{A}_{\mathsf{End}} = I$. The continuation guard is an actual arena order. In particular $\mathsf{A}_{!M.S}$ is not defined as the unguarded tensor $D(M) \otimes \mathsf{A}_S$: that tensor alone would allow independent activity in the two components.

10.3.3 Complete policies of communicating agents

Fix endpoint owners a, b. Let $H(S)$ be the prefix-closed set of session histories, including the empty history ϵ. A *decision position* is a nonterminal history, whereas an event of A_S is a *nonempty extension* of a history. These are different indexing sets. Put

$$\mathcal{D}_a(S) = \{h \in H(S) : S|h \neq \mathsf{End} \text{ and } S|h \text{ begins with a send}\},$$

and define $\mathcal{D}_b(S)$ by replacing send with receive; the send moves of a are exactly the receive moves of b. At h let M_h be the current finite message carrier. Define the complete policy spaces

$$\Sigma_i^S = \prod_{h \in \mathcal{D}_i(S)} M_h, \qquad i \in \{a, b\}. \tag{10.7}$$

These products retain every legal decision position, including the positions inconsistent with the choices made at other positions by the same policy. The empty product is the unit policy type. For an ordinary private value $u_i : O_i$, the corresponding policy carrier is $\prod_{h \in \mathcal{D}_i(S)} M_h^{O_i}$, and its executed choice is $\alpha_h(u_i)$. When the private value is delivered physically, the source strategy additionally records its negative input event, as constructed below.

For $\alpha \in \Sigma_a^S$, recursively construct the prefix-closed subtree P_α by retaining the uniquely selected outgoing event at an a-send position and every outgoing event at a b-send position. The inclusion $P_\alpha \hookrightarrow \mathsf{A}_S$ denotes a strategy $p_\alpha : I \to \mathsf{A}_S$. Dually, the policy β of owner b prunes its positive events in the opposite-polarity arena, giving $q_\beta : \mathsf{A}_S \to I$.

Lemma 10.32 (Endpoint realization)**.** *The two inclusions are receptive courteous strategies. Finite prefix recursion, followed by abstraction of the complete policy, constructs closed displayed agent terms in the interpreted finite session language*

$$p : \mathsf{Ag}_{(\Sigma_a^S, 1)}(yI, y\mathsf{A}_S), \qquad q : \mathsf{Ag}_{(1, \Sigma_b^S)}(y\mathsf{A}_S, yI)$$

with owner list (a, b)*.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** Each pruned subtree is down-closed, locally injective, and preserves single-branch consistency and polarity. Given an enabled negative arena event after a retained source configuration, it belongs to the next receive position and was retained, uniquely, by the recursive construction. All causal edges of a pruned tree are inherited prefix edges, so courtesy holds.

(2) **Construct the endpoint expression.** Work in the ordinary context $\alpha : \Sigma_a^S$. For every legal history h, define a prefix expression $P_h(\alpha)$ at the suffix type $S|h$ by recursion on its remaining height. At End use the ended endpoint (the empty tree). At $!_{m:M_h} S_{hm}$, read $m = \alpha_h$ and form $\mathsf{Send}(m); P_{hm}(\alpha)$, using finite case analysis on that coordinate. At $?_{m:M_h} S_{hm}$, form $\mathsf{Recv}(m); P_{hm}(\alpha)$ with one branch for each $m \in M_h$. These expressions are the finite guarded trees of Construction 10.31 and Equation (10.9). At a send each case retains one specified first edge above the root and grafts its continuation below that edge. At a receive the branches have all the negative first edges, and events in distinct branches conflict. An empty receive menu gives the empty family of branches. In an empty send menu the selected coordinate eliminates from the empty ordinary type. All subexpressions retain the same ordinary register. Each recursive call is at a strict child; hence the construction terminates also for dependent continuations and supplies the indicated suffix type in every branch.

(3) **Compute its denotation and abstract.** Induction on that same height identifies the interpreted events with the retained nonempty suffixes of h. The first edge carries m, and a suffix k in its continuation carries the concatenated history hmk. This bijection preserves and reflects prefix order, single-branch consistency, polarity and boundary labels. At $h = \epsilon$ the denotation is therefore p_α. In the dual recursion for $\beta : \Sigma_b^S$, sends and receives exchange roles and the denotation on the input boundary is q_β. Abstract the ordinary registers by the agent introduction of Theorem 2.15, using the tensor unitor at the empty boundary. This gives the displayed terms. Their evaluations at every complete register are the inclusions just constructed, so the representation bijection identifies their denotations with the stated families. The term construction is the finite prefix recursion; the bijection verifies its denotation.

□

10.3.4 Physically received private information

Construction 10.33 (Receptive endpoint with a private input)**.**

(1) **Fix the policy and session interface.** For finite O_a, take the complete policy $\alpha \in \prod_{h \in \mathcal{D}_a(S)} M_h^{O_a}$. We construct

$$p_\alpha^{O_a} : D(O_a) \longrightarrow \mathsf{A}_S.$$

(2) **Separate shared and private histories.** Write B_- for the set of nonempty session-event histories whose entire prefix contains only negative moves of A_S. For each $u \in O_a$, let $P_{\alpha,u}$ be the prefix-closed session subtree obtained by applying $\alpha_h(u)$ at every positive decision position and retaining all negative branches. Its events in B_- are shared between all input values.

(3) **Build the source events.** The source event set has: a negative event e_u for each $u \in O_a$; a common event b_k for each $k \in B_-$; and an event (u, k) for each $k \in P_{\alpha,u} \setminus B_-$. The e_u are mutually conflicting.

(4) **Generate causal order.** Order common events by their session prefix relation. Order the tagged events, and the common-to-tagged dependencies, by the same prefix relation. Every first tagged event (which is necessarily positive) has the additional predecessor e_u.

(5) **Impose consistency.** Distinct tagged values are inconsistent. A finite set is consistent exactly when its session labels belong to one branch, it uses at most one input value and one tag, and the input value, if present with a tag, equals that tag. The source's finite-consistency family includes down-closures of all these compatible finite sets.

(6) **Label the endpoint.** Label e_u in $D(O_a)^\perp$ and label $b_k, (u, k)$ by the session event k in A_S. The added prerequisite makes the private input causally prior to the first positive session event without imposing an order between the private input and an initial negative-only session prefix.

Apply the identical construction with exchanged session polarities for owner b to obtain

$$q_\beta^{O_b} : \mathsf{A}_S \otimes D(O_b) \longrightarrow I, \qquad \Sigma_b = \prod_{h \in \mathcal{D}_b(S)} M_h^{O_b}.$$

The private-input event is negative in both arrow arenas.

Lemma 10.34 (Input causality, receptivity, and courtesy)**.** *These are receptive courteous strategies. Session inputs available before the endpoint's first send can precede the private-input event; each input-dependent positive response has that event in its causal past. Every complete policy coordinate remains present in the policy carrier, including off-path coordinates.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** Principal causal downsets are finite because S is finite and a tagged suffix acquires only the one extra private predecessor. Cause extension preserves the stated consistency: predecessors of a tagged event have the same tag or are common prefix events, and its input predecessor is e_u. Hence the source is an event structure.

(2) **Causal execution: second comparison.** Its labelling preserves configurations and is locally injective: conflicting input values or tags cannot occur in one configuration and the common and tagged event sets have disjoint session labels.

(3) **Lifting through the comparison.** For receptivity, an enabled negative private-input move has a unique e_u lift. It is available after any common negative-only prefix, and no local positive move can have occurred without some e_u. Before the first local positive move, every enabled negative session move has its unique common-event lift, whether the private input is already present or not.

(4) **Lifting along the surjection: second comparison.** After the first local positive move its value tag u is fixed, and the corresponding negative continuation has a unique tagged lift. These cases exhaust negative arena moves.

(5) **Secured operational interaction.** An immediate source edge inherited from the session prefix tree is an arena dependency. The only newly inserted immediate dependencies go from the negative input e_u to a first tagged positive event. Thus courtesy holds.

(6) **Communication and delivery.** The dual endpoint is proved by the same argument with the session polarities reversed. Neither construction restricts the original product of contingent response maps.

□

A factorization through fixed operational wiring. The same two agents admit a compilation in the generated presentation of Definition 10.1. For the provider, put $P = \Sigma_a^S$ and specialize Construction 10.33 to the private input $u : P$ and the fixed coordinate evaluations $\alpha_h(u) = u_h$. This gives one fixed receptive courteous strategy $v_a : D(P) \to \mathsf{A}_S$. Produce its input using the nullary collector and the singly owned decision $\mathsf{Dec}_a(1, P)$, reparametrized by $u \mapsto (* \mapsto u)$. At policy u the resulting point is $\mathsf{pt}_P(u)$, and

$$v_a \, \mathsf{pt}_P(u) \cong p_u.$$

Indeed the matched input selects the tagged u-suffixes. Hiding it retains every common negative prefix and precisely the selected tagged continuations. Removing the tag gives an isomorphism over the session arena, since the only extra cause was the private input. This also covers a path that has no local send. For the client, use the dual fixed wiring $v_b : \mathsf{A}_S \otimes D(\Sigma_b^S) \to I$ and tensor the policy point with identity on the session input. The same label-preserving bijection gives q_β. Each v_i is an exhibited nonstrategic wiring in $\mathbf{j}_N(\mathcal{C})$, so these factorizations use the declared closure under composition, tensor and parameter

reindexing. The guarded prefix terms and these compiled presentations have the same concurrent denotations. A free signature of flat finite-data generators alone does not declare the general mixed session boundary.

10.3.5 Connection, reduction, and fidelity

Connection is linear composition. In provider–client notation its rule is

$$\frac{\Gamma;\Delta \vdash P :: c : S \qquad \Gamma;\Theta, c : S \vdash Q :: z : T}{\Gamma;\Delta,\Theta \vdash (\nu c)(P \mid Q) :: z : T}. \tag{10.8}$$

Here the session boundary is interpreted by $[\![S]\!]_\ell = y\mathsf{A}_S$ and its dual by $[\![\overline{S}]\!]_\ell = y\mathsf{A}_S^\perp$. The first premise denotes a linear arrow $[\![\Delta]\!] \to y\mathsf{A}_S$; the second denotes $[\![\Theta]\!] \otimes y\mathsf{A}_S \to [\![T]\!]_\ell$. The latter occurrence is an *input* linear variable: it is already polarity-reversed when interpreted in the arrow arena. Thus the endpoint duality $\mathsf{A}_{\overline{S}} = \mathsf{A}_S^\perp$ is enforced by the input/output placement, and one does not replace that input variable by a variable of the distinct linear object $y\mathsf{A}_S^\perp$ in this derived cut rule. The conclusion is their tensor-and-composition composite in $\mathcal{V}$. This gives a derived cut judgment from the core linear rules, not an unrestricted process language. The finite operational language consists only of the constructed endpoint prefix trees, complete-policy registers, and a current history. Its Send and Recv notations name the corresponding selected positive branch and receptive negative branch of these trees, not independent freely asserted primitive processes. Matching prefixes reduce by

$$(\nu c)(\mathsf{Send}_c(m); P \mid \mathsf{Recv}_c(x); Q) \longrightarrow (\nu c)(P \mid Q[m/x]). \tag{10.9}$$

Dual endpoints synchronize on matching communication events. Hiding the shared interface yields the composite, while the matched history records which conversation took place. The residual theorem identifies what each endpoint can do next by the message actually exchanged.

10.3.6 Operational configurations and residual session endpoints

A runtime configuration is (S, h, α, β), where h is a legal history compatible with the complete policies and $S|h$ is its residual session. At a nonterminal history the next sender is uniquely determined by the polarity. Its register gives the next label m_h, and the transition is

$$(S, h, \alpha, \beta) \longrightarrow (S, hm_h, \alpha, \beta). \tag{10.10}$$

There is no transition from End. At a send node of a one has $m_h = \alpha_h$ and at a send node of b one has $m_h = \beta_h$. For physically received private values u_a, u_b, evaluate the corresponding register entries as $\alpha_h(u_a)$ or $\beta_h(u_b)$; the causal input events are prerequisites of the first relevant sends. Local prefix notation projects this communication transition to the matching sender and receiver reduction (10.9). Neither transition alters the complete register.

Lemma 10.35 (Residual session arena)**.** *Let h be a history of S, viewed as a configuration of A_S. The residual arena consisting of events compatible with and strictly after h, with the events of h removed and the inherited causal order, is canonically isomorphic to $\mathsf{A}_{S|h}$. Residual formation commutes with duality.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** Every remaining event is a nonempty extension hk of h, and $hk \mapsto k$ is a bijection to the nonempty histories of the syntactic continuation $S|h$. Prefix order, single-branch consistency, and the send/receive polarity at a continuation node are unchanged by deleting h. Prepending h is the inverse.

(2) **Causal execution: completion.** Reversing polarities before or after this bijection gives the same event labels, proving the duality equation.

□

Construction 10.36 (Restriction of complete session policies)**.**

(1) **Identify continuation coordinates.** For a legal session history h, concatenation gives a bijection

$$\mathcal{D}_i(S|h) \xrightarrow{k\mapsto hk} \{hk \in \mathcal{D}_i(S) : k \in H(S|h)\}.$$

In contrast to the residual *event* bijection, the residual *decision* positions include $k = \epsilon$ when $S|h$ begins with a decision by i.

(2) **Project the complete policy.** Define the ordinary product projection

$$\boxed{\rho_{i,h} : \Sigma_i^S \longrightarrow \Sigma_i^{S|h}, \qquad \rho_{i,h}(\alpha)_k = \alpha_{hk}.}$$

This supplies the coordinates needed by the residual endpoint; the original complete policy register remains unchanged and still contains its earlier and counterfactual coordinates.

(3) **Iterate restriction.** For a further legal history k of $S|h$, product extensionality gives

$$\rho_{i,\epsilon} = \mathrm{id}, \qquad \rho_{i,hk} = \rho_{i,k}^{S|h}\rho_{i,h}. \tag{10.11}$$

Indeed both sides have component α_{hkl} at a residual decision position l of $S|hk$.

Construction 10.37 (Residual status of a physical private input)**.**

(1) **Record the input status.** For owner i define the ordinary local input-status carrier $\mathsf{InputStatus}_i = 1 + O_i$. Its left summand means the physical input is still outstanding; a right-summand value u means its negative input occurrence belongs to the completed source history.

(2) **Residualize an outstanding input.** Let x be a configuration of the strategy of Construction 10.33 and let h be its session projection, so h is a prefix of S.

When the input is outstanding, no local positive session event has occurred, because every first such event requires the missing private input. Residualizing at x leaves the private-input strategy associated with $\rho_{i,h}(\alpha)$ and the external input interface $D(O_i)$.

(3) **Residualize a received input.** When $e_u \in x$, the input has already occurred. Define the fixed-value residual session policy by

$$\alpha_k^{u,h} = (\rho_{i,h}\alpha)_k(u) = \alpha_{hk}(u).$$

Residualizing at x and removing its completed private-input occurrence leaves the fixed-value endpoint strategy over $\mathsf{A}_{S|h}$, with no second private-input port. For owner b use the identical construction in the dual session arena.

Lemma 10.38 (Coherence of input-status residuals)**.** *The two residual descriptions of Construction 10.37 are isomorphisms of strategies over their respective residual session arenas. Receiving a private input changes the status from outstanding to the delivered value u; receiving a session message leaves the status unchanged; a local send is possible only in the received-value status. These residual isomorphisms commute with successive residual formation and session duality.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** An outstanding-input configuration has only common negative-prefix session events. Deleting that prefix identifies the remaining common negative events and tagged suffixes, by $hk \mapsto k$, with the source constructed from $\rho_{i,h}\alpha$; its private input events e_u remain present. If the input e_u has arrived, delete it and the completed session prefix.

(2) **Causal execution: second comparison.** The remaining tagged events (u, hk) are identified with the fixed-u pruning of $S|h$, while any common negative-prefix suffix has the identical image under this bijection. The identifications preserve order, consistency, polarity, and labelling, and the additional private-input cause has already been discharged.

(3) **Causal execution.** A transition receiving e_u selects the second description without changing h. A negative session transition extends h through the same common or tagged branch and leaves the input status unchanged. Every positive session event is tagged and therefore can occur only in the received-value case.

(4) **Policy-level comparison.** For successive session prefixes the resulting policy components are $\alpha_{hkl}(u)$ by Equation (10.11); the input is removed exactly once. Thus both orders of residualization yield the same source event structure over the suffix arena. Reversal of session polarities exchanges the two endpoint arguments without changing the input-status construction.

□

Lemma 10.39 (Residual endpoint strategy isomorphisms)**.** *For a history h compatible with the complete policy profile, residual formation of its two fixed-policy endpoint strategies satisfies*

$$\mathrm{Res}_h(p_\alpha) \cong p_{\rho_{a,h}(\alpha)}, \qquad \mathrm{Res}_h(q_\beta) \cong q_{\rho_{b,h}(\beta)},$$

using the identification $\mathsf{A}_S/h \cong \mathsf{A}_{S|h}$ of Lemma 10.35. These isomorphisms commute with further residual formation and with polarity reversal.

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** A remaining session event is exactly an extension hk, $k \neq \varnothing$. The bijection $hk \mapsto k$ preserves and reflects its prefix order, branchwise consistency, and polarity. At a positive endpoint decision position k (including $k = \epsilon$ when the residual begins with a local send) both prunings retain the same chosen output, since the residual policy has value $\rho_{i,h}(\alpha)_k = \alpha_{hk}$.

(2) **Fibrewise calculation.** At a negative endpoint node both retain every enabled input. The resulting restriction is therefore an isomorphism of the two strategy event structures over the residual arena. The indexed equation (10.11) proves compatibility of successive residuals, and the event bijection is unchanged by polarity reversal.

□

Proposition 10.40 (Derived finite-prefix subject reduction)**.** *For the above finite protocol-prefix notation and its closed complete policy registers, a matching send and receive at history h preserves the external linear typing judgment, changes both connected endpoint types to the dual pair $S|hm$ and $\overline{S|hm}$, and preserves the full registers. The reduction (10.9) is interpreted by residual formation of the secured interaction, followed by the canonical residual endpoint isomorphisms.*

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At the nonterminal history h, the fixed sender entry selects $m \in M_h$; the receptive endpoint uniquely accepts that same input. The session syntax selects the continuation $S|hm$, and polarity reversal selects its dual. The preceding lemma identifies the resulting endpoint strategies with the respective prunings of these continuations.

(2) **Functoriality and substitution.** Substitution of m into a dependent continuation is ordinary substitution, so it cannot duplicate or drop unrelated linear variables. The core linear substitution lemma validates the cut before and after that step. The projections $\rho_{i,hm}$ supply the first post-prefix decision as well as all later decisions.

(3) **Causal execution.** Its full register is unchanged; only those projections determine its residual use. For endpoints with physical private inputs, the additional input-status isomorphisms of Lemma 10.38 verify that an input is neither used before arrival nor requested a second time.

(4) **Secured operational interaction.** Secured interaction of the matching prefix and hiding give precisely the residual composed strategies, by the interaction and hiding construction of Section 1.

(5) **Session subject reduction.** This proves subject reduction for the specified finite prefix language without claiming a process calculus with arbitrary channel creation or mobility.

□

Theorem 10.41 (Finite session preservation, progress, and adequacy)**.** *For every* $(\alpha, \beta) \in \Sigma_a^S \times \Sigma_b^S$*:*

(i) every communication step leaves dual residual endpoint types and preserves the complete-policy profile;

(ii) every nonterminal runtime configuration has a unique next communication, and execution reaches End *in finitely many steps;*

(iii) the configurations of the secured interaction of p_α *and* q_β *are exactly the prefixes of this execution. Its unique maximal configuration records the completed transcript.*

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At the current history h, exactly one endpoint sends. Its complete-policy coordinate selects $m \in M_h$. The other endpoint retains every enabled input and therefore receives this event uniquely.

(2) **Causal execution.** The continuations are indexed by the same m and are dual by Lemma 10.35. Their typed reduction and the unchanged complete register follow from Proposition 10.40. The finite height of the residual syntax tree strictly decreases.

(3) **Policy-level comparison.** A reached node with an empty message carrier would require a component of the given complete profile in the empty set, which is impossible. Hence execution terminates specifically at End.

(4) **Secured operational interaction.** A matching configuration of the endpoint maps identifies session events bearing the same history label. The maps are locally injective, and each endpoint's configurations lie on one root-to-leaf branch. At each nonterminal node the fixed sender pruning retains precisely the event selected by its complete policy, while receptivity gives its unique matching occurrence on the receiver.

(5) **Fixed-point argument.** Induction on the prefix length therefore identifies a matching with exactly one initial segment of the calculated run; conversely, each calculated initial segment gives such a matching. Both endpoint causal orders restrict to prefix order, so their union has no oriented cycle and every such matching is secured.

(6) **Secured operational interaction.** The secured-matching configuration bijection of Theorem 1.7 now identifies the interaction configurations with these prefixes, *before hiding*. The complete run gives the unique maximal secured witness. Hiding can erase the internal transcript events from the composite scalar; the completed witness or the explicit recorder of Lemma 10.43 retains them for subsequent evaluation.

□

Corollary 10.42 (Input-indexed session adequacy)**.** *For fixed complete input-indexed policies α, β and supplied private values $u_a \in O_a, u_b \in O_b$, compose the strategies of Construction 10.33 with the value states $\mathsf{pt}_{O_a}(u_a)$ and $\mathsf{pt}_{O_b}(u_b)$. The projection of their secured interaction to the shared session arena has exactly the prefixes of the execution of (10.10), with next labels $\alpha_h(u_a)$ and $\beta_h(u_b)$. Its maximal session transcript is unique. The physical input events may be concurrent with earlier received session moves; no ordering between the two private inputs is added.*

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At the first local send of each owner its private input is already in its source causal past, by Lemma 10.34. Lemma 10.38 then identifies the remaining endpoint with the fixed-value pruning at each later history, without reissuing the private input. Every negative session continuation remains uniquely receivable.

(2) **Fixed-point argument.** Induction on the current session prefix therefore gives the same unique next synchronized label as the closed case, evaluated at the supplied input. After forgetting private-input occurrences, its session matchings are exactly the calculated prefixes. The input dependencies cannot form a cycle: their edges point into the relevant positive moves and never back towards an input.

(3) **Securedness of synchronized messages.** Hence the matchings are secured. The two input events have no dependency between them, and finite-height termination is unchanged.

□

The theorem establishes adequacy at the level of witnesses. After hiding the entire session, $q_\beta p_\alpha$ has boundary $I \to I$, and the concurrent category has a single scalar. Its transcript must therefore be retained as an execution witness, or delivered on an explicit output wire, when it determines later observations, records, or evaluation.

Lemma 10.43 (A physical transcript output)**.** *The finite closed session has a recorded implementation with boundary $I \to D(T_S)$, where T_S is its finite set of terminating transcripts. For the input-indexed session there is a recorded implementation with boundary $D(O_a) \otimes D(O_b) \to D(T_S)$. Its complete policy carriers are canonically the original ones. At each complete profile, its visible output is the calculated transcript, and a completed secured matching retains the internal communication history witnessing that output.*

Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At each terminating history h, adjoin to the session arena a positive record event r_h whose immediate cause is the final session event of h (or no

cause if $h = \epsilon$). Its full causal past is therefore exactly the events of h. Record events at different leaves remain inconsistent, and their labels distinguish the corresponding leaves.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Call the extended arena A_S^r. These new final positive moves have a prescribed singleton choice; they contribute unit factors rather than new owner policies.

(3) **Policy-level comparison.** Extend the first endpoint by producing r_h at every leaf consistent with its policy. Extend the dual endpoint by accepting every enabled negative occurrence r_h and then producing a positive output d_h labelled by $h \in T_S$. Its only new immediate dependency is the negative-to-positive edge $r_h < d_h$.

(4) **Secured operational interaction.** The two source maps preserve prefix order and conflict, are locally injective, and accept every enabled negative move uniquely. Their new dependencies satisfy courtesy; thus both extended endpoints are receptive courteous strategies.

(5) **Policy-level comparison.** For a fixed complete policy profile, the secured interaction of the extended endpoints has precisely the session prefixes established by Theorem 10.41, together with a final matched r_h and visible output d_h on the unique completed branch. Before hiding, the completed matching explicitly records the internal session events and the final record occurrence.

(6) **Secured operational interaction.** After hiding the A_S^r interface, the output event d_h remains with the induced visible causal order, but the matched session events themselves are no longer events of the composite strategy. This distinction proves the claim about the retained execution witness and the visible output separately.

(7) **Causal execution.** For physical private inputs use the endpoints of Construction 10.33, extending their session components by the same terminal recorder. Their reception events remain independent until the protocol requires them, and the extra causal predecessors of input-dependent positive events persist in the secured interaction.

(8) **Secured operational interaction.** For the input-indexed version, first copy each physical private input by its designated data comonoid Δ_{O_a} or Δ_{O_b}. Send one copy to the corresponding private-input endpoint and the other two copies to $c_{O_a,O_b} : D(O_a) \otimes D(O_b) \to D(O_a \times O_b)$.

(9) **Communication and delivery.** After the session recorder supplies $D(T_S)$, form the final output by

$$D(O_a \times O_b) \otimes D(T_S) \xrightarrow{c_{O_a \times O_b, T_S}} D((O_a \times O_b) \times T_S) \xrightarrow{\widehat{\mathrm{pr}_{T_S}}} D(T_S).$$

This makes the final visible record causally dependent on both physical private inputs and the completed transcript, without ordering the two private input occurrences.

(10) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The entire construction uses only the existing copying, collector, and finite response arrows. Its fixed data wiring preserves the displayed owner policy factors. On composing with the selected value states, Lemma 10.38 and Corollary 10.42 identify the same unique completed transcript.

(11) **Policy-level comparison.** No policy coordinate is created by the recorder: its outputs are functions of the existing terminal history.

□

10.3.7 Composing conversations

Sequential continuation is tree grafting. Given a continuation T_h at each terminating leaf h of S, its decision nodes are those of S and the tagged nodes of every T_h. The complete owner carriers satisfy

$$\Sigma_i^{S[T]} \cong \Sigma_i^S \times \prod_{h \in \mathrm{Leaves}(S)} \Sigma_i^{T_h}.$$

Substituting a continuation at each completed leaf gives the complete policy space of the composite conversation. The policy at an off-path leaf remains part of that product, even when the chosen execution never visits it. Consequently sequential composition retains the counterfactual choices needed by later strategic evaluation.

This compositional account of finite sessions is the operational basis for the communication witnesses used below: typing records which messages can be exchanged, while secured histories record which messages were actually delivered. Neither alone determines a truthful announcement or the recipient's epistemic update.

These finite sessions implement request and reply, labelled choice, private delivery, and conversations with several rounds. The general connection between session typing and cut reduction is developed in Caires and Pfenning (2010). Here the direct operational construction also identifies the owner of each choice and retains its off-path responses. The syntax covers finite sessions with the specified endpoints.

10.4 Epistemic action events from completed communication

The completed secured matchings and the transcript-output wires from this section now provide the event and observation data required by the abstract epistemic action semantics of Section 9. The construction keeps distinct execution witnesses even when their observable action-event labels coincide.

Construction 10.44 (Witnessed delivery of a public report)**.**

(1) **Copy the finite report to its recipients.** At an existing finite report port $D(R)$, use the data comonoid to form one retained report copy and one copy for each owner. The carrier R is the finite image of the existing report function.

(2) **Witness every receipt.** At recipient i, use the finite response $\widehat{!} : D(R) \to D(1)$. Its designated input occurrence is the recipient's actual receipt and its output is an acknowledgement. These are nonstrategic components with singleton policy families.

(3) **Expose the report after delivery.** Collect the retained report and all acknowledgements, then project to R:

$$D(R) \longrightarrow D(R) \otimes \bigotimes_{i \in N} D(R) \longrightarrow D(R) \otimes \bigotimes_{i \in N} D(1) \longrightarrow D(R \times 1^N) \longrightarrow D(R).$$

Use this final output as the completed public-delivery boundary. For the empty owner list the circuit is the identity.

Proposition 10.45 (Exposed identity and witnessed public completion)**.** *Hiding the internal wires of Construction 10.44 gives* $\mathrm{id}_{D(R)}$*. Every completed execution of the original protocol has a unique completed extension through this circuit, containing each recipient's receipt of the report.*

Proof.

(1) **Construct the supplied branch.** For report value r, every copied value and acknowledgement is uniquely determined. The circuit is finite and acyclic, so its full supplied branch is a completed secured execution. Its last output depends on every acknowledgement and hence on every designated receipt.

(2) **Identify the exposed strategy.** The only exposed events are the negative input r and the positive output r, with the input preceding the output. Each has the unique compatible internal history just constructed. Hiding therefore gives copycat on $D(R)$. Appending that branch to a completed original execution gives its unique completed extension; restriction recovers the original execution.

□

Construction 10.46 (Action data from completed execution witnesses)**.**

(1) **Retain the completed executions.** When the report is designated for public receipt, first append Construction 10.44 and use its final output as completion boundary. For a finite implemented protocol, construct Ξ as the dependent carrier of its completed secured matchings, retaining the source world, profile, and completed labelled causal history. Concretely, over input and complete-policy space $W \times \Sigma$, it is the dependent sum of the sets of completed secured matching configurations associated with the specified protocol realizers. The deterministic protocol and session adequacy theorems just proved construct those fibres; for general witnessed finite interactions they retain all completed matchings together with their individual witnesses. Its source projection is $s : \Xi \to W$.

(2) **Read the delivered ports.** Label each designated recipient occurrence by its fixed protocol port occurrence and delivered value. From a completed witness take the induced poset of those occurrences, together with any designated retained local policy register. Its record is the isomorphism class of this labelled poset and register; isomorphisms preserve every port and value label. Let V_i be the image of the resulting map

$$d_i : \Xi \longrightarrow V_i.$$

Distinct protocol positions remain distinct labels, while the disjoint-union parameter tag and unobserved complete-policy coordinates are not part of the observed label. The induced order retains causal comparisons between receipts without assigning independent receptions a total schedule. Write H_i for the finite set of receipt-history classes on these finite occurrence and message carriers, and Γ_i for the image of the designated local-register map out of Ξ (use the unique map $\Xi \to 1$ when no register is retained). Then

$$V_i \hookrightarrow \mathsf{H}_i \times \Gamma_i, \qquad V_i \twoheadrightarrow \Gamma_i.$$

Consequently V_i is finite exactly when Γ_i is finite. For the canonical finite decision protocol, the local policy register is a readout of the finite carrier $\Sigma_i = \prod_{v:i(v)=i} A_v^{O_v}$, so its image and V_i are finite. The finite session policy carriers give the same conclusion. An exhibited reparametrization with an infinite retained register can give an infinite record image; the image construction still applies in **Set**. Taking receipt-history classes requires no choice of a representative. For public delivery the designated ports include the actual broadcast receipts. If a report is retained at the external boundary, use the final output to form $d_0 : \Xi \to V_0$; otherwise take $V_0 = 1$. A report exported only to an external evaluator contributes to d_0, and does not itself add an owner observation.

(3) **Form the joint action image.** Construct the tuple and its image factorization

$$\widetilde{d} = \langle d_0, (d_i)_{i \in N} \rangle : \Xi \xrightarrow{q} E \xhookrightarrow{\iota} V_0 \times \prod_{i \in N} V_i.$$

Here q is the surjective image map and ι is its inclusion. Put $b_0 = \mathrm{pr}_{V_0}\,\iota$. For each owner define $b_i = \mathrm{pr}_{V_i}\,\iota : E \to V_i$, so that $d_i = b_i q$. Thus the event labels and their recipient observations are *constructed from delivery*, not separately specified event equivalence relations. Explicitly,

$$q(\xi) = q(\xi') \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad d_0(\xi) = d_0(\xi') \text{ and } d_i(\xi) = d_i(\xi') \text{ for all } i.$$

This is the coarsest event-label identification preserving the retained output record and every actually delivered recipient record.

(4) **Compute enabling and updated observations.** The enabling predicate is the image

$$U = \mathrm{im}\langle s, q\rangle \hookrightarrow W \times E, \qquad (w,e) \in U \iff \exists \xi \in \Xi\ (s\xi = w \ \wedge\ q\xi = e).$$

The effective updated observation of owner i is the image of

$$o_i^+ : U \to O_i \times V_i, \qquad o_i^+(w,e) = (o_i(w), b_i(e)).$$

Write $R_i = \ker(o_i)$ and construct $S_i = \ker(b_i)$. The witness carrier Ξ remains displayed above U together with each witness's concurrent realization and any institutional certificate. The image is used for the epistemic event label, not to identify distinct execution witnesses.

Proof.

(1) **Secured operational interaction.** The local record restrictions are functions because every completed secured history has a determined induced labelled poset at its designated recipient ports. Its isomorphism class and designated register are therefore determined as well. The image construction has the universal property that every map out of Ξ constant on $\ker(q)$ descends uniquely through the surjection q. The coordinate maps b_i exist by factorization through the image and satisfy $b_i q = d_i$ by definition. For finiteness, let P_i be the finite set of designated occurrence positions and M_p the finite value carrier at position p. A history is encoded by its present positions, their values, and an order relation. Thus, with $m_i = |P_i|$,

$$|\mathsf{H}_i| \le 2^{m_i^2} \prod_{p \in P_i} (1 + |M_p|).$$

Pairing with the register gives the displayed inclusion of V_i; projection onto its actual register image is surjective. These prove both directions of the finiteness characterization, including empty execution carriers. No finiteness is used in the subsequent image or kernel-pair calculations.

(2) **Calculate the updated observation kernel.** The product-update kernel is calculated on the enabled carrier:

$$\begin{aligned}(w,e)\ \ker(o_i^+)\ (v,f) &\Longleftrightarrow o_i(w) = o_i(v) \ \wedge\ b_i(e) = b_i(f)\\ &\Longleftrightarrow wR_iv \ \wedge\ eS_if.\end{aligned}$$

Corestriction to the effective image does not change this kernel pair. The first line is equality in a Cartesian product, and the second is the definition of the two component kernels.

(3) **Witness and legality comparison.** This is exactly Equation (9.20). Nothing in the factorization forgets the separate elements of Ξ: each remains an exhibited witness in the institution's dependent execution carrier.

□

Lemma 10.47 (Invariant delivered records)**.** *The delivered-record maps of Construction 10.46 are invariant under renaming a disjoint-union parameter tag and under isomorphisms of expanded executions preserving their fixed observable port labels and designated local registers. Restriction to a saturated patch containing the designated recipient occurrences preserves the record.*

Proof.

(1) **Forget implementation tags at the observation map.** An observed label is its fixed protocol port occurrence and delivered value. Renaming a parameter tag changes neither. An isomorphism over these labels induces an isomorphism of the observed induced posets. Taking their isomorphism classes, together with the designated local register, therefore gives the same record.

(2) **Restrict without erasing receipts.** A patch containing the designated occurrences retains their labels and the same induced order. The designated register is retained by its ordinary parameter projection. Thus reading before or after restriction gives the same value. Hidden causal histories remain available as execution witnesses but are not additional observed labels.

□

Proposition 10.48 (Effective observations after public delivery)**.** *For the canonical full-record finite protocol, write d_0 for its terminal report and d_i^{old} for its recipient record before appending the witnessed public broadcast. Under the completed-execution bijection of Proposition 10.45, the new effective recipient record is the image of*

$$d_i^{\mathrm{pub}} = \langle d_i^{\mathrm{old}}, d_0 \rangle.$$

If b_0 and b_i^{old} are the corresponding projections from the old joint action image, the new observation is, under the canonical image identification,

$$o_i^{+,\mathrm{pub}}(w, e) = (o_i(w), b_i^{\mathrm{old}}(e), b_0(e)).$$

Its kernel on the enabled carrier is

$$\ker(o_i^{+,\mathrm{pub}}) = \ker(o_i \pi_W) \cap \ker(b_i^{\mathrm{old}} \pi_E) \cap \ker(b_0 \pi_E). \tag{10.12}$$

The old and new joint action-event images and enabling carriers are canonically isomorphic.

Proof.

(1) **Read the appended receipt.** In the canonical compiler every old designated recipient occurrence precedes the terminal full-record report: its outgoing path reaches a decision or record component feeding the final collector. The new recipient receipt follows that report. Its fixed label and value r append one observed occurrence after the old local record. The resulting labelled-poset class is determined by, and recovers, (d_i^{old}, r).

(2) **Identify the joint images.** The map

$$(r, (v_i)_i) \longmapsto (r, ((v_i, r))_i)$$

is bijective onto the new joint image, with inverse given by projection. It preserves the source world under the completed-run bijection. Taking the world-and-event images therefore identifies the enabled carriers as well.

(3) **Calculate the updated knowledge relation.** Equality of the new observation tuple is exactly equality of its three coordinates, proving (10.12). The completion boundary follows all acknowledgements, so the record asserts actual receipt at every owner. This realizes the public observation used in epistemic product update (Baltag, Moss, and Solecki, 1998).

□

Public delivery enlarges each recipient record while preserving the joint action image up to its canonical identification.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Xi^{\mathrm{pub}} & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \Xi^{\mathrm{old}} \\ {\scriptstyle q^{\mathrm{pub}}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle q^{\mathrm{old}}} \\ E^{\mathrm{pub}} & \xrightarrow[\cong]{} & E^{\mathrm{old}} \end{array}$$

For an implementation with additional activity concurrent with the old report, use the actual full induced recipient poset. It retains the relative order of old and new receipts, which the pair formula alone need not encode. The broadcast circuit still witnesses public delivery, and the observation is formed from this complete delivered record. In the following sheaf comparisons, V_i, d_i, b_i always denote the effective actual records, including the public receipt when public delivery is specified. An output exported only to an external evaluator does not add a recipient observation.

10.5 Sheaf-local presentations of completed communication

The completed witness carrier Ξ now includes the evidence extracted from actual delivery. We compare it with the policy-indexed sheaf of Section 8.2 using the fully expanded secured histories before hiding. Compatible local information and global task solutions are related in Felber et al. (2025); here both the task and its delivery witnesses come from the finite concurrent protocol.

Two comparisons must be distinguished. In this canonical finite presentation, the final record lies above every event of the expanded history. Its least retained anchor is the whole interface, so the anchored site is terminal and q^{fin} is an isomorphism (Proposition 10.51). The later map $v_W : T_W \twoheadrightarrow U_W$ genuinely quotients completed records. Local gluing before completion is supplied separately by Section 8.2.

Construction 10.49 (Finite protocol witness site and completion subobject)**.**

(1) **Retain the expanded concurrent histories.** Let $X = U_{\mathrm{ext}} \times \Sigma$ be the finite external-input and complete-policy carrier of a fixed finite causal protocol of Theorem 10.5. For public delivery, include the circuit of Construction 10.44 in the expansion and use its final output as completion boundary. It adds no policy coordinates and preserves the terminal report. For each $x \in X$ retain the resulting finite expanded secured-interaction event structure Q_x before hiding. Write $\Xi_{\mathrm{in},x}$ for the configurations with the protocol's designated completed terminal record. These retain the actual event witnesses. Any further independent institutional certificate family of Section 8.1 remains separately indexed; it is not inferred from a matching graph.

(2) **Give the family a common interface.** Form the finite disjoint-union event structure $E = \bigsqcup_{x \in X} Q_x$, forgetting polarities for the matching comparison. Take $f_x = g_x = \iota_x : Q_x \hookrightarrow E$, the tagged inclusions. A secured matching of the two copies of Q_x over E is

exactly the diagonal of a configuration z of Q_x:

$$\mathcal{M}(\iota_x, \iota_x) \cong \mathrm{Conf}(Q_x), \qquad z \longmapsto \{(e, e) : e \in z\}.$$

Thus the common-family site of Construction 8.3 gives a sheaf of precisely the exhibited concurrent histories, with no new process constructor.

(3) **Choose the completion boundary.** Denote by $F_x \subseteq |Q_x|$ the labelled final-report occurrences of the protocol. Form the saturated anchor A containing their images in E, the designated recipient receipt occurrences, and institutional certificate occurrences. Define the predicate on matching sections

$$\mathsf{Finished}(x, \varphi) \iff \text{a designated final-report event in } F_x \text{ occurs in } \varphi.$$

On the anchored site put $\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}}(V) = \{k \in \mathscr{K}_A(V) : \mathsf{Finished}(k)\}$. The uniqueness of the completed action assignment in Theorem 10.5 constructs its terminal outcome map $z_X : X \to Z$. For the already specified institutional acceptance predicate $Q \hookrightarrow Z$, put

$$X_Q = z_X^{-1}(Q), \qquad \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{acc}} = \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}} \times_{\underline{X}} \underline{X_Q}.$$

The complete input and policy parameter stays fixed on causal restriction, so this is the accepted-history subobject. To derive actual authorization from the exhibited protocol, define R_x as the finite set of issuer-output/recipient-input wire incidences at the authorization ports already exhibited in the finite protocol (so no independent role list is postulated), and let $\mathsf{Tok}_r(k)$ be the set of events of the anchored matching $k = (x, \varphi)$ which are the secured synchronizations of the specified issuer output and corresponding recipient input in role $r \in R_x$. Such an event retains its prime secured causal history; a token-shaped but unmatched label does not belong to this set. Construct the dependent token-proof carrier and its image

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{TokProof}(k) &= \prod_{r \in R_x} \mathsf{Tok}_r(k), \\ J_A &= \coprod_{k \in \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}}(A)} \mathsf{TokProof}(k), \\ C_A &= \mathrm{im}(J_A \xrightarrow{j_A} \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}}(A)). \end{aligned} \tag{10.13}$$

The factors are subobjects of the exhibited secured-event incidence sets, so J_A and C_A are constructed from the actual wiring. The finite product enforces all designated token roles, while J_A retains distinct issuer/recipient witnesses. Define

$$\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{auth}} = \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{acc}} \times_{\underline{\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}}(A)}} \underline{C_A}.$$

Because A contains the token occurrences and their causal past, restriction to A preserves and reflects these synchronizations. The pullback therefore tests actual authorization and institutional acceptance together. Independent certificate objects remain proof-relevant, as in Construction 8.1, rather than being identified with issuer events.

(4) **Read actual received subhistories.** For a configuration in Q_x, the recipient record is the isomorphism class of the induced receiver poset, labelled by fixed protocol port occurrences and delivered values as in Construction 10.46. The tag x in $E = \bigsqcup_x Q_x$ remains part of the execution witness and retained parameter, but is not an additional recipient label. Public reports use the designated actual broadcast receptions. The

institutional record retains the issuer-produced token occurrence and the matched recipient occurrence, with the causal data in their saturated past. These are functions of $k|_A$. On completed configurations they agree with the previously constructed delivery maps $d_i : \Xi_W \to V_i$ after the ordinary world-index pullback and with the institutional certificate record.

Proposition 10.50 (Explicit finite anchor, port readouts, and token witnesses)**.** *In Construction 10.49, let $H \subseteq E$ be the union of the final-report, designated recipient and token occurrences, and let A be its least simultaneously saturated patch. Then*

$$A = {\downarrow_E} H. \tag{10.14}$$

In particular, $A = E$ exactly when every occurrence of E is causally below a designated member of H; in that case the anchored site has the single object E.

Let $\kappa : \Xi_{\mathrm{in}} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathscr{F}(E)$ be the map sending a completed configuration z in Q_x to $(x, \{(e, e) : e \in z\})$, and write $\rho_A : \mathscr{F}(E) \to \mathscr{F}(A)$ for restriction. For each designated recipient and for the public output, the actual completed port-readout functions of Construction 10.46 factor as

$$d_i = \mathrm{rec}_{i,A}\ \rho_A\, \kappa, \qquad d_0 = \mathrm{rec}_{0,A}\ \rho_A\, \kappa. \tag{10.15}$$

The issuer/recipient proof carrier $J_A \to \mathscr{F}(A)$ of (10.13) constructs a proof-relevant sheaf

$$\mathscr{W}_{\mathrm{tok}} = \mathscr{F} \times_{\underline{\mathscr{F}(A)}} \underline{J_A} \longrightarrow \mathscr{F}. \tag{10.16}$$

Its image is precisely the anchored token-certificate subobject,

$$\mathrm{im}(\mathscr{W}_{\mathrm{tok}} \to \mathscr{F}) = \mathscr{F} \times_{\underline{\mathscr{F}(A)}} \underline{C_A}, \qquad \Gamma(\mathscr{W}_{\mathrm{tok}}) \cong \mathscr{F}(E) \times_{\mathscr{F}(A)} J_A.$$

Pulling the same construction back to $\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{acc}}$ gives the actually authorized sheaf $\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{auth}}$ as its image, without identifying distinct token witnesses.

Proof. Since $E = \bigsqcup_x Q_x$ and $f_x = g_x = \iota_x$, the source- and target-predecessor images in the anchor operator are contained in $\downarrow_E U$ for every $U \subseteq E$; conversely $\downarrow_E U$ is a summand of that operator. Hence $\Phi_H(U) = H \cup \downarrow_E U$. Starting at $\varnothing$ gives $U_1 = H$, $U_2 = {\downarrow_E} H$, and $U_3 = U_2$. This proves (10.14) and its characterization of the anchored site.

For each x, both projections of the diagonal matching have configuration z, and their combined secured order is exactly the order of Q_x restricted to z. The inverse of κ therefore forgets the redundant second coordinate and is canonical. By construction every designated recipient and public occurrence lies in A. Since A is downward closed, its restriction retains every causal predecessor of those occurrences. Taking their induced port-and-value-labelled order before or after restriction gives the same record class by Lemma 10.47. The displayed local policy register, when present, is a projection from the persistent parameter x. This proves both equations in (10.15), without choosing a linear schedule or a representative of an image quotient.

The two factors in (10.16) are sheaves; their pullback is a sheaf because limits are computed objectwise. Factor the displayed incidence map as the ordinary regular image $J_A \twoheadrightarrow C_A \hookrightarrow \mathscr{F}(A)$. Both constant presheaves are sheaves in the nonempty-cover topology, and the first map is sectionwise surjective. Its pullback along $\mathscr{F} \to \underline{\mathscr{F}(A)}$ is therefore a regular epimorphism, followed by the pullback of the mono. This is the claimed image factorization. Applying global sections, which preserve pullbacks and satisfy $\Gamma\underline{Y} = Y$ here, gives the displayed formula for $\Gamma\mathscr{W}_{\mathrm{tok}}$. Finally, intersection with acceptance is a further pullback, and regular images in the sheaf topos are pullback-stable. Thus the resulting image is exactly $\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{acc}} \times_{\underline{\mathscr{F}(A)}} \underline{C_A}$, which is the already defined authorized sheaf. □

Proposition 10.51 (Terminal-anchor specialization for the canonical compiler)**.** *For the canonical full-record compiler of Theorem 10.5, let f_x be the final-report occurrence in the fully supplied expansion Q_x. Then*

$$\downarrow_{Q_x} f_x = Q_x, \qquad A = E = \bigsqcup_{x \in X} Q_x.$$

The completed anchored site has one object, and its completed configuration and retained-record carriers satisfy

$$\Xi_{\mathrm{in}} \cong X, \qquad T_{\mathrm{fin}} \cong X, \qquad q^{\mathrm{fin}} : \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}} \xrightarrow{\cong} \underline{X}.$$

The same conclusions hold after the witnessed public broadcast of Construction 10.44, using its final output as completion boundary.

Proof.

(1) **Follow every occurrence to the final collector.** Every external value and every decision action has an institutional-record wire. Each occurrence in a canonical copying tree feeds either that record or a later decision whose action feeds the record. Finiteness and acyclicity therefore give a path from every routed occurrence to the final collector. The observation, response and collection occurrences lie on these paths; a nullary collector precedes its decision output. The final response follows the collected full record. Thus every occurrence lies below f_x.

(2) **Identify the completed configuration and anchor.** The supplied branches form the finite conflict-free Q_x of Proposition 10.16. Its full carrier is a configuration, and a configuration containing f_x must contain all of it. There is exactly one completed configuration c_x over each x. The anchor contains every f_x and is downward closed, so $A = E$. Its only containing patch is E.

(3) **Compute the retained image.** The retained readout includes x. Its completed image therefore has exactly one element over each x, and its quotient is bijective. On the one-object site this is the stated isomorphism of sheaves. Empty parameter carriers give the same statements with empty completed carriers. In the broadcast extension, all acknowledgements and the old final report precede the new final report, so the argument applies to that boundary.

□

This specialization concerns the exhibited canonical compiler. Independent certificate objects remain in their separate witness families, and the general construction also permits implementations with further independent occurrences. The later map $v_W : T_W \twoheadrightarrow U_W$ can still forget complete policy data and remains a substantive epistemic quotient even when q^{fin} is an isomorphism.

Construction 10.52 (Local restrictions of completed canonical runs)**.**

(1) **Retain the completed configurations.** Let c_x be the unique completed configuration just constructed. On the original unanchored common site set

$$\mathscr{C}(U) = \{(x, c_x|_U) : x \in X\} \hookrightarrow \mathscr{K}_X(U),$$

using the diagonal-matching identification of Construction 10.49.

(2) **Restrict the completed views.** For $V \subseteq U$, send $(x, c_x|_U)$ to $(x, c_x|_V)$. The parameter remains fixed; the displayed event history is its restriction to the smaller patch.

Proposition 10.53 (Full-site sheaf of completed-run restrictions)**.** *The displayed $\mathscr{C}$ is a sheaf, naturally isomorphic to $\underline{X}$, and its inclusion in $\mathscr{K}_X$ is a natural monomorphism. Moreover*

$$\Gamma\mathscr{C} \cong \Xi_{\mathrm{in}}, \qquad \mathscr{C}|_{\mathcal{O}_A} \cong \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}}.$$

Proof.

(1) **Identify the sheaf and its inclusion.** The map $x \mapsto (x, c_x|_U)$ is bijective onto $\mathscr{C}(U)$ and natural in U. Constant presheaves are sheaves in the nonempty-cover topology by Theorem 8.4. The inclusion into $\mathscr{K}_X(U)$ is injective because the parameter is retained, and restriction commutes with that inclusion.

(2) **Recover completed runs at the terminal patch.** At E, the sections are exactly (x, c_x), identifying global sections with Ξ_{in}. At the completed anchor $A = E$ these are exactly the finished matching sections. This proves both displayed identifications.

□

The completed-run views retain their parameter while their exhibited histories restrict along the causal site.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathscr{C}(U) & \hookrightarrow & \mathscr{K}_X(U) \\ {\scriptstyle (-)|_V}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle (-)|_V} \\ \mathscr{C}(V) & \hookrightarrow & \mathscr{K}_X(V) \end{array}$$

A section of $\mathscr{C}$ is a local view of an already completed run; it need not contain a final-report occurrence. This differs from the predicate Finished on a partial execution. Knowledge computed from only the receptions on a smaller unanchored patch can change, as in Example 9.37. The completed anchored comparison and the full-site restriction sheaf therefore retain their respective observation interfaces explicitly.

Proposition 10.54 (Exact anchored descent of certificate predicates)**.** *Write $\mathscr{F} = \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}}$, let E be the full interface, and let $\rho_A : \mathscr{F}(E) \to \mathscr{F}(A)$ be restriction. For every global certificate predicate $P \hookrightarrow \mathscr{F}(E)$, put $P_A = \mathrm{im}(\rho_A|_P)$ and define*

$$\mathrm{Cl}_A(P) = \rho_A^{-1}(P_A). \tag{10.17}$$

This is the least anchor-determined predicate containing P. The following are equivalent:

$$\begin{aligned} P &= \mathrm{Cl}_A(P), \\ \mathrm{pr}_1^* P &= \mathrm{pr}_2^* P \qquad \text{on } \mathscr{F}(E) \times_{\mathscr{F}(A)} \mathscr{F}(E), \\ P &= \rho_A^{-1}(C_A) \quad \text{for a unique } C_A \subseteq \mathscr{F}(A). \end{aligned} \tag{10.18}$$

For any $C_A \subseteq \mathscr{F}(A)$ the pullback

$$\mathscr{F}^{C_A} = \mathscr{F} \times_{\underline{\mathscr{F}(A)}} \underline{C_A} \tag{10.19}$$

is a sheaf with $\Gamma(\mathscr{F}^{C_A}) \cong \rho_A^{-1}(C_A)$. For $T_{C_A} = \mathrm{im}(d_A|_{C_A})$, its retained-record map $\mathscr{F}^{C_A} \twoheadrightarrow \underline{T_{C_A}}$ is a regular epimorphism. Thus its designated relations have the source-fixed lifting and modal equations of Theorem 9.34.

Proof.

(1) **Compute the effective-descent criterion.** The map ρ_A is split surjective: extend an anchored completed matching to the full interface by the same graph, using Lemma 9.32; the final-report event is retained. The kernel-pair criterion of Proposition 5.38 therefore identifies the ρ_A-invariant predicates exactly with the inverse images of unique predicates on $\mathscr{F}(A)$. Its image P_A gives the least such predicate containing P. This proves (10.18) and makes Cl_A extensive, monotone and idempotent.

(2) **Construct the certificate sheaf.** Restriction to A defines a natural map $\mathscr{F} \to \underline{\mathscr{F}(A)}$. Both constant presheaves in (10.19) are sheaves by Theorem 8.4. Their pullback is therefore a sheaf. At the terminal patch E, its elements are exactly the completed histories whose anchor lies in C_A.

(3) **Construct the source-fixed quotient.** By the image definition, each $t \in T_{C_A}$ has an anchored preimage $a \in C_A$. For every anchored patch U, extend a to E as the same matching and restrict it to U. The result belongs to $\mathscr{F}^{C_A}(U)$ and reads t. Thus the record map is sectionwise surjective and hence a regular epimorphism of sheaves. Apply the regular-epi pullback argument of Theorem 9.34.

□

Certified histories are a pullback of the retained anchor predicate, not an unrestricted intersection of predicates on partial matchings.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathscr{F}^{C_A} & \hookrightarrow & \mathscr{F} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle (-)|_A} \\ \underline{C_A} & \hookrightarrow & \underline{\mathscr{F}(A)} \end{array}$$

Theorem 10.55 (Completed, authorized and world-indexed witness recovery)**.** *For the finite causal protocol of Construction 10.49, $\mathscr{F} = \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}}$ is a sheaf and $\Gamma(\mathscr{F}) \cong \Xi_{\mathrm{in}}$ over $X = U_{\mathrm{ext}} \times \Sigma$. Its anchored retained record has the regular-epimorphism factorization*

$$q^{\mathrm{fin}} : \mathscr{F} \twoheadrightarrow \underline{T_{\mathrm{fin}}}, \qquad T_{\mathrm{fin}} = \mathrm{im}(d_A|_{\mathscr{F}(A)}).$$

The accepted and actually authorized subobjects $\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{acc}}$ and $\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{auth}}$ constructed above are sheaves. Their global sections are exactly the completed histories satisfying, respectively, the protocol's acceptance test and that test together with its issuer-token witness. Each has a regular-epimorphism retained-record quotient onto the image of its anchored record map, with the exact source-fixed modal comparisons of Theorem 9.34.

For a situated world carrier W and its external-input map $u : W \to U_{\mathrm{ext}}$, write $X_W = W \times \Sigma$ and $\alpha = u \times \mathrm{id}_\Sigma : X_W \to X$. There is a cartesian reconstruction

$$\mathscr{F}_W = \underline{X_W} \times_{\underline{X}} \mathscr{F}, \qquad \Gamma(\mathscr{F}_W) \cong X_W \times_X \Xi_{\mathrm{in}} = \Xi_W. \tag{10.20}$$

Writing $T_W = X_W \times_X T_{\mathrm{fin}}$, the induced map

$$q_W : \mathscr{F}_W \twoheadrightarrow \underline{T_W}$$

is a regular epimorphism. All these comparisons commute with further world substitution and with the accepted and authorized pullbacks. The original witnessed epistemic action-event carrier and its updated-observation kernels are recovered by the canonical regular-epimorphism comparison of Theorem 10.56, constructed from the record images of Construction 10.46. The set of policies having a completed or authorized witness remains the image of the corresponding witness-to-policy projection.

Proof.

(1) **Reconstruct the completed histories.** Each matching of $\iota_x : Q_x \hookrightarrow E$ with itself is the diagonal of a configuration of Q_x, since tagged labels are injective. Its secured order is the original causal order. The final-report predicate is determined by restriction to A, so compatible completed local histories have the uniquely completed amalgamation of Theorem 1.11. At the terminal patch, these are precisely the previously constructed Ξ_{in}, including their reference and owner-profile projections.

(2) **Derive acceptance and authorization.** The causal-height recursion of Theorem 10.5 constructs the completed terminal outcome $z_X(x)$ from the full parameter x. Hence its acceptance predicate is the inverse image of X_Q under the persistent parameter map, and the accepted sheaf is a pullback as displayed in Construction 10.49. The matched issuer and recipient occurrences are all retained in A. The incidence image (10.13) is true exactly when each required token role has a matched synchronization in the completed history. Consequently the global token predicate is the inverse image of C_A along ρ_A, and it equalizes the kernel pair of ρ_A. Proposition 10.54 proves that their intersection is a sheaf with exactly the accepted, issuer-certified completed global sections. Neither predicate follows from the bare token type.

(3) **Recover completed record quotients.** Every record in the image of the anchored completed, accepted or authorized readout has a completing anchored preimage. Extend its matching graph to the full interface and restrict to any anchored patch. The completion, acceptance parameter, and issuer certificate are preserved. The resulting record morphisms are sectionwise surjective and therefore regular epimorphisms, as in Lemma 9.32 and Proposition 10.54. Their source-fixed relation lifting is Theorem 9.34.

(4) **Apply cartesian world base change.** The pullback of Proposition 8.5 gives (10.20), since global sections preserve that pullback. The quotient over $\underline{X}$ pulls back to q_W, which is a regular epimorphism by pullback stability. Iterated pullback comparisons supply naturality and coherence for further substitutions. The same argument applied to the accepted and authorized subobjects gives their world-indexed forms; no uncountable event-structure carrier is introduced.

(5) **Recover enabled action records.** The retained anchor includes the public final output and the actual recipient receptions by Construction 9.31. Hence their joint map on Ξ_W equalizes the kernel pair of $\Gamma(q_W)$. Its unique factorization and the regular image of its world-and-event pairing construct the original enabled action-event carrier as proved in Theorem 10.56. The completed and authorized policy domains follow by taking the images of their respective projections to Σ, as in Construction 5.77.

□

Theorem 10.56 (Canonical action-event image and updated epistemic lifting)**.** *In the world-indexed finite completed protocol of Theorem 10.55, the earlier witnessed action-event carrier U_W of Construction 10.46 is the regular image of a canonically constructed map from T_W. More precisely, there is a surjection $v_W : T_W \twoheadrightarrow U_W$ such that*

$$Q_W : \mathscr{F}_W \xrightarrow{q_W} \underline{T_W} \xrightarrow{v_W} \underline{U_W} \tag{10.21}$$

is a regular epimorphism of sheaves. If $o_i^+ : U_W \to O_i \times V_i$ is the already constructed updated observation, put $\beta_i = o_i^+ v_W$. Then

$$\ker(\beta_i) = (v_W \times v_W)^* \ker(o_i^+). \tag{10.22}$$

For every relation $R \hookrightarrow U_W^2$, including the individual and distributed updated observation relations, the source-fixed lift along Q_W is a regular epimorphism, and

$$Q_W^*[R]P = [(Q_W \times Q_W)^* R]Q_W^* P, \qquad Q_W^*\langle R\rangle P = \langle (Q_W \times Q_W)^* R\rangle Q_W^* P. \tag{10.23}$$

These comparisons preserve the finite-path common-knowledge relation, and are coherent under world substitution. The same construction applies to the completed accepted and issuer-authorized subcarriers, using their corresponding regular images.

Proof.

(1) **Descend the delivered-record map.** Let $\rho_W = \Gamma(q_W) : \Xi_W \twoheadrightarrow T_W$. Its surjectivity follows from the explicit extension of a completed anchored matching to the full interface. Let

$$\widetilde{d}_W = \langle d_0, (d_i)_{i\in N}\rangle : \Xi_W \longrightarrow V_0 \times \prod_i V_i$$

be the existing joint delivered-record map. The readout d_A explicitly retains its public and recipient restrictions, so $\widetilde{d}_W$ equalizes the kernel pair of ρ_W. By effective descent in **Set** (Proposition 5.38), there is a unique map $\bar{d}_W : T_W \to V_0 \times \prod_i V_i$ with $\widetilde{d}_W = \bar{d}_W \rho_W$.

(2) **Construct the original action-event image.** Factor $\bar{d}_W$ by regular image,

$$T_W \xrightarrow{e_W} E_W \hookrightarrow V_0 \times \prod_i V_i.$$

Since ρ_W is surjective, $E_W = \mathrm{im}(\widetilde{d}_W)$, exactly the event carrier of Construction 10.46. Let $w_T : T_W \to W$ be the source-world projection, and form $\langle w_T, e_W\rangle : T_W \to W \times E_W$. Its image equals the image of $\langle w_T, e_W\rangle \rho_W$, hence the previously constructed enabling subobject

$$U_W = \mathrm{im}\langle s, q\rangle \hookrightarrow W \times E_W.$$

Corestriction to that image constructs the surjection $v_W : T_W \twoheadrightarrow U_W$. The constant presheaf on the nonempty-cover site is a sheaf, so $\underline{v_W}$ is sectionwise surjective and therefore a regular epimorphism. Composing with q_W proves (10.21).

(3) **Recover the exact updated observation.** Define $\beta_i = o_i^+ v_W$, where $o_i^+(w, e) = (o_i(w), b_i(e))$ is the original world-and-receipt observation. Here b_i already includes the actual public receipt when public delivery is specified; for the canonical protocol its three-coordinate form is Proposition 10.48. Functoriality of kernel pairs under inverse image gives (10.22). Pullback preserves finite intersections, so the same equality holds for distributed knowledge. No original private observation is inferred solely from an event record.

(4) **Lift every alternative at its specified source.** For $R \hookrightarrow U_W^2$ put $\widetilde{R} = (Q_W \times Q_W)^* \underline{R}$. The comparison

$$\widetilde{R} \longrightarrow \mathscr{F}_W \times_{\underline{U_W}, p_1} \underline{R}$$

is the base change of the regular epimorphism Q_W along the target leg p_2. It is therefore a regular epimorphism and preserves the given source witness. Beck–Chevalley and the quantifier equations of Theorem 9.34 prove (10.23). For a finite path of updated epistemic steps, lift successive edges at their prescribed sources; conversely every lifted path projects. This establishes the common-knowledge comparison. Corollary 9.36 then transports the corresponding positive fixed-point tests.

(5) **Prove cartesian substitution and authorization.** For $t : W' \to W$, the completed-witness and retained-record families are pullbacks by (10.20). The surjective image $\langle s, q \rangle$ is stable under these cartesian pullbacks, so the enabled pair carrier satisfies the canonical identification $U_{W'} \cong W' \times_W U_W$ inside $W' \times E_W$. The separately constructed event-image carrier $E_{W'}$ may be a subobject of E_W; the enabling image is unchanged under that identification. Uniqueness of regular-image factorizations makes $v_{W'}$ the pullback of v_W up to this canonical comparison, and successive substitutions give the same identifications. Updated observations commute because $o'_i(w') = o_i(tw')$. Repeating the image construction on accepted or issuer-authorized completed histories proves the final assertion; the accepted and token predicates were already shown to be anchored pullbacks in Proposition 10.54.

□

The action-event enabling image is recovered from the retained completed witness record, without a separately stipulated epistemic relation.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathscr{F}_W & \xrightarrow{q_W} & \underline{T_W} \\ & \searrow^{Q_W} & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \underline{v_W}} \\ & & \underline{U_W} \end{array}$$

The world-indexed witness and retained-record maps are cartesian reindexings of the finite-input family.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathscr{F}_W & \xrightarrow{q_W} & \underline{T_W} \\ \downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow \\ \mathscr{F} & \xrightarrow[q^{\mathrm{fin}}]{} & \underline{T_{\mathrm{fin}}} \end{array}$$

Completion is a predicate on retained causal evidence, rather than a consequence of finding an arbitrary partial matching.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}} & \hookrightarrow & \mathscr{K}_A \\ {\scriptstyle q^{\mathrm{fin}}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle q} \\ \underline{T_{\mathrm{fin}}} & \hookrightarrow & \underline{T} \end{array}$$

Remark 10.57 (Independent proof-relevant certificates). An independently exhibited certificate carrier is not identified with an issuer-produced token. For an existing certificate map $c : K \to W_{\mathrm{prot}}$ and the existing completed-state map $v : \Xi_{\mathrm{in}} \to W_{\mathrm{prot}}$, form the pullback $K_{\mathrm{exec}} = K \times_{W_{\mathrm{prot}}} \Xi_{\mathrm{in}}$. Its projection to $\Xi_{\mathrm{in}} \cong \Gamma(\mathscr{F})$ transposes under $\underline{(-)} \dashv \Gamma$ to the sheaf map

$$\underline{K_{\mathrm{exec}}} \longrightarrow \mathscr{F}.$$

This preserves distinct certificate–execution pairs and their ordinary policy projections. A certificate which identifies only a protocol state does not, by itself, identify a unique issuer event. If a certificate predicate is specified directly on global completed histories, Proposition 10.54 gives its exact anchor-descent test. Taking the full interface as anchor always represents such a predicate, but need not retain a nontrivial localization. These are constructed comparisons of the existing certificate carrier, not additional certificate axioms.

Remark 10.58 (The completed boundary and finite termination). For finite causal decision protocols with the designated completed report, Theorem 10.5 computes the finished action assignment for each external input and complete policy. Authorization is a separate witnessed predicate and may hold for only some of those profiles. In other witnessed interactions a completion fibre may be empty; all the descent and lifting results then apply on the *image* of the completed-witness projection, not on unimplemented alternatives. The outcome and charge of a completed execution still descend to a coarser policy quotient exactly under the kernel-pair test of Proposition 5.50.

The protocols now supply the complete policies, completed execution witnesses, and received observations needed by epistemic update. We can therefore study disclosure as a strategic choice and compare its policy alternatives with the messages actually delivered.

11 Strategic Communication and the Creation of Knowledge

Once delivery has an operational witness, communication can itself be treated as an agent's controlled choice. We construct complete truthful message policies and compare them with the public messages they produce. The comparison must retain both the sender's unexecuted responses and the recipients' earlier observations; these determine the strategic and epistemic alternatives surrounding the current message.

At the completed-delivery boundary, the resulting maps transport the designated knowledge and coalition-ability tests. This connects information that a group possesses jointly with information its members can use after disclosure. The finite examples then evaluate two consequences: disclosure can remove an obstruction to joint performance, and policy evidence can enable an institutional authorization.

11.1 Public inspection and the disclosure of pooled information

The image in Construction 6.25 is a joint signal. Disclosing its value is an epistemic action that can be described simultaneously at every reference state. For observation relations $R_i = \ker(o_i)$ on W and a coalition C, write

$$R_C = \bigcap_{i \in C} R_i, \qquad \mathsf{DK}_C(P) = [R_C]P, \qquad \mathsf{CK}_C(P) = \left[\left(\bigcup_{i \in C} R_i \right)^* \right] P.$$

The first predicate is distributed knowledge. The second is common knowledge within C; for $C = N$ it is the previously defined CK. Empty intersection is W^2, while the reflexive transitive closure of the empty union is equality. These conventions also define both operations for the empty coalition.

Construction 11.1 (Public inspection of a signal)**.**

(1) **Construct the inspection update.** For $q : W \to O$, let $E = \mathrm{im}(q)$, enable precisely the pair $(w, q(w))$, and equip every agent's action set with equality. The updated carrier is canonically W and

$$R_i^q = R_i \cap \ker(q).$$

If $R_i = \ker(o_i)$, the updated observation is $\langle o_i, q \rangle$.

(2) **Restrict to the designated signal fibre.** At a designated world w, the component $q^{-1}(q(w))$ is the announcement of the observed value. This fibre is closed under all updated accessibility relations. Its inclusion is bounded, so Theorem 9.30 identifies its modal interpretation with that of the full-carrier update at w. Retaining every

possible outcome at once gives the full-carrier presentation of public inspection (van Eijck, Gattinger, and Wang, 2017).

Proposition 11.2 (Inspection is an idempotent coreflection)**.** *In the poset of relation families on a fixed carrier W, ordered by componentwise inclusion, let $\mathcal{R}_q$ be the subposet with $T_i \subseteq \ker(q)$ for every i. Its inclusion ι has right adjoint*

$$\mathsf{Inspect}_q(R)_i = R_i \cap \ker(q), \qquad \iota \dashv \mathsf{Inspect}_q.$$

Write $\mathsf{I}_q = \iota\mathsf{Inspect}_q$ for the associated idempotent comonad on the full relation poset. For two fixed signals q, r on W, these endofunctors satisfy

$$\mathsf{I}_r\mathsf{I}_q = \mathsf{I}_{\langle q,r\rangle} = \mathsf{I}_q\mathsf{I}_r.$$

These statements also hold in the poset of S5 relation families.

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** For $T \in \mathcal{R}_q$, $T \subseteq R$ if and only if $T \subseteq R \cap \ker(q)$. This is the adjunction. Its associated endofunctor I_q has counit $R \cap \ker(q) \subseteq R$ and is idempotent.

(2) **Predicate calculation.** The composition law follows from $\ker\langle q, r\rangle = \ker(q) \cap \ker(r)$. Meets preserve equivalence relations, proving the S5 version.

□

Theorem 11.3 (Public pooling turns distributed knowledge into common knowledge)**.** *Let $R_i = \ker(o_i)$ and let $C \subseteq N$ be nonempty. Form the image factorization of the tuple of coalition observations,*

$$W \xrightarrow{q_C} O_C \hookrightarrow \prod_{i\in C} O_i, \qquad R_C = \ker(q_C) = \bigcap_{i\in C} R_i.$$

After public inspection of q_C, the common-knowledge relation of all owners is exactly R_C. Consequently, for every fixed factual predicate $A \subseteq W$,

$$\mathsf{CK}_N^{q_C}(A) = \mathsf{DK}_C(A), \qquad \mathsf{DK}_C(A) := [R_C]A.$$

Proof.

(1) **Predicate calculation.** Each updated relation is $R_i^+ = R_i \cap R_C$. If $i \in C$ this is R_C; for other i it is contained in R_C. Since C is nonempty,

$$\bigcup_{i\in N} R_i^+ = R_C.$$

The relation R_C is an equivalence relation, hence equals its own reflexive transitive closure. Taking relational boxes proves the equation.

□

Corollary 11.4 (Private pooling within a coalition)**.** *Use the same event set and enabling relation, but take S_i to be equality for $i \in C$ and the universal relation for $i \notin C$. Then members have updated relation R_C and outsiders retain R_i. For fixed A, common knowledge within C after this update equals $\mathsf{DK}_C(A)$ before it.*

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Product update intersects member relations with $\ker(q_C)$ and leaves outsider relations unchanged. The union of the member relations is R_C.

□

This private construction is the resolution of distributed knowledge studied by Ågotnes and Wáng (2016). Public inspection additionally reveals the pooled value to outsiders. In both equations A is retained as a fixed subobject. An epistemic formula re-evaluated after the update may denote a different subobject; Remark 9.7 makes this explicit.

Proposition 11.5 (A connectivity obstruction for general signals)**.** *Let* $E = (\bigcup_i R_i)^*$ *and* $E^q = (\bigcup_i (R_i \cap \ker(q)))^*$. *Then*

$$E^q \subseteq E \cap \ker(q).$$

For the quotient $c : W \to W/E$, *there is a canonical surjection*

$$W/E^q \longrightarrow \mathrm{im}\langle c, q\rangle.$$

It is an isomorphism exactly when every nonempty intersection of an E*-class with a* q*-fibre is connected by the original* R_i*-edges that stay inside that intersection.*

Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** Every generating updated edge preserves both the E-class and q. Thus both are constant on E^q-classes. This gives the factor map, which is surjective because its target is the image.

(2) **Injectivity of the event quotient.** It is injective exactly when equality of those two retained values implies E^q relatedness. The definition of reflexive transitive closure identifies this with the stated connectivity condition.

□

Example 11.6. On $W = \{a, b, c\}$ let R_1 have classes $\{a, b\}, \{c\}$ and R_2 have classes $\{a\}, \{b, c\}$. Put $q(a) = q(c) = 0$ and $q(b) = 1$. Then $E = W^2$, but every updated individual relation is equality. Hence E^q is equality, whereas $E \cap \ker(q)$ still relates a to c. Common knowledge cannot generally be updated by intersecting the old common-knowledge relation with the signal kernel.

Construction 11.7 (Finite operational disclosure)**.**

(1) **Collect the observed tuple.** For the observation maps $o_i : W \to O_i$, take their image factorizations $W \twoheadrightarrow F_i \hookrightarrow O_i$. When these images are finite and C is nonempty, the collector and iterated data comultiplication form the strategy

$$\bigotimes_{i \in C} D(F_i) \xrightarrow{c_C} D\left(\prod_{i \in C} F_i\right) \xrightarrow{\Delta^{(N)}} \bigotimes_{j \in N} D\left(\prod_{i \in C} F_i\right).$$

The collector law of Proposition 1.29 sends the supplied value states to their tuple state.

(2) **Deliver the tuple.** The comonoid law of Proposition 1.26 places that tuple at every recipient's output. Equality of tuples has kernel R_C, so this realizes the disclosed signal of Theorem 11.3 on the supplied observation values.

(3) **Update the recipient observations.** Retaining each recipient's old observation gives the updated map $\langle o_j, q_C\rangle$. The collector waits for all coalition inputs; a decision that uses the disclosure is wired after the corresponding output occurrence.

The signal map identifies the information to be disclosed. The strategy exhibits the collecting and delivery events for those signals. A decision downstream can depend on the disclosure once the relevant delivery has occurred.

11.2 Agent-labelled truthful public actions

Construction 11.8 (The public announcement performed by an agent)**.**

(1) **Form the authored action interface.** Fix an observed agent presentation on W, with effective quotients $\bar{o}_j : W \twoheadrightarrow \Omega_j$. For a sender i, take the action set $E_i = \mathcal{P}(\Omega_i)$ and enable $B \in E_i$ at w precisely when $\bar{o}_i(w) \in B$. Every observer's action relation is equality on E_i.

(2) **Compute its content.** The content and updated carrier are

$$A_{i,B} = \bar{o}_i^{-1}(B), \qquad \mathcal{U}_i = \{(w, B) : w \in A_{i,B}\}.$$

The sender identity is part of the action interface.

(3) **Interpret the pointed announcement.** Write $\mathsf{say}_i(B)$ for the corresponding pointed public action. If $a_{i,B} : A_{i,B} \hookrightarrow W$ and $\jmath_{i,B} : A_{i,B} \to \mathcal{U}_i$ are the inclusion and $w \mapsto (w, B)$, its modalities are

$$[\mathsf{say}_i(B)]Q = \forall_{a_{i,B}} \jmath_{i,B}^* Q, \qquad \langle \mathsf{say}_i(B) \rangle Q = \exists_{a_{i,B}} \jmath_{i,B}^* Q.$$

Proposition 11.9 (Authored announcement and public restriction)**.** *The content $A_{i,B}$ is invariant under the sender's observation relation, so $K_i A_{i,B} = A_{i,B}$. The component of $\mathcal{U}_i$ at event B is isomorphic as an observed frame to $M|_{A_{i,B}}$. Consequently an agent-labelled announcement has exactly the public-restriction semantics of its content, with epistemic formulas evaluated in that restricted frame.*

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** If $\bar{o}_i(v) = \bar{o}_i(w)$, membership of that common value in B is the same at v and w. This proves observation invariance and the knowledge equation. The product-update relation at B is

$$(w, B) R_j^+ (v, B) \iff w R_j v \text{ and } w, v \in A_{i,B},$$

because the action relation is equality.

(2) **Isomorphism of restricted action models.** Thus $w \mapsto (w, B)$ is a frame isomorphism from the restriction onto that component, preserving the restricted factual terms. The displayed dynamic modalities are precisely the inclusion quantifiers of the public restriction. Frame isomorphism and the defining logical operations give the assertion for re-evaluated epistemic formulas and their fixed points.

□

This realizes a sender-labelled public test for the observation-invariant message family. Joint communication consists of one such component per owner, but its strategic interpretation requires complete policies specifying messages at every observation. We construct those carriers next.

Construction 11.10 (A public test as an institutional agent action)**.**

(1) **Supply the test and its owner.** For any predicate $P \hookrightarrow W$, form its characteristic term $\chi_P : W \to 2$ in the paper's ordinary base and corestrict it to $\Omega_P = \mathrm{im}(\chi_P)$. Extend the owner list by a fresh institutional identity $*$, retaining all original world observations. Give this agent observation $\chi_P : W \twoheadrightarrow \Omega_P$ and the truthful message interface $\mathcal{P}(\Omega_P)$.

(2) **Realize the truthful disclosure.** The complete policy $\eta_P(o) = \{o\}$ discloses the test result. Its successful public event is $B_P = \Omega_P \cap \{1\}$; if P is empty, that event has empty enabling carrier. The original agents publicly receive the disclosed result.

(3) **Factor the implementation.** The ordinary test and its concurrent realization have distinct types:

$$W \xrightarrow{\chi_P} 2, \qquad D(\Omega_P) \xrightarrow{\widehat{\chi}} D(2) \xrightarrow{\text{success gate}} D(1),$$

where $\chi : \Omega_P \to 2$ is the inclusion of the image of χ_P. The first arrow is the *specified ordinary signal input* and not an event-structure sensor inferred from an arbitrary predicate on W. The data strategy implements the second, finite-stage operation after that input is actually supplied.

Proposition 11.11 (Public comprehension realized by a test agent)**.** *The successful branch of this institutional action has enabling carrier P, and its frame on the original agent indices is exactly $M|_P$. Its dynamic modalities on retained predicates are the paper's public restriction modalities. The disclosure component has a finite concurrent realization, with its input supplied by the ordinary term χ_P.*

Proof.

(1) **Policy-level comparison.** The event B_P is enabled precisely when $\chi_P(w) \in \Omega_P \cap \{1\}$, equivalently $w \in P$. At such a world the complete policy η_P outputs exactly $B_P = \{1\}$; if no such world exists both enabling carriers are empty. Equality of public events restricts each original relation R_j to $P \times P$.

(2) **Predicate calculation.** Projection of the successful component to P is therefore a frame isomorphism for those indices and the retained factual terms. Its inclusion into W is the same comprehension map, proving both dynamic quantifier equations.

(3) **Observation and knowledge.** The observation image has at most two elements. Its singleton response and public broadcast are the finite data constructions of the operational semantics. The term χ_P supplies their ordinary reference input; the implementation realizes the finite disclosure interface.

(4) **Observation and knowledge: completion.** Predicate evaluation remains the ordinary semantic test that constructed χ_P. The original agents' pre-action observations are retained, and the extra institutional observation is explicitly part of this extended presentation.

□

The implementation records who sends the test, which result is delivered, and which event succeeds. Thus the logical update has an observable cause rather than an unexplained restriction of worlds. The finite disclosure protocol acts on the test-result interface; the underlying world remains an ordinary parameter.

11.3 The full truthful message family and coalition announcement games

A truthful public message is controlled by its sender, but its content is constrained by that sender's observation. Power objects and comprehension generate the entire semantic family of such messages. The coalition effectivity quantifiers then test whether a group can secure a post-announcement goal against truthful outsiders. This relates strategic control of disclosure to the joint-signal operation of Section 11.1.

Construction 11.12 (Truthful message families)**.**

(1) **Form the observed message carriers.** Let $M = (W, (\ker(o_i))_{i\in N})$. Factor each observation as $W \xrightarrow{\bar{o}_i} \Omega_i \hookrightarrow O_i$, where $\Omega_i = \mathrm{im}(o_i)$. Define the ordinary message object $\mathsf{Msg}_i = \mathcal{P}(\Omega_i)$ and its admissible fibre

$$\mathsf{Msg}_i(w) = \{B_i \subseteq \Omega_i : \bar{o}_i(w) \in B_i\}.$$

(2) **Interpret message contents.** The message B_i announces the predicate $A_i = \bar{o}_i^{-1}(B_i)$. This predicate is observation-invariant; when B_i is admissible at w, $K_i A_i(w)$ holds. Conversely every observation-invariant predicate is the inverse image of a unique subset of Ω_i, by Proposition 5.38.

(3) **Construct the updated model.** For $\mathsf{Msg} = \prod_i \mathsf{Msg}_i$ and $B \in \mathsf{Msg}$, put

$$A_B = \bigcap_i \bar{o}_i^{-1}(B_i), \qquad M_B = M|_{A_B}.$$

The updated carriers form the ordinary dependent family $\pi : \mathcal{U} = \{(B, v) : v \in A_B\} \to \mathsf{Msg}$. Its i-relation relates (B, v) and (B', v') precisely when $B = B'$ and $v \ker(o_i) v'$. Thus all epistemic operations in a fibre are those of M_B.

(4) **Specify goals and legal messages.** A goal is a specified subobject $\Psi \hookrightarrow \mathcal{U}$.

The legal message family over the reference state is

$$L = \{(w, B) : B_i \in \mathsf{Msg}_i(w) \text{ for all } i\} \longrightarrow W.$$

For $C \subseteq N$, let $L_C = \{(w, B_C) : B_i \in \mathsf{Msg}_i(w)\ (i \in C)\}$, and write $e_C : L \to L_C$ and $u_C : L_C \to W$ for the projections. These are the realizable coalition-coordinate objects in each fibre: every partial tuple has the canonical completion $B_j = \Omega_j$ for $j \notin C$. The map $g : L \to \mathcal{U}$, $(w, B) \mapsto (B, w)$, evaluates the goal in the announced context. Define

$$\mathsf{AnnAbility}_C(\Psi) = \exists_{u_C} \forall_{e_C} g^* \Psi \quad \in \mathsf{Pred}(W). \tag{11.1}$$

In particular, at w this asserts that some truthful coalition message tuple succeeds against every simultaneous truthful outsider tuple.

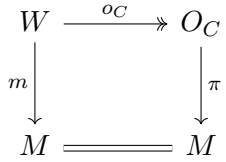
The construction uses power objects, products, projection, and comprehension. Equation (11.1) is the fibrewise instance of Equation (7.16); its quantifiers follow the coalition-announcement pattern. Standard announcement logics restrict messages to a specified epistemic syntax (Ågotnes et al., 2010; Galimullin and Alechina, 2018); our full semantic family instead contains all observation-invariant subobjects. Group announcement logics with distributed knowledge are discussed by Ågotnes, Alechina, and Galimullin (2022). The results below state their own factual-goal and full-family scope rather than identifying these different languages.

Theorem 11.13 (Exact announcement ability for factual common knowledge)**.** *For $P \subseteq W$, let $P^+ = \{(B, v) \in \mathcal{U} : v \in P\}$ and take $\Psi_P = \mathsf{CK}_N^{\mathcal{U}}(P^+)$, using the fibre-preserving relations of Construction 11.12. For every nonempty coalition C,*

$$\mathsf{AnnAbility}_C(\Psi_P) = \mathsf{DK}_C(P). \tag{11.2}$$

The sufficient coalition policy is the uniform observation-admissible map $o \mapsto \{o\}$ for each member. For $C = \varnothing$, $\mathsf{AnnAbility}_\varnothing(\Psi_P) = \mathsf{CK}_N^M(P)$.

A truthful announcement is represented as an informed section over the observation quotient.



Proof.

(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At $w \in \mathsf{DK}_C(P)$, let every member announce $B_i = \{\bar{o}_i(w)\}$. For every admissible outsider tuple,

$$w \in A_B \subseteq R_C[w] \subseteq P.$$

The fact therefore holds throughout the updated carrier and is common knowledge there. Each chosen message is a function of the owner's observation alone, proving uniform observation-admissibility by Proposition 6.2.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, let a coalition tuple establish the displayed common knowledge against every outsider tuple. Take $B_j = \Omega_j$ for outsiders. Truthfulness and observation invariance give $R_C[w] \subseteq A_B$.

(3) **Observation and knowledge.** For any $i \in C$, each $v \in R_C[w]$ is R_i-accessible from w inside A_B. Common knowledge in this updated model therefore gives $v \in P$. This is $\mathsf{DK}_C(P)(w)$.

(4) **Ownerwise alternatives.** For the empty coalition, the outsider tuple of all tautological messages leaves the original model unchanged, proving necessity.

(5) **Reverse implication.** Conversely every path in a restriction containing w is an original path. Hence common knowledge of the fixed fact is preserved under all these restrictions. For $N = \varnothing$, the common-knowledge relation is equality and the same argument gives the predicate P.

□

Proposition 11.14 (Finite message realizations)**.** *When all observation images Ω_i are finite, the full message objects, singleton disclosure maps, and truthfulness tests in Construction 11.12 have finite data realizations.*

Proof.

(1) **Message-policy and membership protocols.** Each $\mathcal{P}(\Omega_i)$ is finite. The map $\Omega_i \to \mathcal{P}(\Omega_i)$, $o \mapsto \{o\}$, and the membership function $\Omega_i \times \mathcal{P}(\Omega_i) \to 2$ have response strategies by Proposition 1.23. Collectors form joint messages, and the data comonoids broadcast them.

(2) **Observation and knowledge.** The public enabling subobject is the conjunction of the membership tests, so its finite presentation is Construction 9.19 on these signal and message carriers. Observational distinctions on an arbitrary original state carrier remain in the ordinary dependent family over that carrier.

□

The construction specifies a full semantic message family. A chosen communication language is represented by its own message object and content map; its effectivity is then obtained by the same dependent quantifiers. The equality in Theorem 11.13 is established for the constructed full family, whose singleton policy is explicitly available.

11.4 Complete truthful policies of communicating agents

A current message is one value of a communication policy. Strategic comparison requires its other values too: they specify what the sender would disclose at a different observation. Following the contingent announcements of Ågotnes and van Ditmarsch (2011), we retain the full truthful response family and compare policy evaluation with the current public message. The comparison also retains private policy records and execution witnesses. It applies to the observation-invariant message family constructed above; restricting the message language changes the available responses.

Construction 11.15 (The complete truthful announcement interface)**.**

(1) **Form complete truthful policies.** Use the effective observation images and message carriers of Construction 11.12. Define

$$\mathsf{AnnPol}_i = \prod_{o\in\Omega_i} \{B \subseteq \Omega_i : o \in B\}, \qquad \mathsf{AnnPol} = \prod_{i\in N} \mathsf{AnnPol}_i.$$

A policy π_i is a truthful message response at every possible observation, including observations different from the current one. It is an ordinary subobject of $\mathsf{Msg}_i^{\Omega_i}$.

(2) **Evaluate at the current observation.** Its evaluation is

$$e_i : \Omega_i \times \mathsf{AnnPol}_i \to \mathsf{Msg}_i, \qquad e_i(o, \pi_i) = \pi_i(o).$$

At w, the legal output of the agent is $\pi_i(\bar{o}_i(w))$. The agent's policy carrier is AnnPol_i, with its canonical selection interface; a goal or comparison is connected to the resulting message or updated state as in the preceding agent calculus.

Lemma 11.16 (Explicit extension of a truthful message)**.** *For every $o \in \Omega_i$, the evaluation map*

$$e_{i,o} : \mathsf{AnnPol}_i \twoheadrightarrow \{B \subseteq \Omega_i : o \in B\}$$

has the explicit section $B \mapsto E_{i,B}$, where

$$E_{i,B}(x) = B \cup \{x\}.$$

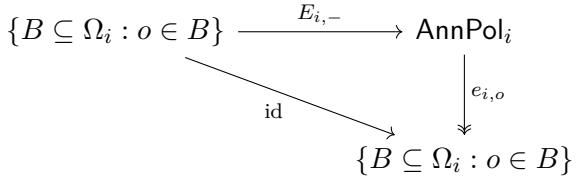
In particular every legal message at w is the current output of an exhibited complete truthful policy.

Proof.

(1) **Split evaluation of public messages.** Every value of $E_{i,B}$ contains x, so the function belongs to AnnPol_i. Since $o \in B$, evaluation at o is $E_{i,B}(o) = B \cup \{o\} = B$. Hence $e_{i,o}(E_{i,B}) = B$. The formula is defined for every indicated pair and uses no choice of a representative.

□

Truthful messages extend to complete policies that evaluate to the chosen message at the given observation.



Construction 11.17 (The policy-state model of public communication)**.**

(1) **Form policy states and their message map.** Put $\mathcal{X} = W \times \mathsf{AnnPol}$ and define the joint evaluation

$$b(w, \pi) = (\pi_i(\bar{o}_i(w)))_{i \in N}.$$

The map to the paper's public-message carrier, retaining its original coordinate order, is

$$F : \mathcal{X} \to \mathcal{U}, \qquad F(w, \pi) = (b(w, \pi), w).$$

(2) **Update the observations.** Give agent j the pre-communication observation $\widetilde{o}_j^0(w, \pi) = (\bar{o}_j(w), \pi_j)$. Use the public action set Msg with equality as every action relation and enabling predicate $B = b(w, \pi)$. Its updated carrier is canonically $\mathcal{X}$, since each source has exactly one enabled joint message. Its post-communication observation is

$$\widetilde{o}_j(w, \pi) = (\bar{o}_j(w), \pi_j, b(w, \pi)), \qquad R_j^{\mathcal{X}} = \ker(\widetilde{o}_j).$$

Thus each agent retains its own complete policy, its original observation, and the delivered public messages. This is an explicit product-update instance of the earlier action-model construction.

(3) **Define strategic alternatives.** The strategic relations hold the reference world fixed:

$$(w, \pi) D_C^{\mathcal{X}} (v, \pi') \iff w = v \text{ and } \pi_{-C} = \pi'_{-C},$$
$$(B, w) D_C^{\mathcal{U}} (B', v) \iff w = v \text{ and } B_{-C} = B'_{-C}.$$

The latter are the legal message deviations in each fibre over W.

Theorem 11.18 (Exact policy-to-message comparison)**.** *The map $F : \mathcal{X} \to \mathcal{U}$ is a split surjection and a bounded morphism for every individual epistemic relation, every nonempty intersection of those relations, and every coalition-deviation relation. More explicitly, for $\varnothing \neq J \subseteq N$ it is bounded from $\bigcap_{j \in J} R_j^{\mathcal{X}}$ to $\bigcap_{j \in J} R_j^{\mathcal{U}}$, and for every $C \subseteq N$ it is bounded from $D_C^{\mathcal{X}}$ to $D_C^{\mathcal{U}}$.*

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** A section sends $(B, w) \in \mathcal{U}$ to

$$(w, (E_{i,B_i})_{i \in N}).$$

It is well-defined by truthfulness of B at w and is a section by Lemma 11.16. This includes the empty owner list, when both carriers are canonically W.

(2) **Observation and knowledge.** Forward preservation of the epistemic relations follows from their observations: equality of $\widetilde{o}_j$ implies equality of the original j-observation and of the public tuple. For the back condition, let $x = (w, \pi)$ and suppose

$$F(x)\Big(\bigcap_{j \in J} R_j^{\mathcal{U}}\Big)(B, v), \qquad J \neq \varnothing.$$

Then $B = b(w, \pi)$ and $\bar{o}_j(v) = \bar{o}_j(w)$ for every $j \in J$.

(3) **Construction on policy coordinates.** Define a profile at v by

$$\pi'_j = \pi_j \quad (j \in J), \qquad \pi'_k = E_{k,B_k} \quad (k \notin J).$$

For a retained coordinate, $\pi_j(\bar{o}_j(v)) = \pi_j(\bar{o}_j(w)) = B_j$; for every other coordinate the extension lemma gives the same output. Hence $F(v, \pi') = (B, v)$. For each $j \in J$ the old observation, its own policy, and the public tuple are unchanged, so $x R_j^{\mathcal{X}} (v, \pi')$.

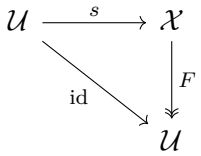
(4) **Lifting intersections along the report map.** This proves the simultaneous back condition and, in particular, its individual case. For an empty intersection the universal relation has the same lifting property by surjectivity alone.

(5) **Ownerwise alternatives.** For strategic relations, retaining the outsider policies at fixed w retains their evaluated messages, which proves the forward clause. Suppose $F(w,\pi)D_C^{\mathcal{U}}(B',w)$. Keep $\pi'_j = \pi_j$ for $j \notin C$ and set $\pi'_i = E_{i,B'_i}$ for $i \in C$.

(6) **Ownerwise alternatives: completion.** The outsider outputs are already B'_{-C}, and the changed outputs are B'_C by the extension lemma. Therefore $F(w,\pi') = (B',w)$ and $(w,\pi)D_C^{\mathcal{X}}(w,\pi')$. This proves the back clause for every coalition, including the empty and grand coalitions.

□

The complete-policy comparison is a split surjection with an explicit section.



Lemma 11.19 (Dependent successor-fibre exactness of truthful communication)**.** *For each nonempty observer set $J \subseteq N$, write $K_J = \bigcap_{j\in J} R_j$ for the joint epistemic relation; for each coalition $C \subseteq N$, retain D_C for strategic deviations. For either $R = K_J$ or $R = D_C$, with the corresponding superscripts $\mathcal{X}$ and $\mathcal{U}$, the canonical map of dependent successor families*

$$\lambda_R : R^{\mathcal{X}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{X} \times_{\mathcal{U},p_1} R^{\mathcal{U}}, \qquad (x,x') \longmapsto (x,(Fx,Fx'))$$

is surjective. Consequently for every $Q \hookrightarrow \mathcal{U}$,

$$F^*[R^{\mathcal{U}}]Q = [R^{\mathcal{X}}]F^*Q, \qquad F^*\langle R^{\mathcal{U}}\rangle Q = \langle R^{\mathcal{X}}\rangle F^*Q.$$

The same statement for an empty epistemic intersection follows from the split surjection F.

Proof.

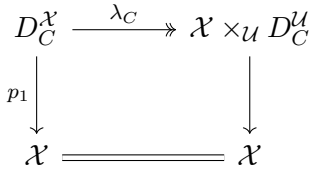
(1) **Fibrewise calculation.** At a fixed $x \in \mathcal{X}$, a point of the displayed pullback is a specified $R^{\mathcal{U}}$-successor of Fx. The epistemic and strategic back-lifts constructed in Theorem 11.18 provide an $R^{\mathcal{X}}$-successor of that very x mapping to it. Thus each fibre of λ_R is inhabited, which is surjectivity in **Set**.

(2) **Predicate calculation.** Forward preservation ensures well-definedness. The source and target existential successor predicates therefore agree on inverse-image tests. Their universal successor predicates agree as well: a target test is true on every successor if and only if its pullback is true on every source successor, because the successor map is onto.

(3) **Modal preservation for empty coalitions.** This proves both displayed modal equations. For an empty epistemic intersection the relation is universal; the split surjection supplies the requisite lift from any fixed source state.

□

Alternative lifting is performed over the fixed policy reference.



Corollary 11.20 (Knowledge, strategic predicates, and dynamic transport)**.** *For predicates and comparisons retained on $\mathcal{U}$, inverse image along F preserves the individual knowledge, distributed knowledge, common-knowledge, coalition-deviation, and positive modal fixed-point operations. It preserves and reflects validity. For a comparison $Q_i \hookrightarrow \mathcal{U}^2$, use $(F \times F)^* Q_i$ on $\mathcal{X}^2$. The Nash predicates defined using the displayed deviation relations satisfy*

$$\mathsf{NE}_{\mathcal{X}} = F^* \mathsf{NE}_{\mathcal{U}},$$

and the corresponding strict coalitional stability predicates satisfy the same equality. Public restrictions by retained assertions and action models pulled back from $\mathcal{U}$ have the same exact dynamic comparison.

Proof.

(1) **Communication and delivery.** The explicit comparison $\lambda_R : R^{\mathcal{X}} \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{X} \times_{\mathcal{U}, p_1} R^{\mathcal{U}}$ of Lemma 11.19 gives the two inverse-image equations

$$F^*[R^{\mathcal{U}}]Q = [R^{\mathcal{X}}]F^*Q, \qquad F^*\langle R^{\mathcal{U}}\rangle Q = \langle R^{\mathcal{X}}\rangle F^*Q.$$

Here the source reference is not chosen afresh: it is fixed in the pullback, and every target successor lifts over that same reference.

(2) **Lifting through the comparison.** Theorem 9.30 proves the positive fixed-point comparison. The intersection lifting in the theorem supplies the distributed knowledge case directly. Common knowledge uses the same individual relations and its previously constructed greatest fixed point.

(3) **Fibrewise calculation.** At a source x, every concrete i-deviation maps to a target deviation with comparison $Q_i(Fx, Fx')$, and every target deviation lifts at that same source. Universal absence of improving alternatives is therefore equivalent on the two carriers. For a coalition use its lifting clause and the specified collective comparison; conjunction over coalitions gives the claimed stability equality.

(4) **Base-change comparison.** For $V \hookrightarrow \mathcal{U}$, the restriction $F^{-1}(V) \to V$ is surjective. A lift of an alternative in V belongs to $F^{-1}(V)$ by its image, so it remains bounded. Comprehension and Beck–Chevalley give the public-restriction comparison.

(5) **Lifting along the surjection.** For a pulled-back action model apply Corollary 9.27. Surjectivity reflects validity in each case.

□

The retained language has its predicates on $\mathcal{U}$, pulled back to $\mathcal{X}$. Predicates concerning additional private policy records are also available on $\mathcal{X}$ and remain attached to that presentation. The comparison theorem relates the specified interfaces and their retained tests; it keeps the whole policy family needed to lift alternatives.

Example 11.21 (A public policy record carries additional information)**.** Take two worlds $0, 1$. Agent 1 observes the world, while agent 2 has one observation. The truthful policy $\pi_1(0) = \{0, 1\}$, $\pi_1(1) = \{1\}$ sends the tautological message at 0. Its content alone leaves both

worlds possible to agent 2. If the complete policy π_1 is also publicly delivered, observing that message identifies world 0. In the policy-state model of Construction 11.17, only agent 1 retains its own policy as a private record. At world 1 the alternative policy $E_{1,\{0,1\}}$ gives the same public message, supplying the lift required for agent 2. The example exhibits the informational effect of an additional policy-record wire and explains the role of the full policy family in F.

11.5 Concurrent implementation and retained policy witnesses

Proposition 11.22 (Concurrent realization of complete announcing agents)**.** *When the observation images Ω_i are finite, the complete truthful policy presentation and its post-communication observations have an implementation in* $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$*. Its complete owner policy carriers are* AnnPol_i*. At reference input $(\bar{o}_i(w))_i$ and policy profile π, its delivered observation to agent j is*

$$(\bar{o}_j(w), \pi_j, b(w, \pi)).$$

The report decisions are concurrent, and the joint message is delivered after its component messages are collected.

Proof.

(1) **Realization of announcement policies.** Each $\mathsf{Msg}_i = \mathcal{P}(\Omega_i)$ and AnnPol_i is finite. Restrict the decision generator $\mathsf{Dec}_i(\Omega_i, \mathsf{Msg}_i)$ along the exhibited inclusion

$$\mathsf{AnnPol}_i \hookrightarrow \mathsf{Msg}_i^{\Omega_i}.$$

It realizes policy π_i by the response strategy $\widehat{\pi}_i$. Tensor these components and apply the finite collector to their message outputs.

(2) **Broadcast of the joint report.** The resulting joint output is $b(w, \pi)$. Broadcast this output using the iterated data comonoid, one copy for each agent.

(3) **Observation and knowledge.** Copy the original input observation to its reporting component and its owner's retained-observation wire. For a private policy record, use the singly owned nullary decision generator with response carrier AnnPol_i; at a fixed policy it realizes the constant $\ulcorner \pi_i \urcorner : I \to D(\mathsf{AnnPol}_i)$, using the nullary collector and the response from 1.

(4) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Compose these two occurrences of owner i and reparametrize their product carrier by the diagonal assigning the same π_i to the reporting and record components. This is a permitted ownerwise reparametrization in the generated calculus. It leaves exactly AnnPol_i as the complete policy carrier.

(5) **Collection of observation outputs.** Finally collect, at each owner's output, its retained observation, private policy record, and public tuple. The full boundaries can be taken as

$$A_{\mathrm{ann}} = \bigotimes_i D(\Omega_i), \qquad B_{\mathrm{ann}} = \bigotimes_j D(\Omega_j \times \mathsf{AnnPol}_j \times \mathsf{Msg}).$$

Every component is a decision generator, nonstrategic data wiring, or an exhibited parameter reindexing, so the process lies in $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$.

(6) **Causal execution.** Evaluating each response and collector gives the displayed record. The reporting components are tensored; the message collector is their explicit delivery barrier. Coherence and scheduling independence follow from Theorem 10.5.

(7) **Observation and knowledge.** The original carrier W remains an ordinary reference index: its tuple of observations supplies the finite input, so no finite realization of W is required.

□

Construction 11.23 (Policy witnesses over a public message state)**.**

(1) **Form the fibre of policy witnesses.** For $u \in \mathcal{U}$ retain the ordinary dependent family

$$K_u = F^{-1}(u).$$

Its total carrier has the canonical bijection

$$\coprod_{u \in \mathcal{U}} K_u \cong \mathcal{X}, \qquad (u, x) \longmapsto x,$$

whose inverse is $x \mapsto (F(x), x)$.

(2) **Realize a witness.** In the finite realization, let $g_{\mathrm{ann}} : \mathsf{AnnPol} \to \mathcal{C}(A_{\mathrm{ann}}, B_{\mathrm{ann}})$ be the process just constructed. Associate to $x = (w, \pi) \in K_u$ the realized arrow $g_{\mathrm{ann}}(\pi)$. This is a witness realization of Construction 8.1; its dependent linear transpose exists by the ordinary–linear adjunction.

(3) **Recover the policy record.** The family retains every implementing policy and its private records, while F gives the exact logical comparison on retained message tests. Reconstructing its total carrier recovers all of $\mathcal{X}$ and the attached realizations.

11.6 Coalition ability through complete communication policies

Theorem 11.24 (Complete-policy announcement ability)**.** *For every goal $\Psi \hookrightarrow \mathcal{U}$ and coalition $C \subseteq N$,*

$$\mathsf{AnnAbility}_C(\Psi)(w) \iff \exists \pi_C \in \prod_{i \in C} \mathsf{AnnPol}_i \; \forall \pi_{-C} \in \prod_{j \notin C} \mathsf{AnnPol}_j \; \Psi(F(w, (\pi_C, \pi_{-C}))).$$

This is the paper's pointwise effectivity predicate, expressed through the complete policy interfaces of the announcing agents.

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** If B_C is a winning legal coalition message at w, choose the explicit policies E_{i,B_i} for its members. Every outsider policy evaluates to a legal outsider message, so every resulting joint message satisfies Ψ.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, let π_C satisfy the right-hand side and let $B_C = (\pi_i(\bar{o}_i(w)))_{i \in C}$. Given any legal outsider tuple B_{-C}, extend it by $\pi_j = E_{j,B_j}$ for $j \notin C$. The resulting policy tuple evaluates to (B_C, B_{-C}), so that legal joint message satisfies Ψ.

(3) **Monoidal comparison.** This is exactly the fibrewise existential–universal quantifier defining $\mathsf{AnnAbility}_C$. The formulas also cover empty products.

□

Corollary 11.25 (Uniform disclosure by complete agent policies)**.** *For $P \hookrightarrow W$, put $\Psi_P = \mathsf{CK}_N^{\mathcal{U}}(P^+)$ as in Theorem 11.13. For every nonempty coalition C, define the fixed complete policies*

$$\eta_i(o) = \{o\} \quad (i \in C).$$

Then, at every w,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{DK}_C(P)(w) &\iff \forall \pi_{-C}\ \Psi_P(F(w, (\eta_C, \pi_{-C}))) \\ &\iff \exists \pi_C\ \forall \pi_{-C}\ \Psi_P(F(w, (\pi_C, \pi_{-C}))). \end{aligned}$$

The same η_C is used at every world. For $C = \varnothing$, complete-policy announcement ability for this goal is $\mathsf{CK}_N^M(P)$.

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** If $R_C[w] \subseteq P$, singleton coalition messages give $w \in A_B \subseteq R_C[w] \subseteq P$ against every truthful outsider output. Hence the fixed fact holds throughout the updated carrier and is common knowledge.

(2) **Comparison of existential witnesses.** This proves the first implication with the exhibited complete policies. Those policies are a particular existential witness, giving the second implication.

(3) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, take any successful complete coalition policies and give each outsider the constant tautological policy $o \mapsto \Omega_j$. At w their joint output B satisfies $R_C[w] \subseteq A_B$ by truthfulness of the coalition messages. For $i \in C$, every $v \in R_C[w]$ is R_i-accessible from w inside that updated carrier.

(4) **Observation and knowledge.** Common knowledge of P^+ gives $v \in P$, so $R_C[w] \subseteq P$. This proves the converse.

(5) **Observation and knowledge: second comparison.** For the empty coalition, tautological outsider policies leave the original model unchanged and establish necessity of original common knowledge.

(6) **Reverse implication.** Conversely every path in a public restriction containing w is an original path, so a fixed fact that was common knowledge remains common knowledge. If N is empty, the common-knowledge relation is equality and the same statement reduces to P.

□

The general ability predicate in Theorem 11.24 is evaluated pointwise at w. For the factual common-knowledge goal, the corollary constructs a stronger witness: one coalition policy independent of w that succeeds at every world satisfying distributed knowledge. The distinction is between a response chosen at the current reference and a single complete policy valid throughout the specified information class.

11.7 Messages change observations

To turn a delivered message into epistemic information, the state carrier must retain enough evidence to identify what was sent. Let X contain the reference world, the complete policy profile, and any execution witness determining $m : X \to M$. A recipient j keeps its previous observation and receives the message through the updated observation map below.

$$o_j^+(x) = (o_j(x), m(x)), \qquad R_j^+ = R_j \cap \ker(m).$$

For deterministic private delivery, each recipient's event observation b_i records the delivered value, whereas a nonrecipient's b_i is constant on event labels. Outsiders therefore keep their prior relations. Public delivery makes the event relation equality for every recipient. These are instances of (9.19)–(9.20). In finite sessions, the retained transcript of Theorem 10.41 determines the message m, while its recipient projection specifies exactly which part of the transcript enters a particular agent's observation.

An endpoint type specifies which messages a recipient may receive next. The enabling predicate tests whether the proposition carried by a message holds at the source world. A correctly ordered exchange therefore supplies evidence of reception. The additional predicate is what licenses the inference from reception to truthful disclosure.

11.7.1 Disclosure removes an obstruction to joint performance

The observation update can change which decentralized responses exist, even when ownership and the outcome criterion stay fixed. The following finite team game evaluates that change using the policy carriers and section construction of Theorems 7.20 and 7.23. The parity pattern is the binary contextuality pattern studied by Abramsky and Brandenburger (2011); here it specifies a joint task for two communicating owners.

Construction 11.26 (A binary team task before and after disclosure)**.**

(1) **Specify the observations and decisions.** Let $W = \{0,1\}^2$, with $o_1(x,y) = x$ and $o_2(x,y) = y$. The complete policies are functions $a, b : \{0,1\} \to \{0,1\}$, and all policy pairs are institutionally permitted. Successful joint response at (x,y) means

$$a(x) \oplus b(y) = xy.$$

This success relation is a performance target, not a restriction removing unsuccessful profiles from the strategic carrier.

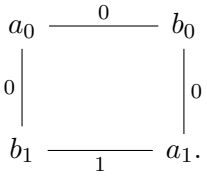
(2) **Evaluate complete policies.** Give both owners the same numerical profile value

$$u_1(a,b) = u_2(a,b) = U(a,b) = \frac{1}{4} \sum_{x,y \in \{0,1\}} \mathbf{1}_{\{a(x) \oplus b(y) = xy\}}.$$

This is a specified score on the four input situations. The sheaf construction does not supply the weights. Every entry of a complete policy contributes to this evaluation, including entries not used at one chosen world.

(3) **Deliver one input before the second decision.** Truthful delivery of x to owner 2 changes its observation to $o_2^+(x,y) = (x,y)$. It leaves owner 1's observation unchanged. The new policies are $a : \{0,1\} \to \{0,1\}$ and $b : \{0,1\}^2 \to \{0,1\}$, evaluated by the same success score. The finite causal implementation delivers the bit before owner 2's response, as in Lemma 11.29; the comparison is at the completed-delivery boundary.

The coarse decision graph is the four-cycle below. An edge label c requires the sum of its endpoint bits to equal c in $\mathbb{F}_2$. The sum of the four labels is one.



Theorem 11.27 (Information obstruction, welfare, and equilibrium)**.** *Before disclosure, the task in Construction 11.26 has no perfect decentralized implementation. Of its sixteen policy profiles, eight have common payoff* $3/4$ *and eight have common payoff* $1/4$*. Its Nash equilibria are exactly the eight profiles with payoff* $3/4$*.*

After disclosure there are sixty-four policy profiles and exactly four Nash equilibria. They are precisely

$$b(x, y) = a(x) \oplus xy,$$

with the two entries of a *chosen freely; all have common payoff one. The affine obstruction vanishes after the observation refinement.*

Proof.

(1) **Compute the obstruction.** On the four-cycle let $s = (a_0, a_1, b_0, b_1)$ and $c_{xy} = xy$ in $\mathbb{F}_2$. Perfect success is $ds = c$. Every ds has even edge parity, whereas c has odd parity. Hence $[c] \neq 0$, and Theorem 7.23 excludes a perfect implementation.

(2) **Count the coarse policies.** The error vector is $ds + c$. The image of d is the eight even-parity edge vectors; each has two preimages, differing by global bit complementation. There are four error vectors of weight one and four of weight three. Thus eight policies have three successes and eight have one success.

(3) **Identify every coarse equilibrium.** Every three-success profile is globally optimal, hence Nash. At a one-success profile one row of the two-by-two input table contains two errors. Owner 1 flips its single decision entry for that row, correcting both errors and strictly increasing the common score. Consequently none of the remaining profiles is Nash.

(4) **Construct every fine implementation.** The refined decision vertices are a_x and b_{xy}, with one edge from a_x to each b_{xy}. This graph is the disjoint union of two stars. Choose a_0, a_1 freely and solve each edge equation for b_{xy}. The resulting four policies are precisely the perfect ones. The forest has no first cohomology, in agreement with the pullback calculation of Proposition 7.24.

(5) **Identify every fine equilibrium.** There are $2^2 \cdot 2^4 = 64$ profiles. At any imperfect profile, owner 2 can correct one erroneous b_{xy} entry while leaving all other entries unchanged. This is a whole-owner policy alternative increasing the score by $1/4$. Hence only perfect profiles are Nash, and global optimality proves that all four are.

□

After disclosure the comparisons form two trees. Forgetting the delivered input sends b_{xy} to b_y and keeps a_x fixed, recovering the coarse graph while preserving every edge label.

$$b_{00} \overset{0}{\text{———}} a_0 \overset{0}{\text{———}} b_{01}$$

$$b_{10} \overset{0}{\text{———}} a_1 \overset{1}{\text{———}} b_{11}.$$

Corollary 11.28 (The value and price of the fixed disclosure architecture)**.** *If the disclosed architecture deducts a common constant fee* κ *from each owner's payoff, its Nash equilibria remain the four perfect policies and their common net payoff is* $1 - \kappa$*. This exceeds the undisclosed equilibrium payoff exactly when* $\kappa < 1/4$*. In the displayed deterministic task, zero communication cannot give perfect success, while one binary message suffices.*

Proof.

(1) **Compare net gains.** Subtracting the same constant at every profile changes no within-architecture deviation gain. Apply Theorem 11.27 and compare $1 - \kappa$ with $3/4$.

(2) **Compare communication requirements.** With no message, the nonzero parity class excludes a perfect policy. Sending x realizes the four displayed perfect policies, so one bit is both necessary and sufficient in worst-case message length for this task.

□

This is an equilibrium and payoff comparison of two specified information architectures. An endogenous purchase of the channel would add controlled choices and their deviations; that adoption game is not identified with the comparison above. Both architectures are common-interest games with exact potential U. Thus an information obstruction can constrain welfare even when the gain-integration obstruction of Theorem 13.8 vanishes.

11.8 Pooling and collective knowledge

Let $q_C : W \twoheadrightarrow O_C$ be the effective joint signal of a nonempty coalition. In the finite protocol of Lemma 11.29, a public delivery uses $J = N$ and a private delivery to the coalition uses $J = C$. At the *completed execution boundary*, the state carrier is the graph of the deterministic completed transcript, canonically isomorphic to W. A designated recipient's new observation is the pair of its earlier observation and the actually received tuple. Thus for public delivery $R_i^+ = R_i \cap \ker(q_C)$ for every owner; private pooling makes that same change for members of C and leaves outsiders' individual relations unchanged. These statements concern the completed state carrier, not an intermediate configuration where some recipients have not yet received the value.

Lemma 11.29 (Physical completed-delivery boundary)**.** *Let $C \neq \varnothing$ be finite with finite effective observation carriers Ω_i, and let J be the designated recipient set. Put $T_C = \prod_{i \in C} \Omega_i$. The previously constructed true-concurrent data strategies give a receptive courteous arrow*

$$\bigotimes_{i \in C} D(\Omega_i) \longrightarrow D(T_C)$$

with a final visible tuple record. In its secured interaction witness before hiding*, the final record causally follows each recipient's reception of the tuple, while distinct recipients' reception events remain unordered. After hiding, the external input events remain causal predecessors of the final output. At supplied observations the final value is $\widetilde{q}_C(w) = (o_i(w))_{i \in C}$; its effective observation quotient is the image $W \twoheadrightarrow O_C \hookrightarrow T_C$.*

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** First use the finite collector c_C to form the tuple from the independent observation inputs. Apply the designated data comonoid to supply one copy to each recipient and retain one for the final output. The recipient j is connected to the receptive response strategy $\widehat{!} : D(T_C) \to D(1)$ for the unique function $! : T_C \to 1$.

(2) **Observation and knowledge: second comparison.** Its negative tuple input is the recipient's actual reception event; its positive acknowledgement follows that input. Collect the retained tuple and all the acknowledgements with

$$c_{T_C,(1)_{j \in J}} : D(T_C) \otimes \bigotimes_{j \in J} D(1) \longrightarrow D(T_C \times 1^J),$$

and then apply the response for the projection $T_C \times 1^J \to T_C$. The empty recipient case uses the nullary product $1^{\varnothing} = 1$.

(3) **Observation and knowledge.** To verify the actual causal claim, inspect the secured interaction *before hiding*. Write e_i for original input occurrences, r_j for each matched recipient reception, a_j for its acknowledgement, and f for the final record.

(4) **Observation and knowledge: second comparison.** The collector and copying dependencies followed by acknowledgement and final collection supply, for every $i \in C$ and $j \in J$,

$$e_i < r_j < a_j < f.$$

There is no path from r_j to r_k or conversely for distinct recipients: the copies share predecessors, but their only later common dependency is the final collector output. The causal graph progresses from original inputs through collection, copying, acknowledgements, and the final output.

(5) **Secured operational interaction.** It contains no directed cycle; every matching used is therefore secured. The components are receptive courteous, and their secured composite is receptive courteous by the closure theorem of Section 1.

(6) **Observation and knowledge.** Upon hiding the internal copy, reception, and acknowledgement events, the induced visible causal order still contains $e_i < f$ for every i, but the internal receptions themselves are recorded by the completed secured witness, not by events in the hidden composite. Data copying, collectors, and functoriality of the finite response maps ensure that the visible label is exactly the input tuple.

(7) **Quotient for pooled observation.** Image factorization of the tuple map on worlds gives O_C, without selecting a retraction of its inclusion into T_C.

□

Theorem 11.30 (Communication realizes pooled information)**.** *For a fixed factual predicate $P \subseteq W$, public inspection satisfies*

$$\mathsf{CK}_N^+ P = \mathsf{DK}_C P.$$

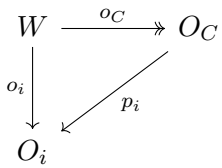
Private pooling satisfies $\mathsf{CK}_C^+ P = \mathsf{DK}_C P$ and leaves each outsider's individual relation unchanged.

Proof.

(1) **Identify the completed observations.** The physical boundary of Lemma 11.29 realizes the effective signal q_C, with each designated recipient retaining its earlier observation and the delivered tuple. Its completed relations are therefore exactly those of Theorem 11.3 and Corollary 11.4. Applying their common-knowledge equations proves both statements.

□

Follow either delivery path at completion. Each designated recipient can recover the same joint signal from its own observation.



Lemma 11.29 supplies the physical finite implementation and its completion witness. The final collector is a barrier for completed delivery, while the independent recipient events remain unordered. The member policies can then use the actual delivered tuple. Owner regrouping separately exposes their combined control; composition coherence for the policy parameters and data wiring makes the two operations compatible. At intermediate asynchronous histories, knowledge must be evaluated on the corresponding history-indexed observations determined by the actual communication history.

11.9 Complete truthful communication policies in the agent calculus

The complete response type and the policy-to-message comparison of Constructions 11.15 and 11.17 have the following ordinary-family expressions in the agent calculus:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathsf{AnnPol}_i &= \prod_{z\in\Omega_i} \{B \subseteq \Omega_i : z \in B\},\\ X &= W \times \prod_i \mathsf{AnnPol}_i,\\ U &= \{(B,w) : \forall i\ \bar{o}_i(w) \in B_i\}.\end{aligned}$$

Evaluation is $F(w,\pi) = (b(w,\pi), w)$. The post-communication observations are $o_j^X(w,\pi) = (\bar{o}_j(w), \pi_j, b(w,\pi))$ and $o_j^U(B,w) = (\bar{o}_j(w), B)$. Each sender retains its own complete policy as a private record, and deviations keep the world and outsider policy coordinates fixed.

For enumerated finite observations the message power set has the ordinary finite function type 2^{Ω_i}, with $2 = 1 + 1$. The complete truthful policy carrier is represented by

$$\prod_{z:\Omega_i} \sum_{b:2^{\Omega_i}} \mathrm{Id}_2(b(z), 1).$$

Finite enumeration, equality, and membership give the displayed policy semantics. For infinite sets, $\mathcal{P}(\Omega_i)$ denotes the power set in the set-based semantics.

The canonical extension $E_{i,B}(x) = B \cup \{x\}$ from Lemma 11.16 gives the section $(B,w) \mapsto (w, (E_{i,B_i})_i)$ of F. The source-fixed epistemic and outsider-preserving strategic lifts of Theorem 11.18 therefore apply to these dependent types. Corollary 11.20 supplies their modal, fixed-point, dynamic, and equilibrium comparisons, including $\mathsf{NE}_X = F^*\mathsf{NE}_U$ for comparisons pulled back from U.

11.9.1 Concurrent implementation and coalition announcement ability

For finite Ω_i, the implementation of Proposition 11.22 realizes the internal families above by decision generators, policy reparametrization, collectors, and data copying. At (w,π) the delivered observation to owner j is $(\bar{o}_j(w), \pi_j, b(w,\pi))$. The reporting decisions are concurrent, and the joint public delivery follows their collection. The possibly infinite reference carrier W remains an ordinary index; the physical interfaces encode the displayed finite observations.

For a goal $\Psi \subseteq U$, coalition announcement ability at w is the existence of a truthful coalition message tuple that achieves Ψ against every truthful outsider tuple. The extension lemma gives exactly

$$\mathsf{AnnCan}_C(\Psi)(w) \iff \exists \pi_C\ \forall \pi_{-C}\ \Psi(F(w,(\pi_C,\pi_{-C}))). \tag{11.3}$$

Indeed, extend any winning coalition message explicitly to policies; every outsider policy evaluates to a legal outsider message. Conversely extend each possible outsider message while retaining the proposed coalition policies. These two constructions prove both implications.

Theorem 11.31 (Uniform disclosure of distributed knowledge)**.** *For nonempty C and a fixed factual predicate $P \subseteq W$, let $P^+(B, w) = P(w)$ and $\eta_i(z) = \{z\}$. Then*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{DK}_C P(w) &\iff \forall \pi_{-C}\, \mathsf{CK}_N^U(P^+)(F(w, (\eta_C, \pi_{-C}))) \\ &\iff \exists \pi_C\, \forall \pi_{-C}\, \mathsf{CK}_N^U(P^+)(F(w, (\pi_C, \pi_{-C}))). \end{aligned}$$

The same complete disclosure policies η_C work at every world.

Proof.

(1) **Evaluate the canonical disclosure policies.** The truthful policies $\eta_i(z) = \{z\}$ are the uniform witnesses constructed in Corollary 11.25. The evaluation comparison of Theorem 11.18 identifies its message semantics with the displayed complete-policy formula, proving both equivalences with the same policies at every world.

□

Policy evaluation retains the underlying world while updating public messages.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathcal{X} & \xrightarrow{F} & \mathcal{U} \\ {\scriptstyle \pi_W}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_W} \\ W & = & W \end{array}$$

For measured communication, Theorem 11.18 applies to the same designated epistemic and strategic relations. If a profile comparison is pulled back from the public message carrier, each forward image and back-lift has identical truth value for that test. Hence the stability equivalence applies, for example to a fee computed from the public message. A fee computed from a private policy register may vary within an evaluation fibre. Test the value (or the paired comparison) for descent as in Proposition 5.50. For a fee that distinguishes such points, retain the relevant record and use the exact refinement of Theorem 12.33 with the specified relations before transporting its tests.

11.10 Choices, disclosure, and the price of authorization

Return to the two private bits x, y and the complete policy carriers $\Sigma_i = 2^2$ of the introduction. A policy profile specifies the functions π_1, π_2 independently of the current world, and at $w = (x, y)$ its response realization produces the action tuple

$$(a, b) = (\pi_1(x), \pi_2(y)).$$

Example 11.32 (The two-bit multiplayer arena)**.** The arena of Construction 10.8 has events

$$x_\epsilon, \quad y_\eta, \quad a_{\epsilon,\alpha}, \quad b_{\eta,\beta} \qquad (\epsilon, \eta, \alpha, \beta \in \{0, 1\}),$$

with $x_\epsilon < a_{\epsilon,\alpha}$ and $y_\eta < b_{\eta,\beta}$. Histories with incompatible values conflict. There are 12 events and 49 configurations: each independent two-node chain has one empty assignment, two input-only assignments, and four completed assignments. The complete strategy spaces remain $\Sigma_1 = \Sigma_2 = 2^2$. For each world and complete profile, Theorem 10.14 gives exactly the action tuple displayed above.

At $(x, y) = (0, 0)$, the profiles $((1, 0), (1, 0))$ and $((1, 1), (1, 0))$, writing each policy as its values at $0, 1$, both play $(1, 1)$. Only the first satisfies $\pi_1(1) \leq \pi_2(1)$. The legal domain is therefore not a predicate of the played actions alone. The complete strategy record retains the distinction, and the policy-entry inspection in Section 11.12 delivers its evidence to the checker.

The legal coupling $\pi_1(1) \leq \pi_2(1)$ has 12 profiles: for the entries at observation 1 it allows $(0,0),(0,1),(1,1)$, while both observation-0 responses vary freely. At the world $w = (0,0)$, let π_1^0 and π_2^0 be the constant-zero policies. The reference (π_1^0, π_2^0) is legal and yields $u_1 = u_2 = 0$. Holding either outsider policy fixed at zero, a change of the current action from 0 to 1 gives the deviator payoff -1; changes only at the off-path observation 1 give payoff 0. Thus there is no strictly profitable unilateral legal deviation at this reference. By contrast, the joint deviation to policies $\pi_i^*(0) = 1$, $\pi_i^*(1) = 0$ is legal and yields the action tuple $(1,1)$, with both utilities equal to 1. This calculates the unilateral and grand-coalition deviation fibres using the same owner-indexed complete-policy space. It also illustrates why changing two decisions under one regrouped owner requires a whole-block deviation test.

Initially each owner sees only its own bit, while the joint image distinguishes the pair. A collector receives both signals and delivers the tuple to the two owners. Theorem 11.30 identifies facts about (x,y) that thereby become common knowledge. For example, put $P = \{(0,0),(1,1)\} \hookrightarrow W$, the assertion $x = y$. Before delivery, $\ker(o_1) \cap \ker(o_2)$ is equality on W, so $\mathsf{DK}_{\{1,2\}}P(0,0)$ holds; but the union of the two observation relations connects all four worlds, so $\mathsf{CK}(P)(0,0)$ fails. After both owners actually receive (x,y), each updated observation is injective and $\mathsf{CK}^+(P) = P$. In particular, $\mathsf{CK}^+(P)(0,0)$ holds. This equality is asserted only at the completed-delivery boundary, not while either copy of the public tuple remains in transit. The recipients' new response policies may depend on the delivered pair; the exact enlargement is given by Propositions 7.60 and 7.60.

To measure one specified link of this collector, give weight 1 to the synchronization of its tuple output with the chosen recipient's input, and weight 0 to every other class. On a completed delivery witness the selected send and its matched receive form one class, so $m(k) = 1$ in $\mathbb{N}$. A budget $m \leq 1$ admits that witness and $m \leq 0$ excludes it. After hiding the link, its internal occurrences no longer appear at the exterior boundary; the retained matching still exhibits the charge. With the cost-insensitive comparison above the action payoffs remain 0 and 1 at the two displayed profiles. A priced evaluation can instead use $v_i = u_i - \eta(\lambda_i m_i)$ on the measured records, with natural counts embedded in R_+. On alternatives that all incur this fixed fee, its deduction is the same on both sides of each comparison. A contingent fee gives a different equilibrium calculation.

Example 11.33 (The price of institutional authorization)**.**

(1) **Complete both branches.** At $w = (0,0)$ use the legal profile domain L. Retain the completed accept/reject bit of the finite checker in Section 11.12. In the accepting branch forward the authorization and acknowledge its receipt; in the rejecting branch return a completed rejection record. The result interface thus records a completed decision also on rejection. Give weight one to the designated matched authorization and zero to the remaining classes. With current actions a, b the measured record is $(ab, (a,b))$, since the accepting branch occurs precisely at $(1,1)$.

(2) **Evaluate and compare.** At common nonnegative rational price λ, the two owner evaluations of this record are $(2ab - a - \lambda ab,\ 2ab - b - \lambda ab)$. They give

(a,b)	m	$(\bar{v}_1, \bar{v}_2)$
$(0,0)$	0	$(0,0)$
$(1,0)$	0	$(-1,0)$
$(0,1)$	0	$(0,-1)$
$(1,1)$	1	$(1-\lambda, 1-\lambda)$.

(3) **Count complete legal equilibria.** At observation zero each owner can change its present action while keeping its entry at one fixed. At $(0,0)$ a unilateral contribution

loses one; at either off-diagonal profile the contributor gains by withdrawing. At $(1,1)$ withdrawal yields zero, so $(1,1)$ is Nash exactly for $\lambda \leq 1$. For each current action pair the off-path entries range over the three pairs $(0,0),(0,1),(1,1)$ allowed by L. There are six legal Nash profiles for $\lambda \leq 1$ and three for $\lambda > 1$. Moving jointly from $(0,0)$ to $(1,1)$ strictly improves both payoffs precisely for $\lambda < 1$. At equality the distinction is a tie in each owner's writer-evaluated comparison.

Regroup the owners to form one control interface while retaining their individual comparisons; a chosen collective comparison then evaluates joint decisions. Let the institution record their messages and commitment. Its execution witness retains the policy profile and transcript, its target map records the commitment, and its permitted subobject enforces the rule. The token-guarded executor of Lemma 10.26 receives an actual issuer-produced authorization event. Final execution depends causally on that event; the bare type $D(1)$ does not certify the token's authority. Composition of witnessed spans and of their concurrent realizations now describes the institutional transaction. A public announcement of the commitment is a further information-changing action.

11.11 A concrete finite check of linearity and information

The finite-data barrier can be tested on two independent bits. The collector $c : D(2) \otimes D(2) \to D(2 \times 2)$ waits for both; the distributor $d : D(2 \times 2) \to D(2) \otimes D(2)$ sends the completed pair. Although $cd = \mathrm{id}$ on the paired interface, dc is not the identity on two independent channels: each output inherits both input prerequisites. The distinction is operational, not merely one of value types.

Initially the two observation kernel pairs R_1 and R_2 distinguish the first and second bit, respectively. Their intersection is equality on the four possible worlds, so private pooling makes facts about the entire pair common knowledge once delivery is complete. For a material resource R, this logical change does not supply a linear contraction $R \to R \otimes R$. The example thereby separates information sharing from resource duplication.

11.12 Which evidence enables the authorization gate?

Return to the oversight question from the introduction. The two owners observe x and y privately. The issuer must decide whether their present actions and the relevant entries of their policies permit execution. On the legal domain, let K be the carrier of accepted completed executions

$$K = \{(x, y, \pi_1, \pi_2) \in W \times L : \pi_1(x) = 1 \ \wedge \ \pi_2(y) = 1\}.$$

Its projection to the full institutional record retains the source world and complete owner-policy profile. On the legal input domain $W \times L$, let $r_L(w, \pi) = (\pi_1(x), \pi_2(y))$. Then $K = r_L^{-1}\{(1,1)\}$. A collector followed by the finite success gate for $(1,1)$ issues the authorization event t exactly on K.

There is also an issuer on the ambient input domain $W \times \Sigma$. For each owner i, pair its current response component with the nullary response whose output is $\pi_i(1)$. Reparametrize ownerwise by $\pi_i \mapsto (\pi_i, (* \mapsto \pi_i(1)))$, as in the policy-record construction of Proposition 11.22. Route the two current actions and the two additional bits to the issuer. The resulting ordinary value map and acceptance set are

$$d(w, \pi) = (a, b, c_1, c_2) = (\pi_1(x), \pi_2(y), \pi_1(1), \pi_2(1)),$$
$$B = \{(a, b, c_1, c_2) \in 2^4 : a = b = 1, \ c_1 \leq c_2\}.$$

The collector, the finite test for B, and the success gate form a receptive courteous issuer. The definitions give $d^{-1}(B) = K$ by the rules for L and r_L, with $W \times L$ included in $W \times \Sigma$. Only the checker receives the two extra bits. To see what the extra entries establish, take $(x, y) = (0, 0)$ and write each policy in observation order. The profiles $((1, 0), (1, 0))$ and $((1, 1), (1, 0))$ both produce $(1, 1)$, yet only the first belongs to L. Consequently a checker restricted to the current action tuple cannot recognize K throughout the ambient domain.

Why local legality and secured evidence differ. The owner-scope cover by $\{1\}$ and $\{2\}$ has the matching object Σ, whereas the institution's legal domain is the proper subobject L of size 12, by Example 7.5. This is a failure of *policy-scope* descent, not a failure of causal secured matching: the checker is allowed to receive joint evidence.

For the two additional policy entries, the existing finite-data strategies exhibit the concrete causal test

$$D(2) \otimes D(2) \xrightarrow{c_{2,2}} D(2 \times 2) \xrightarrow{\widehat{q}} D(2), \qquad q(c_1, c_2) = 1 \iff c_1 \leq c_2.$$

Its two input occurrences remain independent, but the verdict event follows both. The complete checker already incorporates the two current actions through the four-ary collector and the acceptance predicate B. For the final execution, the receptive courteous guard $\gamma : D(2) \to D(1)$ accepts either Boolean input but produces its positive execution event only after input 1. All added dependencies are negative-to-positive. Hence $\gamma\widehat{q}c_{2,2}$ is an exhibited concurrent authorization component, while the four-ary implementation enforces the complete condition $d \in B$. The secured witness of the issued token, rather than the type $D(1)$ alone, supplies the certificate used by the executor.

The sheaf of Section 10.5 localizes these actual secured records before hiding; its anchored retained quotient preserves the selected knowledge and institutional tests at the completed boundary by Theorem 9.34. In particular, independent local policy extendability is not substituted for the checker's joint predicate.

The executor supplies a second check on the design. Its final event e requires receipt of the issuer's token, giving $t < e$ in the completed witness. The legal joint policy (π_1^*, π_2^*) at $(0, 0)$ belongs to K and exhibits such an execution. The type $D(1)$ specifies the token interface. To establish that the issuer actually produced t for this execution, follow the causal predecessors in the witness. The checker thus has evidence for its decision, and the executor has evidence that the decision reached it.

From completed communication to continuing agency. A completed exchange now supports two later decisions. Recipients may base a new response on the joint signal they received, and the executor may use its token for the guarded action. To analyze a subsequent round we must know which signals and permissions persist and which actions remain enabled. The residual strategy and the remaining policy supply the two parts of that continuation.

Part V
Continuing agency and exactness

12 Continuing Agents and Temporal Agency

The completed interactions now provide a starting point for further action. We construct continuing agency by retaining two residuals. A residual policy specifies future responses to

observations; a residual strategy records the interactions still enabled after an execution history. The former generates the controller and determines its minimum reachable state count in the finite case. The latter supports temporal ability and tests whether a visible abstraction preserves the available moves. Fixed points express progress and persistence, while finite public trees allow continuation equilibria to be computed at the charge inherited along each history.

12.1 Fixed points in assertion fibres and their transport

Temporal goals use the universal fixed predicates already constructed in Construction 5.23. An initial algebra gives the least predicate closed under a progress step; a terminal coalgebra gives the greatest predicate preserved by a continuation step. Thus their use here derives from the assertion fibres. The adjoint comparison of Lemma 5.25 transports them along the witnessed successor relations of Theorem 9.30.

12.2 Residual strategies and continuing agents

To interpret action after a history, we must retain both the strategy's remaining event structure and the owner's contingent responses at later decision positions. Pointed residuals provide the operational data. Restriction of a complete policy gives the corresponding future response family, while epistemic action models record information from actually completed rounds. The resulting continuation interface connects temporal objectives to the same control and observation data already used for one-stage agency.

Each completed public round can be read as an enabled epistemic action event from Section 9.1.3. Its state map records the concurrent transition, while its observation records the information actually delivered at completion. Intermediate histories remain represented by operational configurations. Thus successive public updates do not impose a total schedule on events that were independent within a round.

A continuing state can carry commitments or goals as ordinary records. Their persistence, discharge, and revision require explicit update maps; current preference selection alone does not determine such transitions. This is the point of contact with intention accounts such as Cohen and Levesque (1990). Here continued agency is established for the displayed record and residual operations rather than by assigning an intention law to every strategy.

12.2.1 Complete policies and their residual controllers

Two observation histories can share a controller state if they prescribe the same response to every possible future observation word. Thus the memory needed to implement a complete local policy is measured by the number of distinct remaining response functions. The coalgebraic construction, in the sense of Rutten (2000), makes this count exact. After each input the controller emits the prescribed action and moves to the state representing the policy that remains.

Definition 12.1 (Local response controller)**.** For a sequential local observation interface O and action interface M, a controller is a coalgebra

$$\delta : S \longrightarrow (M \times S)^{O}.$$

Write $\delta(s)(o) = (a(s,o), n(s,o))$. A controller map $f : S \to S'$ preserves both components: $a'(f(s),o) = a(s,o)$ and $n'(f(s),o) = f(n(s,o))$. A pointed controller also specifies its initial state s_0.

Let O^+ and O^* denote nonempty and arbitrary finite words, respectively. A complete local policy is an element $b \in \mathcal{B} = M^{O^+}$: its value at a word is the action after the final observation of that word. Set

$$\zeta : \mathcal{B} \to (M \times \mathcal{B})^O, \qquad \zeta(b)(o) = (b(o), b_o), \qquad b_o(v) = b(ov).$$

Theorem 12.2 (Final behaviour and the generated residual controller)**.** *The coalgebra $(\mathcal{B}, \zeta)$ is final. For a complete policy b, put*

$$b_u(v) = b(uv) \quad (u \in O^*,\ v \in O^+), \qquad S_b = \{b_u : u \in O^*\} \subseteq \mathcal{B}.$$

It is a pointed subcoalgebra with initial state $b = b_\varnothing$. Every pointed controller implementing b has a unique surjective pointed controller map from its reachable states onto S_b. Consequently b has a finite-state implementation if and only if S_b is finite. In that case $|S_b|$ is the least possible number of reachable states of an implementation.

A map of controllers must preserve two things at each observed input. Reading either way around the square gives the same action and corresponding successor state.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} S & \xrightarrow{\ \zeta\ } & F(S) \\ {\scriptstyle f}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle Ff} \\ T & \xrightarrow[\ \theta\ ]{} & F(T) \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Fixed-point argument.** For a controller δ, define its behaviour recursively by

$$\mathrm{beh}_\delta(s)(o) = a(s, o), \qquad \mathrm{beh}_\delta(s)(ov) = \mathrm{beh}_\delta(n(s, o))(v) \quad (v \in O^+).$$

Induction on word length defines a unique function $S \to M^{O^+}$. The two equations assert exactly that this function is a coalgebra map into $(\mathcal{B}, \zeta)$.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, every such map must satisfy those equations; induction proves uniqueness. This proves finality, including empty carriers whenever the displayed coalgebra exists.

(3) **Closure of controller derivatives.** For a derivative b_u, its output on o is $b(uo)$ and its next behaviour is b_{uo}, which lies in S_b. Hence restriction of ζ is well defined. Its behaviour map is its inclusion in $\mathcal{B}$, by the same recursion.

(4) **Construction of the comparison.** Let δ with initial state s_0 implement b, so that $\mathrm{beh}_\delta(s_0) = b$. Define $s_\varnothing = s_0$ and $s_{uo} = n(s_u, o)$. The reachable carrier is $\{s_u : u \in O^*\}$.

(5) **Lifting along the surjection.** Induction gives $\mathrm{beh}_\delta(s_u) = b_u$. The restricted behaviour map therefore lands in S_b, is surjective, and preserves initial state, outputs, and transitions. A pointed controller map must send s_u to b_u by induction on u, so it is unique, even when several words reach the same state.

(6) **Verification of the universal property.** Surjectivity implies that a finite reachable implementation has finite S_b and at least its cardinality. Conversely, finite S_b is itself a pointed implementation with that many states.

□

The residual controller remembers exactly the distinctions needed for future local input–output behaviour. A permission, a preference, or a private observation may distinguish states with identical future responses. To use the controller quotient for one of those purposes, the corresponding test must also agree on the merged states.

Proposition 12.3 (Concurrent realization of a finite controller step)**.** *For finite S, O, M, the uncurried response function $\delta : S \times O \to M \times S$ has the one-step realization*

$$D(S) \otimes D(O) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{col}} D(S \times O) \xrightarrow{\widehat{\delta}} D(M \times S) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{dist}} D(M) \otimes D(S).$$

Connecting the returned state to the next local step realizes, for every finite observation word, the output sequence of the pointed controller. If the controller implements b, its final output on a nonempty word u is $b(u)$.

Proof.

(1) **Fixed-point argument.** The finite-data collector and distributor and Proposition 1.23 realize the displayed ordinary function on value inputs. Thus the value pair (s, o) yields exactly $(a(s, o), n(s, o))$. Induction on the number of connected steps shows that the state after u is s_u and that the output at its last step is $\mathrm{beh}_\delta(s_0)(u)$.

(2) **Observation and knowledge.** The implementation equation makes this $b(u)$. Each finite composite is an arrow of the existing concurrent semantics. The collector waits for the local state and observation; its synchronization is part of that arrow and is not an isomorphism identifying $D(S \times O)$ with $D(S) \otimes D(O)$.

□

The words used in the controller are sequential observations at one specified local interface. Concurrent events belonging to other interfaces retain their own partial orders, so the implementation does not choose a global interleaving. The constructed realization covers each finite connected segment, not an unspecified recursive process beyond the declared local protocol.

Petri games provide another setting for causally informed strategies of distributed processes (Finkbeiner and Olderog, 2017). The comparison here concerns implementation: which complete local policies have controllers respecting the observation available at each step? The residual coalgebra answers that question without conflating global concurrency with the chosen local sequence of observations.

12.2.2 Maintaining and eventually achieving collective goals

Residual policies describe how an owner responds after a history. To express a temporal objective, we must additionally test which successor states a coalition can secure. Iterating this ability operator yields the least predicate for reaching a goal and the greatest predicate for maintaining one. Their induction and coinduction principles follow from the universal fixed-point construction.

Definition 12.4 (Public states, histories, and winning regions)**.** For the finite public-state interaction specified below, let W be the set of publicly observed round states, $A_i(w)$ the finite nonempty set of agent i's available actions at w, and $\delta_w : \prod_i A_i(w) \to W$ its deterministic transition. The **history carrier** is the set of finite legal histories

$$\mathsf{Hist} = \coprod_{n \geq 0} \{(w_0, a^0, w_1, \ldots, a^{n-1}, w_n) : \delta_{w_k}(a^k) = w_{k+1} \ (k < n)\},$$

with last : $\mathsf{Hist} \to W$. A **history-dependent pure policy** of owner i is a section of the pulled-back action bundle, equivalently a family $\pi_i(h) \in A_i(\mathrm{last}(h))$ for every $h \in \mathsf{Hist}$. Let Play be the carrier of infinite legal transition-consistent action/state sequences. For initial w and a complete policy profile π, deterministic recursion gives $\mathrm{play}(w, \pi) \in \mathsf{Play}$. For a **temporal objective** $\Phi \hookrightarrow \mathsf{Play}$, the **winning region** of coalition C is

$$\mathrm{Win}_C(\Phi) = \{w \in W : \exists \pi_C \ \forall \pi_{-C},\ \mathrm{play}(w, \pi_C, \pi_{-C}) \in \Phi\} \hookrightarrow W.$$

All agents observe the completed public history, not their opponents' current simultaneous choices. The predecessor construction below derives this ability using dependent action bundles.

Temporal ability requires more than one-stage effectivity: a coalition must choose at successive public histories while outsiders may respond at each stage. The predecessor operator uses dependent quantifiers in the existing predicate doctrine. The ordinary classical **Set** instance supplies the duality between failed coalition ability and a counterpolicy, expressed by $\neg\exists a_C \, \forall a_{-C} P \Rightarrow \forall a_C \, \exists a_{-C} \, \neg P$. The fixed-point construction below retains the quantifier order when moving from one round to repeated play.

Construction 12.5 (Finite public-state interaction and controllable predecessor)**.**

(1) **Specify the public interaction.** A finite public-state interaction has a finite state set W, a finite nonempty action set $A_i(w)$ for each agent at each state, and a transition function

$$\delta_w : \prod_i A_i(w) \to W.$$

Players observe the finite public history before each simultaneous round.

(2) **Form complete history policies.** A coalition policy assigns its action tuple to each such history. Opponents have policies of the same kind. This is an economic policy space in the preceding sense; one round is a causal decision protocol with concurrent action inputs and a deterministic transition rule. Finite prefixes are obtained by composition of these rounds, retaining the current state as the interface.

(3) **Display the state projections.** To expose the categorical structure when action sets depend on the current state, form the action bundles

$$E_C = \{(w, a_C) : a_C \in \prod_{i \in C} A_i(w)\},$$
$$E = \{(w, a_C, a_{-C}) : a_i \in A_i(w) \text{ for all } i\}.$$

Let

$$E \xrightarrow{\pi_C} E_C \xrightarrow{\pi_W} W$$

forget first the outsider actions and then the coalition actions, and let $\delta : E \to W$ be the transition map.

(4) **Construct the controllable predecessor.** For a state predicate X, define

$$\mathrm{Pre}_C(X) = \exists_{\pi_W} \, \forall_{\pi_C} \, \delta^* X. \tag{12.1}$$

Pointwise this is exactly

$$\mathrm{Pre}_C(X)(w) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \exists a_C \ \forall a_{-C},\ X(\delta_w(a_C, a_{-C})).$$

The operator is monotone. It is the state-indexed version of Equation (7.17) and is constructed entirely from reindexing and the two quantifier adjoints of the assertion doctrine.

Proposition 12.6 (Epistemic product update of a public concurrent round)**.** *For the finite public-state interaction above, let the action-occurrence set be the disjoint union*

$$E^{\mathrm{round}} = \coprod_{w \in W} \prod_{i} A_i(w),$$

so an occurrence is a tagged pair (w, a). Give it enabling predicate $P(u, (w, a)) \iff u = w$. Take equality as the prior public-state relation and as the action relation representing the publicly revealed completed tuple. Then its product-update carrier is canonically the original joint-action bundle E used to define Equation (12.1), with the transition postcondition

$$t(u, (u, a)) = \delta_u(a).$$

Under this identification the controllable predecessor is $\exists_{\pi_W} \forall_{\pi_C} t^* X$. This action-model presentation uses a completed joint action as one public update, while the underlying operational realization uses the independent concurrent choice events and the collector's synchronization barrier.

Proof.

(1) **Monoidal comparison.** Comprehension consists precisely of the pairs $(u, (u, a))$, so forgetting the redundant first copy of u is a bijection with the original action bundle E. Both action and old-state relations are equality, hence their restricted product is equality on the updated carrier. The postcondition is the original transition map.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The quantifier expression is Equation (12.1) under the carrier bijection. The circuit of Theorem 10.5 realizes each action tuple by independent owner-controlled response protocols, followed by the finite collector and transition response; no causal order between simultaneous decisions is added.

□

Definition 12.7 (Temporal objectives)**.** Let Play be the carrier of infinite legal plays $\lambda = (w_0, a^0, w_1, a^1, \ldots)$ of the public-state interaction. For state predicates $P, Q \hookrightarrow W$, define the play predicates

$$\begin{aligned} [\![P \,\mathsf{U}\, Q]\!] &= \{\lambda : \exists n \in \mathbb{N},\ w_n \in Q \ \wedge\ \forall k < n\ (w_k \in P)\}, \\ [\![\mathsf{G}P]\!] &= \{\lambda : \forall n \in \mathbb{N},\ w_n \in P\}. \end{aligned}$$

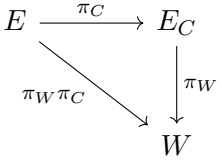
The first requires reaching Q after finitely many rounds while maintaining P beforehand; the second requires P at every state. The coalition-enforcement predicate for either objective is $\mathrm{Win}_C([\![\cdot]\!]) \hookrightarrow W$ of Definition 12.4, quantifying one coalition policy against every outsider policy.

Theorem 12.8 (Temporal ability and fixed points)**.** *For a finite public-state interaction,*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Win}_C(P \,\mathsf{U}\, Q) &= \mu X\,(Q \cup (P \cap \mathrm{Pre}_C(X))), \\ \mathrm{Win}_C(\mathsf{G}P) &= \nu X\,(P \cap \mathrm{Pre}_C(X)). \end{aligned}$$

Every state in either winning set has a policy depending only on the current state. For the until objective, the construction also gives a finite bound on the time to reach Q.

The coalition chooses first in the logical test. A state belongs to the controllable predecessor when one coalition action sends every outsider response into the target set.



Proof.

(1) **Fixed-point argument.** For until, iterate $X_0 = \varnothing$ and $X_{n+1} = Q \cup (P \cap \mathrm{Pre}_C(X_n))$. Because W is finite this increasing sequence reaches its least fixed point L after finitely many steps. Give each state in L its least positive index of entry.

(2) **Witness and legality comparison.** States of index 1 lie in Q. At every other state take an action tuple witnessing predecessor membership in the preceding stage. There are only finitely many such states, so these finitely many witnesses assemble by finite recursion into a state-dependent coalition policy.

(3) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Against every outsider action it moves to a state of smaller index. Until Q is reached, the current state lies in P. The index decreases at each step, so this state-dependent policy reaches Q in fewer steps than the starting index.

(4) **Ownerwise alternatives: second comparison.** To prove the converse, fix any coalition policy at a state outside L. Such a state is not in Q. If it is outside P, the objective has already failed.

(5) **Fibrewise calculation.** At a state in $P \setminus L$, fixed-point equality implies $w \notin \mathrm{Pre}_C(L)$. Expanding the predecessor quantifiers and using the classical finite specialization fixed above gives

$$\forall a_C \; \exists a_{-C}, \qquad \delta_w(a_C, a_{-C}) \notin L.$$

For the finitely many state/action pairs, assemble one such outsider response for each pair by finite recursion.

(6) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Against the fixed coalition policy, this gives an outsider policy on public histories: evaluate that fixed policy at the history and use the selected response. It keeps the play outside L until P is left, if that happens. The play never reaches Q; in either case the until objective fails. Thus no state outside L is winning.

(7) **Policy-level comparison.** For safety let $S = \nu X(P \cap \mathrm{Pre}_C(X))$. For the finitely many states in S, assemble predecessor witnesses that stay in S into a state-dependent policy by finite recursion. Since $S \subseteq P$, this policy enforces safety.

(8) **Reverse implication.** Conversely let Y be the set of states from which some policy enforces safety. At $w \in Y$, the first coalition action must send every outsider completion to another state of Y. Indeed the winning continuation after that first history, with its prefix fixed as a parameter, is a valid policy from the successor state.

(9) **Coinduction and bisimulation.** Also $w \in P$. Hence $Y \subseteq P \cap \mathrm{Pre}_C(Y)$. Coinduction gives $Y \subseteq S$ and proves the converse.

□

The counterpolicy constructed in the until argument responds to a fixed coalition policy: the conclusion is $\forall\sigma_C \exists\sigma_{-C}$, not $\exists\sigma_{-C} \forall\sigma_C$. Both policies use completed public histories as inputs. Exchanging these quantifiers would claim a single outsider policy defeating all coalition policies, which is not what the construction proves.

Consider a single round in which two agents simultaneously choose bits. Whichever bit the first agent chooses, the second has a matching and a nonmatching response. The same holds with the roles reversed. Neither agent can force equality or force inequality. Failure of one coalition to enforce a goal therefore leaves open whether its opponent can enforce the complement.

For a publicly metered finite interaction with natural round charges and cap b, a finite monitored state is (w, n) with $n \in \{0, \dots, b, \mathsf{over}\}$. Start at zero, add the charge of each completed transition, and send a sum exceeding b to the absorbing meter value over. Induction on rounds identifies n with the accumulated cost up to saturation. Apply Theorem 12.8 on this finite product to objectives testing the public budget. A private meter remains on its witness carrier; publicly revealing it would change the available history-dependent policies.

Corollary 12.9 (Translation of alternating-time state formulas)**.** *On these interactions, the state language generated by propositional connectives and the operators $\langle\!\langle C \rangle\!\rangle \mathsf{X}$, $\langle\!\langle C \rangle\!\rangle \mathsf{U}$, and $\langle\!\langle C \rangle\!\rangle \mathsf{G}$ has an exact interpretation in the assertion extension: next is Pre_C, until is the displayed least fixed point, and always is the displayed greatest fixed point.*

Proof.

(1) **Fixed-point argument.** Induct on state formulas. Atomic and propositional cases are the predicate interpretation. The next case is the definition of controllable predecessor.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Once the immediate subformulas have been interpreted as state predicates, Theorem 12.8 supplies the until and always cases. This also allows nested coalition operators, since their interpretations are again state predicates.

□

This gives the specified connection to temporal and alternating-time reasoning (Alur, Henzinger, and Kupferman, 2002). The linear semantics constructs and composes the rounds; ownerwise policy quantifiers specify control; and least and greatest fixed points express progress and persistence. The resulting policies and counterpolicies are exhibited by the finite-history construction rather than inferred from the modal notation alone.

12.2.3 What remains after a history

Definition 12.10 (Residual games, continuation policies, and off-path histories)**.** For a receptive courteous strategy $s : S \to A^{\perp} \parallel B$ and a finite source configuration $x \in \mathrm{Conf}(S)$ with $s(x) = a_x \amalg b_x$, its **pointed operational residual** is the restriction

$$s/x : S/x \longrightarrow (A^{\perp} \parallel B)/s(x) \cong (A/a_x)^{\perp} \parallel (B/b_x).$$

It records the remaining events of that particular strategy after the actually exhibited source history x; its validity is proved in Proposition 12.14.

For a complete-policy game with a total family of histories Hist, a **continuation game** or **subgame** at $h \in \mathsf{Hist}$ is the owned open arena $G_h = (\vec{\Sigma}^h, g_h) : A_h \to B_h$ together with the restriction

$$r_h : \Sigma \to \Sigma^h, \qquad g_h : \Sigma^h \to \mathcal{C}(A_h, B_h), \qquad g^h = g_h r_h.$$

A continuation policy is an element of Σ_i^h; its restriction from a complete policy is $r_{h,i}(\sigma_i)$. If $\mathsf{Reach}(\sigma) \subseteq \mathsf{Hist}$ denotes the histories on the play of σ, then $\mathsf{Off}(\sigma) = \mathsf{Hist} \setminus \mathsf{Reach}(\sigma)$ is the **off-path history** set. A subtree game is defined even at such a history; it is not asserted to be the residual of the particular strategy realized by σ. The comparison at reached histories is constructed below.

Construction 12.11 (The continuing agent at a history)**.**

(1) **Specify the residual agent.** For the continuation presentation G_h and ownerwise restriction r_h, the continuing agent of identity i has interface

$$\mathsf{Ag}_i(G_h) = \big(i, \Sigma_i^h, \varepsilon_{\Sigma_i^h}\big), \qquad r_{h,i} : \Sigma_i \to \Sigma_i^h.$$

Its situated observations are the displayed observation terms on the history or continuation carrier. Its comparison is $P_{i,h}$ on the continuation-arrow sort.

(2) **Transport its comparison.** Pulling that comparison back along g_h and then r_h gives the complete-policy comparison

$$(r_h \times r_h)^*(g_h \times g_h)^* P_{i,h}.$$

Functoriality of inverse image identifies this with feedback through $g^h = g_h r_h$. Thus the history changes the agent's continuation interface while retaining its identity and the complete-policy restriction map. Pointed operational residuals supply the exhibited implementation at reached histories; the full continuation family retains the off-path interfaces used by sequential rationality.

A visible history says what an observer has seen. To compute what the system can do next, we may also need to know which hidden events have occurred. The pointed history retains the source configuration needed to construct that residual.

Write $r_h : \Sigma \to \Sigma^h$ for restriction of complete policies to the future of a history, and $g_h : \Sigma^h \to \mathcal{C}(A_h, B_h)$ for residual play. The history-indexed open play map is $g^h = g_h r_h$. For every continuation comparison P_h, its complete-policy feedback is

$$(g^h)^\sharp P_h = (r_h \times r_h)^*(g_h \times g_h)^* P_h.$$

The equality is the functorial action of coplay on residual realizations. The operational construction first produces continuations at pointed histories; the finite complete-policy trees then organize all continuation choices, including histories not reached in the current play. This retains the alternatives needed for subgame-perfect evaluation.

Construction 12.12 (Residual event structure and residual strategy)**.**

(1) **Restrict the event structure.** For a finite configuration x of an event structure E, define its residual E/x as follows. Its events are the $e \notin x$ such that $x \cup \{e\} \in \mathrm{Con}_E$; its order is the restriction of $\leq_E$; and its finite consistency relation is

$$Z \in \mathrm{Con}_{E/x} \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad x \cup Z \in \mathrm{Con}_E\,.$$

(2) **Inherit polarities.** Residual polarities are inherited.

Lemma 12.13. *The construction E/x is an event structure, and for finite sets of residual events z,*

$$z \in \mathrm{Conf}(E/x) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad x \cup z \in \mathrm{Conf}(E).$$

If $x \subseteq y$ are configurations, there is a canonical isomorphism

$$(E/x)/(y \setminus x) \cong E/y.$$

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** Finite pasts and the consistency axioms are inherited: adjoining a cause of a consistent event preserves consistency with x. Every event in a residual past is compatible with x, by the same axiom. If z is a residual configuration, the causes of an event of z either lie in x or are residual causes and lie in z.

(2) **Residual configuration equivalence.** Thus $x \cup z$ is down-closed, and it is consistent by definition. Conversely, down-closure and consistency of $x \cup z$ give the corresponding properties in the residual.

(3) **Causal execution.** The events of either iterated residual are exactly the events outside y compatible with y. On these events the orders are both the restriction of the original order, and consistency on both sides says that adjoining y is consistent in E. The identity on remaining events is the asserted isomorphism.

□

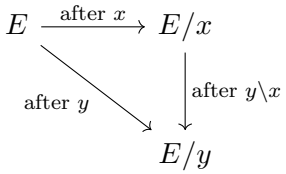


Figure 6: Continuation is independent of whether a history is exposed in one step or in successive prefixes. The arrows denote residual operations.

Proposition 12.14 (Residual strategies)**.** *If $s : S \to A$ is a receptive courteous strategy and $x \in \mathrm{Conf}(S)$, restriction of the labelling map gives a receptive courteous strategy*

$$s/x : S/x \longrightarrow A/s(x).$$

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** First the restricted map is well defined. Let e be an event of S/x. Then $x \cup \{e\}$ is consistent.

(2) **Causal execution: second comparison.** Adjoining the finitely many causes of e one at a time shows that $x \cup \downarrow e$ is a finite configuration of S. Its image under s is therefore a configuration of A. Local injectivity on this configuration implies $s(e) \notin s(x)$, while $s(x) \cup \{s(e)\}$ is consistent. Hence $s(e)$ is an event of $A/s(x)$.

(3) **Causal execution.** If $z \in \mathrm{Conf}(S/x)$, then $x \cup z \in \mathrm{Conf}(S)$ by Lemma 12.13. Thus $s(x \cup z)$ is a configuration of A. Local injectivity separates the labels in $s(x)$ from those in $s(z)$, so $s(z)$ is a configuration of $A/s(x)$. Local injectivity of s/x is inherited from s.

(4) **Secured operational interaction.** For receptivity, let z be a residual configuration and let a be a negative event enabled after $(s/x)(z)$ in $A/s(x)$. Then

$$s(x) \cup s(z) \cup \{a\}$$

is a configuration of A. Receptivity of s at $x \cup z$ gives a unique event e with $s(e) = a$ and $x \cup z \cup \{e\} \in \mathrm{Conf}(S)$.

(5) **Lifting through the comparison.** Since $a \notin s(x)$, local injectivity implies $e \notin x$; hence e lies in S/x and is the unique residual lift.

(6) **Secured operational interaction.** For courtesy, suppose $e \lessdot_{S/x} e'$. If some d satisfied $e < d < e'$ in S, then $d \notin x$ because x is down-closed while $e \notin x$. Since e' is compatible with x and $d \leq e'$, closure of consistency under adjoining causes makes d compatible with x, so d would be an event of S/x.

(7) **Secured operational interaction: completion.** This contradicts immediacy there. Therefore $e \lessdot_S e'$. Whenever courtesy for s requires $s(e) \lessdot_A s(e')$, that immediate edge also remains immediate in the residual arena: an event strictly between the two residual labels would already be an event strictly between them in A. Hence the courtesy condition restricts to the residual strategy.

□

The source history x cannot be discarded: different source configurations may have the same visible history but distinct future interactions. Residualization also does not claim that every arbitrary future policy extends to the original complete policy space. It constructs the continuation of a specified strategy and the exact restriction maps that are available in the presentation.

Construction 12.15 (The dependent object of pointed operational histories)**.**

(1) **Form pointed history classes.** For an open arena $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$, take all triples

$$(\sigma, s : S \to A^{\perp} \parallel B, x), \qquad [s] = g(\sigma), \quad x \in \mathrm{Conf}(S),$$

using the set of countable strategy presentations on subsets of $\mathbb{N}$ from Convention 1.36. Quotient by strategy isomorphisms preserving σ and carrying the marked configuration to the marked configuration. Write H_G for this quotient.

(2) **Project and residualize.** It has canonical projections to Σ and to $\mathrm{Conf}(A) \times \mathrm{Conf}(B)$, with the latter defined by $s[x] = a \amalg b$. Residualization is a term in the pulled-back dependent arrow family:

$$[\sigma, s, x] \longmapsto [s/x] \in \mathcal{C}(A/a, B/b).$$

Indeed an isomorphism $f : S \cong S'$ carrying x to x' restricts to an isomorphism $S/x \cong S'/x'$ over the same residual boundary. Hence this term is independent of the representative. Proposition 12.14 supplies its strategy conditions.

(3) **Compare successive residuals.** The isomorphisms $(S/x)/(y \setminus x) \cong S/y$ of Lemma 12.13 are identities on remaining events, so their iterated comparison maps satisfy coherence. No representative strategy is selected for each σ.

The projection $H_G \to \Sigma$ retains histories actually realized by each strategy. It need not be a product with a common history set. Complete-policy trees additionally specify choices at unreached nodes; their subtree construction below supplies a total continuation family over $\Sigma \times \mathsf{Hist}$.

Construction 12.16 (The dependent type of residual realizations)**.**

(1) **Form the indexed interfaces.** For a full continuation family, as constructed below for finite complete-policy trees, let Hist be its history set, and write $G_h : A_h \to B_h$ for the residual arena, with policy restriction $r_h : \Sigma \to \Sigma^{G_h}$. The families $\mathbf{A}_h = yA_h$ and $\mathbf{B}_h = yB_h$ are objects of $\mathsf{L}(\mathsf{Hist})$.

(2) **Recover the ordinary value family.** Their ordinary value family is

$$\mathsf{Val}_{\mathsf{Hist}}[\mathbf{A},\mathbf{B}]_D \cong (\mathcal{C}(A_h,B_h))_{h\in\mathsf{Hist}}.$$

Its context extension is exactly $\coprod_h \mathcal{C}(A_h,B_h) \to \mathsf{Hist}$. Thus the dependent residual interfaces and the existing continuation carrier are the linear and ordinary parts of the same constructed model.

(3) **Interpret the realization.** The realization section sends (σ,h) to $(h, g_h r_h \sigma)$; comparison terms take values in the corresponding dependent family of squares.

(4) **Quantify over continuations.** Write NE_{G_h} for the residual comparison predicate and form the comprehension

$$E = \{(\sigma,h) : r_h\sigma \in \mathsf{NE}_{G_h}\} \hookrightarrow \Sigma \times \mathsf{Hist}.$$

For $\pi : \Sigma \times \mathsf{Hist} \to \Sigma$, universal continuation equilibrium is the internal predicate $\forall_\pi E$. The quantifier formula proves that it holds exactly when every residual profile is an equilibrium. The history type contains all histories, so the formula includes histories not reached by the reference profile. The subsequent finite decision and concurrent-round constructions specify these residual games and their solution predicates explicitly.

12.2.4 Operational action updates and pointed-history transport

The epistemic action-model construction can now obtain its enabling data directly from event-structure steps. The updated states are pointed transitions, so they retain the causal prerequisites and consistency of the move as well as its visible label. Keeping the source configuration prevents two different internal histories from being identified merely because they expose the same event.

Construction 12.17 (An action model generated by a concurrent strategy)**.**

(1) **Form the enabled action family.** For a receptive courteous strategy $s : S \to A^\perp \parallel B$, put $W_s = \mathrm{Conf}(S)$ and $E_s = |S|$. Use the enabling predicate

$$P_s(x,e) \quad\Longleftrightarrow\quad e \notin x \ \wedge\ x \cup \{e\} \in \mathrm{Conf}(S).$$

Its comprehension is the enabled-event span $\mathsf{Step}(S)$ of Construction 1.2.

(2) **Specify its target.** The state map after an action is the target

$$t_s : \mathsf{Step}(S) \longrightarrow W_s, \qquad (x,e) \longmapsto x \cup \{e\}.$$

For $x \in W_s$, write $s(x) = a_x \amalg b_x$ and form the representable dependent boundary families $\mathbf{A}_x = y(A/a_x)$ and $\mathbf{B}_x = y(B/b_x)$.

(3) **Realize the residual.** Define the pointed residual section

$$\rho_s : 1_{W_s} \longrightarrow \mathsf{Val}_{W_s}[\mathbf{A},\mathbf{B}]_D, \qquad \rho_s(x) = [s/x].$$

Proposition 12.14 gives the component's strategy conditions, and pointwise Yoneda gives its displayed type.

(4) **Update a history observable.** For a history observable $v : W_s \to Z$, define its operational postcondition by $v^+ = vt_s$. No choice of total order on independent events is involved. Action uncertainty relations will be constructed from the actual observation data below.

Theorem 12.18 (Operational realization of one-step product update)**.** *The carrier of the semantic action-model product update determined by P_s is canonically*

$$W_s \odot (E_s, P_s) \cong \mathsf{Step}(S). \tag{12.2}$$

The residual realization over this carrier is

$$(x, e) \longmapsto [s/(x \cup \{e\})] \in \mathcal{C}(A/a_{x,e}, B/b_{x,e}), \tag{12.3}$$

where $s(x \cup \{e\}) = a_{x,e} \amalg b_{x,e}$. It is the reindexing $t_s^* \rho_s$ of the pointed residual family. For an enabled e after x there is also a canonical residual comparison

$$(s/x)/\{e\} \cong s/(x \cup \{e\}).$$

All comparisons respect isomorphisms of strategy presentations.

Proof.

(1) **Equality of the two constructions.** Both sides of the carrier bijection consist of exactly the pairs (x, e) satisfying $P_s(x, e)$, and their source and action projections are the same. The target t_s is the configuration reached by that step. Proposition 12.14 constructs the residual arrow at $x \cup \{e\}$; the iterated-residual isomorphism is Lemma 12.13.

(2) **Secured operational interaction.** The corresponding dependent section is Construction 12.16 on the appropriate pointed history base, and its reindexing is Proposition 1.51. Every construction is by restriction of labels, configurations, and causal order, so it commutes with source isomorphisms preserving marked histories.

□

A witnessed event step determines the corresponding epistemic action transition.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{Step}(S) & \xrightarrow{\text{record}} & U \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle p} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_W} \\ \mathrm{Conf}(S) & \xrightarrow[\text{state}]{} & W \end{array}$$

Construction 12.19 (Action observations and their effective quotients)**.**

(1) **Form recipient observations.** For each owner i, take its already designated observation on source histories $o_i : W_s \to O_i$. If the report of the new event is a map $b_i : E_s \to L_i$, construct the retained observation

$$o_i^+ : \mathsf{Step}(S) \to O_i \times L_i, \qquad o_i^+(x, e) = (o_i(x), b_i(e)).$$

(2) **Calculate the updated kernel.** Use $R_i = \ker(o_i)$ and $S_i = \ker(b_i)$ in the action model. Then the product-updated relation is $\ker(o_i^+)$ by Proposition 9.22.

(3) **Retain a history-dependent report.** A protocol may instead supply a history-dependent fresh observation $\omega_i : \mathsf{Step}(S) \to L_i$. To retain both the preceding information and this new observation, construct

$$o_i^+ = \langle o_i p, \omega_i \rangle : \mathsf{Step}(S) \to O_i \times L_i.$$

This too has an exact action-model presentation: use the *pointed-action set* $E_s^\bullet = \mathsf{Step}(S)$, make an action $\alpha = (x, e)$ enabled exactly at its source x, and put $S_i^\bullet = \ker(\omega_i)$ on pointed actions. Product update then has carrier canonically isomorphic to $\mathsf{Step}(S)$, with epistemic relation $\ker\langle o_i p, \omega_i \rangle$.

Proposition 12.20 (Pointed action presentation of retained observations)**.** *For the history-dependent construction above, let*

$$P^\bullet(w,\alpha) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad w = p(\alpha), \qquad \alpha \in E_s^\bullet.$$

Its action-model update and resulting kernel relations identify with $\mathsf{Step}(S)$ *and* $\ker(o_i^+)$*, respectively. State-dependent action observations are constructed from semantic precondition predicates and effective observation quotients.*

Proof.

(1) **Monoidal comparison.** The comprehension of $P^\bullet$ is the graph of $p : E_s^\bullet \to W_s$, canonically isomorphic to $E_s^\bullet$. Under that isomorphism the old-world projection is p, while the new-action projection is the identity. The product-updated relation is

$$(p \times p)^* \ker(o_i) \wedge \ker(\omega_i) = \ker\langle o_i p, \omega_i \rangle.$$

The latter kernel has its effective image factorization as in Corollary 6.6.

□

Construction 12.21 (Owner-parameterized pointed action families)**.**

(1) **Form the classes of pointed steps.** For an owned interaction $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g)$, use the pointed-history carrier H_G of Construction 12.15. Form the set of classes

$$\mathsf{Step}(G) = \{[\sigma, s, x, e] : [s] = g(\sigma),\ x \in \mathrm{Conf}(S),\ e \notin x, x \cup \{e\} \in \mathrm{Conf}(S)\},$$

where strategy isomorphisms preserve σ, x, and the marked event e.

(2) **Compute endpoints and residuals.** Its source and target maps send a class to $[\sigma, s, x]$ and $[\sigma, s, x \cup \{e\}]$, respectively. The post-step residual is the class of $s/(x \cup \{e\})$.

(3) **Reindex the family.** For $r : G \Rightarrow H$, the realization equation $g = h\Pi_N r$ sends these classes to the corresponding classes for H, changing only their policy index by $\Pi_N r$. These maps commute with both endpoints and the residual realization. Pulling back the reference along $W \to \Sigma^G$ retains the whole fibre of pointed operational histories; it does not restrict the alternative policy sets.

Proposition 12.22 (Causal interchange of iterated action updates)**.** *Let* $\mathsf{Path}(S)$ *be the set of pairs consisting of a finite initial configuration* x *and a finite sequence* $(e_1, \ldots, e_n)$ *of events successively enabled from* x *(including* $n = 0$*). Let* $\equiv$ *be generated by exchanging two adjacent occurrences whenever they are concurrent and both orders yield configurations. Then endpoint assignment induces*

$$\mathsf{Path}(S)/{\equiv} \ \cong \{(x, y) \in \mathrm{Conf}(S)^2 : x \subseteq y\}. \tag{12.4}$$

Residualization after a path depends only on its class, with resulting arrow s/y*. This quotient removes arbitrary linear readings of independence but does not identify epistemic records that genuinely observe their execution order: such records remain on the path carrier until their effective descent is established.*

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** A sequence yields $y = x \cup \{e_1, \ldots, e_n\}$, unchanged by an interchange. Conversely, given $x \subseteq y$, any linear extension of the finite causal order on $y \setminus x$ provides a sequence of enabled events, since y is consistent and down-closed. Any two linear extensions are connected by swaps of adjacent incomparable occurrences; both swapped steps lie within y and are compatible.

(2) **Coherence of iterated residuals.** This proves the bijection. Iterated residuals are canonically isomorphic to s/y by Lemma 12.13; their comparison maps are identities on the remaining events and hence coherent.

□

12.2.5 Secured visible actions, hiding, and epistemic witnesses

The comparison of communication update with concurrent composition has to be made before hiding removes private events. Secured synchronization (Castellan et al., 2017) retains the causal witness, while epistemic product update (Baltag, Moss, and Solecki, 1998) retains the observed event. We construct their correspondence and then identify the additional information required to descend it to visible executions. One visible event can depend on several hidden histories, so forgetting those witnesses too early can change knowledge.

Construction 12.23 (Visible projection and causal lifts)**.**

(1) **Restrict to visible events.** Let U be an event structure with a designated set $V \subseteq |U|$ of visible events. Write $H = U{\downarrow}V$ for the event structure with event set V, the restricted causal order, and consistency inherited from U.

(2) **Lift a visible history.** For $z \in \mathrm{Conf}(H)$ put

$$\widehat{z} = \bigcup_{v \in z} {\downarrow_U}\, v. \tag{12.5}$$

The visible projection of a configuration is $\mathrm{vis}(X) = X \cap V$; its fibre is the dependent witness set

$$K_z = \{X \in \mathrm{Conf}(U) : X \cap V = z\}. \tag{12.6}$$

Lemma 12.24 (Causal lifting and residualization across hiding)**.** *For every $z \in \mathrm{Conf}(H)$, $\widehat{z}$ is a configuration of U, is the least such configuration with visible projection z, and satisfies $\widehat{z} \cap V = z$. In particular* $\mathrm{vis} : \mathrm{Conf}(U) \twoheadrightarrow \mathrm{Conf}(H)$ *is a surjection with canonical section $z \mapsto \widehat{z}$. Put $V_z = V \cap |U/\widehat{z}|$, the visible events that remain in the residual. There is a canonical isomorphism*

$$(U{\downarrow}V)/z \;\cong (U/\widehat{z}){\downarrow}V_z. \tag{12.7}$$

For $z \subseteq z'$ the residual extension corresponds to the finite configuration $\widehat{z'} \setminus \widehat{z}$ of $U/\widehat{z}$.

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** Consistency of z and repeated adjoining of causal predecessors show that $\widehat{z}$ is consistent. It is finite because every principal past is finite, and it is down-closed by construction. Any configuration with visible part z contains all these predecessors.

(2) **Lifting along the surjection.** Since z is down-closed in the restricted visible order, $\widehat{z} \cap V = z$. Hence $\widehat{z}$ is the least lift and the visible projection is surjective.

(3) **Causal execution.** An event $v \in V \setminus z$ belongs to the left residual exactly when $z \cup \{v\}$ is consistent in U. Closure of consistency under adjoining causes makes this equivalent to $\widehat{z} \cup \{v\} \in \mathrm{Con}_U$, which is precisely membership in the right residual.

(4) **Causal execution: completion.** For every finite set Z of these remaining visible events, the same cause-extension argument gives

$$z \cup Z \in \mathrm{Con}_U \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \widehat{z} \cup Z \in \mathrm{Con}_U\,.$$

Both residuals inherit the same restricted causal order, proving the isomorphism. Monotonicity of $z \mapsto \widehat{z}$ and Lemma 12.13 give the final comparison.

□

Proposition 12.25 (Secured interaction at a pointed history)**.** *Let $U = S \circledast_B T$ be the secured interaction of $s : S \to A^{\perp} \parallel B$ and $t : T \to B^{\perp} \parallel C$. For $X \in \mathrm{Conf}(U)$, write x and y for its projections to S and T, and b for their common synchronized B-history. There is a canonical event-structure isomorphism, over the residual three-interface arena,*

$$U/X \;\cong\; (S/x) \circledast_{B/b} (T/y). \tag{12.8}$$

It is natural under marked secured-history isomorphisms and compatible with further residualization.

Proof.

(1) **Secured matching of interaction configurations.** By Theorem 1.7, configurations of the secured interaction are secured matchings of the augmented component maps. The configuration X determines a fixed secured matching of the component histories x, y, including the private interface events. A configuration extending X gives a matching of the additional residual configurations of S/x and T/y, with the already matched B-labels removed.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, the union of this fixed matching with a matching of the residual component configurations is a matching of the original augmented maps. The causality relation has no edges from a new pair to an old pair, because x, y are down-closed. Consequently a cycle in the union exists exactly when a cycle exists in the residual matching; security is preserved and reflected.

(3) **Secured operational interaction.** These constructions are inverse and inclusion-preserving on the secured-matching configuration posets. Taking their prime secured histories identifies the corresponding event structures, including causality, consistency, and boundary projections. The identification uses the same fixed prefix under further residualization, so the comparison maps compose by the identities of Lemma 12.13.

□

Construction 12.26 (Secured weak-step relation)**.**

(1) **Retain internal step witnesses.** For the visible projection above construct

$$\begin{aligned}\mathsf{WStep}(U, V) = \{(X, Y) : X, Y \in \mathrm{Conf}(U),\\ X \subseteq Y, \quad \mathrm{vis}(Y) = \mathrm{vis}(X) \cup \{v\} \text{ for one } v \in V \setminus \mathrm{vis}(X)\}.\end{aligned}$$

The two projections to $\mathrm{Conf}(U)$ are the source and post-step internal history.

(2) **Project to the visible action.** The comparison with the visible action-update carrier is

$$\Theta : \mathsf{WStep}(U, V) \to \mathsf{Step}(H), \qquad (X, Y) \longmapsto (\mathrm{vis}(X), v), \tag{12.9}$$

where v is the unique newly visible event. Each fibre $\Theta^{-1}(z, v)$ is a dependent set of secured witnesses realizing the visible action.

Theorem 12.27 (Secured interaction, epistemic update, and hiding)**.** *Let $U = S \circledast_B T$ be the secured interaction of two concurrent strategies and let V consist of their exterior visible events. The source event structure of their composite is $H = U{\downarrow}V$. The action-model carrier*

generated from H is $\mathsf{Step}(H)$*. The comparison* $\Theta : \mathsf{WStep}(U,V) \to \mathsf{Step}(H)$ *is surjective, with canonical section*

$$(z,v) \longmapsto (\widehat{z}, \widehat{z \cup \{v\}}). \tag{12.10}$$

For every visible step (z,v), residualizing after the visible update is canonically isomorphic to the visible part of the secured residual:

$$H/(z \cup \{v\}) \;\cong (U/\widehat{z \cup \{v\}})\downarrow(V \cap |U/\widehat{z \cup \{v\}}|). \tag{12.11}$$

The visible residual strategy has the same external labels on both sides. If x, y are the component projections of $\widehat{z \cup \{v\}}$, then by Proposition 12.25 this residual strategy is also the concurrent composite of the residual component strategies s/x and t/y, with the common synchronized B-past removed. The comparison and the residual isomorphisms are invariant under arena-preserving isomorphisms of the two component strategies.

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** Every (X,Y) in the weak-step carrier projects to a visible source configuration followed by exactly one enabled visible event, so Θ is well-defined.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, Lemma 12.24 constructs the two configurations in Equation (12.10); the first is included in the second, and their visible parts differ by precisely v. This is a section and proves surjectivity. Apply Equation (12.7) at $z \cup \{v\}$ to obtain Equation (12.11).

(3) **Secured operational interaction.** The hidden composite's source is the visible restriction of U, and its label map is the restriction to the exterior arena. Therefore the identity on visible remaining events also preserves their arena labels. Proposition 12.25 identifies the secured residual at the canonical lift with interaction of the component residual strategies.

(4) **Secured operational interaction: completion.** Hiding those matched internal events gives precisely the displayed exterior residual. The causal-closure construction commutes with isomorphisms of the secured interaction and with the canonical source comparisons of its pullback presentation.

□

Remark 12.28 (Internal histories are not erased by epistemic hiding). The configuration projection $\mathrm{vis} : \mathrm{Conf}(U) \to \mathrm{Conf}(H)$ preserves the secured weak-step relation of Construction 12.26 and the visible enabled-step relation, but it need not be bounded: a visible step need not lift from each internal history over its source. The surjection Θ compares the corresponding step carriers; its surjectivity asserts only that every visible step has some witness. An internal history may include a hidden occurrence that disables a visible move, even though that move remains available at its coarse visible projection. For example, take a hidden event h conflicting with a visible event v, both initially enabled. At internal history $\{h\}$, the event v is impossible, while the empty visible history still permits v. The minimal section in Equation (12.10) and the complete witness fibres K_z are therefore both essential. We do not identify arbitrary private observations of K_z with predicates on visible histories.

Proposition 12.29 (Exact epistemic descent of secured weak steps)**.** *For an owner i, let $\omega_i : \mathsf{WStep}(U,V) \to O_i$ be a specified observation of secured weak steps. The following are equivalent:*

(i) *ω_i is constant on the fibres of Θ;*

(ii) *its two pullbacks to the kernel pair of* Θ *agree;*

(iii) *there is a unique* $\bar{\omega}_i : \mathsf{Step}(H) \to O_i$ *with* $\omega_i = \bar{\omega}_i \Theta$.

Under these equivalent descriptions, Θ *is a surjective bounded morphism from* $\ker(\omega_i)$ *to* $\ker(\bar{\omega}_i)$. *For a finite family of owners satisfying the same descent test, it preserves and reflects all modal fixed-point predicates with descended atomic tests. Observations that do not descend remain on the dependent witness carrier* $\Theta^{-1}(z, v)$ *and have their own epistemic update there.*

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** The equivalence is effective descent along the surjection Θ, using Proposition 5.38. Since $\ker(\omega_i) = (\Theta \times \Theta)^* \ker(\bar{\omega}_i)$, forward preservation of the kernel relation follows immediately. For a reduced successor z' of $\Theta(X, Y)$ with the same $\bar{\omega}_i$-value, surjectivity of Θ supplies any preimage of z'.

(2) **Descent along the kernel pair: completion.** Its ω_i-value equals that of (X, Y), so it supplies the bounded-morphism back lift. Theorem 9.30 then gives the modal fixed-point assertion. For non-descending observations, the witness family is the ordinary fibre of Θ; no image-level observation term is falsely asserted.

□

The results give two complementary readings. The visible action model is constructed from the hidden composite strategy H through its least causal lift; the internal action model retains every secured history and its private observations. Their comparison identifies which information descends to visible histories and which must remain with the witnesses. Hiding alone is not an epistemic quotient.

The limit of sheaf descent after hiding. Theorem 1.12 reconstructs the secured interaction *before* hiding. It does not assert that a visible projection is a bounded morphism of the successor relations used for temporal agency. For example, if a hidden event h conflicts with a visible event v and both are initially enabled, the internal configurations $\varnothing$ and $\{h\}$ have the same visible projection, but v is enabled only at the first. An abstraction that identifies them does not lift the visible v-successor at the second. This is precisely why the exact visible refinement below retains sourcewise successor information. For epistemic tests made after completed delivery, the anchored sheaf quotient of Theorem 9.34 instead retains the designated receipt evidence, and its modal preservation is proved by the separate sourcewise lifting map.

12.2.6 Canonical exact refinements of visible information

Two internal histories may look identical while allowing different next actions. In the preceding example a hidden occurrence disables a visible move that was initially possible. Recording the private observations separates the histories those observations distinguish. To use the result for temporal reasoning, every transition attributed to a visible state must also be available from each internal source that the state represents. The next refinement enforces this requirement for the specified relations.

Proposition 12.30 (The coarsest observation-retaining refinement)**.** *Let* $q : X \twoheadrightarrow Y$ *be a surjection and* $o_i : X \to O_i$ *specified observations. The image factorization*

$$X \xrightarrow{r_0} Z_0 := \mathrm{im}\langle q, (o_i)_{i \in N} \rangle \hookrightarrow Y \times \prod_i O_i$$

is the coarsest quotient through which q and every o_i factor. Moreover r_0 is a surjective bounded morphism from each $\ker(o_i)$ *to* $\ker(\bar{o}_i)$ *on* Z_0.

Proof.

(1) **Apply the retained-data image.** Take $b = (o_i)_i$ in Construction 5.49. Its universal property and kernel-pair equation give the coarsest observation-retaining quotient and all its factor maps.

(2) **Lift observation alternatives.** The observations factor through r_0, so their kernel pairs pull back exactly. Apply Lemma 9.29 to each $\ker(\bar{o}_i)$; hence r_0 is bounded for every specified observation relation.

□

The image quotient alone can still fail to lift visible transitions. To retain both observations and transitions, take a set $\mathcal{A}$ of relation labels with $R_a \subseteq X^2$ for $a \in \mathcal{A}$, together with the specified observation and test maps $t_\lambda : X \to V_\lambda$. The greatest-bisimulation construction identifies histories only when they are indistinguishable by all of these designated interfaces.

$$\ell = \langle q, (o_i)_i, (t_\lambda)_\lambda \rangle : X \to L, \qquad L = Y \times \prod_i O_i \times \prod_\lambda V_\lambda.$$

An atomic predicate can be retained by its characteristic map to 2.

Construction 12.31 (The bisimulation predicate)**.**

(1) **Match successors in both directions.** For $B \subseteq X^2$ define $\mathcal{F}(B)$ by

$$\begin{aligned}(x, x') \in \mathcal{F}(B) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad & \ell(x) = \ell(x') \text{ and, for each } a \in \mathcal{A}, \\ & \forall z\ (xR_a z \Rightarrow \exists z'\ (x'R_a z' \wedge zBz')), \\ & \forall z'\ (x'R_a z' \Rightarrow \exists z\ (xR_a z \wedge zBz')).\end{aligned}$$

The last two lines are simultaneous clauses.

(2) **Take the greatest fixed point.** The map $\mathcal{F}$ is monotone. Define $B_* := \nu\mathcal{F}$ in the existing predicate lattice $\mathcal{P}(X^2)$.

Definition 12.32 (Exact quotient refinements over retained data)**.** Let $\mathbf{Q}_\ell(X)$ have objects consisting of a relation frame $(Z, (\bar{R}_a))$, a surjective bounded map $s : X \to Z$, and a map $\bar{\ell} : Z \to L$ with $\ell = \bar{\ell}s$. An arrow from $(s_1, \bar{\ell}_1)$ to $(s_2, \bar{\ell}_2)$ is a bounded map $h : Z_1 \to Z_2$ satisfying $s_2 = hs_1$. It is automatically surjective, and $\bar{\ell}_1 = \bar{\ell}_2 h$ follows by cancellation of the surjection s_1. Identities and compositions are inherited from frame maps; successive back lifts prove boundedness of composition. Thus the category retains the visible map, observations, and tests as well as the selected relations.

Theorem 12.33 (Coarsest exact quotient refining the visible quotient)**.** *The relation B_* is an equivalence relation. Let $r : X \twoheadrightarrow Z = X/B_*$ and give Z the direct-image relations*

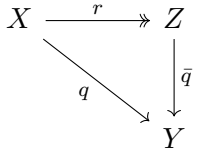
$$u\bar{R}_a v \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \exists x, x'\ (r(x) = u,\ r(x') = v,\ xR_a x').$$

Then:

1. *q, all observations, and all retained tests factor uniquely through r.*
2. *r is a surjective bounded morphism for every R_a.*
3. *For every other surjective bounded morphism $s : X \to Z'$ through which ℓ factors, there is a unique surjective bounded morphism $h : Z' \to Z$ satisfying $r = hs$.*

Thus $(r, \bar{\ell})$ is terminal in $\mathbf{Q}_\ell(X)$. It preserves and reflects the modal fixed-point predicates built from the retained atoms.

The retained visible observation factors through the greatest-bisimulation quotient.



Proof.

(1) **Coinduction and bisimulation.** A relation B with $B \subseteq \mathcal{F}(B)$ is a label-preserving bisimulation. The diagonal is such a relation. The converse of such a relation is again such a relation.

(2) **Witness and legality comparison.** The relational composite of two such relations is also one: to match a successor, first use the witness for the first relation and then the witness for the second; the reverse direction is identical, and label equalities compose. Greatestness therefore gives

$$\Delta_X \subseteq B_*, \qquad B_*^{\mathrm{op}} \subseteq B_*, \qquad B_*; B_* \subseteq B_*.$$

These are reflexivity, symmetry, and transitivity. Since $B_* \subseteq \ker(\ell)$, effective quotient gives the factorizations.

(3) **Lifting through the comparison.** Forward preservation of relations by r is built into $\bar{R}_a$. For back lifting suppose $r(x)\bar{R}_a v$. By definition choose yR_az with $r(y) = r(x)$ and $r(z) = v$.

(4) **Coinduction and bisimulation.** As xB_*y, the bisimulation clause gives xR_az' with $z'B_*z$. Then $r(z') = v$.

(5) **Universal property of the bounded quotient.** For the universal property, $\ker(s)$ preserves labels. We construct h from the quotient universal property and verify both bounded clauses, including the existence of a set map and both bounded-morphism clauses. If $s(x) = s(y)$ and xR_az, forward preservation gives $s(y)R_a^{Z'}s(z)$; back lifting along s gives a matching yR_az' with $s(z') = s(z)$.

(6) **Lifting along the surjection.** Interchanging x, y gives the other clause. Thus $\ker(s)$ is a label-preserving bisimulation and is contained in B_*. Quotient universality gives the unique surjective map $h : Z' \twoheadrightarrow Z$ with $hs = r$.

(7) **Lifting along the surjection: second comparison.** Its compatibility with the retained labels is forced by the equality $\bar{\ell}_s s = \ell = \bar{\ell}_r r$ and surjectivity of s.

(8) **Lifting through the comparison.** To see that h preserves a relation $uR_a^{Z'}v$, take $s(x) = u$ and lift to xR_ax' with $s(x') = v$. Forward preservation by r gives $h(u)\bar{R}_a h(v)$. For the back condition, if $h(u)\bar{R}_a v$, take $s(x) = u$ and use boundedness of r to obtain xR_ax' with $r(x') = v$.

(9) **Choice of representatives and quotients.** Put $u' = s(x')$. Then $uR_a^{Z'}u'$ and $h(u') = v$. Modal fixed-point preservation and reflection are exactly Theorem 9.30, since r is surjective and the atoms descend.

□

Corollary 12.34 (Compatibility with knowledge and action update)**.** *If $R_i = \ker(o_i)$ is among the retained relations, then $\bar{R}_i = \ker(\bar{o}_i)$. If the only relations are these observation kernels, then $B_* = \ker(\ell)$, so the theorem reduces to the image construction, with any additional tests included in that image.*

For an action set E with action relations $(S_a)_{a\in\mathcal{A}}$, an arbitrary enabling subobject $P \subseteq X \times E$ is retained by including among the tests the function

$$t_P : X \to \mathcal{P}(E), \qquad t_P(x) = \{e : (x, e) \in P\}.$$

Its factor $\bar{t}_P : Z \to \mathcal{P}(E)$ defines $\bar{P}(z, e) \iff e \in \bar{t}_P(z)$, and $P = (r \times 1_E)^* \bar{P}$. The resulting map on product updates $\{P\} \to \{\bar{P}\}$, $(x, e) \mapsto (r(x), e)$, is again surjective and bounded for the updated relations. Hence modal fixed-point adequacy continues through this update and through finite successions for which the enabling data are retained at each stage.

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** Equality of quotient observations is equality of the original observations of any representatives, which is exactly R_i; this proves the first claim.

(2) **Coinduction and bisimulation.** For the second, if $\ell(x) = \ell(x')$, every R_i-successor of x is also an R_i-successor of x'. It matches itself under $\ker(\ell)$. Thus this entire kernel is a bisimulation.

(3) **Lifting along the surjection.** The added test makes P constant on r-fibres for each event. Therefore the updated map is well-defined and surjective. A target successor (v, f) of $(r(x), e)$ gives $r(x)\bar{R}_a v$, $eS_a f$, and enabled (v, f).

(4) **Lifting along the surjection: completion.** Boundedness supplies $xR_a x'$ with $r(x') = v$; descent of enablement makes (x', f) enabled. This is the required back lift. Forward preservation is immediate. Iterate this argument for the last claim.

□

Coalgebraic behavioural equivalence (Rutten, 2000) supplies the underlying bisimulation construction. Here the refinement must preserve the visible map, the declared private observations, and the specified epistemic and secured transitions together. The resulting quotient supports reasoning with these tests while leaving other details on the retained history.

For the example in Remark 12.28, take $X = \mathrm{Conf}(U)$ and $q = \mathrm{vis}$, with the secured weak-step relation and the chosen history observations. The empty history and the hidden history $\{h\}$ have the same visible projection, but only the former can match the visible v-step. They cannot be B_*-equivalent. The refined carrier therefore retains exactly the distinction that the original visible projection loses. The map from the refined quotient to visible configurations still preserves the visible-step relation: each quotient edge is represented by a secured weak step, whose visible image is an enabled step. For the map Θ between step carriers, apply the theorem on those carriers with their explicitly specified relations; do not identify it with the configuration projection.

Corollary 12.35 (Comparison of retained data and invariance under isomorphism)**.** *Adding retained tests to ℓ gives a canonical surjective bounded map from the more discriminating exact quotient to the previous one. An isomorphism of the source relation frames that intertwines all retained data induces a unique isomorphism of their exact quotients. These comparison maps compose coherently.*

Proof.

(1) **Coinduction and bisimulation.** The quotient retaining more tests is itself an exact quotient retaining the original tests. The terminal property of Theorem 12.33 supplies the comparison. An intertwining isomorphism transports label-preserving bisimulations in both directions, hence transports their greatest relation exactly.

(2) **Lifting along the surjection.** It therefore induces inverse quotient maps. All composition and identity equations follow from uniqueness after precomposition with the relevant surjective quotient map.

□

Construction 12.36 (Dependent operational witnesses over the refined quotient)**.**

(1) **Form the fibre of the quotient.** For $r : X \twoheadrightarrow Z = X/B_*$, retain the ordinary witness family $K_z = r^{-1}(z)$.

(2) **Recover the total witness context.** The comparison

$$X \xrightarrow{\cong} Z.K, \qquad x \longmapsto (r(x), x),$$

has inverse $(z, x) \mapsto x$. Thus every ordinary or linear family over X, including the pointed residual arenas and their realized strategies, is transported exactly to the total witness context $Z.K$. The refined state quotient carries the preserved modal predicates; its dependent witnesses retain the individual operational residuals. This is an isomorphism of contexts, so all reindexing and realization comparisons follow from Proposition 1.51.

The quotient concerns the chosen visible and modal tests, not an identification of residual linear arenas. Complete linear data remain available on the underlying witness family; Proposition 6.21 then specifies when an interface itself descends. This separates exact logical abstraction from isomorphism of all operational structure.

12.2.7 Finite perfect-information decisions

Definition 12.37 (Finite perfect-information tree and complete policies)**.** A **finite perfect-information tree** is a finite prefix-closed set H of histories with root ε, a set $H_{\mathrm{nt}} \subseteq H$ of nonterminal histories, and leaf set $Z = H \setminus H_{\mathrm{nt}}$. Each $h \in H_{\mathrm{nt}}$ has an owner $i(h) \in N$ and a finite nonempty successor set $A(h)$, with the extension $ha \in H$ for each $a \in A(h)$ giving precisely the children of h. Each owner evaluates a measured terminal record by $e_i : T_C Z \to \mathbb{K}$. The ordinary leaf-payoff case $u_i : Z \to \mathbb{K}$ is $e_i = u_i \epsilon_Z$. A public edge $h \to ha$ may carry a charge $\delta_h(a) \in C$; zero on every edge gives the ordinary tree. A **complete policy** of owner i is an element of

$$\Sigma_i = \prod_{h \in H_{\mathrm{nt}} :\, i(h) = i} A(h), \qquad \Sigma = \prod_i \Sigma_i,$$

including its actions at nodes not on the realized path. Following the prescribed successor from the root defines play : $\Sigma \to Z$. The **subtree** T_h is rooted at a history h and has as nodes the extensions $H_h = \{k \in H : h \preceq k\}$, with inherited ownership, action sets, edge charges, and leaf labels with their evaluators. Its policy restrictions are the coordinate projections $r_h : \Sigma \to \Sigma^h$ constructed below. An agent observes its current history and therefore knows its decision node; perfect information says nothing about shared preferences.

Construction 12.38 (Retained-history realization)**.**

(1) **Form the history arena.** There is a fixed-polarity event-structure realization of the complete history. Let $\mathsf{Hist}(T)$ have the nonempty tree histories as events, ordered by prefix extension, with finite consistent sets precisely the chains, and give every event positive polarity.

(2) **Realize the policy path.** For a profile σ, let P_σ be the chain of nonempty prefixes of $\mathrm{play}(\sigma)$ and let S_σ be the induced chain event structure. Inclusion gives

$$t_\sigma : S_\sigma \longrightarrow \mathsf{Hist}(T),$$

regarded as a strategy $I \to \mathsf{Hist}(T)$. Receptivity is vacuous because the arena has no negative events. Every immediate dependency in S_σ is the corresponding prefix dependency in the arena, so courtesy holds. Hence

$$\sigma \longmapsto t_\sigma$$

is an owned family on one common polarized arena; no event changes polarity with the identity of the agent who owns its decision.

Construction 12.39 (Leaf observation, including the terminal root)**.**

(1) **Define the terminal and nonterminal reports.** If the root is a leaf z, then $\mathsf{Hist}(T) = I$, its unique complete-policy profile has $t_\sigma = \mathrm{id}_I$, and put $r = \mathsf{pt}(z) : I \to D(\{z\})$. For a nonterminal root every leaf is a nonempty history. Define $r : \mathsf{Hist}(T) \to D(Z)$ to have one negative input event $\bar{h}$ for every history h and one positive output o_z for every leaf z. The negative events inherit the tree order. Add the dependency $\bar{z} < o_z$.

(2) **Generate the event structure.** A finite set is consistent precisely when its negative history events form a chain, it contains at most one output, and, if it contains o_z, every negative history in the set is a prefix of z. These clauses make the source an event structure: adjoining a cause of o_z stays on the same prefix chain, while inherited causes of negative history events remain on that chain.

(3) **Verify the labelling.** The labelling sends $\bar{h}$ to the input occurrence of h and o_z to the output value z. A source configuration containing o_z contains $\bar{z}$ and all its prefixes, so its image is a configuration of $\mathsf{Hist}(T)^\perp \parallel D(Z)$; local injectivity is immediate. Thus the labelling is a total map. Every enabled negative history extension is accepted exactly once. The only dependency not already present on the input arena is $\bar{z} < o_z$, which is negative-to-positive. Thus r is receptive and courteous.

(4) **Compose with a realized history.** Synchronizing r with t_σ exposes exactly the prefix chain P_σ; only the leaf $\mathrm{play}(\sigma)$ occurs on that chain. Hiding the history events therefore gives

$$r \circ t_\sigma \cong \mathsf{pt}_Z(\mathrm{play}(\sigma)) : I \to D(Z).$$

Thus the retained-history and outcome-only presentations are related by an explicit strategy with the interface polarities fixed.

(5) **Compare the staged circuit.** The staged public-state circuit constructed below gives a decentralized factorization of the same play function. When specialized to a perfect-information tree, every nonowner has a singleton action at the current node. To compare its flat outcome interface with the prefix-ordered history arena, we now construct an explicit strategy. Merely copying public state values into independent data ports would not itself impose the history arena's prefix order.

Construction 12.40 (Expansion of a leaf into its prefix history)**.**

(1) **Specify the leaf branches.** Let Z be the leaves of the finite tree T. For $z \in Z$, write P_z for its chain of nonempty prefixes and let $t_z : I \to \mathsf{Hist}(T)$ be inclusion of that chain. Construct

$$e_T : D(Z) \longrightarrow \mathsf{Hist}(T)$$

as follows.

(2) **Build the prefix histories.** For each z its source has a negative event n_z and a positive event $p_{z,h}$ for every $h \in P_z$. Within this branch, n_z precedes every positive event and the positive events are ordered by prefix. A finite set is consistent exactly when it is contained in one branch; events in distinct branches conflict.

(3) **Label the expansion.** The labelling sends n_z to the input value z and $p_{z,h}$ to the history event h. If the root is terminal, P_z is empty, so the unique branch has only its negative input and $e_T : D(\{z\}) \to I$ is disposal.

Proposition 12.41 (Comparison with the retained-history realization)**.** *The displayed map e_T is a receptive courteous strategy. For every leaf z and complete policy profile σ,*

$$e_T \circ \mathsf{pt}_Z(z) \cong t_z, \qquad e_T \circ \mathsf{pt}_Z(\mathrm{play}(\sigma)) \cong t_\sigma.$$

These comparisons include the terminal-root case.

Proof.

(1) **Causal execution.** The source is an event structure: each branch is a finite chain and its causes remain in that branch, so the consistency axioms hold. A nonempty configuration contains one n_z and an initial segment of the prefix chain P_z. Its image is consequently a configuration of $D(Z)^\perp \parallel \mathsf{Hist}(T)$, and the labels are injective on that configuration.

(2) **Local injectivity across conflicting branches.** Repeated history labels on different branches cause no failure of local injectivity because those branches conflict.

(3) **Fibrewise calculation.** At the empty configuration every negative input z has the unique lift n_z. Once an input has occurred, the other negative inputs conflict with it already in $D(Z)^\perp$, so there are no further enabled negative extensions.

(4) **Receptivity and courtesy of prefixes.** This proves receptivity. The only new immediate dependency is from n_z to the first positive prefix event. All positive-to-positive immediate dependencies are the corresponding prefix edges of $\mathsf{Hist}(T)$. Hence courtesy holds.

(5) **Causal execution.** Synchronizing with $\mathsf{pt}_Z(z)$ selects the z-branch and hides its input event. The remaining labelled source is exactly the chain P_z, giving the first isomorphism. Substituting the leaf $\mathrm{play}(\sigma)$ gives the second.

(6) **Causal execution: completion.** For a terminal root there are no remaining events, and both sides are the unique arrow $I \to I$.

□

The comparison recovers prefix-ordered records from terminal history values, giving equality for the constructed closed strategies. It does not identify arbitrary strategies on a flat data arena with arbitrary strategies on a history arena. The causal record retained by the protocol is what makes the reconstruction possible.

12.2.8 Backward induction, with all ties retained

A choice can change rank after an earlier round has consumed part of a budget. To evaluate a child on a public tree, we therefore need both its remaining play and the charge inherited along its own path. Backward induction must make this calculation even for a child the proposed policy never visits, because an alternative policy can lead there.

Construction 12.42 (Measured tree play and translated continuations)**.**

(1) **Meter a completed public edge.** In either finite tree presentation, label a designated transition-to-child record by ha and weight this class by $\delta_h(a)$. One realization uses the finite next-history response and its receipt on a recorder port; give all other classes weight zero. The same circuit can use the increments of Proposition 8.11 when its total for a round descends to the public edge. For the displayed child meter the charge is determined by ha on every completing witness. Compute $c_\epsilon = 0$ and $c_{ha} = c_h + \delta_h(a)$ along every legal history, including ones off the selected path. A hidden charge that varies over this public history remains on the witness fibre.

(2) **Return measured play.** At a leaf set $\widehat{P}_z(*) = (0, z)$. Fix a subtree profile s with current action a and child profile s^{ha}. Put

$$S_d(b, z) = (d + b, z), \qquad \widehat{P}_h(s) = S_{\delta_h(a)}(\widehat{P}_{ha}(s^{ha})).$$

Induction on height gives $\epsilon_Z \widehat{P}_h(s) = \mathrm{play}_h(s)$ (with the original terminal history as leaf label). Its first projection sums the charges on the remaining path. These are the class increments of the retained circuit; the price is read after measurement.

(3) **Translate the owner evaluation.** Define $e_i^c = e_i S_c$ and $V_i^{h,c}(s) = e_i^c(\widehat{P}_h(s))$. Since $S_0 = 1$ and $S_c S_d = S_{c+d}$, one has $(e_i^c)^d = e_i^{c+d}$. At $d = \delta_h(a)$ the equality is the commuting square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma^{ha} & \xrightarrow{\widehat{P}_{ha}} & T_C Z \\ {\scriptstyle S_d \widehat{P}_{ha}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle e_i^{c+d}} \\ T_C Z & \xrightarrow[e_i^c]{} & \mathbb{K} \end{array}$$

Thus $V_i^{h,c}(s) = V_i^{ha,c+\delta_h(a)}(s^{ha})$. For an additive price, $e_i^c(b, z) = e_i(b, z) - \ell_i(c)$, so the prefix leaves every ranking inside that subtree unchanged. A nonlinear owner may rank continuations differently: give a safe action reward 1 and extra charge 0, and a fast action reward 2 and extra charge 1. Deduct 3 when total charge exceeds 1. The fast action wins at incoming charge zero and the safe action wins at incoming charge one.

Definition 12.43 (Backward induction and subgame-perfect equilibrium)**.** For a finite perfect-information tree write Σ^h for its subtree profile carrier. For incoming charge c set $\mathsf{BI}(z; c) = \{*\}$ at a leaf. At a nonterminal h with owner $i = i(h)$ use $\Sigma^h \cong A(h) \times \prod_b \Sigma^{hb}$ and put

$$\begin{aligned} (a, (s^{hb})_b) \in \mathsf{BI}(h; c) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad & s^{hb} \in \mathsf{BI}(hb; c + \delta_h(b)) \quad (\forall b), \\ & V_i^{ha,c+\delta_h(a)}(s^{ha}) = \max_{b \in A(h)} V_i^{hb,c+\delta_h(b)}(s^{hb}). \end{aligned}$$

The two right-hand clauses hold jointly. Write $\mathsf{NE}_{G_h}(c)$ for Nash in the subtree using $V_i^{h,c}$ for each owner, and $\mathsf{SPE}(h; c)$ for the subtree profiles that are Nash in every descendant

subtree at the charge obtained by extending (h, c) along its unique path. At the root use $c = 0$ and abbreviate $\mathsf{BI}(\epsilon; 0)$ and $\mathsf{SPE}(\epsilon; 0)$ by $\mathsf{BI}(\epsilon)$ and SPE. The state-indexed conjunction is (12.12). Theorem 12.46 identifies these two root predicates.

This rules out a prescribed future action that ceases to be optimal when its decision is actually reached.

These backward-induction characterizations concern finite trees. For exact rational leaf payoffs the finite maximum is computed by rational comparison. The same choice exists for classical real payoffs by the usual linear-order argument. The categorical construction supplies all finite continuation choices; ordinary maximization selects an optimal continuation while retaining all ties in the resulting policy set.

Construction 12.44 (Subtree policies, restriction, and reference-based extension)**.**

(1) **Form the subtree policy spaces.** For each history h, let T_h be the rooted subtree whose nodes are the histories extending h. Construct its ownerwise policy spaces by

$$\Sigma_i^h = \prod_{\substack{k \succeq h \\ i(k)=i}} A(k),$$

where the product ranges over the nonterminal nodes of T_h owned by i. The canonical product projections give restriction maps

$$r_{h,i} : \Sigma_i \longrightarrow \Sigma_i^h, \qquad r_h = \prod_i r_{h,i} : \Sigma \longrightarrow \Sigma^h.$$

Applying the retained-history and outcome construction above to T_h gives an owned continuation game G_h on the parameter family $\vec{\Sigma}^h$. Thus "the game after h" is a constructed subtree game, with continuation data carried by its dependent policy family.

(2) **Extend a deviation.** Every residual alternative has an explicit extension to a complete policy relative to a reference profile. For $\sigma_i \in \Sigma_i$, define

$$\mathrm{ext}_{h,\sigma_i} : \Sigma_i^h \longrightarrow \Sigma_i$$

coordinatewise by

$$\mathrm{ext}_{h,\sigma_i}(\tau_i)(k) = \begin{cases} \tau_i(k), & k \succeq h, \\ \sigma_i(k), & k \not\succeq h. \end{cases}$$

Then

$$r_{h,i} \, \mathrm{ext}_{h,\sigma_i} = \mathrm{id}_{\Sigma_i^h}.$$

No global section of $r_{h,i}$ is selected once and for all; the displayed extension is constructed from the reference policy whose off-subtree coordinates are to be retained.

(3) **Identify the residual along a realized history.** When h lies on the realized history of a profile σ, this subtree construction agrees with the operational residual. Regard T_h as rooted at h; the nonempty histories of T_h are the nonempty suffixes after h and therefore correspond to the strict extensions of h in T. If P_h is the prefix configuration containing all nonempty prefixes through h, deletion of the executed prefix gives canonical isomorphisms

$$\mathsf{Hist}(T)/P_h \cong \mathsf{Hist}(T_h), \qquad t_\sigma/P_h \cong t^h_{r_h(\sigma)}.$$

The first sends a strict extension of h to its relative suffix in the rooted subtree, and the second restricts that map to the realized continuation chain; order, chain consistency, polarities, and labels are inherited. Off-path subgames are still defined by the subtree construction even though they are not residuals of the particular realized strategy.

Definition 12.45 (Subgame perfection)**.** A profile is **subgame perfect** exactly when every one of these reindexed Nash predicates holds. In the assertion doctrine,

$$\mathsf{SPE} = \bigwedge_h r_h^* \mathsf{NE}_{G_h}(c_h). \tag{12.12}$$

Subgame perfection is the conjunction of equilibrium predicates over all constructed continuation games. The backward-induction theorems below determine this predicate for finite causal trees.

Theorem 12.46. *At every incoming charge c, $\mathsf{BI}(h;c) = \mathsf{SPE}(h;c)$.*

For every finite perfect-information tree, all pure subgame-perfect profiles are generated by the following recursion. At a leaf there is the unique empty policy profile. At a node owned by i, choose a subgame-perfect profile in every child subtree, and choose any child whose resulting payoff to i is maximal, using $c + \delta_h(b)$ at each child hb. Retain the chosen profiles in all child subtrees, including those not selected at the node. In particular a pure subgame-perfect profile exists.

Proof.

(1) **Induction on tree height.** Proceed by induction on tree height. The leaf case is immediate. At a nonterminal root, let the selected child be a and the chosen subgame-perfect continuation in child b be σ^b.

(2) **Strategic comparison.** If a deviating agent j is not the root's owner i, the selected child does not change. The deviation cannot increase its payoff within child a, because σ^a is a Nash equilibrium there. If the deviator is i, it can choose another child b and also change its entire policy inside that child.

(3) **Strategic comparison: second comparison.** The Nash property of σ^b bounds the resulting payoff by $V_i^{hb,c+\delta_h(b)}(\sigma^b)$. This is the parent's evaluation of choosing b with the displayed continuation by Construction 12.42. Maximization over the same indexed values bounds it by the current payoff. Thus no agent has a profitable complete-policy deviation at the root. All proper subgames already have the required property by induction.

(4) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, a subgame-perfect profile restricts to a subgame-perfect profile in every child. Its chosen child must maximize the root owner's payoff among those fixed continuations: otherwise changing only the root decision is profitable. This is exactly one of the profiles in the stated recursion.

(5) **Finite maxima and continuation witnesses.** Finally each finite nonempty set of child payoffs has a maximum, and the finitely many continuation witnesses are assembled by induction over the child set. No choice over an infinite family is involved. This proves existence.

□

The later node may belong to the same owner as an earlier one. Accordingly, optimality is tested against changes to that owner's complete contingent policy rather than one local action at a time. The recursion therefore avoids the componentwise-equilibrium error identified in Section 5.6. The construction relates to selection-function accounts of backward induction (Escardó and Oliva, 2010), but preserves the explicitly concurrent structure of completed stages.

Remark 12.47 (Finite and infinite continuation). The continuation arguments here use finite trees and their residual games. For a coalgebraic treatment of subgame-perfect equilibria in infinite games without discounting, see Abramsky and Winschel (2017). Such an infinite-game analysis is separate from the finite backward decompositions proved here.

12.2.9 Subgame perfection with concurrent public rounds

Definition 12.48 (Finite public game tree with simultaneous rounds)**.** A **finite public game tree** has a finite prefix-closed history set H, its nonterminal subset H_{nt}, leaves $Z = H \setminus H_{\mathrm{nt}}$, and, at every $h \in H_{\mathrm{nt}}$, finite nonempty action sets $A_i(h)$ for all agents. Its dependent joint-action carrier and successor map are

$$\mathsf{Act} = \coprod_{h \in H_{\mathrm{nt}}} \prod_{i \in N} A_i(h) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{succ}} H, \qquad \mathrm{succ}(h, a) = ha.$$

The ha are precisely the distinct children of h. Each owner has a terminal evaluator $e_i : T_C Z \to \mathbb{K}$. Give its public edges the meter of Construction 12.42, using this round's joint action for a. An unpriced leaf payoff $u_i : Z \to \mathbb{K}$ is evaluated by $u_i \epsilon_Z$. Complete owner policies are

$$\Sigma_i = \prod_{h \in H_{\mathrm{nt}}} A_i(h), \qquad \Sigma = \prod_i \Sigma_i.$$

All agents see the public history h before choosing their current components of a, but no agent sees the others' current choices before making its own. The joint tuple is revealed only when the child ha is reached. The **stage game** at h is the one-round normal-form game with its payoffs determined by a specified complete family of child continuation profiles, as typed in Definition 12.51. Its Nash set need not be nonempty. The one-round interaction is a concurrent reporting protocol followed by the continuation interface.

The following construction gives a fixed interface for the entire tree.

Construction 12.49 (Concurrent circuit for a finite public tree)**.**

(1) **Define layers of public states.** Let its height be d. At layer k, let H_k contain its histories of depth k, together with absorbing copies of leaves reached earlier and an error symbol $\perp$. A leaf keeps its label in every subsequent layer.

(2) **Realize the owned decisions.** For agent i take the layer policy set

$$S_i^k = \prod_{\substack{h \in H_k \\ h \text{ nonterminal}}} A_i(h)$$

and the finite response set

$$B_i^k = \{(h, a) : h \in H_k \text{ nonterminal},\ a \in A_i(h)\} \amalg \{\mathsf{idle}\}.$$

The policy s_i^k realizes the function $f_{s_i^k} : H_k \to B_i^k$ which sends a nonterminal h to $(h, s_i^k(h))$ and a leaf or $\perp$ to idle. The map

$$\iota_i^k : S_i^k \longrightarrow (B_i^k)^{H_k}, \qquad s_i^k \longmapsto f_{s_i^k},$$

is injective, since the value of $f_{s_i^k}$ at every nonterminal history recovers the chosen action there. The resulting singly owned response family is therefore the cartesian reindexing

$$(\iota_i^k)^* \mathsf{Dec}_i(H_k, B_i^k)$$

of the full finite decision presentation. In particular it belongs to $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$ by construction.

(3) **Collect concurrent responses.** Use the iterated data comonoid to copy the public H_k input to all agents and to one transition record; if layer-labelled data records are desired, retain one additional copied value at each layer as well. Apply the independent singly owned response families and collect their responses together with the transition copy of the public state. The next-state function sends a tuple of correctly tagged responses at h to the child ha, preserves a leaf when all responses are idle, and sends every other tuple to $\bot$. Set $\bot$ absorbing. This is a total finite function, so its response strategy exists by Proposition 1.23. Every remaining box in the layer is nonstrategic wiring, copying, collecting, or one of the displayed reindexed decision families. Hence each layer, and therefore the complete finite tree circuit, is an open arena in $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$.

(4) **Compose the layers.** Start with the root state and compose the d layers. Induction on the layers proves that $\bot$ is never reached by an available policy: all responses to a genuine nonterminal state have its tag, and all responses to a retained leaf are idle. The same induction shows that the state at each layer is the prescribed public history or the already reached leaf. The optional copied values record the successive public histories in separate data ports; hiding them leaves the leaf-only realization.

(5) **Project to a leaf.** After the last layer, the reachable output states lie in the leaf set $Z \subseteq H_d$. Define the nonstrategic leaf projection $p_Z : D(H_d) \to D(Z)$ as follows. For every $h \in H_d$ it has one negative input n_h; for every $z \in Z$ it has one positive output o_z with $n_z < o_z$. Distinct input branches conflict, and an input outside Z has no positive continuation. This strategy is total as an event-structure map and receptive to every negative input, but is value-partial on the unreachable complement $H_d \setminus Z$. Its only added immediate dependencies are negative-to-positive, so it is courteous. The preceding reachability induction ensures that its composite with the circuit is value-total on all policy profiles. It satisfies $p_Z \circ \mathsf{pt}_{H_d}(z) = \mathsf{pt}_Z(z)$.

(6) **Compare the two realizations.** Composing the layer circuit with $\mathbf{j}_N(p_Z)$ gives, within $\mathbf{DecArena}_N(\mathcal{C})$, the leaf-only family $\ell_\sigma : I \to D(Z)$. The finite-function response and collector equations identify each internal value with its uniquely prescribed value on that profile; after hiding, the sole output event is its leaf. Hence

$$\ell_\sigma \cong \mathsf{pt}_Z(\mathrm{play}(\sigma)).$$

Regard each completed public round as one tree step when forming $\mathsf{Hist}(T)$. Applying the explicit comparison of Proposition 12.41 now gives

$$e_T \circ \ell_\sigma \cong t_\sigma.$$

Thus the circuit and the retained-history presentation are related by a constructed operational strategy, not by identifying independent copied data ports with prefix-ordered history events. Its ownerwise parameter product $\prod_k S_i^k$ is canonically the complete contingent policy space, with no choices added at leaves or at the error state. The error symbol merely makes the transition functions total on unreachable tuples; it creates no additional strategic option. Within each round the response components are tensored, so the agents' simultaneous choices remain causally independent.

Proposition 12.50 (Public trees as iterated epistemic action updates)**.** *For the finite public tree of Construction 12.49, let W_k consist of its valid public histories at layer k, including absorbing copies of earlier leaves but excluding the circuit's unreachable error symbol. At a nonterminal $h \in W_k$ put $A(h) = \prod_i A_i(h)$; at a leaf put $A(h) = 1$. Form the tagged action set $E_k = \coprod_{h \in W_k} A(h)$ and enable (h, a) only at h. Take the publicly observed completed action*

as the action label. The semantic product-update carrier is then canonically $\coprod_{h\in W_k} A(h)$*, and its deterministic successor map is a bijection with* W_{k+1}*. Iterating these updates from the root recovers the full set of reachable complete public histories, including histories off the path of any particular policy profile. On the product with the complete-policy context* Σ*, the residual realization at the successor history* ha *is* $g_{ha}r_{ha}$*, with* $r_{ha} = r_{h,ha}r_h$ *for the subtree restriction maps. Thus history substitution and owner-policy restriction act on their distinct indices and commute in the constructed continuation family.*

Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** The enabling comprehension pairs h with a single tagged legal action (h, a), so it is isomorphic to E_k. A child is uniquely the history ha, and an absorbing leaf has its sole idle successor. Hence the successor function is injective and surjective onto W_{k+1}.

(2) **Induction on layers.** Induction on layers gives the iterated carrier correspondence. The underlying concurrent circuit realizes the same child map by the finite response and collector equations in Construction 12.49. The residual fibre after h is the constructed subtree game.

(3) **Policy-level comparison.** Its policy restriction to ha is the product projection $r_{h,ha}$; composing it with r_h gives r_{ha}, by equality of the selected policy coordinates. Proposition 1.51 applies separately to the history-indexed linear family and shows that the resulting component is $g_{ha}r_{ha}$. This keeps off-path fibres: no update is restricted to the actual reference policy's unique path.

□

Definition 12.51 (Stage game induced by continuation profiles)**.** At a nonterminal public history h, put $A(h) = \prod_{i\in N} A_i(h)$. A specified family of complete child-continuation profiles has type

$$s = (s^{ha})_{a\in A(h)} \in \prod_{a\in A(h)} \Sigma^{ha}.$$

For incoming charge c, the **stage game at** (h, c, s) has utilities

$$U_i^{h,c,s}(a) = e_i^{c+\delta_h(a)}(\widehat{P}_{ha}(s^{ha})).$$

In the game started at the root, the incoming charge at h is c_h. With $e_i = u_i\epsilon_Z$, the expression is $u_i(\mathrm{play}_{ha}(s^{ha}))$, recovering the unpriced stage game. Each current action is tested against the same full family of child profiles; the incoming charge for its selected child is recomputed from that action.

Theorem 12.52 (Concurrent backward decomposition)**.** *A profile at* (h, c) *is subgame perfect exactly when every child continuation is subgame perfect at its own incoming charge and the current joint action is a pure Nash equilibrium of the stage game. All complete profiles satisfying the criterion are given by*

$$\mathrm{SPE}(h; c) \cong \coprod_{s\in\prod_{b\in A(h)} \mathrm{SPE}(hb;c+\delta_h(b))} \mathrm{NE}((A_i(h))_i, (U_i^{h,c,s})_i).$$

At a leaf use the singleton empty profile. The indexing retains all child policies, including those off the current path.

Proof.

(1) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Subgame perfection implies the property in every child. A change only to agent i's current action is among its admissible complete policy deviations; holding its child policies fixed gives exactly the stage-game inequality. This proves necessity.

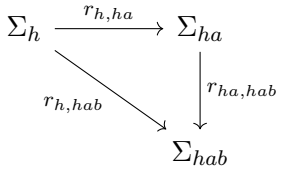
(2) **Forward implication.** For sufficiency, take a complete deviation of agent i. Its new current action, combined with the other agents' unchanged actions, selects a child hb. In that child the deviator may also change its entire continuation.

(3) **Strategic comparison.** The Nash property of the chosen child profile at $(hb, c + \delta_h(b))$ bounds the deviator's payoff by $U_i^{h,c,s}(b)$. Indeed its measured suffix result is evaluated by $e_i^{c+\delta_h(b)}$ on both sides of the child Nash inequality. By the square in Construction 12.42, the left side is the parent's value of the full deviation. Stage Nash bounds the right side by $U_i^{h,c,s}(a)$ for the original joint action a. Thus the complete deviation is not profitable at h.

(4) **Apply the subgame induction.** Every proper subgame already has the required property. Induction on height proves the theorem and the displayed decomposition.

□

Child-continuation policy restriction composes with deeper restriction.



A simultaneous stage need not have a pure Nash equilibrium, so the resulting subgame-perfect set may be empty. When each stage has only one nontrivial owner, its Nash condition becomes the nonempty argmax condition and the construction recovers Theorem 12.46. The same continuation restriction maps cover both cases, distinguishing finite perfect-information choice from simultaneous concurrent rounds.

Corollary 12.53 (One-round deviations suffice)**.** *For a finite public game tree, a profile is subgame perfect iff, at every history, no agent can improve by changing only its action in that round and retaining its original continuation everywhere, evaluating each reached child at its inherited charge.*

Proof.

(1) **Induction from the leaves.** The forward implication is immediate. For the reverse, induct upward from the leaves. The induction gives subgame perfection of every child profile, while the one-round inequalities are the stage Nash condition. Theorem 12.52 proves the inductive step.

□

Continuing agency now has both an operational residual and a policy for future observations. On finite public trees, their evaluation retains off-path continuations and inherited charges. The remaining economic questions concern how such evaluations direct policy change and reporting.

13 Epistemic Rationality and Strategic Dynamics

The theory now describes how agents continue and what alternatives remain available. Evaluation gives those alternatives a direction: a positive gain is a reason to change policy. We study the resulting improvement relation, construct termination ranks in the finite acyclic case, and determine when all unilateral gains integrate to a single potential. Belief and reporting then provide two further uses of the same comparison interface. Rationality evaluates responses against the opponents an owner considers possible; incentive compatibility evaluates reports while keeping the true type fixed.

13.1 Improvement dynamics and termination

Evaluating both ends of a deviation gives its signed gain. The deviations with positive gain form a directed graph, whose sinks are precisely the Nash equilibria. On a finite nonempty carrier, acyclicity supplies an integer rank that decreases at each improvement step. The termination argument applies to a process that actually takes such steps.

Notation 13.1 (Utilities on profiles)**.** In the numerical results below, $u_i : \Sigma \to \mathbb{K}$ denotes the profile value descended from $e_i r$ by Proposition 5.50 on the full completed profile carrier. The elementary strategic-form input is included by taking $K = \Sigma$, $r(\sigma) = (0, \sigma)$ and $e_i(c, \sigma) = u_i(\sigma)$. When the value factors through the concurrent arrow this also gives $u_i = k_i g$. On a proper legal completed carrier, deviations use its restricted span; the full-product elimination results below concern their stated product games. A utility evaluated on a typed outcome will instead have its domain displayed explicitly, as in the reporting contexts of Section 13.3.

Construction 13.2 (The comprehension of profitable alternatives)**.**

(1) **Measure the gain of a deviation.** On the dependent deviation context $p_1 : D_i \to \Sigma$, put $\gamma_i = u_i p_2 - u_i p_1$ and take the comprehension $J_i = \{\gamma_i > 0\} \hookrightarrow D_i$. Its paired endpoint map is jointly monic and presents $\mathsf{PDev}_i \subseteq \Sigma^2$.

(2) **Recover the equilibrium predicate.** Hence in the assertion fibre over 1_G,

$$\mathsf{NE}_G = \bigwedge_i \neg \exists_{p_1 : J_i \to \Sigma} \top.$$

Indeed the existential image consists exactly of profiles with a positive-gain alternative. The term γ_i is retained before comprehension, so the construction preserves the magnitudes used by potential and integrability arguments. For a completed profile with descended exact net value as in Construction 2.8 and Proposition 5.50, choose endpoint witnesses k, k' for a deviation. With $e_i(c, z) = u_i^0(z) - \ell_i(c)$ its gain is

$$\gamma_i = \big[u_i^0(a(k')) - u_i^0(a(k))\big] - \big[\ell_i(m(k')) - \ell_i(m(k))\big].$$

Value descent makes this difference independent of the endpoint witnesses. Both differences are taken in the signed payoff group.

13.1.1 Profitable changes and termination

Definition 13.3 (Improvement paths and ordinal potentials)**.** Put $P = \bigcup_{i \in N} \mathsf{PDev}_i \hookrightarrow \Sigma^2$, the directed relation of strictly profitable unilateral changes. A **finite improvement path** of length n is a tuple $(\sigma_0, \ldots, \sigma_n) \in \Sigma^{n+1}$ with $\sigma_k P \sigma_{k+1}$ for every $k < n$. An **infinite improvement path** is a map $\sigma : \mathbb{N} \to \Sigma$ with $\sigma(k) P \sigma(k+1)$ for every k. A path is **maximal** when it is infinite or its final vertex has no outgoing P-edge.

A **generalized ordinal potential** is a map $\Phi : \Sigma \to \mathbb{K}$ satisfying

$$\sigma P \tau \Longrightarrow \Phi(\sigma) < \Phi(\tau).$$

In the numerical setting, an **exact potential** additionally satisfies $\Phi(\tau) - \Phi(\sigma) = u_i(\tau) - u_i(\sigma)$ for every $(\sigma, \tau) \in D_i$ and every owner i. Exact potentials can be analyzed through the same gain interface; neither kind of potential is identified with welfare or an adjustment scheduler.

Lemma 13.4 (Exact potential in a cancellative value monoid)**.** *For values $u_i, \Phi : \Sigma \to M$ in a commutative cancellative monoid M, the signed gains of u_i and Φ agree in $\mathrm{Gr}(M)$ on the owner-i deviations exactly when*

$$\Phi(\tau) + u_i(\sigma) = \Phi(\sigma) + u_i(\tau) \qquad ((\sigma, \tau) \in D_i).$$

Proof.

(1) **Construct signed differences.** On M^2 put $(a, b) \sim (c, d)$ when $a + d = b + c$. For transitivity add the two balance equations and cancel the common intermediate terms. Reflexivity and symmetry follow from commutativity. Componentwise addition descends to the quotient, $[(0, 0)]$ is its unit and $[(b, a)]$ is the inverse of $[(a, b)]$. Every monoid map f from M to an abelian group extends uniquely by $[(a, b)] \mapsto f(a) - f(b)$, giving the group completion.

(2) **Compare deviations.** Represent the gain of u_i by $[(u_i(\tau), u_i(\sigma))]$. The equivalence relation identifies its sum along two successive deviations with the gain between their outer endpoints. Equality with the corresponding potential gain is precisely the displayed balance equation.

(3) **Recover exact numerical gains.** For $M = R_+$ the completion is $R_\pm$. For signed values, adding the two initial values to the difference equation gives the balance equation, and cancellation recovers the difference equation. Strict improvement is still read from the owner's comparison on its value carrier.

□

Corollary 13.5 (A shared execution price and exact potentials)**.** *Let Φ be an exact potential for intrinsic profile values u_i^0. For a common descended scalar deduction $b : \Sigma \to \mathbb{K}$, the measured utilities $u_i = u_i^0 - b$ have exact potential $\Phi - b$.*

Proof.

(1) **Compute a measured gain.** For an i-deviation (σ, τ), the change in u_i equals the change in u_i^0 minus $b(\tau) - b(\sigma)$. The intrinsic change is $\Phi(\tau) - \Phi(\sigma)$ by exactness. Rearrangement gives exactly $(\Phi - b)(\tau) - (\Phi - b)(\sigma)$.

(2) **Identify the deduction.** For an additive price ℓ, a charge whose price descends gives $b(qk) = \ell(m(k))$. Thus the calculation uses subtraction in the ordered payoff group and only addition in the charge monoid. For distinct owner prices the exactness test uses the corresponding owner's deduction on each deviation, as in Lemma 13.4.

□

Theorem 13.6 (Finite improvement and equilibrium)**.** *Let the profile space Σ be finite and nonempty. The following are equivalent: P has no directed cycle; every improvement path is finite; and an integer-valued generalized ordinal potential exists. Under these conditions every maximal improvement path ends at a Nash equilibrium, and at least one such equilibrium exists. A potential can be constructed with values in $\{0, \dots, |\Sigma| - 1\}$.*

Proof.

(1) **Infinite paths and directed cycles.** A directed cycle can be repeated to make an infinite path. Conversely an infinite path in a finite graph repeats a vertex and therefore contains a directed cycle. An increasing potential excludes such a cycle, since returning to its starting vertex would strictly increase the same potential value.

(2) **Construction of a ranking function.** If the graph is acyclic, define $h(\sigma)$ to be the largest length of a directed path ending at σ. Every such path is simple, so this integer exists and is at most $|\Sigma| - 1$. For an edge $\sigma P \tau$, a longest path to σ cannot already contain τ, since that would give a cycle.

(3) **Strategic comparison.** Appending the edge proves $h(\tau) \geq h(\sigma) + 1$. Thus h is the required potential. Every maximal path is finite and ends at a vertex with no profitable deviation, exactly Equation (5.6).

(4) **Strategic comparison: completion.** For existence, take a profile on which the integer h is maximal. It cannot have an outgoing improvement edge, since every such edge raises h by at least one. Thus it is a Nash equilibrium.

□

An arrow records a profitable deviation. A profile satisfies the equilibrium test exactly when it has no outgoing arrow.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{PDev}_i & \hookrightarrow & L \times L \\ {\scriptstyle p_1}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_1} \\ L & = & L \end{array}$$

This is also a logical termination certificate. The integer $\rho = |\Sigma| - 1 - h$ satisfies

$$P(\sigma, \tau) \Longrightarrow \rho(\tau) < \rho(\sigma).$$

The rank is a certificate for paths that actually take profitable steps. A process permitted to idle at a non-equilibrium state can still run forever; no fairness principle turns arbitrary execution into an improvement path. The termination result is therefore about the displayed improvement relation, not every operational transition.

13.1.2 The obstruction to integrating unilateral gains

The profitable-alternative comprehension retains more than its positive part: each legal deviation has a signed gain. We now ask when these gains are differences of one profile value. The graph-flow analysis of Candogan et al. (2011) supplies a useful precedent. Here the graph uses the actual coupled legal domain, and its comparison with pricing and delegation uses the already constructed measured values and ownerwise alternative lifts.

The constructions in this subsubsection use finite legal carriers $L \subseteq \prod_i \Sigma_i$. Algebraic gains take values in an abelian group A; the quantitative results use $A = \mathbb{R}$. Each $u_i : L \to A$ is the profile value descended by Proposition 5.50, rather than a value obtained by selecting an execution witness. Effective exact numerical algorithms below use rational input. The finite cases are already realized by the complete-policy protocols of Section 10.2.

Construction 13.7 (The legal-deviation graph and its gain cochain)**.**

(1) **Retain legal unilateral comparisons.** Let Γ_L have vertex set L, with an undirected edge between distinct σ, τ when $(\sigma, \tau) \in D^L_{\{i\}}$. Its owner i is unique: distinct tuples cannot differ only in each of two different coordinates. Retain both directed traversals of every edge, with tail $s(e)$, head $t(e)$, and owner $i(e)$.

(2) **Form the cochain complex.** Put

$$C^0 = A^L, \qquad C^1 = C^1(\Gamma_L; A),$$
$$(d\Phi)(e) = \Phi(t(e)) - \Phi(s(e)), \qquad \omega(e) = u_{i(e)}(t(e)) - u_{i(e)}(s(e)).$$

Here C^1 is the antisymmetric cochain group of Lemma 7.21; reversing an edge negates its gain. Define $H^1(\Gamma_L; A) = C^1/dC^0$, the cohomology of this one-dimensional graph with constant coefficients. No extra two-cells or independently feasible policy tuples are inserted.

(3) **Compare with exact potentials.** An exact potential on L is a map $\Phi : L \to A$ with $d\Phi = \omega$. Reflexive deviations have zero gain and impose no additional equation. Thus this condition tests every actual legal unilateral alternative, including changes to unused policy entries.

Theorem 13.8 (Exact potential obstruction and constructive recovery)**.** *The following conditions are equivalent:*

(1) *An A-valued exact potential exists on L.*

(2) *$[\omega] = 0$ in $H^1(\Gamma_L; A)$.*

(3) *The signed gain sum around every closed walk is zero.*

(4) *The gain sum around every fundamental cycle of a spanning forest is zero.*

When they hold, integration along the forest constructs every potential, with one free additive constant per connected component. For a graph with v vertices, e edges, and k components,

$$H^1(\Gamma_L; A) \cong A^{e-v+k}.$$

The isomorphism records the signed fundamental-cycle sums.

Proof.

(1) **Identify the primitive fibre.** By Construction 13.7, an exact potential is precisely an element of $\mathrm{Prim}(\omega)$ on the actual legal-deviation graph.

(2) **Integrate the gains.** Apply Lemma 7.21 with $K = \Gamma_L$. Its period tests, torsor description, and obstruction coordinates give all four equivalences and both recovery statements.

□

Construction 13.9 (The sheaf of local potential primitives)**.**

(1) **Use the graph incidence space.** Give the face poset of Γ_L, with arrows from vertices to incident edges, its upper Alexandrov topology. Assign a copy of A to each vertex and edge. For $e : u \to v$, use the stalk maps

$$A_u \longrightarrow A_e, \quad a \longmapsto a, \qquad A_v \longrightarrow A_e, \quad b \longmapsto b - \omega(e).$$

Compatible tuples on opens define a sheaf $\mathcal{T}_\omega$. The maps are equivariant bijections under addition by A.

(2) **Identify local and global primitives.** A vertex star trivializes this sheaf by selecting its vertex value and transporting it to its incident edges. Hence $\mathcal{T}_\omega$ is a torsor for the locally constant sheaf $\underline{A}$. A global section satisfies $\Phi(u) = \Phi(v) - \omega(e)$ on every edge; its vertex values are exactly an exact potential.

(3) **Compute its gluing class.** Cover the incidence space by its vertex stars. Distinct stars meet in their common edge point when adjacent, and no three stars meet. The constant-sheaf sections are one copy of A on each star and each nonempty intersection. The resulting Čech differential is exactly $d : A^L \to A^{E(\Gamma_L)}$. Each star has an initial object, so its sections functor is stalk evaluation and is exact; the edge intersections are likewise acyclic. This cover computes sheaf cohomology. With the displayed orientation convention, the translation class of $\mathcal{T}_\omega$ is $[\omega]$.

Local primitives glue precisely when their common translation class is zero. The endpoint equation is the following commuting square.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} 1 & \xrightarrow{\Phi(u)} & A_u \\ {\scriptstyle \Phi(v)}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle a\mapsto a} \\ A_v & \xrightarrow[b\mapsto b-\omega(e)]{} & A_e. \end{array}$$

Proposition 13.10 (Returning a finite potential to the value monoid)**.** *Let $u_i : L \to M$ take values in a commutative cancellative monoid, and form gains in $A = \mathrm{Gr}(M)$. On finite L, $[\omega] = 0$ exactly when there is $\Phi : L \to M$ satisfying*

$$\Phi(\tau) + u_i(\sigma) = \Phi(\sigma) + u_i(\tau) \qquad ((\sigma, \tau) \in D^L_{\{i\}}).$$

Proof.

(1) **Pass to signed gains.** The displayed balance equations give $d\Phi = \omega$ in the group completion by Lemma 13.4, proving necessity.

(2) **Translate a group-valued primitive into the monoid.** For the converse, Theorem 13.8 constructs a primitive with values $a_\sigma - b_\sigma$, where $a_\sigma, b_\sigma \in M$. Put $c = \sum_{\rho \in L} b_\rho$. Adding c leaves each gain unchanged and represents the value at σ by $a_\sigma + \sum_{\rho \neq \sigma} b_\rho \in M$. Cancellativity makes $M \to \mathrm{Gr}(M)$ injective, so the group equalities recover the balance equations in M.

□

13.1.3 Pricing and delegation of the potential obstruction

Theorem 13.11 (Attainable pricing corrections)**.** *For specified descended charges $b_i : L \to A$, put $u_i' = u_i - b_i$ and $\beta_b(e) = b_{i(e)}(t(e)) - b_{i(e)}(s(e))$. Then*

$$\omega' = \omega - \beta_b, \qquad [\omega'] = [\omega] - [\beta_b].$$

For the actual permitted family $\mathcal{B}$ of charge profiles, an exact-potential correction exists exactly when

$$[\omega] \in \{[\beta_b] : b \in \mathcal{B}\}.$$

The permitted family need not be a vector space or group.

Proof.

(1) **Evaluate the charged alternatives.** Subtract the charged endpoint utilities on each owner-labelled edge. This gives $\omega' = \omega - \beta_b$ and hence the equality of classes.

(2) **Test the actual attainable corrections.** Apply Theorem 13.8: a permitted b gives an exact potential precisely when $[\omega] = [\beta_b]$. When this holds, forest integration constructs the corrected potential.

□

Corollary 13.12 (Charges that preserve the obstruction)**.** *The class $[\omega]$ is unchanged by each of the following operations, or any sum of them:*

(1) *Every owner is charged the same profile-dependent value $b(\sigma)$.*

(2) *Owner i is charged $f_i(\sigma_i)$, depending only on its own policy.*

(3) *Owner i is charged $g_i(\sigma_{-i})$, depending only on outsiders.*

Proof.

(1) **Compute common and own-policy charges.** In the first case $\beta_b = db$. In the second, put $B(\sigma) = \sum_i f_i(\sigma_i)$. Along an owner-$i$ edge, every other summand is unchanged, so $\beta_b = dB$, even on a coupled legal domain.

(2) **Compute outsider charges and sums.** In the third case the charge does not change on that owner's deviation, so $\beta_b = 0$. Each correction is therefore exact, and the same holds for their sums by additivity.

□

An owner-specific price of a shared execution measurement need not have one of these forms. Its effect is computed from Theorem 13.11. The corollary strengthens Corollary 13.5 by also excluding a potential repair by these charges when the initial obstruction is nonzero. It does not assert invariance of equilibrium profiles.

Theorem 13.13 (Whole-owner delegation preserves and reflects the obstruction)**.** *Use the finite ownerwise implementation $h = \prod_i h_i : \prod_i \Theta_i \twoheadrightarrow \prod_i T_i$ onto the actually implemented parent policies, with $L_T = L \cap \prod_i T_i$ and $L_h = h^{-1}(L_T)$. Treat the delegates of each parent as one block, as in Theorem 4.14, and give it the parent's pulled-back utility. The induced graph map, allowing collapsed edges, satisfies*

$$\omega_h = h^* \omega_T, \qquad [\omega_h] = 0 \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad [\omega_T] = 0.$$

More generally, $h^* : H^1(\Gamma_{L_T}; A) \to H^1(\Gamma_{L_h}; A)$ is injective.

Proof.

(1) **Compare gain cochains.** A whole-block change either changes one parent coordinate or leaves the parent profile fixed. Pulled-back utilities give the same gain in the first case and zero in the second. Set pullback cochains to zero on collapsed edges. Then $\omega_h = h^* \omega_T$ and $h^* d = d h^*$.

(2) **Descend a primitive along implementation fibres.** For any parent cochain α, suppose $h^* \alpha = d\psi$. Each fibre $h^{-1}(\sigma)$ is a product of nonempty coordinate fibres. Changing its coordinates one block at a time connects any two points by legal edges collapsed by h. The primitive ψ is constant on each such edge, and therefore on the entire fibre. It descends to a function $\Phi : L_T \to A$.

(3) **Recover every parent edge equation.** A parent edge lifts at a chosen source by retaining outsider coordinates and choosing a preimage of the changed coordinate. Evaluating $d\psi = h^*\alpha$ on this edge gives $d\Phi = \alpha$. Thus h^* is injective. Applying this to $\alpha = \omega_T$ proves reflection, while pulling back a potential proves preservation.

□

The cochain comparison retains collapsed edges as zero gains. It descends to the injective map on obstruction classes.

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} A^{L_T} & \xrightarrow{d} & A^{E(\Gamma_{L_T})} & \longrightarrow & H^1(\Gamma_{L_T}; A) \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle h^*} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle h^*} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle h^*} \\ A^{L_h} & \xrightarrow[d]{} & A^{E(\Gamma_{L_h})} & \longrightarrow & H^1(\Gamma_{L_h}; A). \end{array}$$

The comparison is with the implemented parent domain. It neither discards parent policies outside that domain nor identifies a single delegate's move with a whole-parent deviation.

13.1.4 A sharp approximation and equilibrium certificate

For real-valued gains on the finite graph, put

$$\varepsilon_* := \min_{\Phi: L \to \mathbb{R}} \|\omega - d\Phi\|_\infty.$$

The empty edge set has norm zero. For a cycle C, let $\omega(C)$ denote its gain sum with the chosen traversal orientation.

Theorem 13.14 (Cycle-mean formula and constructive optimizer)**.** *The minimum is attained and*

$$\varepsilon_* = \max\left(\{0\} \cup \left\{\frac{|\omega(C)|}{|C|} : C \text{ a simple cycle in } \Gamma_L\right\}\right). \tag{13.1}$$

For rational gains, finite cycle enumeration followed by a difference-constraint construction computes an optimizing potential exactly.

Proof.

(1) **Bound every approximation by a cycle.** For every Φ, summing along C cancels $d\Phi$, so

$$|\omega(C)| \le |C| \, \|\omega - d\Phi\|_\infty.$$

Thus the right side of (13.1), denoted μ, is a lower bound.

(2) **Construct a graph without positive cycles.** Replace each edge by two directed arcs with opposite gains. Give an arc $u \to v$ weight $w(u, v) = \omega(u, v) - \mu$. Every simple directed cycle has nonpositive weight: a two-arc return has weight -2μ, and a longer simple cycle satisfies $\omega(C) \le |C|\mu$. Splitting a closed walk at repeated vertices proves the same for every directed closed walk.

(3) **Integrate by maximum path weights.** Add a source with a zero-weight arc to every vertex. Let $\Phi(v)$ be the maximum weight of a path from it to v. Removing a nonpositive cycle never decreases weight, so the maximum is attained among finitely many simple paths. Appending an arc and then removing cycles gives

$$\Phi(v) \ge \Phi(u) + \omega(u, v) - \mu.$$

Apply the same inequality to the reverse arc to obtain $|\omega(u,v) - (\Phi(v) - \Phi(u))| \le \mu$. This attains the lower bound and proves the formula. All operations are finite rational additions, comparisons, and divisions on rational input; arbitrary represented real comparisons are not treated as decidable operations.

□

Corollary 13.15 (Approximate equilibrium and finite improvement)**.** *For finite nonempty L, if $\|\omega - d\Phi\|_\infty \le \varepsilon$, every maximizer σ of Φ satisfies*

$$u_i(\tau) - u_i(\sigma) \le \varepsilon \qquad (\tau \in D^L_{\{i\}}(\sigma)).$$

In particular Theorem 13.14 gives a legal ε_*-Nash equilibrium. When $[\omega] = 0$, every strictly profitable unilateral path is finite and every maximal such path ends at a legal Nash equilibrium.

Proof.

(1) **Bound the deviator's gain.** At a maximizer, $\Phi(\tau) - \Phi(\sigma) \le 0$. The residual bound therefore gives $u_i(\tau) - u_i(\sigma) \le \varepsilon$ on every oriented legal deviation, including the reversed orientation of an edge.

(2) **Use an exact potential for termination.** With zero residual, every strictly profitable step strictly increases Φ. No vertex can repeat on a finite carrier. A maximal path ends at a profile with no profitable legal deviation, exactly the legal Nash predicate. This recovers Theorem 13.6 for the exact-potential case on the actual legal subobject.

□

For arbitrary real-valued data, maximization here is the ordinary finite numerical statement. With rationally encoded values, its comparisons and the construction are effective. An empty legal domain has no equilibrium; its vacuous potential equations do not give one.

Corollary 13.16 (Pricing invariance of the approximation obstruction)**.** *Every charge operation in Corollary 13.12 preserves ε_*.*

Proof.

(1) **Translate the candidate primitives.** Such a charge changes ω by dB for some B. Translating every candidate Φ by B leaves the set of residual cochains unchanged. Equivalently, all cycle circulations in (13.1) remain unchanged.

□

The invariant is the best uniform approximation of all unilateral gains by one potential. It is not the smallest equilibrium regret at an individual profile.

Example 13.17 (A nonzero obstruction and a pricing-induced equilibrium)**.** In matching pennies, take $a, b \in \{0,1\}$ and $u_1(a,b) = \mathbf{1}_{\{a=b\}}$, $u_2(a,b) = \mathbf{1}_{\{a\neq b\}}$. The cycle

$$(0,0) \longrightarrow (0,1) \longrightarrow (1,1) \longrightarrow (1,0) \longrightarrow (0,0)$$

has gain one at each edge. Its period is four and $\varepsilon_* = 1$, so no exact potential exists. Charge both owners $b(0,0) = 0$ and $b = 2$ elsewhere. The obstruction class is unchanged, yet $(0,0)$ becomes a strict Nash equilibrium: owner 1's deviation to $(1,0)$ has gain -3, and owner 2's deviation to $(0,1)$ has gain -1.

Example 13.18 (Ordinal integration does not imply exact integration)**.** On $\{0,1\}^2$, let $u_1(a,b) = a(1+b)$ and $u_2(a,b) = b$. Every profitable move changes a zero coordinate to one, so $a+b$ is an ordinal potential and $(1,1)$ is the unique Nash equilibrium. The cycle $(0,0),(1,0),(1,1),(0,1),(0,0)$ has gains $1,1,-2,-1$, whose sum is -1. Its exact-potential obstruction is nonzero. Thus the cohomological test identifies exact integration; it does not equate nonintegrability with failure of ordinal termination or absence of equilibrium.

13.2 Epistemic rationality and elimination

Situated rationality combines the realized profile $s : W \to \Sigma^G$, supplied comparison feedback, and the owners' possibility relations. An agent's response is tested against the opponents it considers possible, which need not be the actual opponents. To connect such a predicate to elimination of strategies, we must keep the rectangular closure of these possibilities explicit and retain the witnesses used by best-response and dominance tests.

Public restriction uses the comprehension update of Section 9.1. Iterated elimination applies that operation repeatedly, with the rationality predicate evaluated afresh in the surviving model. Following van Benthem and Gheerbrant (2010); van Benthem, Pacuit, and Roy (2011), we compare the policies that survive with the policies compatible with common belief in rationality.

13.2.1 Belief, common belief, and survival under elimination

Definition 13.19 (Rectangular closure)**.** For $S \hookrightarrow \Sigma = \prod_{j\in N} \Sigma_j$, put

$$\mathrm{Rect}(S) = (\pi_j[S])_{j\in N}, \qquad \mathrm{Prod}(L) = \prod_j L_j.$$

The rectangular closure $\mathrm{Prod}(\mathrm{Rect}(S))$ recombines represented owner coordinates independently. For example, (a,b) and (a',b') generate $\{a,a'\} \times \{b,b'\}$, including the crossed combinations.

Fix a possibility model as in Section A.2.14, over a $\mathbb{K}$-valued strategic game. The closure has the following universal property; Definition 13.22 then uses it to define rationality once on the resulting opponent sets.

Proposition 13.20 (Rectangular closure)**.** *For the maps in Definition 13.19, with rectangular restrictions ordered coordinatewise,*

$$\mathrm{Rect}(S) \le L \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad S \subseteq \mathrm{Prod}(L). \tag{13.2}$$

Hence $\mathrm{Rect} \dashv \mathrm{Prod}$*, and* $\mathrm{Prod}(\mathrm{Rect}(S))$ *is the closure of* S *under independent recombination of its represented owner coordinates.*

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The inequality $\mathrm{Rect}(S) \le L$ says $\pi_j[S] \subseteq L_j$ for every owner j. This holds exactly when every $s \in S$ has each coordinate in L_j, namely when $S \subseteq \prod_j L_j$. The adjunction follows.

(2) **Rectangular-closure unit.** Its unit $S \subseteq \mathrm{Prod}(\mathrm{Rect}(S))$ is the asserted rectangular closure.

□

Corollary 13.21 (Rectangular algebras)**.** *The endomap* Prod Rect *is an idempotent monad on* $\mathsf{Pred}(\Sigma)$*. Its algebra poset consists of the subsets that are products of coordinate subsets, ordered by inclusion.*

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The adjunction gives an extensive monotone map, and the two triangle inequalities give idempotence. Its fixed subsets are exactly the image of Prod, because any right-adjoint value is fixed by the induced posetal monad and every fixed value has that form.

□

Definition 13.22 (Pointwise rationality)**.** For agent i define

$$Q_i(w) = \mathrm{Prod}(\mathrm{Rect}(s[P_i(w)])) = \prod_{j \in N} s_j[P_i(w)].$$

Rectangularity is the closure under independent recombination of strategy coordinates represented at states related to w. Player i is **pointwise rational** at w when some $t \in Q_i(w)$ makes its current strategy a global best response:

$$\exists t \in Q_i(w)\ \forall a_i \in \Sigma_i, \qquad u_i(s_i(w), t_{-i}) \geq u_i(a_i, t_{-i}). \tag{13.3}$$

This is rationality relative to a possible pure opponent profile, not expected utility relative to a probability distribution. Let Rat be the states where every agent is pointwise rational and put

$$E(X) = \bigcap_i B_i X.$$

Proposition 13.23 (Pointwise rationality after private action update)**.** *Let $s : W \to \Sigma$ be the world realization of the qualitative possibility model, and apply an epistemic action model $\mathcal{E} = (E, (S_i), P)$. Use the unchanged reference-profile term $sp : U \to \Sigma$. At $(w, e) \in U$, define the old-world projection of the updated possibility set by*

$$V_i^{\mathcal{E}}(w, e) = \{w' \in W : \exists f \in E,\ R_i(w, w') \wedge S_i(e, f) \wedge P_f(w')\}.$$

The updated pointwise-rationality predicate of owner i is exactly

$$\exists t \in \prod_{j \in N} s_j[V_i^{\mathcal{E}}(w, e)]\ \forall b_i \in \Sigma_i, \qquad u_i(s_i(w), t_{-i}) \geq u_i(b_i, t_{-i}). \tag{13.4}$$

Thus the same selection predicate is tested against the product-updated possibility fibre, which can change under private action information even when the economic policy and utility maps do not change.

Proof.

(1) **Policy-level comparison.** Equation (9.9) says that the updated possible states at (w, e) are exactly the enabled pairs (w', f) with $R_i(w, w')$ and $S_i(e, f)$. Their image under the unchanged profile map sp is the set of profiles $s(w')$ with $w' \in V_i^{\mathcal{E}}(w, e)$. Taking rectangular closure gives the product in Equation (13.4), as in Definition 13.22.

(2) **Strategic comparison.** The global best-response inequality uses the same current policy $s_i(w)$ and original alternatives Σ_i, proving the formula even when the updated possibility fibre is empty.

□

Construction 13.24 (Rationality and common belief)**.**

(1) **Form the greatest fixed point.**

$$C = \nu X(\mathrm{Rat} \wedge E(X)) = \mathrm{Rat} \wedge \mathsf{CB}(\mathrm{Rat}). \tag{13.5}$$

(2) **Identify the common-belief predicate.** The equality is Proposition 6.10.

By Theorem 5.24, $C \subseteq \mathrm{Rat}$ and $P_i(w) \subseteq C$ whenever $w \in C$. Equivalently, C consists of states that are rational themselves and whose states reachable by every finite positive-length chain of supplied belief relations are rational. The factorization above makes explicit that no factivity axiom has been hidden in the word "belief."

Definition 13.25 (Local strict dominance and iterated elimination)**.** For a restriction $L = (L_j)_{j \in N}$ with $L_j \subseteq \Sigma_j$, a policy $a_i \in L_i$ is **strictly dominated within** L if there is $b_i \in L_i$ such that the opponent product $\prod_{j \neq i} L_j$ is inhabited and

$$u_i(b_i, a_{-i}) > u_i(a_i, a_{-i}) \quad \text{for every } a_{-i} \in \prod_{j \neq i} L_j.$$

Iterated elimination repeatedly removes such dominated policies, using the remaining policy sets at each step and intersections at limits.

The tested policy and its possible dominator are both drawn from the current restriction. The explicit opponent witness also prevents vacuous strict dominance when the opponent carrier is empty. This is a different test from being a best response to at least one possible opponent profile; changing their quantifiers changes the resulting elimination operator.

Construction 13.26 (Pure strict-dominance elimination)**.**

(1) **Iterate strict-dominance elimination.** Define iterated elimination of locally strictly dominated pure strategies by $L_i^0 = \Sigma_i$ and

$$\begin{aligned} L_i^{\alpha+1} = \{a_i \in L_i^\alpha : \text{there is no } b_i \in L_i^\alpha \text{ such that} \\ \big(\exists a_{-i} \in \prod_{j \neq i} L_j^\alpha\big) \wedge \\ \forall a_{-i} \in \prod_{j \neq i} L_j^\alpha,\ u_i(b_i, a_{-i}) > u_i(a_i, a_{-i})\}, \end{aligned}$$

with intersections at limit ordinals.

(2) **Test opponents in the restriction.** The explicit witness of an opponent profile prevents strict dominance from becoming vacuously true after a restriction has no realizable opponent tuple. On every inhabited rectangular restriction this is exactly the ordinary definition. Each stage is determined extensionally by the preceding restriction; no strategy is selected for deletion.

(3) **Read off stabilization.** For finite games the sequence stabilizes after finitely many strict deletions. The survival theorem below only uses transfinite induction over these recursively defined stages, so no stabilization claim for arbitrary strategy sets is needed.

Theorem 13.27. *Every strategy played at a state in C survives every stage of this elimination procedure.*

Proof.

(1) **Construction of the comparison.** Put $S_i = s_i[C]$. We prove $S_i \subseteq L_i^\alpha$ for every i by transfinite induction. The initial and limit cases are immediate.

(2) **Fixed-point argument.** For the successor step, take $a_i = s_i(w)$ with $w \in C$. Pointwise rationality gives $t \in Q_i(w)$ satisfying Equation (13.3). Since $P_i(w) \subseteq C$, each coordinate t_j belongs to S_j, hence by induction to L_j^α.

(3) **Strategic comparison.** If a surviving b_i strictly dominated a_i against every surviving opponent profile, then in particular

$$u_i(b_i, t_{-i}) > u_i(a_i, t_{-i}),$$

contradicting the global best-response inequality, which quantifies over every original b_i. Thus a_i is not removed at the successor stage.

□

This reconstructs a qualitative rationality-to-survival comparison of the kind considered in Apt and Zvesper (2010). Global best response and local strict dominance have deliberately different quantifier patterns, and the theorem relies on those exact definitions. The resulting implication uses the pointwise rationality predicate of (13.3), not an expected-payoff or arbitrary best-response variant.

Epistemic conditions leading to Nash equilibrium are studied in Aumann and Brandenburger (1995). Here the comparison keeps actual and possible outsiders distinct at every step, so the epistemic assumptions are represented by the supplied possibility relation rather than folded into the outcome comparison.

13.2.2 Common belief under public restriction

Construction 13.28 (Relativized common belief)**.**

(1) **Restrict the belief relation.** For $a : U \hookrightarrow W$ put $A = \exists_a \top$, $E_W(X) = \bigwedge_i [R_i]X$, and $E_U(X) = \bigwedge_i [R_i|_U]X$.

(2) **Lift a predicate from the restriction.** For Q on U, put $\widehat{Q} = \forall_a Q$ and

$$\mathsf{RCB}_{A,\widehat{Q}} = \nu X \, (A \Rightarrow E_W(A \Rightarrow (\widehat{Q} \wedge X))).$$

Theorem 13.29 (Common belief after restriction)**.**

$$[!a]\mathsf{CB}_U(Q) = \mathsf{RCB}_{A,\widehat{Q}}. \tag{13.6}$$

Proof.

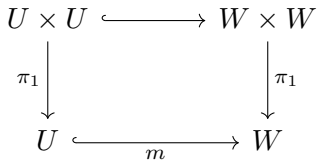
(1) **Construction of the comparison.** Let $\rho = a^*$, $J = \forall_a$, and $j_A = J\rho$. The public-update equation gives $JE_U(X) = j_A E_W(JX)$. For $F(X) = E_U(Q \wedge X)$, the operator $JF\rho$ is therefore

$$Y \longmapsto j_A E_W(JQ \wedge j_A Y) = j_A E_W(j_A(\widehat{Q} \wedge Y)),$$

since $\widehat{Q}$ is fixed by the meet-preserving nucleus j_A. Apply Corollary 9.10 to νF.

□

Restriction of the epistemic model is obtained by intersecting each accessibility relation with the announced subspace.



13.2.3 An exact epistemic characterization

Definition 13.30 (Global pure best responses and point rationalizability)**.** A **point-rationalizable** policy survives repeated removal of policies that cannot be a best response to any remaining pure opponent tuple. In the global operator defined here, a candidate is tested against all of the agent's original alternatives; only the possible opponents are restricted at each step. This distinction from local dominance elimination determines the exact epistemic characterization. No distribution over opponents is used in this notion of rationalizability.

The preceding survival theorem can be strengthened to an exact characterization when the elimination operator matches the rationality predicate. For a finite game, let a restriction be a tuple $L = (L_i)_{i \in N}$ with $L_i \subseteq \Sigma_i$. Define

$$\mathcal{B}_i(L) = \{a_i \in \Sigma_i : \exists t_{-i} \in \prod_{j \neq i} L_j \ \forall b_i \in \Sigma_i, \quad u_i(a_i, t_{-i}) \geq u_i(b_i, t_{-i})\}.$$

The opponent witness ranges over the current restriction, but the comparison ranges over every original alternative of the agent. Throughout this paper, "point rationalizability" refers to the greatest fixed point of this displayed global-best-response operator with pure opponent witnesses. The operator $\mathcal{B} = (\mathcal{B}_i)_i$ is monotone on the product lattice $\prod_i \mathcal{P}(\Sigma_i)$. Call its greatest fixed point $R = \nu\mathcal{B}$ the point-rationalizable restriction.

Construction 13.31 (Descending best-response iteration)**.**

(1) **Iterate best response.** Starting at the full restriction, put

$$L^0 = \Sigma, \qquad L^{n+1} = \mathcal{B}(L^n).$$

The sequence is descending: $\mathcal{B}(\Sigma) \subseteq \Sigma$, and if $L^n \subseteq L^{n-1}$ then monotonicity gives $L^{n+1} = \mathcal{B}(L^n) \subseteq \mathcal{B}(L^{n-1}) = L^n$.

(2) **Identify the greatest fixed point.** The product lattice is finite, so the sequence stabilizes at some L^* with $L^* = \mathcal{B}(L^*)$. If $F = \mathcal{B}(F)$ is any fixed point, then $F \subseteq L^0$, and induction gives $F = \mathcal{B}(F) \subseteq \mathcal{B}(L^n) = L^{n+1}$. Hence $F \subseteq L^*$, so L^* is the greatest fixed point $R = \nu\mathcal{B}$. No separate nonemptiness premise is needed. The fixed-point equation itself supplies exactly the extension property required by the epistemic construction.

Lemma 13.32 (Surviving strategies extend to surviving profiles)**.** *Let $R = \mathcal{B}(R)$. For every owner i and every $a_i \in R_i$, there is a profile $w \in \prod_j R_j$ with $w_i = a_i$. Consequently, if any surviving individual strategy exists then the full product $\prod_j R_j$ is nonempty.*

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** Since $a_i \in R_i = \mathcal{B}_i(R)$, the definition of $\mathcal{B}_i$ provides a tuple

$$t_{-i} \in \prod_{j \neq i} R_j$$

against which a_i is a global best response. The profile $w = (a_i, t_{-i})$ lies in $\prod_j R_j$ and has the required ith coordinate. No selection from a family of nonempty sets is involved: the needed opponent tuple is already the witness carried by membership in the fixed point.

□

Theorem 13.33 (Rationality with common belief and point rationalizability)**.** *In every possibility model satisfying the definitions of Section 13.2, every strategy played at a state satisfying pointwise rationality together with common belief of pointwise rationality belongs to R. Equivalently, the conclusion holds at every state in the predicate C of Equation (13.5). Conversely every profile in $\prod_i R_i$ occurs in a finite epistemic model in which agents know their own strategies and pointwise rationality is common knowledge at every state. Thus the surviving strategies have an exact epistemic realization.*

Pointwise rationality uses the actual observation kernel pair on epistemic states.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} W \times_{O_i} W & \hookrightarrow & W \times W \\ {\scriptstyle p_1}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \pi_1} \\ W & = & W \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Witness and legality comparison.** For the forward direction, let C be the rationality-and-common-belief predicate constructed above and put $S_i = s_i[C]$. For $a_i = s_i(w)$ with $w \in C$, rationality supplies an opponent witness drawn from $s_j[P_i(w)]$ for each $j \neq i$. Possibility closure gives $s_j[P_i(w)] \subseteq S_j$.

(2) **Coinduction and bisimulation.** The rationality inequality is global in the agent's alternatives, so $a_i \in \mathcal{B}_i(S)$. Therefore $S \subseteq \mathcal{B}(S)$. Coinduction in the product lattice gives $S \subseteq R$.

(3) **Reverse implication.** For the converse take the finite state space

$$W = \prod_i R_i.$$

It may be empty only when there is no surviving individual strategy to represent, by Lemma 13.32. Let the strategy map be inclusion into Σ and define $o_i(w) = w_i$.

(4) **Choice of representatives and quotients.** Take the epistemic relation to be the constructed kernel pair

$$R_i^{\mathrm{ep}} = \ker(o_i),$$

so its possibility fiber is

$$P_i(w) = \{t \in W : t_i = w_i\}.$$

Player i therefore knows its own strategy. Since $R_i = \mathcal{B}_i(R)$, the current strategy w_i is a global best response to some tuple in R_{-i}. Combining that tuple with w_i gives a state in $P_i(w)$ and hence a witness for Equation (13.3).

(5) **Common knowledge of rationality.** Thus all agents are rational at every state. Every epistemically accessible state is again in W, so rationality is common knowledge everywhere. Every profile in W is represented by construction.

(6) **Policy-level comparison.** Lemma 13.32 shows in addition that every surviving individual strategy occurs as a coordinate of one of those profiles. Thus the same constructed model realizes all surviving behavior without a separate nonemptiness premise.

□

The converse constructs a finite state space and observation maps in which every surviving profile satisfies the specified common-knowledge rationality condition. It also identifies the relevant elimination operator: global never-best-response elimination with pure opponent witnesses. This is the exact characterization compared with Apt and Zvesper (2010), not a claim about every iterative deletion procedure.

Example 13.34 (Pure best responses versus pure strict dominance)**.** Pure-witness rationalizability need not coincide with elimination of pure strictly dominated actions. For example, give agent 1 the rows a, b, c, agent 2 the columns L, R, and utilities

	L	R
a	2	0
b	0	2
c	11/10	11/10

for agent 1; give agent 2 utility zero everywhere. No row strictly dominates c, but c is not a best response to either pure column and is removed by $\mathcal{B}$. This exact difference is why the development has not called all these elimination procedures one notion of rationality. Probability distributions over opponent choices give a further best-response operator in probabilistic models of games.

The inclusion of a public comprehension has the quantifier adjoints of Theorem 5.22. When an update also changes the policy carriers, the counterfactual relation must be transported by Construction 5.70. The rectangular-image and possibility comparisons therefore occur at the correct updated strategic context, rather than merely at its reference world.

13.2.4 Re-evaluation and repeated public restriction

Iterated public announcements are successive comprehensions of the epistemic state carrier, as in Plaza (2007). The relevant rationality or survival predicate is re-evaluated after each restriction. Keeping this change of model explicit distinguishes public elimination from simply repeating a predicate on the original state space.

Proposition 13.35 (Finite stabilization of re-evaluated announcements)**.** *For every submodel carrier $A \subseteq W$, let $\Phi_A \subseteq A$ be a specified updated goal predicate, for example the denotation of a fixed epistemic formula in $M|_A$. Define*

$$F_\Phi(A) = \Phi_A \quad \textit{viewed as a subset of } W, \qquad A_0 = W, \quad A_{n+1} = F_\Phi(A_n).$$

If W is finite, this chain stabilizes after at most $|W|$ strict deletions. At the stable carrier the goal holds everywhere. If F_Φ is monotone, the stable carrier is its greatest fixed point. Without monotonicity that last conclusion need not hold.

Proof.

(1) **Fixed-point argument.** By construction $F_\Phi(A) \subseteq A$. Every strict step removes at least one element; thus there are at most $|W|$ strict steps. Equality at one step is the fixed-point equation.

(2) **Fixed-point argument: second comparison.** If F_Φ is monotone, every fixed point B is contained in A_0 and induction gives $B = F_\Phi(B) \subseteq F_\Phi(A_n) = A_{n+1}$.

(3) **Greatest fixed point and counterexample.** This proves greatestness. For failure without monotonicity, use the two-world model of Example 9.8 and $\Phi_A = [\![Kp]\!]_{M|_A}$. Then $F_\Phi(W) = \varnothing$ while $F_\Phi(\{x\}) = \{x\}$.

□

The operator $\mathcal{B}$ records one such elimination step, and $\nu\mathcal{B}$ denotes the states surviving every finite iteration. Its greatest-fixed-point meaning is justified by the descending comprehensions, not by treating a public update as an ordinary reference substitution.

13.2.5 Public elimination as an epistemic update

For each current policy carrier, the institutional test agent of Construction 11.10 uses the current elimination predicate as its observable test. By Proposition 11.11, success of that public test realizes the next comprehension carrier. Thus the fixed-point elimination sequence also has an agent-labelled execution at each step; its predicate is evaluated anew on the surviving carrier.

Construction 13.36 (Successive rationality announcements)**.**

(1) **Initialize the epistemic model.** Begin with state space $W_0 = \prod_i \Sigma_i$ and observations $o_i(s) = s_i$.

(2) **Announce rationality at each stage.** At a stage with $W_n = \prod_i L_i^n$, announce the assertion

$$\mathrm{Rat}_n(s) \iff \forall i\ \exists t_{-i} \in L_{-i}^n\ \forall b_i \in \Sigma_i,\ u_i(s_i, t_{-i}) \geq u_i(b_i, t_{-i}).$$

This is pointwise rationality in the restricted observation model: the agent's own action is known, while every surviving opponent tuple is possible.

(3) **Restrict the model.** Public announcement restricts the state space and its observation equivalence relations as in Equation (9.5).

Proposition 13.37 (Update equals elimination)**.** *Repeated announcements of these current rationality predicates give*

$$W_{n+1} = \prod_i \mathcal{B}_i(L^n).$$

They stabilize at the canonical point-rationalizable epistemic model with state space $\prod_i R_i$.

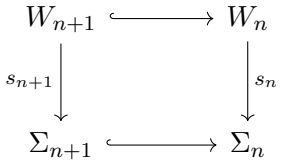
Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** Within the current product domain, the announcement says independently for each coordinate that $s_i \in \mathcal{B}_i(L^n)$. Thus the new domain is $\prod_i (L_i^n \cap \mathcal{B}_i(L^n))$. Along the descending iteration already proved, $\mathcal{B}_i(L^n) \subseteq L_i^n$, giving the displayed equality.

(2) **Observation and knowledge.** Observation relations remain equality of the appropriate coordinate, restricted to the new domain. Each announcement is the singleton action model with enabling predicate Rat_n and a trivial action relation; their iterated product update is canonically the successive comprehension by Theorem 9.25. Finite stabilization of the restrictions therefore proves stabilization of the models as well.

□

An elimination step is the pullback of the surviving-strategy inclusion along the profile map.



The resulting public updates realize the successive eliminations through the announcement and product-update semantics, while retaining the rationality predicate appropriate to each restricted game. This explains the link with the elimination result: repeatedly announcing one fixed subset of the original model would not, in general, implement the same sequence.

Proposition 13.38 (Actual-opponent rationality)**.** *At a pointwise rational state w, if every state considered possible by i has opponents' tuple $s_{-i}(w)$, for every i, then $s(w)$ is Nash. Conversely every Nash profile occurs in a one-state observation model with these properties.*

Proof.

(1) **Observation and knowledge.** The rationality witness has the actual opponents' tuple, so its inequalities are the Nash inequalities. Conversely take a singleton state with the given profile and the unique observation maps. Its only possible tuple is the given profile, and its Nash inequalities establish pointwise rationality.

□

At a fixed price, an opponent tuple that witnesses a global best response still witnesses it when the set of possible opponents expands. All the alternatives against that tuple have the same measured values as before, by Proposition 5.50. This gives the monotonicity step in Theorem 13.33. Changing the price can change the winning comparison. Revealing the charge to the owner would additionally require a signal and its observation map.

13.3 Reporting agents, incentive compatibility and truthfulness

A checker that accepts a report has received a message. What would give the sender an incentive to report its true type? We model the types and messages as ordinary data in T and their transmission and receipt as linear processes in L. Incentive compatibility compares the records produced by truthful and alternative messages at the same true type.

13.3.1 Type-indexed reporting interfaces

Definition 13.39 (Economic types and type-dependent valuations)**.** An **economic type** of owner i is a point $t_i \in T_i$ of its specified ordinary type carrier. For an outcome or allocation carrier Z, a **type-dependent valuation** has type

$$v_i : T_i \times Z \longrightarrow \mathbb{K}, \qquad (t_i, z) \longmapsto v_i(t_i, z).$$

If an outcome is presented by a resource certificate in K with allocation map $a : K \to Z$, the corresponding evaluation of a certificate is the composite $T_i \times K \xrightarrow{1\times a} T_i \times Z \xrightarrow{v_i} \mathbb{K}$; a certificate need not be identified with its allocation. The true type is held fixed when reports are varied. Economic types are ordinary parameters of valuation, distinct from resource types and from dependent semantic types.

Definition 13.40 (Messages, reports, and truthful reporting)**.** For an economic type carrier T_i and an allowed message carrier M_i, a **message** is $m_i \in M_i$. A **report** is a message

interpreted by the institution as a declaration of information about type. A **reporting policy** has type

$$s_i : T_i \longrightarrow M_i;$$

its value $s_i(t_i)$ is the message sent at true type t_i. In a **direct mechanism** $M_i = T_i$, and the **truthful reporting policy** is $\mathrm{tr}_i = \mathrm{id}_{T_i} : T_i \to T_i$. For finite carriers, its concurrent response realization has type $\widehat{s_i} : D(T_i) \to D(M_i)$. A general mechanism may instead use messages that do not denote types; no probabilistic inference from a message to a true type is implied.

Each reporting policy is a type-indexed function $s_i : T_i \to M_i$. It chooses the message associated with each possible type, including types not realized in the current execution. No prior or probabilistic inference from a message to a true type is introduced by the protocol.

Construction 13.41 (Concurrent reporting protocol)**.**

(1) **Wire the reporting components.** For finite message sets, a reporting rule has a direct concurrent realization even when its ambient outcome set is infinite. Tensor the agents' message-selection components and collect the chosen messages.

(2) **Collect the profile of messages.** The collector has one negative event for each possible input on each component; distinct values on a component conflict. For each full tuple it has an output event labelled by that tuple, dependent on all its input events. An input can occur as soon as its component is ready, in any order. Its only new dependencies are negative-to-positive, and it accepts every enabled input, so it is a receptive courteous strategy.

(3) **Compute the reported outcome.** If $m : \prod_i M_i \to R$, $R = T_C Z$, is the measured rule, construct its finite image $F_m = m[\prod_i M_i]$ and corestrict it to $\bar{m} : \prod_i M_i \to F_m$. Proposition 1.23 realizes $\widehat{\bar{m}}$ on the finite outcome arena $D(F_m)$. Thus the construction preserves concurrency of reporting while explicitly waiting for the data the rule needs; no operational presentation of unused elements of R is required. The token labels a declared measured result. If the reporting circuit itself is separately metered, its physical charge is computed on the corresponding secured witness.

13.3.2 Dominant strategies and direct mechanisms

Definition 13.42 (Mechanism, selected dominance, and direct truthfulness)**.** A reporting strategy is **dominant** when, for every true type and every outsider message tuple, its prescribed message is at least as good as every alternative message. The weak inequality permits ties. A direct mechanism is **dominant-strategy incentive compatible** (DSIC) when truthful reporting has this property. Nash equilibrium fixes the outsiders' actual policies in its comparison; dominance requires the comparison for every outsider message tuple. A dominant truthful strategy can coexist with other equilibrium reports.

Fix finite type and message sets T_i, M_i, put $M = \prod_i M_i$, and use the measured result sort $R = T_C Z$. A reporting rule is $m : M \to R$ and the numerical evaluator is $e_i : T_i \times R \to \mathbb{K}$. The ordinary outcome rule is $\epsilon_Z m$. Conversely an unpriced rule $m_0 : M \to Z$ and utility u_i^0 give $m = \eta_Z^T m_0$, $e_i(t,(c,z)) = u_i^0(t,z)$. This embeds the original reporting interface and recovers its inequalities. Only the finite image of m need be represented by the finite-data protocol. Its selected strategy is a family $s_i : T_i \to M_i$. The selection is dominant if

$$\forall i, \theta_i, m_i, m_{-i}, \qquad e_i\big(\theta_i, m(s_i(\theta_i), m_{-i})\big) \geq e_i\big(\theta_i, m(m_i, m_{-i})\big). \tag{13.7}$$

The quantifiers range over types and messages without a prior distribution.

A direct rule $r : \prod_i T_i \to R$ is **dominant-strategy incentive compatible** (DSIC) if truthful reporting is dominant. In the assertion language this is the formula

$$\forall i, \theta_i, \widehat{\theta}_i, \widehat{\theta}_{-i}, \qquad e_i\big(\theta_i, r(\theta_i, \widehat{\theta}_{-i})\big) \geq e_i\big(\theta_i, r(\widehat{\theta}_i, \widehat{\theta}_{-i})\big).$$

It is an explicit comparison of two realizations of the same typed reporting protocol. The report changes; the true type in the utility comparison does not.

Construction 13.43 (The dependent type of dominant selections)**.**

(1) **Construct the dominant-message fibres.** For each owner, form the comprehension

$$\mathsf{Dom}_i(m) = \{(t, a) \in T_i \times M_i : \quad \forall \beta \in M_{-i}\ \forall b \in M_i, \\ e_i(t, m(a, \beta)) \geq e_i(t, m(b, \beta))\}.$$

with projection $d_i : \mathsf{Dom}_i(m) \to T_i$. Its section set is $\{s_i : T_i \to \mathsf{Dom}_i(m) : d_i s_i = \mathrm{id}_{T_i}\}$.

(2) **Select a message at every type.** Define the dependent product

$$\mathsf{Sel}(m) = \prod_i \mathsf{Sect}(d_i) \cong \prod_i \prod_{t \in T_i} \mathsf{Dom}_i(m)_t.$$

(3) **Verify incentive compatibility.** Evaluation gives the selected messages uniformly over $\mathsf{Sel}(m)$; write $s_i(t) \in M_i$ for the message component. Its defining inequality is exactly Equation (13.7). Substituting $b = s_i(\widehat{t})$ and $\beta = s_{-i}(\widehat{\theta}_{-i})$ proves DSIC of $r_s = m \prod_i s_i$. Thus a selected implementation is precisely an element of this constructed witness type, and directization is defined uniformly on that type.

(4) **Identify empty fibres.** The type can be empty. In the two-player bit-matching game, agent 1 receives 1 for equal bits and 0 otherwise. Message 0 fails to dominate against opponent message 1, and message 1 fails against opponent message 0. With a singleton true-type set, $\mathsf{Dom}_1(m)$ is empty. In a concrete truthful mechanism, its incentive proof exhibits the identity report map as an inhabitant of this predicate.

Proposition 13.44 (Dominance as uniform agent selection)**.** *For a true type $t \in T_i$ and fixed outsider messages β, put*

$$q_{i,t,\beta}(a)(b) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad e_i(t, m(a, \beta)) < e_i(t, m(b, \beta)).$$

Then selected dominance is $\forall i, t, \beta\ \varepsilon_{M_i}(s_i(t), q_{i,t,\beta})$. If $r = m \prod_i s_i$, the direct mechanism's feedback is the pullback of the mechanism's feedback along the selected report maps in both comparison arguments. At the measured sort this equality retains both the outcome and its charge. For a witness family $p_m : K_m \to M$ with record $r_m : K_m \to T_C Z$, directization along $s : T = \prod_i T_i \to M$ is given by

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} T \times_M K_m & \xrightarrow{\pi_2} & K_m & \xrightarrow{r_m} & T_C Z \\ {\scriptstyle \pi_1}\downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle p_m} & & \\ T & \xrightarrow[s]{} & M & & \end{array}$$

and record $r_m \pi_2$.

Proof.

(1) **Strategic comparison.** Expanding selection gives the absence of every strictly improving message. In the linear order of $\mathbb{K}$ this is exactly Equation (13.7). For directization the play equation is $r = m \prod_i s_i$; applying Theorem 5.11 gives its two-argument feedback equation.

(2) **Direct-message alternative comparison.** Hence every alternative direct report is compared through its exhibited message, with the true type fixed in the continuation.

(3) **Lift each direct report witness.** The fibre at a reported tuple t consists of (t, k) with $p_m(k) = s(t)$. Projection to k is a bijection with inverse $k \mapsto (t, k)$. Hence the record, its evaluation at the fixed true type, and the two quantifiers on witness pairs transport through these bijections. A separately executed adapter $f : T \to T_C M$ instead realizes $m^\dagger f$. For $f(t) = (d, s(t))$ its result is $S_d(m(s(t)))$. A report-dependent d can change the comparison: even two reports with identical original payoff can acquire different net values. The pulled-back DSIC proof applies to the inherited measured rule; a separately priced adapter is tested on its composite record.

□

13.3.3 Dominance and direct truthfulness in the assertion doctrine

Proposition 13.45 (Dominance in the internal reporting language)**.** *For owner i, put $\Gamma_i = T_i \times M_{-i}$ and let $\rho_i : \Gamma_i \times M_i \to \Gamma_i$ project the alternative message. Define the bad-alternative predicate*

$$B_i(t, \beta, a) \iff e_i(t, m(s_i(t), \beta)) < e_i(t, m(a, \beta)).$$

Selected dominance is $\bigwedge_i \forall_{!:\Gamma_i \to 1} \forall_{\rho_i} \neg B_i$. Substituting $a = s_i(\widehat{t})$ and $\beta = s_{-i}(\widehat{\beta})$ gives direct truthfulness of $r = m \prod_i s_i$.

Proof.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** The adjoint formulas expand the displayed predicate to all true types, all outsider messages, and all alternative messages, with no improving alternative. This is Equation (13.7). Universal elimination substitutes the two displayed report terms, leaving the true type t fixed in both values.

(2) **Lifting along the surjection.** The resulting inequality is exactly DSIC for r. The terms take values in constant message types; neither surjectivity nor a choice of representatives is used.

□

Truthful reporting has now been checked against every outsider message and every alternative report. The remaining question is how the direct reporting rule relates to other implementations that realize the same measured rule. The selected message policies themselves supply the comparison maps.

Construction 13.46 (The category of selected implementations)**.**

(1) **Fix the selected outcome rule.** Fix the type carriers T_i, measured result carrier $R = T_C Z$, and evaluators $e_i : T_i \times R \to \mathbb{K}$ of the reporting interface. For a selected dominant implementation (M, m, s), put $r = m \circ \prod_i s_i$.

(2) **Specify the objects and arrows.** Define $\mathbf{Impl}_r$ to have as objects the selected dominant implementations (M', m', s') of this same rule: each M'_i is a finite message

carrier, $s'_i : T_i \to M'_i$ is dominant for m', and $m' \circ \prod_i s'_i = r$. A morphism

$$f : (M', m', s') \longrightarrow (M'', m'', s'')$$

is an ownerwise family $f_i : M'_i \to M''_i$ satisfying

$$m'' \circ \prod_i f_i = m', \qquad f_i \circ s'_i = s''_i.$$

(3) **Define composition.** Identities are coordinatewise identity maps, and composition is coordinatewise function composition. Substitution in the two displayed equations proves closure under composition; associativity and the unit laws follow from those of functions.

Proposition 13.47 (Initiality of the truthful direct implementation)**.** *The truthful direct implementation* (T, r, id) *is initial in* $\mathbf{Impl}_r$*. Its unique morphism to* (M', m', s') *is the selected policy family* $(s'_i)_i$*.*

Proof.

(1) **Construct the object and its arrow.** By Proposition 13.45, $r = m \prod_i s_i$ is DSIC when evaluated at the true type, so (T, r, id) is an object. For any (M', m', s') of $\mathbf{Impl}_r$, $m' \prod_i s'_i = r$ is equality in $T_C Z$ and $s'_i \,\mathrm{id} = s'_i$. Thus s' is a morphism.

(2) **Prove uniqueness and recover the ordinary comparison.** Any morphism f from the direct object satisfies $f_i \,\mathrm{id} = s'_i$. Therefore $f = s'$. Erasure of the record equation gives the original outcome equation. For an ordinary fixed rule, lifting every implementation by η^T preserves and reflects its morphism equations since $\epsilon\eta^T = 1$. This recovers the unpriced initiality statement on the zero-charge presentations.

□

Proposition 13.48 (Reporting agents as observation-based response interfaces)**.** *At a reporting interface where agent* i *observes its economic type* t_i*, the complete reporting carrier is* $M_i^{T_i}$*. Its policy* s_i *realizes the response* $t_i \mapsto s_i(t_i)$*, and for finite carriers its concurrent realization is* $\widehat{s_i}$*. Connecting the reporting agents to the institutional outcome rule gives the reporting protocol above. Uniform selection over true types and outsider reports is the dominance predicate of Proposition 13.44.*

Proof.

(1) **Choice of representatives and quotients.** Take the observation quotient to be the identity of T_i in the response interface of Proposition 6.7. Its policies are exactly the maps $T_i \to M_i$, and the finite decision generator realizes each by its response strategy. Tensor and the collector connect these responses to the same rule.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** The selection comparison keeps t_i fixed and varies only the report; quantification over all true types and outsider reports is exactly the displayed dominance construction. The internal identification is proved in Proposition 13.44.

□

Improvement, epistemic rationality, and truthful reporting thus use the same controlled-alternative and evaluation interfaces. Their different quantifiers retain different information. We now use those distinctions to determine what an abstraction of the complete agent system must preserve.

14 Reconstruction and Exact Abstraction of Agent Systems

The constructions have related several descriptions of an agent: a displayed linear object, an owned concurrent presentation, a witnessed institution, and a strategic or epistemic frame. We now determine exactly what these descriptions retain. Reconstruction recovers the displayed owners, policies, observations, comparisons, legal alternatives, and execution witnesses. Reduction then identifies states only relative to specified tests and the alternatives those tests inspect. The final metatheoretic comparisons separate soundness and equational completeness of the calculus from behavioural characterization in the fixed semantics.

14.1 Reconstructing the complete agent presentation

We first construct the reconstruction maps and their compatibility with composition. The subsequent reductions are relative to specified tests, including the communication policies of Section 11.4 and the observations and transitions of the visible refinement.

14.1.1 Reconstruction of the structured agent presentation

Reconstruction concerns the displayed economic presentation. Ownership, realization, observation, and comparison data must be recovered together; a collection of truth predicates alone would not identify who controls a given deviation. The constructions below exhibit inverse maps between the declared presentation and its fibred semantic record.

Lemma 14.1 (Transport of displayed constructions)**.** *An isomorphism of displayed ordinary carriers, commuting with their specified maps and predicates, induces canonical isomorphisms of the products, dependent sums and products, pullbacks, images, quotients of displayed equivalence relations, sections, and power objects constructed from those data. It transports the resulting relation modalities and least and greatest fixed points of conjugate monotone predicate operators. These comparisons commute with ordinary base substitution. On original linear boundaries, restricted Yoneda also recovers the displayed concurrent realizers and their composition.*

Proof.

(1) **Construct the carrier comparisons.** Write $b : X \cong X'$ for a base comparison and $b_x : A_x \cong A'_{b(x)}$ for its fibre comparisons. A dependent-sum element (x, a) goes to $(b(x), b_x(a))$, and a section s goes to s' defined by $s'(b(x)) = b_x(s(x))$. Coordinatewise maps give products and pullbacks. Commuting structure maps restrict these bijections to comprehensions and images. An equivalence class $[x]$ goes to $[b(x)]$; preservation and reflection of the displayed relation make this well defined with the stated inverse. Power objects are transported by $P \mapsto b[P]$.

(2) **Transport predicates and binders.** These bijections identify each quantified fibre, hence its existential and universal predicates and the boxes and diamonds of its displayed relations. Let J be the induced complete-lattice isomorphism on predicates. If $F'J = JF$, then J bijects the pre-fixed points of F with those of F' and the post-fixed points likewise. Preservation of their meets and joins gives $J(\mu F) = \mu F'$ and $J(\nu F) = \nu F'$. Structural induction also handles nested binders.

(3) **Recover realizers and coherence.** Yoneda full faithfulness recovers each map on original representable boundaries; its functoriality recovers identities and composites. All ordinary comparisons above use the displayed coordinates and their inverses. They therefore commute with substitution and with the maps of the constructed diagrams. Structural induction on the constructions proves the claim.

□

Theorem 14.2 (Equivalence of agent presentations and fibred economic presentations)**.** *Fix the operational category $\mathcal{C}$ of Section 1.1. Its owner-indexed presentations and the constructed fibred open-arena presentations are equivalent, with inverse constructions in indexed-family notation and canonical equivalences in slice notation. The fibred presentation retains*

$$\vec{\Sigma}^G, \quad \mathsf{Assn}_G \longrightarrow \mathsf{St}(G), \quad \Delta_G, \quad \widehat{g} : 1_G \longrightarrow \Delta_G \mathcal{C}(A, B),$$

the designated owner projections and deviation contexts, and canonical coplay. It retains every ownerwise reparametrisation, including its deviation comparison maps, and commutes with sequential and parallel composition.

Equivalently, by Proposition 2.13, these are the agent presentations with their designated interfaces. The correspondence recovers the complete-policy composition law and the control regroupings.

For a measured execution the retained family consists of $p : K \to \Sigma$ with $r = \langle m, a \rangle : K \to T_C Z$ and the evaluators $e_i : T_C Z \to V_i$. The projections of r recover m, a; the composite $e_i r$ recovers the evaluated utility. Comprehension of $B(m(k))$ reconstructs the budget witnesses before taking their endpoint image. Retaining $e_i r$ alone preserves that evaluation; changing its price or budget can distinguish witnesses with the same retained value.

The correspondence extends to evaluated, observed, legal, history-indexed, certified, and epistemically action-decorated games by retaining their evaluation terms, observation and action-relation terms, enabling comprehensions, updated observable terms, dependent continuation families, and certificate carriers with their structure maps. Public inspection, the full dependent announcement games and their complete-policy realizations, and the exact visible refinements are recovered from these retained data. Every interpreted formula of the agency language has the same denotation. Player selection, best response, Nash equilibrium, coalition stability, continuation equilibrium, and truthful implementation are preserved and reflected on their original carriers.

Proof.

(1) **Exhibit the inverse presentations.** From $\vec{\Sigma}^G$ and g, construct the tower of Theorem 5.3 and its section $\widehat{g}(\sigma) = (\sigma, g_\sigma)$. Conversely recover $g = \pi_2 \widehat{g}$, keeping the displayed owner carriers. The family/slice comparison sends a displayed domain to the disjoint union of its fibres and back. These are the stated inverse constructions, and canonical coplay is the same inverse-image map.

(2) **Recover morphisms and composition.** An ownerwise map is the same family r_i; its equation $g = h\bar{r}$ is exactly the equation between realization sections. Cartesian lifts are the same pullbacks. Theorems 3.20 and 4.3 identify composition and deviation contexts, including their coherence maps.

(3) **Transport the retained decorations.** Apply Lemma 14.1 to the displayed evaluation, observation, legality, continuation, certificate, and action data. This retains the witness carrier before any image. For measured records, $r = \langle m, a \rangle$ and its projections are inverse descriptions; evaluation is $e_i r$, and budgets are comprehensions. Prefix charges and charge regrading are reconstructed by their retained increment maps and the equation $e_i' T_j r = e_i r$ of Proposition 8.12.

(4) **Transport the derived tests.** The action and operational comparisons are those of Theorems 9.16, 9.25, 12.18 and 12.27. Announcement policies are reconstructed from

their observation images as in Construction 11.12; exact visible refinement uses its same monotone operator and the retained families of Construction 12.36. The transport lemma applies to their comprehensions, selection quantifiers, and fixed points. Dynamic bodies remain monotone by Lemma A.6. This proves preservation and reflection of all the specified predicates.

□

The recovered object includes the full declared presentation. The hyperdoctrine alone would not determine ownership or concurrent play, since distinct realizations can share one profile carrier. Keeping the underlying arena and its distinguished terms makes the reconstruction reversible. The operational arrow remains taken up to arena-preserving strategy isomorphism; the reductions to follow are additional quotients relative to explicitly chosen economic tests.

Corollary 14.3 (Recovery of completed and enriched presentations)**.** *The reconstruction equivalence has the following canonical extensions, all commuting with ordinary base substitution.*

(1) *On original representable boundaries, the completed dependent model preserves and reflects concurrent realizations and all the predicates of Theorem 14.2, including dependent residual arenas and certificate realization maps.*

(2) *Action enablement and updated epistemic relations are recovered on their ordinary carriers. Operationally generated post-action residuals are recovered from their dependent linear internal-hom values; secured weak-step witnesses and their observable predicates are retained before existential image or descent.*

(3) *Agent interfaces, complete-policy composition, regrouped control, legal choice fibres, observations, and continuation interfaces are recovered. For truthful communication this includes* AnnPol_i*,* $\mathcal{X}$*,* $F : \mathcal{X} \to \mathcal{U}$*, and its dependent policy witnesses and concurrent realizations, with the modal, fixed-point, dynamic, selection, and coalition comparison equations of Section 9.1.*

(4) *Retained delegation maps reconstruct their implemented images and deviation comparisons. Feasibility predicates reconstruct informed legal policies and the decentralized-to-pooled comparison. Institutional spans reconstruct witness-matching composition, realizers, permissions, and box and diamond operations.*

(5) *Retained local controller data reconstruct controller behaviour and the residual controller generated by each retained complete policy.*

Proof.

(1) **Decode the original boundaries.** For $\alpha : yA \to yB$, Theorem 1.38 recovers $\alpha_c(u)u^{-1}$ for a local isomorphism $u : Jc \to A$, independently of its presentation. Full faithfulness and $\mathsf{ValLin} \cong 1$ recover the linear arrows and ordinary fields. Proposition 1.51 commutes this decoding with action-target reindexing.

(2) **Transport the displayed constructions.** Apply Lemma 14.1 to the retained fields. In particular, the power objects of Ω_i reconstruct the truthful-policy comprehensions and evaluation. The canonical bijection $\coprod_{u \in \mathcal{U}} F^{-1}(u) \cong \mathcal{X}$ recovers the policy witnesses of Construction 11.23. Their retained extension policies give the source-fixed lifts of Theorem 11.18. The same transport applies to delegation images, legal inverse images, $\forall_{o \times \mathrm{id}} F$, its sections, coordinate descent equations, and institutional endpoint pullbacks.

(3) **Recover controller behaviour and coherence.** The retained output and next-state maps determine behaviour inductively on observation words. Carrier bijections preserve this induction, word concatenation, and policy derivatives; hence they recover S_b, its transitions, and initial state. All comparisons use the displayed coordinate maps, so they commute with ordinary substitution.

□

14.1.2 Reconstruction of sheaf-local situated witnesses

The locality enhancement retains a specified synchronization family, its common causal site, owner-labelled parameter projection, and the actual observation/certificate readouts. Forgetting these maps and retaining only an abstract sheaf object would not recover an owner signature or an institutional rule. The following reconstruction fits the preceding fibred presentation without identifying its two notions of descent.

Theorem 14.4 (Structured witnessed reconstruction and tests)**.** *For the sheaf-local witnessed family of Construction 8.3 and its finite completed implementation of Theorem 10.55, the global-section functor, together with the displayed parameter, owner, and secured-matching maps, recovers the completed finite-input witness carrier Ξ_{in} and its profile projection. Its ordinary pullback along the situated input map recovers the world-indexed carrier Ξ_W of the manuscript. The retained-state quotient q^{fin} recovers the completed observed image T_{fin}; its accepted and issuer-certified subquotients recover exactly their corresponding retained images, as constructed in Theorem 10.55. The pullback of each of these regular epimorphisms reflects and preserves the Boolean modal predicates generated by the designated strategic and epistemic relations and predicates on its retained carrier. For the situated finite protocol the composite Q_W of (10.21) additionally identifies these epistemic tests with the original action-updated model on U_W, including finite-path common knowledge and positive modal fixed points. Measured owner values descend through this quotient exactly when they equalize its completed-witness kernel pair; otherwise the measured witness carrier remains displayed.*

Proof.

(1) **Recover the completed source.** By Theorems 8.4 and 10.55, global sections of the finished subobject are exactly completed secured configurations of the exhibited pre-hiding interaction. The projection onto X and then Σ is unchanged on every causal restriction, so the original owner factors and complete policies are recovered. The world-indexed form is the cartesian reconstruction (10.20), constructed by Proposition 8.5 and Theorem 10.55.

(2) **Recover retained records.** The image construction of (9.14) retains the specified actual receipt and certificate records. Its regular-epimorphism comparison in Lemma 9.32 and the completed restriction in Theorem 10.55 recover the completed observed image, not an arbitrary quotient of unmatched sends. The acceptance pullback and the anchor-detected issuer predicate yield the exact authorized image by Proposition 10.54; neither is inferred from a hidden scalar.

(3) **Reflect and preserve designated tests.** For retained knowledge, coalition deviations and their finite-path combinations, Theorem 9.34 commutes inverse image with boxes and diamonds. The direct comparison Q_W of Theorem 10.56 identifies the updated epistemic kernels with the original witnessed action model. Boolean operations commute with inverse image in the sheaf topos, and Corollary 9.36 carries the positive fixed-point binders. Since the completed, accepted and certified record quotients are regular

epimorphisms, their inverse images are order-reflecting: if two retained predicates have equal pullbacks, their equality descends along the quotient. Induction on the designated modal grammar proves preservation and reflection.

(4) **Retain charge distinctions.** For a completed measured record $r = \langle m, a\rangle$ and owner evaluator e_i, the descent of $e_i r$ through the retained image is exactly the kernel-pair equalization test of Proposition 5.50. The sheaf construction does not erase an independently varying charge or manufacture a profile payoff where that descent fails.

□

Structured global-section recovery and retained-state abstraction are different operations.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Gamma(\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}}) & \xrightarrow{\cong} & \Xi_{\mathrm{in}} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \mathrm{record}} \\ T_{\mathrm{fin}} & = & T_{\mathrm{fin}} \end{array}$$

Remark 14.5 (Fixed-semantic exactness). The sheaf-locality result is a reconstruction and modal transport property of exhibited true-concurrent realizations. It introduces no new definitional equality in the ordinary or linear calculus and does not claim completeness for an independently added sheaf type former. The classifying-model completeness theorem below consequently keeps its original scope.

14.1.3 Strategic reduction relative to semantic tests

Reconstruction has retained the full displayed presentation. A reduction has a different purpose: it keeps enough of that presentation to answer a specified family of questions. We therefore define reduction relative to tests and prove which alternatives lift from each retained source. This makes explicit why agreement on current outcomes alone need not preserve equilibrium or knowledge.

Definition 14.6 (Semantic tests and contextual policy equivalence)**.** A **semantic-test family** on $\Sigma = \prod_{i\in N} \Sigma_i$ consists of set-indexed functional tests $T_\lambda : \Sigma \to X_\lambda$ $(\lambda \in \Lambda)$ and predicate tests $P_\mu \hookrightarrow \Sigma$ $(\mu \in M)$. For owner i, transpose these along $\Sigma \cong \Sigma_{-i} \times \Sigma_i$ into

$$\kappa_i^{T,P} : \Sigma_i \longrightarrow \left(\prod_{\lambda\in\Lambda} X_\lambda^{\Sigma_{-i}}\right) \times \left(\prod_{\mu\in M} \mathsf{Pow}(\Sigma_{-i})\right),$$
$$\kappa_i^{T,P}(a_i) = \Big((\sigma_{-i} \mapsto T_\lambda(\sigma_{-i}, a_i))_\lambda, (\{\sigma_{-i} : P_\mu(\sigma_{-i}, a_i)\})_\mu\Big).$$

Here $\mathsf{Pow}(X)$ is the power object representing predicates on X. Two policies are **contextually equivalent** for the tests precisely when

$$a_i \approx_i^{T,P} b_i \quad\Longleftrightarrow\quad \kappa_i^{T,P}(a_i) = \kappa_i^{T,P}(b_i).$$

Thus $\approx_i^{T,P}$ is the kernel pair of the contextual-test map. Its image factorization gives the exact test-induced quotient below; equivalence compares policies against every fixed outsider profile.

Choosing a test family gives a precise meaning to agreement of behaviour. A test of the current payoff can identify two policies that a later permission check, observation, or

continuation distinguishes. The quotient below retains each distinction that some chosen test detects in an opponent context.

A strategic abstraction should forget a difference in policies only when the designated assertions cannot detect it. Some of those tests are functions recording observable outputs; others are predicates recording comparisons or permissions. The following image factorization reduces both kinds of test simultaneously, making the meaning of the resulting equivalence explicit.

Construction 14.7 (Contextual test quotient and its comparison category)**.**

(1) **Specify the retained tests.** Let

$$T_\lambda : \Sigma = \prod_i \Sigma_i \longrightarrow X_\lambda \qquad (\lambda \in \Lambda)$$

be a set-indexed family of functional semantic tests, and let

$$P_\mu \hookrightarrow \Sigma \qquad (\mu \in M)$$

be a set-indexed family of predicate tests. A predicate is treated by pullback to owner contexts and transposition along the power-object representation. Thus the construction remains valid in the intuitionistic reading of the assertion doctrine.

We use the predicate-descent form of Proposition 5.38, placed beside functional descent above.

(2) **Represent their contexts.** Because **Set** is Cartesian closed and its subobject doctrine has power objects, the contextual tests can be assembled without replacing a predicate by a chosen Boolean-valued characteristic function. Write $\mathsf{Pow}(X)$ for the power object representing subobjects of X. For each owner i, exponential transposition gives

$$\widehat{T}_{\lambda,i} : \Sigma_i \longrightarrow X_\lambda^{\Sigma_{-i}}, \qquad \widehat{T}_{\lambda,i}(a_i)(\sigma_{-i}) = T_\lambda(\sigma_{-i}, a_i),$$

while power-object transposition of $P_\mu \hookrightarrow \Sigma_{-i} \times \Sigma_i$ gives

$$\widehat{P}_{\mu,i} : \Sigma_i \longrightarrow \mathsf{Pow}(\Sigma_{-i}),$$

characterized by

$$\sigma_{-i} \in \widehat{P}_{\mu,i}(a_i) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad P_\mu(\sigma_{-i}, a_i).$$

(3) **Form the contextual image.** Define the canonical contextual-test map

$$\kappa_i^{T,P} = \left\langle (\widehat{T}_{\lambda,i})_{\lambda\in\Lambda}, (\widehat{P}_{\mu,i})_{\mu\in M} \right\rangle : \Sigma_i \longrightarrow \left(\prod_{\lambda\in\Lambda} X_\lambda^{\Sigma_{-i}} \right) \times \left(\prod_{\mu\in M} \mathsf{Pow}(\Sigma_{-i}) \right). \tag{14.1}$$

Take its image factorization in **Set**,

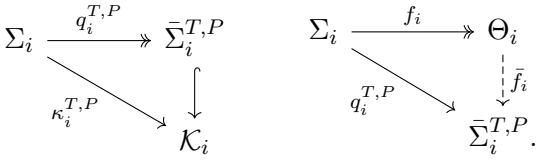
$$\Sigma_i \xrightarrow{q_i^{T,P}} \bar{\Sigma}_i^{T,P} \hookrightarrow \left(\prod_{\lambda\in\Lambda} X_\lambda^{\Sigma_{-i}} \right) \times \left(\prod_{\mu\in M} \mathsf{Pow}(\Sigma_{-i}) \right). \tag{14.2}$$

Thus $\bar{\Sigma}_i^{T,P}$ is the image of the map that records exactly the functional behavior and predicate behavior visible in every opponent context.

(4) **Identify its fibres.** Elementwise,

$$q_i^{T,P}(a_i) = q_i^{T,P}(b_i) \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \begin{aligned} &\forall \sigma_{-i}\, \forall \lambda \in \Lambda, \quad T_\lambda(\sigma_{-i}, a_i) = T_\lambda(\sigma_{-i}, b_i), \\ &\forall \sigma_{-i}\, \forall \mu \in M, \quad P_\mu(\sigma_{-i}, a_i) \leftrightarrow P_\mu(\sigma_{-i}, b_i). \end{aligned} \tag{14.3}$$

Writing $\mathcal{K}_i$ for the displayed target of $\kappa_i^{T,P}$, the image construction and its terminal factorization have the forms



For utility at fixed prices, include the descended maps $\bar{v}_i$ among the functional tests. To permit reevaluation at other prices or recovery of the charge, include the full descended record instead. A record defined only on K stays on that dependent witness family with its projection and chosen tests: the displayed profile test map takes functions on profiles. The dashed factorization is proved in the theorem below. No representatives of equivalence classes are chosen: the reduced policy set is the image object of the displayed universal map.

(5) **Construct the comparison category.** To state the universal property, let $\mathsf{Quot}_{T,P}(\vec{\Sigma})$ have as objects ownerwise surjections

$$f : \vec{\Sigma} \twoheadrightarrow \vec{\Theta}$$

through which every T_λ factors and along which every P_μ descends: there are maps $\widetilde{T}_\lambda$ and predicates $\widetilde{P}_\mu$ with

$$T_\lambda = \widetilde{T}_\lambda \prod_i f_i, \qquad P_\mu = \left(\prod_i f_i\right)^* \widetilde{P}_\mu.$$

A morphism $h : f \to f'$ is an ownerwise map between quotient parameter objects satisfying $f' = hf$. Surjectivity of f makes the descended maps and predicates commute with h automatically.

Theorem 14.8 (Test-induced strategic reduction)**.** *Let $q^{T,P} = \prod_i q_i^{T,P}$. Every functional test descends uniquely to*

$$\bar{T}_\lambda : \prod_i \bar{\Sigma}_i^{T,P} \longrightarrow X_\lambda, \qquad T_\lambda = \bar{T}_\lambda q^{T,P},$$

and every predicate test descends uniquely to

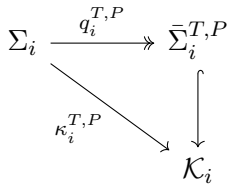
$$\bar{P}_\mu \hookrightarrow \prod_i \bar{\Sigma}_i^{T,P}, \qquad P_\mu = (q^{T,P})^* \bar{P}_\mu.$$

The reduced family has no distinct policies of one owner with the same values under every functional test and the same truth values under every predicate test against every reduced opponent profile. Moreover, if $f_i : \Sigma_i \twoheadrightarrow \Theta_i$ are ownerwise surjections through which every T_λ factors and along which every P_μ descends, then there is a unique ownerwise map

$$\bar{f} : \vec{\Theta} \longrightarrow \bar{\vec{\Sigma}}^{T,P} \qquad \textit{with} \qquad q^{T,P} = \bar{f} f.$$

Hence $q^{T,P}$ is terminal in $\mathsf{Quot}_{T,P}(\vec{\Sigma})$: it is the coarsest ownerwise effective quotient preserving all chosen functional and predicate tests.

The contextual-test map admits its canonical image factorization.



Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** Each $q_i^{T,P}$ is surjective by image factorization, so their finite product $q^{T,P}$ is surjective by Proposition 5.38. Suppose two profiles have the same $q^{T,P}$-image. Replace their finitely many owner coordinates one at a time.

(2) **Fibrewise calculation.** At the ith replacement, Equation (14.3) says, against the currently fixed opponent profile, that every T_λ retains its value and every P_μ retains its truth value. Hence every T_λ is constant on the fibers of $q^{T,P}$, while every P_μ is fiber-invariant.

(3) **Predicate calculation.** Functional descent follows from Proposition 5.38 and predicate descent from Proposition 5.38.

(4) **Separation by contextual tests.** For the separation statement, write $\bar{\Sigma}_{-i} = \prod_{j \neq i} \bar{\Sigma}_j^{T,P}$ and

$$\mathcal{K}_i = \left(\prod_\lambda X_\lambda^{\Sigma_{-i}} \right) \times \left(\prod_\mu \mathsf{Pow}(\Sigma_{-i}) \right)$$

for the original contextual-test object, and let

$$\bar{\mathcal{K}}_i = \left(\prod_\lambda X_\lambda^{\bar{\Sigma}_{-i}} \right) \times \left(\prod_\mu \mathsf{Pow}(\bar{\Sigma}_{-i}) \right)$$

be its reduced analogue.

(5) **Conclusion: second comparison.** The quotient map $q_{-i} : \Sigma_{-i} \twoheadrightarrow \bar{\Sigma}_{-i}$ induces a canonical map

$$\theta_i : \bar{\mathcal{K}}_i \longrightarrow \mathcal{K}_i$$

by precomposition with q_{-i} on every functional component and inverse image along q_{-i} on every predicate component. Let

$$\bar{\kappa}_i : \bar{\Sigma}_i \longrightarrow \bar{\mathcal{K}}_i$$

be the contextual-test map formed from the descended tests.

(6) **Lifting along the surjection.** By construction,

$$\kappa_i^{T,P} = \theta_i \bar{\kappa}_i q_i^{T,P}.$$

If

$$\kappa_i^{T,P} = m_i q_i^{T,P}$$

is its image factorization, epimorphicity of $q_i^{T,P}$ gives

$$m_i = \theta_i \bar{\kappa}_i.$$

Since the image inclusion m_i is monic, $\bar{\kappa}_i$ is monic. Hence two reduced policies with the same values under all reduced functional tests and the same reduced contextual predicate behavior are equal. No representatives of the reduced policies are selected in this argument.

(7) **Policy-level comparison.** For the universal property, suppose $f_i(a_i) = f_i(b_i)$. Against every original opponent profile the two full profiles have the same f-image. Factorization of the functional tests and descent of the predicate tests then give both equalities in Equation (14.3).

(8) **Factorization of the representation map.** Thus $q_i^{T,P}$ equalizes the kernel pair of f_i. Since f_i is the coequalizer of that kernel pair, there is a unique $\bar{f}_i : \Theta_i \to \bar{\Sigma}_i^{T,P}$ with $q_i^{T,P} = \bar{f}_i f_i$. Taking the ownerwise product gives $\bar{f}$.

□

Corollary 14.9 (Canonical strategic reduction)**.** *Take the single functional test*

$$T = g : \Sigma \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A, B)$$

and no predicate tests. Then owner i's contextual-behavior map is

$$\kappa_i^g : \Sigma_i \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A, B)^{\Sigma_{-i}}, \qquad a_i \longmapsto \big(\sigma_{-i} \mapsto g_{(\sigma_{-i}, a_i)}\big),$$

and its image gives the canonical behavioral reduction $\bar{G}$. For every coalition, the quotient map is a bounded morphism of deviation relations. For every ownerwise surjective realization-preserving 2-cell $f : G \Rightarrow H$, there is a unique realization-preserving 2-cell $\bar{f} : H \Rightarrow \bar{G}$ with $q = \bar{f} f$.

Proof.

(1) **Descent along the kernel pair.** The realization descends by Theorem 14.8. Write the realizations of $G, H, \bar{G}$ as $g, h, \bar{g}$, respectively. The universal property supplies a unique ownerwise parameter map $\bar{f}$ with $q = \bar{f} f$.

(2) **Lifting along the surjection.** Since f is realization-preserving and q is the quotient presentation map,

$$hf = g = \bar{g} q = \bar{g}\, \bar{f}\, f.$$

The total profile map $f = \prod_i f_i$ is surjective by Proposition 5.38, hence is an epimorphism in **Set**. Cancelling it gives

$$h = \bar{g}\, \bar{f},$$

so $\bar{f} : H \Rightarrow \bar{G}$ is itself realization-preserving. Uniqueness as a 2-cell follows from uniqueness of the ownerwise parameter map.

(3) **Descent along the kernel pair.** Every coalition alternative descends to the quotient. To lift a reduced alternative, keep the original outsider coordinates and lift the finite tuple of coalition coordinates along $\prod_{i \in C} q_i$. This product is an effective quotient by Proposition 5.38, so such a lift exists without choosing sections.

(4) **Lifting through the comparison.** Realizations and every comparison or full-product outcome predicate that factors through realization have the same truth value before and after this lifting. Thus the quotient has the claimed lifting property, and Theorem 9.30 applies to all descended atoms.

□

Proposition 14.10 (Reduction and composition)**.** *Let $q_G : G \Rightarrow \bar{G}$ and $q_H : H \Rightarrow \bar{H}$ be canonical behavioral reductions. There is a unique ownerwise surjective, realization-preserving comparison*

$$\bar{H} \circ \bar{G} \longrightarrow \overline{H \circ G}$$

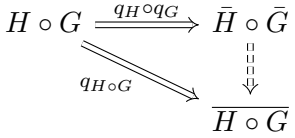
whose composite with $q_H \circ q_G$ is the canonical reduction of $H \circ G$. The analogous comparison exists for tensor. Such a comparison need not be invertible.

Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** The ownerwise products of the two quotient maps are surjective and preserve the composite realization. Terminality of the composite's test quotient supplies the unique comparison. It is surjective at each owner because its composite with a surjection is the surjective canonical quotient.

(2) **Ownerwise alternatives.** For noninvertibility, let one owner choose 0 or 1 in $G : I \to D(\{0,1\})$, and let H be the nonstrategic response induced by the constant function $\{0,1\} \to 1$. The reduction of G retains two policies, whereas every composite realization is the same value state in $D(1)$ and its behavioral reduction has one policy. Thus the comparison has a two-element domain and a singleton codomain at that owner.

□



14.1.4 The reflection and reduced composition

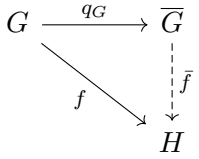
Definition 14.11 (Surjective presentation category)**.** For fixed A, B, let $\mathsf{Pres}_{\mathrm{epi}}(A, B)$ have open arenas as objects and ownerwise surjective realization-preserving 2-cells as morphisms. Let $\mathsf{Red}(A, B)$ be its full subcategory on presentations whose contextual-behavior maps κ_i^g are injective. Write I for its inclusion.

Theorem 14.12 (Strategic reduction is a reflection)**.** *Behavioral reduction defines a functor*

$$\mathrm{Red} : \mathsf{Pres}_{\mathrm{epi}}(A, B) \longrightarrow \mathsf{Red}(A, B), \qquad \mathrm{Red} \dashv I.$$

Its unit is $q_G : G \to \bar{G}$. For every morphism $f : G \to H$, $\mathrm{Red}(f) : \bar{G} \to \bar{H}$ is an isomorphism.

The quotient comparison satisfies the universal property of a reflection.



Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** Write $g = h \prod_i f_i$. For two i-policies a, b, one has

$$a \sim_G b \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad f_i(a) \sim_H f_i(b).$$

For the forward implication, lift every H-opponent profile along the surjection $\prod_{j \neq i} f_j$ and use the realization equation.

(2) **Reverse implication.** For the reverse implication substitute the image of each G-opponent profile. Hence $q_{H,i} f_i$ descends uniquely through $q_{G,i}$ to a bijection $\bar{f}_i$. The descended realization equation follows by cancelling the surjective total parameter map.

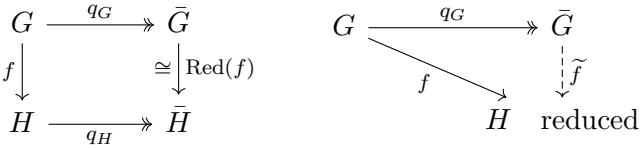
(3) **Lifting along the surjection.** The equations $\bar{f} q_G = q_H f$ prove identity and composition preservation by epimorphic cancellation.

(4) **Lifting along the surjection: second comparison.** If H is reduced, $a \sim_G b$ implies $f_i(a) = f_i(b)$. Thus f factors uniquely as $\widetilde{f} q_G$ with $\widetilde{f} : \bar{G} \to H$. It is surjective because f is, and preserves realization by cancelling q_G.

(5) **Reverse implication.** Conversely every such $\widetilde{f}$ gives a morphism by precomposition with q_G. These inverse operations are natural and give the adjunction. Reduction is reduced by Theorem 14.8, so the stated codomain is correct.

(6) **Policy-level comparison.** The bijections constructed in the first paragraph prove the last assertion, including the empty-policy cases.

□



Construction 14.13 (Composition after reduction)**.**

(1) **Reduce the composite.** For reduced $G : A \to B$ and $H : B \to C$, put

$$H \star G = \mathrm{Red}(H \circ G), \qquad H \mathbin{\widehat{\otimes}} G = \mathrm{Red}(H \otimes G).$$

(2) **Act on maps and identities.** On 2-cells apply the original horizontal composition or tensor and then the reduction functor. Retain the original arena objects and the reduced identity presentations.

Theorem 14.14 (Coherence of reduced composition)**.** *The preceding construction is a symmetric monoidal bicategory, with hom-categories* $\mathsf{Red}(A, B)$*. Its associators, unitors, and monoidal coherence maps are the canonical comparisons induced from those of open arenas. In particular,*

$$\mathrm{Red}(\bar{H} \circ \bar{G}) \cong \mathrm{Red}(H \circ G),$$

although the unreduced comparison of Proposition 14.10 need not be invertible.

Proof.

(1) **Composition.** Composition and tensor of ownerwise surjections are ownerwise surjections. The preceding theorem therefore sends every quotient map inserted in a composite to an isomorphism after reduction. For example, reduce the map $q_H \circ q_G : H \circ G \to \bar{H} \circ \bar{G}$; its image is the displayed isomorphism, with the orientation reversed if necessary.

(2) **Monoidal comparison.** For three arrows, both $(K \star H) \star G$ and $K \star (H \star G)$ are consequently canonically isomorphic to the reduction of an unreduced triple composite. Transport its original associator through these isomorphisms. Define the unitors and tensor comparisons in the same way. Naturality follows from the naturality of q and of the original structural maps.

(3) **Lifting along the surjection.** For each pentagon, triangle, symmetry, or monoidal interchange diagram, precompose the two candidate composites with the product of the unreduced parameter quotients. This is surjective at every owner. The resulting diagram is the corresponding coherence diagram in $\mathbf{Arena}_N(\mathcal{C})$, followed by the unique reduction map, and therefore commutes.

(4) **Lifting along the surjection: completion.** Cancel the surjections ownerwise. This proves all the asserted coherence equations and their compatibility, without choosing representatives of reduced policies.

□

Remark 14.15 (The morphisms used by the reflection). The proof uses the lifting of opponent contexts along the displayed surjections. Arbitrary parameter maps remain available in the original open-arena bicategory; the reflection just proved is on its surjective presentation categories. A change that introduces new opponent policies is represented there before any new contextual reduction is performed.

Remark 14.16 (Strategy reduction and epistemic state spaces). For $s : W \to \Sigma$, behavioral reduction replaces it by $qs : W \to \bar{\Sigma}$ and preserves $gs = \bar{g}qs$. It need not identify states of W. Observations and belief relations on W may be retained unchanged. If a separate state quotient is taken, its relations and atoms are subject to the bounded-morphism theorem independently. When action enablement descends along such a bounded state quotient, the updated state quotient is again bounded by Corollary 9.27; this is not inferred from equality of play maps alone.

14.1.5 Reduction of dependent legal agency

The authorization example gives two policies with the same immediate output and different legal status. A quotient that merged them could give the regulated system a deviation it cannot execute. We therefore descend the legal domain and its dependent alternative fibres along with the outcome map.

Construction 14.17 (Legality-sensitive strategic reduction)**.**

(1) **Form the ownerwise quotient.** The predicate-sensitive strategic reduction now gives the reduction that is appropriate when institutional legality must survive abstraction. Apply Theorem 14.8 to the functional test

$$g : \Sigma \to \mathcal{C}(A, B)$$

and the predicate test $L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$. Write the resulting ownerwise quotient as

$$r_i : \Sigma_i \twoheadrightarrow \bar{\Sigma}_i, \qquad r = \prod_i r_i : \Sigma \twoheadrightarrow \bar{\Sigma}.$$

Then there are a unique realization $\bar{g}$ and a unique descended legal subobject $\bar{L} \hookrightarrow \bar{\Sigma}$ such that

$$g = \bar{g}r, \qquad L = r^*\bar{L}. \tag{14.4}$$

(2) **Restrict to legal profiles.** Let

$$r_L : L \twoheadrightarrow \bar{L}$$

be the restriction of r. It is surjective: every point of $\bar{L}$ has an r-preimage by surjectivity, and Equation (14.4) places every such preimage in L.

(3) **Descend the coordinate maps.** Construct the realizable-coordinate functor $\bar{L}_{(-)}$ of the reduced legal domain in the same way as Proposition 7.28. For every $S \subseteq N$, the composite $\bar{e}_S r_L : L \to \bar{L}_S$ is constant on the fibers of e_S, because equal original S-coordinates have equal reduced S-coordinates. Effective descent therefore gives a unique map

$$r^L_S : L_S \longrightarrow \bar{L}_S, \qquad r^L_S e_S = \bar{e}_S r_L. \tag{14.5}$$

It is surjective: for $\bar{s} \in \bar{L}_S$, take $\bar{\ell} \in \bar{L}$ with $\bar{e}_S(\bar{\ell}) = \bar{s}$, lift $\bar{\ell}$ along r_L to $\ell \in L$, and then $r_S^L(e_S(\ell)) = \bar{s}$.

(4) **Verify their compatibility.** These quotient maps are compatible with every coordinate restriction. If $S \subseteq T$, then

$$\bar{\rho}_S^T r_T^L = r_S^L \rho_S^T. \tag{14.6}$$

Indeed both sides become $\bar{e}_S r_L$ after precomposition with the surjection e_T. Hence

$$r_{(-)}^L : L_{(-)} \Longrightarrow \bar{L}_{(-)}$$

is a levelwise surjective natural transformation of realizable-coordinate functors.

Theorem 14.18 (Exact descent of legal alternatives)**.** *For every $S \subseteq N$, the commutative square*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L & \xrightarrow{\;r_L\;} & \bar{L} \\ {\scriptstyle e_S}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \bar{e}_S} \\ L_S & \xrightarrow[\;r_S^L\;]{} & \bar{L}_S \end{array}$$

has a surjective comparison map

$$L \twoheadrightarrow L_S \times_{\bar{L}_S} \bar{L}, \qquad \ell \longmapsto (e_S(\ell), r_L(\ell)). \tag{14.7}$$

Thus, in **Set***, each displayed square is a regular pushout of surjections. Consequently, for every coalition C, r_L is a surjective bounded morphism from the legal deviation relation D_C^L to $D_C^{\bar{L}}$, and the counterfactual realizations commute with the induced map of deviation objects. Legal Nash equilibrium is therefore preserved and reflected by r_L; the same is true of every modal fixed-point assertion built from legal deviation relations and atomic predicates that descend through r_L.*

Exact legal reduction is a Cartesian square of legal profiles over their policy spaces.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L & \xrightarrow{\;r_L\;} & \bar{L} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \Sigma & \xrightarrow[\;r\;]{} & \bar{\Sigma} \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Choice of representatives and quotients.** Take a compatible pair

$$(s, \bar{\ell}) \in L_S \times_{\bar{L}_S} \bar{L}.$$

Surjectivity of e_S gives $\ell_0 \in L$ with $e_S(\ell_0) = s$, and surjectivity of r_L gives $\ell_1 \in L$ with $r_L(\ell_1) = \bar{\ell}$.

(2) **Witness and legality comparison.** Compatibility says

$$r_S^L(e_S(\ell_0)) = \bar{e}_S(r_L(\ell_1)).$$

Using Equation (14.5) on the left gives

$$\bar{e}_S(r_L(\ell_0)) = \bar{e}_S(r_L(\ell_1)).$$

Since $\bar{L}_S \hookrightarrow \bar{\Sigma}_S$ is monic, the reduced S-coordinates of ℓ_0 and ℓ_1 coincide. Form the ambient profile $\tau \in \Sigma$ by taking its S-coordinates from ℓ_0 and its coordinates outside S from ℓ_1.

(3) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Ownerwise equality of the reduced S-coordinates gives

$$r(\tau) = r(\ell_1) = \bar{\ell}.$$

Because $L = r^*\bar{L}$ and $\bar{\ell} \in \bar{L}$, the profile τ belongs to L. It also satisfies $e_S(\tau) = s$. Hence τ maps to the chosen compatible pair, proving surjectivity of Equation (14.7).

(4) **Lifting through the comparison.** For the bounded-morphism lifting property take $S = -C$. If

$$r_L(\ell)\ D_C^{\bar{L}}\ \bar{\tau},$$

then $\bar{e}_{-C}(r_L\ell) = \bar{e}_{-C}(\bar{\tau})$. By Equation (14.5), the pair $(e_{-C}(\ell), \bar{\tau})$ lies in $L_{-C} \times_{\bar{L}_{-C}} \bar{L}$.

(5) **Verification of the universal property.** Surjectivity of the comparison map supplies $\tau \in L$ with

$$e_{-C}(\tau) = e_{-C}(\ell), \qquad r_L(\tau) = \bar{\tau}.$$

Thus $\ell D_C^L \tau$, giving the required lift. Forward preservation follows from the commutative square.

(6) **Strategic comparison.** The induced map on legal deviation objects sends (ℓ, τ) to $(r_L\ell, r_L\tau)$. Equation (14.4) gives

$$\delta_C^{\bar{G},\bar{L}}(r_L\ell, r_L\tau) = \delta_C^{G,L}(\ell, \tau).$$

Hence profitable legal alternatives are preserved and lifted with the same two realized interactions. Equation (7.12) is therefore preserved and reflected.

(7) **Fixed-point argument.** The fixed-point statement is the bounded-morphism argument of Theorem 9.30, applied to the legal state sort L and its legal deviation relations.

□

Theorem 14.19 (Legal ability under strategic reduction)**.** *Let $r_L : L \twoheadrightarrow \bar{L}$ be the legality-sensitive reduction of Theorem 14.18, and suppose an outcome map $q : L \to Z$ descends to $\bar{q} : \bar{L} \to Z$, so $q = \bar{q}r_L$. Then for every coalition C and predicate $P \hookrightarrow Z$,*

$$[C]_L P \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad [C]_{\bar{L}} P.$$

Thus the legality-sensitive strategic quotient preserves and reflects coalition ability as well as legal strategic stability.

Proof.

(1) **Choice of representatives and quotients.** Put

$$A = \forall_{e_C : L \to L_C} q^* P, \qquad \bar{A} = \forall_{\bar{e}_C : \bar{L} \to \bar{L}_C} \bar{q}^* P.$$

We first prove

$$A = (r_C^L)^* \bar{A}.$$

Suppose $A(c)$ and let $\bar{\ell} \in \bar{L}$ satisfy $\bar{e}_C(\bar{\ell}) = r_C^L(c)$. By the surjective comparison map in Theorem 14.18, there is $\ell \in L$ with $e_C(\ell) = c$ and $r_L(\ell) = \bar{\ell}$. Hence $P(q(\ell))$, and therefore $P(\bar{q}(\bar{\ell}))$.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, suppose $\bar{A}(r_C^L(c))$ and let $\ell \in L$ satisfy $e_C(\ell) = c$. Then

$$\bar{e}_C(r_L\ell) = r_C^L(c),$$

so $P(\bar{q}(r_L\ell))$, equivalently $P(q(\ell))$. This proves the predicate equality.

(3) **Preservation of coalition effectivity.** Finally r_C^L is surjective, so existential quantification over L_C is preserved and reflected:

$$\exists_{!:L_C \to 1} A \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \exists_{!:\bar{L}_C \to 1} \bar{A}.$$

Using Equation (7.16) on both sides gives the result.

□

In particular, an observable outcome map of the form $q = o \circ g \circ m$ descends automatically: if $\bar{m} : \bar{L} \hookrightarrow \bar{\Sigma}$ is the descended legal inclusion, then

$$\bar{q} = o \circ \bar{g} \circ \bar{m}$$

satisfies $q = \bar{q} r_L$ by Equation (14.4).

14.1.6 Continuation-sensitive open-game reduction

Definition 14.20 (Continuation tests)**.** For a complete history-indexed continuation family with history set Hist, use its restriction and realization maps

$$r_h : \Sigma \to \Sigma^h, \qquad g_h : \Sigma^h \to \mathcal{C}(A_h, B_h), \qquad g^h = g_h r_h : \Sigma \to \mathcal{C}(A_h, B_h) \quad (h \in \mathsf{Hist}).$$

A **functional continuation test** is the map g^h, which observes the continuation of a complete policy after h, whether reached or off-path. The family $(g^h)_{h \in \mathsf{Hist}}$ induces the ownerwise contextual equivalence

$$a_i \approx_i^{\mathrm{cont}} b_i \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \forall h \in \mathsf{Hist}\ \forall \sigma_{-i} \in \Sigma_{-i}, \qquad g^h(a_i, \sigma_{-i}) = g^h(b_i, \sigma_{-i}).$$

Comparison predicates $P_h \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A_h, B_h)^2$ are transported along the same maps; identical continuation realizations give identical comparison tests. The superscript on $\approx_i^{\mathrm{cont}}$ is suppressed in the continuation-quotient construction below. Additional factual or certificate observations are retained by including them in the general semantic-test family.

A root outcome records what the selected policies do along the realized play. A test of subgame perfection can also ask what they prescribe after a history that play never reaches. To preserve that test, the policy quotient must commute with restriction to the relevant continuations. The example below exhibits the distinction that a root test misses.

Example 14.21 (Root behavior does not determine sequential rationality)**.** Root-outcome equivalence alone does not preserve sequential rationality. Consider a one-player tree: the root can stop for payoff 2, or continue to a choice between payoffs 1 and 0. The complete policies "stop, then choose 1" and "stop, then choose 0" have the same root behavior and are both root Nash equilibria. Only the first is subgame perfect. The canonical root strategic quotient therefore identifies policies that the continuation predicates in Equation (12.12) still need to distinguish.

Construction 14.22 (Continuation test quotient)**.**

(1) **Evaluate every continuation.** For each history h, let

$$g^h : \Sigma \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A_h, B_h)$$

be the realization of the residual game after restricting complete policies. Use the family $(g^h)_h$ as the semantic tests of Theorem 14.8. This is the family in Definition 14.20.

(2) **Identify the policy equivalence.** The resulting ownerwise equivalence is

$$a_i \approx_i b_i \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \forall h\, \forall s_{-i}, \qquad g^h(a_i, s_{-i}) = g^h(b_i, s_{-i}).$$

Lemma 14.23 (Coherent reduction of continuation games)**.** *For either finite complete-policy tree construction, order histories by extension and write $r_{hk,i} : \Sigma_i^h \to \Sigma_i^k$ for coordinate restriction when $h \preceq k$. At each history define*

$$a_i \approx_i^h b_i \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad \forall k \succeq h\, \forall \tau_{-i} \in \Sigma_{-i}^h, \qquad g_k\big(r_{hk}(a_i, \tau_{-i})\big) = g_k\big(r_{hk}(b_i, \tau_{-i})\big).$$

Let $q_i^h : \Sigma_i^h \twoheadrightarrow \bar{\Sigma}_i^h$ be its quotient. There are unique surjective maps $\bar{r}_{hk,i} : \bar{\Sigma}_i^h \to \bar{\Sigma}_i^k$ satisfying

$$\bar{r}_{hk,i} q_i^h = q_i^k r_{hk,i}. \tag{14.8}$$

They satisfy $\bar{r}_{hh,i} = 1$ and $\bar{r}_{k\ell,i}\bar{r}_{hk,i} = \bar{r}_{h\ell,i}$. Every g_h descends uniquely to $\bar{g}_h$ with $g_h = \bar{g}_h q^h$, where $q^h = \prod_i q_i^h$. At the root, this is the continuation test quotient above.

Proof.

(1) **Lifting along the surjection.** The coordinate projections satisfy $r_{hh,i} = 1$ and $r_{k\ell,i} r_{hk,i} = r_{h\ell,i}$. They are surjective: the finitely many omitted coordinates have nonempty action sets, so finite induction supplies their product, and adjoining those coordinates extends any subtree policy. Equivalently, the paper's reference-based extension gives a section after fixing the reference policy. Neither argument selects sections globally.

(2) **Lifting along the surjection: second comparison.** Suppose $a_i \approx_i^h b_i$. For $\ell \succeq k \succeq h$ and an opponent profile $\eta_{-i} \in \Sigma_{-i}^k$, lift η_{-i} to $\tau_{-i} \in \Sigma_{-i}^h$.

(3) **Stability under continuation restriction.** Restriction composition gives

$$\begin{aligned} g_\ell\big(r_{k\ell}(r_{hk,i} a_i, \eta_{-i})\big) &= g_\ell\big(r_{h\ell}(a_i, \tau_{-i})\big) \\ &= g_\ell\big(r_{h\ell}(b_i, \tau_{-i})\big) \\ &= g_\ell\big(r_{k\ell}(r_{hk,i} b_i, \eta_{-i})\big). \end{aligned}$$

Thus $r_{hk,i} a_i \approx_i^k r_{hk,i} b_i$, and the quotient universal property supplies the unique map in Equation (14.8).

(4) **Lifting along the surjection.** It is surjective because $q_i^k r_{hk,i}$ is surjective. Moreover,

$$\bar{r}_{k\ell,i}\bar{r}_{hk,i} q_i^h = q_i^\ell r_{k\ell,i} r_{hk,i} = q_i^\ell r_{h\ell,i} = \bar{r}_{h\ell,i} q_i^h.$$

Cancelling the epimorphism q_i^h proves composition coherence; the identity law follows in the same way. The test at h occurs in the defining family.

(5) **Ownerwise alternatives.** Replacing the finitely many owner coordinates successively therefore proves that g_h is constant on the fibres of q^h, giving its unique descent. The root tests are exactly $(g^k)_k$.

□

Theorem 14.24 (Continuation-sensitive reduction)**.** *The test-induced quotient for the family $(g^h)_h$ is the coarsest ownerwise quotient preserving all continuation realizations and has the universal factorization property of Theorem 14.8. For measured games retain, at each subtree h, the tuple consisting of g_h and $(V_i^{h,c_h})_i$ in the test family and in its induced*

subtree quotients. This is the corresponding coarsest quotient for the enlarged tests. To vary the initial charge retain all desired translations, or retain the full measured suffix outcome from which they are computed. The assertion below uses the quotients for the chosen tests. In the measured instance NE_{G_h} *and* $\mathsf{NE}_{\bar{G}_h}$ *below use the values at* c_h *and their descents, respectively.*

For the finite complete-policy trees, the reduced games and restriction maps of Lemma 14.23 preserve and reflect subgame-perfect profiles. Writing o *for the root,*

$$\mathsf{SPE}_G = (q^o)^* \left(\bigwedge_h \bar{r}_{oh}^* \mathsf{NE}_{\bar{G}_h} \right). \tag{14.9}$$

Proof.

(1) **Reduced continuations and test descent.** Theorem 14.8 gives descent and the universal property. Lemma 14.23 constructs the reduced continuation diagram. For the enlarged tuple of tests the proof of that lemma applies to each component: lift an opponent profile from a child, restrict it along the same composite restriction, and evaluate the same descendant test. The value components therefore descend at their inherited charges, and the quotient restriction squares commute by epimorphic cancellation. For each h, an original unilateral alternative maps to a reduced alternative.

(2) **Reverse implication.** Conversely any reduced unilateral alternative lifts through q_i^h, while the reference opponents remain fixed. Since $g_h = \bar{g}_h q^h$, both realized interactions in the comparison are preserved. Hence, for each continuation comparison,

$$\mathsf{NE}_{G_h} = (q^h)^* \mathsf{NE}_{\bar{G}_h}.$$

The product of the ownerwise descent squares gives $q^h r_{oh} = \bar{r}_{oh} q^o$.

(3) **Functoriality and substitution.** Functoriality of reindexing and its preservation of meets therefore yield

$$\bigwedge_h r_{oh}^* \mathsf{NE}_{G_h} = (q^o)^* \left(\bigwedge_h \bar{r}_{oh}^* \mathsf{NE}_{\bar{G}_h} \right),$$

which is Equation (14.9).

□

Reducing a policy and then restricting it to a later history gives the same reduced continuation as restricting it first. This is the equality needed to transport a subgame test.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma_i^h & \xrightarrow{q_i^h} & \bar{\Sigma}_i^h \\ {\scriptstyle r_{hk,i}}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \bar{r}_{hk,i}} \\ \Sigma_i^k & \xrightarrow[q_i^k]{} & \bar{\Sigma}_i^k \end{array}$$

Thus the two strategic reductions in the paper are not different abstraction mechanisms. They are the same test-induced quotient with different observation families: root realization for ordinary strategic stability, and all residual realizations for sequential stability.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma_i^h & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{ext}_{h,\sigma_i}} & \Sigma_i \\ & \searrow & \downarrow{\scriptstyle r_{h,i}} \\ & & \Sigma_i^h \end{array} \qquad \begin{array}{ccc} \Sigma & \xrightarrow{q} & \bar{\Sigma} \\ & {\scriptstyle g^h}\searrow & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \bar{g}^h} \\ & & \mathcal{C}(A_h, B_h) \end{array}$$

14.2 Soundness and classifying-model completeness

The exact comparisons concern particular semantic presentations. We now relate them to the calculus. Soundness interprets its judgments in the completed concurrent model; the syntactic classifying model establishes first-layer equational completeness across the designated model class. The later separation and modal results address the distinct question of what can be distinguished within the fixed semantics.

14.2.1 The two-layer soundness theorem

The soundness statement connects the four levels already constructed: the ordinary judgments of Section A.1.1, the displayed agent operations, the finite protocols of Section 10.3, and the contextual assertions in $\mathcal{T}(W)$, $\mathcal{L}(W)$, and $\mathcal{P}(W)$. Ordinary equality is interpreted through diagonal comprehension, while linear variables remain governed by tensor-context splitting. Agent abstraction is internal-hom transposition; observed responses are effective coequalizer factors; legal policies are dependent universal images; and institutional composition matches witnesses by pullback. Primitive comparisons, permissions, and undelivered observations are interpreted by their declared typed data, not inferred from the operational arrows. The inference rules and their proof obligations are displayed in the appendices.

Theorem 14.25 (Soundness of the two-layer agency calculus)**.** *The completed true-concurrent semantics of Section 1 interprets every well-formed type, term, display, and contextual assertion of this calculus. Derivable term equations are equalities of morphisms; derivable assertion entailments are inclusions of predicates. Interpretation preserves ordinary and linear substitution, agent composition, owner regrouping, delegation, finite protocol execution, perspective, witnessed institutional composition, and epistemic update.*

The proof is given in Appendix B.

The two semantic layers remain distinct: linear terms retain resources and execution witnesses, whereas assertions retain truth values. Soundness does not identify their units, products, or notions of equality.

14.2.2 Reconstruction of the displayed economic model

Theorem 14.26 (Exact reconstruction)**.** *Encoding a displayed owned presentation on original arenas as an agent state and decoding it by Theorem 2.18 recovers that presentation. The construction extends to situated presentations, regroupings, delegation maps, witnessed institutions, and complete finite communication presentations, retaining every displayed ordinary carrier and map. Both round trips are identity up to their canonical isomorphisms.*

Agent reconstruction is the inverse of policy-indexed currying and Yoneda decoding.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbf{Set}(\Sigma, \mathcal{C}(A,B)) & \xrightarrow{\text{encode}} & \mathcal{V}(\mathsf{I}, \mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(yA, yB)) \\ & \searrow^{\text{id}} & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \text{decode}} \\ & & \mathbf{Set}(\Sigma, \mathcal{C}(A,B)) \end{array}$$

Proof.

(1) **Use the inverse representation.** The encoding and decoding of Theorem 2.19 give both round trips, including ownerwise composition. Theorem 14.2 and Corollary 14.3 transport the displayed fields. For finite sessions these include endpoint policies, pruned trees, and secured transcripts, including off-path coordinates. The decision observations

and acceptance domains of Theorem 10.29 and Proposition 5.78 and the delivered-record construction of Construction 10.46 therefore have the same canonical round trips.

□

Exact reconstruction depends on retaining the ownership signature and execution witnesses as displayed data. The underlying linear agent object does not recover who controls its policy factors, and the predicate doctrine cannot recover a hidden execution from its truth value. The reconstruction theorem recovers precisely the data that were retained.

Type-theoretic construction	Recovered semantic construction
Agent state	Owned complete-policy realization
Linear sequential and parallel operations	Composition and tensor of concurrent realizers
Ownerwise parameter substitution	Realization-preserving policy maps
Regrouping and delegation	Collective control and implemented parent policies
Linear dependent products	Families of perspective-dependent resources
Predicate observation box	Knowledge from observation fibres
Uniform policy section	Observation-based legality at every compatible world
Session interaction witness	Secured communication history
Institutional span composition	Matching records, realizers, and permissions
Public comprehension	Restriction of both epistemic endpoints
Complete communication policies	Truthful reporting and delivered private/public observations

14.2.3 The classifying model of the first layer

Fix a typed primitive signature $\mathcal{K}$ for ordinary sorts and operations, linear boundary sorts, and linear generators. All primitive declarations have specified arities. The first-layer theory $\mathbb{T}_{\mathrm{Ag}}(\mathcal{K})$ is generated by the rules of Section A.1.1 and Section A.1.1; agent types, composition, regrouping, and delegation are the displayed definitions above. The measured witness package and its explicit charge tag in Section A.1.2 expand into dependent linear sum, tensor and Lin terms over the declared ordinary maps. The budget modalities belong to the assertion and dependent-family interpretations. Finite data use the exhibited generators of Construction 10.25. Finite sessions have the guarded prefix interpretation of Lemma 10.32 and its factorization through fixed session wiring in $\mathbf{j}_N(\mathcal{C})$. A primitive signature declares operation symbols with typed arities; it does not silently assert that unrelated symbols obey equations proved only in one semantic interpretation. Consequently the following completeness statement concerns the equational first-layer theory, not operational progress or equality in one fixed concurrent model.

A split indexed linear–nonlinear model consists of an ordinary comprehension model for the stated extensional dependent type constructors (with equality comprehensions given by pullbacks of diagonals), an indexed symmetric monoidal closed linear category with additives and dependent linear sums and products, and a substitution-stable adjunction $\mathsf{Lin} \dashv \mathsf{Val}$ with strong monoidal Lin. Its indexed adjoints obey the base-change and Frobenius comparisons expressed by the rules. A model of $\mathcal{K}$ interprets its declared constants at their arities. These are the semantic structures specified by the type constructors, rather than an identification of all ordinary contexts with sets.

Construction 14.27 (Syntactic indexed model)**.**

(1) **Construct the ordinary base.** Let $\mathcal{B}_{\mathrm{syn}}$ have ordinary contexts as objects and ordinary substitutions modulo derivable equality as arrows. Its terminal object is the empty context and its comprehension is context extension.

(2) **Construct the linear fibres.** Over Γ, let $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{syn}}(\Gamma)$ have linear types modulo conversion as objects and arrows $A \to B$ represented by

$$\Gamma; x : A \vdash t : B$$

modulo derivable equality and bound-variable renaming. Composition is linear substitution.

(3) **Define reindexing.** Reindexing substitutes ordinary parameters in types and terms. The ordinary type fibre is defined similarly using ordinary terms.

Proposition 14.28 (Diagonal construction of extensional equality)**.** *In an ordinary extensional comprehension model, equality between sections $a, b : \Gamma \to \Gamma.X$ is the diagonal pullback*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Gamma.\,\mathrm{Eq}_X(a,b) & \longrightarrow & \Gamma.X \\ \downarrow e & & \downarrow \Delta_X \\ \Gamma & \xrightarrow{\langle a,b\rangle} & \Gamma.X \times_\Gamma \Gamma.X. \end{array}$$

A term of this equality family yields the equation $a = b$; two terms of the same equality family are equal. These properties are stable under ordinary substitution. The corresponding extensional equality conversion in the syntax presents *this universal property: the categorical argument proves its soundness, not a derivation of equality reflection from weaker syntactic constructors. It is part of the chosen* ordinary *foundation, not a rule for agents or linear resources, and it does not follow from intensional identity types or from dependent sums and products alone.*

Proof.

(1) **Extensional equality elimination.** The diagonal and its pullback e are monomorphisms. The pullback equations give $ae = be$. A term p of the equality family is a section $\bar{p}$ of e, so $a = ae\bar{p} = be\bar{p} = b$.

(2) **Functoriality and substitution.** For two such sections p, q, monicity gives $p = q$ from $ep = eq = \mathrm{id}$. Pullback stability of diagonals proves substitution stability. This proof derives the categorical consequences of the chosen extensional equality interpretation; it does not identify intensional equality with extensional conversion.

□

Lemma 14.29 (General-map dependent adjoints in the syntax)**.** *For every definable ordinary substitution $f : V \to W$, its ordinary equality fibres together with the linear dependent sum and product along comprehension construct left and right adjoints to reindexing on the syntactic linear fibres. They obey Beck–Chevalley for pullback squares and Frobenius for tensor.*

The proof is given in Appendix B.

Lemma 14.30 (Equality-fibre base change and Frobenius coherence)**.** *For a pullback of definable ordinary substitutions*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V' & \xrightarrow{a} & V \\ {\scriptstyle f'}\downarrow & \lrcorner & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f} \\ W' & \xrightarrow[b]{} & W, \end{array}$$

there is a substitution-natural equivalence of equality fibres

$$\chi_{w'} : \mathrm{Fib}_{f'}(w') \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathrm{Fib}_{f}(b(w')).$$

Its induced comparison maps give

$$b^{*}\Sigma^{\ell}_{f} \cong \Sigma^{\ell}_{f'}a^{*}, \qquad b^{*}\Pi^{\ell}_{f} \cong \Pi^{\ell}_{f'}a^{*}.$$

The comparisons compose coherently under iterated pullbacks, and intertwine the Frobenius maps $\Sigma^{\ell}_{f}(f^{*}B \otimes A) \cong B \otimes \Sigma^{\ell}_{f}A$.

The proof is given in Appendix B.

Lemma 14.31 (The syntax carries the required structure)**.** *The construction is a split indexed linear–nonlinear model of* $\mathbb{T}_{\mathrm{Ag}}(\mathcal{K})$.

The proof is given in Appendix B.

Interpretations and their comparisons. Fix a target model and an interpretation of the typed signature $\mathcal{K}$. Strict interpretations preserve the chosen operations and substitution on the nose. For the weak formulation, use functors on contexts and functors on the ordinary and linear fibres over that base functor. Their specified invertible comparisons transport reindexing, comprehension, the monoidal and closed structures, the additives, the indexed adjoints and the $\mathsf{Lin}, \mathsf{Val}$ adjunction. Preservation of a universal construction includes its defining arrows (projections, injections, evaluation, or unit and counit). Coherence compares identity and composite reindexing and the substitution comparisons of the constructors, including Beck–Chevalley and Frobenius. At a primitive declaration the identification with its fixed interpretation is part of the data, over the already interpreted arity. This is the usual distinction between strict and pseudo interpretations in a category with families; compare the ordinary fragment in Castellan, Clairambault, and Dybjer (2017).

In the category of such interpretations a structural 2-cell $\theta : F \Rightarrow G$ consists of a natural isomorphism on contexts and natural fibre isomorphisms

$$\theta_{\Gamma,A} : F_{\Gamma}A \longrightarrow \theta^{*}_{\Gamma}G_{\Gamma}A$$

for ordinary and linear types. These commute with substitutions, with the specified structure comparisons and with the identifications of primitive declarations. In particular, on an arrow $t : A \to B$ the fibre naturality square is $\theta_{\Gamma,B}F(t) = (\theta^{*}_{\Gamma}G(t))\theta_{\Gamma,A}$. Composition uses composition on contexts and reindexing on the fibres. Thus uniqueness up to coherent comparison is a statement in a definite category of interpretations over the fixed signature.

Theorem 14.32 (Initiality and equational completeness)**.** *Every interpretation of* $\mathcal{K}$ *in a split indexed linear–nonlinear model extends uniquely, up to its specified coherent structure comparisons, to an interpretation of the first-layer syntax. For well-typed terms* t, u*,*

$$\mathbb{T}_{\mathrm{Ag}}(\mathcal{K}) \vdash t = u \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad [\![t]\!]_{\mathcal{M}} = [\![u]\!]_{\mathcal{M}} \text{ in every such model } \mathcal{M}.$$

The same assertion holds for its derived agent operations.

The proof is given in Appendix B.

14.2.4 Operational and modal completeness in the fixed semantics

The classifying-model result concerns derivability relative to all split indexed linear–nonlinear models. The fixed concurrent model admits stronger comparison results of a different kind: original arenas separate its open agent morphisms, while its retained transition relations admit a logical characterization by modal tests. These statements concern equality and expressivity in the specified semantics, rather than derivability of every fixed-model equation in the freely presented syntax.

Theorem 14.33 (Original-arena probes separate open agent morphisms)**.** *For original arenas A, B and an ordinary complete-policy carrier Σ, put $H_\Sigma(A,B) = [\mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes yA, yB] \in \mathcal{V}$. For every $K \in \mathcal{C}_0$ there is a natural bijection*

$$\mathcal{V}(y(JK), H_\Sigma(A,B)) \cong \mathbf{Set}\big(\Sigma, \mathcal{C}(JK \otimes A, B)\big). \tag{14.10}$$

For any $T \in \mathcal{V}$ and $f, g : T \to H_\Sigma(A,B)$, the following are equivalent:

(i) *$f = g$ in the fixed presheaf category;*

(ii) *for every $K \in \mathcal{C}_0$, every $z : y(JK) \to T$, and every $\sigma \in \Sigma$, the concurrent arrows $JK \otimes A \to B$ decoded from fz and gz at σ are equal in $\mathcal{C}$.*

The comparison is stable under ordinary parameter substitution, by applying it in each indexed fibre. For $T = yR$, it reduces to pointwise equality of the families of actual concurrent arrows $R \otimes A \to B$.

Proof.

(1) **Closedness, copowers, and Yoneda decoding.** By closedness, the copower description of Lin, and strong monoidality of restricted Yoneda, there are natural isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{V}(y(JK), H_\Sigma(A,B)) &\cong \mathcal{V}(y(JK) \otimes \mathsf{Lin}\Sigma \otimes yA, yB)\\ &\cong \prod_{\sigma\in\Sigma} \mathcal{V}(y(JK \otimes A), yB)\\ &\cong \prod_{\sigma\in\Sigma} \mathcal{C}(JK \otimes A, B).\end{aligned}$$

The second isomorphism distributes Day tensor over the copower and identifies the resulting representables; the third is restricted Yoneda. Each comparison is natural in the arena probe and in the policy coordinate.

(2) **Separation by original arenas.** Yoneda identifies a map $z : y(JK) \to T$ with an element of $T(K)$. Two natural transformations $f, g : T \to H_\Sigma(A,B)$ are equal exactly when their component maps agree on every such element, for every $K \in \mathcal{C}_0$. The displayed bijection identifies this equality componentwise with equality of the decoded concurrent arrows at all $\sigma \in \Sigma$, proving both implications.

(3) **Representable contexts and substitution.** For $T = yR$, choose $K \in \mathcal{C}_0$ and an isomorphism $JK \cong R$; evaluation at the corresponding Yoneda element reduces the comparison to equality of the families $R \otimes A \to B$. In a dependent fibre all comparisons are pointwise, so ordinary reindexing preserves them. Ownerwise reparametrization simply precomposes the displayed policy family.

□

Corollary 14.34 (Effective semantic equality of finite causal agents)**.** *Consider two closed agent states with the same displayed finite policy carrier Σ and boundaries A, B, generated by*

the explicitly presented finite causal protocols of Theorems 10.5 and 10.28. Their denotations in $\mathcal{V}$ are equal if and only if, for every $\sigma \in \Sigma$, their realized finite strategies are isomorphic over $A^{\perp} \parallel B$. Equality of these explicitly encoded finite interpretations is decidable: a successful comparison supplies an arena-preserving event-structure isomorphism for every policy coordinate. The procedure also tests an exhibited finite ownerwise reparametrization.

Proof.

(1) **Recovery of concurrent arrows.** For closed agent states, Theorem 2.18 and restricted Yoneda identify semantic equality with equality of the realized arrows in $\mathcal{C}(A, B)$ at each complete policy. By the definition of $\mathcal{C}$, equality of two such arrows is precisely isomorphism of their strategy event structures over the common polarized arrow arena.

(2) **Finite comparison procedure.** In the finite causal protocols, the policy sets, event carriers, event labels, orders, and consistency tables are finite explicitly specified data. For each policy, enumerate the finitely many bijections between the two event carriers and test preservation of order, consistency, polarity, and arena labelling. The procedure returns an isomorphism exactly when one exists and terminates over the finite policy carrier.

(3) **Ownerwise reparametrization.** For a displayed finite map $r : \Theta \to \Sigma$, compare the source arrow at θ with the target arrow at $r(\theta)$. This is the defining realization equation for reparametrization and again requires finitely many comparisons.

□

Let X, $\ell : X \to L$, and $(R_a \subseteq X^2)_{a \in \mathcal{A}}$ be the retained carrier, observable data, and designated relations of Construction 12.31. Write $B_* = \nu\mathcal{F}$ for its greatest retained-label bisimulation. The predicates $P_v = \ell^{-1}\{v\} \hookrightarrow X$, $v \in \ell[X]$, are inverse images of ordinary equality predicates in the already constructed doctrine. Let $\mathsf{ML}_{\ell,R}$ be the Boolean *semantic test language* built from these equality-fibre tests, $\top$, Boolean operations, and $\langle a\rangle Q = \exists_{p_1} p_2^* Q$ for R_a. As usual, $[a]Q = \neg\langle a\rangle\neg Q$. Each P_v may be regarded as a parameterized equality test at the retained value v; a closed syntactic formula requires a term naming that value. This distinction will be maintained in the expressive-completeness result.

Theorem 14.35 (Modal characterization of the exact retained refinement)**.** *If each successor set $\{y : xR_a y\}$ is finite, then, for $x, y \in X$,*

$$x\, B_*\, y \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad (\forall \varphi \in \mathsf{ML}_{\ell,R})(x \models \varphi \Longleftrightarrow y \models \varphi).$$

Thus the coarsest exact quotient of Theorem 12.33 identifies precisely the states indistinguishable by these retained Boolean modal tests. This is the Hennessy–Milner separation argument (Hennessy and Milner, 1980, 1985), applied to the paper's displayed observation, strategic, and execution relations.

Proof.

(1) **Invariance under retained bisimulation.** The relation B_* preserves ℓ and matches R_a-successors in both directions. Therefore each equality-fibre test P_v is invariant. Boolean operations preserve invariance, and the two successor clauses show that the diamond (hence also the box) preserves it. Induction on modal tests proves the forward implication.

(2) **Separating an unmatched successor.** Let M relate states satisfying exactly the same tests. The tests P_v give $M \subseteq \ker(\ell)$. Suppose xMy and $xR_a x'$, but no a-successor

y' of y satisfies $x'My'$. For each of the finitely many such y' choose a modal test $\varphi_{y'}$ true at x' and false at y'. Boolean negation permits this orientation. Then

$$\psi = \bigwedge_{yR_ay'} \varphi_{y'}$$

is true at x' and false at every a-successor of y; the empty conjunction is $\top$. Thus $x \models \langle a\rangle\psi$ but $y \not\models \langle a\rangle\psi$, contradicting xMy.

(3) **Coinduction.** Interchanging x, y gives the reverse successor clause. Consequently $M \subseteq \mathcal{F}(M)$. Coinduction for the greatest fixed point gives $M \subseteq B_*$, completing the converse.

□

The characteristic formulas below belong to the semantic language of retained equality tests: $P_{\ell(x)}$ is available as a predicate interpreting equality with the displayed label $\ell(x)$. Their finite expressivity is relative to those named semantic tests. A separately presented first-layer signature denotes such a formula only when it contains a term naming the corresponding retained label; no general surjectivity from freely generated terms onto semantic labels is used.

Theorem 14.36 (Finite-depth characteristic formulas and full expressivity)**.** *Suppose X and $\mathcal{A}$ are finite. Define*

$$E_0 = \ker(\ell), \qquad E_{n+1} = \mathcal{F}(E_n).$$

If X is nonempty, this sequence stabilizes at B_* after at most $|X| - 1$ strict refinement steps. In particular, B_* is definable without a fixed-point binder by finitely many instances of ordinary equality, the designated relation tests, and their quantifier adjoints.

More explicitly, for each $x \in X$ put

$$\chi_x^0 = P_{\ell(x)},$$
$$\chi_x^{n+1} = P_{\ell(x)} \ \wedge \bigwedge_{a\in\mathcal{A}} \left(\bigwedge_{xR_az} \langle a\rangle\chi_z^n \ \wedge \ [a]\Big(\bigvee_{xR_az} \chi_z^n \Big) \right).$$

Empty conjunctions and disjunctions mean $\top$ and $\bot$. For all x, y, n,

$$y \models \chi_x^n \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad (x, y) \in E_n.$$

If m is the first stable index, then χ_x^m defines the B_*-class of x. Every B_*-invariant predicate $P \hookrightarrow X$ is consequently denoted by the finite modal expression $\bigvee_{x\in P} \chi_x^m$. In particular, evaluation induces an isomorphism of Boolean algebras

$$\mathsf{ML}_{\ell,R}/{\equiv_X} \ \cong \ \mathsf{Pred}(X/B_*),$$

where $\equiv_X$ denotes equality of denotations in this fixed finite model. This is expressive completeness of the semantic test language, not proof-theoretic completeness of the freely generated first-layer syntax. For $X = \varnothing$ the analogous statement holds with the unique predicate and $\bot$.

Proof.

(1) **Finite bisimulation refinement.** For an equivalence relation E, let $[z]_E$ denote its equivalence class. Then $\mathcal{F}(E)$ is the kernel equivalence of the map

$$x \longmapsto \left(\ell(x), \left(\{[z]_E : xR_a z\}\right)_{a\in\mathcal{A}}\right).$$

Indeed, equality of the reached class sets expresses both successor matching clauses. Hence $\mathcal{F}(E)$ is an equivalence relation. Since $E_1 \subseteq E_0$ and $\mathcal{F}$ is monotone, the sequence E_n descends. On nonempty finite X every strict refinement splits at least one class, so there are at most $|X| - 1$ strict refinements.

(2) **Identification with the greatest fixed point.** If $E_m = E_{m+1}$, then E_m is a fixed point and therefore $E_m \subseteq B_*$. Conversely $B_* \subseteq E_0$ by retained-label preservation, and monotonicity inductively gives $B_* \subseteq E_n$ for all n. Hence $E_m = B_*$. An explicit first-order definition is obtained recursively from $E_0(x, y) \equiv \ell(x) = \ell(y)$ by

$$\begin{aligned} E_{n+1}(x,y) \;\equiv\; & \ell(x) = \ell(y) \wedge \\ & \bigwedge_{a\in\mathcal{A}} \left[\forall x' \left(xR_a x' \Rightarrow \exists y' \left(yR_a y' \wedge E_n(x', y')\right)\right)\right. \\ & \qquad \left.\wedge\, \forall y' \left(yR_a y' \Rightarrow \exists x' \left(xR_a x' \wedge E_n(x', y')\right)\right)\right]. \end{aligned}$$

The construction uses the existing equality, predicate, and quantifier operations and gives $\mathcal{F}(E_n)$ at each stage.

(3) **Characteristic modal tests.** We prove $y \models \chi_x^n \iff (x, y) \in E_n$ by induction on n. At $n = 0$ it says precisely $\ell(x) = \ell(y)$. For the successor case, the diamond conjunction states that every a-successor of x has an E_n-matching successor of y; the box states that every a-successor of y has an E_n-matching successor of x. These are exactly the clauses defining E_{n+1}. At stabilization, χ_x^m therefore denotes the B_*-class of x.

(4) **Classification of invariant predicates.** A predicate $P \subseteq X$ is B_*-invariant precisely when it is a union of B_*-classes. Therefore $\bigvee_{x\in P} \chi_x^m$ denotes P. All modal tests are B_*-invariant by the previous theorem, so their interpretations descend to predicates on X/B_*. Passing to tests modulo equality of denotations gives an injective Boolean-algebra map to $\mathsf{Pred}(X/B_*)$, and the characteristic formulas make it surjective. When $X = \varnothing$, both Boolean algebras have one element, represented by the denotation of $\bot$.

□

Corollary 14.37 (Finite-model elimination of modal fixed points)**.** *On a fixed finite retained relation frame, every modal fixed-point predicate built from the retained atoms and relations has the same denotation as a finite Boolean modal expression without μ or ν. For any monotone $F : \mathsf{Pred}(X) \to \mathsf{Pred}(X)$ given by the displayed assertion constructors, its least and greatest fixed points are also obtained by iteration from $\bot$ and $\top$, respectively, after at most $|X|$ strict changes.*

Proof.

(1) **Descent of modal fixed-point predicates.** By Theorem 12.33, the quotient by B_* is surjective and bounded for each retained relation, and the designated atoms descend. The modal fixed-point transport theorem 9.30 consequently makes every such fixed-point denotation B_*-invariant. The characteristic-formula theorem then expresses it by a finite Boolean modal test without fixed-point binders.

(2) **Finite monotone iteration.** For any monotone F on $\mathsf{Pred}(X)$, the iteration $\bot \le F(\bot) \le F^2(\bot) \le \cdots$ is increasing, while $\top \ge F(\top) \ge F^2(\top) \ge \cdots$ is decreasing. Each

strict change adds or removes at least one state, so a chain stabilizes after at most $|X|$ strict changes. At stabilization the value is a fixed point; induction and coinduction identify it with μF and νF, respectively.

□

Remark 14.38 (Why the fixed-model result is not unrestricted syntactic completeness). These results separate all denotationally distinct open agent maps and characterize every finite-state bisimulation-invariant predicate, but they do not infer definitional equality of arbitrary primitive terms from equality in the fixed concurrent model. In the interpreted finite-data signature of Construction 10.25, the primitive name for the response $\widehat{\mathrm{id}_X} : D(X) \to D(X)$ denotes copycat, which is also the interpretation of the structural identity. When that name is freely declared, the existing rules need not equate its term with the identity term. Indeed, the split indexed linear–nonlinear model with both ordinary and linear fibres $\mathbf{Set}^{\Gamma_{\mathrm{disc}}}$, Cartesian tensor, and $\mathsf{Lin} = \mathsf{Val} = 1$ may interpret d_X as a two-element set and the free response name as a nonidentity endomap. Soundness then rules out derivability of their equation in the free theory. The modal Boolean-algebra isomorphism above is likewise modulo *equality of denotations in the specified finite model*, not an unproved assertion about equations derivable in all indexed models. In particular, the concrete assertion fibres are Boolean whereas the listed logical inference rules are formulated through Heyting operations; a proof-theoretic completeness claim would also need to derive the corresponding fixed-model Boolean validities from the stated rules.

14.2.5 The different meanings of completeness

Several completeness results must be distinguished. The representation theorem 2.18 identifies semantic agent states with owned concurrent realizations. The finite causal protocol theorem 10.28 gives definability for that generated fragment; Theorem 10.41 retains its finite session realizations and witnesses. The classifying-model theorem 14.32 establishes derivability from equality in all the designated first-layer models. In contrast, Theorem 14.33 separates arrows in the single fixed presheaf model, and Theorems 14.35 and 14.36 characterize modal indistinguishability and finite-state expressivity relative to the retained tests. Neither conclusion equates all fixed-model denotational equalities with derivable syntactic equations.

For instance, two unrelated primitive scalar constants can remain distinct in the free syntax while both necessarily denote the unique element of $\mathcal{C}(I, I)$. Remark 14.38 exhibits the same obstruction using a named finite response and copycat. The operational separation and modal results characterize fixed-model semantic equality at their specified interfaces; they do not prove derivability of those equalities. Full completeness in particular causal-invariant linear fragments (Castellan and Yoshida, 2019) is not transferred here to all receptive courteous strategies.

The resulting theory offers two complementary tests of a representation. Original arenas distinguish its concurrent arrows; the designated modal tests distinguish its retained alternatives on a finite frame. Together with reconstruction, these results specify which operational and agency claims survive the passage between the paper's descriptions.

Conclusion

The theory constructed here represents agency by an owned family of complete policies with concurrent realizations. Its linear representation allows agents to participate as resources in larger interactions, while the displayed owner factors retain who controls each

alternative. Observation, evaluation, and permission then determine which alternatives can be implemented, preferred, and legally exercised. This gives a compositional account of agency whose strategic and epistemic statements can be compared with the executions that realize them.

The comparison results explain why the retained data matter. Complete policies preserve choices outside the current history. Witnessed institutions preserve the certificate passed to a successor. Completed communication records identify what each recipient actually received. Residual policies generate controllers, while residual strategies retain the interactions still possible. A representation that preserves one of these structures need not preserve the others. The source-fixed lifting results specify when the designated alternatives survive a change of presentation, and reconstruction identifies the data recovered from the displayed semantics.

What locality reveals. Local descriptions answer different questions in this theory. Causal patches glue secured matching histories and reconstruct interaction before hiding. Owner-local policy views can instead miss a joint legal restriction; their completion identifies that loss and commutes with delegation onto implemented policies. At completed communication, persistent policies and anchored records connect these comparisons to the specified epistemic and strategic modalities. Hiding still need not lift every visible successor, and a payoff descends to policies exactly when it equalizes the completed-witness kernel pair.

The finite economic results give three further uses of these distinctions. An affine obstruction can prevent decentralized implementation even when joint information permits it; in the binary team example, disclosure raises every equilibrium's common payoff from 3/4 to 1 before fees. On the legal-deviation graph, cycle circulations detect failure of exact potential integration and determine a sharp uniform approximation bound. Common and own-policy charges preserve that class, and whole-parent-block implementation preserves and reflects its vanishing on the implemented image. Finally, blocking selections with acyclic owner graphs construct preferences without a stable legal profile; absence of such certificates characterizes finite robust solvability. The last construction uses the intersection locality of interaction arrays, rather than higher cohomology on the discrete outcome space.

Scope and interfaces. These results establish a theory for the displayed agent data, pure policies, and qualitative information. The calculus is sound; classifying-model completeness characterizes first-layer derivability across the designated model class. In the fixed concurrent semantics, original arenas separate open-agent arrows, and finite retained frames admit the stated modal characterization. These different results support the respective representation, reasoning, and abstraction tasks without identifying their notions of completeness.

For an application, the interface determines what the theory can certify. The comparisons in Theorems 11.18, 14.2 and 14.26 specify how observations, controlled alternatives, and witnesses are retained. In the authorization example, access to the required policy entries is implemented by the finite protocol. Another implementation must likewise identify the evidence it supplies to each decision point.

Remark 14.39 (Retained economic interfaces). The linear semantics determines how exhibited interactions compose. Ownership, observations, comparison predicates, technologies, and institutional rules are explicitly typed economic data. Concurrent strategies determine event enablement and residualization; observation wires and retained pointed histories determine the displayed action uncertainty. The resulting predicates express equilibrium, ability, rationalizability, feasibility, coalition blocking, and truthful implementation for the specified economic presentation. The Cartesian-frame, local-state, and choice-cell comparisons identify

their respective interfaces. Persistent intentions and corporate judgements can be represented through explicit commitment and aggregation data retained by the same presentation.

A matched delivery contributes one class to an additive charge; the causal order additionally determines critical-path duration. A budget restricts the permitted witnesses, whereas a price changes their evaluation. In the two-bit example, joint affirmative action remains an equilibrium at price one and ceases to be one above it. In a continuation game, the inherited charge ensures that alternatives are compared from the same prior history. Projecting away the charge recovers outcome-only play. The measured record thus supports distinct tests of feasibility, incentives, and subsequent action.

Remark 14.40 (Probability and intensional interfaces). The policy sets and private policy records used here are semantic values; their finite realizations are extensional response protocols. Models of open-source games additionally represent program descriptions, permitting self-reference and inspection of another agent's strategy description. Interactive diagonalization is studied by Abramsky and Zvesper (2010), and provability-based equilibria by Barasz et al. (2014). Rational synthesis, as studied by Fisman, Kupferman, and Lustig (2009), asks for implementations satisfying strategic specifications.

The present theory uses pure policies and qualitative information. Probabilistic extensions require distributions and chance kernels, as in Bayesian games (Harsanyi, 1967) and stochastic games (Shapley, 1953). The disclosure and action-model constructions here have the formula semantics and reduction laws of Appendix A.2. Observational distinctions that do not descend to the original visible quotient are retained on the exact refinement and its dependent operational witness family.

The completion, linearization, and dependent adjoints are set-theoretic categorical constructions, and least and greatest fixed points are order-theoretic operations on predicates. Finite path maxima construct the potentials of Theorem 13.6; directization constructs $r_s = m \prod_i s_i$ with the universal comparison of Proposition 13.47.

The resulting categorical theory makes the passage between descriptions of agency a mathematical question. Given the displayed control, information, evaluation, and institutional data, one can construct the agent interface, compose its realization, and prove which alternatives and witnesses a comparison preserves. This is the connection the theory establishes between an agent's possible choices and its place in an executing system.

A Natural-Deduction Presentation of the Logic of Agency

The main text constructs policies, their causal realizations, and the assertions an observer can make about them. This appendix gives the inference rules for reasoning at each of those three levels. In particular the context of a judgement shows which ordinary parameters can be reused and which linear occurrences an execution must account for. Appendix B proves soundness and the classifying-model result for the rules.

A.1 Ordinary and linear agent type theory

The proof-theoretic fragment is interpreted through the linear–nonlinear adjunction of Benton (1995) and the indexed dependent setting of Vákár (2015). The rule tables preserve the distinction between ordinary variables, which may be reused, and linear variables, which must be accounted for by context splitting.

The ordinary and linear judgements below are interpreted in the indexed categories of the main text. In a rule with several premises, the contexts show how the linear resources are divided. This is the information used in the soundness induction and in deriving the displayed operations on agents.

A.1.1 Judgments of the agent calculus

Ordinary parameters and linear resources The ordinary fragment is extensional dependent type theory with finite products and coproducts, dependent sums and products, and equality. Ordinary types and terms have judgments

$$\Gamma \vdash X\ \mathsf{Type}, \qquad \Gamma \vdash u : X.$$

An ordinary context is built by comprehension $\Gamma, x : X$. Linear families may depend on ordinary variables:

$$\Gamma \vdash A\ \mathsf{LType}, \qquad \Gamma; \Delta \vdash t : A.$$

Here $\Delta = x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$ is a linear context whose families are all indexed by Γ. Each A_k is indexed by the ordinary context. A later linear type does not depend on a preceding linear variable. Ordinary dependence is therefore available in type formation, while resource occurrences remain governed by tensor-context use.

The linear type constructors are

$$\mathsf{I}, \quad A \otimes B, \quad A \multimap B, \quad A \,\&\, B, \quad \top, \quad A \oplus B, \quad \mathbf{0}, \quad \Sigma^{\ell}_{x} A, \quad \Pi^{\ell}_{x} A, \quad \mathsf{Lin} X.$$

The ordinary family $\mathsf{Val}A$ records monoidal states of the linear family A. The adjunction $\mathsf{Lin} \dashv \mathsf{Val}$ connects the two kinds of judgments, and $!A$ abbreviates $\mathsf{LinVal}A$, the resulting exponential. These rules do not supply an unrestricted contraction on arbitrary linear terms.

The multiplicative and adjunction rules The essential multiplicative rules are

$$\frac{}{\Gamma; x : A \vdash x : A}, \qquad \frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash t : A \quad \Gamma; \Theta \vdash u : B}{\Gamma; \Delta, \Theta \vdash t \otimes u : A \otimes B},$$

$$\frac{\Gamma; \Delta, x : A \vdash t : B}{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash \lambda x.t : A \multimap B}, \qquad \frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash f : A \multimap B \quad \Gamma; \Theta \vdash t : A}{\Gamma; \Delta, \Theta \vdash f(t) : B}.$$

Each multiplicative rule partitions its linear premises into disjoint contexts. Tensor elimination consumes its argument and binds both components, while the unit is introduced only

with the appropriate empty linear context. These conditions implement the resource-sensitive meaning of the connectives.

Ordinary terms are introduced into $\mathsf{Lin}X$ by

$$\frac{\Gamma \vdash u : X}{\Gamma; \varnothing \vdash \mathsf{return}(u) : \mathsf{Lin}X}.$$

Elimination of $\mathsf{Lin}X$ binds an ordinary $x : X$ inside the continuation:

$$\frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash s : \mathsf{Lin}X \quad \Gamma, x : X; \Theta \vdash t : A}{\Gamma; \Delta, \Theta \vdash \mathsf{let}\ \mathsf{return}(x) = s\ \mathsf{in}\ t : A}. \tag{A.1}$$

The displayed instance has Θ and A pulled back from Γ. Dependent result types are expressed by the indexed sum Σ^{ℓ}. Elimination binds an ordinary parameter that may be reused in its continuation, while the supplied linear term s is consumed exactly once.

The value rules are

$$\frac{\Gamma; \varnothing \vdash t : A}{\Gamma \vdash \mathsf{thunk}(t) : \mathsf{Val}A}, \qquad \frac{\Gamma \vdash v : \mathsf{Val}A}{\Gamma; \varnothing \vdash \mathsf{force}(v) : A}.$$

The value rules express the hom-set adjunction by their computation and uniqueness laws. The introduction rule requires an empty linear context: a term depending on a linear resource cannot thereby be turned into reusable ordinary information.

Definitional equality consists of the displayed β and η equations for tensor, unit, internal hom, additives, dependent sums and products, and the adjunction. Its commuting conversions make eliminators natural in their continuations. The soundness proof checks each family of equations against the corresponding categorical universal property.

Indexed linear abstraction For $\Gamma \vdash X\ \mathsf{Type}$ and $\Gamma, x : X \vdash A\ \mathsf{LType}$, the dependent product introduction rule is

$$\frac{\Gamma, x : X; p^{*}\Delta \vdash t : A}{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash \Lambda x.t : \Pi^{\ell}_{x} A}, \qquad p : \Gamma.X \to \Gamma.$$

Application selects one ordinary index from the dependent product. The same linear resource may be mentioned in alternative components of an additive product, but it cannot be extracted twice as simultaneous linear occurrences. The distinction is essential for the agent abstraction derived from the dependent product.

Lemma A.1 (Substitution)**.** *Ordinary substitution preserves all formation, typing, and equality judgments. If*

$$\Gamma; \Delta \vdash s : A, \qquad \Gamma; \Theta, x : A \vdash t : B,$$

then $\Gamma; \Theta, \Delta \vdash t[s/x] : B$*. The substitution uses the resources of* Δ *once in the multiplicative sense and preserves definitional equality.*

Proof.

(1) **Induction on derivations.** Proceed by induction on the derivation into which substitution is made. For a variable, substitute s if it is x, and retain the variable otherwise. At a multiplicative rule, x belongs to exactly one premise; apply the induction to that premise and retain the other disjoint context.

(2) **Fibrewise calculation.** At an additive introduction or case rule, the same context is present in the alternative premises, so substitute in each alternative, retaining one shared context in the conclusion. Under an ordinary binder, rename its variable to avoid capture and pull s back along comprehension. Under a linear binder, rename that variable and apply the induction to the body.

(3) **Preserve the empty linear context.** The Val introduction case has empty linear context, so it cannot contain a free x. The Lin eliminator uses the two induction steps for its split premises. These exhaust the constructors.

(4) **Functoriality and substitution.** Each defining equation is stable under the same capture-avoiding substitutions, proving the equality claim.

□

Corollary A.2 (Preservation for the core reductions)**.** *Every well-typed β reduction and every typed commuting conversion preserves its judgment.*

Proof.

(1) **Use the adjoint comparisons.** The internal-hom and dependent elimination cases are instances of Lemma A.1. Tensor and unit reduction consume precisely the components introduced by their matching constructors. Additive reduction selects one branch with its declared context.

(2) **Adjunction and transposition.** Adjunction reduction substitutes the ordinary value supplied by return or removes a matching thunk–force pair. Commuting conversions rearrange the same context splits and bindings.

□

Example A.3 (Linear occurrences and ordinary descriptions)**.** Given $a : R \multimap A$, $b : R \multimap B$, and one linear occurrence $x : R$, the expression $a(x) \otimes b(x)$ is not derivable: tensor introduction would place x in both split premises. An exhibited map $R \to R \otimes R$, or a supplied input $R \otimes R$, makes the needed resource available. An ordinary identifier of R supplies neither. There is an important distinction for an actual value $v : \mathsf{Val}R$: ordinary contraction together with the value and tensor rules derives

$$\Gamma, v : \mathsf{Val}R; \varnothing \vdash \mathsf{force}(v) \otimes \mathsf{force}(v) : R \otimes R.$$

This constructs two states from a reusable ordinary state description; it does not contract a linear variable. Consequently linear typing alone does not establish unforgeability of an authorization token. The causally token-guarded protocol of Lemma 10.26 provides the operational dependency needed in the finite-data fragment.

Complete rule tables and formation conventions

Binding and formation conventions The rules are schematic under ordinary substitution and type conversion. Bound variables are chosen fresh and substitutions avoid capture. Multiplicative context concatenation requires disjoint variable sets; a rule over $\Gamma, x : X$ pulls back any context or target originally over Γ along its projection. A resource may appear in alternative additive premises, but this does not allow simultaneous duplication. These are the binding conventions used in the later soundness induction.

Ordinary formation is generated from the declared sorts by $1, 0, X + Y, \Sigma_{x:X} Y, \Pi_{x:X} Y$, and extensional equality. The ordinary rules are variable, weakening, contraction, exchange, substitution, unit introduction, empty elimination, sum injections and case, dependent pairing and projections, abstraction and application, and equality reflexivity and substitution. Their $\beta\eta$ equations are the evaluation and uniqueness equations for these constructors. Ordinary equality is *extensional*: the ordinary foundation presents equality by comprehension of the diagonal. Its eliminator and conversion rule are those of this extensional ordinary type

theory. Semantically, a section of a diagonal pullback forces its two compared sections to be equal, and monicity makes its equality witness unique. The proof is given in Proposition 14.28. This is a genuine feature of the selected ordinary foundation, not a consequence of products, sums, or dependent products and not an additional law of agency. No equality reflection for arbitrary linear resources is introduced.

The mixed formation rules are

$$\frac{\Gamma \vdash X\ \mathsf{Type}}{\Gamma \vdash \mathsf{Lin}X\ \mathsf{LType}}, \qquad \frac{\Gamma \vdash A\ \mathsf{LType}}{\Gamma \vdash \mathsf{Val}A\ \mathsf{Type}},$$

$$\frac{\Gamma \vdash A, B\ \mathsf{LType}}{\Gamma \vdash A \otimes B,\ A \multimap B,\ A \,\&\, B,\ A \oplus B\ \mathsf{LType}},$$

$$\frac{\Gamma \vdash X\ \mathsf{Type} \qquad \Gamma, x : X \vdash A\ \mathsf{LType}}{\Gamma \vdash \Sigma^{\ell}_{x} A,\ \Pi^{\ell}_{x} A\ \mathsf{LType}}.$$

The nullary constructors are $\mathsf{I}, \top, \mathbf{0}$. For every displayed signature $(\vec{\Sigma}; A, B)$, $\mathsf{Ag}_{\vec{\Sigma}}(A, B)$ abbreviates $[\mathsf{Lin}(\prod_i \Sigma_i) \otimes A, B]$ with that signature retained.

The remaining linear introduction and elimination rules Tensor elimination and the multiplicative unit are

$$\frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash s : A \otimes B \qquad \Gamma; \Theta, x : A, y : B \vdash t : C}{\Gamma; \Delta, \Theta \vdash \mathsf{let}\ x \otimes y = s\ \mathsf{in}\ t : C},$$

$$\frac{}{\Gamma; \varnothing \vdash * : \mathsf{I}}, \qquad \frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash s : \mathsf{I} \qquad \Gamma; \Theta \vdash t : C}{\Gamma; \Delta, \Theta \vdash \mathsf{let}\ * = s\ \mathsf{in}\ t : C}.$$

Additive products have

$$\frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash t : A \qquad \Gamma; \Delta \vdash u : B}{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash \langle t, u \rangle : A \,\&\, B}, \qquad \frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash t : A \,\&\, B}{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash \pi_1 t : A},$$

and the analogous second projection. The nullary additive product has a unique term $\Gamma; \Delta \vdash \langle\rangle : \top$ at every linear context. This is the terminal-object rule, not weakening into an arbitrary target.

For additive sums, either injection uses its premise's context, and

$$\frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash s : A \oplus B \qquad \Gamma; \Theta, x : A \vdash t : C \qquad \Gamma; \Theta, y : B \vdash u : C}{\Gamma; \Delta, \Theta \vdash \mathsf{case}\ s\ \mathsf{of}\ (x.t \mid y.u) : C}.$$

A term of $\mathbf{0}$ eliminates into any target, with an additional linear context allowed in that impossible branch. Semantically this is the unique map $0 \otimes X \to C$, using $0 \otimes X \cong 0$.

For dependent linear sums, with $p : \Gamma.X \to \Gamma$,

$$\frac{\Gamma \vdash u : X \qquad \Gamma; \Delta \vdash t : A[u/x]}{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash (u, t) : \Sigma^{\ell}_{x} A},$$

$$\frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash s : \Sigma^{\ell}_{x} A \qquad \Gamma, x : X; p^{*}\Theta, z : A \vdash t : p^{*}B}{\Gamma; \Delta, \Theta \vdash \mathsf{let}\ (x, z) = s\ \mathsf{in}\ t : B}.$$

Dependent product abstraction is in Section A.1.1; its application is

$$\frac{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash f : \Pi^{\ell}_{x} A \qquad \Gamma \vdash u : X}{\Gamma; \Delta \vdash f[u] : A[u/x]}.$$

The ordinary–linear rules are those of Section A.1.1. Each primitive linear generator consumes the tensor of its declared input resources, with the indicated context split. No additional copying rule is attached to a primitive generator.

The defining equations include

$$\begin{aligned} (\lambda x.t)(u) &= t[u/x], & \lambda x.f(x) &= f, \\ \pi_1\langle t, u\rangle &= t, & \langle \pi_1 s, \pi_2 s\rangle &= s, \\ (\Lambda x.t)[u] &= t[u/x], & \Lambda x.f[x] &= f, \\ \mathsf{force}(\mathsf{thunk}(t)) &= t, & \mathsf{thunk}(\mathsf{force}(v)) &= v. \end{aligned}$$

Tensor, dependent-sum, additive-sum, unit, and Lin computation laws identify elimination immediately following the corresponding introduction. Their uniqueness counterparts say that a value is determined by its projections or case components; in particular, maps out of sums are determined by all branches. For the mixed ordinary–linear eliminator, the fundamental equations (with the context conditions of (A.1)) include

$$\begin{aligned} &\mathsf{let}\ \mathsf{return}(x) = \mathsf{return}(u)\ \mathsf{in}\ t = t[u/x], \\ &\mathsf{let}\ \mathsf{return}(x) = z\ \mathsf{in}\ \mathsf{return}(x) = z \qquad (z : \mathsf{Lin}X). \end{aligned}$$

The remaining commuting conversions express naturality of the eliminators in their linear continuations. If $E_s(t)$ eliminates a constructor whose parameter is s and continuation is t, and k follows the result, then eliminating into the composite continuation agrees with eliminating first and composing with k, with identical context splitting. These equations include the coproduct and Lin commuting conversions used by the classifying-model construction. Each equation is checked under the same typed substitution rules. The value equations retain the empty linear context required by thunk. This completes the formal first-layer equations used by the classifying model.

A.1.2 Measured witnesses in the dependent linear calculus

The data of Construction 2.8 have an ordinary indexed presentation. Over $\Gamma, \sigma : \Sigma$ declare the completed witness family K_σ. In context $\Gamma, \sigma : \Sigma, k : K_\sigma$ the outcome $a_\sigma(k) : Z$ and the charge $m_\sigma(k) : C$ are ordinary terms. The measured-record term and its projections are

$$r_\sigma(k) = \langle m_\sigma(k), a_\sigma(k)\rangle : T_C Z, \qquad \pi_1 r_\sigma(k) = m_\sigma(k), \quad \pi_2 r_\sigma(k) = a_\sigma(k).$$

Here $(C, +, 0)$ interprets the selected charge monoid. In a finite secured execution the term m evaluates the multiset of matched classes in Construction 8.10. It reads the ordinary execution witness, which is why a derivation using the charge must retain that witness even when the linear strategy has been composed and hidden.

Retaining an execution and its linear output Abbreviate $\Gamma, \sigma : \Sigma$ by Γ' and let $\Gamma', k : K_\sigma \vdash A(k)\ \mathsf{LType}$. Define $\mathsf{Run}_K(A) = \Sigma^\ell_{k:K_\sigma} A(k)$. For a linear family D over Γ' the introduction and elimination rules specialize to

$$\frac{\Gamma' \vdash h : K_\sigma \qquad \Gamma'; \Delta \vdash t : A(h)}{\Gamma'; \Delta \vdash (h, t) : \mathsf{Run}_K(A)},$$

$$\frac{\Gamma'; \Delta \vdash u : \mathsf{Run}_K(A) \qquad \Gamma', k : K_\sigma; p^*\Theta, x : A(k) \vdash v : p^*D}{\Gamma'; \Delta, \Theta \vdash \mathsf{let}\ (k, x) = u\ \mathsf{in}\ v : D}, \qquad p : \Gamma'.K_\sigma \to \Gamma'.$$

Eliminating (h, t) gives $v[h/k, t/x]$. Repacking (k, x) after opening u gives u. In the elimination branch $a_\sigma(k)$ and $m_\sigma(k)$ may each be used in an ordinary comparison, while the output x occupies one linear slot.

An explicit cost tag For a linear output A over a fixed ordinary context put $\mathsf{Log}_C(A) = \mathsf{Lin}C \otimes A$. Write $\mathsf{tag}_C(c,t) = \mathsf{return}(c) \otimes t$. Its introduction uses an ordinary term $c : C$ and exactly the linear context of $t : A$. A completed witness h can therefore accompany its output with the tag $m_\sigma(h)$. Opening a tag is tensor elimination followed by Lin elimination on its first component. A homomorphism $j : C \to C'$ induces $j_* = \mathsf{Lin}(j) \otimes 1_A$; adding an ordinary charge $d : C$ induces $\mathsf{step}^d = \mathsf{Lin}(c \mapsto d + c) \otimes 1_A$. Erasure is induced by $C \to 1$ and the unit comparison $\mathsf{Lin}1 \otimes A \cong A$. On a displayed tag these maps give

$$\begin{aligned} j_*\mathsf{tag}_C(c,t) &= \mathsf{tag}_{C'}(j(c),t), \\ \mathsf{step}^d\mathsf{tag}_C(c,t) &= \mathsf{tag}_C(d+c,t), \\ \mathsf{erase}_C\mathsf{tag}_C(c,t) &= t. \end{aligned}$$

The zero and addition laws for step, the equation $j_*\mathsf{step}^d = \mathsf{step}^{j(d)}j_*$, and $\mathsf{erase}_{C'}j_* = \mathsf{erase}_C$ follow by functoriality of Lin and the corresponding ordinary maps. Reindexing substitutes the ordinary parameters in each formula. These are derived operations of the existing type theory. Their concrete equations use the indicated equalities of the interpreted ordinary maps. The tag accompanies a completed output; the fibre K_σ separately records whether any such output was obtained.

Proposition A.4 (Linear interpretation of the cost writer)**.** *In each linear fibre $L(A) = \mathsf{Log}_C(A) = \mathsf{Lin}C \otimes A$ has the writer monad structure induced by the ordinary cost monoid. There is a natural comparison $\chi_X : \mathsf{Lin}(T_C X) \cong L(\mathsf{Lin}X)$ intertwining both units and multiplications. The constructions commute with ordinary base substitution.*

Proof.

(1) **Transport the cost operations.** Strong monoidality gives $u : \mathsf{I} \cong \mathsf{Lin}1 \xrightarrow{\mathsf{Lin}(0)} \mathsf{Lin}C$ and $v : \mathsf{Lin}C \otimes \mathsf{Lin}C \cong \mathsf{Lin}(C \times C) \xrightarrow{\mathsf{Lin}(+)} \mathsf{Lin}C$. Put $\eta^L_A = (u \otimes 1_A)\lambda_A^{-1}$ and $\mu^L_A = (v \otimes 1_A)\alpha^{-1}_{\mathsf{Lin}C,\mathsf{Lin}C,A}$, with $\alpha : (X \otimes Y) \otimes Z \to X \otimes (Y \otimes Z)$. The unit laws follow from the two unit laws for v, and both routes from L^3A use the same associativity equation for v after coherent rebracketing. These are equalities of open arrows.

(2) **Verify the comparison.** Take χ_X to be the strong monoidal comparison $\mathsf{Lin}(C \times X) \cong \mathsf{Lin}C \otimes \mathsf{Lin}X$. Then $\chi_X\mathsf{Lin}(\eta^T_X) = \eta^L_{\mathsf{Lin}X}$ by unit coherence, and

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathsf{Lin}(T_C^2X) & \xrightarrow{L(\chi_X)\,\chi_{T_CX}} & L^2(\mathsf{Lin}X) \\ {\scriptstyle \mathsf{Lin}(\mu^T_X)}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \mu^L_{\mathsf{Lin}X}} \\ \mathsf{Lin}(T_CX) & \xrightarrow[\chi_X]{} & L(\mathsf{Lin}X) \end{array}$$

Both routes apply $\mathsf{Lin}(+)$ to the two charge factors and identity to the result. Naturality of the monoidal comparison proves this equation. The indexed adjunction comparisons reindex u, v, χ and their diagrams fibrewise.

(3) **Compute the term operations.** Unit tags a linear input with the ordinary zero. Multiplication opens the outer and inner tags, then returns one tag with the sum and the original linear output. Tensor and Lin elimination consume that output once. Applying Lin to $c \mapsto d + c$, to j, or to $C \to 1$ recovers the step, regrading and erasure calculations above. In the free first layer, equalities of compound tags use the corresponding derivable equalities of their ordinary charge terms; for a concrete interpreted monoid the displayed laws hold in its interpretation.

□

A.2 Strategic, epistemic, institutional, and temporal assertions

The assertion calculus is generated from the quantifier adjunctions in Jacobs (1999) and the complete-lattice fixed-point construction of Tarski (1955). The rules below record which modalities are derived from which maps, so that ordinary logical reasoning and linear execution remain separate judgments.

There are two coordinated languages: assertions over ordinary state contexts and linear terms over those contexts. For a situated agent with complete policy carrier Σ, legal carrier L, reference map $s : W \to L$, observation quotients $o_i : W \twoheadrightarrow O_i$, and comparison predicates P_i, the clauses of the predicate language are interpreted in $\mathsf{Pred}(W)$ using exactly those carriers and their typed relations. Its formulas therefore inherit the available alternatives from the declared game rather than treating control as an untyped modal primitive.

A.2.1 Assertion and strategic judgments

Write $W \mid \Phi \vdash \varphi$ when $\bigcap_{\psi\in\Phi}[\![\psi]\!] \subseteq [\![\varphi]\!]$. Ordinary equality, conjunction, disjunction, implication, quantifiers, and substitution have the extensional subobject interpretation. For a coalition C and the kernel pair $D_C^L = L \times_{L_{-C}} L$, the alternatives from a reference are its fibres under the first projection. The existential and universal counterfactual operations are

$$\langle C\rangle Q = \exists_{p_1} p_2^* Q, \qquad [C]Q = \forall_{p_1} p_2^* Q.$$

Selection and best response are obtained by pulling back strict-improvement comparisons along paired concurrent realizations. The predicate NE universally excludes profitable unilateral alternatives. Coalition effectivity uses a different order of quantifiers: it chooses a realizable coalition coordinate and tests every legal completion. The formal rules retain that distinction.

A.2.2 Knowledge, perspective, and common knowledge

For $o_i : W \twoheadrightarrow O_i$ put

$$K_i P = o_i^* \forall_{o_i} P, \qquad D_C P = q_C^* \forall_{q_C} P,$$

where q_C is the effective image of the tuple of the members' observations. Let R_C^* be the finite-path equivalence closure of $\bigcup_{i\in C} \ker(o_i)$. Then

$$\mathsf{CK}_C P = [R_C^*]P = \nu X.\left(P \wedge \bigwedge_{i\in C} K_i X\right).$$

The knowledge rules follow from the observation quotient and its kernel pair. The proof-relevant linear operation $K_{o_i}^{\ell} = o_i^* \Pi_{o_i}^{\ell}$ is separately interpreted as a comonad. Its predicate reflection yields the stated knowledge operator, without identifying their witness products.

A.2.3 Institutional and epistemic action formulas

For a witnessed span $X \xleftarrow{s} E \xrightarrow{t} Y$, the dynamic clauses are

$$\langle E\rangle Q = \exists_s t^* Q, \qquad [E]Q = \forall_s t^* Q.$$

A public announcement of φ has updated carrier $j : U = \{w : \varphi(w)\} \hookrightarrow W$ with relations $(j \times j)^* R_i$ and box $[!\varphi]\psi = \forall_j [\![\psi]\!]_{M|\varphi}$. A general epistemic action $(E, (S_i), \mathsf{pre})$ has updated carrier $U = \{(w, e) : \mathsf{pre}(w, e)\}$ and relation $(w, e)R_i^+(v, f)$ exactly when $wR_i v$ and $eS_i f$. All postformulas are evaluated in the updated model.

A.2.4 Fixpoint and temporal rules

Least and greatest fixed points, denoted by μ and ν, are evaluated in the complete predicate lattice of the current context. Induction uses the least prefixpoint property, while coinduction uses the greatest postfixpoint property. Temporal maintenance and achievement apply these operations to the controllable predecessor supplied by the finite public transition game. The formulas do not create transition witnesses; those are supplied by the operational construction.

A.2.5 Formal reductions and soundness obligations

Public announcement, epistemic action, substitution, and modal reduction are consequences of comprehension, pullback, and the dependent adjunctions. The displayed equations fix the interpretation of these operations for the soundness proof; no independent reduction principle is added at the level of concurrent arrows.

$$[!\varphi]K_i\psi \leftrightarrow (\varphi \Rightarrow K_i[!\varphi]\psi), \qquad [!\varphi][!\psi]\chi \leftrightarrow [!(\varphi \wedge [!\varphi]\psi)]\chi.$$

Each assertion rule is sound when it denotes an inclusion of subobjects, and each typed term equation is sound when it denotes equality of arrows. Appendix B verifies these obligations by induction on derivations.

Definition A.5 (Positive modal fixed-point language)**.** Fix a state set X, atomic predicates $A_p \hookrightarrow X$, relations $R_a \hookrightarrow X^2$, and predicate variables Z drawn from a set Var. Formulas have the grammar

$$\varphi ::= p \mid Z \mid \top \mid \bot \mid (\varphi \wedge \varphi) \mid (\varphi \vee \varphi) \mid (\varphi \Rightarrow \varphi) \mid [R_a]\varphi \mid \langle R_a\rangle\varphi \mid \mu Z.\varphi \mid \nu Z.\varphi.$$

An environment $\eta : \mathsf{Var} \to \mathsf{Pred}(X)$ gives the interpretation $[\![\varphi]\!]_{X,\eta} \in \mathsf{Pred}(X)$ by interpreting atoms as A_p, variables as $\eta(Z)$, and connectives and modalities by the already-defined operations. A bound variable must occur **positively** in its binder: antecedents of implication reverse polarity, consequents preserve it, and the other constructors preserve polarity. Hence $F_{\varphi,\eta}(U) = [\![\varphi]\!]_{X,\eta[Z\mapsto U]}$ is monotone, and the binder clauses are

$$[\![\mu Z.\varphi]\!]_{X,\eta} = \mu F_{\varphi,\eta}, \qquad [\![\nu Z.\varphi]\!]_{X,\eta} = \nu F_{\varphi,\eta}.$$

The two fixed points are those of Construction 5.23. This sign calculation is for the fixed relations in the displayed grammar. The assertion language with formula-valued public announcements uses the guarded expansion and formation derivation of Lemma A.6.

A.2.6 Types, formulas, and contexts

Fix a displayed agent process $G = (\vec{\Sigma}, g) : A \to B$, a legal comprehension $m : L \hookrightarrow \Sigma$, and a reference context $s : W \to L$. Its sorts include ordinary state and policy families, linear families over those states, the concurrent arrow carrier $\mathcal{C}(A, B)$, and dependent witness families. An ordinary term is interpreted as a section of an ordinary family over its declared context; a linear term is interpreted as a morphism from the tensor of its linear context. A formula in context W denotes a subobject $[\![\varphi]\!] \hookrightarrow W$. For each ordinary context map $f : V \to W$ there is a substitution operation $f^* : \mathsf{Pred}(W) \to \mathsf{Pred}(V)$.

The logical grammar may be given schematically by

$$\begin{aligned}\varphi, \psi ::= {} & X \mid \top \mid \bot \mid P(t_1, \ldots, t_n) \mid t = u \mid (\varphi \wedge \psi) \mid (\varphi \vee \psi) \mid (\varphi \Rightarrow \psi) \\ & \mid \exists_f\varphi \mid \forall_f\varphi \mid \langle C\rangle\varphi \mid [C]\varphi \mid K_i\varphi \mid \mathsf{DK}_C\varphi \mid \mathsf{CK}_C\varphi \\ & \mid \langle E\rangle\varphi \mid [E]\varphi \mid [!\varphi]\psi \mid [\mathcal{A}, e]\psi \mid \mu X.\varphi(X) \mid \nu X.\varphi(X).\end{aligned}$$

Each predicate atom is typed at a declared ordinary carrier. The coalition variable C refers to actual owner coordinates; E is an exhibited witness span; and $(\mathcal{A}, e)$ is an epistemic event with enabling data. Each predicate variable has a state sort. For the extended grammar, binder formation checks the variance of its expanded body as follows.

Expansion over a restricted state carrier. For $j_D : D \hookrightarrow W$, write $T_D(\psi)$ for the ambient predicate supported on D that expresses truth of ψ in $M|_D$. Free world predicates are restricted along j_D. For a fixed factual atom p and a variable Y, the clauses are $T_D(p) = D \wedge p$ and $T_D(Y) = D \wedge Y$. Updated atoms use their specified postcondition term at the updated sort. Put $T_D(\top) = D$, $T_D(\bot) = \bot$, distribute T_D over meets and joins, and put

$$T_D(\theta \Rightarrow \psi) = D \wedge \big(T_D(\theta) \Rightarrow T_D(\psi)\big).$$

For a fixed accessibility relation R on W, and for a public announcement, the clauses are

$$\begin{aligned} T_D([R]\psi) &= D \wedge [R](D \Rightarrow T_D(\psi)), \\ T_D(\langle R\rangle\psi) &= D \wedge \langle R\rangle T_D(\psi), \\ T_D([!\theta]\psi) &= D \wedge \big(A \Rightarrow T_A(\psi)\big), \qquad A = T_D(\theta). \end{aligned} \tag{A.2}$$

Here A is already supported on D. Thus successive announcements compute their guards in the appropriate restricted model.

More generally the expansion carries a domain comprehension for *each* occurring sort. For an actual span from sort U to sort V, let D_U, D_V be those domains, and write $G(k)$ for membership in the displayed witness comprehension in the current model, including its endpoint conditions. The guarded box at u is

$$D_U(u) \ \wedge \ \forall k \, \big((G(k) \wedge s(k) = u) \Rightarrow T_{D_V}(\psi)(t(k))\big).$$

The diamond replaces the universal implication by existential conjunction. Graph spans and their converses give reindexing and the ordinary quantifiers. This construction uses the witnesses of the declared span: for instance a change of reference restricts the source of a legal deviation span, whereas a public epistemic restriction restricts both ends of an observation relation. Knowledge uses that restricted relation, distributed knowledge the intersection of the member relations, and common knowledge its defining greatest-fixed-point expression with the restricted individual boxes. For an epistemic action with precondition $P(w, e)$ in the current model, its updated domain in $W \times E$ is $D'(w, e) = D(w) \wedge P(w, e)$. At a designated event e, the pointed box expands to $D(w) \wedge (P(w, e) \Rightarrow T_{D'}(\psi)(w, e))$. The relation on the new carrier is the restricted product relation, and its atoms and terms use the declared updated values. An inherited world variable is pulled back along the old-world projection when it is used at this new sort. All these guards, including preconditions formed from formulas, are expanded before deciding the variance of a bound variable.

Formation at a binder. For $\kappa \in \{\mu, \nu\}$, rename Y fresh for the ambient domain parameters. With P an ambient predicate at the binder's sort, form the expression $F(P) = T_D(\psi)[Y := P]$; the occurrence clause for Y already restricts P to D. The binder is formed by deriving

$$P \subseteq P' \ \vdash \ F(P) \subseteq F(P') \tag{A.3}$$

at two fresh predicate variables, with the other parameters fixed. The proof of this variance judgment is a premise of binder formation. It uses the already formed proper subexpressions, so the induction on derivations for soundness applies to it before interpreting this binder.

Then $T_D(\kappa Y.\psi) = \kappa P.F(P)$. This is a derivation in the existing predicate order. In the usual positive fragment it is constructed by the sign calculation below. A derivably equivalent expanded body can be used by equality substitution. In particular an occurrence inside the formula specifying an announcement domain does not acquire a sign merely from the fact that the outer operator is a box.

Lemma A.6 (Relativization and sound binder formation)**.** *For each well-formed expression of the extended grammar, $T_D(\psi)$ is the extension by false of its interpretation on D. Every binder formed by* (A.3) *denotes the corresponding least or greatest fixed predicate in that fibre. The construction commutes with substitution of external parameters.*

Proof. Proceed from the proper subexpressions toward the root. For predicates on D, extension by false is the image along j_D and identifies $\mathsf{Pred}(D)$ with the interval $\downarrow D$ in $\mathsf{Pred}(W)$. Relative implication on this interval is $D \wedge (U \Rightarrow V)$. Quantifying the actual witness k in the guarded span formula gives exactly the restricted span modality at u. For (A.2), a point of D outside A satisfies the box vacuously. At a point of A the updated model is the restriction to A, so the induction hypothesis for ψ gives $T_A(\psi)$. Both sides have empty support outside D. The pointed action case makes the same calculation at (w, e). This proves the nonbinding clauses.

For the sign calculation, an occurrence of a variable is increasing in itself, and a fixed parameter is constant. Meets, joins, inverse image and both quantifiers on fixed maps preserve inequalities. Implication reverses the first inequality and preserves the second. These facts prove the positive and negative variance judgments simultaneously by induction after domains and witness guards have been expanded. At an inner binder, if $H(P, Y) \subseteq H(P', Y)$ for every Y and both inner bodies are monotone in Y, then $\mu_Y H(P', Y)$ is a pre-fixed point for $H(P, -)$ and $\nu_Y H(P, Y)$ is a post-fixed point for $H(P', -)$. Induction and coinduction give the two parameter inequalities for μ and ν. Reversing the parameter inclusion gives the negative case. This constructs (A.3) for positive expanded bodies, including ones with nested binders.

At the current binder F is monotone by its formation derivation. Writing $L = \exists_{j_D}$ and $\rho = j_D^*$, the induction hypothesis on the body gives $F = LF_D\rho$, where F_D is its operator on D. Since $\rho L = 1$, $F_D = \rho F L$ is monotone too. An F-fixed predicate is supported on D. The maps ρ, L therefore identify its fixed predicates in both directions with those of F_D, preserving inclusion. Their least and greatest elements correspond by Lemma 5.26. This proves the binder clause without choosing a fixed point of a nonmonotone operator. Every step is fibrewise in the external parameters, so reindexing them gives the same expansion and the same fibrewise least or greatest predicate. □

For example, on a nonempty singleton W the expanded body $[!Y]\bot$ is $W \setminus Y$. It interchanges $\varnothing$ and W, so (A.3) fails and there is no fixed predicate. An announcement guard has no uniform negative variance either: take two mutually accessible worlds w, v with p true only at v. At w, $[!Y]\langle R\rangle p$ has truth values true, false, true for $Y = \varnothing, \{w\}, \{w, v\}$, respectively. A variable may nevertheless occur in a guard of a well-formed binder. For example, in the Boolean state fibre the body $Q \vee \neg[!Y]\neg\langle R\rangle p$ expands on W to

$$Q \ \vee \ \big(Y \wedge \langle R\rangle(Y \wedge p)\big).$$

Indeed, the announcement diamond requires membership in Y and the inner possibility needs an R-successor in $Y \cap p$. At $Y \subseteq Y'$ that same successor witnesses the required inclusion, so both fixed-point binders have the stated formation derivation. For the fixed-relation language of Definition A.5 take $D = W$; the expansion then gives its ordinary positivity derivation.

For a state context $s : W \to \Sigma$, logical equality is the diagonal of $W \times_\Sigma W$. If a state is represented by a term $t : V \to W$, an assertion is tested by the inverse image $t^*[\![\varphi]\!]$. In particular, assertions about ownership, legality, or observations are not forced to factor through the realized concurrent arrow: they may use the full displayed state record.

A.2.7 Predicate inference from adjunctions

The order structure on each predicate fibre supplies the inference relation $\Phi \vdash_W \varphi$ by inclusion. The ordinary connective rules are those of its Heyting algebra, so for example

$$R \wedge P \leq Q \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad R \leq (P \Rightarrow Q).$$

The dependent quantifier introduction and elimination rules are the following equivalences, applicable to every ordinary context map $f : V \to W$:

$$\boxed{\exists_f P \leq Q \iff P \leq f^*Q, \qquad f^*Q \leq P \iff Q \leq \forall_f P.}$$

The rules for conjunction, implication, and quantification follow from the Heyting structure and adjunctions. Their stability under ordinary substitution is the Beck–Chevalley comparison. In particular, for the following pullback square, the two directions of quantifier transport are fixed by the same fibre bijection.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V' & \xrightarrow{a} & V \\ {\scriptstyle f'}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f} \\ W' & \xrightarrow[b]{} & W \end{array}$$

one has

$$b^*\exists_f \cong \exists_{f'} a^*, \qquad b^*\forall_f \cong \forall_{f'} a^*, \qquad \exists_f (P \wedge f^*Q) = \exists_f P \wedge Q.$$

The dependent sum and product underlie ordinary existential and universal quantification, with subterminal reflection converting witness-bearing sums into truth values. The assertion rules therefore reuse the indexed type operations rather than duplicating their semantic structure.

A.2.8 Counterfactual and selection rules

Let $\pi_{-C} : \Sigma \to \Sigma_{-C}$ be the outsider projection. Its kernel pair $D_C = \Sigma \times_{\Sigma_{-C}} \Sigma$ has source and target p_1, p_2. The relation modalities are

$$\begin{aligned} \langle C \rangle P(\sigma) &\iff \exists \tau \, [\pi_{-C}(\tau) = \pi_{-C}(\sigma) \wedge P(\tau)], \\ [C] P(\sigma) &\iff \forall \tau \, [\pi_{-C}(\tau) = \pi_{-C}(\sigma) \Rightarrow P(\tau)]. \end{aligned}$$

They are monotone, preserve the respective finite joins and meets, and satisfy $\langle \varnothing \rangle P = [\varnothing] P = P$ on an unrestricted profile carrier. On unrestricted products the relation identity $D_C ; D_D = D_{C \cup D}$ gives

$$\langle C \rangle \langle D \rangle P = \langle C \cup D \rangle P, \qquad [C][D]P = [C \cup D]P.$$

With a legal carrier, replace the full product kernel pair by $D_C^L = L \times_{L_{-C}} L$. Sequentially composed legal changes must retain an intermediate profile lying in the same legal subobject. The unrestricted identity for coalitional composition need not hold without that witness.

For each owner i, the paired realization is $\delta_i = (gp_1, gp_2) : D_i \to \mathcal{C}(A,B)^2$. If $P_i \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}(A,B)^2$ compares the second interaction favorably with the first, define the strict-improvement test $\delta_i^* P_i$. The selected legal best-response predicate says that no improvement exists against the fixed outsider profile:

$$\mathsf{BR}_i(\sigma, \sigma_i) \iff \forall \tau \, (\sigma D_i^L \tau \Rightarrow \neg P_i(g\sigma, g\tau)).$$

Equilibrium conjoins the ownerwise absence-of-improvement tests. Under reparametrization its exact transport depends on lifting the relevant deviations at a fixed reference, as well as preserving both realized endpoints. Numerical utilities give a particular comparison presentation; they do not alter this logical rule.

A.2.9 Epistemic and informed-ability rules

An observation quotient $o_i : W \twoheadrightarrow O_i$ induces the relation $R_i = \ker(o_i)$. The knowledge operator has the explicit universal-fibre interpretation

$$K_i P(w) \iff \forall v \in W \, [o_i(v) = o_i(w) \Rightarrow P(v)].$$

It preserves truth and conjunction, and the defining equivalence relation gives

$$K_i(P \Rightarrow Q) \leq (K_i P \Rightarrow K_i Q), \quad K_i P \leq P, \quad K_i P = K_i K_i P, \quad \neg K_i P \leq K_i \neg K_i P.$$

These are the normality, factivity, and introspection properties of an observation equivalence relation. The linear perspective $K_{o_i}^{\ell} = o_i^* \Pi_{o_i}^{\ell}$ instead carries proof-relevant witness products, satisfying its comonad and lax-monoidal laws. The predicate laws are not read as equations of arbitrary linear resources.

For a nonempty coalition C the joint quotient q_C is the image of $\langle o_i \rangle_{i \in C}$, and $\mathsf{DK}_C P = q_C^* \forall_{q_C} P$. The common-knowledge operator is the greatest fixed point

$$\mathsf{CK}_C P = \nu X. \left(P \wedge \bigwedge_{i \in C} K_i X \right).$$

Its unfolding law and its coinduction rule have the forms

$$\mathsf{CK}_C P = P \wedge \bigwedge_{i \in C} K_i \mathsf{CK}_C P, \qquad \frac{X \leq P \quad X \leq K_i X \ (i \in C)}{X \leq \mathsf{CK}_C P}.$$

The greatest fixed point is computed using finite paths in the union of the owners' observation relations. The joint quotient classifies distributed knowledge but does not by itself deliver a usable pooled signal. Section 11 supplies its communication realization.

For a worldwise feasibility or permission predicate $F \hookrightarrow W \times M$, an informed legal policy is a section of $\forall_{o \times 1_M} F$ over O. The judgement $\pi : \mathsf{Pol}_o(F)$ is equivalent to the uniformly quantified permission formula $\forall w \, F(w, \pi(o(w)))$. An individual or coalition guarantee uses existential quantification over a realizable choice coordinate, followed by universal quantification over its actual legal completions. A separate existence conjunct is retained for executable guarantees while a vacuous universal assertion.

A.2.10 Dynamic execution and public restriction

For a witnessed span $X \xleftarrow{s} E \xrightarrow{t} Y$, put

$$\langle E \rangle P = \exists_s t^* P, \qquad [E] P = \forall_s t^* P.$$

The composition of witnessed spans by pullback gives, for a second span F,

$$[F \circ E]P = [E][F]P, \qquad \langle F \circ E\rangle P = \langle E\rangle\langle F\rangle P.$$

Identity spans induce identity modalities and pullback composition supplies their sequential laws. The proof-relevant versions use $\Sigma^{\ell}_{s} t^{*}$ and $\Pi^{\ell}_{s} t^{*}$, so two distinct witnesses sharing one endpoint pair still contribute separate summands or factors. Restricting E to its permission predicate gives the permitted modalities before either construction is applied.

Budget judgments on completed witnesses For $X \xleftarrow{s} E_{\mathrm{ret}} \xrightarrow{t} Y$ as in Proposition 8.12, let E_x be the dependent family of completed witnesses with source x. In context $x : X, k : E_x$ there are ordinary terms $t(k) : Y$ and $m(k) : C$. Given $c : C \mid B(c)\ \mathsf{Prop}$ and $y : Y \mid P(y)\ \mathsf{Prop}$, the two budget judgments at x expand to

$$(\langle E\rangle^{B} P)(x) \equiv \exists k : E_x\ [B(m(k)) \wedge P(t(k))],$$
$$([E]^{B} P)(x) \equiv \forall k : E_x\ [B(m(k)) \Rightarrow P(t(k))].$$

A diamond introduction presents a witness k and derives the two conjuncts. Elimination opens this existential and its two conjuncts, with the fresh witness absent from the conclusion. A box introduction checks $P(t(k))$ for a fresh $k : E_x$ satisfying $B(m(k))$; elimination instantiates it at the supplied completed witness and its budget proof. All four are the ordinary quantifier rules after expansion.

For a linear postcondition $y : Y \vdash A(y)\ \mathsf{LType}$, form the comprehension $E_{x,B} = \{k : E_x \mid B(m(k))\}$. With $|h|$ the underlying witness of $h : E_{x,B}$, the two linear types are

$$\Sigma^{\ell}_{h:E_{x,B}} A(t(|h|)), \qquad \Pi^{\ell}_{h:E_{x,B}} A(t(|h|)).$$

Their introduction, opening, abstraction and application are the dependent linear rules above. For regrading j the comprehensions defined by $B'(j(m(k)))$ and $(j^{*}B')(m(k))$ are canonically identical over E_x. The induced comparison on each dependent sum or product is the identity on the indexed branches in the family presentation. This is the typed form of Proposition 8.12.

For a public announcement φ interpreted in model M, construct its comprehensional inclusion $j : U \hookrightarrow W$ and restrict every accessibility relation on both endpoints. The box is

$$[\![[!\varphi]\psi]\!]_{M} = \forall_{j} [\![\psi]\!]_{M|\varphi}.$$

The postcondition belongs to the restricted epistemic model, not to the original state space. The displayed announcement reductions follow from the dependent-product and comprehension equations and must therefore use the updated accessibility relation.

$$[!\varphi]p \leftrightarrow (\varphi \Rightarrow p),$$
$$[!\varphi](\psi \wedge \chi) \leftrightarrow [!\varphi]\psi \wedge [!\varphi]\chi,$$
$$[!\varphi]\neg\psi \leftrightarrow (\varphi \Rightarrow \neg[!\varphi]\psi),$$
$$[!\varphi]K_i\psi \leftrightarrow (\varphi \Rightarrow K_i[!\varphi]\psi),$$
$$[!\varphi][!\psi]\chi \leftrightarrow [!(\varphi \wedge [!\varphi]\psi)]\chi.$$

At a removed state the first announcement makes the universal condition vacuous. At a retained state, a knowledge reduction ranges only over accessible worlds that also survive the restriction. This is why updating both endpoints of the relation differs from substituting the reference state alone.

A.2.11 General epistemic events and their reduction

For a finite event set E, relations S_i, and enabling predicate $\mathsf{pre} \hookrightarrow W \times E$, the product-update model has carrier $U = \{(w, e) : \mathsf{pre}(w, e)\}$ with

$$(w, e)R_i^+(v, f) \iff wR_iv \wedge eS_if.$$

For a designated event e let $j_e : W_e \hookrightarrow W$ be its precondition comprehension and $k_e : W_e \to U$ its insertion. Define

$$[\mathcal{A}, e]\psi = \forall_{j_e} k_e^* [\![\psi]\!]_{M\otimes\mathcal{A}}.$$

The derived finite-event knowledge reduction is

$$[\mathcal{A}, e]K_i\psi \leftrightarrow \left(\mathsf{pre}_e \Rightarrow \bigwedge_{f:eS_if} K_i[\mathcal{A}, f]\psi\right).$$

The finite-event knowledge reduction quantifies over enabled, epistemically compatible event alternatives through guarded boxes. Successive product updates retain their event pairs and the conjunction of enabling predicates. The canonical reassociation of these pairs proves compatibility with repeated updates.

A.2.12 Temporal induction and rationality

For a finite public transition game with controllable predecessor Pre_C, the formulas for maintenance and bounded-until ability are respectively

$$\nu X.(P \wedge \mathrm{Pre}_C(X)), \qquad \mu X.(Q \vee (P \wedge \mathrm{Pre}_C(X))).$$

For a monotone operator F on a predicate lattice, its fixed-point inference principles are

$$\frac{F(P) \le P}{\mu F \le P}, \qquad \frac{P \le F(P)}{P \le \nu F},$$

The unfolding equations $F(\mu F) = \mu F$ and $F(\nu F) = \nu F$ express the least and greatest fixed points. Finite-state strategy extraction is a separate operational theorem: its witnesses come from the displayed predecessor construction. Likewise, a profitable-deviation relation becomes a temporal step only when the corresponding transition is specified.

A.2.13 Compositionality and exact transport of formulas

The recursive interpretation of assertions commutes with ordinary substitution by Beck–Chevalley and reindexing of the designated maps. For semantic arrow tests, one has

$$\mathrm{Test}_Q(mtu) = u^* \,\mathrm{Test}_Q(mt) = \mathrm{Test}_{m^*Q}(tu)$$

For a wiring map m, a realized-arrow tuple t, and a reference substitution u, semantic testing commutes with composition. Relation modalities also require their alternatives to be preserved: a comparison map must send related pairs forward and lift each abstract successor at an image state. Under these two conditions the specified modal fixed points transport exactly, rather than merely one-way.

The soundness induction sends an assertion entailment $W \mid \Phi \vdash \varphi$ to inclusion of subobjects and each linear equation to equality of its denotations. The cases use the universal properties established in the main text and this appendix: adjunction and Beck–Chevalley for quantifiers, kernel pairs for alternatives, comprehension for updates, and fixed-point induction and coinduction for temporal operators.

A.2.14 The formal logic of agency

The agent calculus supplies control, observation, and state contexts with their intended carriers. Relation spans turn these structures into predicate modalities: owner projections describe controlled changes, observation kernels describe indistinguishable states, and witnessed executions describe possible action. The different meanings arise from their displayed relations, not from different untyped modal operators.

The carriers of agent assertions Assertions must be interpreted over their correct carrier. Legal profile predicates lie in $\mathsf{Pred}(L)$, whereas situated epistemic assertions lie in $\mathsf{Pred}(W)$. For a reference $s : W \to L$, the corresponding lifted deviation relation has a source on the situated-state carrier and a target in the legal profile space, with type

$$W \xleftarrow{d_C} W \times_{L,p_1} D_C^L \xrightarrow{q_C} L.$$

Its box therefore sends $\mathsf{Pred}(L)$ into $\mathsf{Pred}(W)$. The knowledge relation $\ker(o_i)$ instead relates states within W and induces an endomap of $\mathsf{Pred}(W)$. Fixed-point expressions require compatible state sorts, which the typed span calculus enforces.

A.2.15 Derived locality and witnessed-descent judgments

No additional primitive type former or equation is required for the locality results. With the constructed owner-scope site, the legal policy gluing test is the assertion

$$\mathrm{Loc}_{\mathcal{U}}(L) = \bigwedge_{U \in \mathcal{U}} \pi_U^* \exists_{\pi_U} L.$$

For the anchored completed-witness quotient $q : \mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}} \twoheadrightarrow \underline{T}$ and a designated relation $R \hookrightarrow T^2$, the following are derived semantic rules of the assertion interpretation:

$$\frac{T \mid \Phi \vdash [R]P}{\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}} \mid q^*\Phi \vdash [\mathscr{R}]q^*P} \qquad \frac{T \mid \Phi \vdash \langle R\rangle P}{\mathscr{K}_A^{\mathrm{fin}} \mid q^*\Phi \vdash \langle \mathscr{R}\rangle q^*P}.$$

Their converses for predicates and formulas pulled back from T are valid because q^* is order-reflecting on such predicates. On the world-indexed completed boundary the same rules apply with $Q_W : \mathscr{F}_W \twoheadrightarrow \underline{U_W}$ and the original action-updated relations of Theorem 10.56; their positive fixed-point instances follow from Corollary 9.36. These are rules for the specified *semantic comparison*, not formation rules creating a new modal operator in the first-layer syntax.

Proposition A.7 (Soundness of the derived sheaf comparisons)**.** *The locality equality, the modal transport rules, and their converse reflection on retained predicates are valid in the exhibited true-concurrent and sheaf-local interpretations. They commute with ownerwise reparametrization on the implemented policy image.*

Proof.

(1) **Compute the legal predicates.** The first equality is the inverse-image and existential-image calculation of Theorem 7.2. Its ownerwise implementation comparison is Theorem 7.7.

(2) **Transport modal predicates.** The sourcewise regular-epimorphism lift of Theorem 9.34 yields the displayed box and diamond equations. Inverse image of a surjective retained quotient reflects inclusion of predicates, giving the converse rules on its image. The completed restriction is Theorem 10.55.

□

B Soundness and Equational Completeness

Reconstruction starts from the data displayed in the indexed semantics and recovers the corresponding agent presentation. Soundness goes the other way, interpreting the rules of the calculus in that semantics. For equational completeness we build the syntactic classifying model. This last argument concerns validity across the designated class of models. The separate tests for equality in the fixed concurrent model are proved in the main text. We use the indexed semantics of Jacobs (1999); Vákár (2015).

The inverse reconstruction and its displayed extensions are proved in Section 14.1; here we verify the calculus rules.

B.1 Soundness of the agency calculus

Proof of Theorem 14.25.

(1) **Adjunction and transposition.** Formation and the core terms are interpreted by Proposition 2.20. Agent operations are composites of evaluation, tensor, currying, and ordinary parameter maps, so Theorem 3.2 and Construction 4.13 validate their equations. Regrouping uses the product bijections and kernel-pair comparison of Construction 4.13.

(2) **Observation and knowledge.** Decision protocols are interpreted by Theorem 10.28, with non-anticipation and stagewise observations proved in Theorem 10.29. The acceptance domains of protocol-generated situated contexts are the image and dependent quantifier constructions of Proposition 5.78.

(3) **Witness and legality comparison.** Finite endpoint terms and their reductions are interpreted by Lemma 10.32, Proposition 10.40, and Theorem 10.41, retaining execution witnesses when the external interface is hidden. Lemma 10.43 supplies the explicit physical output for a retained transcript.

(4) **Causal execution.** Lemma 10.34, Lemma 10.38, and Corollary 10.42 cover physical private-input occurrences, their status-indexed residuals, and their causal constraints.

(5) **Adjunction and transposition.** For contextual terms, Corollary 1.54 validates the dependent adjoints and their substitution laws. Theorem 2.15 constructs the agent abstraction as the corresponding dependent closed product, constructed using the linear–nonlinear adjunction. Predicate introduction and elimination rules are the corresponding order adjunctions in $\mathrm{Sub}(W)$.

(6) **Measured witnesses and budget rules.** The packages of Section A.1.2 are dependent linear sums. Their opening and repacking equations are the sum equations. The unit, multiplication and ordinary-to-linear comparison are the arrows of Proposition A.4; their unit and associativity equations follow there on arbitrary linear contexts. The tagged output uses tensor introduction and Lin, so its elimination uses the declared resource once. Functoriality carries the given ordinary charge maps to the displayed regrading and erasure maps. By Proposition 8.12, restricting the completed witness family gives exactly the quantifier domains of the budget rules, points and linear branches alike.

(7) **Adjunction and transposition: second comparison.** Perspective uses (6.3); its coherence and epistemic laws are Theorem 6.29 and Proposition 6.30. Uniform policies and comparison feedback are subobjects defined by the proved graph adjunction and inverse-image equations. Hence their rules are sound comprehensions and quantifications.

(8) **Witness and legality comparison.** For dynamic rules, Theorems 8.8 and 8.14 validate composition and its modalities. Theorems 9.39 and 9.40, followed by Proposition 9.43, validate public and general epistemic updates.

(9) **Observation and knowledge.** Proposition 9.42 distinguishes a logical public comprehension from the exact tests implementable using an actual finite observation wire.

(10) **Observation and knowledge: second comparison.** Construction 10.46 constructs an implemented epistemic action and its event-observation kernels from the image of actual recipient records in retained witnesses, and Lemma 11.29 supplies the synchronization barrier for completed pooling. Proposition 8.13 constructs the separate realized map of witnessed execution.

(11) **Coinduction and bisimulation.** At a binder of the contextual grammar, Lemma A.6 interprets the expanded body on its actual state domain and derives monotonicity by (A.3). The predicate fixed-point theorem supplies unfolding, induction and coinduction

there. Common-knowledge unfolding and coinduction also have the finite-path proof of Proposition 6.32. Induction on a complete derivation therefore establishes each judgment and equation, with the same substitution comparisons at every constructor.

□

B.2 The classifying model and equational completeness

Proof of Lemma 14.29.

(1) **Encode ordinary contexts.** Encode each finite ordinary context telescope by its iterated dependent sum, retaining the canonical packing and unpacking substitutions. Thus f may be written as a map of the corresponding ordinary total types.

(2) **Functoriality and substitution.** Over $w : W$ form its equality fibre

$$\mathrm{Fib}_f(w) = \sum_{v:V} \mathrm{Id}_W(f(v), w).$$

The maps $v \mapsto (f(v), v, \mathrm{refl}_{f(v)})$ and $(w, v, p) \mapsto v$ give inverse context substitutions between V and $W.\,\mathrm{Fib}_f$; the reverse composite uses the diagonal equality property of Proposition 14.28 to identify $w = f(v)$ and its equality witness with reflexivity.

(3) **Dependent sum and product expressions.** For a linear family A over V put

$$(\Sigma^\ell_f A)(w) = \Sigma^\ell_{(v,p):\mathrm{Fib}_f(w)} A(v), \qquad (\Pi^\ell_f A)(w) = \Pi^\ell_{(v,p):\mathrm{Fib}_f(w)} A(v).$$

These are expressions of the existing dependent constructors, not new quantifier symbols. Given $\alpha : \Sigma^\ell_f A \to B$, define $\beta_v : A(v) \to B(f(v))$ by applying α at the fibre witness (v, refl).

(4) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, for $\beta : A \to f^*B$, map an element $((v, p), a)$ to the transport along p of $\beta_v(a)$. Extensional equality elimination and the dependent-sum $\beta\eta$ equations make the two operations inverse.

(5) **Adjunction and transposition.** For the right adjunction, evaluate a map $\alpha : B \to \Pi^\ell_f A$ at (v, refl) to obtain $\beta_v : B(f(v)) \to A(v)$.

(6) **Reverse implication.** Conversely, $\beta : f^*B \to A$ determines the dependent abstraction

$$\alpha_w(b) = \Lambda(v, p).\beta_v(p_*^{-1} b).$$

The equality-transport and dependent-product $\beta\eta$ equations again prove the two inverse equations. Thus

$$\Sigma^\ell_f \dashv f^* \dashv \Pi^\ell_f.$$

For a pullback of ordinary substitutions, its two equality-fibre presentations are equivalent by inserting or deleting the redundant pullback coordinate.

(7) **Base-change comparison.** Substituting that equivalence into the displayed sum and product constructs both Beck–Chevalley maps and their inverses. Every iterated comparison has the same projections to the original fibre witnesses, proving its cocycle by dependent η. The explicit comparison maps and the two inverse substitutions are verified in Lemma 14.30; in particular their composite-substitution equations hold at arbitrary linear contexts.

(8) **Linear Frobenius comparison maps.** Finally, the map $\Sigma^{\ell}_{f}(f^{*}B \otimes A) \to B \otimes \Sigma^{\ell}_{f}A$ eliminates the fibre witness and moves the independent B-factor outside its dependent sum. Its inverse eliminates the sum in the right tensor factor and pairs B with the selected fibre component. Tensor and dependent-sum $\beta\eta$ make the composites identities, giving Frobenius and its substitution coherence.

□

Proof of Lemma 14.30.

(1) **Construction and inverse of the fibre comparison.** In the equality-fibre presentation a point of $\mathrm{Fib}_{f'}(w')$ is a pair (v', p') with $p' : f'(v') = w'$. Define

$$\chi_{w'}(v', p') = (a(v'), b_{*}(p')),$$

where the second component is the equality $f(a(v')) = b(w')$ obtained by transporting p' through the commuting square. Conversely, a pair $(v, p : f(v) = b(w'))$ defines the point $v' = (w', v, p)$ of the ordinary pullback comprehension, with $f'(v') = w'$ by the first projection; send it to $(v', \mathrm{refl}_{w'})$. The pullback's defining property and extensional equality elimination identify the two composites with the identity substitutions, including their equality witnesses.

(2) **Dependent sums, products, and naturality.** After substitution along b, the fibre of $\Sigma^{\ell}_{f}A$ at w' is $\Sigma^{\ell}_{(v,p):\mathrm{Fib}_{f}(b(w'))}A_v$. The fibre of $\Sigma^{\ell}_{f'}a^{*}A$ is the analogous dependent sum indexed by $\mathrm{Fib}_{f'}(w')$. Reindexing the summands along $\chi_{w'}$ and its inverse gives the two comparison maps; the same argument using dependent products gives the right-adjoint comparison. Their inverse equations follow from the Σ^{ℓ} and Π^{ℓ} uniqueness laws. No particular representative of an equality class is selected.

(3) **Iterated base change.** For two composable pullback squares, either route sends a fibre witness to its projection in the original context V together with the equality obtained by successively applying the two base substitutions. Functoriality of equality transport identifies this with the direct transported equality. By the uniqueness laws of the ordinary pullback and the linear dependent sums and products, the associated comparisons commute on arbitrary linear terms, and not only on closed states.

(4) **Frobenius comparison and compatibility.** At $w : W$, the Frobenius map is the copower-distribution comparison

$$\Sigma^{\ell}_{(v,p):\mathrm{Fib}_{f}(w)}(B_w \otimes A_v) \longrightarrow B_w \otimes \Sigma^{\ell}_{(v,p):\mathrm{Fib}_{f}(w)}A_v.$$

On a summand indexed by (v, p), it sends (b, a) to $(b, \mathrm{in}_{(v,p)}\, a)$; its inverse eliminates the dependent sum in the right-hand tensor factor and retains the same b. The tensor and dependent-sum $\beta\eta$ laws prove the inverse equations. Both base-change routes use $\chi_{w'}$ to transport exactly the same fibre witness and leave the independent B-term unchanged. Thus Frobenius commutes with Beck–Chevalley, including its composite-substitution coherence.

□

Proof of Lemma 14.31.

(1) **Monoidal comparison.** The substitution lemma makes composition well-defined and associative; variables give identities. Ordinary substitution gives functorial reindexing and comprehension. Tensor on objects is the type constructor; on arrows it is tensor introduction after tensor elimination on the input.

(2) **Secured operational interaction.** Its associators, symmetry, and unitors are the corresponding resource rearrangements. Their equations follow from tensor and unit $\beta\eta$.

(3) **Frobenius and coproduct comparison.** Currying and application give mutually inverse bijections

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{syn}}(\Gamma)(A \otimes B, C) \cong \mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{syn}}(\Gamma)(A, B \multimap C).$$

Additive pairing, projections, injections, and case analysis prove the product and coproduct universal properties, including their nullary cases.

(4) **Adjunction and transposition.** Dependent abstraction and application prove the right-adjoint bijection for comprehension projections; dependent pairing and elimination prove the left-adjoint bijection. The uniqueness equations supply naturality. Lemma 14.29 constructs their extension to general ordinary substitutions. The equality-fibre comparison of Lemma 14.30 verifies Beck–Chevalley, Frobenius, and the two composite-substitution coherences, so these constructions are coherent on open terms and not merely fibrewise on closed values.

(5) **Term-level linear–nonlinear adjunction.** Finally, the mutually inverse maps for $\mathsf{Lin} \dashv \mathsf{Val}$ send a linear term $z : \mathsf{Lin}X \vdash t : A$ to $x : X \vdash \mathsf{thunk}(t[\mathsf{return}(x)/z]) : \mathsf{Val}A$, and send an ordinary term $x : X \vdash v : \mathsf{Val}A$ to $z : \mathsf{Lin}X \vdash \mathsf{let}\ \mathsf{return}(x) = z\ \mathsf{in}\ \mathsf{force}(v) : A$. Their composites are the adjunction $\beta\eta$ equations.

(6) **Monoidal comparison.** For strong monoidality, the comparison $\mathsf{Lin}X \otimes \mathsf{Lin}Y \to \mathsf{Lin}(X \times Y)$ eliminates the two linearized ordinary values and returns their pair. Its inverse eliminates the ordinary pair $p : X \times Y$ and forms $\mathsf{return}(\pi_1 p) \otimes \mathsf{return}(\pi_2 p)$. Their composites are identities by the Lin, tensor, and ordinary product $\beta\eta$ equations.

(7) **Monoidal comparison: completion.** The same computation gives $\mathsf{Lin}1 \cong \mathsf{I}$ and the associativity, unit, and symmetry coherence of this strong monoidal structure. All constructions are stable under ordinary substitution. The declared constants interpret themselves.

□

Proof of Theorem 14.32.

(1) **Existence and strict interpretation.** Interpret contexts by successive comprehension, types by the chosen constructors, terms by introduction and elimination and substitutions by tuples. In a strictly stable presentation these clauses determine the interpretation on raw syntax. Identity and composition of substitutions follow by substitution into the components of a tuple. Conversion follows from the computation and uniqueness laws of the chosen constructions, including the diagonal-pullback interpretation of extensional equality. Consequently the interpretation descends to derivable-equality classes.

Here is an explicit way to use the recursion when substitution for a constructor is supplied by coherent isomorphisms. In either indexed fibre over Γ, present a family by objects A_f over Δ for every $f : \Delta \to \Gamma$, with coherent isomorphisms $u^* A_f \cong A_{fu}$; arrows are compatible families of fibre arrows. Evaluation at 1_Γ is an equivalence. An inverse sends A to $(f^* A)_f$, and the structure isomorphism at $(1_\Gamma, f)$ supplies its comparison with any presented family. Reindexing this presentation amounts to precomposing the subscript and is strictly functorial. Use $\Gamma.A_{1_\Gamma}$ as comprehension. The map $\bar{f} : \Delta.A_f \to \Gamma.A_{1_\Gamma}$ pairs f after projection with the generic term transported through $A_f \cong f^* A_{1_\Gamma}$. For $u : \Theta \to \Delta$, both $\overline{fu}$ and the composite of the two extension maps have the same projection and transported generic term by the cocycle law; comprehension makes them

equal. Evaluate each nonbinding constructor at f on its f-components. For a binder evaluate the body at $\bar{f}$ and use the chosen dependent constructor along $\Delta.A_f \to \Delta$. The substitution and Beck–Chevalley isomorphisms give the family comparisons; their composition law is precisely the pasting law for those comparisons. The identity for the extension maps just proved makes reindexing of the resulting expressions strict. Fibre arrows, units, counits and their equations are interpreted componentwise. This gives the recursive interpretation in the family presentation; evaluation at identities gives its weak interpretation in the original model. As evaluation is faithful on each fibre, the interpretations give the same judgments of arrow equality after the displayed type identifications.

(2) **Reverse implication.** For the converse, use the syntactic model of Lemma 14.31. Interpretation there returns precisely the term's own derivable-equality class. Thus, if two interpretations coincide in every model, they coincide in this model and are related by the derivable-equality judgment.

(3) **Monoidal comparison.** This applies to open terms because the hom-set of the syntactic fibre is *defined* by their equality classes, not by evaluation at global points. Open linear contexts are represented by their tensor and unpacked by tensor elimination; its $\beta\eta$ equations identify this encoding with the original judgment.

(4) **Conservativity of displayed agent types.** The displayed agent judgment is conservative by Definition 2.14: erasure recovers the underlying term and the tag is recovered unchanged. Agent operations are constructed terms with specified displayed maps, so the same syntactic-model argument applies to their typed equations. In split strict presentations the interpretation is unique on the nose.

(5) **The comparison between weak interpretations.** Let F, G be interpretations in the fixed target. We construct $\theta : F \Rightarrow G$ simultaneously on contexts and types and verify naturality on substitutions and terms. At the empty context take the unique isomorphism of the two terminal objects. At a primitive take the composite of its two prescribed identifications, transporting its arity using the components already constructed. At $\Gamma.A$ use the two comprehension comparisons to identify the source and target as context extensions. Pair the map on Γ after projection with the generic term transported by $\theta_{\Gamma,A}$. Its inverse uses the inverse components; projection and the generic term determine both composite identities.

For a type constructor c write $\phi^F_c : F(c(\vec{A})) \cong c(F\vec{A})$ for its structure comparison, with reindexing into the common context understood. The component at a composite is forced to be

$$\theta_{c(\vec{A})} = (\phi^G_c)^{-1}\, c_{\#}(\theta_{\vec{A}})\, \phi^F_c .$$

Here $c_{\#}$ transports isomorphisms through the displayed constructor. For tensor it tensors the two components. For internal hom it precomposes with the inverse of the input component and postcomposes with the output component. For a dependent sum or product, first transport its index by the extension isomorphism above, use the body component over that isomorphism, and apply the dependent functor. The change of index is the Beck–Chevalley isomorphism for the resulting square of projections. Ordinary binders use the same square. Products and coproducts use their projection and injection characterizations, equality uses the diagonal pullback, and $\mathsf{Lin}, \mathsf{Val}$ apply the indicated functors to the component. All these maps are invertible by the same construction on the inverse components.

(6) **Substitution, terms and conversion.** For $A[\sigma]$ use the reindexing comparisons of F, G and the pullback of θ_A along $F\sigma$, using the base naturality equation $\theta_\Gamma F\sigma = G\sigma\,\theta_\Delta$ for $\sigma : \Delta \to \Gamma$. For a tuple (σ, t) this equation follows by projecting to the base and to the generic term, which gives the equations for σ and t. Identity substitutions give identity comparisons. For composable substitutions their comparison is the composite one by the reindexing cocycle law. Substituting into a constructor gives the same component by naturality of its structure comparison; for a dependent binder the square for two substitutions is the pasting of the two extension squares. The two Beck–Chevalley maps agree by pasting, and Frobenius commutes with the same base change by Lemma 14.30 in the syntax and by its interpreting comparison in the target.

For terms, context projection gives the variable case and the identifications of the signature give the generator case. Pairing commutes with θ because its two projections do; copairing commutes because its restrictions to the injections do. For a transposed term, undo the transposition on both sides of the naturality square. Compatibility of evaluation (or of the adjunction counit) identifies the resulting square with the square for the body. Bijectivity of transposition gives the required equality. This verifies ordinary and linear abstraction, the indexed binders, and the mixed adjunction. Tensor and unit introduction use the monoidal comparison; elimination follows by precomposing with their context-unpacking isomorphism. These verifications apply also in a context with further linear inputs, using the same tensor rearrangement on both sides. Equality reflection equates the two base substitutions because a section of the diagonal pullback equates their interpretations. Proof uniqueness there is monicity. The computation, uniqueness and commuting conversions are respected by the preceding projection, injection and transposition calculations. Congruence, symmetry and transitivity preserve the commuting squares. This simultaneous induction therefore descends to the equality classes used in the syntactic model.

(7) **Uniqueness.** Any structural 2-cell has the stated components on the terminal context and on each primitive. Its comprehension square forces the component on each extended context, and its square for c forces the displayed formula on each constructed type. Its reindexing square forces the remaining substitution instances. Induction gives equality with θ on every component. In particular the unique self-comparison is the identity and comparison composites are the unique comparisons with their endpoints. The category of interpretations over the fixed target and fixed signature interpretation is inhabited and has exactly one arrow between every pair of objects. It is therefore equivalent to the terminal category, which proves bi-initiality for the specified weak interpretations.

□

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